THE SEMESTER BOOKS

Book 1 · Company, Brand & Operating

Company · Brand · Operating

One of three books that together cover everything about Semester: Book 1 Company, Brand & Operating · Book 2 Product · Book 3 Design System & Building. Compiled from *The Main Semester design system*.

Edition of 21 October 2026 · Pre-seed, founder-led · Large figures are labelled sample data

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BOOK 1

Company, Brand & Operating

What Semester is and how the company is built, positioned, presented and run.

Executive summary

Semester describes itself as the student action platform: one daily workspace that turns a student's semester into the next clear step, with the source of every fact shown beside it. The README also calls it the native Student Operating System for the whole educational journey, with workspaces for faculty, advisors, registrars, finance and IT or security staff. "Student OS" is internal only, because it implies replacement. The product works alongside a school's official systems (SIS, LMS, identity provider). It reads from them, labels each fact as official, connected, personal or AI-assisted, and shows when it last synced.

The company is Harrison Rubin's: a solo-founder LLC at pre-seed, bootstrapped, with no revenue. Contractors work under signed IP assignments. As of October 2026 a first paid pilot is signed with Vanderbilt University, but pilot start and renewal-decision dates are not set. The Operating Pack lists six launch blockers that must close before real student records arrive: cyber insurance, E&O insurance, DPA/FERPA obligation mapping, HECVAT Full, SAML SSO and a VPAT/ACR. It counts 23 open P0 items. Of its 56 checklist items, only LLC formation, IP assignments and the signed pilot agreement are marked done.

The target customer is a four-year university of 5,000 to 30,000 students. The champion is a director of student success, advising or the registrar; the economic buyer is a VP of Student Success, the provost's office or the CIO. The wedge offer is the Registration Readiness Pilot: one term, one cohort, named success measures, SSO and a read-only SIS sync. It targets students surprised by holds and missed registration steps, and overloaded advisors. The GTM plan's strategy in one line: universities first, through one paid one-term pilot per institution, with a renewal decision date. Vanderbilt is pilot #1 and its results are meant to become the case study that sells pilots #2 to #5. Free pilots are not allowed.

The business model has several planned streams, all priced as planning assumptions, not published prices. The student workspace is free at participating schools; Student Premium is planned at $8.99 a month or $69 a year. The institution platform is planned at $18 per enrolled student per year with a $30,000 minimum. Other lines are implementation ($35,000 to $150,000, waived or credited for early pilots), premium support, AI overage and a 12% marketplace commission. The pilot fee is quoted per pilot and credited against year one if the institution converts within 60 days of results. No source states the Vanderbilt fee; the Finance Model leaves it as "[signed fee]".

Go-to-market is founder-led. The 12-month targets are a 40-account target list, 15 discovery conversations, 10 demos, 6 pilot designs, 5 security and legal reviews, 3 signed pilots (including Vanderbilt) and 2 annual conversions. The sources say plainly that these are founder planning numbers, sized to one person selling alongside delivery.

The company is meant to run on the discipline it sells. The Company OS defines 15 business functions, each with an owner, system of record, priority and next action, plus a cadence and a KPI tree whose north star is students who complete their next action each week in the pilot cohort. The founder owns all 15 today. Hiring is revenue-triggered: no role opens until its trigger is true and signed revenue covers its cost. The setup budget is $5,000 to $20,000; the Finance Model's three scenarios total $4,873, $12,430 and $19,910, with a run-rate of about $565 a month and a $0 founder salary.

The brand stance is calm, precise and source-aware: "a good registrar's assistant crossed with a precision instrument." The company states status, not certifications it does not hold (no "SOC 2 compliant", no "FERPA certified"). The visual system uses near-black Ink chrome, warm Parchment content and one restrained Semester blue for action; every status carries a glyph and a word. A standing product rule is that student records never reach an AI provider.

The strategy documents are labelled "design-stage evidence only" and score platform maturity at an average of 1.16 out of 5. Several handoff artefacts are described as not yet run or tested. This overview reports what the founder's documents plan and claim; it does not verify that any of it exists in running code.

Semester in numbers

Planning rows are assumptions the sources say are not published or quoted prices. Sample and illustrative rows are not real company data.

Fact	Value	Source file
Company stage	Pre-seed, no revenue, bootstrapping, solo founder, LLC	ui_kits/business/Operating Pack.html
Customer status	First paid pilot signed with Vanderbilt; dates not set	README.md; docs/brief/One-pager.html
Pilot fee (Vanderbilt)	Not stated ("[signed fee]")	docs/run/Finance Model.html
Launch blockers / open P0 items	6 / 23	ui_kits/business/Operating Pack.html
Master checklist size	56 items	ui_kits/business/Operating Pack.html
Setup total, lean / base / full	$4,873 / $12,430 / $19,910 (budget range $5,000 to $20,000)	docs/run/Finance Model.html
Monthly run-rate after launch	$565 (about $6,780 a year)	docs/run/Finance Model.html
Cash needed before pilot fee, lean / base / full	$6,568 / $14,125 / $21,605	docs/run/Finance Model.html
Hosting plus AI per institution; gross margin (estimates)	About $1,500 a year; about 95% before people	docs/run/Finance Model.html
Institution platform (planning)	$18 per enrolled student per year, $30,000 floor	docs/grow/GTM Plan.html
Student Premium (planning)	$8.99 a month or $69 a year	docs/grow/GTM Plan.html
Implementation (planning)	$35,000 to $150,000 one-time; waived or credited for early pilots	docs/grow/GTM Plan.html
Premium support (planning)	15% of platform fee, $15,000 minimum	docs/grow/GTM Plan.html
AI overage / marketplace commission (planning)	$30 per 1,000 governed requests / 12%	docs/grow/GTM Plan.html
Pilot credit rule	Credited against year 1 if annual order signed within 60 days of results	docs/grow/GTM Plan.html; docs/legal/Order Form.html
Revenue scenarios, base / high (planning)	Signed fee + $45,000 / + $90,000	docs/run/Finance Model.html
Discount limits	Multi-year up to 10% per year; reference up to 5%; nothing below floor	docs/grow/GTM Plan.html
Spend approval threshold	Founder approves spend above $500	docs/business/FINANCE_AND_CAPITAL_SYSTEM.md
12-month pipeline targets	40 accounts, 15 discovery, 10 demo, 6 design, 5 security/legal, 3 pilots, 2 annual	docs/grow/GTM Plan.html
US postsecondary enrollment, fall 2025	19.4 million; public four-year about 7.9 million	ui_kits/business/Market Research.html
Theoretical ceiling at $18 (arithmetic, not forecast)	About $349 M a year (all); about $142 M (public four-year)	ui_kits/business/Market Research.html
Incumbent pricing signal (indicative, competitor-sourced)	$50,000 to $300,000 a year	ui_kits/business/Market Research.html
Illustrative 13,000-student university	About $234 k a year at $18 (enrollment illustrative)	ui_kits/business/Market Research.html
Pilot SLOs (not contractual)	SSO and availability 99.5%; freshness 99% within 15 min; p95 reads under 800 ms; AI student-record leaks: 0	docs/operate/Operations Handbook.html

Fact	Value	Source file
Support response targets	S1 15 min; S2 30 min; S3 1 h; S4 same business day	docs/launch/Support Plan.html
Disaster recovery; patching	RPO 24 h, RTO 8 h; critical 7 days, high 30	docs/secure/Security Policies.html
Platform security review	11 findings (1 critical, 3 high); fixes in migration 050, not yet run	docs/secure/Platform Security Review.html
Platform maturity average	1.16 / 5 (design-stage)	docs/strategy/SEMESTER_PLATFORM_MATURITY_SCORECARD.md
Company OS functions; launch gates; cutover steps	15; 11; 11 (C1 to C11)	docs/business/COMPANY_OPERATING_SYSTEM.md; docs/launch/
Design catalogue breadth	64 student destinations; 673 screens; 51 roles	README.md; NEXT-SESSION.md
Design system components	49 (Operating Manual) vs 57 (NEXT-SESSION.md): sources differ	ui_kits/business/Operating Manual.html; NEXT-SESSION.md

How the company works

Operating system and cadence

The Company OS (dated 2026-10-05) covers 15 functions: governance and legal; finance and capital; product and engineering; trust (security, privacy, accessibility, compliance); revenue; marketing; customer success; support; partnerships; people; data and outcomes; vendors; risk and continuity; board and investors; and the operations command center. Every owner is the founder, sometimes paired with counsel, a bookkeeper or a fractional security lead. The principle: Semester must operate with the same coherence, evidence, reliability and trust it promises institutions.

Everything is meant to run in Semester's own `/ops` console. Regulated systems stay external and embedded: bank, payment processor, payroll, the bookkeeper's ledger, e-signature, GitHub, Vercel and Supabase. The product database tracks quotes, orders, invoices and entitlements but is not the statutory ledger.

The cadence runs from daily operations triage to weekly reviews (revenue, product, customer success, security and reliability, marketing), monthly finance and trust reviews, and a quarterly OKR and board review. While solo, the weekly reviews collapse into one 60-minute operating review. The Operating Manual's week: Monday planning and pipeline review, Wednesday engineering review, Thursday pilot check-in with the champion, Friday metrics, cash and risks. Monthly there is a two-hour close with access and claims reviews; quarterly, a half-day reset and a tabletop exercise. Decisions are logged one per pull request in DECISIONS.md, yet the backlog still lists a company decisions log as a gap. The Master Backlog sorts functions P0 to P3 and adds a 90-day plan, a 12-month plan, a 36-month plan and a top-50 action list.

KPIs

The north star is students who complete their next action each week (pilot cohort). Seven branches sit beneath it: product (weekly actives, first meaningful action, readiness completion), revenue (pipeline, pilots, conversion, ARR, NRR), customer (activation, health, measures met), trust (controls with evidence, incidents), finance (cash, runway, margin, AI cost per workflow), reliability (SLO attainment, restore time) and people (capacity versus demand). The pilot one-pager names three example measures: students with no unresolved hold at registration time, advising appointments arriving with an agenda, and weekly active students completing a next action. Baselines and targets are "agreed at kickoff"; no source states them.

Finance and capital

Finance must answer cash and runway, committed versus collected revenue, per-customer profitability, the margin effect of AI and infrastructure, and what the company can afford next. The quote-to-cash flow runs quote, pricing-exception check, order form, invoice, reconciliation, entitlement, revenue-recognition review and renewal. Discounts need founder approval until a deal desk exists; credits and refunds need finance approval.

The Finance Model gives three setup scenarios, each with a 10% contingency; base is recommended. Line items are counsel review, cyber plus E&O premiums, accessibility testing, accounting setup, tools, hosting, AI usage and campus travel; a pen test appears only in the full scenario. The monthly run-rate is mostly insurance if paid monthly ($250), bookkeeping ($150) and AI usage ($50). The model assumes the pilot invoice is paid about three months after setup starts

and recommends asking for 50% at signature. Moving to Supabase Team for a vendor SOC 2 report would add about $574 a month. Fundraising is deferred until pilot results; an LLC-to-Delaware C-corp conversion is planned before any priced round. The documents flag that accounting, tax, legal and insurance content needs qualified professional review.

People and hiring

Only the founder exists today. Fractional counsel, an insurance broker and a bookkeeper (about two hours a month) are needed now, and an accessibility tester before launch. A founding full-stack engineer comes after the pilot fee arrives; an implementation and customer success lead after the second pilot; a fractional security lead after the first annual contract; an account executive and product designer after three annual contracts; a support specialist last. Six job descriptions and four contractor briefs are written. Every hire gets confidentiality and IP assignment before access, FERPA and security training, and least-privilege access reviewed quarterly. Twelve cultural standards include student agency over surveillance, evidence over hype, and every public claim has evidence. Gaps: handbook, equity plan, compensation bands.

Governance, legal and risk

No contract is signed without a template or counsel redline. Counsel is required for any contract with student data, liability above fees or non-standard indemnity. Draft MSA, Order Form, DPA, Terms, Privacy Policy, Cookie Notice, Accessibility Statement, Community Guidelines and Subprocessors exist, all awaiting attorney review. Gaps: SLA, SOW, security addendum, contractor templates, trademark filing and a policy register.

The Business Risk Register lists ten risks. Customer concentration (one pilot) and founder capacity are rated high on both likelihood and impact. The rest include pilot without insurance, runway shortfall, vendor breach, unsupported promises, accessibility complaints, prices too low to fund support and over-claiming. The key-person continuity plan is not yet written; the Security Policies describe a sealed emergency kit with a named backup contact. Every vendor needs a purpose, a review and an exit; reviews for Supabase, Vercel, the AI provider and the email provider are not yet recorded.

Go-to-market and revenue

Two engines: institutional (paid pilots, annual contracts, expansion, references) and student adoption (activation, retained use, institutional proof). The funnel has 15 stages with exit criteria, from Target to Closed lost. The GTM plan holds the ICP, six personas with promises and objections, a ten-line offer ladder, pipeline targets and a case-study plan: sign measures before launch, ask permission at the midpoint review, publish a two-page study within 30 days of results. Disqualifiers: no named champion, a need for SIS write-back during the pilot, or procurement over six months. Claim rule: say "in a paid pilot with one university" until there are more.

Market Research supports positioning, not forecasting. It names EAB Navigate360, Starfish, Civitas Learning and AI-native entrants, all with vendor-claimed scale, and positions Semester as complementing Navigate and Starfish on the staff side in year one rather than replacing them. Gaps: content calendar, SEO plan, account scoring, ROI calculator, battlecards, procurement FAQ, demo environment, win/loss log.

Customer success

Sales must hand off the signed scope, timeline, conversion date, sponsor, IT, security and procurement contacts, cohort, baseline and success criteria. A health score is proposed with example weights (student activation 20%, core workflow completion 20%, admin engagement 15%, first meaningful action 15%, and others), but its definition is a listed gap. The

strategy adds an implementation factory (tenant templates, LTI and OneRoster wizards, SSO/SCIM guide, reconciliation dashboard) promising launch in weeks, not years.

Partnerships

Partnerships are P3 and post-pilot. First partners are the pilot's own dependencies: SIS, LMS, identity provider and AI provider. Any data-sharing partner needs a DPA and review. The strategy sketches a developer platform, partner certification and a marketplace with governed installs.

Trust program

Trust is meant to be evidence-based: each control has an owner, policy, implementation, evidence, test and review date. A new subprocessor needs privacy review and 30 days' notice. The P0 next action is to bind insurance, submit HECVAT Full and complete vendor reviews. Security detail is in the operations section below.

Brand in brief

Positioning. The brand identity document says "Semester is the education operating system". The README and Operating Manual use "the student action platform" publicly. The sources do not reconcile this; the design system states it wins on conflicts. The intended student feeling is "I know what to do next."

Personality. Calm, not sterile; intelligent, not patronizing; ambitious, not inflated; academic, not bureaucratic; warm, not childish; human-centred, not surveillance-centred.

Voice rules, with the sources' examples.

- Use the status sentence: what is true, what it means for you, what you can do. "Your Canvas calendar hasn't updated since Tuesday. Deadlines below may have moved. Reconnect it, or check the course page."
- Prefer "helps you organise" to "revolutionises"; "alongside your school's systems" to "replaces" or "all-in-one"; "AI-assisted, source-linked" to "AI-powered" or "magic". Never claim "secure", "compliant" or "certified" without evidence.
- Say "student", not "user". Sentence case. No emoji, streaks, ranks, exclamation marks or confetti.
- State consequences before confirm: "You leave CHEM 101 and a W is recorded on your transcript. It cannot be undone here."
- Say what is safe in errors: "Your draft is safe on this device."
- Never call Semester the official gradebook, registrar or payment system. Label demo data "Sample".

Visual identity.

- *Colour.* Ink (#090a0e) for all chrome; Parchment (#f4f1ea) for content; Semester blue 700 (#416180) on light and 400 (#94bce3) on dark as the one action colour. Brass (#d8c79a) is editorial only; sterling (#d4d9e2) is the metal of the mark. Source hues are desaturated stones used as ink, hairline and 8% wash, never large fills.
- *Status glyphs.* ◆ official, ○ yours, ✦ AI, ⇄ connected or conflict, ? review, ! attention, ✓ done, ⊘ offline, … working, ◌ sample. Colour is never the only carrier.
- *Type.* Barlow body (16/1.55), Barlow Condensed 600 for headings and controls, Cinzel for rare editorial display and the wordmark, system mono for IDs. Tabular figures.
- *Shape and motion.* Corners 3/6/10 px; hairline first, shadow last. Motion 130 to 280 ms, zeroed by reduced-motion. No bounce, parallax or spinners.
- *Mark.* Three slabs on a 512 grid, shown as a lit silver mark on Ink. Never recolour it; in co-brand lockups Semester leads. No photography or AI imagery in-product. Icons: 108 glyphs, 1.5 px stroke.
- *Open decision.* The source PDF proposed indigo with emerald, amber and rose status hues; the design system kept blue and stone hues and flags this for the founder.

How Semester is operated

Support. Four tiers: self-help, the customer's own help channel (Vanderbilt's, named by its IT), Semester's support desk run by the founder, and vendors. Severities S1 to S4: S1 is possible student-data exposure; S2 is blocked (SSO down, SIS data wrong); S3 is degraded; S4 is a question. Targets are in the numbers table. Tickets never contain student record content; they use internal IDs. Reply macros cover sign-in, wrong-looking data, "Is AI reading my records?", not-in-pilot, known issues and accessibility barriers. Week-1 cover ends after no open S1 or S2, two days without a new S2, clean reconciliation and sponsor agreement.

On-call and SLOs. The founder is on-call lead until a first engineer joins. Escalation runs on-call, founder, vendor support, institution IT. More than two night pages in a week makes the next week reliability work. Error budget policy: above 50% remaining, normal releases; 0 to 50%, fixes only; exhausted, freeze and write a reliability plan. Ten alerts map to runbooks; for example, 5xx above 2% for 15 minutes is an S2 and rollback trigger, and an RLS-denial spike from one session is an S1.

Runbooks. Eight follow detect, stabilise, fix, verify, tell people, write it down: R1 bad release, R2 SSO outage, R3 SIS sync (mismatches are never auto-corrected; the registrar decides the right source), R4 backup and restore (to a scratch project first), R5 suspected exposure (cohort flag off first, preserve evidence, postmortem in 5 business days), R6 AI gateway, R7 capacity, R8 a student who cannot see data. Maintenance is weekly patching, a monthly restore drill, quarterly access review and tabletop, and yearly pen test, ACR re-test and HECVAT refresh.

Launch and cutover for the Vanderbilt pilot. All dates are relative to launch day (L). Eleven go/no-go gates must be green with evidence: DPA signed (L-45), HECVAT accepted, insurance bound and ACR delivered (L-30), SSO in staging (L-21), SIS reconciliation at zero unexplained mismatches, RLS tests and AI-gateway red-team (L-14), restore drill (L-10), incident contacts and signed success measures (L-7). Final go/no-go and code freeze at L-3. The cutover plan has eleven steps: production migrations and RLS tests, secrets, Vanderbilt's SAML service provider, institution configuration, first SIS sync, a registrar spot-check of 25 students, DNS and TLS, baseline backup, staff accounts, fresh sync, and finally the student cohort flag. Each step has a check and an undo. There is no point of no return: until the cohort flag is on students see nothing, and afterwards it turns everything off in under a minute without deleting data. Rollback triggers: suspected exposure, SSO down over 30 minutes, SIS data shown wrongly, error rate above 2% for 15 minutes. Welcome messages come from Vanderbilt; nothing is public until both sides approve.

Security readiness. The policy set (v0.1 draft) has ten policies: access, encryption, AI and student data, vendors, incident response, BCP/DR, retention, secure development, devices and logging. Key commitments: MFA on every company account, RLS on every student-data table tested in CI, an AI gateway that blocks student-record fields before any model call, and deletion within 30 days of contract end. The readiness tracker holds draft HECVAT Full answers across 14 sections (mostly in progress), a SOC 2 table (Type I planned after the pilot), a staging-only pen-test scope and an insurance checklist (cyber, E&O, general liability, certificate; all not started). The platform security review found 11 issues, including a critical one letting a tenant user insert themselves as an ops role. Fixes are written but unrun and need a qualified security engineer.

Compliance. Stated status: HECVAT Full in progress, SOC 2 not started, no pen test, insurance not bound, VPAT/ACR in preparation. The DPA draft makes Semester a FERPA "school official" with no sale, advertising, profiling or AI training on institution data.

Open decisions and risks

Gating items before real student records. Insurance is "not started" in the Operating Pack, readiness tracker and MSA draft, yet the pilot requires it. The DPA is "in review". HECVAT Full, SAML SSO and the VPAT/ACR are open. Also open: EIN and tax registrations, business bank account, accounting setup, subprocessor list, retention schedule, a tested AI boundary, data inventory and a tested restore.

Decisions not yet made.

- Pilot start and renewal dates, to be fixed in a mutual action plan.
- Pilot measures, baselines and targets, signed before launch.
- The Vanderbilt fee and invoice schedule (the Order Form offers 100% at signature, or 50% and 50%).
- Raise versus bootstrap, and C-corp conversion.
- Brand hues (blue and stone versus the PDF's indigo set).
- Whether to fund the pen test.
- When to publish prices, which wait for pilot results and counsel review.

Top risks. Customer concentration, founder capacity, runway before the pilot invoice, pilot without insurance, HECVAT delay, SSO readiness, student-record exposure (low likelihood, critical impact), VPAT gaps, a pilot drifting without a decision date, claims outrunning evidence, and prices too low to fund support. The Platform Risk Register adds cross-tenant exposure, AI receiving records and SIS data shown wrongly.

Gaps from audits and backlogs. The completion audit's top 25 include no production code for pilot paths, RLS untested, no monitoring, SIS connector unbuilt, AI red-team not run, no status page, no policy engine, no usability test, no 36-month model, no help centre, no event taxonomy and no decision log. The gap register lists 84 workflow steps without a screen. No maturity dimension scores above 2 of 5; developer ecosystem and global readiness score 0.

Where the sources disagree.

- *Accessibility standard.* The Operating Pack targets WCAG 2.1 AA for the ACR; the README, Accessibility Statement, MSA and GTM plan say 2.2 AA.
- *Launch blockers.* The Operating Pack's six differ from the launch kit's Command Center six (HECVAT, data agreement, SSO, accessibility, insurance as one item, and an incident plan).
- *Severity targets.* The Operating Manual uses P0 to P3 with 1 h, 4 h, 1 day and 2 day targets; the Support Plan uses S1 to S4 with 15 min, 30 min, 1 h and same day.
- *Restore drills.* Monthly in the Operations Handbook; quarterly in the Security Policies.
- *Breach notice.* 24 hours in Security Policies; a bracketed 72 hours in the DPA template.
- *Drafts versus "not started".* The Operating Pack lists the subprocessor list and a 12-month model as not started, though drafts exist in docs/legal and docs/run.
- *Pen-test timing.* After first renewal (Operating Pack) versus before the pilot goes broad (Security Policies).
- *First engineer.* After the pilot fee (Hiring Plan) versus after the second paid customer (Operating Manual).
- *Insurance risk.* Medium likelihood (Business Risk Register) versus High (Operating Pack).
- *Pilot term.* The Vanderbilt one-pager says "Fall 2026"; other documents say dates are not set.

- *Counts.* 49 versus 57 components.

Reader's guide

- **The company operating system.** The 15-function Company OS, systems of record, KPI tree, cadence, master backlog and top-50 actions.
- **Go-to-market, revenue and marketing.** Revenue operations, funnel stages, CRM fields, sales assets and the marketing and brand system.
- **GTM plan and price book.** ICP, personas, offer ladder, discount rules, pipeline targets, channels, case-study plan and claim rules.
- **Market and competitor research.** Enrollment base, sizing arithmetic, competitor landscape and positioning, with sources.
- **Finance and capital.** Finance questions, console, revenue streams, quote-to-cash, controls, KPIs and monthly close.
- **Finance model.** Setup scenarios, run-rate, revenue scenarios, runway, sourced vendor prices and unit economics.
- **People and hiring.** Org design, hiring sequence, cultural standards and the people system card.
- **Hiring plan.** Trigger-based plan, hiring process, six job descriptions and contractor briefs.
- **Governance, legal, risk and vendors.** Governance and legal operations, the business risk register, continuity, vendors and the trust program card.
- **Strategy.** Completion audit, maturity scorecard, moats, 36-month plan, AI and trust plans, implementation and migration factories, outcome proof.
- **Operating manual.** "How to run Semester": the company function by function, with cadence and scorecard.
- **Company operating pack.** The pre-records checklist: open P0 gaps, 56-item checklist, 90-day roadmap, pilot checklist, risks.
- **The decks.** Deck templates named in the README. Their slide text was not reviewed for this overview.
- **Company workspaces.** The business workspace, twelve role-gated `/ops` consoles and staff workspaces, all labelled sample data. The staff workspaces page is script-rendered and was not read as text.
- **Legal documents.** Draft MSA, Order Form, DPA, Terms, Privacy Policy, Cookie Notice, Accessibility Statement, Community Guidelines, Subprocessors.
- **Brand chapters.** Content fundamentals, visual foundations, iconography, brand identity, visual language and the launch kit.
- **Operating chapters.** Operations Handbook, Runbooks, launch runbook, cutover plan, support plan, security policies, readiness tracker and security review.

Glossary

Term	Meaning
Semester	The student action platform; company and product.
Student OS	Internal name; avoided publicly because it implies replacing school systems.
Ask Semester	The AI assistant; no human persona, always labelled AI-assisted, never receives student records.
Today	The student home destination; the spine is Today, My Path, Search, Plan, Me.
Status sentence	Voice unit: what is true, what it means, what you can do.
Provenance labels	Source vocabulary: official, connected, yours, AI-assisted, estimated.
Registration Readiness Pilot	Wedge offer: one term, one cohort, named measures, SSO, read-only SIS sync.
Success measures sheet	One-page signed baseline and target for each pilot measure.
Mutual action plan	Shared plan with a named economic buyer and decision date.
Champion	Institution person who owns the outcome and runs the pilot.
Economic buyer	Person who can fund the pilot (VP Student Success, provost office, CIO).
ICP	Ideal customer profile: four-year university, 5,000 to 30,000 students.
Price book	The GTM plan's offer ladder and discount rules; planning prices only.
Floor	Minimum price ($30,000 platform; $15,000 premium support).
ACV / NRR	Annual contract value; net revenue retention.
Claims register	Register where every public claim or number needs a source.
Status, not certifications	Rule to state control status, never a certification not held.
Company OS	The 15-function operating system for the company.
/ops	Semester's operations console, intended to run the company.
System of record	The authoritative system for a domain.
SIS / LMS	Student information system / learning management system.
LTI 1.3 / OneRoster	Interoperability standards for LMS connection and roster import.
IdP / SAML SSO	Identity provider / single sign-on required by the pilot.
RLS	Postgres row-level security, used for tenant isolation.
Tenant	One institution's isolated slice of the platform.
AI gateway	Server component that scopes, scans, routes, logs and blocks student-record fields.
Policy engine	Deterministic rules component: the AI explains a rule, the engine decides it.
HECVAT	Higher-education vendor security questionnaire; Full required by the pilot.
VPAT / ACR	Accessibility conformance template / completed report.
DPA / FERPA addendum	Data protection terms making Semester a "school official".
E&O	Errors and omissions (technology professional liability) insurance.
Go/no-go gate	Evidence-backed readiness check required before launch.
Launch day (L)	Reference for relative dates, as actual pilot dates are unset.

Term	Meaning
Cohort flag	Feature switch turning the pilot cohort on or off in under a minute.
Cutover (C1 to C11)	Eleven-step production move, each with a check and undo.
Reconciliation	Comparing synced data with the registrar extract; goal zero unexplained mismatches.
SLO / error budget	Service target and allowed failure that drives release policy.
S1 to S4 / P0 to P3	Incident severities / backlog priorities.
Implementation factory	Planned repeatable path from sales hand-off to launch.
Migration factory	Planned reusable migration product; replacement only with reconciliation evidence.
Health score	Proposed customer health metric; definition still open.
Ink / Parchment	Near-black chrome ground / warm off-white content ground.
Semester blue	The single action colour (#416180 light, #94bce3 dark).
Sample data	Figures labelled illustrative, not real company or student data.

PART 1

Company

What Semester is, who it serves, how the company is run, financed, staffed and governed — and the strategy for winning.

Semester at a glance

Semester is the native Student Operating System for the complete educational journey — one governed, accessible platform for a student's academic, personal, campus, financial, career and lifelong life, plus the institutional workspaces (faculty, advisor, registrar, finance, IT/security) that serve them. Surfaces include Student Today, Calendar, Tasks, Courses, Study, Write, Degree, Registration, Grades, Campus, Dining, Housing, Family, Career, Billing, Support, the AI Assistant, and the Institution Console.

The system is calm, scholarly and source-aware: near-black chrome, warm off-white content, restrained Semester blue for action and focus, and a controlled vocabulary that keeps **official, connected, personal and AI-generated** information visibly distinct.

Status (Oct 2026): pre-seed, founder-led, bootstrapped; first paid pilot signed with Vanderbilt University (dates not set). HECVAT Full, VPAT/ACR, SAML SSO and insurance are in progress. Large figures anywhere in this system are labelled sample data.

Sources

- **Codebase (ground truth):** https://github.com/harrisonjrubin7-cmyk/semester (branch `main`). Key files read: `DESIGN-SYSTEM-GUIDE.md`, `docs/COLOR-AND-DARK-MODE-SPEC.md`, `app/src/styles/{tokens,typefaces,industry,unity}.css`, `app/src/lib/{look,status,source}.ts`, `app/src/components/{Brand,Icons,icons.data,mark.data,SourceBadge,StatusNotice,StartToday}.tsx`, `app/src/components/unity/*`, `app/src/components/console/*`. Also read: `docs/BRAND-PLATFORM.md` (voice, naming, Source Line), `enrollment/StudentRegistration.tsx`, `gradebook/StudentGrades.tsx`, `AdvisorMeeting.tsx`. Explore the repo further — especially `docs/design/`, `company-site/` and `app/src/components/` — to build closer to the real product.
- **Uploads:** `uploads/download-1.png` (lit silver logo mark on Ink), `uploads/Semester build Architecture.pdf`, `uploads/audit [...].pdf/.md` (repo audit).
- **Brief:** the user's written design direction (source-status hues, Semester blue, warm off-white content). Where it diverges from the code it is noted below.

Reconciling brief and code

The app's own rule is "one colour for attention, the rest in words and glyphs", with a sterling/brass metal accent. The brief asks for a Semester blue action colour and distinct source hues. This system **keeps the code's grounds, type, radii, motion, glyph+word status vocabulary and contrast floors**, and **adopts the brief's palette** using hues pulled from the code's own measured ramps (Industry blue → Semester blue; Jade/Moss/Indigo/Old gold → teal/green/violet/amber). Every chip still carries a glyph and a word; colour is never the only carrier.



The system cover

The company operating system

docs/business/README.md

docs/business

Semester must operate with the same coherence, evidence, reliability and trust it promises to institutions.

- CORPORATE_GOVERNANCE_AND_LEGAL_OPS.md
- FINANCE_AND_CAPITAL_SYSTEM.md
- PRODUCT_AND_ENGINEERING_OPERATIONS.md
- TRUST_PROGRAM.md
- REVENUE_OPERATIONS.md
- MARKETING_AND_BRAND_SYSTEM.md
- CUSTOMER_SUCCESS_AND_IMPLEMENTATION.md
- SUPPORT_AND_SERVICE_OPERATIONS.md
- PARTNERSHIPS_AND_MARKETPLACE.md
- PEOPLE_AND_HIRING_SYSTEM.md
- DATA_RESEARCH_AND_OUTCOMES.md
- VENDOR_AND_PROCUREMENT_SYSTEM.md
- RISK_RESILIENCE_AND_CONTINUITY.md
- BOARD_AND_INVESTOR_OPERATIONS.md
- OPERATIONS_COMMAND_CENTER.md
- COMPANY_OPERATING_SYSTEM.md
- GTM_AND_SALES_SYSTEM.md
- COMPANY_KPI_TREE.md
- COMPANY_OPERATING_CADENCE.md
- BUSINESS_MASTER_BACKLOG.md

Five connected systems

- finance/FINANCE_AND_ACCOUNTING_OPERATIONS.md
- revenue/GTM_AND_REVENUE_OPERATIONS.md
- trust/SECURITY_PRIVACY_ACCESSIBILITY_COMPLIANCE.md
- customer/CUSTOMER_SUCCESS_AND_IMPLEMENTATION.md
- people/PEOPLE_HIRING_AND_CULTURE.md
- BUSINESS_SYSTEMS_OF_RECORD.md
- BUSINESS_RISK_REGISTER.md

Interactive: ui_kits/company-os/index.html

Company operating system

Semester Company OS · 2026-10-05 · Source: uploads/what else on the bussnius and opprations site also.pdf.

Semester must operate with the same coherence, evidence, reliability and trust it promises to institutions.

Function	Owner	System of record	Priority	Next action	Doc
Corporate governance and legal	Founder + fractional counsel	Contracts register in /ops legal; corporate records folder	P0	Counsel review of MSA, DPA and order form before pilot launch	CORPORATE_GOVERNANCE_AND_LEGAL_OPS.md
Finance, accounting and capital	Founder + bookkeeper	/ops finance (invoices, AR, dunning); accounting ledger (bookkeeper); bank	P0	Open business bank account and accounting ledger; set the monthly close date	FINANCE_AND_CAPITAL_SYSTEM.md
Product and engineering operations	Founder → founding engineer	GitHub (code, PRs), /ops product operations (backlog, flags, releases)	P1	Run execute stream 00 and approve the design-system baseline	PRODUCT_AND_ENGINEERING_OPERATIONS.md
Security, privacy, accessibility and compliance	Founder + fractional security lead	/ops trust & compliance (controls, evidence, HECVAT, data requests)	P0	Bind insurance; submit HECVAT Full; complete vendor reviews for Supabase, Vercel, AI provider	TRUST_PROGRAM.md
Go-to-market and revenue operations	Founder	/ops GTM pipeline (CRM)	P1	Build the 40-account target list in /ops	REVENUE_OPERATIONS.md
Marketing, brand and communications	Founder	Company site + content register; /ops social	P2	Publish pilot, pricing and trust pages	MARKETING_AND_BRAND_SYSTEM.md
Customer success and implementation	Founder → implementation lead	/ops customer success (implementation, health, QBR)	P0	Kick off Vanderbilt implementation with the mutual action plan	CUSTOMER_SUCCESS_AND_IMPLEMENTATION.md
Support and service operations	Founder → support specialist	/ops support desk	P1	Write the first 10 KB articles from the pilot paths	SUPPORT_AND_SERVICE_OPERATIONS.md
Partnerships, marketplace and developer relations	Founder	/ops partnerships	P3	List the integration partners the pilot depends on (SIS, LMS, IdP, AI provider)	PARTNERSHIPS_AND_MARKETPLACE.md
People, hiring and culture	Founder	/ops people (hiring, onboarding); payroll provider (embedded)	P2	Engage counsel and bookkeeper as the first contractors	PEOPLE_AND_HIRING_SYSTEM.md
Data, research and outcomes	Founder	Analytics (aggregate), research repository	P1	Define the pilot event taxonomy (no PII)	DATA_RESEARCH_AND_OUTCOMES.md
Procurement, vendors and supply chain	Founder	/ops vendors	P1	Record reviews for Supabase, Vercel, AI provider, email provider	VENDOR_AND_PROCUREMENT_SYSTEM.md
Risk, resilience and continuity	Founder	/ops risk register, incidents, SLOs	P1	Write the key-person continuity plan (credentials escrow, runbooks, counsel contact)	RISK_RESILIENCE_AND_CONTINUITY.md
Board, investor and stakeholder operations	Founder	/ops board/investor reports; investor portal	P3	Draft the data room index (deferred)	BOARD_AND_INVESTOR_OPERATIONS.md
Operations command center	Founder	/ops	P1	Start the weekly operating review from the executive overview	OPERATIONS_COMMAND_CENTER.md

Systems-of-record map

Everything runs in Semester's /ops console (see ui_kits/one-place). Regulated systems stay external and embedded: bank, payment processor, payroll, accounting ledger (bookkeeper), e-sign provider, GitHub, Vercel, Supabase.

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docs/business/COMPANY_OPERATING_CADENCE.md

Company operating cadence

Semester business operations · 2026-10-05 · Source: uploads/Show the finance and accounting operations section.pdf. ***Accounting, tax, legal, insurance, privacy, security, accessibility and compliance content needs qualified professional review before use.***

> Every customer promise connects to a financial owner, delivery owner, support process, security/privacy control, product capability and evidence trail.

Cadence	Review	Required output
Daily	Operations triage	P0/P1 issues, customer blockers, incident decisions
Weekly	Revenue	Pipeline, deals, pilots, forecast, next steps
Weekly	Product/engineering	Releases, quality, tech debt, feedback
Weekly	Customer success	Adoption, support, health, renewal risk
Weekly	Security/reliability	Vulnerabilities, incidents, SLOs, access, changes
Weekly	Marketing/growth	Funnel, content, campaigns, activation
Monthly	Finance	P&L, cash, burn, runway, variance, collections
Monthly	Trust/compliance	Evidence, reviews, vendor risk, HECVAT, privacy
Monthly	Leadership	KPIs, decisions, hiring, risks
Quarterly	OKR/board	Strategy, roadmap, capital, performance, risk, priorities

While solo, the weekly reviews run as one 60-minute operating review with five sections.

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docs/business/COMPANY_KPI_TREE.md

Company KPI tree

Semester Company OS · 2026-10-05 · Source: uploads/what else on the bussnius and opprations site also.pdf.

> Semester must operate with the same coherence, evidence, reliability and trust it promises to institutions.

North star: students who complete their next action each week (pilot cohort)

- Product
- Weekly actives
- First meaningful action
- Readiness completion
- Support load

- Revenue
- Pipeline
- Pilots signed
- Pilot-to-annual conversion
- ARR
- NRR
- Customer
- Activation
- Health
- Measures met
- References
- Trust
- Controls with evidence
- Incidents
- Questionnaire turnaround
- Finance
- Cash
- Runway
- Gross margin
- AI cost per workflow
- Reliability
- SLO attainment
- Error budget
- Restore time
- People
- Capacity vs demand
- Hires on trigger

`docs/business/BUSINESS_SYSTEMS_OF_RECORD.md`

Business systems of record

Semester business operations · 2026-10-05 · Source: uploads/Show the finance and accounting operations section.pdf.
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> Every customer promise connects to a financial owner, delivery owner, support process, security/privacy control, product capability and evidence trail.

Domain	System of record	Shown in Semester
CRM, pipeline, quotes	/ops GTM	Native
Contracts and obligations	/ops legal register	Native; e-sign embedded
Invoices, subscriptions, entitlements, dunning	/ops finance	Native

Domain	System of record	Shown in Semester
Statutory ledger	Accounting software (accountant-designed)	Embedded view
Bank and payments	Bank + payment processor	Embedded balances and payouts
Payroll	Payroll provider	Embedded status
Support tickets	/ops support desk	Native
Incidents, SLOs, status	/ops incidents + status page	Native
Controls and evidence	/ops trust & compliance	Native, links to GitHub/Supabase/Vercel
Code, CI, deploys	GitHub + Vercel	Embedded status
Database	Supabase	Embedded health
Hiring and onboarding	/ops people	Native
Docs, sheets, decks	Semester Write/Sheets/Decks	Native

`docs/business/OPERATIONS_COMMAND_CENTER.md`

Operations command center

Semester Company OS · 2026-10-05 · Source: uploads/what else on the bussnius and opprations site also.pdf.

> Semester must operate with the same coherence, evidence, reliability and trust it promises to institutions.

Field	Value
Mission	Run the platform and the company from one place.
Owner	Founder
Inputs	Every function above
System of record	/ops
KPIs	Decisions with owner and date; Approvals in SLA
Reports	Executive overview
Meeting cadence	Daily glance; weekly operating review
Risk controls	Business data only; two-person approvals
Approval thresholds	See approvals matrix
Required documents	Operating manual
Required integrations	All company modules
Current status	ui_kits/ops/ (12 consoles), templates/command-center/, ui_kits/one-place/
Gaps	Decisions log, work items
Priority	P1
Next action	Start the weekly operating review from the executive overview

Workflows

- Request → evidence → approval → impact preview → execution → audit → read-model refresh → operator review

Go-to-market, revenue and marketing

docs/business/GTM_AND_SALES_SYSTEM.md

GTM and sales system

Semester Company OS · 2026-10-05 · Source: uploads/what else on the bussnius and opprations site also.pdf.

> Semester must operate with the same coherence, evidence, reliability and trust it promises to institutions.

See REVENUE_OPERATIONS.md and docs/grow/GTM Plan.html for ICP, personas, offers, prices and pipeline targets.

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docs/business/revenue/GTM_AND_REVENUE_OPERATIONS.md

GTM and revenue operations

Semester business operations · 2026-10-05 · Source: uploads/Show the finance and accounting operations section.pdf.
Accounting, tax, legal, insurance, privacy, security, accessibility and compliance content needs qualified professional review before use.

> Every customer promise connects to a financial owner, delivery owner, support process, security/privacy control, product capability and evidence trail.

Two engines: **institutional** (paid pilots → annual contracts → expansion → references) and **student adoption** (value → activation → retained use → institutional proof → referrals).

Funnel

Target accounts → researched → personalized outreach → replies/referrals → discovery → qualified → role demos → pilot design → security/privacy/procurement → pilot proposal → paid pilot signed → implementation → activation → measured success → annual conversion → expansion/renewal/reference.

CRM data

Account: name, segment, enrollment range, system type, geography, tech stack, priority score, trigger event, champion, economic buyer, technical buyer, security reviewer, procurement contact, stage, estimated ACV, pilot value, annual potential, probability, close date, risks, next step, owner.

Opportunity: problem, current workflow, scope, cohort, buyer goals, baseline and success metrics, security requirements, integration needs, terms, mutual action plan, decision process, competitors, objections, win/loss reason.

Stages and exit criteria

Stage	Exit criteria
Target	Account researched and scored
Contacted	Relevant stakeholder reached with a personalized message
Discovery	Pain, champion, timeline and buyer path documented
Qualified	Problem, budget path, decision process, feasibility confirmed
Demo	Use case shown to required stakeholders
Pilot design	Cohort, scope, baseline, success criteria agreed
Procurement/security	Review owners, artifacts, decision path identified
Proposal	Price, terms, conversion path, decision date delivered
Contracting	Legal/procurement reviewing
Closed won: pilot	Executed; kickoff scheduled
Pilot active	Cohort launched; metrics measured
Conversion	Annual decision in process
Closed won: annual	Annual agreement active
Expansion	New campus, department, module or users identified
Closed lost	Reason, competitor, re-engagement path recorded

Sales assets

ICP, persona library, account scoring, discovery script, qualification scorecard, demo script and environment, pilot design agenda, proposal, mutual action plan, ROI and pricing calculators, quote template, order-form intake, security overview, HECVAT roadmap, DPA/SLA process, accessibility response, procurement FAQ, battlecards, objection library, case-study template, reference guide, renewal/expansion deck.

Have: GTM plan, personas, objections, mutual action plan, sales process (ui_kits/business), order form, decks (templates/).
Gaps: account scoring model, ROI calculator, battlecards, procurement FAQ, demo environment.

Marketing and lifecycle

Site (home, product, pilot, pricing, demo request, Trust Center, resources, SEO pages, case studies, contact); content (LinkedIn, YouTube, webinars, newsletter, guides, research, founder, student, partner); lifecycle (nurture, demo and webinar follow-up, pilot nurture, onboarding, student activation, retention, renewal, referral).

`docs/business/REVENUE_OPERATIONS.md`

Go-to-market and revenue operations

Semester Company OS · 2026-10-05 · Source: uploads/what else on the bussnius and opprations site also.pdf.

> Semester must operate with the same coherence, evidence, reliability and trust it promises to institutions.

Field	Value
Mission	A predictable path from target account to annual contract.
Owner	Founder
Inputs	ICP, target list, conversations, pilot results
System of record	/ops GTM pipeline (CRM)
KPIs	Target accounts, replies, discovery meetings; Qualified opportunities, demos, pilot designs; Pilots signed, activation, KPI attainment; Pilot-to-annual conversion, ACV, NRR; Sales cycle, win/loss, CAC, payback
Reports	Weekly pipeline; monthly forecast
Meeting cadence	Weekly pipeline review
Risk controls	Price book and discount rules; claims register for every deck
Approval thresholds	Below floor not allowed; discounts per GTM plan
Required documents	GTM plan, Buyer map, Mutual action plan, Proposal template, Order form
Required integrations	Email and calendar inside Semester
Current status	docs/grow/GTM Plan.html, ui_kits/business (GTM), templates (decks)
Gaps	Target list built, win/loss log
Priority	P1
Next action	Build the 40-account target list in /ops

Workflows

- Target → outreach → discovery → qualified → role demo → pilot design → security/procurement → proposal → mutual action plan → contract → implementation → activation → outcome report → annual conversion → expansion/reference

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`docs/business/MARKETING_AND_BRAND_SYSTEM.md`

Marketing, brand and communications

Semester Company OS · 2026-10-05 · Source: uploads/what else on the bussnius and opprations site also.pdf.

> Semester must operate with the same coherence, evidence, reliability and trust it promises to institutions.

Field	Value
Mission	Explain Semester honestly and earn buyer and student trust.
Owner	Founder
Inputs	Positioning, proof, product releases

Field	Value
System of record	Company site + content register; /ops social
KPIs	Qualified site requests; Trust Center visits; Content published per month; Ambassador activations (later)
Reports	Monthly marketing summary
Meeting cadence	Monthly content plan
Risk controls	Every claim sourced in the claims register; status, not certifications
Approval thresholds	Customer names or quotes → written approval
Required documents	Brand system, Messaging, Claims register, Content calendar
Required integrations	Site CMS, social channels (embedded scheduling)
Current status	ui_kits/company-site/ (10 pages), design system, ui_kits/ops (social, marketing)
Gaps	Content calendar, SEO plan, webinar plan
Priority	P2
Next action	Publish pilot, pricing and trust pages

Workflows

- Plan → draft → claims check → approve → publish → measure

`docs/business/PARTNERSHIPS_AND_MARKETPLACE.md`

Partnerships, marketplace and developer relations

Semester Company OS · 2026-10-05 · Source: uploads/what else on the bussnius and opprations site also.pdf.

> Semester must operate with the same coherence, evidence, reliability and trust it promises to institutions.

Requires qualified professional review before use.

Field	Value
Mission	Borrow trust and distribution; let others build on Semester safely.
Owner	Founder
Inputs	Partner targets, integration needs
System of record	/ops partnerships
KPIs	Active partners; Certified integrations; Partner-sourced pipeline
Reports	Quarterly partner review
Meeting cadence	Quarterly
Risk controls	Security/privacy approval before any data access
Approval thresholds	Any data-sharing partner → DPA + review
Required documents	Partner agreement, Publisher agreement, Certification checklist
Required integrations	Developer platform (later)

Field	Value
Current status	ui_kits/workflow-runner (Developer platform workflow)
Gaps	Partner list, agreements
Priority	P3
Next action	List the integration partners the pilot depends on (SIS, LMS, IdP, AI provider)

Workflows

- Target → qualify → due diligence → value proposition → agreement → technical integration → security/privacy approval → GTM plan → launch → measure → co-sell → renew → offboard

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`docs/business/CUSTOMER_SUCCESS_AND_IMPLEMENTATION.md`

Customer success and implementation

Semester Company OS · 2026-10-05 · Source: uploads/what else on the bussnius and opprations site also.pdf.

> Semester must operate with the same coherence, evidence, reliability and trust it promises to institutions.

Field	Value
Mission	Every customer launches cleanly and can prove value.
Owner	Founder → implementation lead
Inputs	Signed order form, measures sheet, contacts
System of record	/ops customer success (implementation, health, QBR)
KPIs	Days signature-to-launch; Activation; Health score; Renewal rate
Reports	Weekly sponsor update; results report
Meeting cadence	Weekly during pilot; quarterly QBR after
Risk controls	Go/no-go gates with evidence
Approval thresholds	Scope change → order form amendment
Required documents	Launch runbook, Cutover plan, Support plan, Results report template
Required integrations	Tenant health from the platform
Current status	docs/launch/, templates/pilot-results-report/
Gaps	Health score definition, customer advisory board
Priority	P0
Next action	Kick off Vanderbilt implementation with the mutual action plan

Workflows

- Signed → sales-to-CS hand-off → kickoff → implementation → data readiness → admin setup → training → launch → activation → adoption → weekly review → midpoint → value report → conversion → QBR → renewal → expansion → reference

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`docs/business/customer/CUSTOMER_SUCCESS_AND_IMPLEMENTATION.md`

Customer success and implementation

Semester business operations · 2026-10-05 · Source: uploads/Show the finance and accounting operations section.pdf. ***Accounting, tax, legal, insurance, privacy, security, accessibility and compliance content needs qualified professional review before use.***

> Every customer promise connects to a financial owner, delivery owner, support process, security/privacy control, product capability and evidence trail.

Sales-to-CS hand-off (sales must deliver)

Signed agreement, commercial and implementation scope, pilot timeline, conversion date, executive sponsor, compliance evidence record, economic buyer, champion, IT contact, security/privacy/procurement contacts, cohort, workflow, baseline, success criteria, promised integrations, data categories, known risks, commitments on both sides, decision process.

Implementation workspace

Project plan, RACI, milestones, dependencies, data and integration readiness, tenant and role setup, training, launch communications, risk register, issue tracker, status report, acceptance testing, go-live gate, transition to success.

Customer health score (example weights)

Signal	Weight
Admin engagement	15%
Student/user activation	20%
First meaningful action	15%
Core workflow completion	20%
Weekly active use	10%
Support sentiment	5%
Executive engagement	5%
Pilot/renewal outcome trend	10%

Assets

Welcome sequence, kickoff deck, implementation plan, RACI, data readiness checklist, admin setup guide, training curriculum, office hours, student launch kit, support policy, escalation matrix, weekly pilot report, midpoint review, final value report, QBR, renewal and expansion plans, churn playbook, case-study consent, reference process, advisory board charter.

Have: docs/launch/ (runbook, cutover, support plan), templates/pilot-results-report/, role onboarding templates. **Gaps:** RACI, kickoff deck, data readiness checklist, admin setup guide, health score in /ops.

SEMESTER

Go-to-market plan and price book

Owner: founder. Status: draft, October 2026. Prices are planning assumptions, not published prices, until the pilot results and counsel review are in. External numbers come from Market Research, where each is sourced.

Strategy in one line: universities first, through one paid one-term pilot per institution, with named success measures and a renewal decision date. Vanderbilt is pilot #1; its results become the case study that sells pilot #2–#5.

1. Ideal customer profile

Attribute	Fit	Why
Institution type	Four-year university, 5,000–30,000 students	Public four-year schools are the largest class (~7.9 M students, Market Research §1); research universities have the registration complexity Semester solves
Pain	Students surprised by holds, missed registration steps, advisors overloaded	The Registration Readiness Pilot targets exactly this
Champion	AVP / Director of Student Success, Advising or Registrar	Owns the outcome and can run a one-term pilot
Economic buyer	VP Student Success, Provost office or CIO	Can fund a pilot from discretionary budget
Systems	SIS with a read API or extract; SAML IdP; LMS with LTI 1.3	Read-only connection is enough for the pilot
Disqualifiers	No named champion; needs write-back to SIS in the pilot; procurement over 6 months for a pilot	Too slow for a solo founder

2. Personas and promises

Persona	Cares about	Promise	Top objection → answer
VP Student Success	Retention, on-time progress	Fewer students surprised by holds and deadlines	More advisor work? → Advisors see only what students share; no new queue
Registrar	Accurate records	Students arrive at registration ready	Changes records? → Read-only; your SIS stays authoritative
CIO / IT	Security, integration load	One governed integration, SSO, audit	Another system to secure? → HECVAT Full, SAML SSO, tenant isolation, subprocessor list

Persona	Cares about	Promise	Top objection → answer
Accessibility office	WCAG 2.2 AA	Accessible by design, ACR provided	VPAT? → ACR in preparation; test protocol shared
Procurement / counsel	Risk and terms	Standard DPA/FERPA, insurance, SLA	FERPA and AI? → Student records never reach an AI provider
Students	What do I do next?	One clear next step, with its source	Tracking me? → You decide what is shared; export or delete any time

3. Offer ladder

Offer	What it is	Price (planning)	Commitment
Student workspace	Planning workspace, Today, sharing	Free to students	None
Student Premium	Optional extras for individual students	$8.99 / month or $69 / year	Monthly or annual
Registration Readiness Pilot	One term, one cohort, named measures, SSO, read-only SIS sync	Fixed fee, quoted per pilot; credited against year 1 if converting within 60 days of results	One term
Department	One school or department, advisor workflows	$18 per enrolled student per year, floor $30,000	Annual
Institution	Whole campus, console, integrations, SSO	$18 per enrolled student per year, floor $30,000	Annual, 1–3 years
Enterprise / multi-campus	Advanced controls, multiple tenants	Quoted	Multi-year
Premium support	Named contact, faster response, quarterly reviews	15% of platform fee, floor $15,000	Annual add-on
Implementation	SSO, SIS/LMS connection, training	$35,000–$150,000 one-time by scope; waived or credited for early pilots	One-time
AI overage	Governed AI requests above the plan allowance	$30 per 1,000 requests	Usage
Marketplace commission	Partner apps sold through Semester (later)	12%, separate from core viability	Per transaction

The $18 per student and the floors are planning assumptions from the GTM playbook. Third-party estimates of incumbent student-success platforms run $50,000–$300,000 a year (Market Research §3, indicative only), so the floor sits at the low end on purpose.

4. Discount and approval rules

Lever	Allowed	Approval
Multi-year (2–3 years)	Up to 10% per year committed	Founder
Early conversion (signed within 60 days of results)	Pilot fee credited	Pre-approved
Reference + case study	Up to 5%	Founder; written reference agreement
Below floor	Not allowed	—
Free pilot	Not allowed: paid pilots qualify buyers	—

5. Pipeline and targets (first 12 months)

Stage	Exit criteria	Target
Target list	Tier-1 list of named institutions with a named champion	40 accounts
Discovery	Pain, owner, budget, timeline confirmed	15
Demo	Role-specific demo of the exact workflow	10
Pilot design	Measures, scope and data agreed	6
Security / legal	HECVAT, DPA, ACR path agreed	5
Pilot signed	Order form signed	3 (including Vanderbilt)
Annual conversion	Results report, annual order form	2

Targets are founder planning numbers, sized to one person doing sales alongside delivery. Revisit after Vanderbilt’s midpoint review.

6. Channels

Channel	Use	Cost
Founder outbound	Named champions at tier-1 accounts, referencing the pilot	Time only
Warm intros	Vanderbilt sponsor references (after results, with permission)	Time only
Conferences	Attend one student-success or registrar conference in year 1; no booth	Registration + travel, within setup budget
Company site	Pilot page, Trust Center, pricing, request-a-pilot form	Hosting only
Content	One article a month from real pilot learning; no claims we can’t prove	Time only

7. Case study plan (from the pilot)

Step	When	Output
Agree measures and baseline	Before launch (runbook gate)	Signed measures sheet
Ask for case-study permission in writing	At midpoint review	Signed permission, wording approval rights for Vanderbilt
Results report	End of term	templates/pilot-results-report
Case study	Within 30 days of results	Two-page PDF and site page, approved by Vanderbilt
Reference call	After case study	Sponsor agrees to two calls a quarter

8. 90-day GTM plan

Days	Do
1–30	Finish pilot launch blockers; build the tier-1 list (40); write the price book into the order-form template
31–60	Ten discovery calls; three demos; publish pilot and pricing pages on the site
61–90	Two pilot designs in security/legal review; midpoint review at Vanderbilt; ask for case-study permission

9. Metrics

Metric	Definition
Qualified pipeline	Accounts past discovery with champion and buyer named
Pilot KPI attainment	Share of agreed measures met at end of term
Pilot-to-annual conversion	Pilots that sign annual within 90 days of results
Sales cycle	First call to signed pilot, in days
Net revenue retention	Year-2 revenue from year-1 customers ÷ year-1 revenue

10. Claim rules

Say “in a paid pilot with one university” until there are more. State status, not certifications we don’t hold (no “SOC 2 compliant”, no “FERPA certified”). Every number on the site or in a deck needs a source in the public claims register.

SEMESTER · RESEARCH · 5 OCT 2026

Market and competitor research

Web research for the company deck’s market slide and for sales positioning. Every number cites its source. Sizing below is arithmetic on public enrollment and Semester’s planning price — not a forecast.

1. The enrollment base

MEASURE	VALUE	SOURCE
Total US postsecondary enrollment, fall 2025	19.4 million (+1.0% YoY)	National Student Clearinghouse Research Center, via EssayPro / High5 summaries
Undergraduate / graduate, fall 2025	16.2 M / 3.2 M	NSCRC, via Bryan Alexander
Public four-year universities	~7.9 M students (~41%)	High5 summary of NSCRC/NCES
Trend	Community colleges +3.0%; public 4-year +1.4%; private nonprofit 4-year −1.6%	NSCRC, via Bryan Alexander

2. Sizing arithmetic (planning, not forecast)

SCOPE	STUDENTS	× $18 / STUDENT / YR
All US postsecondary	19.4 M	≈ $349 M / yr theoretical ceiling
Public four-year universities (beachhead class)	~7.9 M	≈ $142 M / yr
One 13,000-student research university (e.g. pilot scale)	13,000	≈ $234 k / yr (above the $30 k floor)

$18 is Semester’s planning assumption from the GTM playbook, not a published price. The last row’s enrollment is illustrative — confirm Vanderbilt’s actual headcount before using it externally.

3. Landscape — student success platforms

PLAYER	WHAT IT IS	SCALE (AS CLAIMED)	NOTE
EAB Navigate360	Student-lifecycle CRM: advising, early alerts, student self-service	EAB says 850+ partner institutions and 10M+ students supported	Vendor claims; graduation-rate gains of 3–15% are EAB’s own case-study figures
Starfish (EAB)	Early alert, care networks, advising	“Nearly 500 colleges and universities” (Starfish)	Acquired by EAB from Hobsons in Feb 2021; Penn State announced moving from Starfish to Navigate360 for 2027–28

PLAYER	WHAT IT IS	SCALE (AS CLAIMED)	NOTE
Civitas Learning	Predictive analytics for student success	—	Listed alongside Navigate and Starfish in third-party comparisons
AI-native entrants (e.g. ibl.ai)	Course-aware AI tutors and agents	—	Position on AI tutoring, which incumbents lack

Pricing signal. One third-party estimate puts Navigate software at $50,000–$300,000 per year depending on size, with bundles above $500,000 for large universities. That estimate comes from a competitor's comparison page (ibl.ai) — treat it as indicative only.

4. Where Semester fits

INCUMBENTS OPTIMISE FOR	SEMESTER OPTIMISES FOR
Staff: alerts, caseloads, dashboards	The student's next action, ranked by what blocks them
Risk scores	Provenance: official / connected / yours / AI-assisted on every fact
AI as a feature (or absent)	AI governed by course policy; student records never reach a model
Replacing workflows	Sitting beside the SIS/LMS in a bounded, paid pilot

Positioning line: *complements* Navigate/Starfish (staff side) rather than replacing them in year one — the pilot does not ask a school to rip anything out.

5. Sources

- EssayPro, "Postsecondary Enrollment Statistics: Changes From Fall 2025" (NSCRC data)
- Bryan Alexander, "Fall 2025 enrollment data: uneven growth, emerging trends"
- High5Test, "40+ College Enrollment Statistics (2024–2025)"
- EAB, "Student Success and Retention" solutions page
- Starfish, a part of EAB (LinkedIn showcase)
- EAB press release, "EAB to Enhance Its Student Success Collaborative by Acquiring Starfish," Feb 18 2021
- Penn State Starfish info site, Navigate360 transition update
- ibl.ai, "EAB Navigate Alternatives: Student Success Platforms for 2026" (competitor source)

Finance and capital

docs/business/FINANCE_AND_CAPITAL_SYSTEM.md

Finance, accounting and capital

Semester Company OS · 2026-10-05 · Source: uploads/what else on the bussnius and opprations site also.pdf.

> Semester must operate with the same coherence, evidence, reliability and trust it promises to institutions.

Requires qualified professional review before use.

Field	Value
Mission	Know cash, runway and unit economics every month; bill accurately and collect on time.
Owner	Founder + bookkeeper
Inputs	Bank and card feeds, invoices, contracts, payroll/contractor costs, vendor bills
System of record	/ops finance (invoices, AR, dunning); accounting ledger (bookkeeper); bank
KPIs	Cash, burn, runway; ARR, pilot revenue; Gross margin incl. AI and cloud cost; DSO; Forecast variance
Reports	Monthly close pack; dashboards: cash, revenue, pipeline, margin, CAC, retention, spend, forecast (conservative/base/ambitious/downside)
Meeting cadence	Monthly close (1 h); weekly cash check
Risk controls	Founder approves spend above $500; separation of invoicing and payment where possible
Approval thresholds	Spend > $500 → founder; discounts per price book; anything off price book → founder
Required documents	Chart of accounts, Expense policy, Tax calendar, Price book, Discount policy, Finance model
Required integrations	Bank, payment processor, accounting software (embedded views)
Current status	docs/run/Finance Model.html, docs/grow/GTM Plan.html (price book), ui_kits/ops (finance console)
Gaps	36-month model, AI cost per workflow, revenue recognition review, tax calendar
Priority	P0
Next action	Open business bank account and accounting ledger; set the monthly close date

Workflows

- Month ends → invoices and payments reconciled → expenses categorized → payroll posted → vendor costs reviewed → revenue/deferred revenue reviewed → P&L → balance sheet → cash flow → runway → forecast variance → executive review → investor summary

docs/business/finance/FINANCE_AND_ACCOUNTING_OPERATIONS.md

Finance and accounting operations

Semester business operations · 2026-10-05 · Source: uploads/Show the finance and accounting operations section.pdf.
Accounting, tax, legal, insurance, privacy, security, accessibility and compliance content needs qualified professional review before use.

> Every customer promise connects to a financial owner, delivery owner, support process, security/privacy control, product capability and evidence trail.

Questions the system must answer any time

- How much cash do we have, and how long is the runway?
- What is committed revenue, and what is actually collected?
- Which contracts and pilots are profitable; what does each customer cost to serve?
- What is the margin impact of AI and infrastructure?
- What can we afford to hire or build next?

Console: /ops/finance

- Cash, runway, revenue dashboards and revenue forecast
- P&L, balance sheet, cash-flow views; budget vs actual
- Expense categories, vendor spend, payroll and contractor forecast
- Unit economics, customer profitability, AI cost and cloud cost dashboards
- Pricing calculator, discount approvals, finance risk alerts
- Collections/dunning, invoices, payment reconciliation
- Tax calendar, insurance tracker, board finance pack, forecast scenarios

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Data model (commercial and billing state only)

Accounting periods, accounts, journal-entry references, bank accounts, cash snapshots, budgets, forecast scenarios, revenue and expense plans, cost centers, customers, contracts, orders, subscriptions, invoices and lines, payments, credits/refunds, dunning cases, vendor contracts, purchase orders, expenses, payroll and contractor costs, cloud costs, AI costs, security/compliance costs, reporting snapshots.

The product database tracks quotes, orders, subscriptions, invoices, entitlements, payment events, dunning and profitability. It is not the statutory ledger. The ledger lives in accounting software designed with the accountant; /ops shows it embedded.

Revenue streams

Paid pilots; implementation fees; annual platform licenses (per enrolled student); premium support; AI usage overages; Student Premium; department, enterprise and multi-campus plans; marketplace commissions; partner revenue; professional, training and migration services.

Planning prices (assumptions, not published)

Item	Planning price
Student workspace	Free at participating schools
Student Premium	$8.99 / month or $69 / year
Institution platform	$18 per enrolled student per year, $30,000 annual minimum
AI overage	$30 per 1,000 governed requests
Implementation	$35,000–$150,000 one-time (waived or credited for the first pilots)
Premium support	15% of annual platform fee, $15,000 minimum
Marketplace / partner commission	12%, optional and separate from core viability

Quote-to-cash

Quote → pricing exception check → approval if required → order form accepted → contract active → invoice → payment collected and reconciled → entitlement granted → revenue recognized/reviewed → renewal tracked → expansion, cancellation or dunning → profitability reviewed.

Controls

Action	Required control
Create draft quote	Revenue operations role
Approve discount	Deal desk by margin/ACV threshold (founder until a deal desk exists)
Send final quote	Revenue approval
Change commercial plan	Approval + entitlement impact review
Issue credit/refund	Finance approval + invoice/payment reference
Write off receivable	Finance + executive approval above threshold
Change billing account	Verified customer authority
Change bank/payment settings	Strong authentication + finance approval
Publish forecast	Finance owner review
Board/investor reporting	Founder/finance approval
Create vendor commitment	Budget owner approval

KPIs

Cash, burn, runway, committed ARR, recognized revenue, collected cash, MRR, ARR, pilot/implementation/expansion revenue, gross and contribution margin, AI and cloud cost per active user, support cost per customer, implementation cost per pilot, CAC, payback, LTV sensitivity, gross retention, NRR, ACV, sales cycle, invoice aging, collections rate, dunning recovery, budget variance, headcount cost, revenue per employee.

Monthly close

Calendar opens → invoices reviewed → payments reconciled → vendor invoices recorded → payroll and contractor costs recorded → cloud and AI costs allocated → expenses categorized → deferred revenue reviewed → P&L → balance sheet → cash flow → forecast variance explained → runway updated → executive review → board/investor summary.

Processes

Process	Trigger	Owner	System of record	Approval	Output	KPI	Failure → escalation
Monthly close	Calendar day 5	Founder + bookkeeper	Ledger	Founder	Close pack	Close on time	Late → founder same week
Invoice	Order form signed / milestone	Founder	/ops invoices	—	Invoice sent	DSO	Unpaid 30 days → dunning
Discount	Quote below list	Founder	/ops quotes	Founder	Approved quote	Avg discount	Below floor → reject
Refund/credit	Customer request	Founder	/ops payments	Finance	Credit note	Refund rate	Dispute → counsel

Status and gaps

- Have: docs/run/Finance Model.html, docs/grow/GTM Plan.html, ui_kits/ops finance console.
- Gaps (P0): bank account, ledger and chart of accounts with the accountant, tax registrations, invoice the pilot. (P1): AI cost allocation, customer profitability, 36-month model.

`docs/business/BOARD_AND_INVESTOR_OPERATIONS.md`

Board, investor and stakeholder operations

Semester Company OS · 2026-10-05 · Source: uploads/what else on the bussnius and opprations site also.pdf.

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Field	Value
Mission	Clear, honest updates when there are stakeholders to update.
Owner	Founder
Inputs	KPI tree, finance, pipeline, risks
System of record	/ops board/investor reports; investor portal
KPIs	Updates sent on time
Reports	Monthly founder update
Meeting cadence	Monthly (deferred while bootstrapped)
Risk controls	Numbers from the close pack only
Approval thresholds	Fundraising deferred until pilot results
Required documents	Investor deck, Data room index, Cap table
Required integrations	—
Current status	templates/investor-deck/, ui_kits/investor/
Gaps	Data room index
Priority	P3
Next action	Draft the data room index (deferred)

Workflows

- Monthly update → board deck (when a board exists) → decisions → follow-ups

SEMESTER

Finance model · pre-revenue to first annual contract

Owner: founder. Status: draft, October 2026. All cost lines are estimates to confirm with quotes, except hosting list prices, which are sourced in §5. Founder salary is $0 in every scenario.

Budget rule: setup must fit the $5,000–$20,000 range. Spend in launch-gate order (insurance, counsel, accessibility, security) before anything else. The pilot fee is the first revenue; nothing below assumes outside money.

1. Setup budget: three scenarios

Item	Basis	Lean	Base	Full
Counsel review: MSA, DPA, order form, terms, privacy	Quote from counsel	$1,500	$4,000	$6,000
Cyber + E&O insurance, first-year premium	Broker quote (launch gate)	$1,500	$3,000	$4,500
Accessibility: ACR test pass	Self-test / partial audit / third-party audit	$0	$1,500	$2,500
Penetration test	Not in lean or base; scope in Security Readiness	$0	$0	$2,000
Accounting setup, tax registrations	Accountant quote	$300	$800	$1,000
Domain, email, password manager, tools	Vendor list prices	$200	$300	$500
Hosting, first 6 months (Supabase Pro + staging, Vercel Pro)	See §5 sources	$330	$400	$600
AI provider usage, first 6 months	Gateway spend cap	$100	$300	$500
Travel to campus (setup, launch)	Estimate	$500	$1,000	$500
Subtotal		$4,430	$11,300	$18,100
Contingency 10%		$443	$1,130	$1,810
Total setup		**$4,873**	**$12,430**	**$19,910**

Lean meets the contract minimum with self-testing and the smallest legal scope. **Base** is the recommendation: counsel reviews every institution document and accessibility gets a partial outside audit. **Full** adds a third-party pen test and full accessibility audit, which strengthens HECVAT answers for pilot #2.

2. Monthly run-rate after launch

Line	Per month
Supabase Pro (production)	$25
Supabase staging project	$10
Vercel Pro, 1 seat	$20
Email and tools	$60
AI provider usage (capped)	$50
Bookkeeping	$150
Insurance, if paid monthly	$250
Total	**$565**

That's about $6,780 a year. Hosting stays under $100 a month at pilot scale. When an institution asks for the hosting vendor's own SOC 2 report through Semester, budget the Supabase Team plan (§5) as a step change: +$574 a month.

3. Revenue scenarios (first 12 months)

Scenario	Pilot fee (Vanderbilt)	Pilots #2–#3	Annual conversions	12-month revenue
Low	[signed fee]	0	0	[signed fee]
Base	[signed fee]	1 × $15,000	1 × $30,000 (floor)	[signed fee] + $45,000
High	[signed fee]	2 × $15,000	2 × $30,000	[signed fee] + $90,000

The Vanderbilt fee is in the signed order form; fill it in. Pilot #2–#3 fees and annual prices are planning assumptions from the GTM plan ($18 per student per year, $30,000 floor), not quotes. Pilot fees credited against year 1 are revenue once, not twice.

4. Cash and runway

Measure	Lean	Base	Full
Setup spend	$4,873	$12,430	$19,910
Run-rate, 12 months	$6,780	$6,780	$6,780
Cash needed before pilot fee arrives	$6,568	$14,125	$21,605
Break-even point	Pilot fee ≥ setup + 3 months	Pilot fee ≥ setup + 3 months	Pilot fee ≥ setup + 3 months

"Cash needed" assumes the pilot invoice is paid about three months after setup starts. Ask for 50% at signature in the order form to shorten that.

5. Sourced prices (checked 5 Oct 2026)

Vendor	Price used	Source
Supabase Pro	$25 a month per organization, includes a Micro compute credit; extra projects about $10 a month	makerkit.dev and flexprice.io Supabase pricing guides, 2026
Supabase Team	$599 a month (SOC 2, SLA)	flexprice.io and costbench.com, 2026
Vercel Pro	$20 per user a month billed annually, $24 monthly	vendr.com Vercel pricing, 2026

Re-check on the vendors' own pricing pages before each budget review; third-party summaries can lag.

6. Unit economics at the planning price

Measure	Value	Note
Annual contract (floor)	$30,000	Planning assumption
Hosting + AI per institution	≈ $1,500 a year	Estimate at pilot scale
Support time	Founder hours	Not costed while salary is $0
Gross margin before people	≈ 95%	Falls when support and engineering are hired

7. Monthly close (one hour)

1. Reconcile bank and card.
2. Categorize spend against the lines above.
3. Update cash, run-rate and runway.
4. Compare actual setup spend to the chosen scenario; flag any line over 20%.
5. Note any contract, insurance or renewal dates in the next 60 days.

People and hiring

docs/business/PEOPLE_AND_HIRING_SYSTEM.md

People, hiring and culture

Semester Company OS · 2026-10-05 · Source: uploads/what else on the bussnius and opprations site also.pdf.

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Field	Value
Mission	Hire on triggers, onboard safely, keep the culture evidence-first.
Owner	Founder
Inputs	Hiring triggers, revenue
System of record	/ops people (hiring, onboarding); payroll provider (embedded)
KPIs	Time to hire; Onboarding checklist completion; Access revoked same day on exit
Reports	Quarterly workforce plan
Meeting cadence	Quarterly
Risk controls	IP + confidentiality before access; FERPA/security training
Approval thresholds	Every hire tied to signed revenue
Required documents	Hiring plan, Job descriptions, Handbook, Equity plan
Required integrations	Payroll provider, identity provider
Current status	docs/run/Hiring Plan.html
Gaps	Handbook, equity plan, compensation bands
Priority	P2
Next action	Engage counsel and bookkeeper as the first contractors

Workflows

- Trigger → scorecard → recruit → loop → references → offer → onboarding → access provisioning → 90-day review → offboarding → access revocation

docs/business/people/PEOPLE_HIRING_AND_CULTURE.md

People, hiring and culture

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Org design

Founder/CEO → product and design; engineering and platform; learning and academic operations; student success and implementation; sales and GTM; customer success and support; security, privacy, compliance and legal ops; finance and business operations; partnerships and developer ecosystem; people and culture.

Hiring sequence

Stage	First priority hires
Prototype to pilot	Full-stack/platform engineer, product designer, implementation/CS lead
First paid pilots	Institutional sales lead, security/compliance adviser, support/implementation capacity
Pilot conversion	Product manager, data/analytics, registrar/academic operations expert
Expansion	Platform/SRE, partnerships/integrations, marketing/content, finance/operations
Platform scale	Developer relations, marketplace/partner team, regional operations, research/outcomes

Every hire still waits for its revenue trigger (docs/run/Hiring Plan.html).

Every role has

Mission, outcomes, competencies, technical/domain requirements, decision rights, metrics, interview process, references, compensation and equity range, onboarding plan, 30/60/90 deliverables, access needed, security/privacy training, review expectations.

Cultural standards

- Student agency over surveillance
- Evidence over hype
- Accessibility by default
- Trust before shortcuts
- Interoperability over lock-in
- Human judgment in high-stakes decisions
- Reliability before vanity features
- Documentation is part of the product
- Every critical workflow has a rollback
- Every public claim has evidence
- Every customer promise has an owner

- Every incident creates a learning loop

SEMESTER

Hiring plan and job descriptions

Owner: founder. Status: draft, October 2026. Semester is bootstrapped: every hire is triggered by revenue or by a contract obligation, never by a calendar date.

Rule: no role is opened until its trigger is true and its cost is covered by signed revenue. Anyone touching student data signs confidentiality terms, completes FERPA and security training, and gets least-privilege access, reviewed quarterly.

1. Plan

When	Role	Type	Trigger	Paid from
Now	Fractional counsel	Contract	Pilot paper (MSA, DPA, order form) needs review	Covered in finance model setup
Now	Insurance broker	Vendor	Cyber + E&O required by the pilot contract	Commission-based
Now	Bookkeeper	Contract, ~2 h/month	Pilot invoice and monthly close	In run-rate
Before launch	Accessibility tester	Contract, per engagement	ACR test log for the pilot	Base / full scenario
After pilot fee	Founding full-stack engineer	Contract-to-hire	Two pilots in delivery, or founder spending >50% of time on engineering	Paid from pilot revenue only
After 2nd pilot	Implementation & customer success lead	Part-time → full-time	Two concurrent institutions in setup or live	Paid from contracted revenue
After 1st annual	Security & compliance lead (fractional)	Fractional	SOC 2 readiness, or a buyer requiring it	Per engagement
After 3 annuals	Account executive (higher ed)	Full-time	Founder can no longer run all discovery calls	Base + commission
After 3 annuals	Product designer	Full-time	Design debt slowing releases; design system needs an owner	—
Later	Support specialist	Part-time	Tickets exceed founder capacity during pilot hours	—

2. How we hire

1. Write the job description from this document; post with a salary range.

2. 30-minute screen: motivation and the role's must-haves.
3. Paid work sample (2–4 hours, real but not production work, no student data).
4. Two references, one a former manager.
5. Offer with IP assignment, confidentiality and a background check where the institution contract requires it.

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3. Onboarding (every hire)

Week	Do
1	Accounts with MFA, read the operating manual, design system readme, security policies and acceptable use
1	FERPA and security training; sign confidentiality and acceptable-use
2	Shadow a support shift and a customer call
2–4	First owned deliverable with a named reviewer
12	90-day review against the role's first-90 list

Job descriptions

Founding full-stack engineer

Contract-to-hire · remote (US) · reports to founder

Build Semester with the founder: the student app, staff workspaces and the data layer that keeps every institution's records isolated.

You'll own

- Features end to end in React + TypeScript on Supabase (Postgres, RLS, Auth) and Vercel
- Row-level security policies and the tests that prove them
- SIS and LMS read integrations (SAML SSO, LTI 1.3, OneRoster)
- CI, releases and on-call rotation with the founder

First 90 days

- Ship the SAML SSO and SIS read sync for the pilot
- Land RLS test coverage on every student table
- Take one on-call week with the support plan

You have

- 3+ years shipping production web apps in TypeScript
- Postgres you can reason about: schemas, indexes, policies
- Care for accessibility and plain interfaces
- Comfort working directly with a founder and with customers

Good to have

- Higher-ed systems (Banner, Workday Student, Canvas)
- Supabase or row-level security in production
- Security reviews (HECVAT, SOC 2)

This role is not a role where you only take tickets. You'll make product calls.

Implementation & customer success lead

Part-time to full-time · remote (US) with campus travel · reports to founder

Get each institution live and make the pilot succeed against the measures it agreed.

You'll own

- Implementation plans from signature to launch
- Weekly sponsor updates and the week-1 review
- Staff training for advisors, registrar and student affairs
- Results reports and the annual conversion conversation

First 90 days

- Run setup for pilot #2 using the launch runbook
- Own day-1 / week-1 support for one launch
- Draft the case study from the Vanderbilt pilot

You have

- Experience implementing software at colleges or universities
- Clear writing to executives and to front-line staff
- Comfort with data mapping and spreadsheets

Good to have

- Advising, registrar or student success background
- FERPA training

Security & compliance lead (fractional)

Fractional · remote · reports to founder

Turn Semester's security policies into evidence that institutions and auditors accept.

You'll own

- HECVAT responses and the evidence register
- SOC 2 readiness plan and vendor management
- Access reviews, incident response exercises and the restore drill
- Pen-test scoping and remediation tracking

First 90 days

- Review the HECVAT Full answers against real controls
- Run one tabletop incident exercise
- Produce a SOC 2 gap list with costs

You have

- Security program experience at a SaaS company
- Familiarity with FERPA and higher-ed security reviews
- Practical, evidence-first approach

Good to have

- CISSP, CISM or similar

This role is not a full-time hire yet.

Account executive, higher education

Full-time · remote (US) · base + commission · reports to founder

Find and close the next universities, using the pilot motion that worked.

You'll own

- Pipeline from target list to signed pilot
- Discovery, demos and mutual action plans
- Security and legal review coordination with the founder
- Forecast in the weekly metrics review

First 90 days

- Learn the GTM plan, price book and claim rules
- Run 15 discovery calls
- Bring two pilots to security / legal review

You have

- Track record selling software to colleges or universities
- Comfort with long, multi-stakeholder sales
- Honest selling: status, not promises

Good to have

- Student success or registrar buyers

Product designer

Full-time · remote (US) · reports to founder

Own the Semester design system and the product experience for students and staff.

You'll own

- The design system: tokens, components, patterns, templates
- Flows for new workflows from the catalog
- Accessibility review on every release
- Research sessions with students and staff

First 90 days

- Audit the design system against the shipped app
- Redesign one high-traffic flow with research
- Set up the accessibility review in the release checklist

You have

- Portfolio of shipped product work, including complex data or forms

- Working knowledge of WCAG 2.2
- Can prototype in code or work closely with engineers who do

Good to have

- Higher-ed or civic product experience

Support specialist

Part-time · remote (US), pilot hours · reports to implementation lead

Answer staff and escalated student questions quickly and route the rest to the right place.

You'll own

- The support queue during pilot hours
- Known-issues notes and reply macros
- Ticket tagging that feeds the product backlog

First 90 days

- Learn the support plan and severities
- Handle a launch week alongside the implementation lead

You have

- Support experience, ideally software or a campus help desk
- Calm, plain writing

This role is not access to raw student records: tickets reference internal IDs only.

Contractor briefs

Role	Brief	Deliverable
Fractional counsel	Review MSA, DPA, order form, terms, privacy; advise on liability caps and institution paper	Redlines and a fallback position memo
Insurance broker	Quote cyber + E&O at the limits in the pilot contract	Bound policies and certificates
Bookkeeper	Monthly close per the finance model; invoices and receivables	Monthly P&L and cash report
Accessibility tester	Manual and assistive-technology testing on pilot paths	Test log and ACR draft

Governance, legal, risk and vendors

docs/business/CORPORATE_GOVERNANCE_AND_LEGAL_OPS.md

Corporate governance and legal

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Requires qualified professional review before use.

Field	Value
Mission	Keep the company legally sound, its IP owned, and every contract and obligation tracked.
Owner	Founder + fractional counsel
Inputs	Formation documents, contracts, policies, counsel advice
System of record	Contracts register in /ops legal; corporate records folder
KPIs	Contracts with obligations logged; Days to signature; Renewals missed (0)
Reports	Monthly legal queue and obligations calendar
Meeting cadence	Weekly legal queue review (15 min)
Risk controls	No signature without template or counsel redline; IP assignment for every contributor
Approval thresholds	Any contract with student data, liability above fees, or non-standard indemnity → counsel
Required documents	Operating agreement, IP assignment, NDA, MSA, Order form, DPA, SLA, Terms, Privacy, Acceptable use, Cookie notice, Accessibility statement, Security addendum, Contractor / employee / advisor templates, Marketplace publisher agreement, Trademark register
Required integrations	E-sign (embedded), contracts register
Current status	docs/legal/ (MSA, order form, DPA, terms, privacy, cookie, accessibility, community, subprocessors)
Gaps	SLA, SOW, security addendum, contractor/advisor templates, trademark filing, policy register
Priority	P0
Next action	Counsel review of MSA, DPA and order form before pilot launch

Workflows

- Request → classify → business owner → legal owner → risk rating → template → redline → approval → signature → obligations extracted → renewal reminder → evidence → amendment/termination

docs/business/BUSINESS_RISK_REGISTER.md

Business risk register

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Risk	Category	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation	Owner
Pilot starts without insurance	Legal/compliance	Medium	High	Bind before go/no-go	Founder
Customer concentration (one pilot)	Financial	High	High	Pipeline of 40 targets; conversion plan	Founder
Runway shortfall before pilot invoice paid	Financial	Medium	High	50% at signature; lean setup	Founder
Founder capacity	People	High	High	Revenue-triggered hires; contractors; runbooks	Founder
Vendor breach (hosting/AI)	Vendor	Low	High	Reviews, DPAs, breach plan	Founder
Unsupported promise in a deal	Revenue	Medium	Medium	Claims register; scope in order form	Founder
Ledger built in product DB	Finance	Low	Medium	Accountant-designed ledger	Bookkeeper
Accessibility complaint	Compliance	Medium	High	ACR, barrier process	Founder
Price too low to fund support	Financial	Medium	Medium	Floors, premium support, overage	Founder
Reputation from over-claiming	Reputation	Low	High	Status not certifications	Founder

docs/business/RISK_RESILIENCE_AND_CONTINUITY.md

Risk, resilience and continuity

Semester Company OS · 2026-10-05 · Source: uploads/what else on the bussnius and opprations site also.pdf.

> Semester must operate with the same coherence, evidence, reliability and trust it promises to institutions.

Field	Value
Mission	See risks early and recover fast.
Owner	Founder
Inputs	Risk register, incidents, SLO data
System of record	/ops risk register, incidents, SLOs
KPIs	Risks with owners; Restore drill time; Postmortems on time
Reports	Monthly risk review
Meeting cadence	Monthly
Risk controls	Error budget policy; key-person continuity plan
Approval thresholds	P0 risks reviewed weekly
Required documents	Risk register, BCP/DR, Runbooks, Platform risk register
Required integrations	Monitoring

Field	Value
Current status	ui_kits/business (risks), docs/operate/, docs/platform/PLATFORM_RISK_REGISTER.md
Gaps	Key-person continuity plan, customer concentration plan
Priority	P1
Next action	Write the key-person continuity plan (credentials escrow, runbooks, counsel contact)

Workflows

- Identify → rate → owner → mitigation → review

`docs/business/VENDOR_AND_PROCUREMENT_SYSTEM.md`

Procurement, vendors and supply chain

Semester Company OS · 2026-10-05 · Source: uploads/what else on the bussnius and opprations site also.pdf.

> Semester must operate with the same coherence, evidence, reliability and trust it promises to institutions.

Requires qualified professional review before use.

Field	Value
Mission	Every vendor has a purpose, a review and an exit.
Owner	Founder
Inputs	Vendor requests
System of record	/ops vendors
KPIs	Vendors reviewed; Vendors with DPA; Renewals reviewed before date
Reports	Subprocessor list (public)
Meeting cadence	Annual vendor review
Risk controls	Need-to-know access, MFA, encryption, breach plan
Approval thresholds	Student-data vendors → subprocessor notice
Required documents	Vendor risk policy, Subprocessors
Required integrations	—
Current status	docs/legal/Subprocessors.html, docs/secure/
Gaps	Vendor review records
Priority	P1
Next action	Record reviews for Supabase, Vercel, AI provider, email provider

Workflows

- Intake → purpose → data classification → security/privacy review → contract terms → access scope → onboarding → periodic review → incident escalation → renewal → offboarding

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docs/business/DATA_RESEARCH_AND_OUTCOMES.md

Data, research and outcomes

Semester Company OS · 2026-10-05 · Source: uploads/what else on the bussnius and opprations site also.pdf.

> Semester must operate with the same coherence, evidence, reliability and trust it promises to institutions.

Requires qualified professional review before use.

Field	Value
Mission	Prove outcomes with privacy-safe evidence.
Owner	Founder
Inputs	Event taxonomy, cohorts, measures
System of record	Analytics (aggregate), research repository
KPIs	Pilots with baseline; Measures met; Claims approved with evidence
Reports	Pilot results report
Meeting cadence	Per term
Risk controls	Minimum cell size; no row-level export; research governance
Approval thresholds	Any publication → institution approval
Required documents	Event taxonomy, Metric definitions, Research governance
Required integrations	Warehouse (later)
Current status	templates/pilot-results-report/, docs/platform/RESEARCH_AND_OUTCOMES_ENGINE.md
Gaps	Event taxonomy, metric definitions
Priority	P1
Next action	Define the pilot event taxonomy (no PII)

Workflows

- Hypothesis → baseline → cohort → intervention → measurement → analysis → evidence review → customer validation → claim approval → iteration

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docs/business/BUSINESS_MASTER_BACKLOG.md

Business master backlog

Semester Company OS · 2026-10-05 · Source: uploads/what else on the bussnius and opprations site also.pdf.

Semester must operate with the same coherence, evidence, reliability and trust it promises to institutions.

P0

- **Corporate governance and legal:** Counsel review of MSA, DPA and order form before pilot launch *(gaps: SLA, SOW, security addendum, contractor/advisor templates, trademark filing, policy register)*
- **Finance, accounting and capital:** Open business bank account and accounting ledger; set the monthly close date *(gaps: 36-month model, AI cost per workflow, revenue recognition review, tax calendar)*
- **Security, privacy, accessibility and compliance:** Bind insurance; submit HECVAT Full; complete vendor reviews for Supabase, Vercel, AI provider *(gaps: HECVAT submitted, insurance bound, ACR, vendor reviews documented)*
- **Customer success and implementation:** Kick off Vanderbilt implementation with the mutual action plan *(gaps: Health score definition, customer advisory board)*

P1

- **Product and engineering operations:** Run execute stream 00 and approve the design-system baseline *(gaps: PRD template, ADR log, experiment registry)*
- **Go-to-market and revenue operations:** Build the 40-account target list in /ops *(gaps: Target list built, win/loss log)*
- **Support and service operations:** Write the first 10 KB articles from the pilot paths *(gaps: Help center, KB articles, feature-request taxonomy)*
- **Data, research and outcomes:** Define the pilot event taxonomy (no PII) *(gaps: Event taxonomy, metric definitions)*
- **Procurement, vendors and supply chain:** Record reviews for Supabase, Vercel, AI provider, email provider *(gaps: Vendor review records)*
- **Risk, resilience and continuity:** Write the key-person continuity plan (credentials escrow, runbooks, counsel contact) *(gaps: Key-person continuity plan, customer concentration plan)*
- **Operations command center:** Start the weekly operating review from the executive overview *(gaps: Decisions log, work items)*

P2

- **Marketing, brand and communications:** Publish pilot, pricing and trust pages *(gaps: Content calendar, SEO plan, webinar plan)*
- **People, hiring and culture:** Engage counsel and bookkeeper as the first contractors *(gaps: Handbook, equity plan, compensation bands)*

P3

- **Partnerships, marketplace and developer relations:** List the integration partners the pilot depends on (SIS, LMS, IdP, AI provider) *(gaps: Partner list, agreements)*
- **Board, investor and stakeholder operations:** Draft the data room index (deferred) *(gaps: Data room index)*

90-day plan

- Sellable pilot package complete (contracts reviewed, insurance bound)
- Finance: bank, ledger, monthly close
- Trust: HECVAT, vendor reviews, ACR in progress
- Pipeline: 40 targets, 10 discovery calls
- Implementation: Vanderbilt launched with support plan
- Reliability: monitoring, restore drill

12-month plan

- Pilot results and annual conversion
- Pilots #2–#3
- First engineer and implementation lead
- KB and help center
- Event taxonomy and results reporting
- SOC 2 readiness plan

36-month plan

- Repeatable implementation factory
- Platform maturity stages 2–4
- Partner program and certified integrations
- Board and investor operations if raising
- Multi-campus customers
- Published outcomes research

Budget and capacity

See docs/run/Finance Model.html (setup $4,873 / $12,430 / $19,910; run-rate ≈ $565/mo) and docs/run/Hiring Plan.html.

Top 50 business and operations actions

1. Counsel review: MSA, DPA, order form
2. Bind cyber + E&O insurance
3. Open business bank account
4. Set up accounting ledger and chart of accounts
5. Register for state/local taxes (accountant)

6. Sign Vanderbilt DPA
7. Submit HECVAT Full
8. Record vendor reviews (Supabase, Vercel, AI, email)
9. Publish subprocessor list
10. Sign success-measures sheet
11. Kickoff with mutual action plan
12. Name Vanderbilt contacts
13. Set monthly close date
14. Invoice the pilot (50% at signature if possible)
15. Start weekly operating review
16. Create contracts register with obligations
17. Create decisions log
18. Write key-person continuity plan
19. Escrow credentials and runbooks
20. Define pilot event taxonomy
21. Write 10 KB articles
22. Set up status page
23. Run support plan on launch
24. Build 40-account target list
25. Book 10 discovery calls
26. Publish pilot, pricing, trust pages
27. Claims register review of site and decks
28. Write SLA document
29. Write SOW template
30. Write security addendum
31. Contractor and advisor templates
32. File trademark search (counsel)
33. Draft employee handbook (counsel)
34. Midpoint review
35. Case-study permission
36. Results report
37. Annual conversion proposal
38. Extend finance model to 36 months
39. AI cost per workflow model
40. Health score definition
41. Win/loss log
42. Content calendar
43. Partner list for pilot dependencies
44. Policy register
45. Quarterly access review
46. Tabletop incident exercise

47. Restore drill
48. Hiring trigger review
49. Data room index (deferred)
50. Quarterly scorecard and plan refresh

Strategy

The competitive plan, moats, AI differentiation, ecosystem, implementation and outcome-proof programs.

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docs/strategy/README.md

docs/strategy

Become the platform hardest to leave because it makes education clearer for students, more effective for educators, safer for institutions, more open for partners and more reliable for everyone.

- SEMESTER_COMPETITIVE_COMPLETION_AUDIT.md
- SEMESTER_PLATFORM_MATURITY_SCORECARD.md
- SEMESTER_COMPETITIVE_MOAT_PLAN.md
- SEMESTER_GLOBAL_PLATFORM_ROADMAP.md
- SEMESTER_OUTCOME_PROOF_PROGRAM.md
- SEMESTER_IMPLEMENTATION_FACTORY.md
- SEMESTER_MIGRATION_FACTORY.md
- SEMESTER_ECOSYSTEM_AND_MARKETPLACE_PLAN.md
- SEMESTER_MOBILE_EXCELLENCE_PLAN.md
- SEMESTER_AI_DIFFERENTIATION_PLAN.md
- SEMESTER_TRUST_ADVANTAGE_PLAN.md
- SEMESTER_36_MONTH_COMPETITIVE_PLAN.md

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docs/strategy/SEMESTER_36_MONTH_COMPETITIVE_PLAN.md

36-month competitive plan

Semester strategy · 2026-10-05 · Source: uploads/anything else to finish semester and make it the m.pdf. Design-stage evidence only; scores rise with repo, test and release evidence.

> Semester wins when students prefer it daily, institutions trust it operationally, and partners prefer building on it.

0–6 months · Prove the pilot

- Close six launch blockers
- Ship SSO, SIS read sync, Today, registration readiness, governed AI
- Run the Vanderbilt pilot with signed measures
- Monitoring, runbooks, restore drill live

6–12 months · Convert and repeat

- Results report and case study
- Annual conversion
- Pilots #2–#3 via the implementation factory
- First engineer and implementation lead

12–24 months · Become the operating layer

- Course Studio, advising, registrar desk in production
- Migration factory runs first real domain migration
- SOC 2 readiness; pen test
- Public API beta and first certified partner

24–36 months · Platform and ecosystem

- Marketplace with governed installs
- Multi-campus and system offices
- First non-US or K–12 model
- Published outcome research

Growth loop

Pilot → student activation → measured outcomes → annual conversion → expansion → reference → new pipeline → partner interest → ecosystem.

Acquisition engines

Engine	Goal
Institutional sales	Paid pilots, annual contracts
Student adoption	Daily use, internal proof
Faculty/advisor champions	Trusted workflow adoption
Campus ambassadors	Peer activation
SEO/resources	Inbound demand
Content/webinars	Category authority
Partnerships	Borrowed trust
Developers/marketplace	Ecosystem distribution

Engine	Goal
Alumni/employers	Career network value
References	Enterprise credibility

Repeatability

Sell → contract → implement → support → measure → renew → expand → migrate → govern → improve, without founder memory or heroics.

Budget, team, partners, trust

Budget: docs/run/Finance Model.html. Team: docs/run/Hiring Plan.html and docs/business/people/. Partners: SIS, LMS, IdP, AI provider first. Trust: SEMESTER_TRUST_ADVANTAGE_PLAN.md.

Exact next 50 actions

1. Bind cyber + E&O insurance
2. Get counsel review of MSA, DPA, order form
3. Sign the DPA/FERPA addendum
4. Submit HECVAT Full
5. Name Vanderbilt IT, registrar and sponsor contacts
6. Sign the success-measures sheet and baseline
7. Run stream 00 (repo audit, toolkit, CI)
8. Approve the design-system baseline
9. Run stream 01 (migrations, RLS tests)
10. Prove every RLS policy red-then-green
11. Install semester-core and pass its tests
12. Set up staging Supabase + Vercel projects
13. Configure staging SAML with the test IdP
14. Map IdP attributes to pilot roles
15. Build the SIS read connector for the pilot extract
16. Build the reconciliation report
17. Reach 0 unexplained mismatches on staging data
18. Ship Today with source labels
19. Ship registration readiness and hold hand-off
20. Ship sharing with advisor and revoke
21. Ship the AI gateway with course policy
22. Write and pass the red-team suite
23. Ship advisor caseload (consented shares)

24. Ship registrar desk read views
25. Ship institution console: roles, cohorts, kill switch, audit
26. Wire error tracking and uptime checks
27. Wire SSO-failure and SIS-lag alerts
28. Time a restore drill
29. Run axe in CI on pilot routes
30. Manual screen-reader pass on pilot paths
31. Draft the ACR
32. Run a 5-student usability test of Today
33. Fix the top 5 usability findings
34. Staff training for advisors and registrar
35. Dry run with test accounts
36. Final go/no-go with the sponsor
37. Production cutover C1–C11
38. Launch to the pilot cohort
39. Run day-1 and week-1 support
40. Week-1 review with the sponsor
41. Midpoint review and case-study permission
42. Build the 40-account target list
43. Book 10 discovery calls
44. Publish pilot, pricing and trust pages
45. Extend finance model to 36 months
46. Results report at end of term
47. Annual conversion proposal
48. Hire the founding engineer on trigger
49. Start pilot #2 through the implementation factory
50. Publish the case study

`docs/strategy/SEMESTER_AI_DIFFERENTIATION_PLAN.md`

AI differentiation plan

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Safer and more useful than general chat, not just more conversational.

Every answer can show

- Context used

- Sources
- Policy applied
- Model/provider selected
- Uncertainty
- Official versus guidance
- Action the user can take
- When a human should be involved

AI trust UI

Answer · source citations · institution/course policy · context used · confidence and limits · suggested next actions · ask an advisor/instructor/office · give feedback · report a problem.

Deterministic policy engine

Prerequisites, co-requisites, credit limits, registration windows, holds, degree requirements, residency, transfer equivalencies, academic standing, grade rules, regrade policy, graduation, payment-plan eligibility, feature/role/consent eligibility, retention, AI policy. **The AI can explain a rule. The policy engine decides it.**

`docs/strategy/SEMESTER_COMPETITIVE_COMPLETION_AUDIT.md`

Competitive completion audit

Semester strategy · 2026-10-05 · Source: uploads/anything else to finish semester and make it the m.pdf. Design-stage evidence only; scores rise with repo, test and release evidence.

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The decisive advantage is not more features. It is being the easiest to adopt, safest to operate, clearest to use, fastest to implement and most credible to buy.

Core loop

Identity → Path → Action → Learning → Support → Evidence → Progress → Opportunity. Every feature must strengthen at least one node.

Coherence test (release gate for any new feature)

- Who uses it?
- What problem does it solve?

- What source is authoritative?
- What data does it need?
- What action does it create or complete?
- What policy governs it?
- How does it connect to Path, Action Center, Support and Career?
- What happens when it fails?
- What happens when data is stale?
- How is it supported?
- How is it measured?
- How is it rolled back? If the answers are unclear, the feature is not ready.

Audit by area

Area	Current evidence	Benchmark (5)	Customer impact	Priority	Required capability	Test / metric
Daily student experience	ui_kits/student, every-screen, templates/platform-shell	Beats email+LMS+calendar+portal+AI chat combined	Daily return, action completion	P0	Today, Action Center, return loop	Usability test 5 students; first action ≥70%
Product coherence	One design system, 673 screens, one shell	One intuitive system	Fewer dead ends	P0	Coherence test on every feature (below)	Release checklist enforces it
Mobile/native quality	ui_kits/mobile (tab bar)	Native-feeling, reliable	Students judge on phone	P0	Fast shell, offline-safe workspace, deep links, quick capture, low-bandwidth	Lighthouse mobile, offline sync tests
Course Studio and learning	Partly designed (staff kit)	Connected learning environment	Faculty adoption	P1	Course Studio, LTI to LMS	Faculty workflow e2e
Academic records / registrar	Registrar desk designed; SIS stays official	Deterministic, auditable workflows	Correctness	P0	Policy engine for prerequisites, holds, credit limits, windows	Rule tests per policy
Governed AI	Gateway logic + AIResponse	Policy-bound, source-aware	Safety + usefulness	P0	AI trust UI: context, sources, policy, model, uncertainty, action, human	Red-team suite
Institutional trust	Trust Center page, policies, contracts	Evidence-backed procurement	Shorter procurement	P0	Procurement room, HECVAT Lite + Full, questionnaire library, AI provider registry	Reviewer can answer 10 questions unaided
Security/privacy/accessibility	Policies, test plans	Continuous controls	Risk	P0	Evidence register, VDP, ACR	Controls with evidence
Integration factory	Designed workflow	Repeatable interoperability	Implementation speed	P0	LTI wizard, OneRoster import, SSO/SCIM guide, test harness	Connector certification
Migration factory	Designed workflow + cutover	Reusable migration product	Replacement confidence	P1	Mapping studio, reconciliation, rollback automation	0 unexplained mismatches
Reliability/SLO/incidents	Handbook + runbooks	SLO-driven ops	Uptime	P0	Monitoring, status page, alerts	Restore drill time
Implementation and CS	Runbook, support plan	Repeatable implementation	Weeks not months	P0	Implementation factory: questionnaire, tenant templates, role bundles, launch kit	Days signature-to-launch

Area	Current evidence	Benchmark (5)	Customer impact	Priority	Required capability	Test / metric
GTM and pilot conversion	GTM plan, price book	Predictable conversion	Revenue	P1	Pipeline, MAP, results report	Pilot-to-annual
Finance and unit economics	Finance model	Predictable economics	Survival	P1	36-month model, AI cost per workflow	Gross margin
Developer platform/marketplace	Designed workflow	Documented APIs, partners	Ecosystem	P3	API standard, sandbox, certification	Certified apps
Global readiness	US assumptions	Configurable international	Expansion	P3	i18n, calendars, grading, residency	Strings externalized
Research and outcome proof	Results template	Verified evidence	Credibility	P1	Measurement protocol, evidence register	Measures met
Brand and category authority	Brand system, site	Recognized infrastructure brand	Trust	P2	Case study, research, transparent status	References
Company operations	docs/business, /ops	Systems not heroics	Repeatability	P1	Operating cadence, decision log	Cadence held
Organizational maturity	Solo founder	Owners, cadence, resilience	Continuity	P1	Key-person plan, revenue-triggered hires	Owners per function

Top 25 gaps

1. Insurance not bound
2. DPA not signed
3. HECVAT not submitted
4. No ACR
5. No production code for pilot paths
6. RLS untested
7. No monitoring
8. SIS connector not built
9. No reconciliation run
10. AI red-team not run
11. No mobile build
12. No implementation factory assets
13. No procurement room
14. No status page
15. No policy engine
16. No usability test
17. Measures not signed
18. No case study
19. No 36-month model

20. Founder single point of failure
21. No KB/help center
22. No event taxonomy
23. No API standard implemented
24. US-only data model
25. No decision log

What not to do

- Build everything as a separate module
- Make every dashboard dense
- Hide complex policy behind AI
- Collect data just in case
- Make high-impact recommendations opaque
- Overpromise replacement before migration proof
- Make configuration need custom engineering
- Let tenants fork the product
- Use student data for advertising or surveillance
- Let compliance become static PDFs
- Ship without support, monitoring and rollback
- Depend on one AI provider
- Build a closed ecosystem without export
- Scale paid acquisition before pilot conversion works
- Pursue every segment at once

`docs/strategy/SEMESTER_COMPETITIVE_MOAT_PLAN.md`

Competitive moat plan

Semester strategy · 2026-10-05 · Source: uploads/anything else to finish semester and make it the m.pdf. Design-stage evidence only; scores rise with repo, test and release evidence.

> Semester wins when students prefer it daily, institutions trust it operationally, and partners prefer building on it.

Top 25 moats

1. Daily student workspace students prefer over their tool stack
2. Source authority and freshness on every fact
3. Education graph of relationships, not just records
4. Governed AI that is course-, policy- and source-aware

5. Zero student records to AI providers, proven by tests
6. Migration factory that makes replacement safer than staying
7. Reconciliation engine with rollback on every domain
8. Consent and sharing model students trust
9. Tenant isolation proven per table in CI
10. Trust Center with evidence, not claims
11. One design system across product, site and ops
12. Implementation factory: signature to launch in weeks
13. Pilot-to-annual playbook with signed measures
14. Outcome evidence from real cohorts
15. Interoperability with LTI, OneRoster, Edu-API, SIS adapters
16. Developer platform with certification and scoped installs
17. Marketplace governed by the same consent model
18. Company runs on Semester: nobody leaves the product
19. Accessibility as a product feature, not a checkbox
20. Long institutional relationships through renewal evidence
21. Deterministic policy engine: the AI explains a rule, the engine decides it
22. Implementation in weeks, not years
23. Procurement reviewer self-service (no chasing the team)
24. Mobile-first daily loop
25. Hardest to leave because it makes education clearer

`docs/strategy/SEMESTER_ECOSYSTEM_AND_MARKETPLACE_PLAN.md`

Ecosystem and marketplace

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> Semester wins when students prefer it daily, institutions trust it operationally, and partners prefer building on it.

- Developer portal, API standards (docs/platform/API_CONTRACT_STANDARD.md)
- OAuth/OIDC, service accounts, webhooks, event subscriptions, SDKs
- Sandbox tenants and test data
- Integration certification
- Marketplace, partner directory, tenant install approval, data-scope review
- Revenue sharing (12% planning), versioning/deprecation, partner support and incidents

Flywheel: more institutions → partner demand → integrations → platform value → institutional demand. Post-pilot priority (P3 now).

`docs/strategy/SEMESTER_GLOBAL_PLATFORM_ROADMAP.md`

Global platform roadmap

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> Semester wins when students prefer it daily, institutions trust it operationally, and partners prefer building on it.

- Internationalization, localization, RTL
- Time zones, academic calendars, term structures
- Currency/tax abstraction, regional payments
- Regional data residency, hosting, subprocessors
- Regional privacy and accessibility law
- Local identity systems
- Different credential and grading models
- Government reporting requirements
- Local support and implementation

Do not hardcode US higher-ed assumptions into the education graph. See docs/platform/GLOBAL_EXPANSION_ARCHITECTURE.md.

`docs/strategy/SEMESTER_IMPLEMENTATION_FACTORY.md`

Implementation factory

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> Semester wins when students prefer it daily, institutions trust it operationally, and partners prefer building on it.

Sales hand-off → tenant template → SSO → roster/data mapping → policy configuration → admin training → user communication → controlled launch → adoption monitoring → pilot review → annual conversion.

Accelerators

- Institution onboarding questionnaire
- Tenant templates by segment
- Prebuilt policies and role bundles
- Course/program mapping templates
- LTI setup wizard
- OneRoster import wizard
- SSO/SCIM setup guide
- Integration test harness
- Data mapping studio

- Reconciliation dashboard
- Admin training academy
- Launch communications generator
- Pilot dashboard
- Implementation checklist and go-live gate
- Common support playbooks
- Rollback and offboarding automation

Promise: powerful enough for a university, straightforward enough to launch a useful workflow in weeks, not years.

Existing: docs/launch/ (runbook, cutover, support), templates/role-onboarding/, workflow runner (Institution implementation).

`docs/strategy/SEMESTER_MIGRATION_FACTORY.md`

Migration factory

Semester strategy · 2026-10-05 · Source: uploads/anything else to finish semester and make it the m.pdf. Design-stage evidence only; scores rise with repo, test and release evidence.

> Semester wins when students prefer it daily, institutions trust it operationally, and partners prefer building on it.

See docs/platform/INTEGRATION_AND_MIGRATION_FACTORY.md and the 17-step Domain migration workflow in ui_kits/workflow-runner. Replacement only with reconciliation evidence and institutional approval.

`docs/strategy/SEMESTER_MOBILE_EXCELLENCE_PLAN.md`

Mobile excellence plan

Semester strategy · 2026-10-05 · Source: uploads/anything else to finish semester and make it the m.pdf. Design-stage evidence only; scores rise with repo, test and release evidence.

> Semester wins when students prefer it daily, institutions trust it operationally, and partners prefer building on it.

- Fast mobile shell
- Offline-safe student-owned workspace
- Push notifications with explicit preference controls
- Deep links from email, calendar, QR codes, announcements
- Native-feeling gestures, never gesture-only critical functions
- Mobile-first Action Center
- Quick capture: tasks, notes, assignments, photos/documents where permitted
- Fast course/resource access; campus QR flows
- Location only with explicit opt-in and clear benefit
- Low-bandwidth and reduced-data modes
- Accessible mobile controls

- Minimum safe offline data; clear sync state and conflict recovery

Never cache on device unnecessarily: official grades, financial records, sensitive support details, secrets, privileged institutional data.

`docs/strategy/SEMESTER_OUTCOME_PROOF_PROGRAM.md`

Outcome proof program

Semester strategy · 2026-10-05 · Source: uploads/anything else to finish semester and make it the m.pdf. Design-stage evidence only; scores rise with repo, test and release evidence.

> Semester wins when students prefer it daily, institutions trust it operationally, and partners prefer building on it.

Build

- Outcome metric catalog
- Research governance
- Baseline methodology and cohort definition
- Pilot measurement protocol
- Experiment registry and survey system
- Student confidence, action-completion and support-friction measures
- Faculty workload and implementation measures
- Case-study approval workflow
- Research partnership program
- Whitepaper pipeline
- Customer evidence register

Proof hierarchy

Product usage → workflow completion → student-reported clarity → staff efficiency → pilot outcome → annual conversion → expansion → independent research → sector authority.

Do not jump from a few happy quotes to broad outcome claims.

`docs/strategy/SEMESTER_PLATFORM_MATURITY_SCORECARD.md`

Competitive scorecard (quarterly)

Semester strategy · 2026-10-05 · Source: uploads/anything else to finish semester and make it the m.pdf. Design-stage evidence only; scores rise with repo, test and release evidence.

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Dimension	0 means	5 means	Now
Student daily value	Rarely useful	Preferred daily education workspace	2
Product coherence	Disconnected modules	One intuitive system	2
Mobile quality	Desktop port	Native-feeling, reliable mobile	1
Learning quality	Content container	Connected learning with evidence	1
AI quality	Generic chat wrapper	Policy-bound, source-aware intelligence	2
Academic authority	Informal planning	Deterministic, auditable official workflows	1
Institutional trust	Marketing claims	Evidence-backed procurement readiness	1
Security/privacy	Reactive	Continuous controls and governance	1
Accessibility	Patchwork	Embedded design/release discipline	2
Integration	One-off integrations	Repeatable interoperability factory	1
Migration	Manual project work	Reusable migration product	1
Reliability	Best effort	SLO-driven, incident-ready	1
Customer success	Reactive support	Repeatable implementation and renewal	1
Commercial maturity	Ad hoc pricing	Predictable unit economics and deal governance	2
Developer ecosystem	Closed product	Documented APIs, marketplace, partners	0
Global readiness	Local assumptions	Configurable international architecture	0
Outcome proof	Anecdotes	Verified measurable evidence	1
Brand trust	Unknown	Recognized education infrastructure brand	1
Organizational maturity	Founder heroics	Owners, cadence, systems, resilience	1

Average now: 1.16 / 5. Detailed 24-dimension scorecard: docs/platform/PLATFORM_READINESS_SCORECARD.md.

`docs/strategy/SEMESTER_TRUST_ADVANTAGE_PLAN.md`

Trust advantage plan

Semester strategy · 2026-10-05 · Source: uploads/anything else to finish semester and make it the m.pdf. Design-stage evidence only; scores rise with repo, test and release evidence.

> Semester wins when students prefer it daily, institutions trust it operationally, and partners prefer building on it.

Build

- Public Trust Center (ui_kits/company-site #/trust)
- Controlled procurement room
- HECVAT Lite readiness and Full evidence roadmap

- Security questionnaire library
- Data-flow and architecture diagrams (ui_kits/architecture)
- Subprocessor and AI provider registries
- Accessibility roadmap and statement
- DPA workflow, SLA/support policy
- Status page and incident communication policy
- Vulnerability disclosure program
- Data export/deletion and tenant offboarding processes

A procurement reviewer answers unaided

- What data does Semester use, and not collect?
- Where does data go?
- Which AI providers receive what data?
- How are roles and permissions controlled?
- How can we turn off a feature?
- What happens in an incident?
- How does data leave Semester?
- How is accessibility supported?
- How do we migrate or offboard?

How to run Semester

Everything the company does — business, sales, marketing, product, engineering, security, success, support and people — with owners, cadence and the evidence that shows it is done. A planning document, not legal, tax or financial advice.

1. What Semester is, in one paragraph

Semester is the student action platform: one daily workspace that turns a student's semester into the next clear step, with the source of every fact shown beside it. It works alongside a school's official systems, sells to universities through paid one-term pilots, and keeps student records out of AI providers. Today it is a solo-founder LLC, bootstrapping, with one paid university pilot signed.

2. The operating system on one page

FUNCTION	OWNER NOW	WEEKLY OUTPUT	LIVES IN
Company & legal	Founder + counsel	Open legal items reviewed	Business workspace → Launch checklist
Finance	Founder + accountant	Cash, burn, invoices	Bookkeeping system + 12-month model
Sales	Founder	Pipeline review, next steps per account	CRM (any) + Go-to-market tab
Marketing	Founder	One proof-backed piece shipped	Company site + claims register
Product	Founder	Prioritised backlog, one decision logged	DECISIONS.md, Atlas, Role lens
Engineering	Founder + contractors	Shipped PRs, green gate list	GitHub, CI, CLAUDE.md
Security & privacy	Founder	Access review, alerts triaged	Evidence register, Trust Center
Customer success	Founder	Pilot KPIs, check-in notes	Pilot checklist, mutual action plan
Support	Founder	Tickets closed, SLA met	Support queue (console)
People	Founder	Contractor capacity vs. plan	Hiring plan

3. Weekly operating cadence

DAY	RITUAL	TIME	OUTPUT
Monday	Plan the week: top 3 company outcomes	45 min	Written in DECISIONS.md / notes
Monday	Pipeline + pilot KPI review	30 min	Next step and date per account
Wednesday	Engineering review: shipped, blocked, risks	30 min	Updated backlog
Thursday	Pilot check-in with champion	30 min	Notes + actions
Friday	Metrics, cash, risk register	45 min	One-page weekly brief
Monthly	Close books, access review, claims review	2 h	P&L, access log, approved claims
Quarterly	Strategy + roadmap reset, tabletop exercise	Half day	New 90-day plan, IR record

4. Business: legal, finance, insurance

ITEM	DO	EVIDENCE
Entity	Keep the LLC; plan the Delaware C-corp conversion before any priced round	Counsel memo
IP	Company owns everything; founder + contractor assignments on file	Signed assignments
Tax + banking	EIN, state registrations, business bank, approval rules	Registrations, bank account
Bookkeeping	Monthly close checklist, expense policy, tax calendar	Monthly P&L, balance sheet, cash flow
Model	36-month driver model: pilots → annual, cost per active user, runway	Spreadsheet with scenarios
Pricing	Pilot quoted; platform $18 / enrolled student / yr, $30k floor (planning)	Approved price book + discount rules
Insurance	Cyber + E&O before real student records; general liability	Certificates sent to the university
Contracts	MSA, order form, DPA/FERPA addendum, SLA, NDA	Versioned, counsel-reviewed templates

5. Sales: from target to annual contract

STAGE	EXIT CRITERIA	KPI
Target	Tier-1 list, named champion	Accounts researched
Discovery	Pain, owner, budget, timeline confirmed	Qualification rate
Demo	Champion agrees success metrics	Demo → design rate
Pilot design	Scope, data, integrations signed off	Design → proposal
Security/legal	HECVAT, DPA, VPAT path agreed	Days in review
Proposal	Mutual action plan with decision date	Proposal → signature
Pilot	Activation + weekly KPIs	KPI attainment
Conversion	Results deck → annual order form	Pilot → annual rate
Expansion	New department or cohort; reference	Net revenue retention

6. Marketing: what to say and how to prove it

ASSET	PURPOSE	RULE
Company site	Home, Pilot, Pricing, Trust, Company	Status map: use now / in a pilot / later
Pilot one-pager + institution deck	Book design sessions	Scope + what stays official
Trust Center	Answer security and accessibility first	Status, never certifications not held
Case study (after pilot)	Prove outcomes	Measured baseline, method, sponsor approval
Founder posts / talks	Category voice	Claims register before publishing
Email list	Institution leaders only	Opt-in, one-click unsubscribe
Voice	Plain, specific, calm	Say “AI-assisted, source-linked”; never “revolutionise”, “guaranteed”, “compliant”
FTC	Testimonials, endorsements, statistics	Consent, disclosure, evidence for every claim

7. Product

PRACTICE	HOW
North star	Students who complete their next action each week
Spine	Five destinations: Today · My Path · Search · Plan · Me; seven areas, 64 screens
Trust	Every fact labelled official / connected / yours / AI-assisted
Decisions	One decision per PR, numbered, in DECISIONS.md
Discovery	Weekly: one student and one staff conversation
Roadmap	Pilot obligations first, then what moves the conversion metric
Design system	This project: tokens, 49 components, templates; never raw values

8. Engineering

AREA	STANDARD
Stack	Vite + React (app), Next.js + Supabase (workflow lab), Vercel hosting
Gate	npx tsc -b · npm run lint · npm test · npm run build · design-system:check
Data	Postgres + RLS per tenant; migrations reviewed; no service key in the browser
Integrations	LTI 1.3, OneRoster, SIS read; SAML / Shibboleth SSO
Read models	Outbox → projections with version + freshness; capability-checked RPCs
AI	Gateway: scope, policy, routing, citations, logs; student records never sent
Quality	Contract tests for tokens, contrast, targets, motion; revert-to-red proof
Release	Feature flags per tenant, staged rollout, rollback plan
Observability	Error + uptime monitoring, audit log, alert runbook

9. Security, privacy and accessibility

CONTROL	MINIMUM BEFORE LAUNCH
Identity	MFA on admin, code, cloud, finance, CRM, support, production
Access	Least privilege, quarterly review, contractor offboarding
Data	Encryption in transit/at rest, backups, tested restore with RTO/RPO
Vendors	Subprocessor list (Vercel, Supabase), vendor register
Incidents	IR plan, tabletop, breach notification path per DPA
Procurement	HECVAT Full, answer library, DPA/SLA path
Accessibility	WCAG 2.2 AA target, ACR/VPAT, manual test protocol, statement

10. Customer success and support

PRACTICE	STANDARD
Onboarding	Admin setup, SSO, invitations, baseline recorded
Severity	P0 outage · P1 data issue · P2 degraded · P3 question
Response	P0 1 h · P1 4 h · P2 1 business day · P3 2 business days (pilot target)
Cadence	Weekly KPI check-in; mid-pilot review; results review before decision date

PRACTICE	STANDARD
Feedback	Tagged, linked to backlog, answered

11. People

WHEN	ROLE	TRIGGER
Now	Fractional counsel, insurance broker, bookkeeper	Pilot obligations
After pilot launch	Implementation / support contractor	Support > founder capacity
After 2nd paid customer	First full-time engineer	Two institutions live
After 3–5 customers	Founding sales / CS hire	Pipeline > founder capacity

12. Company scorecard

METRIC	WHY
Cash + runway (months)	Survival
Pilot KPI attainment	Conversion readiness
Pilot → annual conversion	Commercial proof
Qualified pipeline (accounts)	Next customers
Weekly active students + next-action completion	Product value
P0/P1 incidents, SLA met	Trust
Open P0 launch items	Readiness

13. Path to a real company

STAGE	DONE WHEN
Now → launch	Six pilot blockers closed: insurance ×2, DPA mapping, HECVAT, SSO, VPAT
Pilot running	Weekly KPIs, onboarding live, support SLA met
First renewal	Results deck, annual order form signed
Repeatable	2–3 institutions; price book; references
Raise or keep bootstrapping	Decide with pilot results; convert to C-corp if raising
Team	First engineer, then sales/CS; operating cadence unchanged

What to finish before real student records arrive

Prepared for the founder, team, counsel/accountant, institution buyers and investors. Status is inferred from repository documents where evidence exists and from founder answers otherwise; “Not confirmed — verify” marks items neither could confirm. This is a planning document, not legal or financial advice — have counsel, an accountant and an insurance broker review the items they own.

1. Situation

FACT	VALUE
entity	LLC (home state)
stage	Pre-seed, no revenue, bootstrapping
team	Solo founder; contractors with signed IP assignments
pilot	Paid university pilot signed — DPA/FERPA addendum, HECVAT Full, VPAT/ACR, SAML SSO, cyber + E&O insurance required; real student records; dates not decided
hosting	Vercel + Supabase; AI never sees student records
budget	$5k–$20k setup budget

Six launch blockers. The signed paid pilot requires cyber + E&O insurance, a DPA/FERPA mapping, HECVAT Full, SAML SSO and a VPAT/ACR before real student records arrive. 23 P0 items remain open in total. Pilot start and renewal-decision dates are not set — agree them in a mutual action plan first.

2. Gap analysis — open P0 items

AREA	GAP	BLOCKS	STATUS	EVIDENCE
Formation	EIN, state/local tax registrations	Before invoicing the pilot	Not started	Not confirmed — verify
Formation	Dedicated business bank + payments account	Before pilot invoice	Not started	Not confirmed — verify
Insurance	Cyber liability	Pilot contract requires it	Not started	Required by pilot; not held

AREA	GAP	BLOCKS	STATUS	EVIDENCE
Insurance	Professional / E&O	Pilot contract requires it	Not started	Required by pilot; not held
Contracts	Data Processing Addendum / FERPA addendum	Before real student records	In review	Pilot has DPA/FERPA addendum — confirm obligations mapped
Privacy	Privacy Policy + Terms of Service	Before student sign-in	Draft	docs/legal-drafts/
Privacy	Subprocessor list (Vercel, Supabase, AI provider)	DPA requires it	Not started	Hosting: Vercel + Supabase
Privacy	Data inventory + data-flow map (student records)	Before real data	In progress	database/DATA_CLASSIFICATION_REGISTER.md
Privacy	Retention + deletion schedule	DPA / HECVAT	Not started	—
Privacy	AI boundary: student records never reach an AI provider — enforce + document	HECVAT, DPA	In progress	Policy decided; needs a test + doc
Security	HECVAT Full completed	University security review	Not started	Required by pilot
Security	University SSO (SAML / Shibboleth)	Pilot launch	Not started	Required by pilot
Security	Access-control + least-privilege policy	HECVAT	In progress	database/TENANT_ISOLATION_MATRIX.md, RLS
Security	Incident response plan + tabletop	HECVAT	Draft	docs/INCIDENT-RECOVERY-PLAYBOOK.md
Security	Backup + disaster-recovery runbook (tested)	HECVAT	Draft	docs/sre/
Accessibility	VPAT / ACR (WCAG 2.1 AA)	Pilot contract requires it	Not started	a11y tests exist; no ACR
Finance	Bookkeeping + accounting system	Before pilot invoice	Not started	—
Finance	Pilot invoice + revenue recognition	Pilot start	Not started	Paid pilot
Sales	Pilot success plan + baseline metrics	Pilot start	Not started	Pilot dates not decided

AREA	GAP	BLOCKS	STATUS	EVIDENCE
Sales	Mutual action plan with named decision date	Pilot start	Not started	Renewal date not decided
Customer success	Onboarding plan for pilot users	Pilot start	Not started	—
Customer success	Support intake, severity levels, response times	Pilot start	Not started	—
Customer success	Weekly pilot check-in + KPI review	Pilot start	Not started	—

3. Master checklist

Formation

#	ITEM	OWNER	PRI	STATUS	LAUNCH GATE
1	LLC formed in home state, operating agreement signed	Founder	P0	Done	Before any contract
2	EIN, state/local tax registrations	Founder + accountant	P0	Not started	Before invoicing the pilot
3	Dedicated business bank + payments account	Founder	P0	Not started	Before pilot invoice
4	Corporate records folder + contract repository	Founder	P1	Not started	Before diligence
5	Cap table (single-member LLC; record any promised equity)	Founder	P1	Not started	Before advisors/hires
6	IP assignment from founder + every contractor	Founder + counsel	P0	Done	Before code ships to customer
7	Trademark / name clearance for “Semester”	Counsel	P1	Not started	Before public launch
8	Decision: convert LLC → Delaware C-corp	Founder + counsel	P2	Deferred	Before priced equity round

Insurance

#	ITEM	OWNER	PRI	STATUS	LAUNCH GATE
9	Cyber liability	Founder + broker	P0	Not started	Pilot contract requires it
10	Professional / E&O	Founder + broker	P0	Not started	Pilot contract requires it
11	General liability	Founder + broker	P1	Not started	Campus presence

Contracts

#	ITEM	OWNER	PRI	STATUS	LAUNCH GATE
12	Pilot agreement (signed)	Founder	P0	Done	—
13	Data Processing Addendum / FERPA addendum	Counsel	P0	In review	Before real student records
14	Master Services Agreement + SaaS terms	Counsel	P1	Draft	Before annual conversion
15	Order form + SOW template	Founder	P1	Not started	Annual proposal
16	Service Level Agreement / support policy	Founder	P1	Draft	Annual conversion
17	Mutual NDA	Counsel	P2	Not started	New prospects

Privacy

#	ITEM	OWNER	PRI	STATUS	LAUNCH GATE
18	Privacy Policy + Terms of Service	Counsel	P0	Draft	Before student sign-in
19	Subprocessor list (Vercel, Supabase, AI provider)	Founder	P0	Not started	DPA requires it
20	Data inventory + data-flow map (student records)	Founder	P0	In progress	Before real data
21	Retention + deletion schedule	Founder	P0	Not started	DPA / HECVAT
22	AI boundary: student records never reach an AI provider — enforce + document	Founder	P0	In progress	HECVAT, DPA

Security

#	ITEM	OWNER	PRI	STATUS	LAUNCH GATE
23	HECVAT Full completed	Founder	P0	Not started	University security review
24	Security questionnaire answer library	Founder	P1	Not started	HECVAT, RFPs
25	University SSO (SAML / Shibboleth)	Engineering	P0	Not started	Pilot launch
26	Access-control + least-privilege policy	Founder	P0	In progress	HECVAT
27	Incident response plan + tabletop	Founder	P0	Draft	HECVAT
28	Backup + disaster-recovery runbook (tested)	Engineering	P0	Draft	HECVAT
29	Vulnerability management + dependency scanning	Engineering	P1	In progress	HECVAT
30	Logging + monitoring policy	Engineering	P1	In progress	HECVAT
31	Evidence register mapped to controls	Founder	P1	In progress	HECVAT
32	Penetration-test plan	Founder	P2	Not started	After first renewal
33	Trust Center page (verified controls only)	Founder	P1	Not started	Procurement

Accessibility

#	ITEM	OWNER	PRI	STATUS	LAUNCH GATE
34	VPAT / ACR (WCAG 2.1 AA)	Founder	P0	Not started	Pilot contract requires it
35	Accessibility statement + feedback route	Founder	P1	Not started	Public launch

Finance

#	ITEM	OWNER	PRI	STATUS	LAUNCH GATE
36	Bookkeeping + accounting system	Founder + accountant	P0	Not started	Before pilot invoice

#	ITEM	OWNER	PRI	STATUS	LAUNCH GATE
37	Pilot invoice + revenue recognition	Founder	P0	Not started	Pilot start
38	12-month model: burn, runway, scenarios	Founder	P1	Not started	Bootstrapped planning
39	Unit costs: infra + AI cost per active user	Founder	P1	Not started	Pricing
40	Pricing memo: pilot → department → institution	Founder	P1	Draft	Annual proposal

Sales

#	ITEM	OWNER	PRI	STATUS	LAUNCH GATE
41	Ideal customer profile + tier-1 account list	Founder	P1	Not started	Second pilot
42	Discovery + demo scripts by persona	Founder	P1	Not started	Second pilot
43	Pilot success plan + baseline metrics	Founder + champion	P0	Not started	Pilot start
44	Mutual action plan with named decision date	Founder + champion	P0	Not started	Pilot start
45	Results deck + annual conversion proposal	Founder	P1	Not started	Before renewal decision
46	Security/procurement response kit	Founder	P1	Not started	Second pilot

Customer success

#	ITEM	OWNER	PRI	STATUS	LAUNCH GATE
47	Onboarding plan for pilot users	Founder	P0	Not started	Pilot start
48	Support intake, severity levels, response times	Founder	P0	Not started	Pilot start
49	Weekly pilot check-in + KPI review	Founder	P0	Not started	Pilot start
50	QBR / renewal process	Founder	P1	Not started	Mid-pilot

Operations

#	ITEM	OWNER	PRI	STATUS	LAUNCH GATE
51	Weekly operating cadence + decision log	Founder	P1	In progress	Ongoing
52	Risk register (owner, mitigation, review)	Founder	P1	In progress	Ongoing
53	Public claims approval register	Founder	P1	In progress	Any marketing

Hiring

#	ITEM	OWNER	PRI	STATUS	LAUNCH GATE
54	Contractor onboarding/offboarding (access, IP, NDA)	Founder	P1	Not started	Next contractor
55	First hire profile + trigger	Founder	P2	Not started	Second paid customer

Fundraising

#	ITEM	OWNER	PRI	STATUS	LAUNCH GATE
56	Fundraising readiness checklist	Founder	P2	Deferred	When raising

4. 90-day roadmap

Days 1–30 · Make the pilot legal to run

1. Bind cyber + E&O insurance (contract requirement)
2. EIN, state tax registration, business bank, bookkeeping
3. Map every DPA/FERPA obligation to a control and an owner
4. Publish subprocessor list: Vercel, Supabase (+ AI provider, with "no student records" boundary)
5. Data inventory + data-flow map for student records
6. Retention + deletion schedule
7. Test that student records never reach an AI provider; document it

Days 31–60 · Pass the university reviews

1. Complete HECVAT Full from docs/trust + evidence register
2. Ship SAML / Shibboleth SSO with the university IdP
3. VPAT / ACR against WCAG 2.1 AA (use existing a11y tests as evidence)
4. Incident-response tabletop; record it
5. Restore-from-backup test; record RTO/RPO
6. Privacy Policy + Terms reviewed by counsel

Days 61–90 · Launch and prove the pilot

1. Agree pilot start + renewal decision dates in a mutual action plan
2. Baseline the success metrics with the champion
3. Onboarding + support intake with severity levels
4. Weekly check-in and KPI review
5. Draft the results deck and annual conversion proposal

5. Pilot / contract checklist

OBLIGATION	OWNER	STATUS	EVIDENCE
EIN, state/local tax registrations	Founder + accountant	Not started	Not confirmed — verify
Dedicated business bank + payments account	Founder	Not started	Not confirmed — verify
Cyber liability	Founder + broker	Not started	Required by pilot; not held
Professional / E&O	Founder + broker	Not started	Required by pilot; not held

OBLIGATION	OWNER	STATUS	EVIDENCE
Pilot agreement (signed)	Founder	Done	Paid pilot signed
Data Processing Addendum / FERPA addendum	Counsel	In review	Pilot has DPA/FERPA addendum — confirm obligations mapped
Privacy Policy + Terms of Service	Counsel	Draft	docs/legal-drafts/
Subprocessor list (Vercel, Supabase, AI provider)	Founder	Not started	Hosting: Vercel + Supabase
Data inventory + data-flow map (student records)	Founder	In progress	database/DATA_CLASSIFICATION_REGISTER.md
Retention + deletion schedule	Founder	Not started	—
AI boundary: student records never reach an AI provider — enforce + document	Founder	In progress	Policy decided; needs a test + doc
HECVAT Full completed	Founder	Not started	Required by pilot
Security questionnaire answer library	Founder	Not started	docs/trust/ (66 files) as source
University SSO (SAML / Shibboleth)	Engineering	Not started	Required by pilot
Access-control + least-privilege policy	Founder	In progress	database/TENANT_ISOLATION_MATRIX.md, RLS
Incident response plan + tabletop	Founder	Draft	docs/INCIDENT-RECOVERY-PLAYBOOK.md
Backup + disaster-recovery runbook (tested)	Engineering	Draft	docs/sre/
Vulnerability management + dependency scanning	Engineering	In progress	codeql.yml, supply-chain.yml, hawkscan.yml
Logging + monitoring policy	Engineering	In progress	production-smoke.yml
Evidence register mapped to controls	Founder	In progress	EVIDENCE-REGISTER.md
VPAT / ACR (WCAG 2.1 AA)	Founder	Not started	a11y tests exist; no ACR
Bookkeeping + accounting system	Founder + accountant	Not started	—
Pilot invoice + revenue recognition	Founder	Not started	Paid pilot

OBLIGATION	OWNER	STATUS	EVIDENCE
Pricing memo: pilot → department → institution	Founder	Draft	PUBLIC-CLAIMS register: prices “planned”
Ideal customer profile + tier-1 account list	Founder	Not started	—
Discovery + demo scripts by persona	Founder	Not started	—
Pilot success plan + baseline metrics	Founder + champion	Not started	Pilot dates not decided
Mutual action plan with named decision date	Founder + champion	Not started	Renewal date not decided
Security/procurement response kit	Founder	Not started	—
Onboarding plan for pilot users	Founder	Not started	—
Support intake, severity levels, response times	Founder	Not started	—
Weekly pilot check-in + KPI review	Founder	Not started	—
QBR / renewal process	Founder	Not started	—

6. Risk register

RISK	LIKELIHOOD	IMPACT	MITIGATION	OWNER
Pilot starts without required insurance	High	High	Bind cyber + E&O in days 1–30; send certificate to the university	Founder
HECVAT Full not complete → security review stalls	High	High	Start from docs/trust; answer only verified controls; book a review call	Founder
SAML SSO not ready for launch	Medium	High	Prioritise SSO in days 31–60; test with the university IdP early	Engineering
Student record exposure / breach	Low	Critical	RLS + tenant isolation tests, least privilege, IR plan, AI boundary test	Founder
VPAT gaps found late	Medium	Medium	Run ACR early; fix blockers before launch; disclose known gaps	Founder
No decision date → pilot drifts, no conversion	High	High	Mutual action plan with named economic buyer and decision date	Founder

RISK	LIKELIHOOD	IMPACT	MITIGATION	OWNER
Solo-founder capacity	High	Medium	Use budget for counsel/broker/accountant; contractors with IP + NDA; defer P2	Founder
Claims outrun evidence in marketing	Medium	Medium	Public claims register; no "secure/compliant" without evidence	Founder

7. Hiring plan

WHEN	ROLE	TYPE	TRIGGER
Now	Fractional counsel (DPA, MSA, privacy)	Contract	Pilot obligations
Now	Insurance broker	Contract	Cyber + E&O
Now	Bookkeeper / accountant	Contract	First invoice
After pilot launch	Implementation / support contractor	Contract	Pilot support load > founder capacity
After second paid customer	First full-time engineer	Hire	Two institutions live

8. Fundraising readiness (deferred — bootstrapping)

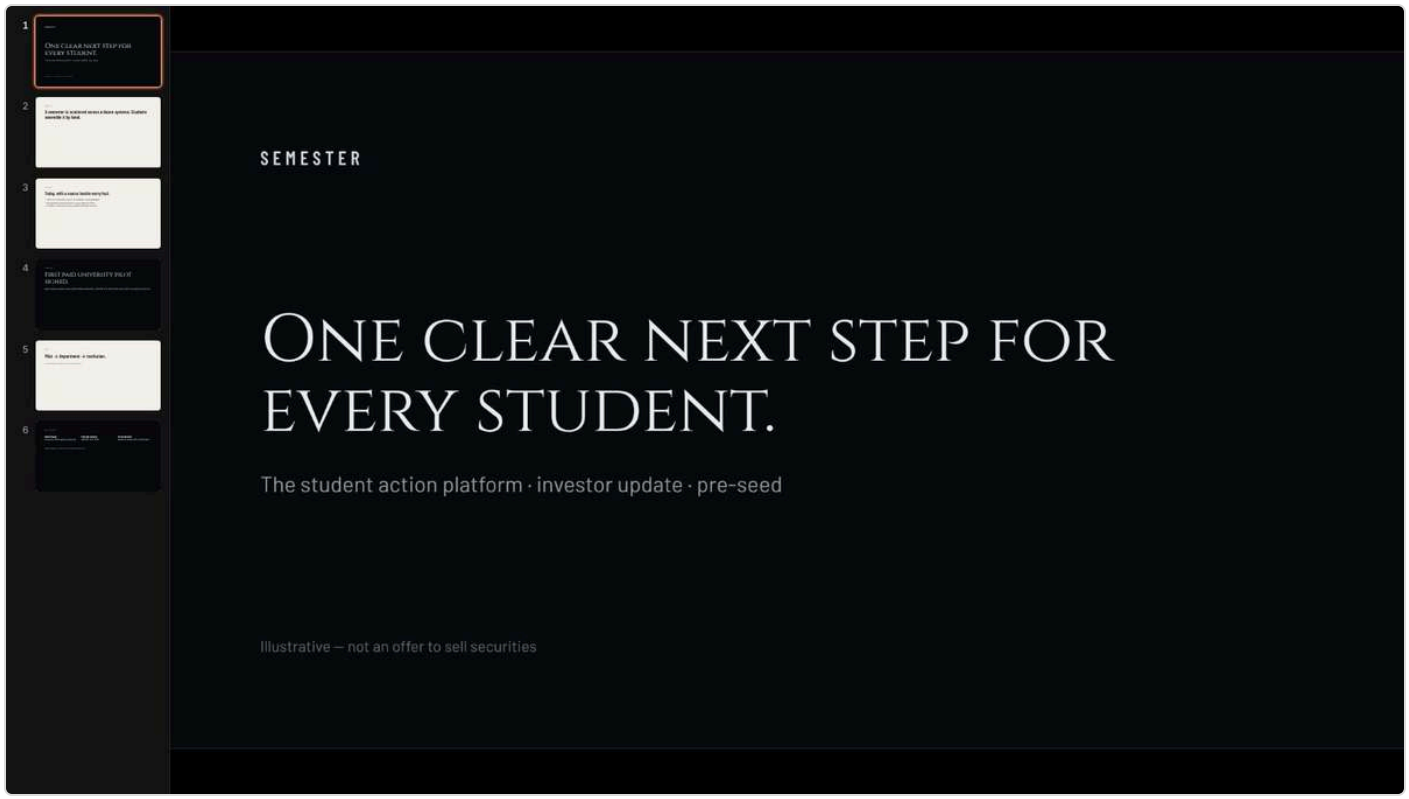
ITEM	STATE
Decide raise vs. bootstrap after pilot results	Deferred
Convert LLC → Delaware C-corp before a priced round	Deferred
Clean cap table + IP chain	Ready (IP signed)
Data room: contracts, security, financials	Not started
Investor deck from pilot results	Draft (this kit)
12-month model with scenarios	Not started

9. What was not covered

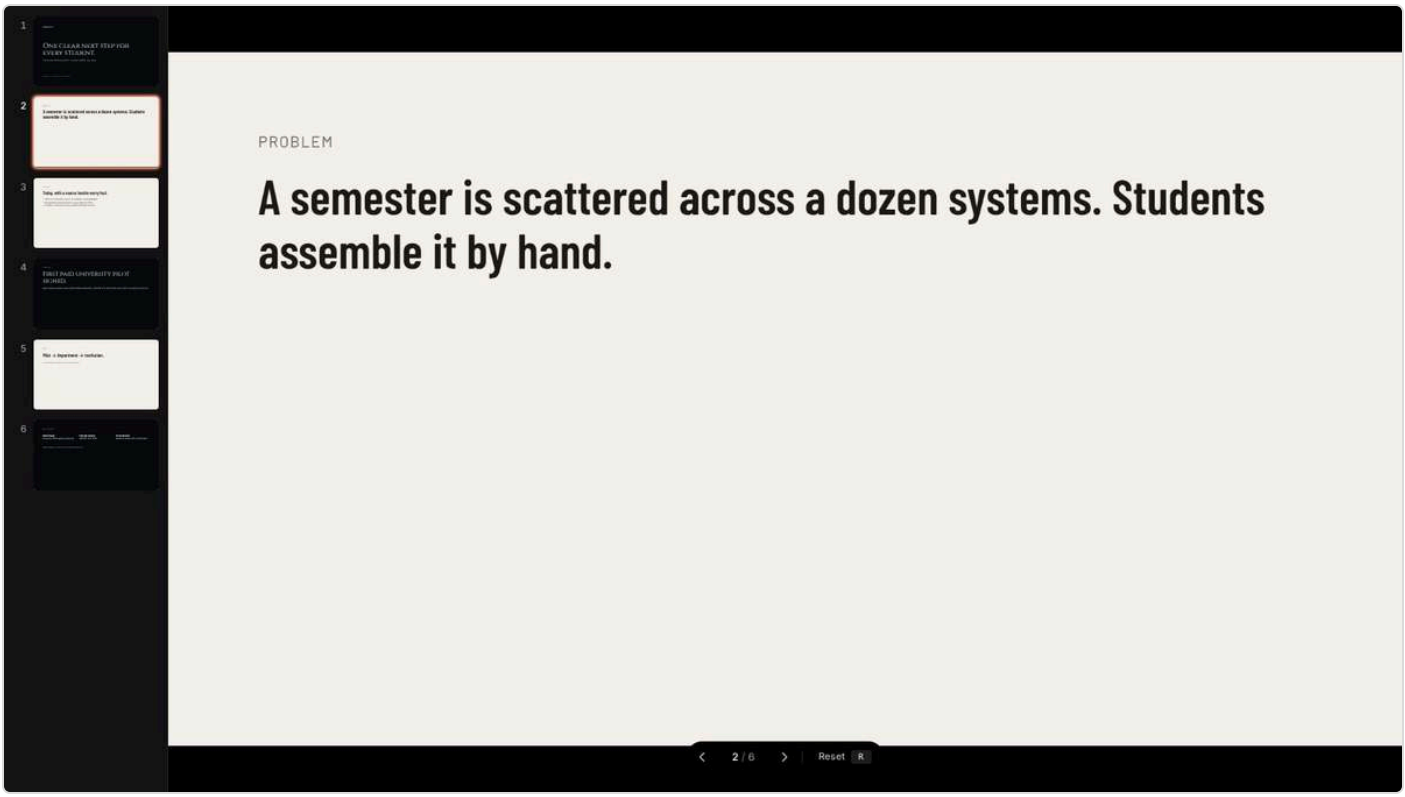
- State-specific registrations for the home-state LLC — confirm with the accountant.
- Exact insurance limits — take them from the pilot contract.
- HECVAT answers — complete only from verified controls; never claim certifications not held.

Investor deck

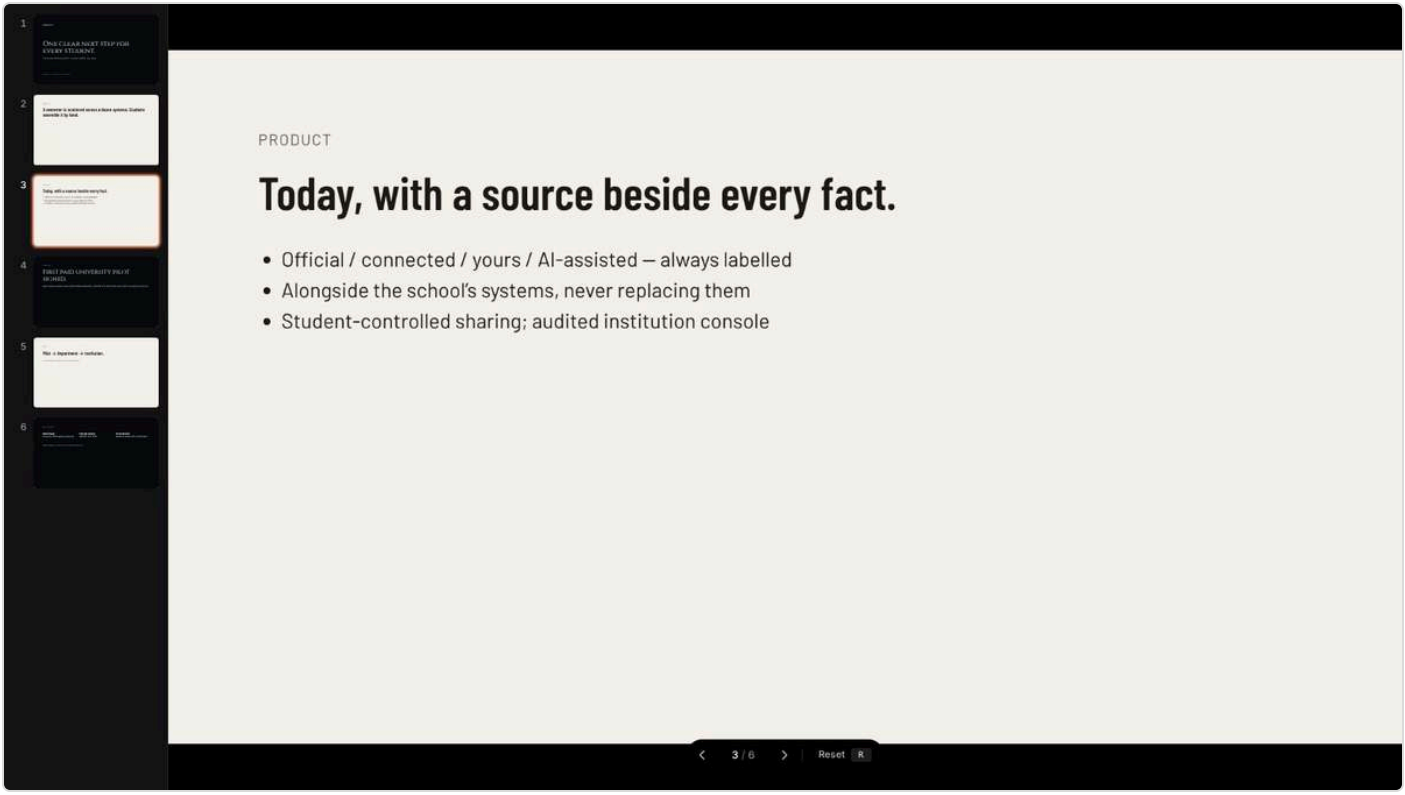
Every slide, rendered from the deck template. **6 screens.**



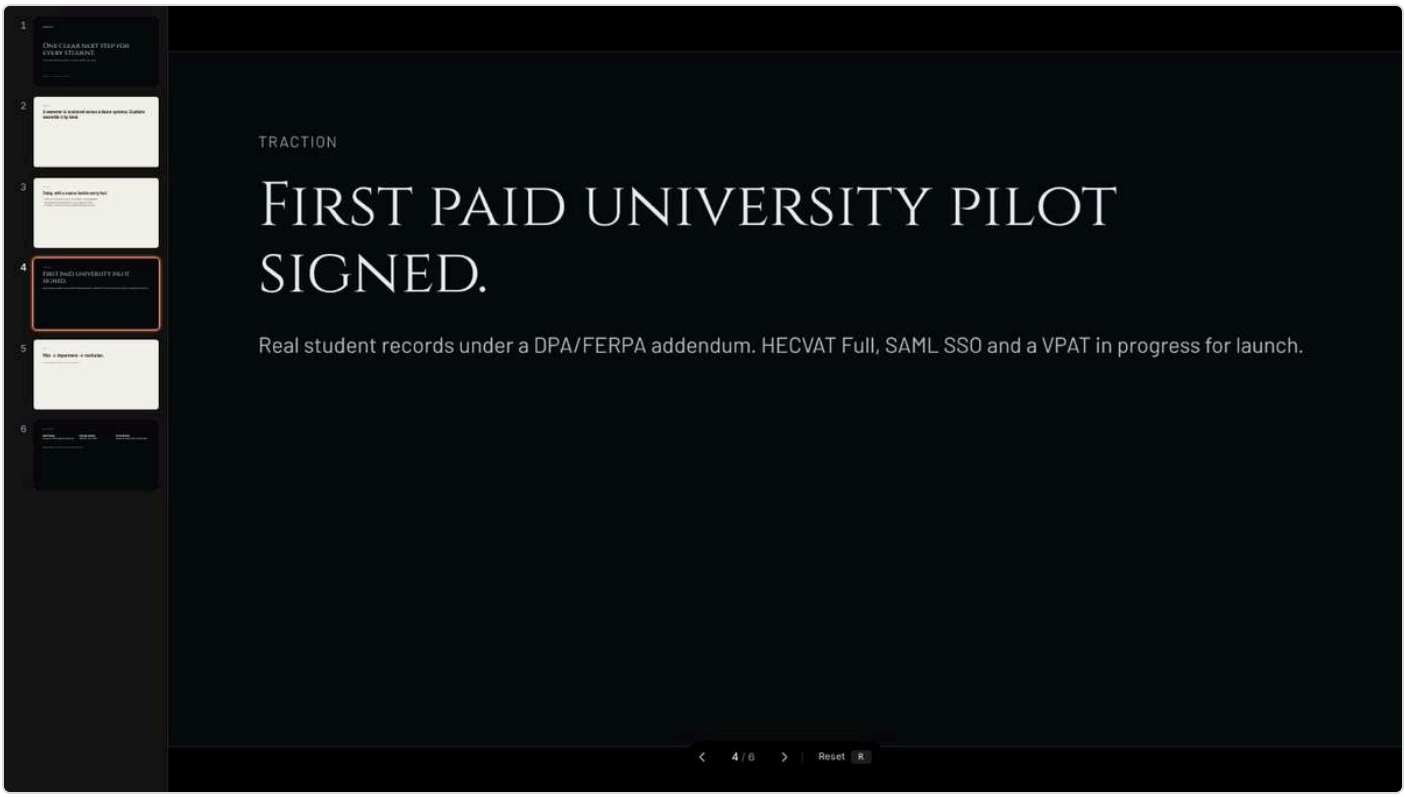
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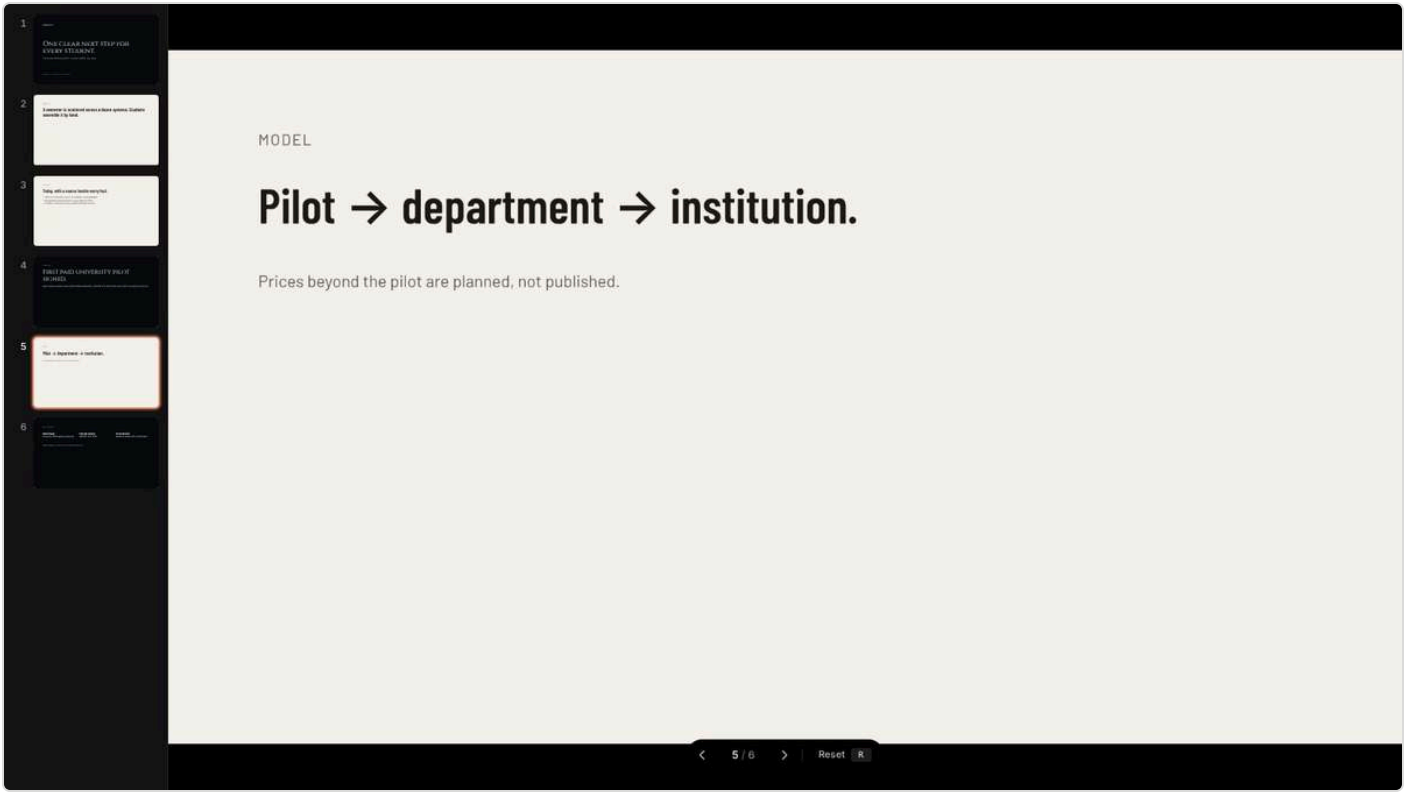
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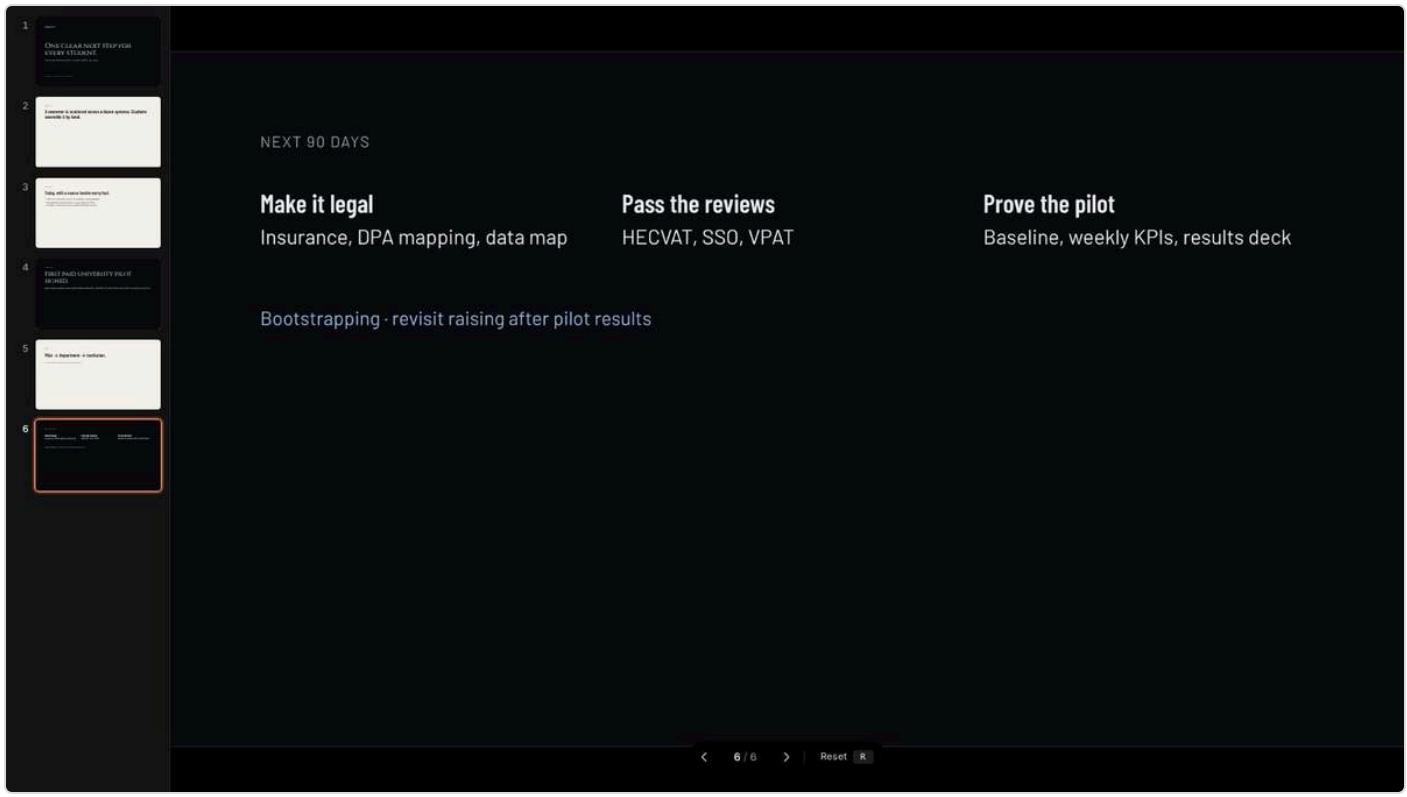
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Slide 4



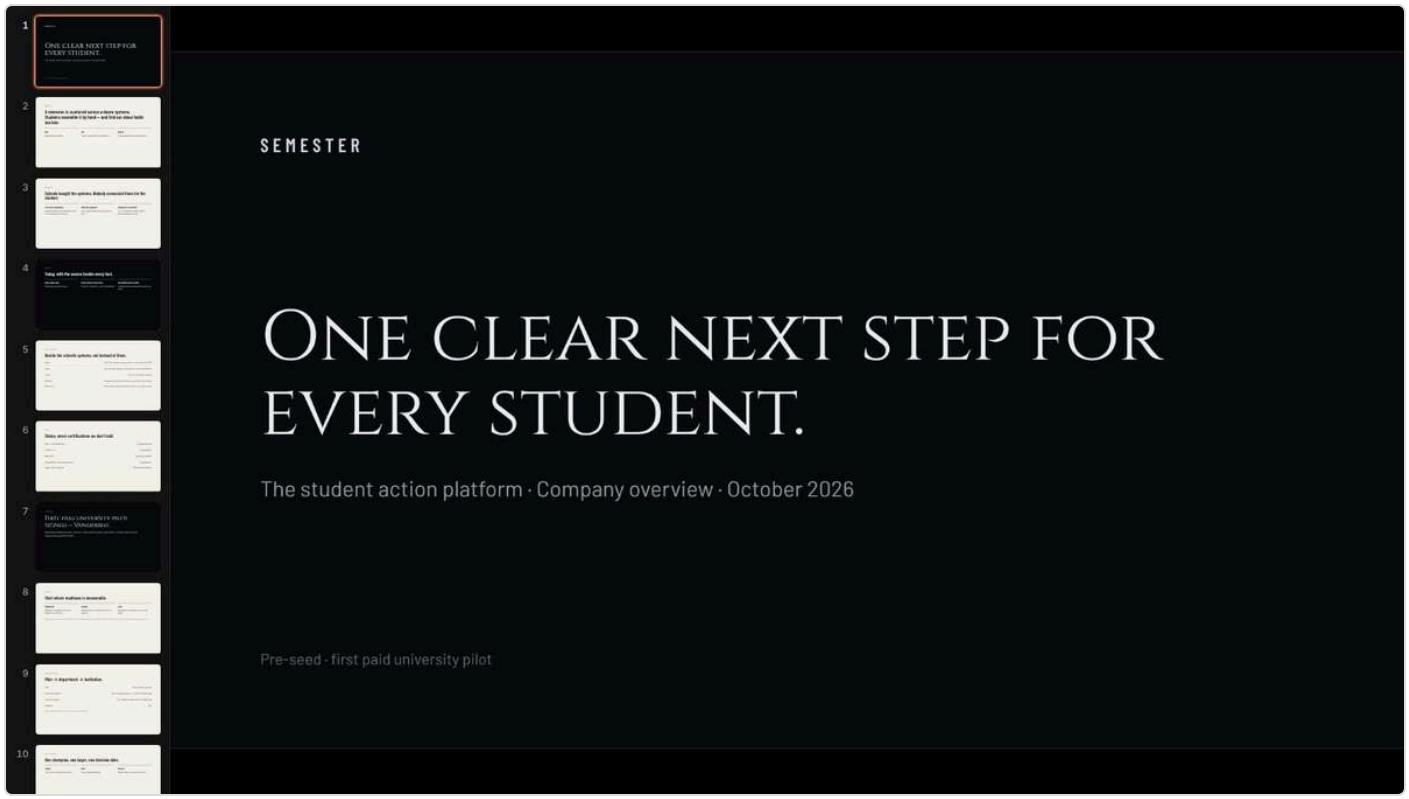
Slide 5


NEXT 90 DAYS
Make it legal
Insurance, DPA mapping, data map
Pass the reviews
HECVAT, SSO, VPAT
Prove the pilot
Baseline, weekly KPIs, results deck
Bootstrapping · revisit raising after pilot results
6 / 6
Reset
R

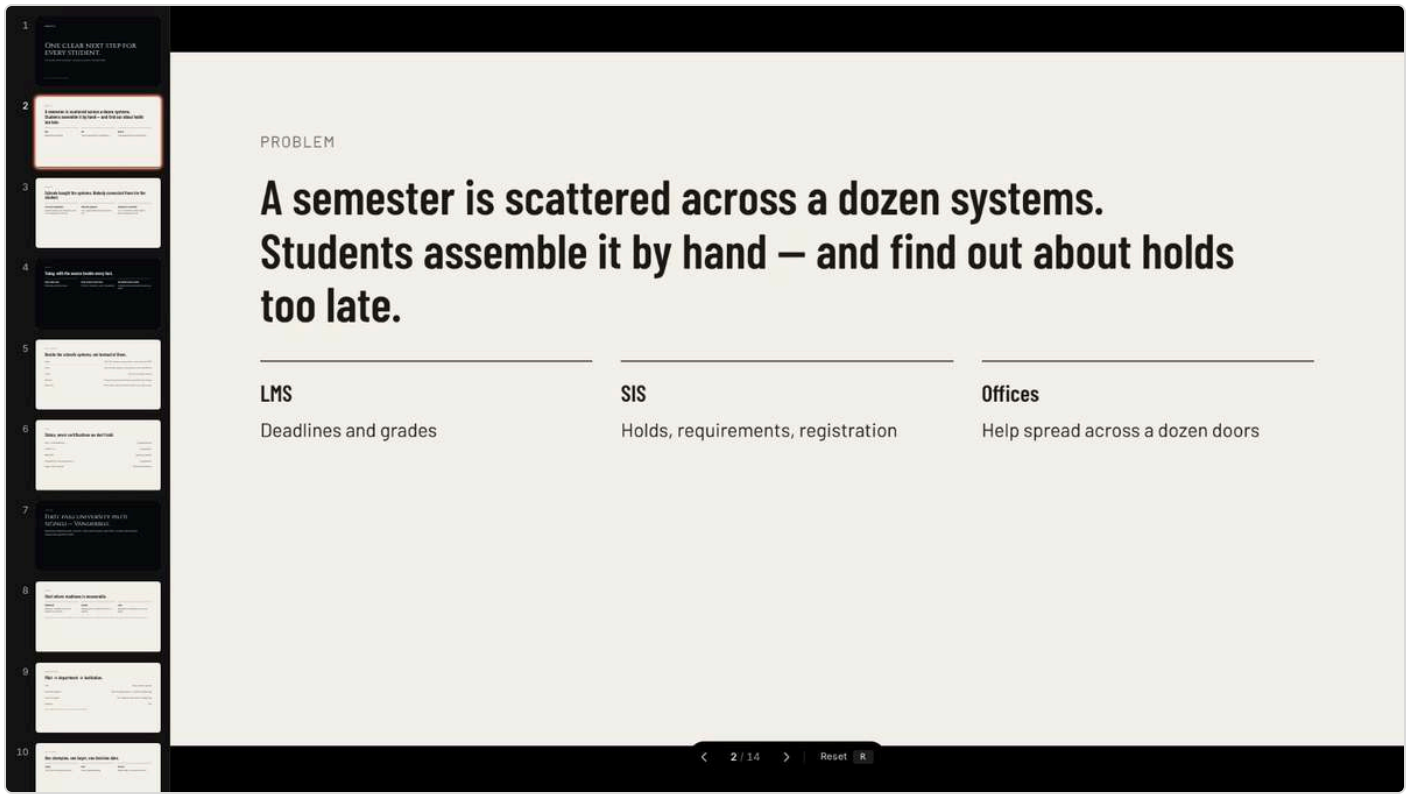
Slide 6

Company deck

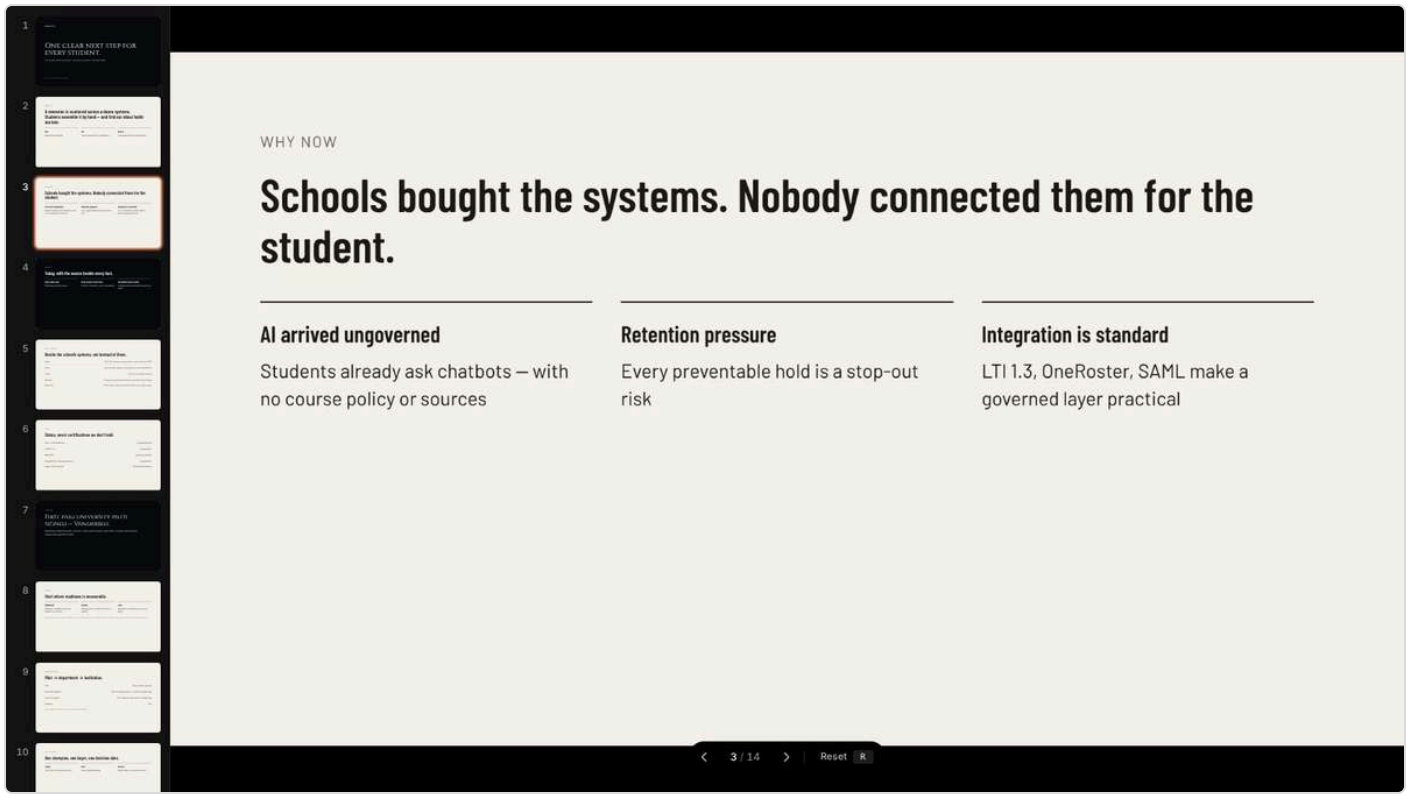
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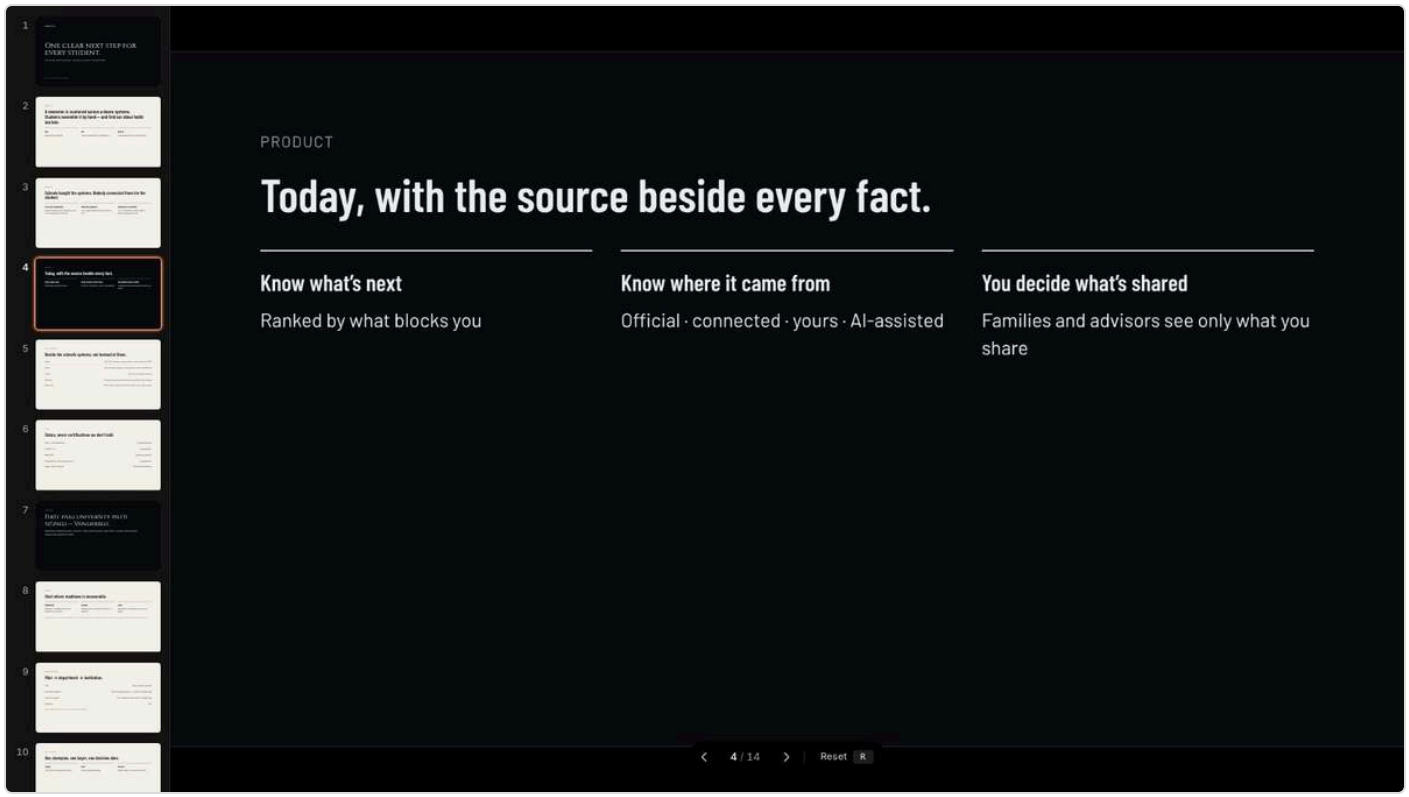
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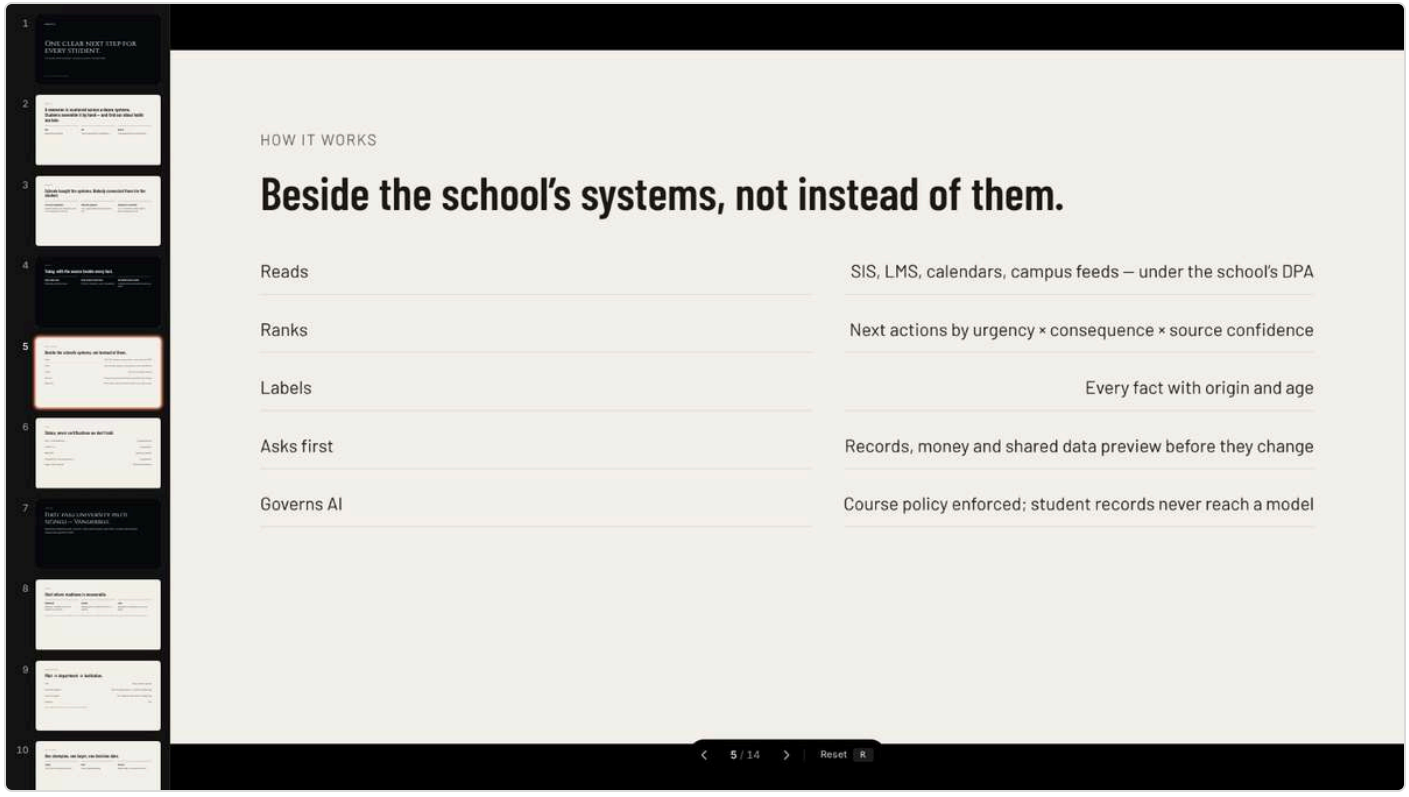
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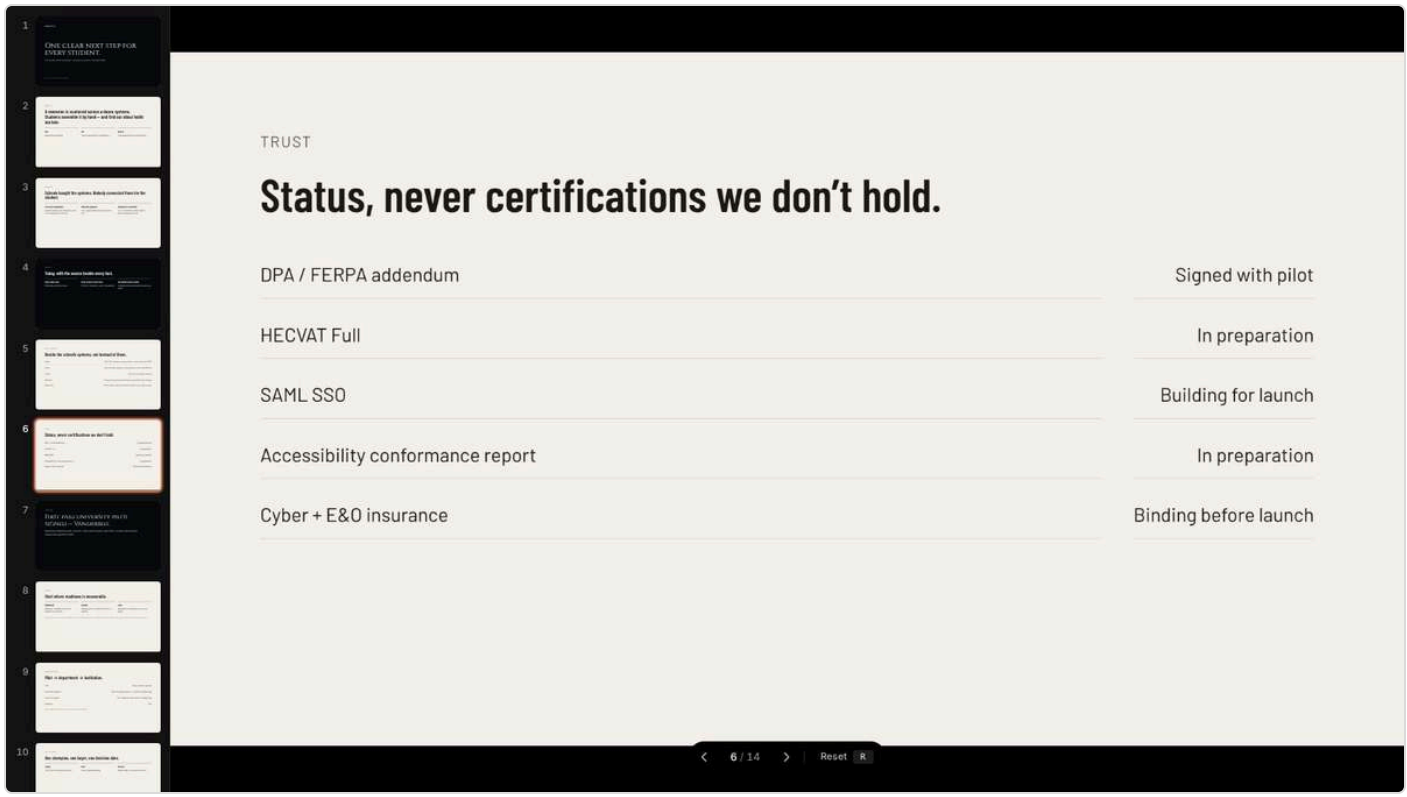
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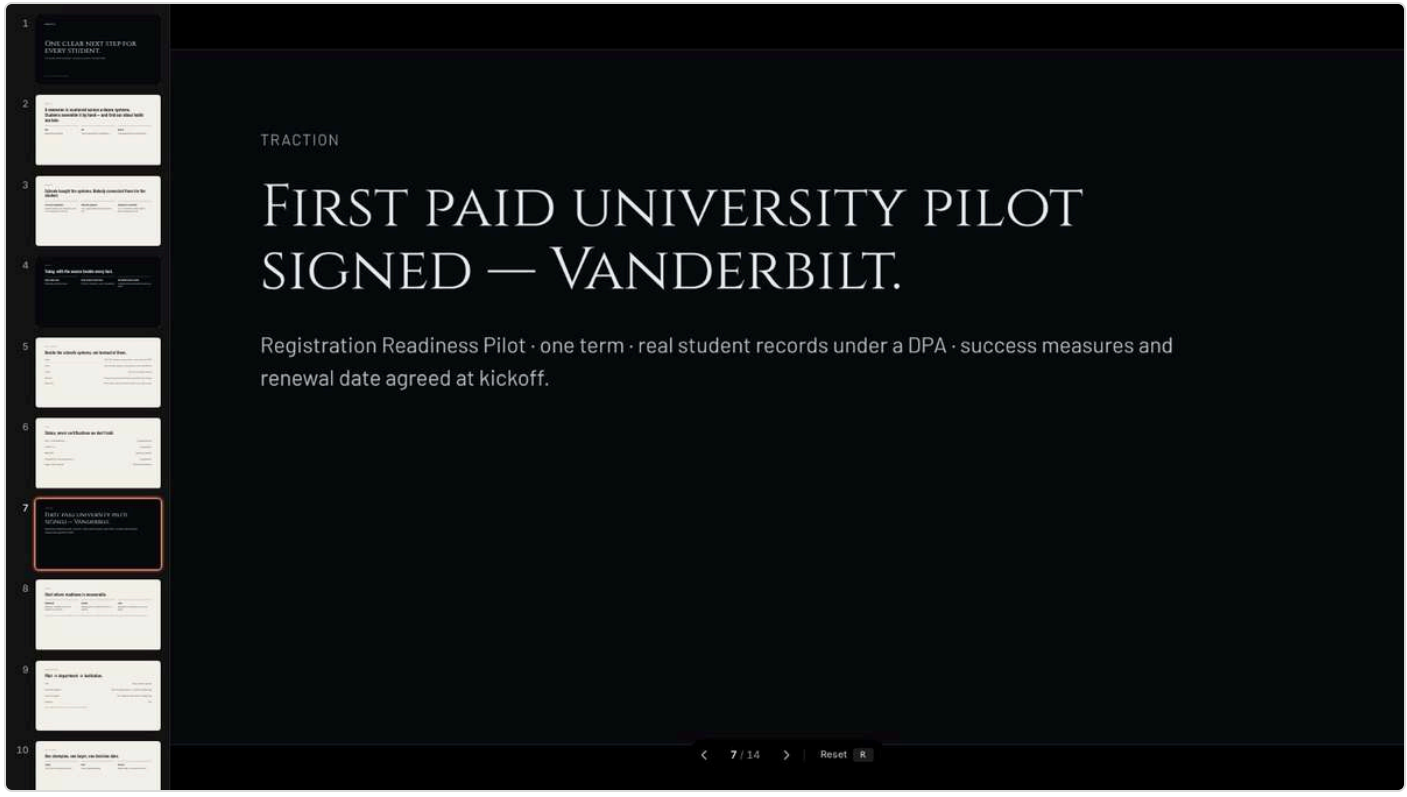
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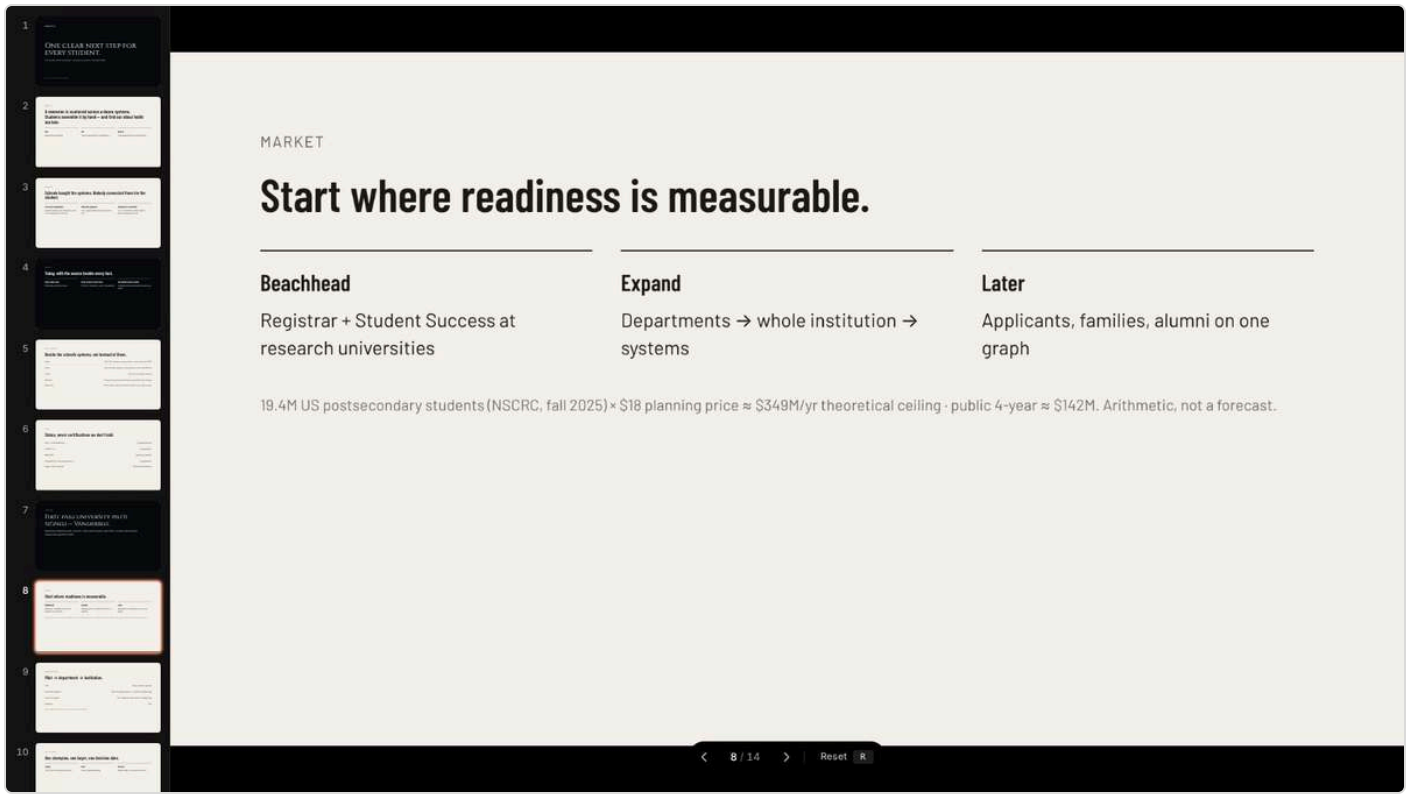
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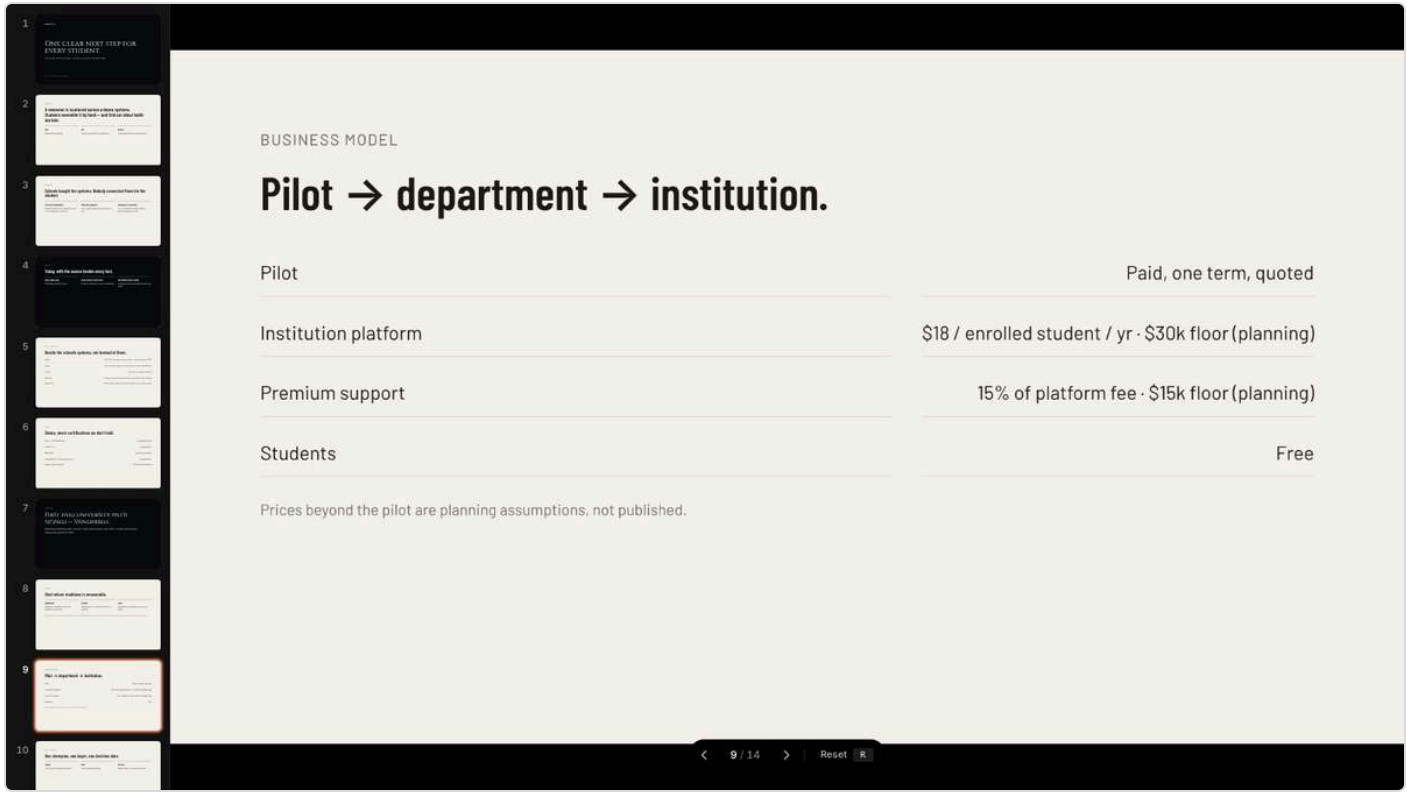
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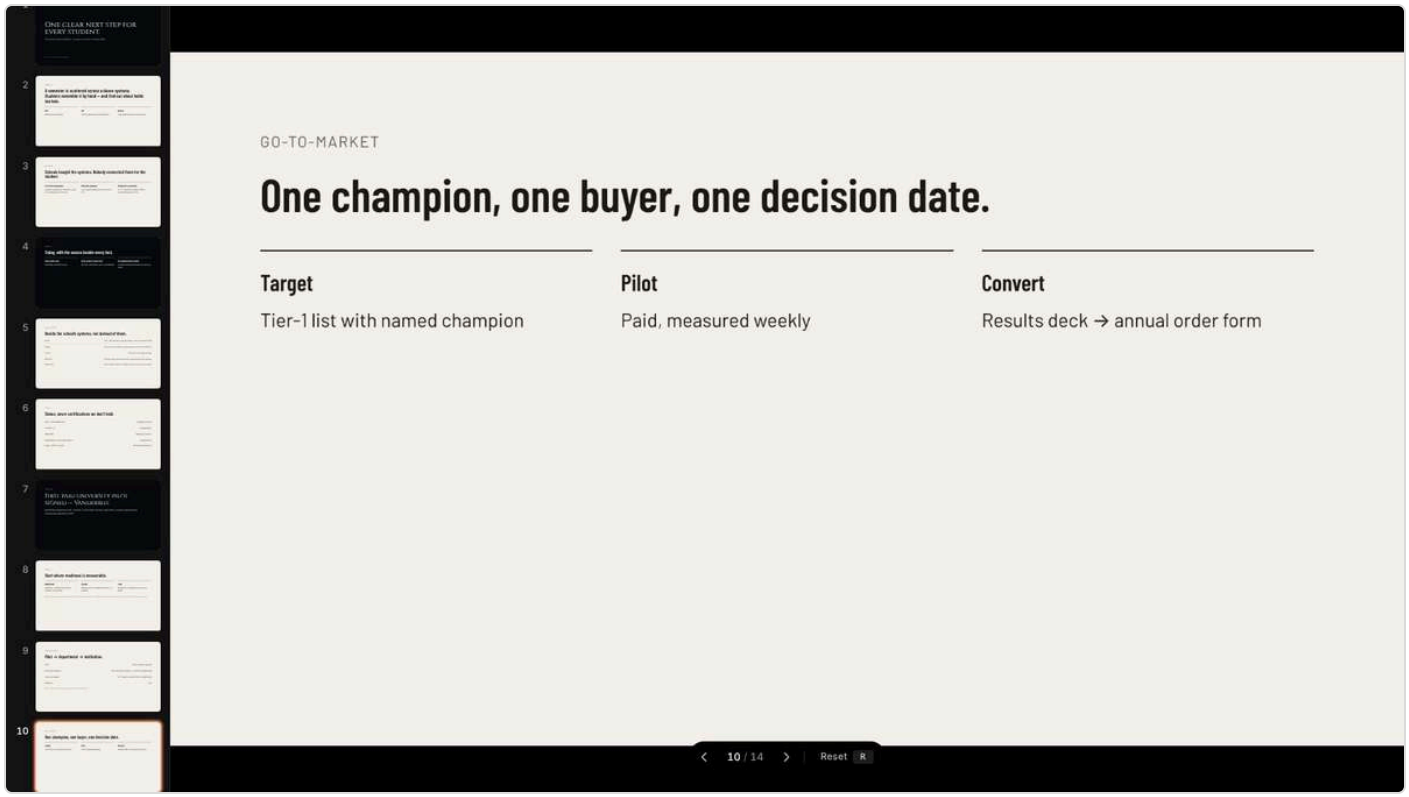
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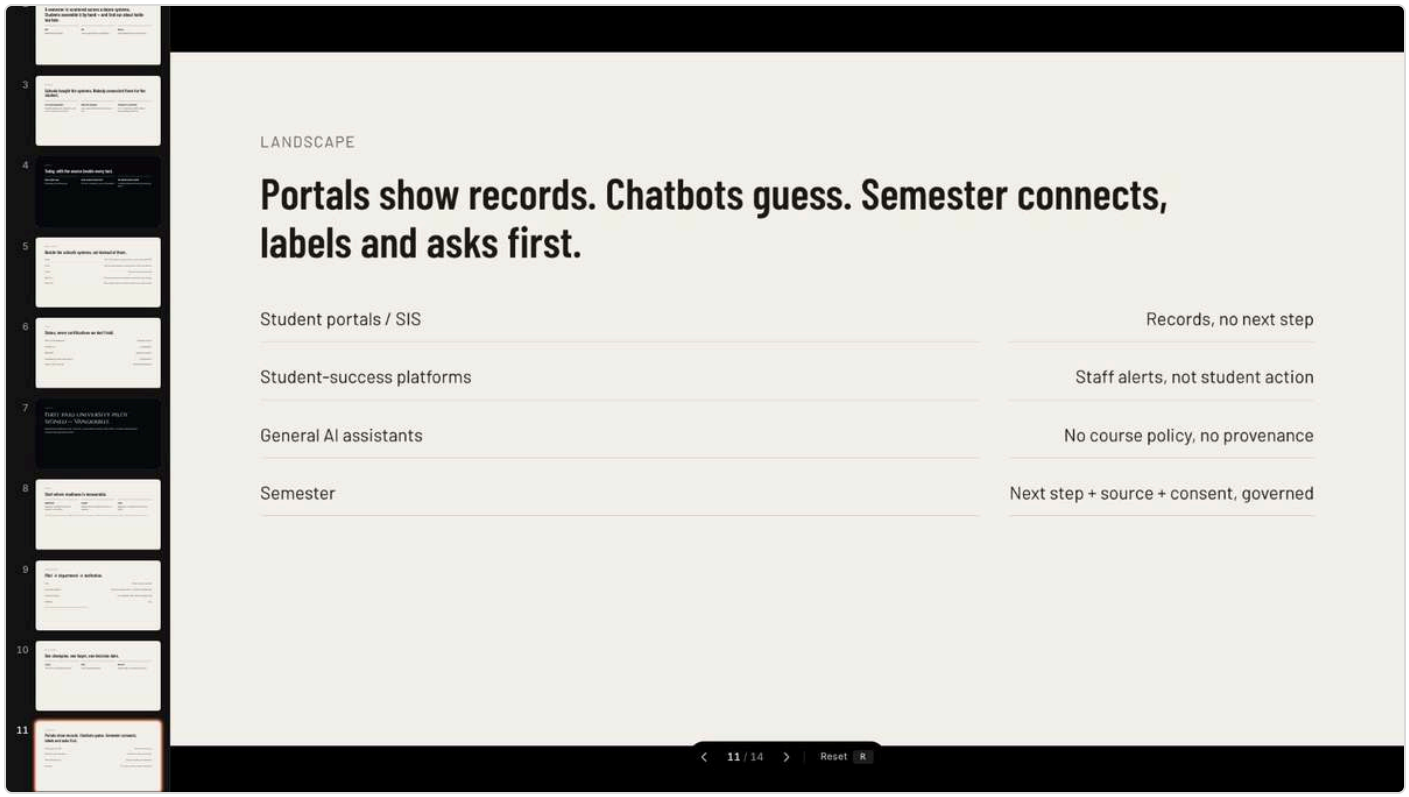
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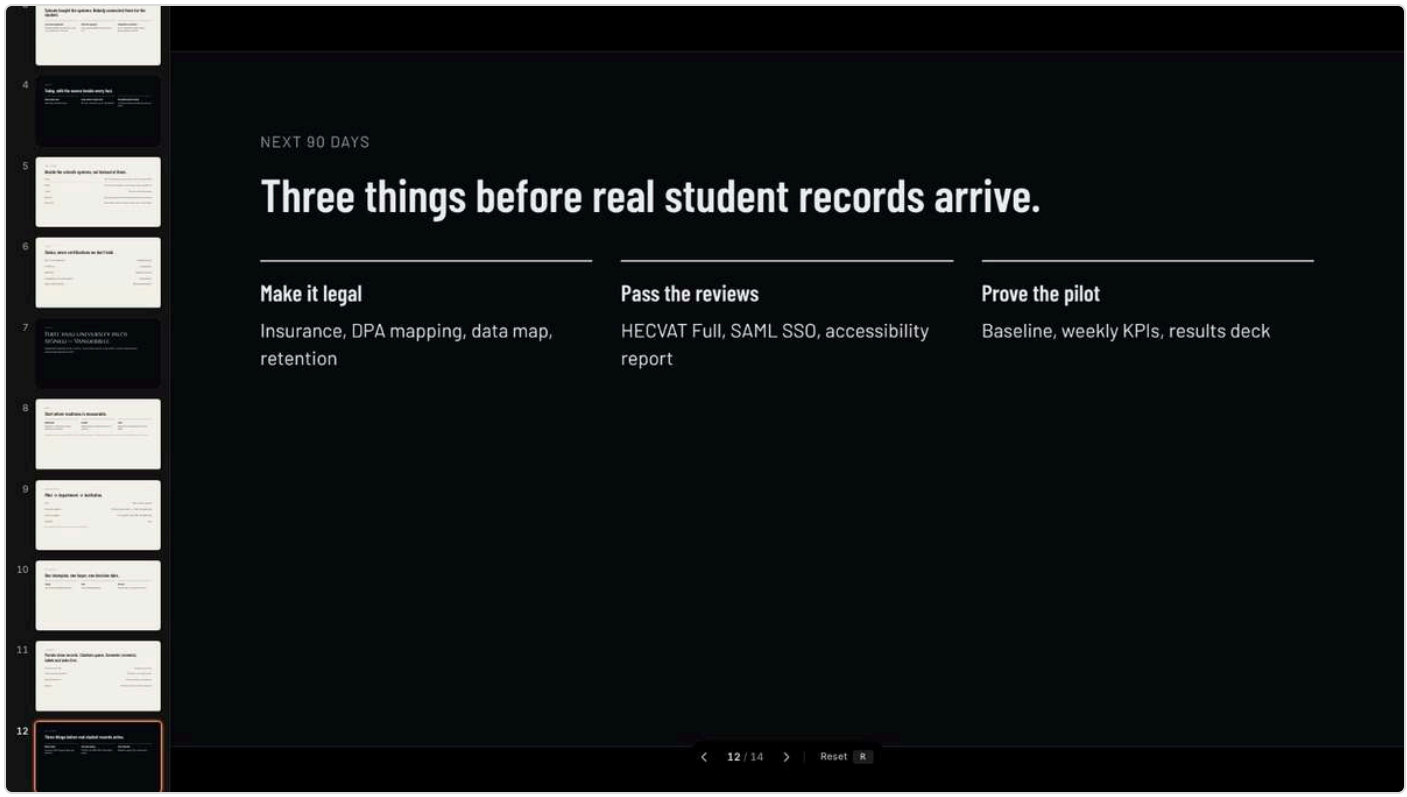
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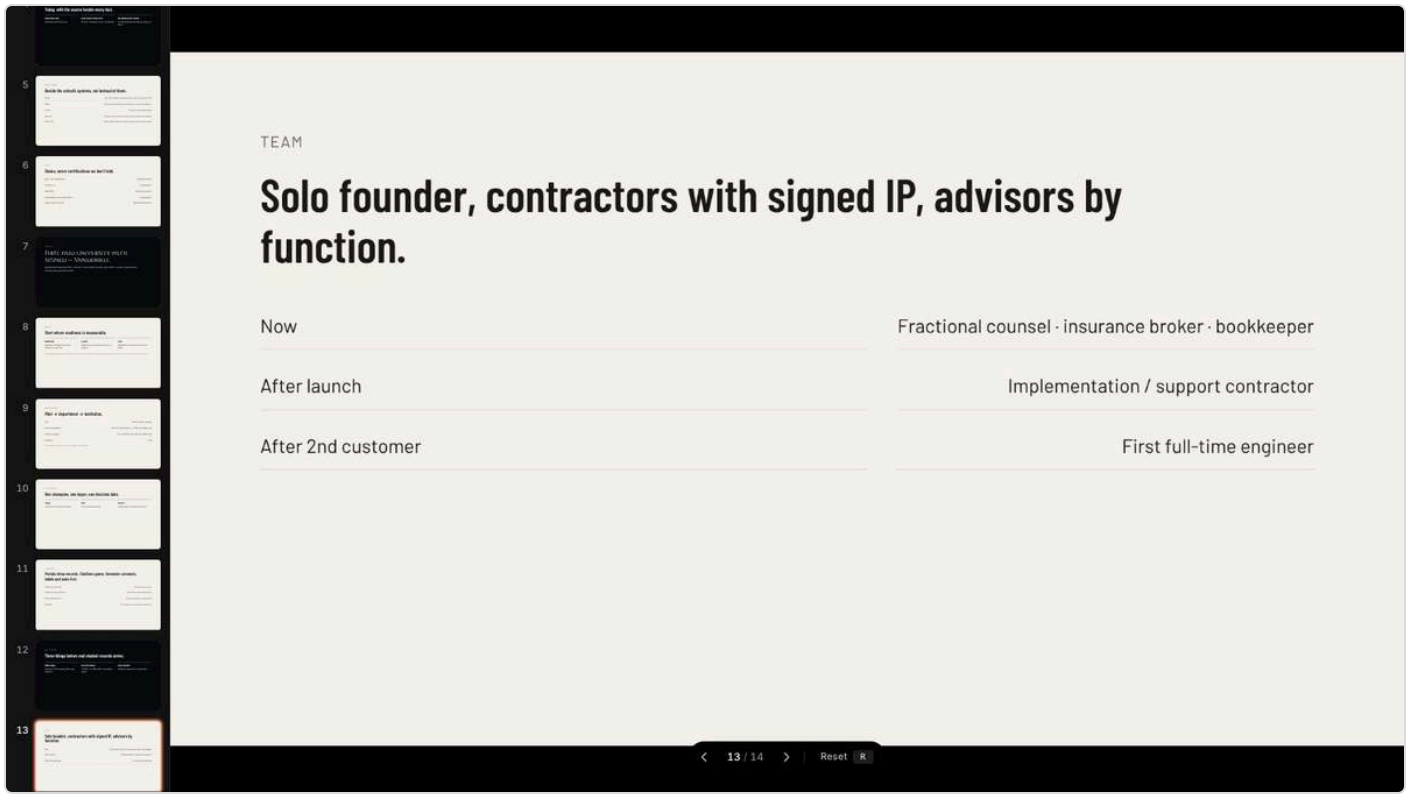
Slide 10



Slide 11



Slide 12



Slide 13

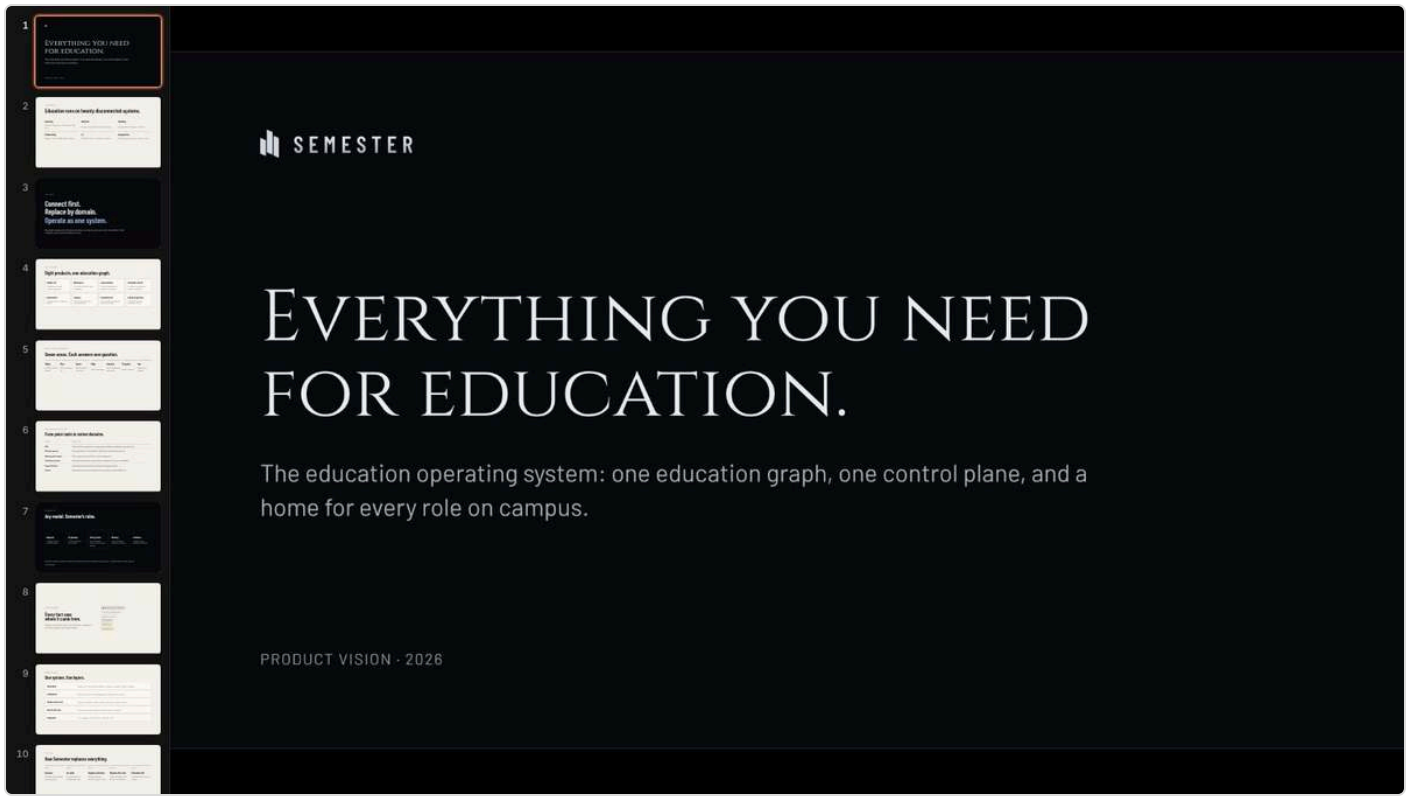

6
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14
EVERY STUDENT, ONE CLEAR NEXT STEP.
hello@semester.example · Bootstrapping today; raising decision after pilot results
14 / 14
Reset R

Slide 14

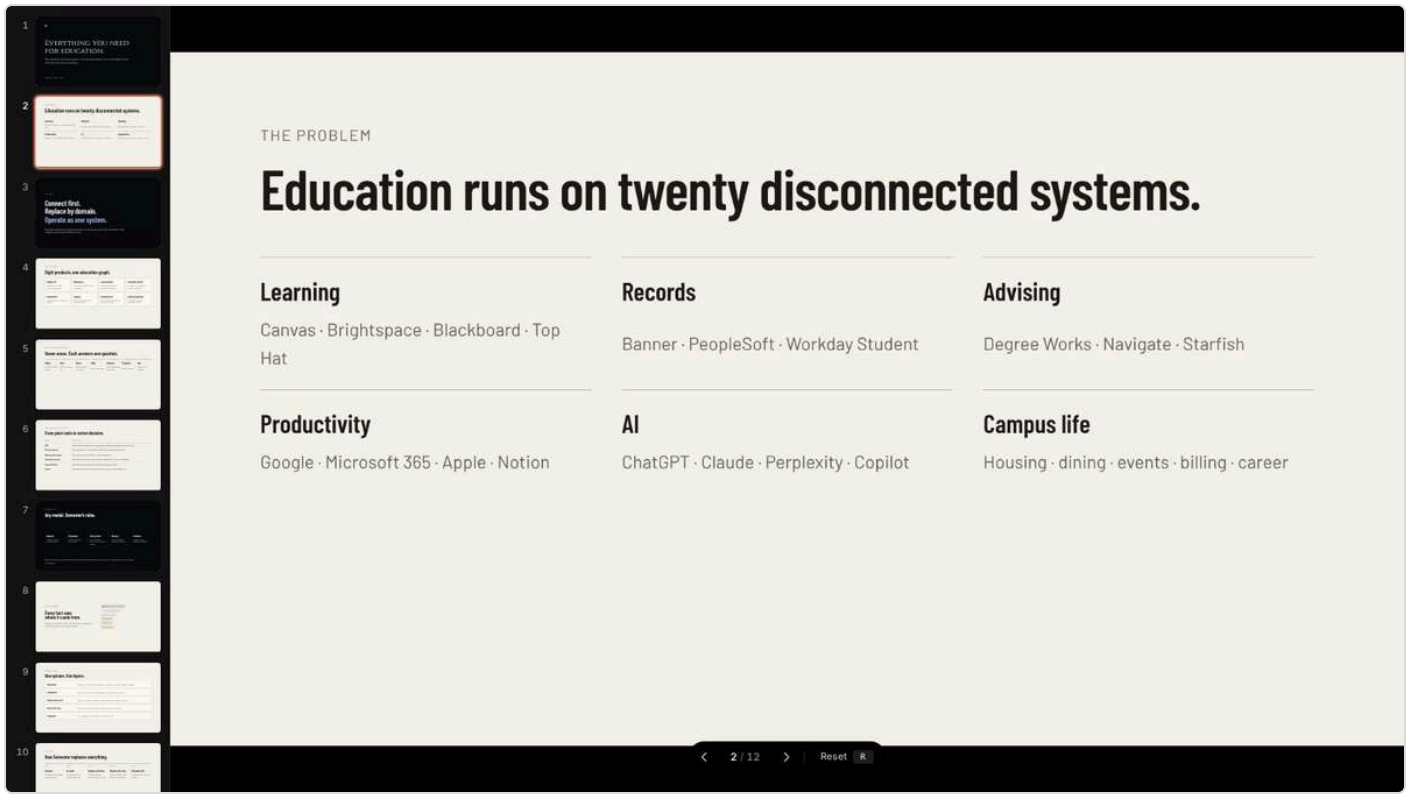
COMPANY · DECK

Vision deck

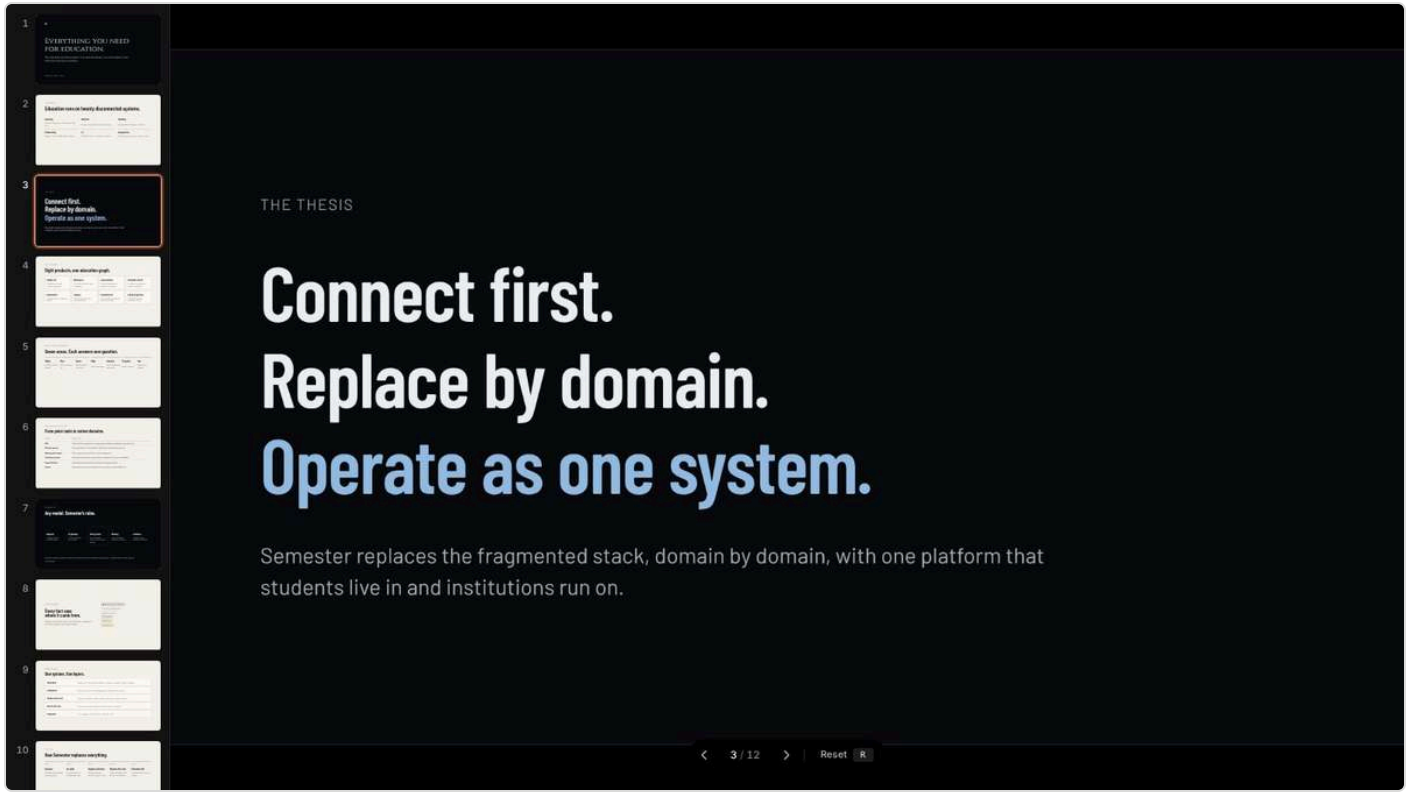
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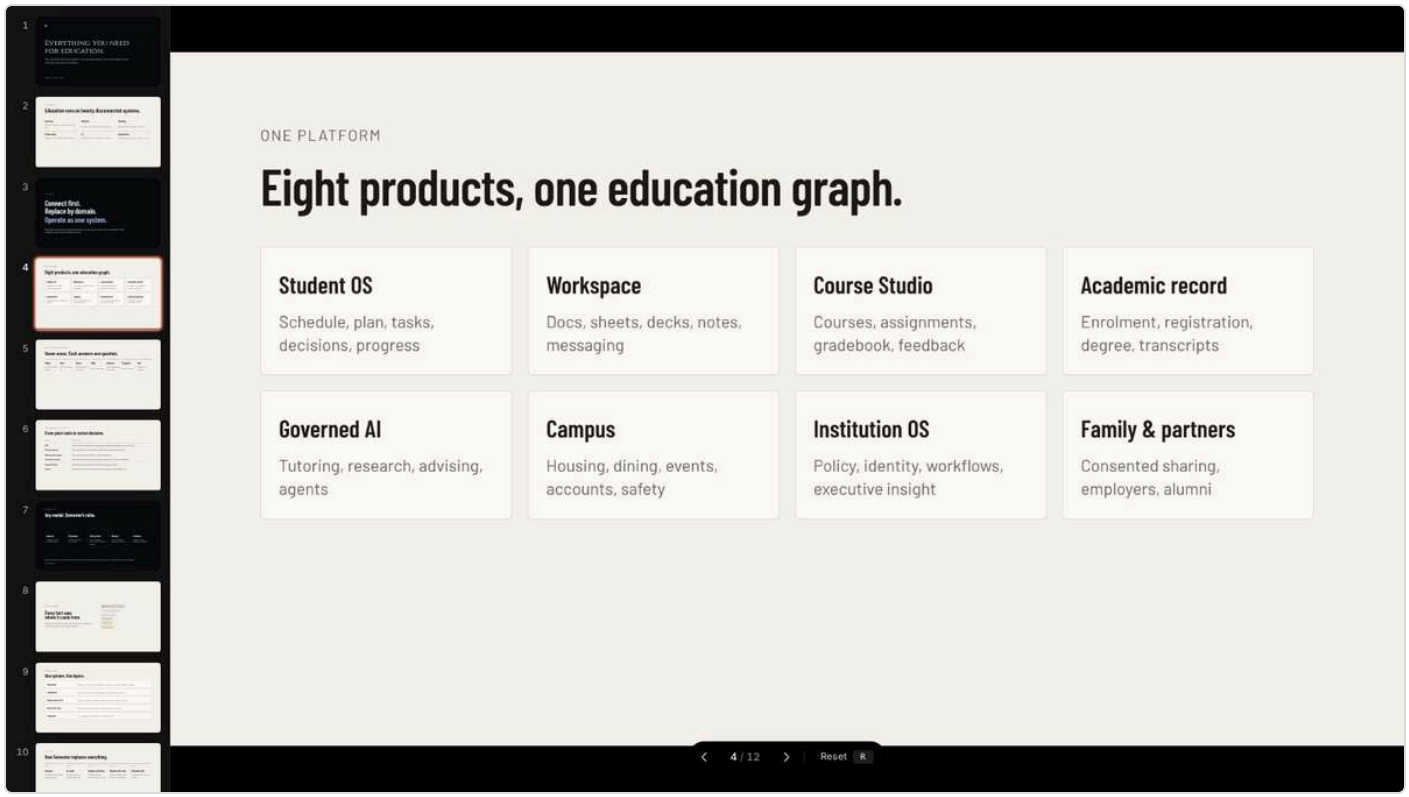
Slide 1



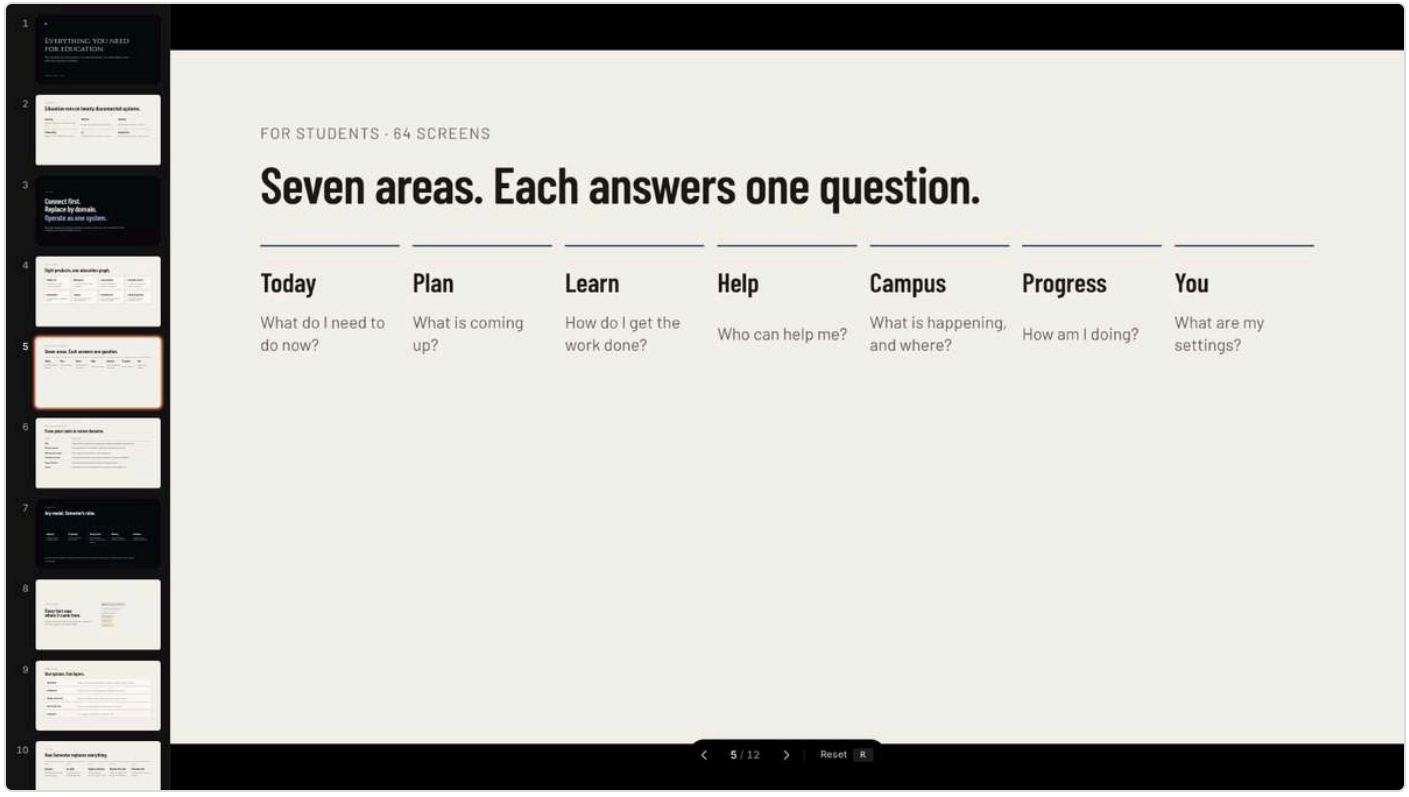
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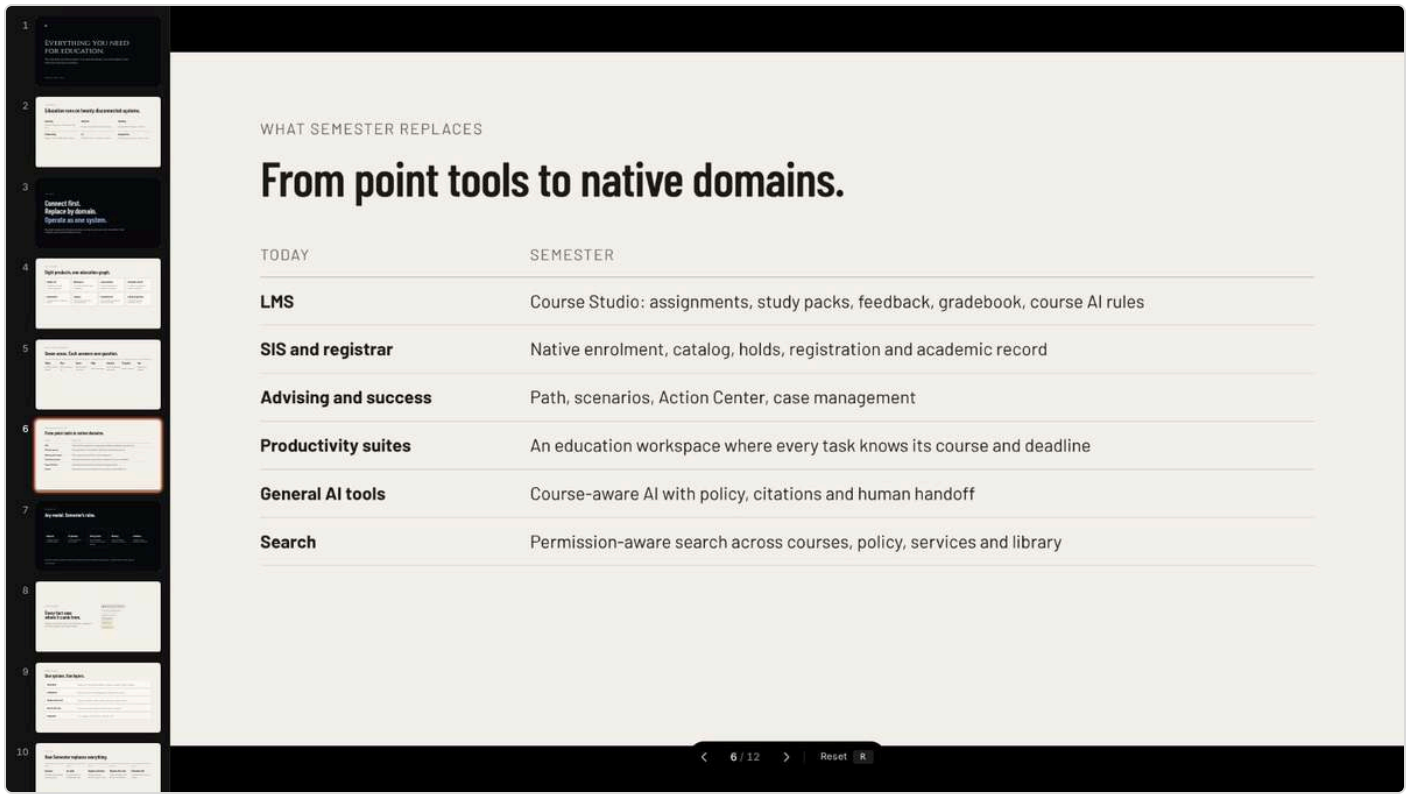
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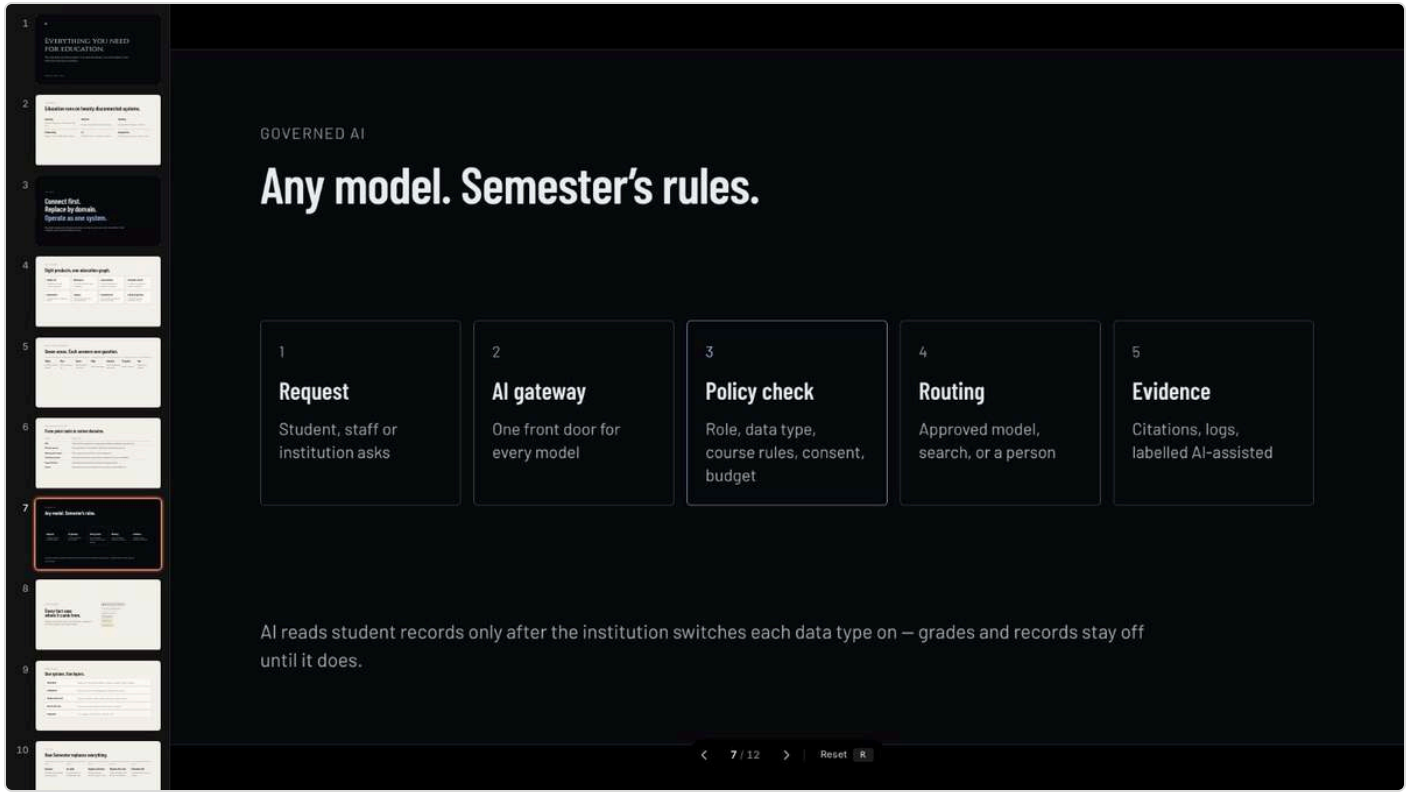
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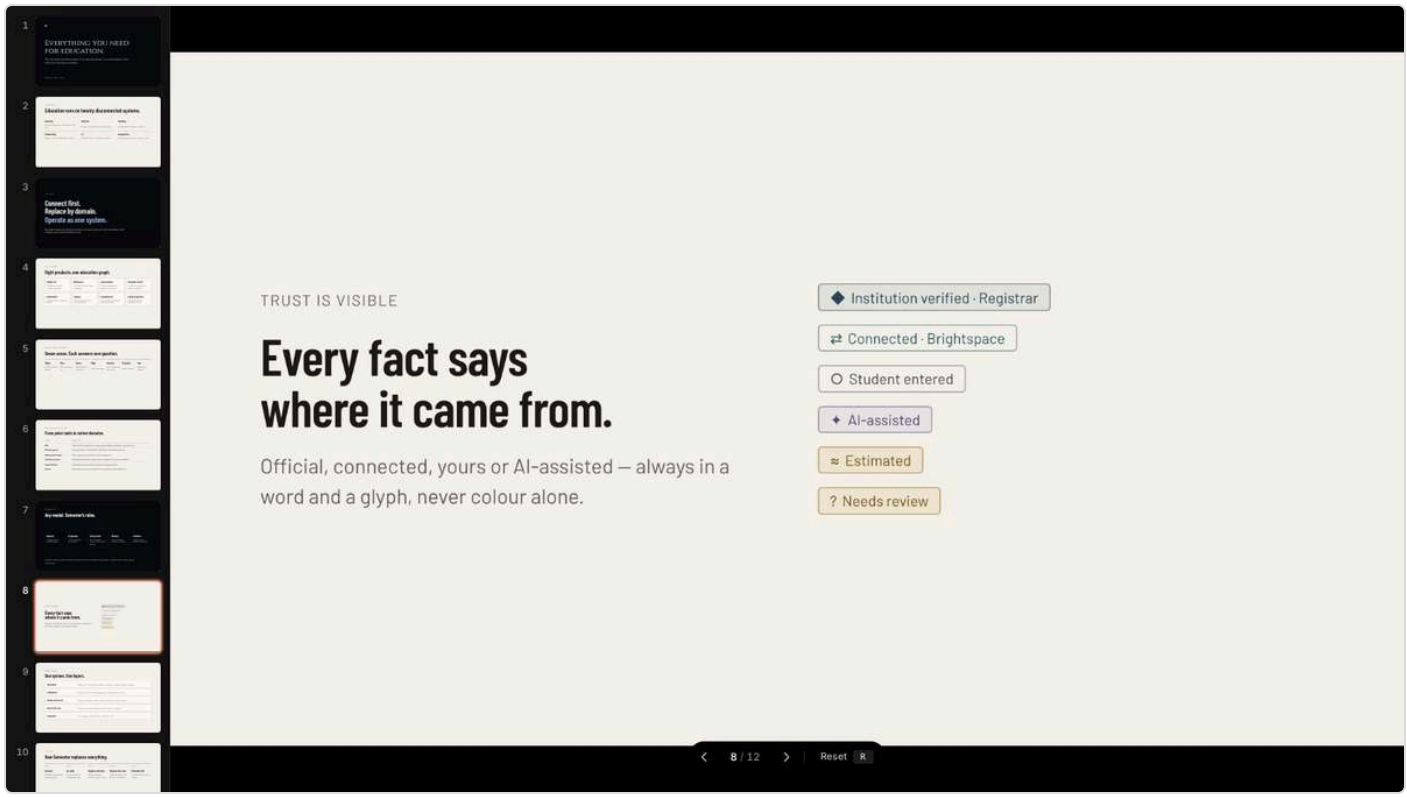
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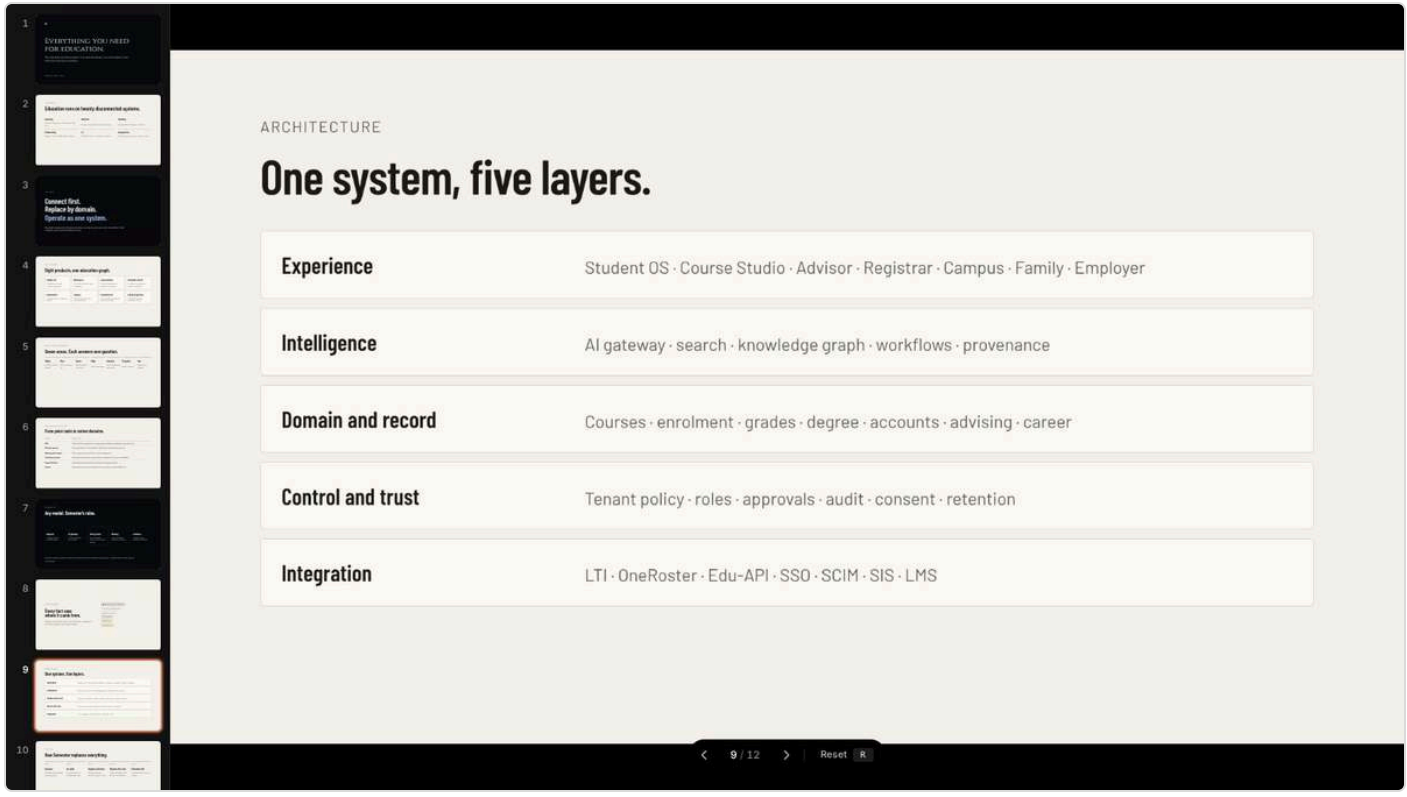
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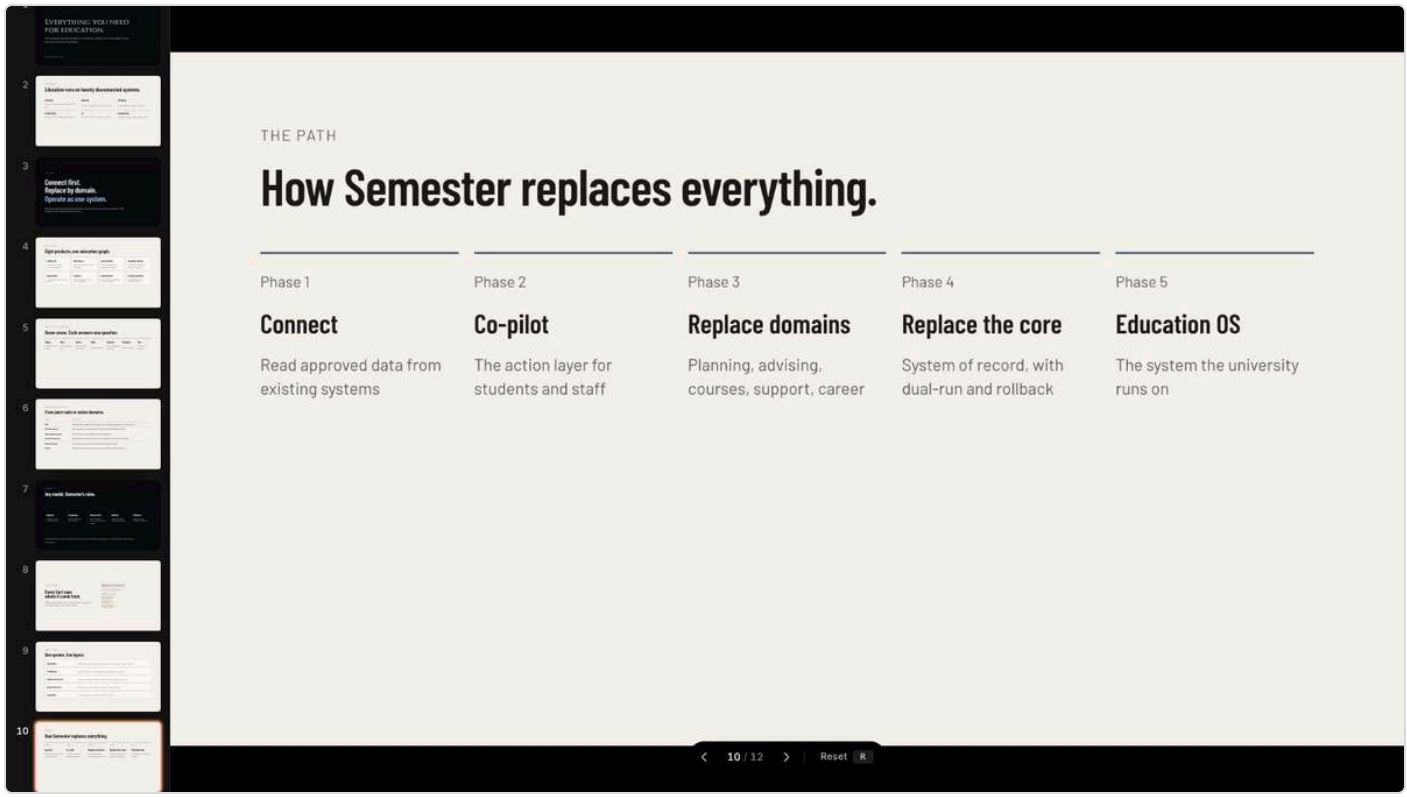
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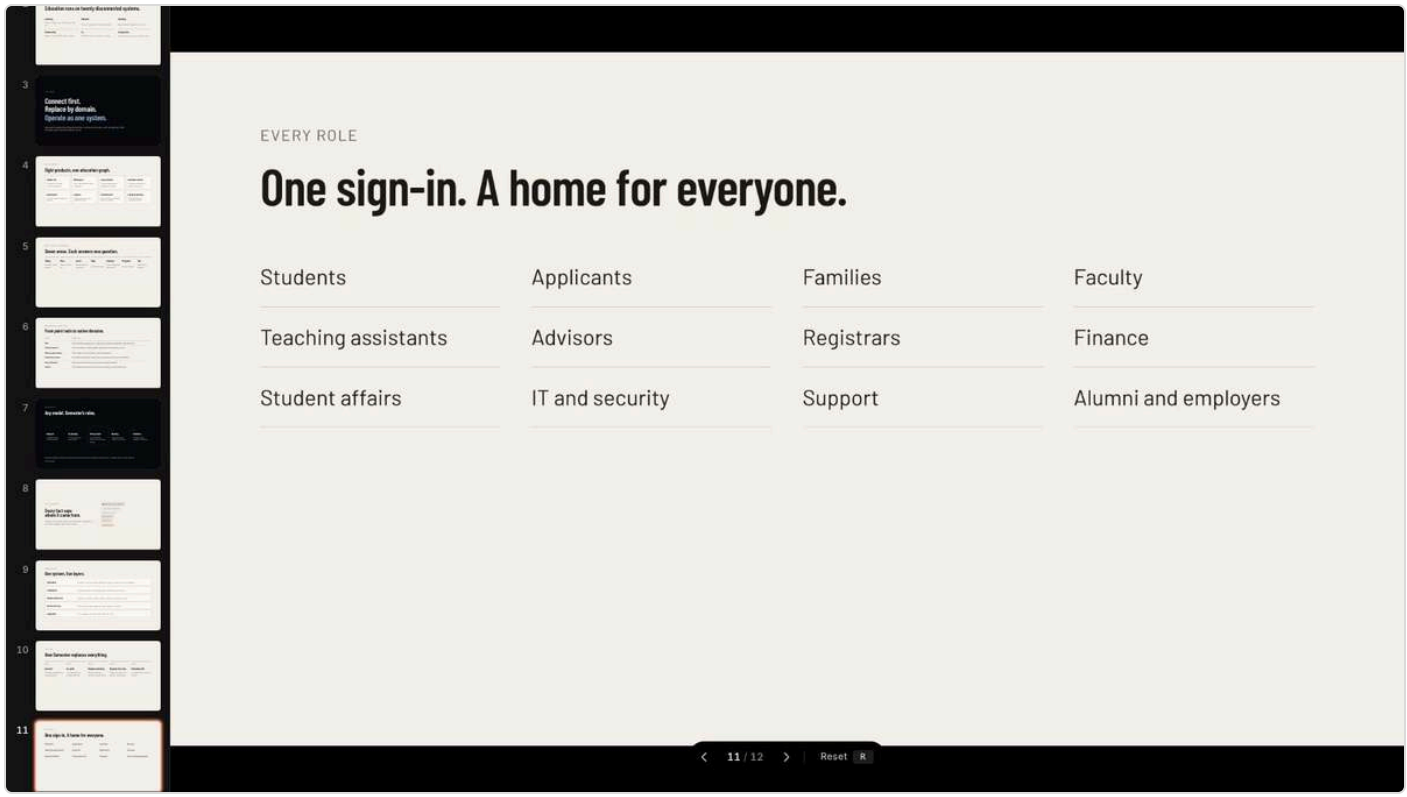
Slide 8



Slide 9



Slide 10



Slide 11


Connect first.
Replace by domain.
Operate as one system.
4
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12
ONE SYSTEM. EVERY ROLE.
EVERY YEAR OF EDUCATION.
semester · the education operating system
12 / 12
Reset R

Slide 12

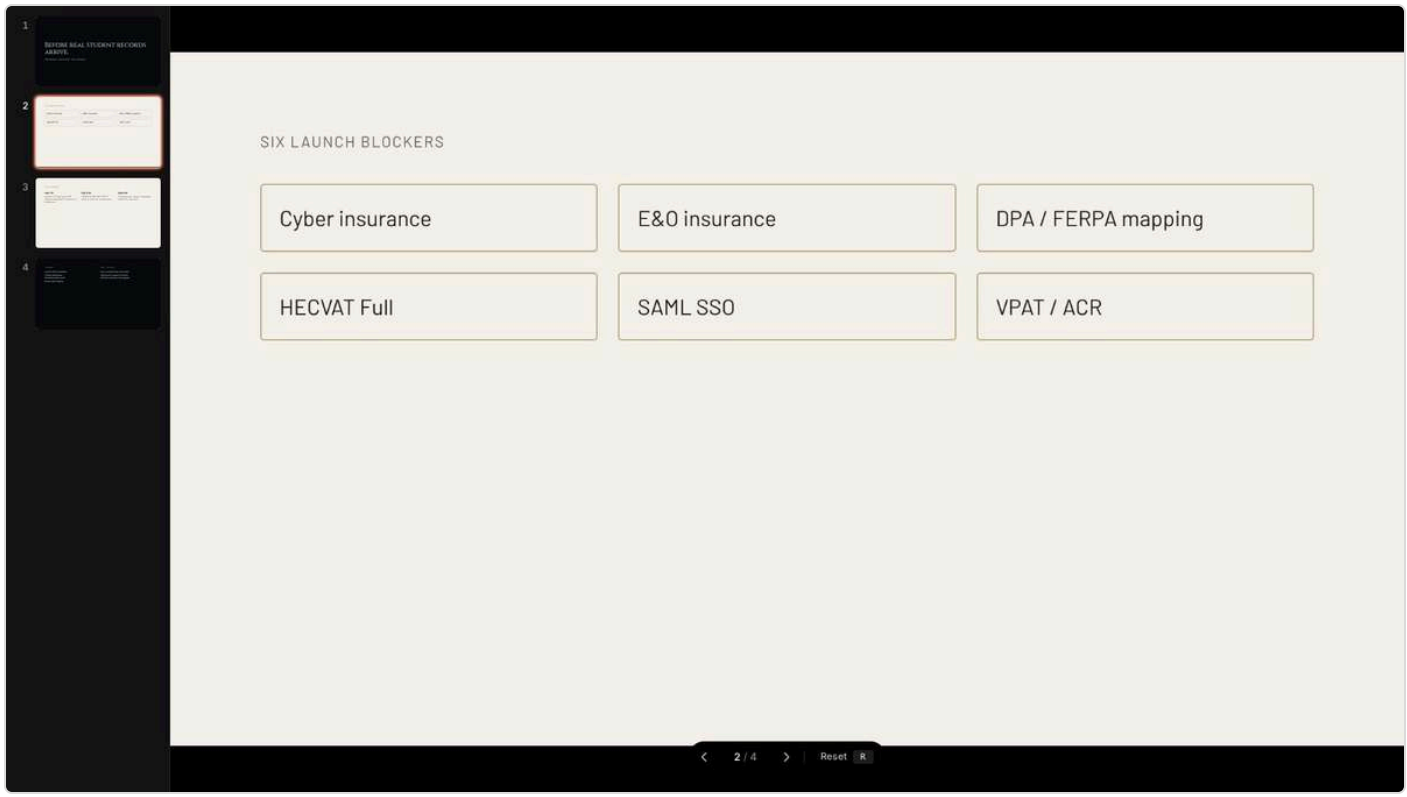
COMPANY · DECK

Internal plan deck

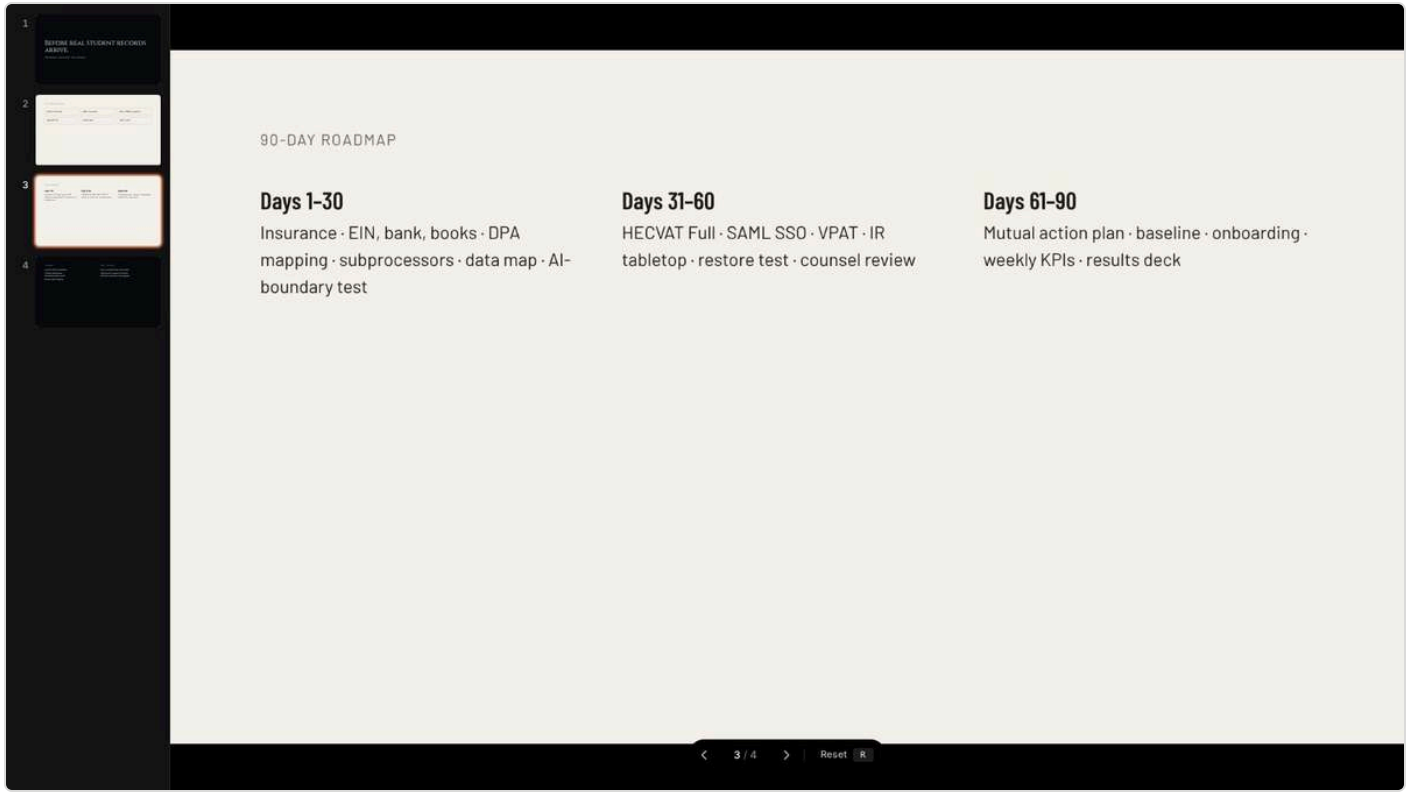
Every slide, rendered from the deck template. **4 screens.**



Slide 1



Slide 2



Slide 3


1
BEFORE REAL STUDENT RECORDS ARRIVE.
2
3
4
TOP RISKS
Launch without insurance
HECVAT stalls review
No decision date → drift
Solo-founder capacity
HIRE / CONTRACT
Now: counsel, broker, accountant
After launch: support contractor
After 2nd customer: first engineer
4 / 4
Reset R

Slide 4

Company workspaces

The business workspace, investor room, master control and the public company site. **31 screens.**

business



Opening view



Launch tracker (1/2)

31 Security	Evidence register mapped to controls	Founder	P1	In progress	HECVAT	EVIDENCE-REGISTER.md
33 Security	Trust Center page (verified controls only)	Founder	P1	Not started	Procurement	docs/trust/
35 Accessibility	Accessibility statement + feedback route	Founder	P1	Not started	Public launch	—
38 Finance	12-month model: burn, runway, scenarios	Founder	P1	Not started	Bootstrapped planning	Budget $5k–$20k for setup
39 Finance	Unit costs: infra + AI cost per active user	Founder	P1	Not started	Pricing	—
40 Finance	Pricing memo: pilot → department → institution	Founder	P1	Draft	Annual proposal	PUBLIC-CLAIMS register: prices “planned”
41 Sales	Ideal customer profile + tier-1 account list	Founder	P1	Not started	Second pilot	—
42 Sales	Discovery + demo scripts by persona	Founder	P1	Not started	Second pilot	—
45 Sales	Results deck + annual conversion proposal	Founder	P1	Not started	Before renewal decision	—
46 Sales	Security/procurement response kit	Founder	P1	Not started	Second pilot	—
50 Customer success	QBR / renewal process	Founder	P1	Not started	Mid-pilot	—
51 Operations	Weekly operating cadence + decision log	Founder	P1	In progress	Ongoing	DECISIONS.md, docs/decisions/
52 Operations	Risk register (owner, mitigation, review)	Founder	P1	In progress	Ongoing	LAUNCH-RISK-REGISTER.md
53 Operations	Public claims approval register	Founder	P1	In progress	Any marketing	PUBLIC-CLAIMS-APPROVAL-REGISTER.md
54 Hiring	Contractor onboarding/offboarding (access, IP, NDA)	Founder	P1	Not started	Next contractor	IP assignments in place
8 Formation	Decision: convert LLC → Delaware C-corp	Founder + counsel	P2	Deferred	Before priced equity round	Bootstrapping — revisit at fundraising
17 Contracts	Mutual NDA	Counsel	P2	Not started	New prospects	—
32 Security	Penetration-test plan	Founder	P2	Not started	After first renewal	—
55 Hiring	First hire profile + trigger	Founder	P2	Not started	Second paid customer	Solo founder
56 Fundraising	Fundraising readiness checklist	Founder	P2	Deferred	When raising	Bootstrapping for now

56 of 56 · status changes save on this device

Launch tracker (2/2)

SEMESTER

Gap analysis | Launch tracker | 90-day roadmap | Go-to-market | Launch checklist | Pilot checklist | Risk register | Hiring plan | Fundraising | Documents & decks

Business workspace
Solo founder · LLC · paid pilot

90-day roadmapSemester company

Search or ask… ⌘K

○On this device only

Business · 90-day roadmap

90-day roadmap

Days 1–30 · Make the pilot legal to run

1. Bind cyber + E&O insurance (contract requirement)
2. EIN, state tax registration, business bank, bookkeeping
3. Map every DPA/FERPA obligation to a control and an owner
4. Publish subprocessor list: Vercel, Supabase (+ AI provider, with "no student records" boundary)
5. Data inventory + data-flow map for student records
6. Retention + deletion schedule
7. Test that student records never reach an AI provider; document it

Days 31–60 · Pass the university reviews

1. Complete HECVAT Full from docs/trust + evidence register
2. Ship SAML / Shibboleth SSO with the university IdP
3. VPAT / ACR against WCAG 2.1 AA (use existing a11y tests as evidence)
4. Incident-response tabletop; record it
5. Restore-from-backup test; record RTO/RPO
6. Privacy Policy + Terms reviewed by counsel

Days 61–90 · Launch and prove the pilot

1. Agree pilot start + renewal decision dates in a mutual action plan
2. Baseline the success metrics with the champion
3. Onboarding + support intake with severity levels
4. Weekly check-in and KPI review
5. Draft the results deck and annual conversion proposal

90-day roadmap

SEMESTER

Gap analysis | Launch tracker | 90-day roadmap | Go-to-market | Launch checklist | Pilot checklist | Risk register | Hiring plan | Fundraising | Documents & decks

Business workspace
Solo founder · LLC · paid pilot
Go-to-marketSemester company

Search or ask… ⌘K

○On this device only
Business · Go-to-market

Go-to-market

WedgeUniversities first. One department champion, one economic buyer, a paid one-term pilot with named success metrics and a renewal decision date.

Offer
Registration Readiness Pilot
Buyer: Student Success, Advising or Registrar

Platform (planning)
$18 / enrolled student / yr
Floor $30,000 · planning assumption
≈EstimatedWorked out by Semester from what it knows. Not an official figure.

Premium support
15% of platform fee
Floor $15,000 · planning assumption
≈EstimatedWorked out by Semester from what it knows. Not an official figure.

Personas

Personas

Persona	Cares about	Our promise	Objection	Answer
VP Student Success	Retention and on-time progress	Fewer students surprised by holds and deadlines	Will it add work for my advisors?	Advisors see only what students share; no new queue
Registrar	Accurate records, clean registration	Students arrive at registration ready	Will it change official records?	Read-only; your SIS stays authoritative
CIO / IT	Security, integration load	One governed integration, SSO, audit	Another system to secure?	HECVAT Full, SAML SSO, RLS per tenant, subprocessor list
Accessibility office	WCAG 2.2 AA	Accessible by design, ACR provided	Do you have a VPAT?	ACR in preparation; manual test protocol shared
Procurement / counsel	Risk and terms	Standard DPA/FERPA, insurance, SLA	FERPA and AI?	DPA addendum; student records never reach an AI provider
Students	What do I do next?	One clear next step with its source	Is this tracking me?	You decide what is shared; export or delete anytime

Messaging

Headline
One clear next step for every student.
Subhead
Semester turns the semester into the next thing to do — and shows where each fact came from. Your official systems stay official.
Pilot CTA
Request a pilot design session
Proof line
In a bounded, paid pilot with one university.
AI line
AI-assisted, source-linked. Student records never reach an AI provider.

Objection handling

We already have a portal
Semester sits on top of it and turns its data into a next step; nothing is replaced in the pilot.
Our advisors are overloaded
Students resolve more on their own; advisors get shared plans, not a new inbox.
AI risk
Course AI policy is enforced, answers are labelled and cited, and records stay out of AI providers.
No budget this year
A one-term paid pilot fits a discretionary budget; annual pricing is decided after results.
You are a small company
Insurance, DPA, HECVAT and exit/export terms are in the contract; data is yours to export.

Acquisition funnel

Stage	Required evidence	Primary KPI
Contacted	Personalised outreach, channel, date, contact role	Reply / referral rate
Discovery	Pain, stakeholders, budget, timeline, workflow	Qualification rate
Demo	Role-specific demo, objections, next action	Demo-to-design rate
Activated pilot	Admin setup, invitations, adoption baseline	Activation rate
Success achieved	Outcome report + sponsor validation	Pilot KPI attainment
Annual conversion	Annual order form, scope, close date	Pilot-to-annual conversion
Expansion	New cohort/department, reference	Net revenue retention

Mutual action plan

Workstream	Customer owner	Semester owner	Completion evidence
Executive sponsorship	Named VP / Dean / CIO	Founder	Goals, decision date, sponsor attendance
Security / privacy	CISO / privacy office	Founder	HECVAT Full, DPA signed
Accessibility	Accessibility office	Founder	ACR reviewed
Integration	IT / registrar	Engineering	SSO live, data feed validated
Adoption	Champion	Founder	Invitations sent, baseline recorded

Sales process

Stage	Objective	Exit criteria
1 Targeting	Accounts with real, visible pain	Tier-1 list with named champion
2 Outreach	Relevant first conversation	Discovery booked
3 Discovery	Confirm urgent pain + owner	Champion + economic buyer named
4 Demo	Show the exact target workflow	Champion agrees success metrics
5 Solution design	Scope pilot, data, integrations	Pilot design signed off
6 Security/legal	Start HECVAT, DPA, VPAT early	Review path agreed
7 Proposal	Pilot price + annual conversion price	Mutual action plan
8 Contracting	Signature	Signed pilot (done for #1)
9 Pilot	Activation + weekly KPIs	KPIs met
10 Conversion	Results deck → annual contract	Renew / expand / close-lost

Go-to-market (1/2)

Qualification

- Is the problem expensive, risky or visible?
- Is there a champion and an economic buyer?
- Can the buyer fund a pilot?
- Can success be measured within one term?
- Can the account become a reference?

Funnel metrics

Named target accounts
Top-of-funnel capacity
Qualified opportunities
Real pipeline
Champion + buyer identified
Deal viability
Security review initiated
Institutional seriousness
Pilot close rate
Offer quality
Pilot KPI attainment
Conversion readiness
Pilot → annual conversion
Commercial proof

Go-to-market (2/2)

SEMESTER

Gap analysis | Launch tracker | 90-day roadmap | Go-to-market | Launch checklist | Pilot checklist | Risk register | Hiring plan | Fundraising | Documents & decks

Business workspace
Solo founder · LLC · paid pilot

Launch checklistSemester company

Search or ask… ⌘K

○On this device only
Business · Launch checklist

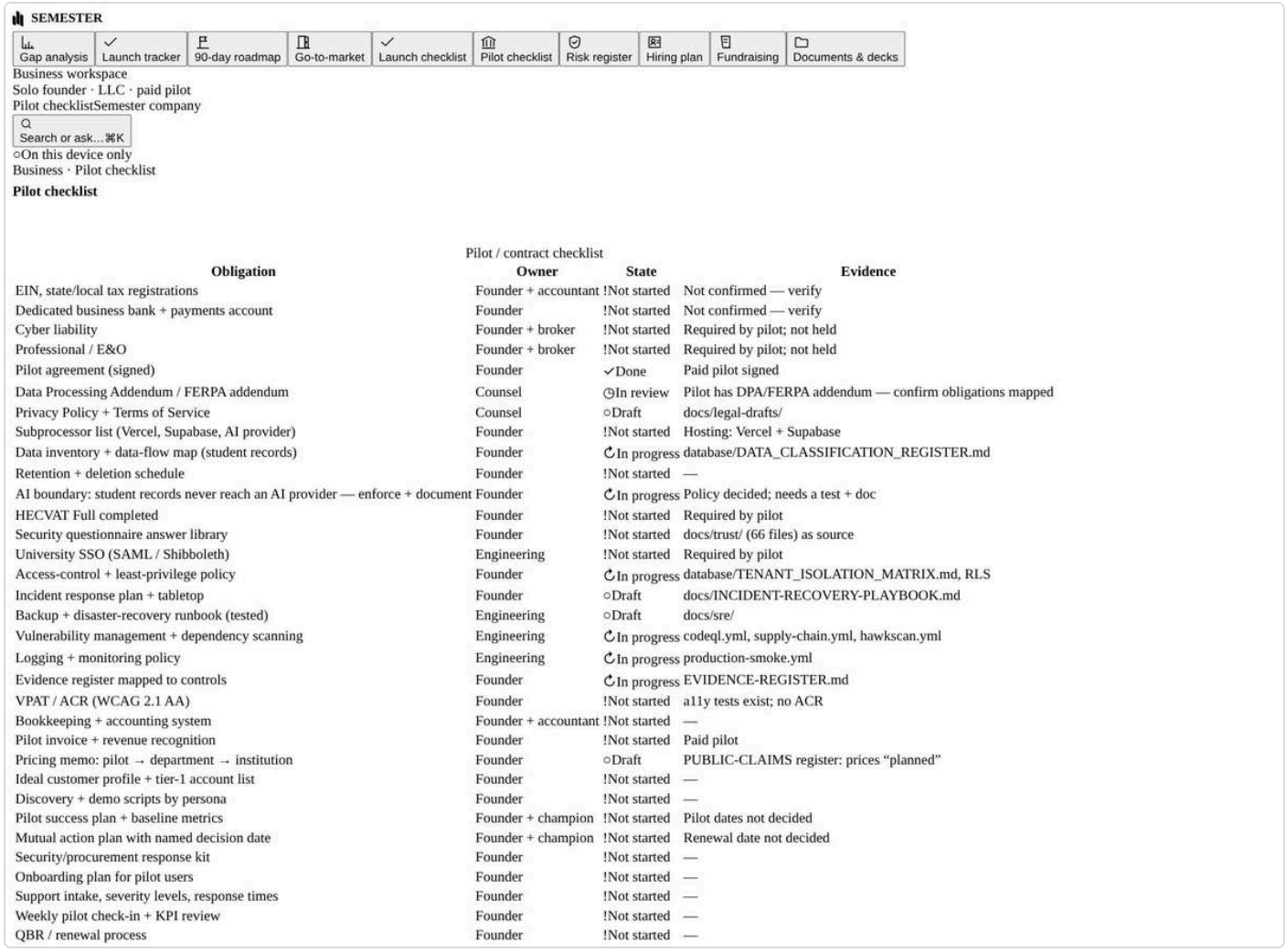
Launch checklist

Launch master checklist Each area lists what to create and the evidence that proves it is done. Counsel, accountant and broker own their rows.

Launch master checklist

Area	Create / complete	Launch evidence
Corporate	Company owns all IP; founder + contractor assignments filed	Signed assignments in records folder
Banking	Business account, approval rules, chart of accounts	Business funds separate from personal
Accounting	Bookkeeping, monthly close checklist, expense policy, tax calendar	Monthly P&L, balance sheet, cash flow
Financial model	36-month driver-based model	Unit economics, runway, break-even
Pricing	Pilot, institution, implementation, AI overage, support	Approved price book + discount rules
Insurance	Cyber, E&O, general liability; evaluate D&O later	Coverage reviewed against contract
Legal	Terms, Privacy, DPA, SLA, MSA	Versioned and counsel-reviewed
Identity	MFA on admin, code, cloud, finance, CRM, support, production	MFA report
Access	Least privilege, role review, contractor offboarding	Quarterly access review log
Data	Encryption in transit/at rest, backups, restore test	Restore test record with RTO/RPO
Monitoring	Errors, uptime, security alert triage, audit logging	Alert runbook + on-call
Resilience	Business continuity + DR runbook, tested	Tabletop record
Vendor risk	Subprocessor review + vendor register	Vendor register
Procurement	HECVAT Full, answer library, DPA/SLA path	Completed HECVAT
Accessibility	ACR/VPAT, manual test protocol, statement	Published ACR

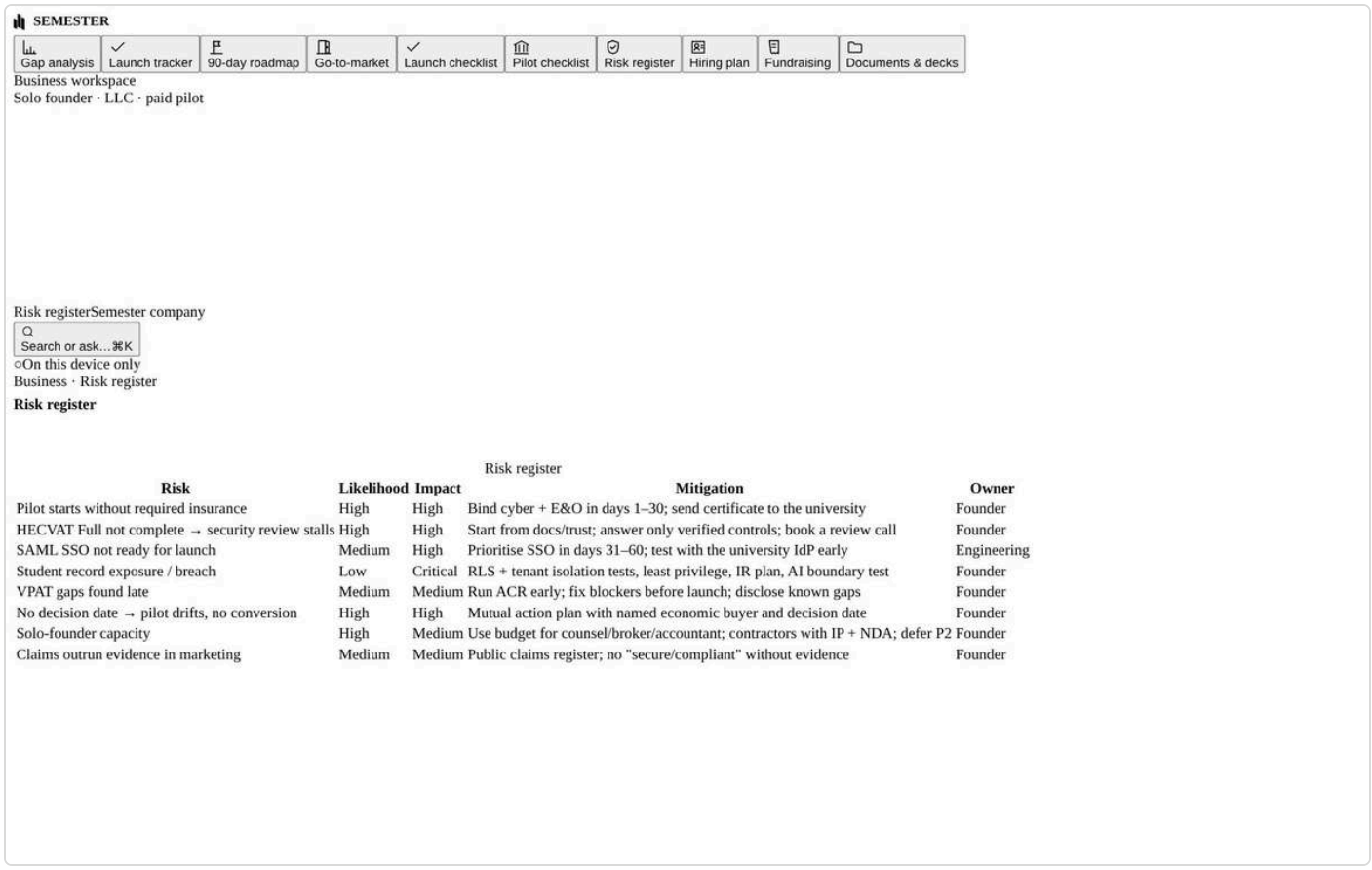
Launch checklist



Pilot / contract checklist

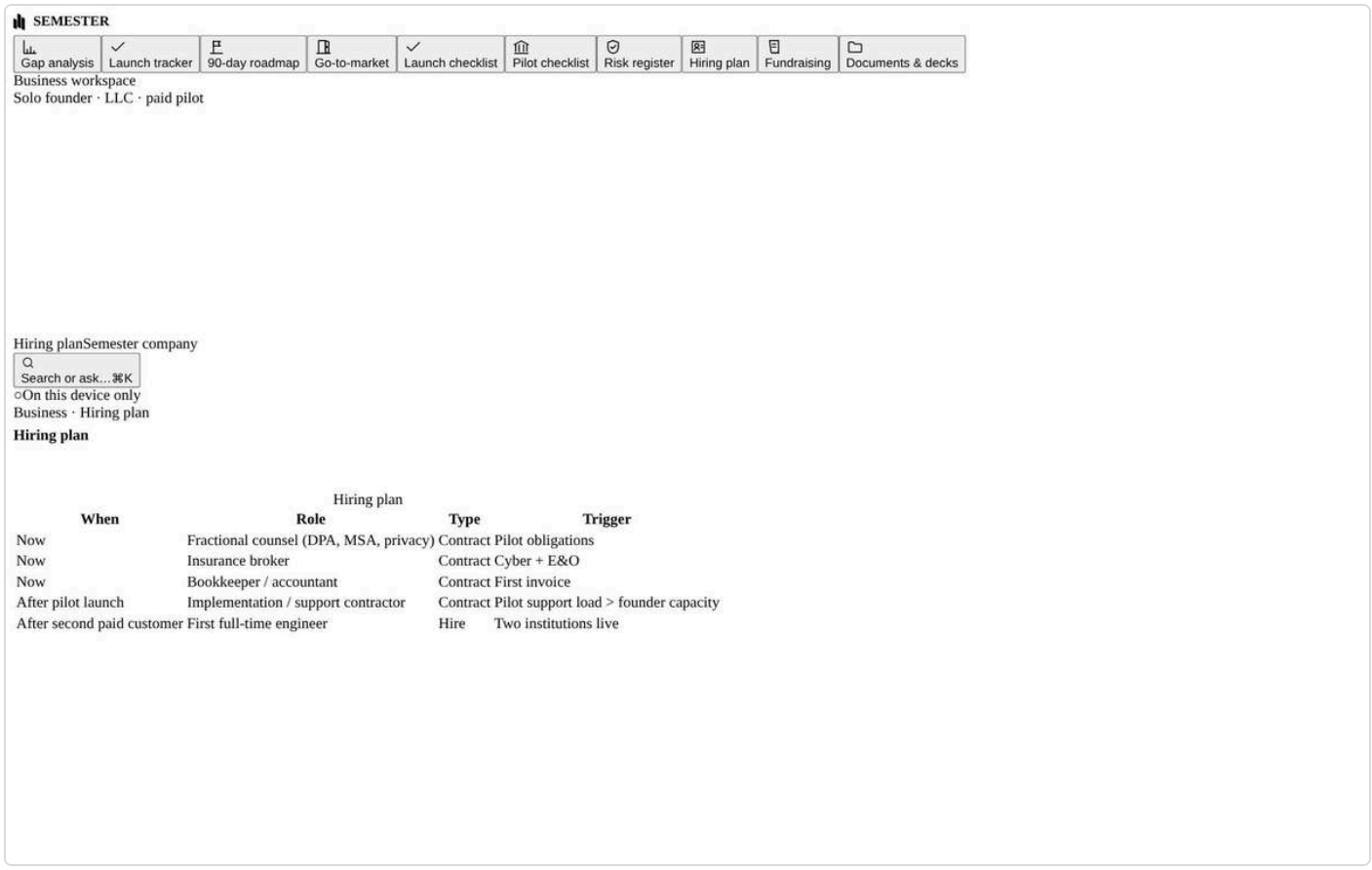
Obligation	Owner	State	Evidence
EIN, state/local tax registrations	Founder + accountant	!Not started	Not confirmed — verify
Dedicated business bank + payments account	Founder	!Not started	Not confirmed — verify
Cyber liability	Founder + broker	!Not started	Required by pilot; not held
Professional / E&O	Founder + broker	!Not started	Required by pilot; not held
Pilot agreement (signed)	Founder	✓Done	Paid pilot signed
Data Processing Addendum / FERPA addendum	Counsel	◷In review	Pilot has DPA/FERPA addendum — confirm obligations mapped
Privacy Policy + Terms of Service	Counsel	○Draft	docs/legal-drafts/
Subprocessor list (Vercel, Supabase, AI provider)	Founder	!Not started	Hosting: Vercel + Supabase
Data inventory + data-flow map (student records)	Founder	↻In progress	database/DATA_CLASSIFICATION_REGISTER.md
Retention + deletion schedule	Founder	!Not started	—
AI boundary: student records never reach an AI provider — enforce + document	Founder	↻In progress	Policy decided; needs a test + doc
HECVAT Full completed	Founder	!Not started	Required by pilot
Security questionnaire answer library	Founder	!Not started	docs/trust/ (66 files) as source
University SSO (SAML / Shibboleth)	Engineering	!Not started	Required by pilot
Access-control + least-privilege policy	Founder	↻In progress	database/TENANT_ISOLATION_MATRIX.md, RLS
Incident response plan + tabletop	Founder	○Draft	docs/INCIDENT-RECOVERY-PLAYBOOK.md
Backup + disaster-recovery runbook (tested)	Engineering	○Draft	docs/sre/
Vulnerability management + dependency scanning	Engineering	↻In progress	codeql.yml, supply-chain.yml, hawkscan.yml
Logging + monitoring policy	Engineering	↻In progress	production-smoke.yml
Evidence register mapped to controls	Founder	↻In progress	EVIDENCE-REGISTER.md
VPAT / ACR (WCAG 2.1 AA)	Founder	!Not started	a11y tests exist; no ACR
Bookkeeping + accounting system	Founder + accountant	!Not started	—
Pilot invoice + revenue recognition	Founder	!Not started	Paid pilot
Pricing memo: pilot → department → institution	Founder	○Draft	PUBLIC-CLAIMS register: prices “planned”
Ideal customer profile + tier-1 account list	Founder	!Not started	—
Discovery + demo scripts by persona	Founder	!Not started	—
Pilot success plan + baseline metrics	Founder + champion	!Not started	Pilot dates not decided
Mutual action plan with named decision date	Founder + champion	!Not started	Renewal date not decided
Security/procurement response kit	Founder	!Not started	—
Onboarding plan for pilot users	Founder	!Not started	—
Support intake, severity levels, response times	Founder	!Not started	—
Weekly pilot check-in + KPI review	Founder	!Not started	—
QBR / renewal process	Founder	!Not started	—

Pilot checklist

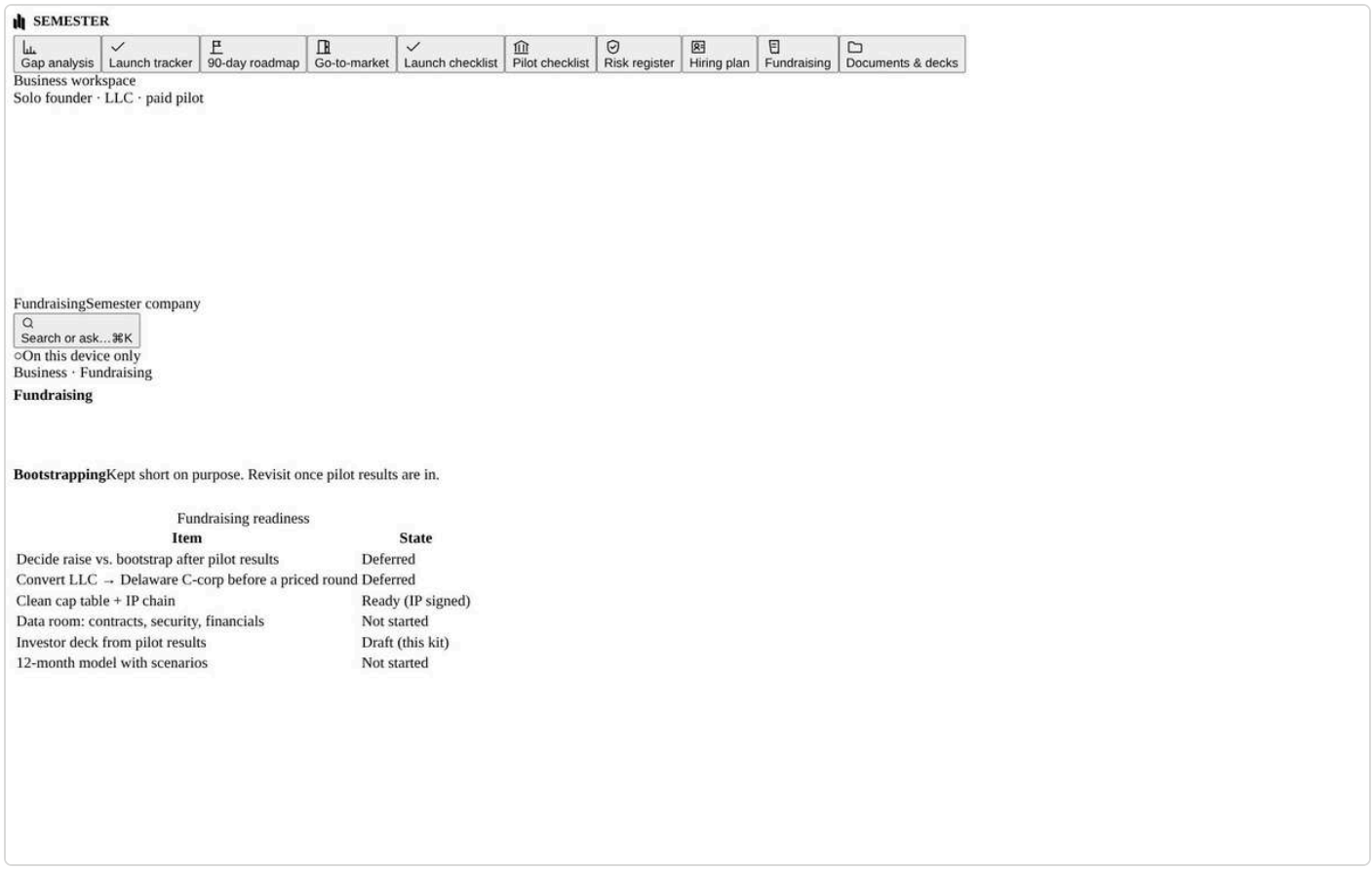


Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation	Owner
Pilot starts without required insurance	High	High	Bind cyber + E&O in days 1–30; send certificate to the university	Founder
HECVAT Full not complete → security review stalls	High	High	Start from docs/trust; answer only verified controls; book a review call	Founder
SAML SSO not ready for launch	Medium	High	Prioritise SSO in days 31–60; test with the university IdP early	Engineering
Student record exposure / breach	Low	Critical	RLS + tenant isolation tests, least privilege, IR plan, AI boundary test	Founder
VPAT gaps found late	Medium	Medium	Run ACR early; fix blockers before launch; disclose known gaps	Founder
No decision date → pilot drifts, no conversion	High	High	Mutual action plan with named economic buyer and decision date	Founder
Solo-founder capacity	High	Medium	Use budget for counsel/broker/accountant; contractors with IP + NDA; defer P2	Founder
Claims outrun evidence in marketing	Medium	Medium	Public claims register; no "secure/compliant" without evidence	Founder

Risk register


SEMESTER
Gap analysis
Launch tracker
90-day roadmap
Go-to-market
Launch checklist
Pilot checklist
Risk register
Hiring plan
Fundraising
Documents & decks
Business workspace
Solo founder · LLC · paid pilot
Hiring planSemester company
Search or ask...⌘K
On this device only
Business · Hiring plan
Hiring plan
Hiring plan
When
Role
Type
Trigger
Now
Fractional counsel (DPA, MSA, privacy)
Contract
Pilot obligations
Now
Insurance broker
Contract
Cyber + E&O
Now
Bookkeeper / accountant
Contract
First invoice
After pilot launch
Implementation / support contractor
Contract
Pilot support load > founder capacity
After second paid customer
First full-time engineer
Hire
Two institutions live

Hiring plan



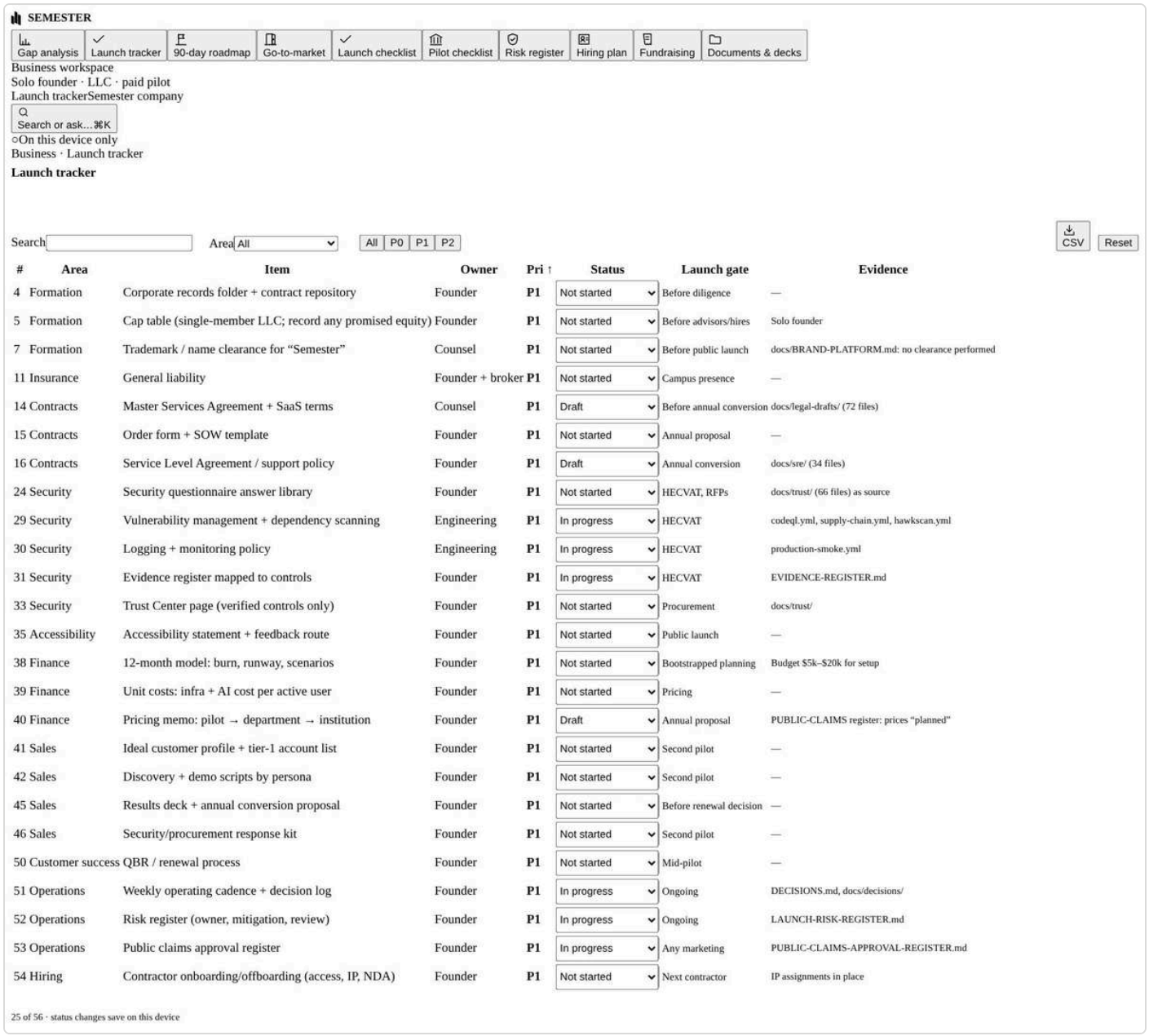
Fundraising



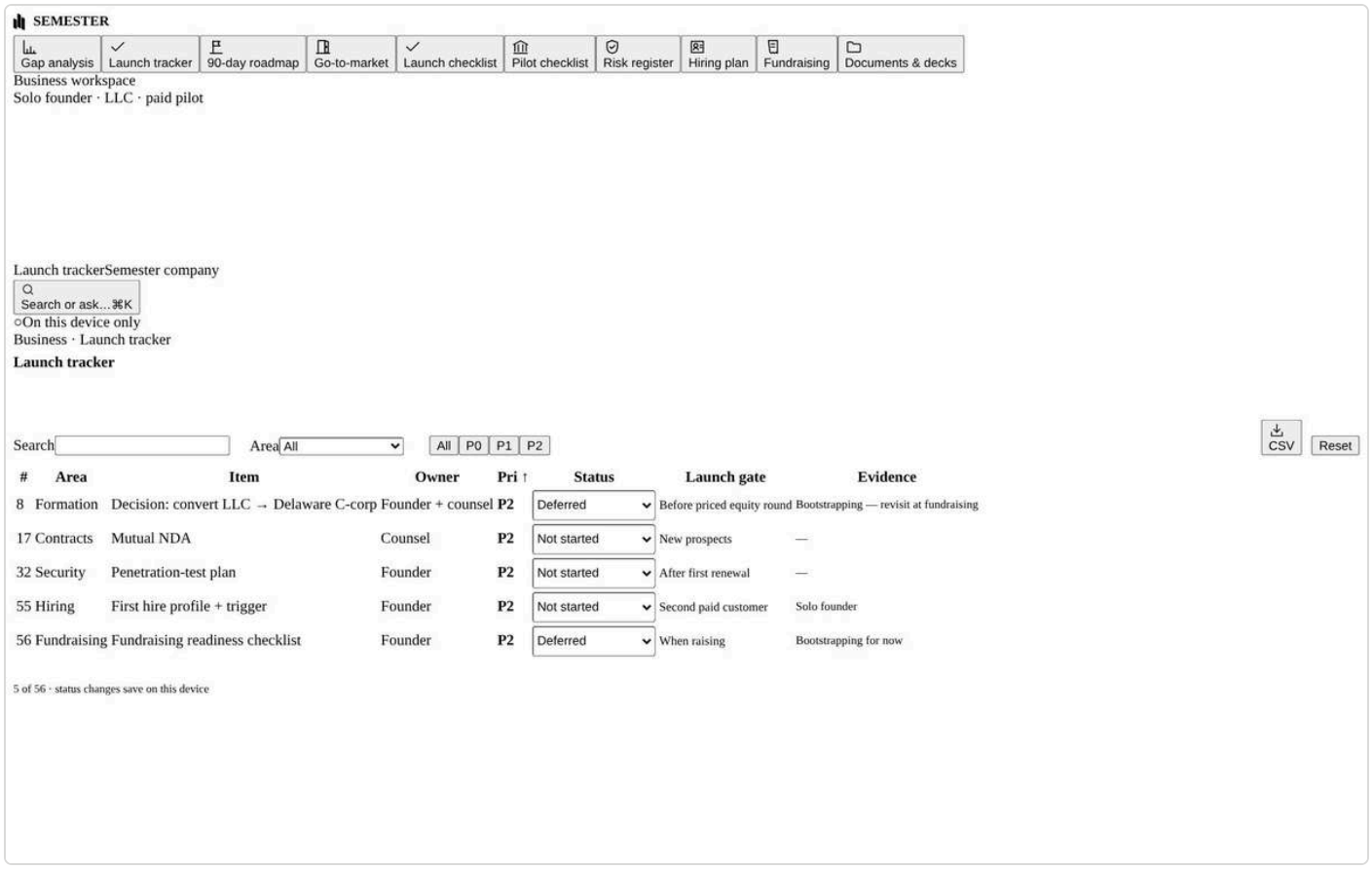
Documents & decks



Launch tracker › P0

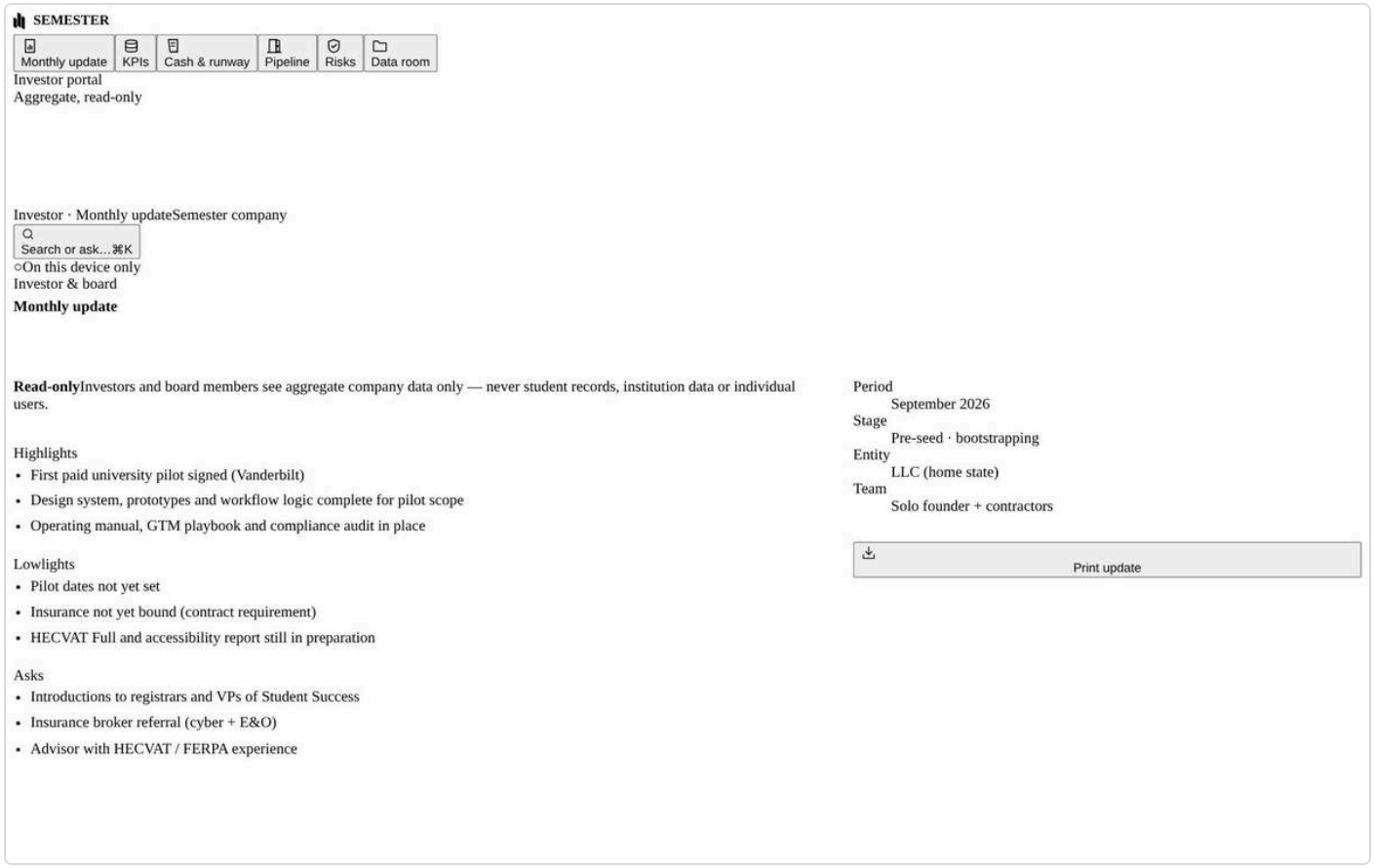


Launch tracker › P1

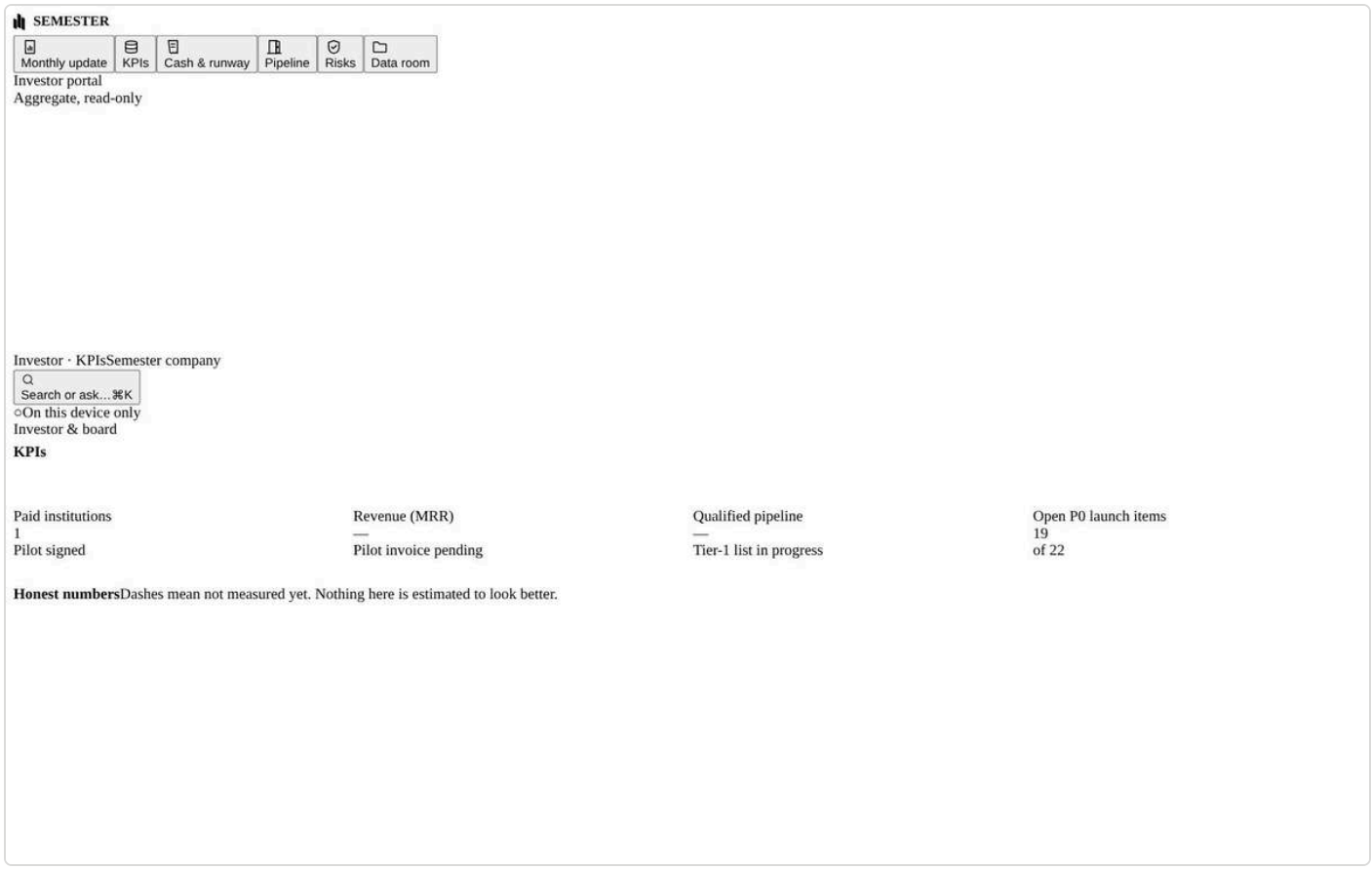


Launch tracker › P2

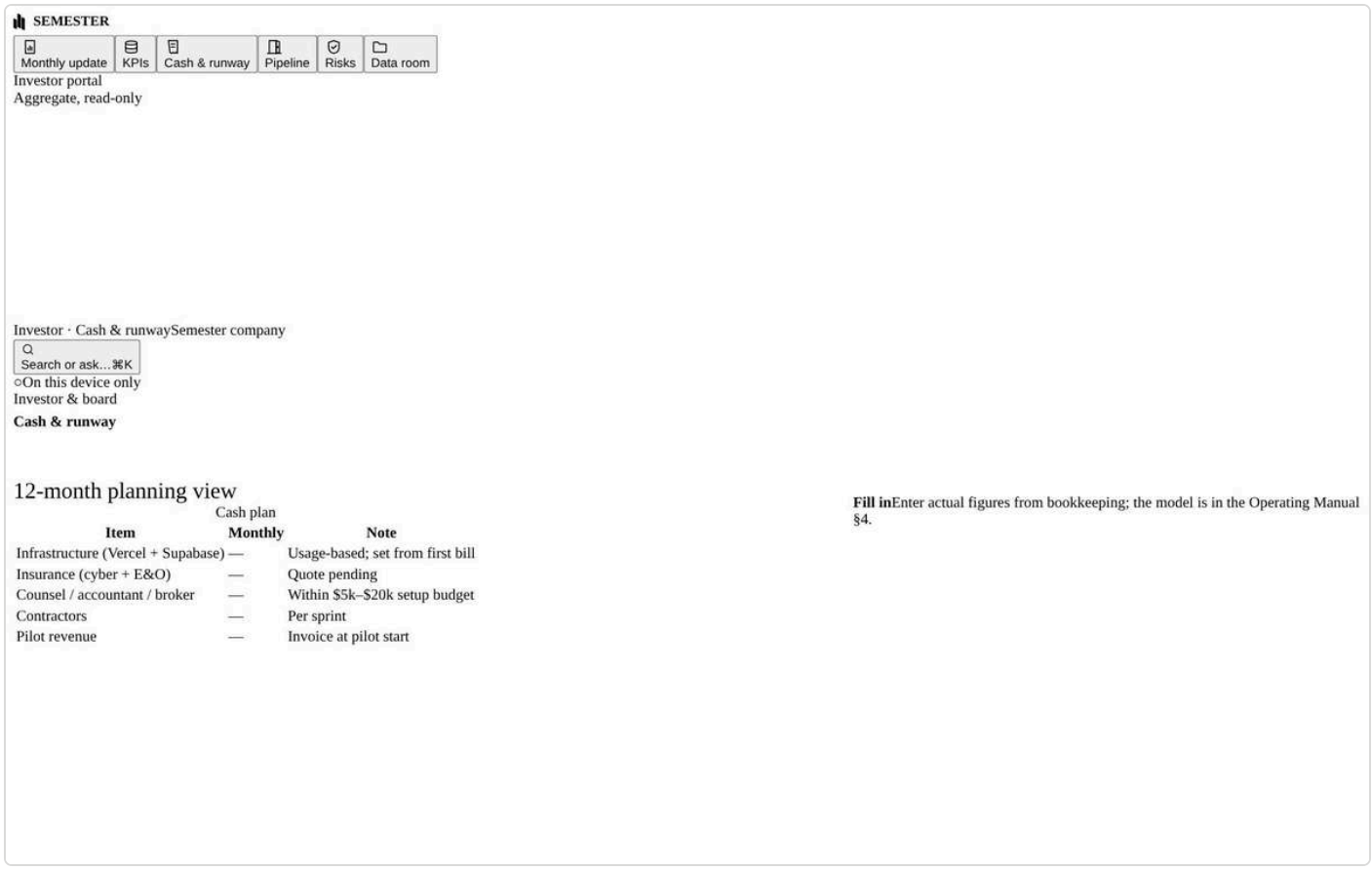
investor



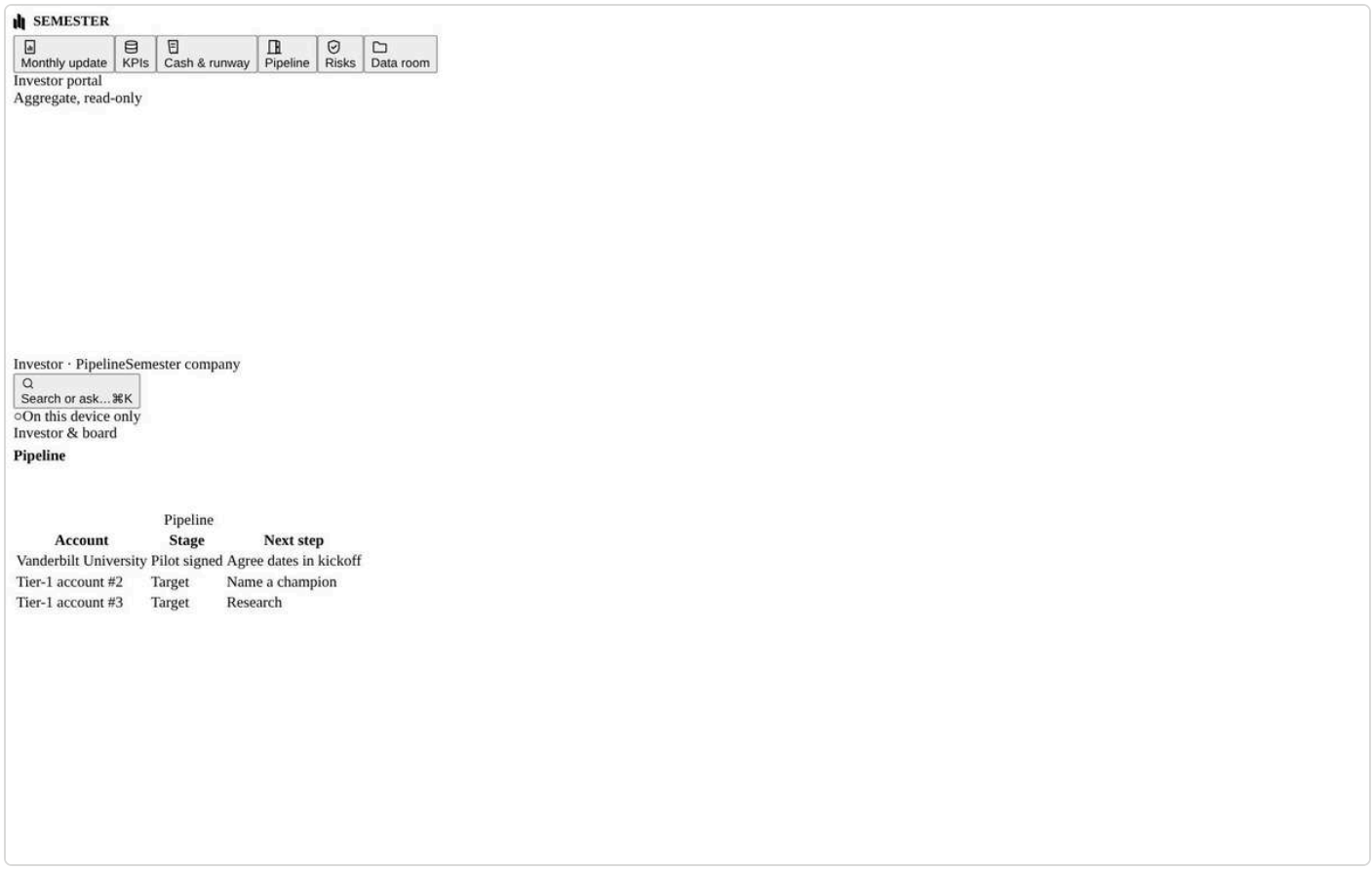
Opening view


SEMESTER
Monthly update
KPIs
Cash & runway
Pipeline
Risks
Data room
Investor portal
Aggregate, read-only
Investor · KPIsSemester company
Search or ask… ⌘K
On this device only
Investor & board
KPIs
Paid institutions
1
Pilot signed
Revenue (MRR)
—
Pilot invoice pending
Qualified pipeline
—
Tier-1 list in progress
Open P0 launch items
19
of 22
Honest numbersDashes mean not measured yet. Nothing here is estimated to look better.

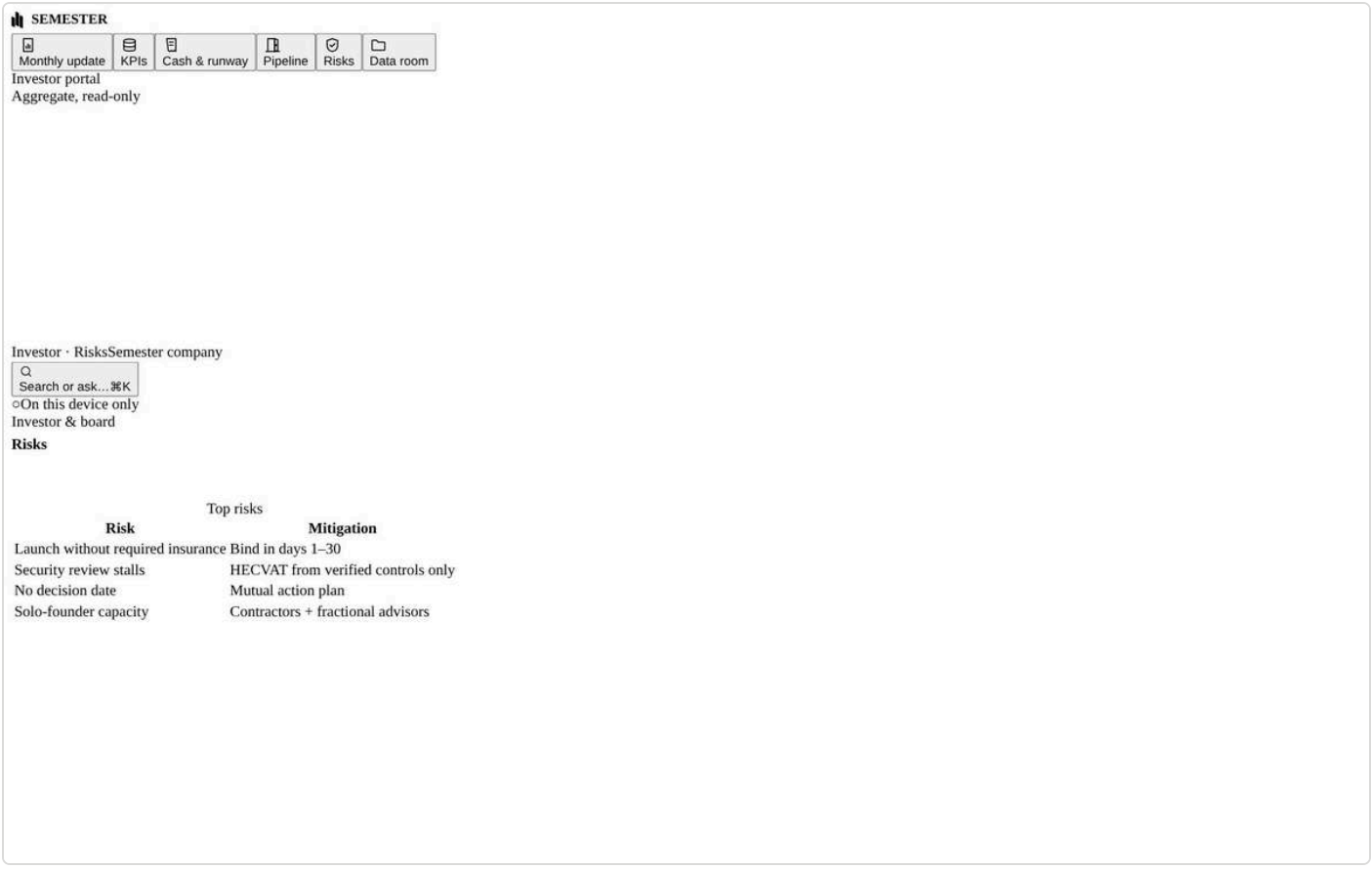
KPIs


SEMESTER
Monthly update
KPIs
Cash & runway
Pipeline
Risks
Data room
Investor portal
Aggregate, read-only
Investor · Cash & runwaySemester company
Search or ask…⌘K
On this device only
Investor & board
Cash & runway
12-month planning view
Cash plan
Item
Monthly
Note
Infrastructure (Vercel + Supabase) —
Usage-based; set from first bill
Insurance (cyber + E&O) —
Quote pending
Counsel / accountant / broker —
Within $5k–$20k setup budget
Contractors —
Per sprint
Pilot revenue —
Invoice at pilot start
Fill inEnter actual figures from bookkeeping; the model is in the Operating Manual §4.

Cash & runway


SEMESTER
Monthly update
KPIs
Cash & runway
Pipeline
Risks
Data room
Investor portal
Aggregate, read-only
Investor · PipelineSemester company
Search or ask… ⌘K
On this device only
Investor & board
Pipeline
Pipeline
Account
Stage
Next step
Vanderbilt University
Pilot signed
Agree dates in kickoff
Tier-1 account #2
Target
Name a champion
Tier-1 account #3
Target
Research

Pipeline

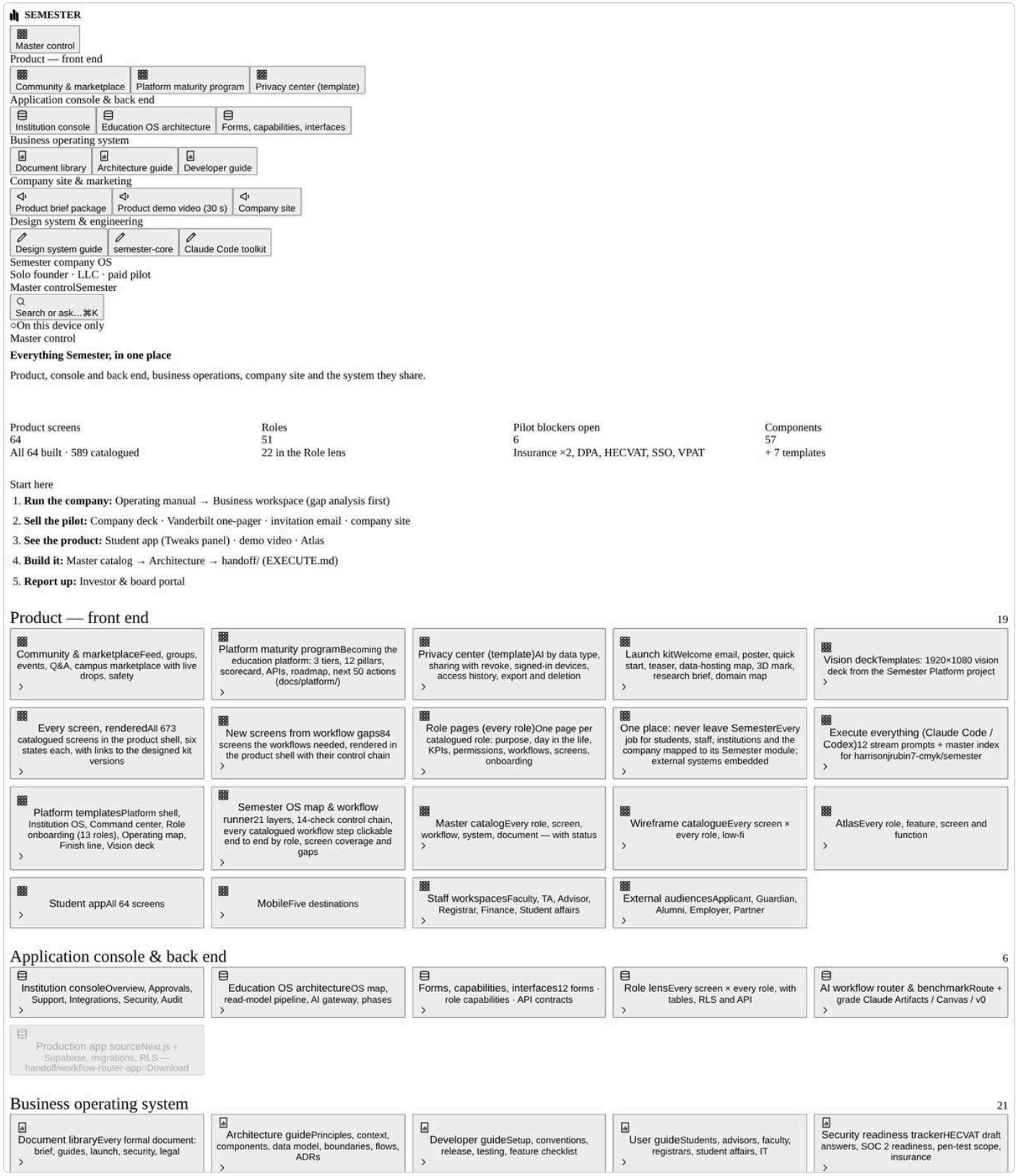

SEMESTER
Monthly update
KPIs
Cash & runway
Pipeline
Risks
Data room
Investor portal
Aggregate, read-only
Investor · RisksSemester company
Search or ask…⌘K
On this device only
Investor & board
Risks
Top risks
Risk
Mitigation
Launch without required insurance
Bind in days 1–30
Security review stalls
HECVAT from verified controls only
No decision date
Mutual action plan
Solo-founder capacity
Contractors + fractional advisors

Risks

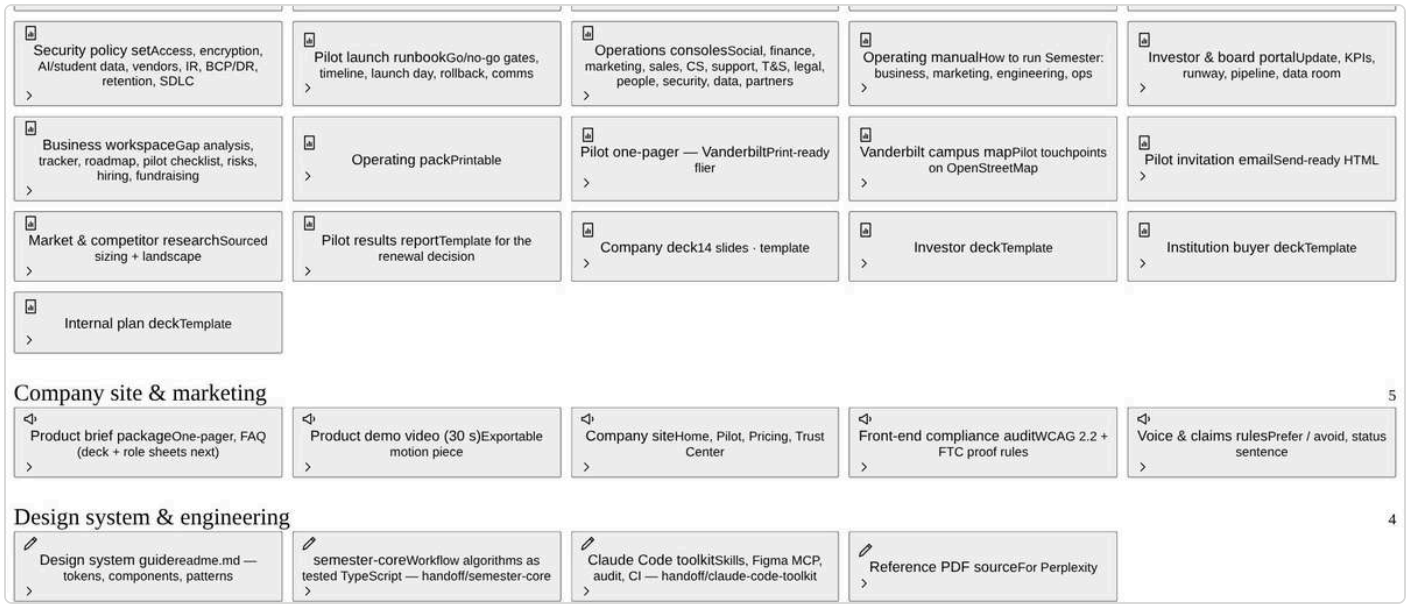

SEMESTER
Monthly update
KPIs
Cash & runway
Pipeline
Risks
Data room
Investor portal
Aggregate, read-only
Investor · Data roomSemester company
Search or ask... ⌘K
On this device only
Investor & board
Data room
Company deckOpen
Investor deckOpen
Market & competitor researchOpen
Operating manualOpen
ArchitectureOpen
Master catalogOpen

Data room

master-control



Opening view (1/2)

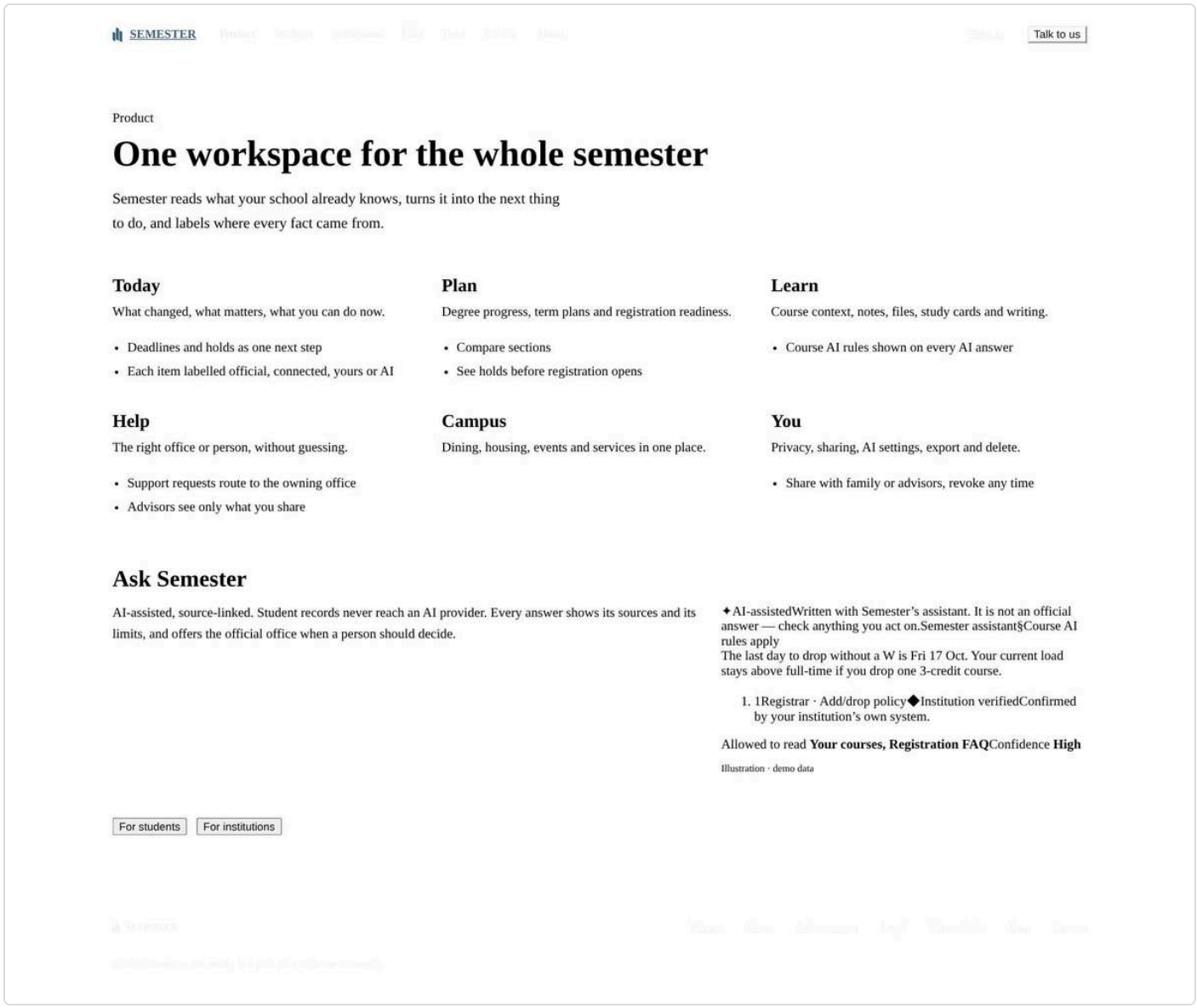


Opening view (2/2)

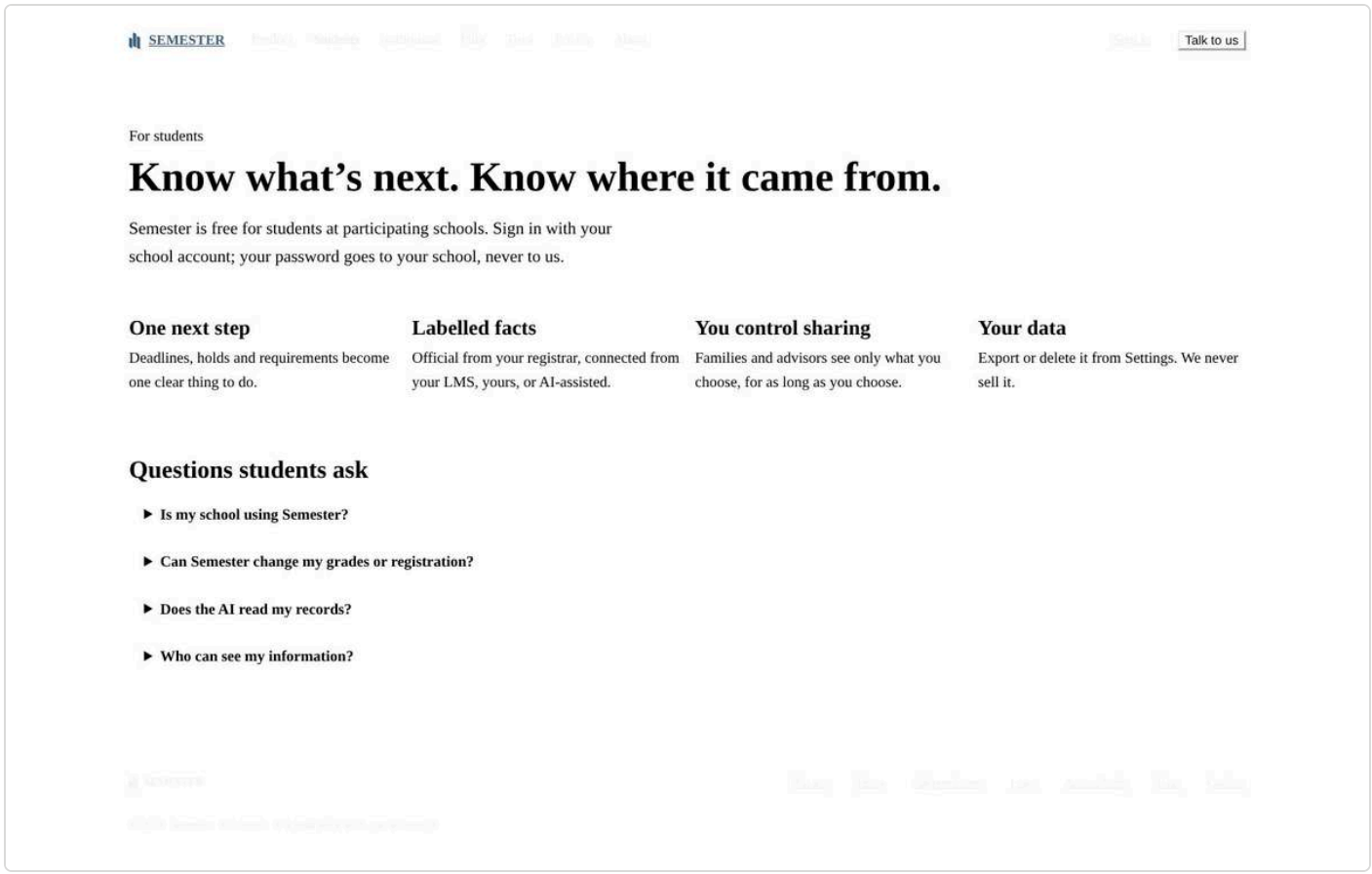
company-site



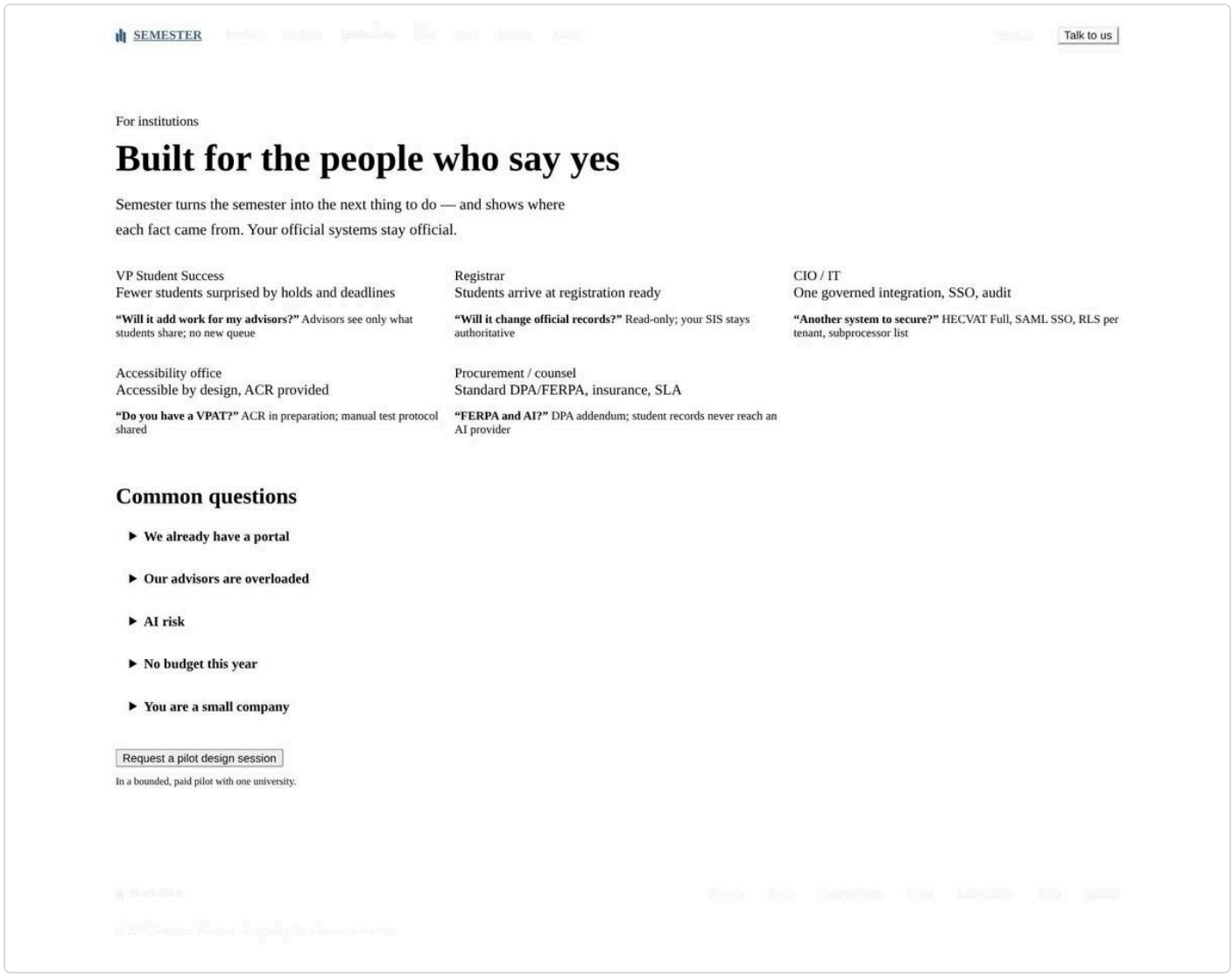
Opening view


SEMESTER
Talk to us
Product
One workspace for the whole semester
Semester reads what your school already knows, turns it into the next thing to do, and labels where every fact came from.
Today
What changed, what matters, what you can do now.
Deadlines and holds as one next step
Each item labelled official, connected, yours or AI
Plan
Degree progress, term plans and registration readiness.
Compare sections
See holds before registration opens
Learn
Course context, notes, files, study cards and writing.
Course AI rules shown on every AI answer
Help
The right office or person, without guessing.
Support requests route to the owning office
Advisors see only what you share
Campus
Dining, housing, events and services in one place.
You
Privacy, sharing, AI settings, export and delete.
Share with family or advisors, revoke any time
Ask Semester
AI-assisted, source-linked. Student records never reach an AI provider. Every answer shows its sources and its limits, and offers the official office when a person should decide.
✦AI-assistedWritten with Semester's assistant. It is not an official answer — check anything you act on.Semester assistant§Course AI rules apply
The last day to drop without a W is Fri 17 Oct. Your current load stays above full-time if you drop one 3-credit course.
1. 1Registrar · Add/drop policy◆Institution verifiedConfirmed by your institution's own system.
Allowed to read Your courses, Registration FAQConfidence High
Illustration · demo data
For students
For institutions

Product


SEMESTER
Talk to us
For students
Know what’s next. Know where it came from.
Semester is free for students at participating schools. Sign in with your school account; your password goes to your school, never to us.
One next step
Deadlines, holds and requirements become one clear thing to do.
Labelled facts
Official from your registrar, connected from your LMS, yours, or AI-assisted.
You control sharing
Families and advisors see only what you choose, for as long as you choose.
Your data
Export or delete it from Settings. We never sell it.
Questions students ask
Is my school using Semester?
Can Semester change my grades or registration?
Does the AI read my records?
Who can see my information?

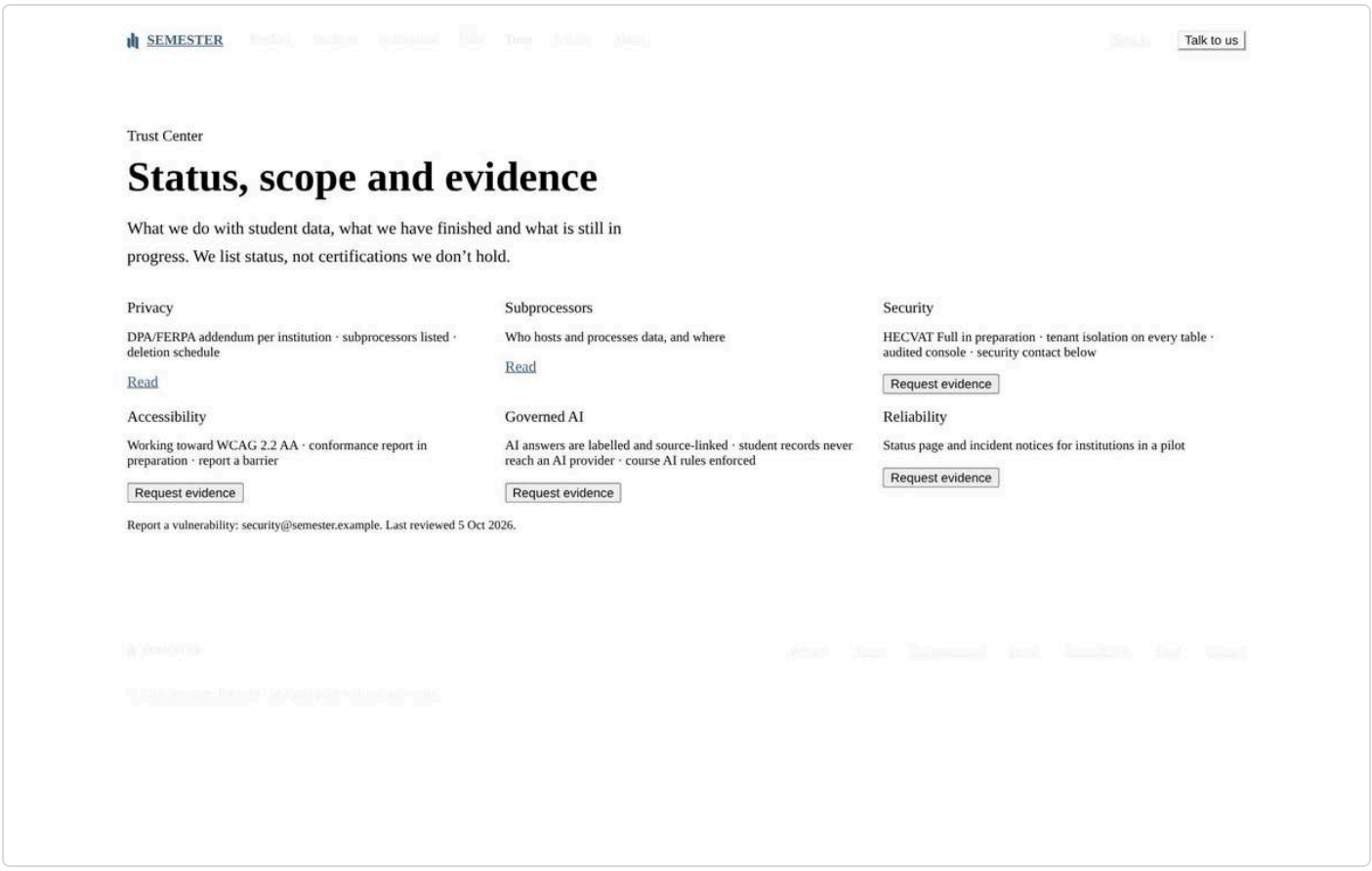
Students



Institutions


SEMESTER
Talk to us
Registration Readiness Pilot
A one-term pilot with named success measures
Paid, bounded and read-only. You agree the measures before launch, and the results decide what happens next.
Who it’s for
A student success, advising or registrar team that wants fewer students surprised by holds and missed registration steps.
What changes
Students in the pilot cohort see one next step for registration, with the source of each fact. Advisors see what students choose to share.
Scope and non-goals
One term, one cohort. Read-only SIS and LMS connection. No changes to official records; no replacement of existing systems.
Timeline
About six weeks of setup before launch: contracts and security review, SSO and SIS connection, staff training, then a dry run.
Data, security, accessibility
DPA/FERPA addendum, HECVAT Full, SAML SSO and an accessibility conformance report. Student records never reach an AI provider.
Success measures
Agreed and signed before launch, measured against a baseline, reported at the end of term.
Roles
Your sponsor, champion, IT and registrar contacts; Semester runs setup, support and reporting.
After the pilot
A results report, then a decision: annual agreement, a second term, or a clean exit with your data exported and deleted.
Request a pilot design session
Name (required)
Work email (required)
Institution type
University
Anything we should know
Send
We reply within two business days. No marketing list. Please don’t include student information.

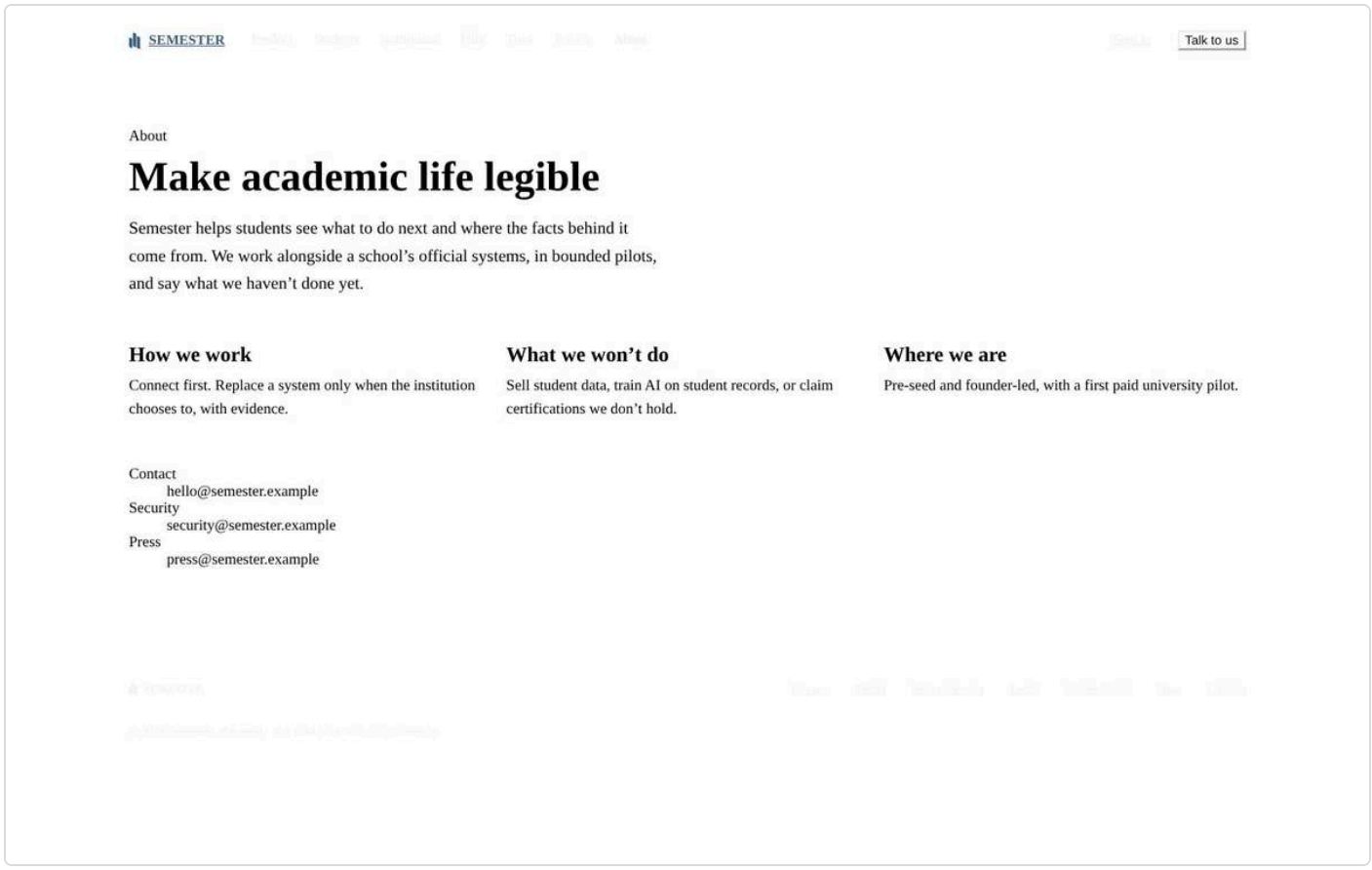
Pilot


SEMESTER
Talk to us
Trust Center
Status, scope and evidence
What we do with student data, what we have finished and what is still in progress. We list status, not certifications we don’t hold.
Privacy
DPA/FERPA addendum per institution · subprocessors listed · deletion schedule
Read
Subprocessors
Who hosts and processes data, and where
Read
Security
HECVAT Full in preparation · tenant isolation on every table · audited console · security contact below
Request evidence
Accessibility
Working toward WCAG 2.2 AA · conformance report in preparation · report a barrier
Request evidence
Governed AI
AI answers are labelled and source-linked · student records never reach an AI provider · course AI rules enforced
Request evidence
Reliability
Status page and incident notices for institutions in a pilot
Request evidence
Report a vulnerability: security@semester.example. Last reviewed 5 Oct 2026.

Trust


SEMESTER
Talk to us
Pricing
Plans
Free for students. Institution prices are quoted per pilot and per campus; they are not published yet.
Student
Free
Planning workspace, Today, sharing
Pilot
Quoted
One term, named measures, SSO, read-only connection
Institution
Quoted
Console, integrations, SSO, annual
Enterprise
Quoted
Multi-campus, advanced controls
Features
Feature
Student
Department
Institution
Enterprise
Student planning workspace
Included
Included
Included
Included
Advisor workflows
Limited
Included
Included
Advanced
Tenant configuration
—
Limited
Included
Advanced
SSO
—
Optional
Included
Required
Integrations
—
Limited
Included
Advanced
Premium support
—
Add-on
Add-on
Included
Ask for a quote

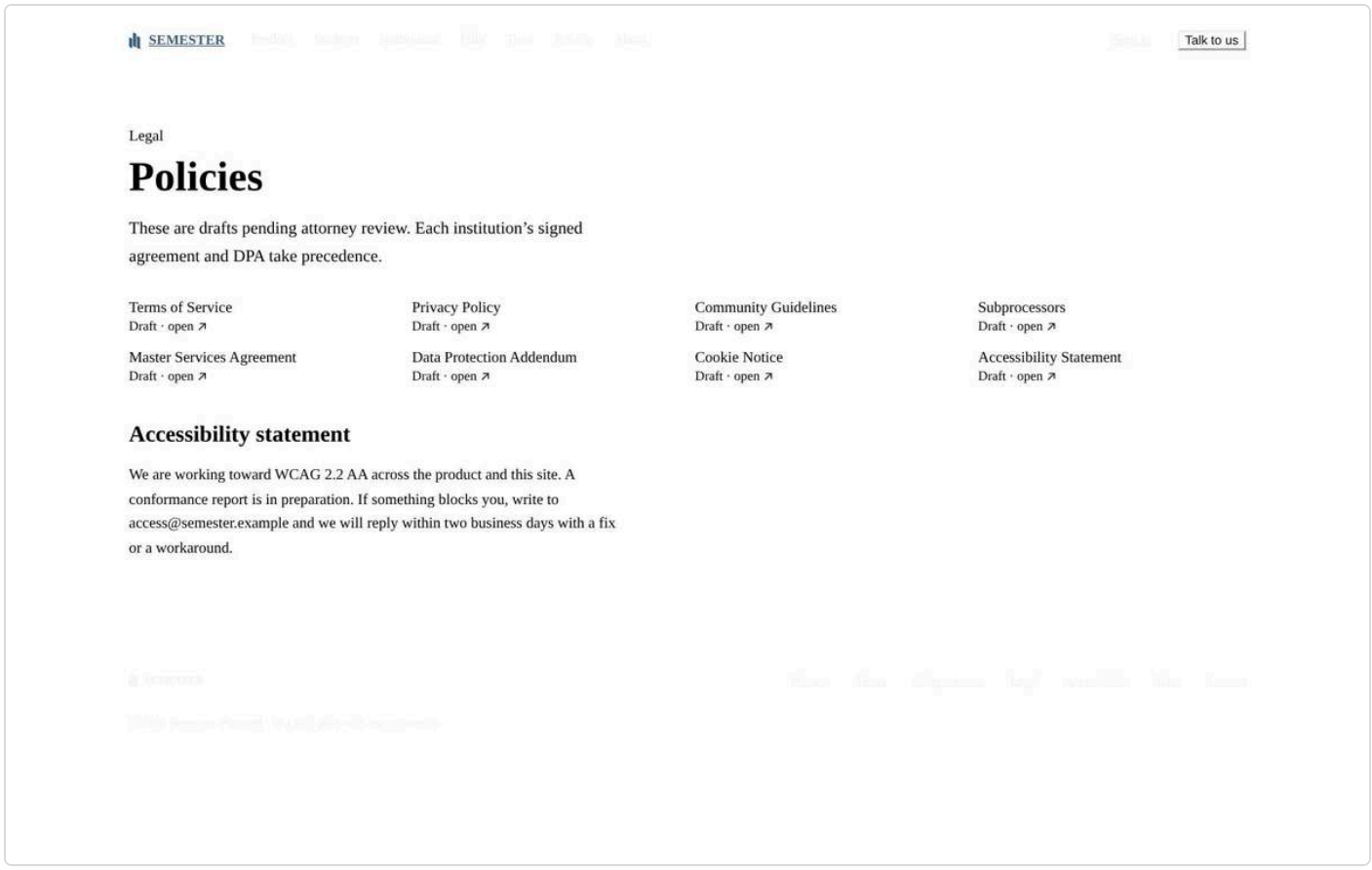
Pricing


SEMESTER
Talk to us
About
Make academic life legible
Semester helps students see what to do next and where the facts behind it come from. We work alongside a school’s official systems, in bounded pilots, and say what we haven’t done yet.
How we work
Connect first. Replace a system only when the institution chooses to, with evidence.
What we won’t do
Sell student data, train AI on student records, or claim certifications we don’t hold.
Where we are
Pre-seed and founder-led, with a first paid university pilot.
Contact
hello@semester.example
Security
security@semester.example
Press
press@semester.example

About


SEMESTER
Talk to us
Contact
Talk to us
Pilots, pricing, security reviews or accessibility questions. A person replies within two business days.
General
hello@semester.example
Security
security@semester.example
Accessibility
access@semester.example
Students: questions about your account go to your school's help desk first.
Send a message
Name (required)
Work email (required)
Topic
Pilot or pricing
Anything we should know
Send
We reply within two business days. No marketing list. Please don't include student information.

Talk to us

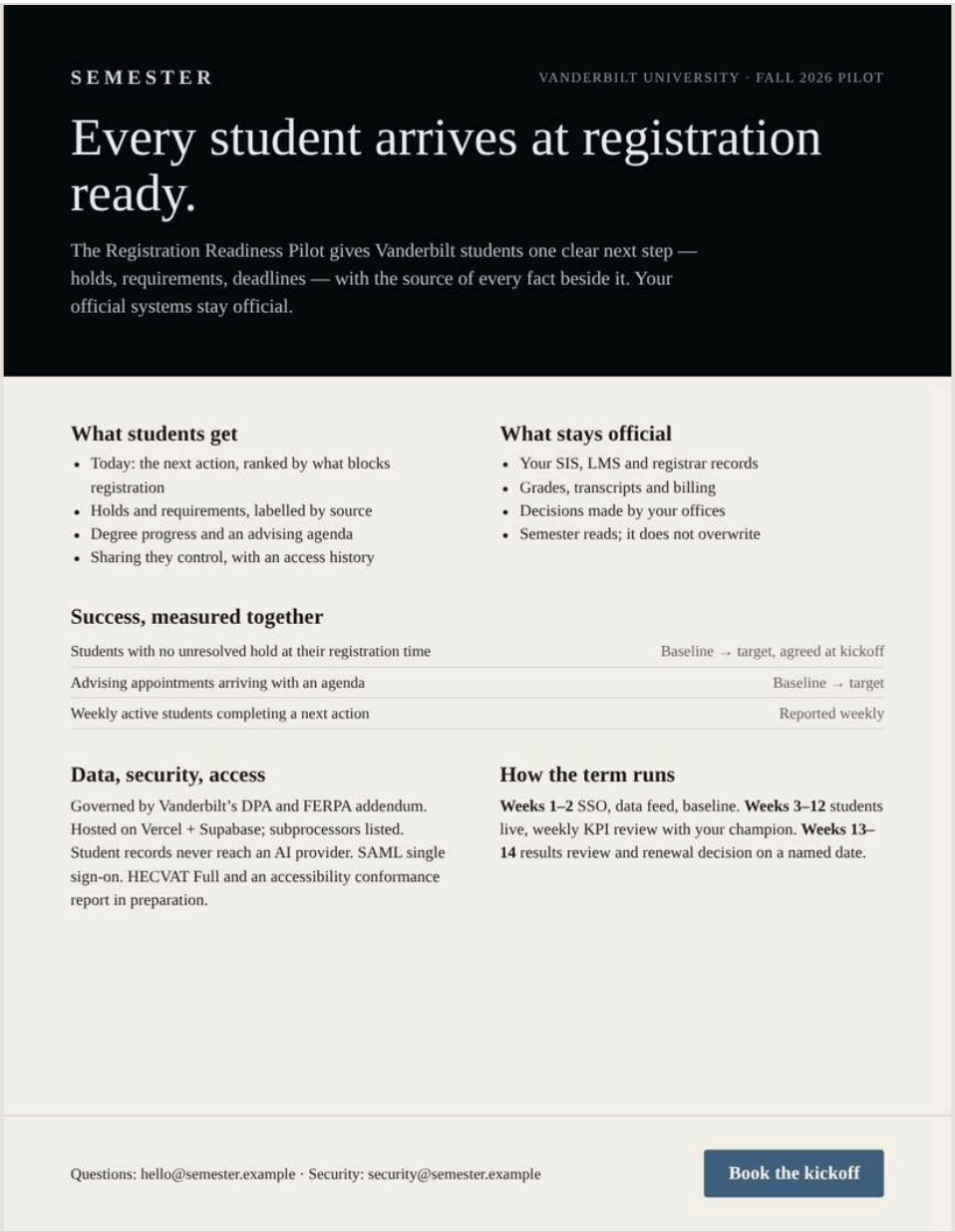

SEMESTER
Talk to us
Legal
Policies
These are drafts pending attorney review. Each institution’s signed agreement and DPA take precedence.
Terms of Service
Draft · open ↗
Privacy Policy
Draft · open ↗
Community Guidelines
Draft · open ↗
Subprocessors
Draft · open ↗
Master Services Agreement
Draft · open ↗
Data Protection Addendum
Draft · open ↗
Cookie Notice
Draft · open ↗
Accessibility Statement
Draft · open ↗
Accessibility statement
We are working toward WCAG 2.2 AA across the product and this site. A conformance report is in preparation. If something blocks you, write to access@semester.example and we will reply within two business days with a fix or a workaround.

Legal


SEMESTER
Talk to us
Registration Readiness Pilot
A one-term pilot with named success measures
Paid, bounded and read-only. You agree the measures before launch, and the results decide what happens next.
Who it’s for
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Timeline
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Data, security, accessibility
DPA/FERPA addendum, HECVAT Full, SAML SSO and an accessibility conformance report. Student records never reach an AI provider.
Success measures
Agreed and signed before launch, measured against a baseline, reported at the end of term.
Roles
Your sponsor, champion, IT and registrar contacts; Semester runs setup, support and reporting.
After the pilot
A results report, then a decision: annual agreement, a second term, or a clean exit with your data exported and deleted.
Request a pilot design session
! 2 fields need attention.
Name (required)
!Enter your name.
Work email (required)
!Enter a full email address, like name@university.edu.
Institution type
University
Anything we should know
Send
We reply within two business days. No marketing list. Please don’t include student information.

Pilot › Send

Pilot One Pager



SEMESTER

VANDERBILT UNIVERSITY · FALL 2026 PILOT

Every student arrives at registration ready.

The Registration Readiness Pilot gives Vanderbilt students one clear next step — holds, requirements, deadlines — with the source of every fact beside it. Your official systems stay official.

What students get

- Today: the next action, ranked by what blocks registration
- Holds and requirements, labelled by source
- Degree progress and an advising agenda
- Sharing they control, with an access history

What stays official

- Your SIS, LMS and registrar records
- Grades, transcripts and billing
- Decisions made by your offices
- Semester reads; it does not overwrite

Success, measured together

Students with no unresolved hold at their registration time	Baseline → target, agreed at kickoff
Advising appointments arriving with an agenda	Baseline → target
Weekly active students completing a next action	Reported weekly

Data, security, access

Governed by Vanderbilt's DPA and FERPA addendum. Hosted on Vercel + Supabase; subprocessors listed. Student records never reach an AI provider. SAML single sign-on. HECVAT Full and an accessibility conformance report in preparation.

How the term runs

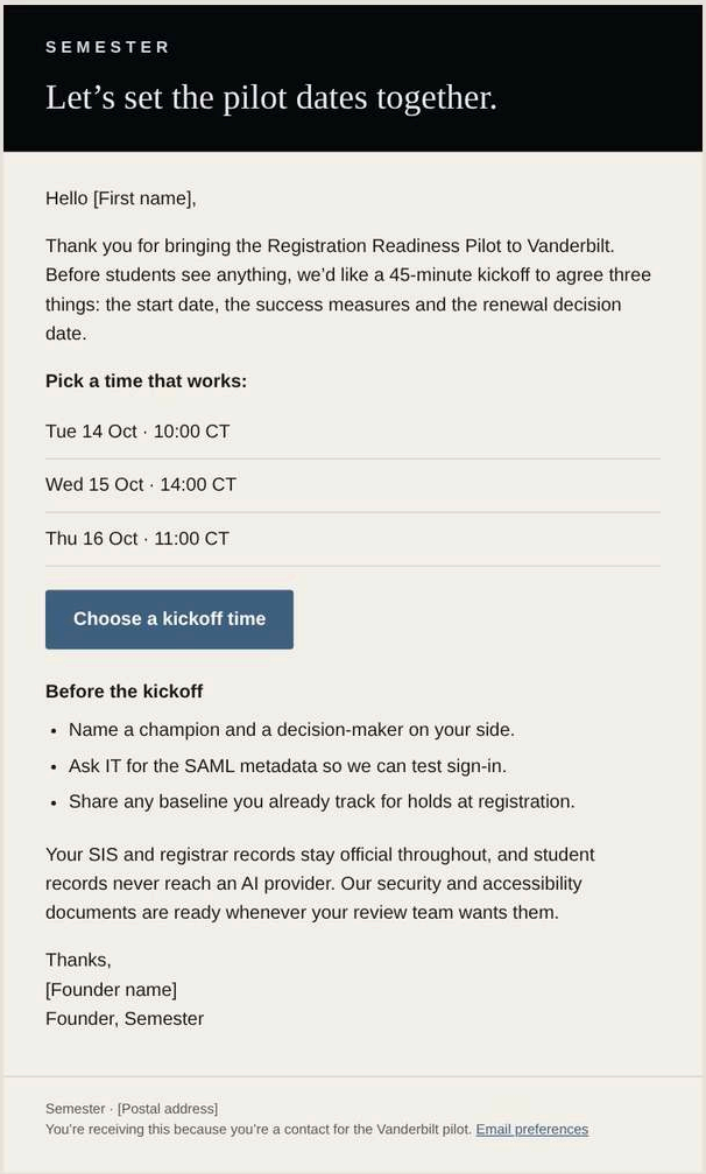
Weeks 1–2 SSO, data feed, baseline. **Weeks 3–12** students live, weekly KPI review with your champion. **Weeks 13–14** results review and renewal decision on a named date.

Questions: hello@semester.example · Security: security@semester.example

Book the kickoff

Opening view

Pilot Invitation Email



SEMESTER

Let’s set the pilot dates together.

Hello [First name],

Thank you for bringing the Registration Readiness Pilot to Vanderbilt. Before students see anything, we’d like a 45-minute kickoff to agree three things: the start date, the success measures and the renewal decision date.

Pick a time that works:

Tue 14 Oct · 10:00 CT

Wed 15 Oct · 14:00 CT

Thu 16 Oct · 11:00 CT

Choose a kickoff time

Before the kickoff

- Name a champion and a decision-maker on your side.
- Ask IT for the SAML metadata so we can test sign-in.
- Share any baseline you already track for holds at registration.

Your SIS and registrar records stay official throughout, and student records never reach an AI provider. Our security and accessibility documents are ready whenever your review team wants them.

Thanks,
[Founder name]
Founder, Semester

Semester · [Postal address]
You’re receiving this because you’re a contact for the Vanderbilt pilot. Email preferences

Opening view

Vanderbilt Campus Map

SEMESTER

Where the pilot touches campus

1 · Kirkland Hall

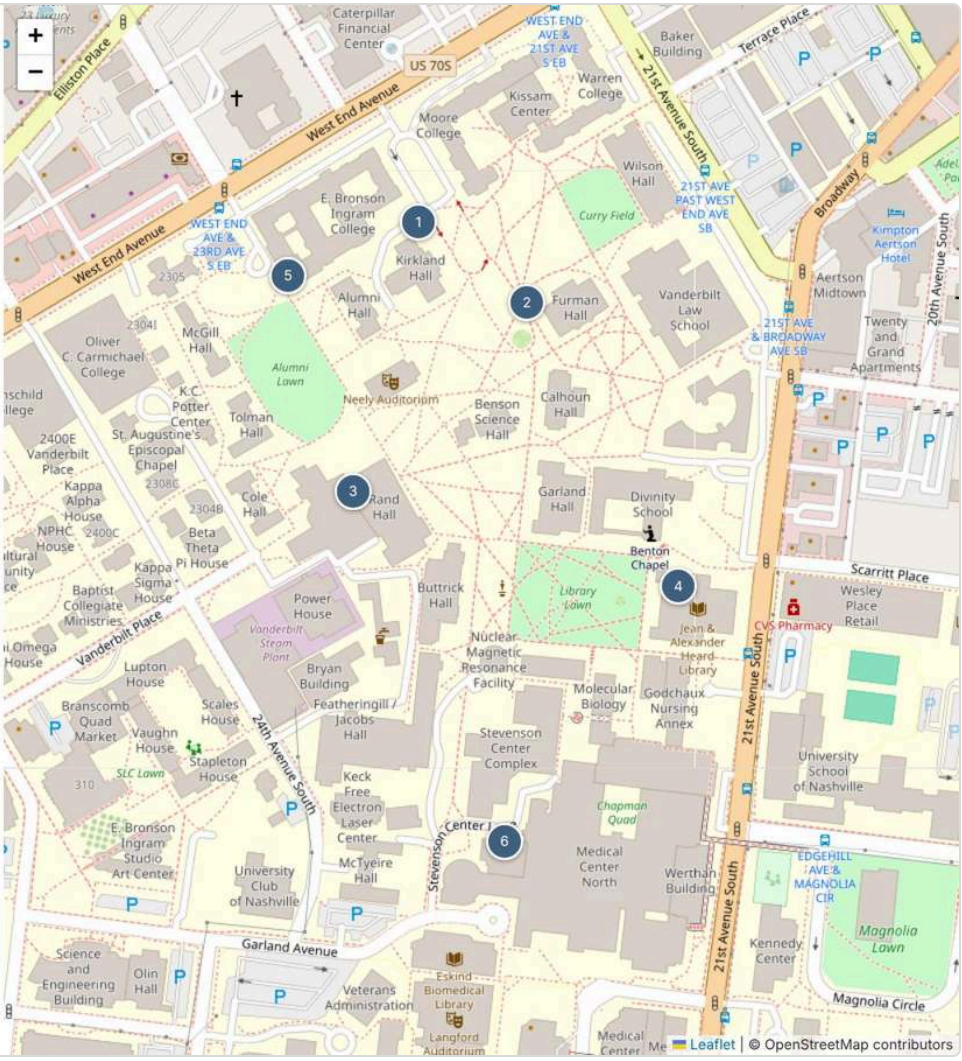
2 · University Registrar

3 · Rand Hall

4 · Central Library

5 · Student Accounts

6 · Student Health Center



Opening view

SEMESTER

Master Services Agreement

Version [x] · Between Semester [LLC legal name], a [state] limited liability company ("Semester"), and [Institution legal name] ("Institution")

Draft for review by a licensed attorney. Not legal advice. Brackets [ ] mark details to fill in. Institutions often require their own paper; use this as Semester's starting position and fallback.

1. Structure

This Agreement sets the terms for every Order Form signed under it. Each Order Form lists the services, term, fees and named measures. The Data Protection Addendum (DPA) governs student and personal data. If documents conflict, the order of precedence is: DPA, then Order Form, then this Agreement, then documentation.

2. Definitions

- **Services:** the Semester platform and any implementation or support listed in an Order Form.
- **Institution Data:** data Institution or its users provide or connect, including Education Records as defined by FERPA.
- **Authorized Users:** students, staff and others Institution permits to use the Services.
- **Official System:** Institution's SIS, LMS or other system of record.

3. Services

- Semester provides the Services described in the Order Form and the documentation.
- Official Systems remain authoritative. Semester reads from them as Institution approves and doesn't change official records unless an Order Form expressly allows a write integration, approved in writing.
- Semester may update the Services if it doesn't materially reduce agreed functionality, security or accessibility.

4. Institution responsibilities

- Name an executive sponsor, an operational champion and IT, registrar and security contacts.
- Provide SSO configuration and the agreed data access in time for the implementation plan.
- Make sure its use and its disclosures to Semester comply with FERPA and its own policies.

5. Data protection and security

- Semester acts as a "school official" with a legitimate educational interest under FERPA, under Institution's direct control for its use of Education Records, as set out in the DPA.

- Semester keeps an information security program described in its security policies and HECVAT response, including tenant isolation, encryption in transit and at rest, access logging and incident response.
- Semester doesn't send Education Records to AI model providers and doesn't use Institution Data to train AI models.
- Semester doesn't sell Institution Data or use it for advertising.

---

6. Accessibility

Semester designs to WCAG 2.2 AA, provides an accessibility conformance report (ACR) on request, and fixes reported barriers on a timeline agreed in the Order Form.

---

7. Fees and payment

- Fees are in the Order Form. Invoices are due [net 30] from receipt.
- Fees exclude taxes; Institution's tax-exempt status is honored with a valid certificate.
- Late amounts may be suspended after written notice and a [30]-day cure period. Suspension never deletes data.

---

8. Term and termination

- This Agreement runs until all Order Forms end.
- Either party may terminate for material breach not cured within [30] days of notice.
- Institution may terminate a pilot Order Form at the end of the pilot term without cause.
- On termination, Semester makes Institution Data available for export for [30] days, then deletes it as the DPA requires and certifies deletion on request.

---

9. Confidentiality

Each party protects the other's confidential information with at least reasonable care and uses it only for this Agreement. Public-records laws that apply to Institution take precedence.

---

10. Intellectual property

- Semester owns the Services and improvements to them. Institution owns Institution Data.
- Institution grants Semester the right to process Institution Data only to provide the Services.
- Feedback may be used without obligation, with no Institution Data attached.

---

11. Warranties

- Semester warrants the Services will perform materially as documented and that it won't knowingly introduce malicious code.
- Each party warrants it has authority to enter this Agreement.
- [Other warranties disclaimed to the extent the law allows; counsel to draft.]

12. Indemnities

[Semester: third-party IP infringement claims against the Services. Institution: to the extent its governing law allows. Many public institutions can't indemnify; counsel to adjust.]

13. Limitation of liability

[Cap: fees paid in the 12 months before the claim. Carve-outs: data breach caused by Semester's breach of the DPA (super-cap [x] or insurance limits), confidentiality, indemnity. No indirect damages. Counsel to set.]

14. Insurance

Semester will keep cyber liability and technology errors & omissions insurance at the limits in the Order Form or Institution's requirements, and provide certificates on request. *Status: not yet bound. This is a launch gate.*

15. Publicity

Neither party uses the other's name or marks without written approval, except that Semester may list Institution as a customer once Institution approves the wording.

16. General

Governing law: [Institution's state where required, otherwise Semester's state]. Notices in writing to the contacts in the Order Form. No assignment without consent, except to a successor of Semester's business that assumes this Agreement and the DPA. Entire agreement; amendments in writing.

Signatures

	Semester	Institution
Name		
Title		
Date		
Signature		

SEMESTER

Order Form

Under the Master Services Agreement dated [date] · Order Form #[ ]

Draft for review by a licensed attorney. Not legal advice. Brackets [ ] mark details to fill in. Institutions often require their own paper; use this as Semester's starting position and fallback.

1. Parties and contacts

Role	Institution	Semester
Legal name	[ ]	Semester [LLC legal name]
Executive sponsor	[name, title, email]	[founder]
Operational champion	[ ]	—
IT / SSO contact	[ ]	[ ]
Registrar data owner	[ ]	—
Security / incident contact	[ ]	security@[domain]
Billing contact	[ ]	billing@[domain]

2. Services ordered

Item	Scope	Term	Fee
Registration Readiness Pilot	[cohort, e.g. 500 first-year students], one term, read-only SIS + LMS connection, SAML SSO	[start] – [end of term]	[$ fixed]
Implementation	SSO, SIS read sync, role mapping, staff training	Before pilot start	Waived for pilot
Support	Pilot support per the support plan: S1 any hour in week 1; pilot hours 08:00–18:00 [TZ] weekdays	Pilot term	Included
Premium support (optional)	Named contact, quarterly review	Annual	15% of platform fee, min $15,000

3. Success measures

Agreed before launch and signed by the sponsor. Attach the measures sheet.

Measure	Baseline	Target	Source
[e.g. share of cohort with no unresolved hold at registration open]	[ ]	[ ]	Registrar extract

Measure	Baseline	Target	Source
[e.g. weekly active students in cohort]	—	[ ]	Semester analytics (aggregate)
[e.g. advisor time on registration questions]	[ ]	[ ]	Advisor survey

4. Conversion option

If Institution signs an annual Order Form within 60 days of the results report, the pilot fee is credited against year-1 fees. Planning price for annual: $[18] per enrolled student per year for the agreed scope, minimum $[30,000]. Prices are confirmed in the annual Order Form.

5. Data and security terms

- DPA dated [ ] applies. Data categories and subprocessors are listed there.
- Feature switches at launch: [community: off] · [marketplace: off] · [Ask Semester: on, course rules apply] · [family sharing: on].
- Insurance limits: cyber $[ ] · E&O $[ ].

6. Billing

Field	Value
Invoice schedule	[100% at signature / 50% at signature, 50% at launch]
Payment terms	Net [30]
PO number	[ ]
Tax status	[exempt — certificate attached]

Signatures

	Semester	Institution
Name		
Title		
Date		
Signature		

SEMESTER

Data Protection Addendum (FERPA)

Addendum to the Master Services Agreement · Template · Institution paper takes precedence where required

Draft for review by a licensed attorney. Not legal advice. Brackets [ ] mark details to fill in. Institutions often require their own paper; use this as Semester's starting position and fallback.

1. Roles

Institution is the owner and controller of Education Records. Semester is designated a school official with a legitimate educational interest under FERPA (34 CFR §99.31(a)(1)(i)(B)), performs an institutional service, is under Institution's direct control for its use and maintenance of Education Records, and uses them only for the authorized purposes below.

2. Purpose

Provide the Services in the Order Form. No other use. No sale, no advertising, no profiling for non-educational purposes, no AI model training.

3. Data categories

Category	Examples	Source	Classification
Directory / identity	Name, institutional email, student ID, program	IdP, SIS	Directory
Enrollment and registration	Terms, sections, holds, registration windows	SIS (read)	Education record
Course context	Course list, assignments, due dates	LMS (read)	Education record
Advising	Shared plans and notes the student chooses to share	Student, advisor	Education record · sensitive
Account balance (if enabled)	Balance, holds, payment plan status	SIS / bursar (read)	Education record · financial
Usage	Sign-ins, feature use, errors	Semester	Personal
Student-entered	Notes, tasks, preferences	Student	Personal · student-controlled

4. Redisclosure

Semester won't redisclose Education Records except to subprocessors listed in Annex B under written terms at least as protective as this DPA, to the student with Institution's authorization, or as required by law with prompt notice to Institution unless legally prohibited.

5. Security

- Tenant isolation enforced in the database (row-level security on every table, tenant ID on every row).
- Encryption in transit (TLS 1.2+) and at rest.
- Least-privilege access for Semester personnel, MFA, access logged and reviewed [quarterly].
- Audit log of record access by staff users, available to Institution.
- AI gateway blocks Education Records from model providers; tested before launch and on each change.
- Backups with tested restore; documented incident response plan.

6. Incident notification

Semester notifies Institution's security contact without undue delay and within [72] hours of confirming unauthorized access to Education Records, with the facts known, the data involved, steps taken and a contact. Semester cooperates with Institution's investigation and any required notices; Institution controls notices to students.

7. Student rights

Semester supports Institution in responding to requests to inspect, correct or delete records within [10] business days of Institution's request. Corrections to official records are made in the Official System by Institution.

8. Retention and deletion

Data	Retention	On termination
Synced Education Records	Duration of the Order Form	Deleted within [30] days after the export window
Student-entered content	Until deleted by the student or termination	Exported to student on request, then deleted
Audit logs	[1–7] years per Institution policy	Delivered to Institution, then deleted
Backups	Rolling [30] days	Expire on schedule

Semester certifies deletion in writing on request.

9. Data location

Data is hosted in [United States] regions of the subprocessors in Annex B.

10. Audits

On reasonable notice, once a year, Semester answers Institution's security questionnaire (HECVAT) and provides evidence summaries. On-site audits by agreement.

11. Children

Where any user is under 18, Semester follows Institution's instructions and applicable law; marketplace features stay off for users under 18.

Annex A · Institution-specific terms

[State student-privacy law requirements, e.g. data governance board approvals; Institution's own DPA language.]

Annex B · Subprocessors

See Subprocessors. Semester gives [30] days' notice before adding one; Institution may object on reasonable grounds.

Signatures

	Semester	Institution
Name		
Title		
Date		
Signature		

SEMESTER

Subprocessors

The vendors that process institution data for Semester. We give 30 days' notice before adding one.

Draft for review by a licensed attorney. Not legal advice. Brackets [ ] mark details to fill in. Don't publish this until counsel approves it.

Vendor	Purpose	Data	Location
Vercel	Application hosting	Request data in transit	[US region]
Supabase	Database, authentication, storage	Institution data at rest	[US region]
[AI model provider]	Ask Semester answers	Course content and student prompts only, no student records, no training	[region]
[Payment processor]	Marketplace payments	Buyer and seller payment details	[region]
[Email provider]	Transactional email	Name, email	[region]
[Error monitoring]	Error tracking	Technical logs with identifiers scrubbed	[region]

SEMESTER

Terms of Service

Last updated: [date] · Semester [LLC legal name], a [state] limited liability company

Draft for review by a licensed attorney. Not legal advice. Brackets [ ] mark details to fill in. Don't publish this until counsel approves it.

1. Who these terms are for

These terms cover your use of Semester through your school. If your school has a separate agreement with us, that agreement controls how your school's data is handled. Where it conflicts with these terms, it wins.

2. Your account

- You sign in with your school account. Keep it secure, and tell your school if you think someone else has used it.
- You must be eligible under your school's rules. Some features, including the marketplace, need you to be 18 or older.

3. Your school's information

Your school's systems remain the official record. Semester shows information from them along with its source and when it last updated. If something looks wrong, your school's office decides what's correct.

4. Ask Semester and AI features

- AI-assisted answers can be wrong. Check them against the sources shown.
- Ask Semester doesn't receive your student records.
- Follow your instructor's course AI policy. Using AI against that policy is an academic integrity matter for your school.

5. Community and marketplace rules

- Be respectful. No harassment, threats, hate, or sharing other people's private information.
- Don't sell or share graded work, exams, answer keys or anything that breaks academic integrity rules.
- No illegal items, weapons, drugs, alcohol, counterfeit goods or off-app payment requests.
- Marketplace payments run through our payment processor under its own terms. Semester isn't a party to sales between users and doesn't hold funds.
- We and your school may remove content or limit accounts that break these rules.

6. Your content

You own what you post. You give us permission to host and display it to the audience you choose, only to run the service. You can delete it at any time, though copies may stay in backups for a limited period.

7. Acceptable use

Don't attempt to access data you aren't permitted to see, interfere with the service, scrape it, or reverse-engineer it except where the law allows.

8. Device permissions

Camera, microphone, location and notifications are used only after you allow them, only for the feature you're using, and you can turn them off in your device or in Semester's privacy settings.

9. Changes and ending

We'll tell you about material changes before they take effect. You can stop using Semester at any time. If your school ends its agreement, your access ends and data is handled as that agreement requires.

10. Disclaimers and liability

[Standard warranty disclaimer and limitation of liability. Counsel to draft for the governing state, and to check consumer-protection limits where users are students.]

11. Governing law and disputes

[Governing law: state]. [Dispute resolution clause: counsel to decide.]

12. Contact

[legal@ email] · [mailing address]

SEMESTER

Privacy Policy

Last updated: [date]

Draft for review by a licensed attorney. Not legal advice. Brackets [ ] mark details to fill in. Don't publish this until counsel approves it.

Summary

- Your school decides how your student information is used. We act on its behalf under a written agreement that covers FERPA.
- We never sell personal information, and we don't use student data for advertising.
- AI models never receive your student records.
- Our company staff in sales, marketing and finance never see student records.

What we collect

Type	Examples	Source
School records	Enrollment, courses, holds, grades as released	Your school's systems
Account	Name, school email, role	Your school sign-in
What you add	Notes, plans, posts, listings, messages	You
Device (if you allow it)	Location while using, camera or mic for a feature, notification token	Your device
Usage	Pages viewed, errors, device type	Automatically

How we use it

To provide the service, keep it secure, support you, and improve it using aggregate data. Personalisation uses only the signals you allow, and you can reset it.

Who we share it with

Your school; subprocessors that host and run the service (listed at [subprocessors URL]); payment processors for marketplace purchases; and authorities when the law requires it. Nothing else.

Your choices

See, correct or delete your data through Privacy & data in the app, or through your school. Control who sees your profile details, turn off device permissions, and reset personalisation.

Security and retention

Encrypted in transit and at rest, with role-based access and every access logged. Retention follows your school's agreement. By default, data is deleted within 30 days after it ends.

Children

Semester is for postsecondary students. Where a school enrols users under 18, the school's consent and the applicable laws apply, and some features stay off.

Contact

[privacy@ email]

SEMESTER

Cookie and storage notice

Last updated: [date] · Applies to the Semester app and semester.[domain]

Draft for review by a licensed attorney. Not legal advice. Brackets [ ] mark details to fill in.

1. The short version

Semester uses only the cookies and browser storage it needs to sign you in, keep you secure and remember your settings. We don't use advertising cookies, and we don't let third parties track you across sites.

2. What we store

Name / type	Purpose	Category	Lasts
Session cookie	Keeps you signed in after your school sign-in	Strictly necessary	Session, or [x] hours
CSRF token	Protects forms from cross-site attacks	Strictly necessary	Session
SSO state	Completes the sign-in round-trip with your school	Strictly necessary	Minutes
Preferences (local storage)	Theme, text size, calm mode, dismissed tips	Functional	Until you clear it
Offline queue (local storage / IndexedDB)	Saves actions made offline until you reconnect	Functional	Until sent
Privacy-preserving analytics	Aggregate page counts, no cross-site tracking, no student record content	Analytics (off by default where consent is required)	[x] days

3. Public website

The marketing site uses no advertising or social-media tracking. If we add analytics, they will be aggregate and cookieless where possible, and we will update this notice first.

4. Your choices

- Strictly necessary items can't be switched off; Semester won't work without them.
- Functional and analytics items can be cleared in your browser or turned off in You → Privacy & data.
- Where law requires consent (for example in the EU or UK), analytics stay off until you agree.

5. Changes and contact

We'll update this notice before adding any new kind of cookie or storage. Questions: privacy@[domain].

SEMESTER

Accessibility statement

Last updated: [date] · Applies to the Semester app and semester.[domain]

Draft. Update the status table from the latest test run before publishing. Never state full conformance until the ACR supports it.

1. Our commitment

Semester should work for every student and staff member, including people who use screen readers, keyboards, voice control, magnification or captions. We design and test to the Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG) 2.2, Level AA.

2. Current status

Area	Status	Last tested
Pilot student paths (sign-in, Today, registration readiness, Ask Semester, sharing, settings)	Working toward WCAG 2.2 AA; manual testing in progress	[date]
Staff pilot paths (advisor, registrar, institution console)	Working toward WCAG 2.2 AA	[date]
Public website	Working toward WCAG 2.2 AA	[date]
Accessibility Conformance Report (VPAT 2.x)	In preparation; available to institutions on request when complete	—

3. How we test

- Automated checks on every change before it ships.
- Manual keyboard and screen-reader testing (NVDA, JAWS, VoiceOver, TalkBack) on pilot paths each release.
- Zoom to 200%, reflow at 320 px, reduced motion, high contrast and forced colors.
- Plain language, visible focus and target sizes of at least 44 px in the product.

4. Known limitations

[List any known issues with a workaround and a fix date. Example: "Charts in Progress have a data table alternative; a fully navigable chart is planned for [month]."]

5. Report a barrier

Email access@[domain] or use "Report a barrier" in Help. Tell us the page, what you were trying to do, and the device or assistive technology if you're comfortable sharing it. We reply within two business days with a fix or a workaround. Students can also contact their school's disability services office, which can work with us directly.

6. Formal complaints

If you aren't satisfied with our response, contact your institution's accessibility or ADA/504 coordinator. [Institution-specific contact added per tenant.]

SEMESTER

Community & marketplace guidelines

Plain-language rules. The Terms of Service are the binding version.

Do

- Help each other: answer questions, share study tips, show up for your groups.
- Keep it on campus: meet at the suggested safe spots and pay in the app.
- Report what's wrong. Reports are confidential.

Don't

- Harass, threaten, demean or share someone's private information.
- Sell or trade graded work, exams, answer keys, or offers to do someone's work.
- List prohibited items: weapons, drugs, alcohol, counterfeits, anything illegal.
- Ask for payment outside the app, or impersonate anyone, including school offices.

What happens

Severity	Example	Typical action
Low	Spam, off-topic	Content removed, reminder
Medium	Integrity violation, scam attempt	Removal, feature limit, school notified per policy
High	Threats, self-harm risk, illegal items	Immediate removal; escalated to the school's designated contacts

You can appeal through Privacy & safety, and a different moderator will review it.

Company data catalogs

The structured data behind the company workspaces: operating streams, owners, metrics, plans and copy.

Company OS — ui_kits/company-os/company-os-data.js

Window.COMPANYOS

Principle

Semester must operate with the same coherence, evidence, reliability and trust it promises to institutions.

Functions

Corporate governance and legal

Id: governance
Name: Corporate governance and legal
File: CORPORATE_GOVERNANCE_AND_LEGAL_OPS
Owner: Founder + fractional counsel
Review: True
Mission: Keep the company legally sound, its IP owned, and every contract and obligation tracked.
Sor: Contracts register in /ops legal; corporate records folder
Inputs: Formation documents, contracts, policies, counsel advice
Workflows: Request → classify → business owner → legal owner → risk rating → template → redline → approval → signature → obligations extracted → renewal reminder → evidence → amendment/termination
Kpis: Contracts with obligations logged, Days to signature, Renewals missed (0)
Reports: Monthly legal queue and obligations calendar
Cadence: Weekly legal queue review (15 min)
Controls: No signature without template or counsel redline; IP assignment for every contributor
Thresholds: Any contract with student data, liability above fees, or non-standard indemnity → counsel
Docs: Operating agreement, IP assignment, NDA, MSA, Order form, DPA, SLA, Terms, Privacy, Acceptable use, Cookie notice, Accessibility statement, Security addendum, Contractor / employee / advisor templates, Marketplace publisher agreement, Trademark register
Integrations: E-sign (embedded), contracts register
Have: docs/legal/ (MSA, order form, DPA, terms, privacy, cookie, accessibility, community, subprocessors)
Gaps: SLA, SOW, security addendum, contractor/advisor templates, trademark filing, policy register
Priority: P0
Next: Counsel review of MSA, DPA and order form before pilot launch

Finance, accounting and capital

Id: finance

Name: Finance, accounting and capital

File: FINANCE_AND_CAPITAL_SYSTEM

Owner: Founder + bookkeeper

Review: True

Mission: Know cash, runway and unit economics every month; bill accurately and collect on time.

Sor: /ops finance (invoices, AR, dunning); accounting ledger (bookkeeper); bank

Inputs: Bank and card feeds, invoices, contracts, payroll/contractor costs, vendor bills

Workflows: Month ends → invoices and payments reconciled → expenses categorized → payroll posted → vendor costs reviewed → revenue/deferred revenue reviewed → P&L → balance sheet → cash flow → runway → forecast variance → executive review → investor summary

Kpis: Cash, burn, runway, ARR, pilot revenue, Gross margin incl. AI and cloud cost, DSO, Forecast variance

Reports: Monthly close pack; dashboards: cash, revenue, pipeline, margin, CAC, retention, spend, forecast (conservative/base/ambitious/downside)

Cadence: Monthly close (1 h); weekly cash check

Controls: Founder approves spend above $500; separation of invoicing and payment where possible

Thresholds: Spend > $500 → founder; discounts per price book; anything off price book → founder

Docs: Chart of accounts, Expense policy, Tax calendar, Price book, Discount policy, Finance model

Integrations: Bank, payment processor, accounting software (embedded views)

Have: docs/run/Finance Model.html, docs/grow/GTM Plan.html (price book), ui_kits/ops (finance console)

Gaps: 36-month model, AI cost per workflow, revenue recognition review, tax calendar

Priority: P0

Next: Open business bank account and accounting ledger; set the monthly close date

Product and engineering operations

Id: product

Name: Product and engineering operations

File: PRODUCT_AND_ENGINEERING_OPERATIONS

Owner: Founder → founding engineer

Review: False

Mission: Turn evidence into shipped, reliable, accessible product.

Sor: GitHub (code, PRs), /ops product operations (backlog, flags, releases)

Inputs: Customer signals, research, catalog gaps, incidents

Workflows: Signal → research → problem → opportunity → strategy fit → priority score → PRD → design → threat/privacy/accessibility review → technical design → build → test → controlled release → measure → iterate or retire

Kpis: Release cadence, Change failure rate, Error budget remaining, Accessibility issues open

Reports: Release notes; monthly product review

Cadence: Weekly planning; release per engineering playbook

Controls: CI gates, RLS proof, two-person review for auth/RLS/AI/billing

Thresholds: No release in pilot launch week, finals or registration opening except S1/S2 fixes

Docs: Engineering playbook, QA test plan, Accessibility test plan, ADR log, PRD template

Integrations: GitHub, Vercel, Supabase (deploy status in /ops)

Have: docs/build/, handoff/execute/, docs/master/

Gaps: PRD template, ADR log, experiment registry

Priority: P1

Next: Run execute stream 00 and approve the design-system baseline

Security, privacy, accessibility and compliance

Id: trust

Name: Security, privacy, accessibility and compliance

File: TRUST_PROGRAM

Owner: Founder + fractional security lead

Review: True

Mission: Make trust evidence-based: controls designed, implemented, tested and shown to buyers.

Sor: /ops trust & compliance (controls, evidence, HECVAT, data requests)

Inputs: Asset/data inventory, policies, vendor list, incidents, questionnaires

Workflows: Inventory → risk assessment → control design → implementation → evidence → testing → monitoring → intake → remediation → verification → control review → customer evidence, Vendor intake → purpose → data classification → security/privacy review → contract terms → access scope → onboarding → periodic review → incident escalation → renewal → offboarding

Kpis: Controls with evidence, Questionnaire turnaround, Access reviews on time, Open high vulnerabilities

Reports: Quarterly trust report; HECVAT response

Cadence: Quarterly access review and tabletop; annual policy review

Controls: Vendor security obligations in writing, need-to-know access, MFA, encryption, vendor-breach plan (FTC vendor guidance)

Thresholds: Any new subprocessor → privacy review + 30-day notice

Docs: Security policies, Security readiness, Incident response, BCP/DR, Vendor risk, Claims register

Integrations: Evidence links to GitHub, Supabase, Vercel

Have: docs/secure/, docs/operate/, ui_kits/compliance/

Gaps: HECVAT submitted, insurance bound, ACR, vendor reviews documented

Priority: P0

Next: Bind insurance; submit HECVAT Full; complete vendor reviews for Supabase, Vercel, AI provider

Go-to-market and revenue operations

Id: revops

Name: Go-to-market and revenue operations

File: REVENUE_OPERATIONS

Owner: Founder

Review: False

Mission: A predictable path from target account to annual contract.

Sor: /ops GTM pipeline (CRM)

Inputs: ICP, target list, conversations, pilot results

Workflows: Target → outreach → discovery → qualified → role demo → pilot design → security/procurement → proposal → mutual action plan → contract → implementation → activation → outcome report → annual conversion → expansion/reference

Kpis: Target accounts, replies, discovery meetings, Qualified opportunities, demos, pilot designs, Pilots signed, activation, KPI attainment, Pilot-to-annual conversion, ACV, NRR, Sales cycle, win/loss, CAC, payback

Reports: Weekly pipeline; monthly forecast

Cadence: Weekly pipeline review

Controls: Price book and discount rules; claims register for every deck

Thresholds: Below floor not allowed; discounts per GTM plan

Docs: GTM plan, Buyer map, Mutual action plan, Proposal template, Order form

Integrations: Email and calendar inside Semester

Have: docs/grow/GTM Plan.html, ui_kits/business (GTM), templates (decks)

Gaps: Target list built, win/loss log

Priority: P1

Next: Build the 40-account target list in /ops

Marketing, brand and communications

Id: marketing
Name: Marketing, brand and communications
File: MARKETING_AND_BRAND_SYSTEM
Owner: Founder
Review: False
Mission: Explain Semester honestly and earn buyer and student trust.
Sor: Company site + content register; /ops social
Inputs: Positioning, proof, product releases
Workflows: Plan → draft → claims check → approve → publish → measure
Kpis: Qualified site requests, Trust Center visits, Content published per month, Ambassador activations (later)
Reports: Monthly marketing summary
Cadence: Monthly content plan
Controls: Every claim sourced in the claims register; status, not certifications
Thresholds: Customer names or quotes → written approval
Docs: Brand system, Messaging, Claims register, Content calendar
Integrations: Site CMS, social channels (embedded scheduling)
Have: ui_kits/company-site/ (10 pages), design system, ui_kits/ops (social, marketing)
Gaps: Content calendar, SEO plan, webinar plan
Priority: P2
Next: Publish pilot, pricing and trust pages

Customer success and implementation

Id: cs
Name: Customer success and implementation
File: CUSTOMER_SUCCESS_AND_IMPLEMENTATION
Owner: Founder → implementation lead
Review: False
Mission: Every customer launches cleanly and can prove value.
Sor: /ops customer success (implementation, health, QBR)
Inputs: Signed order form, measures sheet, contacts
Workflows: Signed → sales-to-CS hand-off → kickoff → implementation → data readiness → admin setup → training → launch → activation → adoption → weekly review → midpoint → value report → conversion → QBR → renewal → expansion → reference
Kpis: Days signature-to-launch, Activation, Health score, Renewal rate
Reports: Weekly sponsor update; results report
Cadence: Weekly during pilot; quarterly QBR after
Controls: Go/no-go gates with evidence
Thresholds: Scope change → order form amendment
Docs: Launch runbook, Cutover plan, Support plan, Results report template
Integrations: Tenant health from the platform
Have: docs/launch/, templates/pilot-results-report/
Gaps: Health score definition, customer advisory board
Priority: P0
Next: Kick off Vanderbilt implementation with the mutual action plan

Support and service operations

Id: support
Name: Support and service operations
File: SUPPORT_AND_SERVICE_OPERATIONS
Owner: Founder → support specialist
Review: False
Mission: Fast, honest help that feeds the product.
Sor: /ops support desk
Inputs: Tickets, status, incidents
Workflows: Intake → classify → severity → assign → respond → escalate → communicate → resolve → root cause → KB/product update → satisfaction
Kpis: First response, Resolution time, P0/P1 count, CSAT
Reports: Weekly support summary
Cadence: Daily triage in pilot
Controls: No student record content in tickets
Thresholds: P0 = security/data exposure/broad outage; P1 = critical workflow blocked; P2 degraded with workaround; P3 minor
Docs: Support plan, Runbooks, Macros, Escalation matrix
Integrations: Status page, incident console
Have: docs/launch/Support Plan.html, docs/operate/
Gaps: Help center, KB articles, feature-request taxonomy
Priority: P1
Next: Write the first 10 KB articles from the pilot paths

Partnerships, marketplace and developer relations

Id: partners
Name: Partnerships, marketplace and developer relations
File: PARTNERSHIPS_AND_MARKETPLACE
Owner: Founder
Review: True
Mission: Borrow trust and distribution; let others build on Semester safely.
Sor: /ops partnerships
Inputs: Partner targets, integration needs
Workflows: Target → qualify → due diligence → value proposition → agreement → technical integration → security/privacy approval → GTM plan → launch → measure → co-sell → renew → offboard
Kpis: Active partners, Certified integrations, Partner-sourced pipeline
Reports: Quarterly partner review
Cadence: Quarterly
Controls: Security/privacy approval before any data access
Thresholds: Any data-sharing partner → DPA + review
Docs: Partner agreement, Publisher agreement, Certification checklist
Integrations: Developer platform (later)
Have: ui_kits/workflow-runner (Developer platform workflow)
Gaps: Partner list, agreements
Priority: P3
Next: List the integration partners the pilot depends on (SIS, LMS, IdP, AI provider)

People, hiring and culture

Id: people
Name: People, hiring and culture
File: PEOPLE_AND_HIRING_SYSTEM
Owner: Founder
Review: True
Mission: Hire on triggers, onboard safely, keep the culture evidence-first.
Sor: /ops people (hiring, onboarding); payroll provider (embedded)
Inputs: Hiring triggers, revenue
Workflows: Trigger → scorecard → recruit → loop → references → offer → onboarding → access provisioning → 90-day review → offboarding → access revocation
Kpis: Time to hire, Onboarding checklist completion, Access revoked same day on exit
Reports: Quarterly workforce plan
Cadence: Quarterly
Controls: IP + confidentiality before access; FERPA/security training
Thresholds: Every hire tied to signed revenue
Docs: Hiring plan, Job descriptions, Handbook, Equity plan
Integrations: Payroll provider, identity provider
Have: docs/run/Hiring Plan.html
Gaps: Handbook, equity plan, compensation bands
Priority: P2
Next: Engage counsel and bookkeeper as the first contractors

Data, research and outcomes

Id: data
Name: Data, research and outcomes
File: DATA_RESEARCH_AND_OUTCOMES
Owner: Founder
Review: True
Mission: Prove outcomes with privacy-safe evidence.
Sor: Analytics (aggregate), research repository
Inputs: Event taxonomy, cohorts, measures
Workflows: Hypothesis → baseline → cohort → intervention → measurement → analysis → evidence review → customer validation → claim approval → iteration
Kpis: Pilots with baseline, Measures met, Claims approved with evidence
Reports: Pilot results report
Cadence: Per term
Controls: Minimum cell size; no row-level export; research governance
Thresholds: Any publication → institution approval
Docs: Event taxonomy, Metric definitions, Research governance
Integrations: Warehouse (later)
Have: templates/pilot-results-report/, docs/platform/RESEARCH_AND_OUTCOMES_ENGINE.md
Gaps: Event taxonomy, metric definitions
Priority: P1
Next: Define the pilot event taxonomy (no PII)

Procurement, vendors and supply chain

Id: vendors
Name: Procurement, vendors and supply chain
File: VENDOR_AND_PROCUREMENT_SYSTEM
Owner: Founder
Review: True
Mission: Every vendor has a purpose, a review and an exit.
Sor: /ops vendors
Inputs: Vendor requests
Workflows: Intake → purpose → data classification → security/privacy review → contract terms → access scope → onboarding → periodic review → incident escalation → renewal → offboarding
Kpis: Vendors reviewed, Vendors with DPA, Renewals reviewed before date
Reports: Subprocessor list (public)
Cadence: Annual vendor review
Controls: Need-to-know access, MFA, encryption, breach plan
Thresholds: Student-data vendors → subprocessor notice
Docs: Vendor risk policy, Subprocessors
Integrations: —
Have: docs/legal/Subprocessors.html, docs/secure/
Gaps: Vendor review records
Priority: P1
Next: Record reviews for Supabase, Vercel, AI provider, email provider

Risk, resilience and continuity

Id: risk
Name: Risk, resilience and continuity
File: RISK_RESILIENCE_AND_CONTINUITY
Owner: Founder
Review: False
Mission: See risks early and recover fast.
Sor: /ops risk register, incidents, SLOs
Inputs: Risk register, incidents, SLO data
Workflows: Identify → rate → owner → mitigation → review
Kpis: Risks with owners, Restore drill time, Postmortems on time
Reports: Monthly risk review
Cadence: Monthly
Controls: Error budget policy; key-person continuity plan
Thresholds: P0 risks reviewed weekly
Docs: Risk register, BCP/DR, Runbooks, Platform risk register
Integrations: Monitoring
Have: ui_kits/business (risks), docs/operate/, docs/platform/PLATFORM_RISK_REGISTER.md
Gaps: Key-person continuity plan, customer concentration plan
Priority: P1
Next: Write the key-person continuity plan (credentials escrow, runbooks, counsel contact)

Board, investor and stakeholder operations

Id: board
Name: Board, investor and stakeholder operations
File: BOARD_AND_INVESTOR_OPERATIONS
Owner: Founder
Review: True
Mission: Clear, honest updates when there are stakeholders to update.
Sor: /ops board/investor reports; investor portal
Inputs: KPI tree, finance, pipeline, risks
Workflows: Monthly update → board deck (when a board exists) → decisions → follow-ups
Kpis: Updates sent on time
Reports: Monthly founder update
Cadence: Monthly (deferred while bootstrapped)
Controls: Numbers from the close pack only
Thresholds: Fundraising deferred until pilot results
Docs: Investor deck, Data room index, Cap table
Integrations: —
Have: templates/investor-deck/, ui_kits/investor/
Gaps: Data room index
Priority: P3
Next: Draft the data room index (deferred)

Operations command center

Id: occ
Name: Operations command center
File: OPERATIONS_COMMAND_CENTER
Owner: Founder
Review: False
Mission: Run the platform and the company from one place.
Sor: /ops
Inputs: Every function above
Workflows: Request → evidence → approval → impact preview → execution → audit → read-model refresh → operator review
Kpis: Decisions with owner and date, Approvals in SLA
Reports: Executive overview
Cadence: Daily glance; weekly operating review
Controls: Business data only; two-person approvals
Thresholds: See approvals matrix
Docs: Operating manual
Integrations: All company modules
Have: ui_kits/ops/ (12 consoles), templates/command-center/, ui_kits/one-place/
Gaps: Decisions log, work items
Priority: P1
Next: Start the weekly operating review from the executive overview

Kpi Tree

- North star: students who complete their next action each week (pilot cohort)
- Product, Weekly actives, First meaningful action, Readiness completion, Support load
- Revenue, Pipeline, Pilots signed, Pilot-to-annual conversion, ARR, NRR
- Customer, Activation, Health, Measures met, References

- Trust, Controls with evidence, Incidents, Questionnaire turnaround
- Finance, Cash, Runway, Gross margin, AI cost per workflow
- Reliability, SLO attainment, Error budget, Restore time
- People, Capacity vs demand, Hires on trigger

Cadence

- Daily, Ops inbox, tickets, alerts (15 min)
- Monday, Plan the week: top 3 company outcomes
- Weekly, Pipeline, pilot health, support, SLOs, risks (operating review, 60 min)
- Monthly, Close, runway, scorecard re-score, risk review, founder update
- Quarterly, Access review, tabletop, roadmap and hiring plan, QBRs
- Yearly, Policy review, insurance renewal, HECVAT refresh, ACR re-test, planning

Plans

D90	Sellable pilot package complete (contracts reviewed, insurance bound), Finance: bank, ledger, monthly close, Trust: HECVAT, vendor reviews, ACR in progress, Pipeline: 40 targets, 10 discovery calls, Implementation: Vanderbilt launched with support plan, Reliability: monitoring, restore drill
M12	Pilot results and annual conversion, Pilots #2–#3, First engineer and implementation lead, KB and help center, Event taxonomy and results reporting, SOC 2 readiness plan
M36	Repeatable implementation factory, Platform maturity stages 2–4, Partner program and certified integrations, Board and investor operations if raising, Multi-campus customers, Published outcomes research

Top50

Counsel review: MSA, DPA, order form, Bind cyber + E&O insurance, Open business bank account, Set up accounting ledger and chart of accounts, Register for state/local taxes (accountant), Sign Vanderbilt DPA, Submit HECVAT Full, Record vendor reviews (Supabase, Vercel, AI, email), Publish subprocessor list, Sign success-measures sheet, Kickoff with mutual action plan, Name Vanderbilt contacts, Set monthly close date, Invoice the pilot (50% at signature if possible), Start weekly operating review, Create contracts register with obligations, Create decisions log, Write key-person continuity plan, Escrow credentials and runbooks, Define pilot event taxonomy, Write 10 KB articles, Set up status page, Run support plan on launch, Build 40-account target list, Book 10 discovery calls, Publish pilot, pricing, trust pages, Claims register review of site and decks, Write SLA document, Write SOW template, Write security addendum, Contractor and advisor templates, File trademark search (counsel), Draft employee handbook (counsel), Midpoint review, Case-study permission, Results report, Annual conversion proposal, Extend finance model to 36 months, AI cost per workflow model, Health score definition, Win/loss log, Content calendar, Partner list for pilot dependencies, Policy register, Quarterly access review, Tabletop incident exercise, Restore drill, Hiring trigger review, Data room index (deferred), Quarterly scorecard and plan refresh

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`Business workspace — ui_kits/business/business-data.js`

Window.BIZ

Facts

Entity	LLC (home state)
Stage	Pre-seed, no revenue, bootstrapping

Team	Solo founder; contractors with signed IP assignments
Pilot	Paid university pilot signed — DPA/FERPA addendum, HECVAT Full, VPAT/ACR, SAML SSO, cyber + E&O insurance required; real student records; dates not decided
Hosting	Vercel + Supabase; AI never sees student records
Budget	$5k–$20k setup budget

Items

1

Id: 1
Area: Formation
Item: LLC formed in home state, operating agreement signed
Owner: Founder
Priority: P0
Status: Done
Gate: Before any contract
Evidence: Confirmed by founder

2

Id: 2
Area: Formation
Item: EIN, state/local tax registrations
Owner: Founder + accountant
Priority: P0
Status: Not started
Gate: Before invoicing the pilot
Evidence: Not confirmed — verify

3

Id: 3
Area: Formation
Item: Dedicated business bank + payments account
Owner: Founder
Priority: P0
Status: Not started
Gate: Before pilot invoice
Evidence: Not confirmed — verify

4

Id: 4
Area: Formation
Item: Corporate records folder + contract repository
Owner: Founder
Priority: P1
Status: Not started
Gate: Before diligence
Evidence: —

5

Id: 5
Area: Formation
Item: Cap table (single-member LLC; record any promised equity)
Owner: Founder
Priority: P1
Status: Not started
Gate: Before advisors/hires
Evidence: Solo founder

6

Id: 6
Area: Formation
Item: IP assignment from founder + every contractor
Owner: Founder + counsel
Priority: P0
Status: Done
Gate: Before code ships to customer
Evidence: Confirmed: contractors signed

7

Id: 7
Area: Formation
Item: Trademark / name clearance for "Semester"
Owner: Counsel
Priority: P1
Status: Not started
Gate: Before public launch
Evidence: docs/BRAND-PLATFORM.md: no clearance performed

8

Id: 8
Area: Formation
Item: Decision: convert LLC → Delaware C-corp
Owner: Founder + counsel
Priority: P2
Status: Deferred
Gate: Before priced equity round
Evidence: Bootstrapping — revisit at fundraising

9

Id: 9
Area: Insurance
Item: Cyber liability
Owner: Founder + broker
Priority: P0
Status: Not started
Gate: Pilot contract requires it
Evidence: Required by pilot; not held

10

Id: 10
Area: Insurance
Item: Professional / E&O
Owner: Founder + broker
Priority: P0
Status: Not started
Gate: Pilot contract requires it
Evidence: Required by pilot; not held

11

Id: 11
Area: Insurance
Item: General liability
Owner: Founder + broker
Priority: P1
Status: Not started
Gate: Campus presence
Evidence: —

12

Id: 12
Area: Contracts
Item: Pilot agreement (signed)
Owner: Founder
Priority: P0
Status: Done
Gate: —
Evidence: Paid pilot signed

13

Id: 13
Area: Contracts
Item: Data Processing Addendum / FERPA addendum
Owner: Counsel
Priority: P0
Status: In review
Gate: Before real student records
Evidence: Pilot has DPA/FERPA addendum — confirm obligations mapped

14

Id: 14
Area: Contracts
Item: Master Services Agreement + SaaS terms
Owner: Counsel
Priority: P1
Status: Draft
Gate: Before annual conversion
Evidence: docs/legal-drafts/ (72 files)

15

Id: 15
Area: Contracts
Item: Order form + SOW template
Owner: Founder
Priority: P1
Status: Not started
Gate: Annual proposal
Evidence: —

16

Id: 16
Area: Contracts
Item: Service Level Agreement / support policy
Owner: Founder
Priority: P1
Status: Draft
Gate: Annual conversion
Evidence: docs/sre/ (34 files)

17

Id: 17
Area: Contracts
Item: Mutual NDA
Owner: Counsel
Priority: P2
Status: Not started
Gate: New prospects
Evidence: —

18

Id: 18
Area: Privacy
Item: Privacy Policy + Terms of Service
Owner: Counsel
Priority: P0
Status: Draft
Gate: Before student sign-in
Evidence: docs/legal-drafts/

19

Id: 19
Area: Privacy
Item: Subprocessor list (Vercel, Supabase, AI provider)
Owner: Founder
Priority: P0
Status: Not started
Gate: DPA requires it
Evidence: Hosting: Vercel + Supabase

20

Id: 20
Area: Privacy
Item: Data inventory + data-flow map (student records)
Owner: Founder
Priority: P0
Status: In progress
Gate: Before real data
Evidence: database/DATA_CLASSIFICATION_REGISTER.md

21

Id: 21
Area: Privacy
Item: Retention + deletion schedule
Owner: Founder
Priority: P0
Status: Not started
Gate: DPA / HECVAT
Evidence: —

22

Id: 22
Area: Privacy
Item: AI boundary: student records never reach an AI provider — enforce + document
Owner: Founder
Priority: P0
Status: In progress
Gate: HECVAT, DPA
Evidence: Policy decided; needs a test + doc

23

Id: 23
Area: Security
Item: HECVAT Full completed
Owner: Founder
Priority: P0
Status: Not started
Gate: University security review
Evidence: Required by pilot

24

Id: 24
Area: Security
Item: Security questionnaire answer library
Owner: Founder
Priority: P1
Status: Not started
Gate: HECVAT, RFPs
Evidence: docs/trust/ (66 files) as source

25

Id: 25
Area: Security
Item: University SSO (SAML / Shibboleth)
Owner: Engineering
Priority: P0
Status: Not started
Gate: Pilot launch
Evidence: Required by pilot

26

Id: 26
Area: Security
Item: Access-control + least-privilege policy
Owner: Founder
Priority: P0
Status: In progress
Gate: HECVAT
Evidence: database/TENANT_ISOLATION_MATRIX.md, RLS

27

Id: 27
Area: Security
Item: Incident response plan + tabletop
Owner: Founder
Priority: P0
Status: Draft
Gate: HECVAT
Evidence: docs/INCIDENT-RECOVERY-PLAYBOOK.md

28

Id: 28
Area: Security
Item: Backup + disaster-recovery runbook (tested)
Owner: Engineering
Priority: P0
Status: Draft
Gate: HECVAT
Evidence: docs/sre/

29

Id: 29
Area: Security
Item: Vulnerability management + dependency scanning
Owner: Engineering
Priority: P1
Status: In progress
Gate: HECVAT
Evidence: codeql.yml, supply-chain.yml, hawkscan.yml

30

Id: 30
Area: Security
Item: Logging + monitoring policy
Owner: Engineering
Priority: P1
Status: In progress
Gate: HECVAT
Evidence: production-smoke.yml

31

Id: 31
Area: Security
Item: Evidence register mapped to controls
Owner: Founder
Priority: P1
Status: In progress
Gate: HECVAT
Evidence: EVIDENCE-REGISTER.md

32

Id: 32
Area: Security
Item: Penetration-test plan
Owner: Founder
Priority: P2
Status: Not started
Gate: After first renewal
Evidence: —

33

Id: 33
Area: Security
Item: Trust Center page (verified controls only)
Owner: Founder
Priority: P1
Status: Not started
Gate: Procurement
Evidence: docs/trust/

34

Id: 34
Area: Accessibility
Item: VPAT / ACR (WCAG 2.1 AA)
Owner: Founder
Priority: P0
Status: Not started
Gate: Pilot contract requires it
Evidence: a11y tests exist; no ACR

35

Id: 35
Area: Accessibility
Item: Accessibility statement + feedback route
Owner: Founder
Priority: P1
Status: Not started
Gate: Public launch
Evidence: —

36

Id: 36
Area: Finance
Item: Bookkeeping + accounting system
Owner: Founder + accountant
Priority: P0
Status: Not started
Gate: Before pilot invoice
Evidence: —

37

Id: 37
Area: Finance
Item: Pilot invoice + revenue recognition
Owner: Founder
Priority: P0
Status: Not started
Gate: Pilot start
Evidence: Paid pilot

38

Id: 38
Area: Finance
Item: 12-month model: burn, runway, scenarios
Owner: Founder
Priority: P1
Status: Not started
Gate: Bootstrapped planning
Evidence: Budget $5k–$20k for setup

39

Id: 39
Area: Finance
Item: Unit costs: infra + AI cost per active user
Owner: Founder
Priority: P1
Status: Not started
Gate: Pricing
Evidence: —

40

Id: 40
Area: Finance
Item: Pricing memo: pilot → department → institution
Owner: Founder
Priority: P1
Status: Draft
Gate: Annual proposal
Evidence: PUBLIC-CLAIMS register: prices "planned"

41

Id: 41
Area: Sales
Item: Ideal customer profile + tier-1 account list
Owner: Founder
Priority: P1
Status: Not started
Gate: Second pilot
Evidence: —

42

Id: 42
Area: Sales
Item: Discovery + demo scripts by persona
Owner: Founder
Priority: P1
Status: Not started
Gate: Second pilot
Evidence: —

43

Id: 43
Area: Sales
Item: Pilot success plan + baseline metrics
Owner: Founder + champion
Priority: P0
Status: Not started
Gate: Pilot start
Evidence: Pilot dates not decided

44

Id: 44
Area: Sales
Item: Mutual action plan with named decision date
Owner: Founder + champion
Priority: P0
Status: Not started
Gate: Pilot start
Evidence: Renewal date not decided

45

Id: 45
Area: Sales
Item: Results deck + annual conversion proposal
Owner: Founder
Priority: P1
Status: Not started
Gate: Before renewal decision
Evidence: —

46

Id: 46
Area: Sales
Item: Security/procurement response kit
Owner: Founder
Priority: P1
Status: Not started
Gate: Second pilot
Evidence: —

47

Id: 47
Area: Customer success
Item: Onboarding plan for pilot users
Owner: Founder
Priority: P0
Status: Not started
Gate: Pilot start
Evidence: —

48

Id: 48
Area: Customer success
Item: Support intake, severity levels, response times
Owner: Founder
Priority: P0
Status: Not started
Gate: Pilot start
Evidence: —

49

Id: 49
Area: Customer success
Item: Weekly pilot check-in + KPI review
Owner: Founder
Priority: P0
Status: Not started
Gate: Pilot start
Evidence: —

50

Id: 50
Area: Customer success
Item: QBR / renewal process
Owner: Founder
Priority: P1
Status: Not started
Gate: Mid-pilot
Evidence: —

51

Id: 51
Area: Operations
Item: Weekly operating cadence + decision log
Owner: Founder
Priority: P1
Status: In progress
Gate: Ongoing
Evidence: DECISIONS.md, docs/decisions/

52

Id: 52
Area: Operations
Item: Risk register (owner, mitigation, review)
Owner: Founder
Priority: P1
Status: In progress
Gate: Ongoing
Evidence: LAUNCH-RISK-REGISTER.md

53

Id: 53
Area: Operations
Item: Public claims approval register
Owner: Founder
Priority: P1
Status: In progress
Gate: Any marketing
Evidence: PUBLIC-CLAIMS-APPROVAL-REGISTER.md

54

Id: 54
Area: Hiring
Item: Contractor onboarding/offboarding (access, IP, NDA)
Owner: Founder
Priority: P1
Status: Not started
Gate: Next contractor
Evidence: IP assignments in place

55

Id: 55
Area: Hiring
Item: First hire profile + trigger
Owner: Founder
Priority: P2
Status: Not started
Gate: Second paid customer
Evidence: Solo founder

56

Id: 56
Area: Fundraising
Item: Fundraising readiness checklist
Owner: Founder
Priority: P2
Status: Deferred
Gate: When raising
Evidence: Bootstrapping for now

`Business extras and launch plan — ui_kits/business/extras.js`

Window.BIZ EXTRA

Roadmap

Span	Items
Days 1–30 · Make the pilot legal to run	Bind cyber + E&O insurance (contract requirement), EIN, state tax registration, business bank, bookkeeping, Map every DPA/FERPA obligation to a control and an owner, Publish subprocessor list: Vercel, Supabase (+ AI provider, with "no student records" boundary), Data inventory + data-flow map for student records, Retention + deletion schedule, Test that student records never reach an AI provider; document it
Days 31–60 · Pass the university reviews	Complete HECVAT Full from docs/trust + evidence register, Ship SAML / Shibboleth SSO with the university IdP, VPAT / ACR against WCAG 2.1 AA (use existing a11y tests as evidence), Incident-response tabletop; record it, Restore-from-backup test; record RTO/RPO, Privacy Policy + Terms reviewed by counsel
Days 61–90 · Launch and prove the pilot	Agree pilot start + renewal decision dates in a mutual action plan, Baseline the success metrics with the champion, Onboarding + support intake with severity levels, Weekly check-in and KPI review, Draft the results deck and annual conversion proposal

Risks

- Pilot starts without required insurance, High, High, Bind cyber + E&O in days 1–30; send certificate to the university, Founder
- HECVAT Full not complete → security review stalls, High, High, Start from docs/trust; answer only verified controls; book a review call, Founder
- SAML SSO not ready for launch, Medium, High, Prioritise SSO in days 31–60; test with the university IdP early, Engineering
- Student record exposure / breach, Low, Critical, RLS + tenant isolation tests, least privilege, IR plan, AI boundary test, Founder

- VPAT gaps found late, Medium, Medium, Run ACR early; fix blockers before launch; disclose known gaps, Founder
- No decision date → pilot drifts, no conversion, High, High, Mutual action plan with named economic buyer and decision date, Founder
- Solo-founder capacity, High, Medium, Use budget for counsel/broker/accountant; contractors with IP + NDA; defer P2, Founder
- Claims outrun evidence in marketing, Medium, Medium, Public claims register; no "secure/compliant" without evidence, Founder

Hiring

- Now, Fractional counsel (DPA, MSA, privacy), Contract, Pilot obligations
- Now, Insurance broker, Contract, Cyber + E&O
- Now, Bookkeeper / accountant, Contract, First invoice
- After pilot launch, Implementation / support contractor, Contract, Pilot support load > founder capacity
- After second paid customer, First full-time engineer, Hire, Two institutions live

Fundraising

- Decide raise vs. bootstrap after pilot results, Deferred
- Convert LLC → Delaware C-corp before a priced round, Deferred
- Clean cap table + IP chain, Ready (IP signed)
- Data room: contracts, security, financials, Not started
- Investor deck from pilot results, Draft (this kit)
- 12-month model with scenarios, Not started

Window.BIZ LAUNCH

- Corporate, Company owns all IP; founder + contractor assignments filed, Signed assignments in records folder
- Banking, Business account, approval rules, chart of accounts, Business funds separate from personal
- Accounting, Bookkeeping, monthly close checklist, expense policy, tax calendar, Monthly P&L, balance sheet, cash flow
- Financial model, 36-month driver-based model, Unit economics, runway, break-even
- Pricing, Pilot, institution, implementation, AI overage, support, Approved price book + discount rules
- Insurance, Cyber, E&O, general liability; evaluate D&O later, Coverage reviewed against contract
- Legal, Terms, Privacy, DPA, SLA, MSA, Versioned and counsel-reviewed
- Identity, MFA on admin, code, cloud, finance, CRM, support, production, MFA report
- Access, Least privilege, role review, contractor offboarding, Quarterly access review log
- Data, Encryption in transit/at rest, backups, restore test, Restore test record with RTO/RPO
- Monitoring, Errors, uptime, security alert triage, audit logging, Alert runbook + on-call
- Resilience, Business continuity + DR runbook, tested, Tabletop record
- Vendor risk, Subprocessor review + vendor register, Vendor register
- Procurement, HECVAT Full, answer library, DPA/SLA path, Completed HECVAT
- Accessibility, ACR/VPAT, manual test protocol, statement, Published ACR

Window.GTM COPY

Personas

- VP Student Success, Retention and on-time progress, Fewer students surprised by holds and deadlines, Will it add work for my advisors?, Advisors see only what students share; no new queue
- Registrar, Accurate records, clean registration, Students arrive at registration ready, Will it change official records?, Read-only; your SIS stays authoritative
- CIO / IT, Security, integration load, One governed integration, SSO, audit, Another system to secure?, HECVAT Full, SAML SSO, RLS per tenant, subprocessor list
- Accessibility office, WCAG 2.2 AA, Accessible by design, ACR provided, Do you have a VPAT?, ACR in preparation; manual test protocol shared
- Procurement / counsel, Risk and terms, Standard DPA/FERPA, insurance, SLA, FERPA and AI?, DPA addendum; student records never reach an AI provider
- Students, What do I do next?, One clear next step with its source, Is this tracking me?, You decide what is shared; export or delete anytime

Messages

- Headline, One clear next step for every student.
- Subhead, Semester turns the semester into the next thing to do — and shows where each fact came from. Your official systems stay official.
- Pilot CTA, Request a pilot design session
- Proof line, In a bounded, paid pilot with one university.
- AI line, AI-assisted, source-linked. Student records never reach an AI provider.

Objections

- We already have a portal, Semester sits on top of it and turns its data into a next step; nothing is replaced in the pilot.
- Our advisors are overloaded, Students resolve more on their own; advisors get shared plans, not a new inbox.
- AI risk, Course AI policy is enforced, answers are labelled and cited, and records stay out of AI providers.
- No budget this year, A one-term paid pilot fits a discretionary budget; annual pricing is decided after results.
- You are a small company, Insurance, DPA, HECVAT and exit/export terms are in the contract; data is yours to export.

PART 2

Brand

Identity, voice, the mark and logo system, iconography, imagery and launch materials.

Brand identity

docs/system/design/SEMESTER_BRAND_IDENTITY.md

Brand identity

Semester design, intelligence, workflow and data system · 2026-10-05 · Source: uploads/expand further on brand identy algorthims workflow.pdf, reconciled with this design system (readme.md, tokens/, components/). Where they differ, this design system wins and the difference is listed.

> Semester should make an institutionally complex world feel personally clear.

Position

Semester is the education operating system. It turns fragmented academic information, campus systems, learning tools, support workflows, productivity tools and AI into one clear, governed, human-centered environment.

Emotional outcome by audience

Audience	Desired feeling
Student	I know what to do next.
Faculty	This helps me teach clearly without adding administrative burden.
Advisor	I can support students without chasing information across systems.
Registrar	This respects academic authority, auditability and correctness.
CIO / security	This is controlled, governable, interoperable and operationally mature.
Parent / guardian	I can support without invading the student's privacy.
Employer	This is credible, verified educational evidence — not a scraped profile.
Semester operator	I can see, govern, support and improve the platform safely.

Personality

- Calm, not sterile
- Intelligent, not patronizing
- Ambitious, not inflated
- Academic, not bureaucratic
- Modern, not trendy for its own sake
- Warm, not childish
- Trustworthy, not vague

- Human-centered, not surveillance-centered
- Powerful, not overwhelming

Vocabulary

Use: path, action, progress, evidence, source, guide, workspace, Course Studio, support, plan, clarity, next step, governed, trusted, connected, official, student-controlled, explainable, accessible, institution-ready.

Avoid: disrupt everything, revolutionary AI magic, replace humans, guaranteed outcomes, fully automated advising, perfect personalization, total surveillance, one-click compliance, all-in-one without explanation, enterprise-grade without evidence.

Core statements

Context	Statement
Short	Semester is the education operating system.
Student	Semester helps you understand where you are, what matters next, and how to move forward.
Institution	Semester connects student action, learning, planning, support and institutional operations in one governed platform.
Technical	A multi-tenant education platform with role-aware workflows, policy-governed AI, source authority, evidence, interoperability and operational controls.
Trust	Built to make educational information clearer, more actionable, more accessible and more accountable.

These sit alongside the existing tagline system in readme.md (Content fundamentals). Assets: assets/logo-*.svg, guidelines/brand-*.html.

`docs/system/design/SEMESTER_VISUAL_LANGUAGE.md`

Visual language

Semester design, intelligence, workflow and data system · 2026-10-05 · Source: uploads/expand further on brand identy algorthims workflow.pdf, reconciled with this design system (readme.md, tokens/, components/). Where they differ, this design system wins and the difference is listed.

> Semester should make an institutionally complex world feel personally clear.

Primary feeling: a calm, high-trust academic workspace. Not a noisy social app, a legacy portal, a generic corporate dashboard, a childish EdTech product, or a glowing "AI" landing page.

Color semantics (adopted) and hues (this design system)

Role	Meaning	Token in this system
Action / focus / selected	User action, trusted navigation	Semester blue —blue-700 #416180 (light), —blue-400 #94bce3 (dark)

Role	Meaning	Token in this system
Neutral	Calm, focus, readable density	Ink (#090a0e family) chrome, Parchment (#f4f1ea) content, text tokens
Success	Completed, healthy, confirmed	Source/status "done" stone hue (ink + hairline + 8% wash)
Warning	Needs attention, review, limited confidence, freshness	Attention / review stone hue
Critical	Error, security concern, failed, urgent	—status-danger
Information	Source, guidance, context	Connected / official source hues
Context	Inactive, historical, unavailable	Text secondary / tertiary

Rules: never use status colour as decoration; never show a critical state by colour alone (glyph + words: ◆ ○ ✦ ⇄ ? ! ✓ ⊘).

Open decision for the founder: the source PDF proposes indigo/blue-violet as primary and emerald/amber/rose as status hues. This design system uses Semester blue and desaturated stone status hues (readme.md, Visual foundations). The roles above are adopted; the hues are unchanged until you decide otherwise.

Type

Role	Use	Token
Display	Narrative statements, hero	Cinzel (rare)
Heading	Screen titles, sections, steps	Barlow Condensed 600
Subheading	Cards, modules	Barlow Condensed
Body	Explanation and reading	Barlow 16/1.55
Body small	Metadata, source, freshness	Barlow 13–14
Label	Forms, controls, status	Kicker 10.5 tracked caps
Mono	Record, audit, correlation IDs	System mono

One H1 per page; strict heading order; short student sentences; plain language first; expand acronyms; no long all-caps; tabular figures for money, analytics, schedules; source and freshness readable but secondary.

Shape, depth, motion

Corners 3/6/10 (moderate, never toy-like). Border and contrast before shadow. Motion 130–280 ms, purposeful, zeroed by reduced motion and calm mode. Illustration only when it clarifies a workflow or reduces anxiety; never filler art.

Voice and content

Content fundamentals

From `docs/BRAND-PLATFORM.md` (draft) and in-app copy. **Personality:** a good registrar's assistant crossed with a precision instrument — exact, calm, candid, warm sparingly, self-possessed. **Public descriptor:** "the student action platform" ("Student OS" is internal only — it implies replacement). **Assistant name:** *Ask Semester* — no human name, face or persona; always labelled AI-assisted.

The status sentence (the unit of Semester voice): *what is true → what that means for you → what you can do.* "Your Canvas calendar hasn't updated since Tuesday. Deadlines below may have moved. Reconnect it, or check the course page."

Prefer / avoid: "helps you organise" not "revolutionises"; "alongside your school's systems" not "replaces / all-in-one"; "AI-assisted, source-linked" not "AI-powered / intelligent / magic"; name the control, never "secure / private / compliant / certified"; "planned / in private beta / pilot" not "launching soon"; "can / is designed to" not "guarantees / always / 100%"; "student" not "user / learner". Destinations are always Today, My Path, Search, Plan, Me.

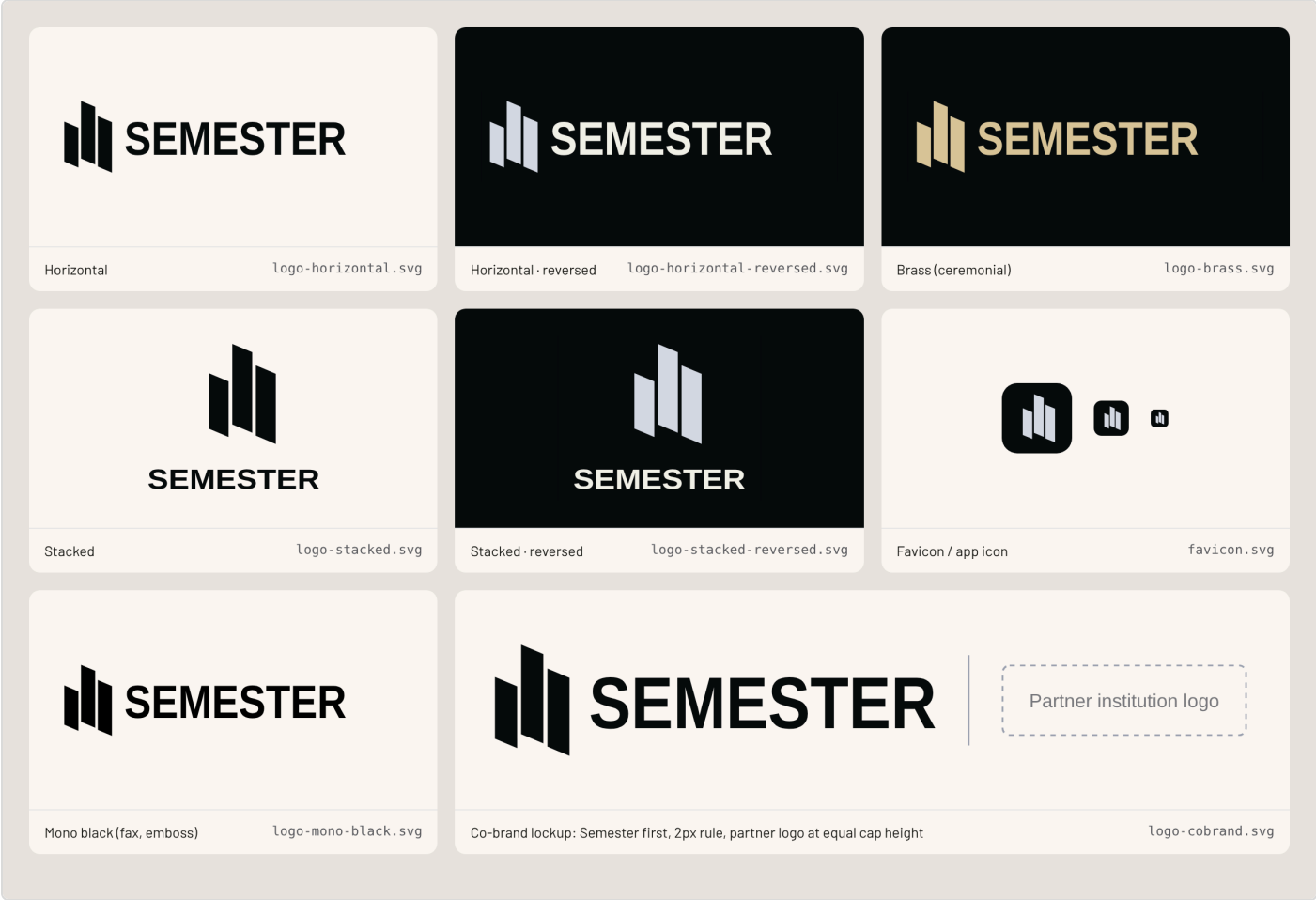
Consequence copy from the product: "Confirming puts you on the waitlist, number 3 in line. You are not enrolled until a seat comes to you." · "You leave CHEM 101 and a W is recorded on your transcript. It cannot be undone here." · "Worked out by Semester from released grades only; your instructor's final grade is the one that counts." · "Only what you tick here can be shared. Nothing else — not your study history, grades, notes or anything else — ever is."

- **Voice:** plain, precise, quietly warm. Speaks to the student as **"you"**; the product never says "we" about itself in-UI ("Semester has not checked it with your institution"). First person only in the assistant's own answer ("I'd place them…").
- **Casing:** Sentence case everywhere — buttons, titles, chips ("Needs confirmation", "Sync trouble"). UPPERCASE only for tracked kickers/eyebrows and the wordmark.
- **Say what, why, who decides.** Every state explains itself: *"You are offline. You can keep working — 2 changes will sync when you are back."* Errors say what is safe: *"Your draft is safe on this device."*
- **Name the source.** "Institution verified", "Imported", "Student entered", "Estimated", "AI-assisted", "Needs review". Never "verified" unless it was.
- **Consequences before confirm:** What happens / Exactly what / What stays the same / Taking it back. *"This can be reversed on request: ask the Registrar before Oct 20."*
- **Respectful, not celebratory:** no streaks, ranks, exclamation marks or confetti. *"Registration submitted. Next: review your fall schedule."*
- **Never overclaim:** don't call Semester the official gradebook, registrar or payment system; label demo data "Sample".
- **Numbers:** tabular figures; dates as "Thu 9 Oct · 23:59"; middle dot `·` separates metadata.
- **Emoji:** never. Unicode glyphs are used as status marks: ◆ official, ○ yours, ✦ AI, ⇄ connected/conflict, ? review, ! attention, ✓ done, ⊘ offline, … working, ◌ sample.

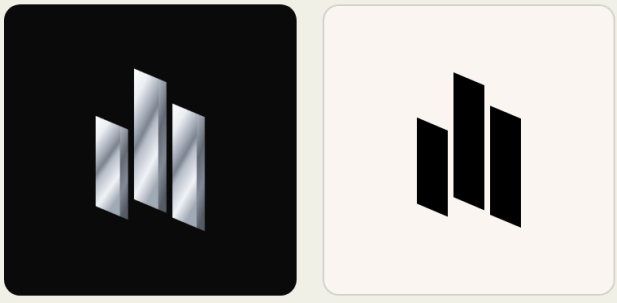
✓ helps you organise · turns … into	✕ revolutionises · transforms · supercharge
✓ alongside your school’s systems	✕ replaces · all-in-one · everything school
✓ AI-assisted, source-linked · Ask Semester	✕ AI-powered · intelligent · knows you · magic
✓ built with controls for [named control]	✕ secure · private · compliant · certified
✓ planned · in private beta · in a pilot	✕ launching soon · coming Spring
✓ can · is designed to	✕ guarantees · always · never fails · 100%
✓ student	✕ user · learner
✓ Your Canvas calendar hasn’t updated since Tuesday. Deadlines may have moved. Reconnect it.	✕ Oops! Something went wrong 😕

Voice — prefer / avoid

The mark and logo system

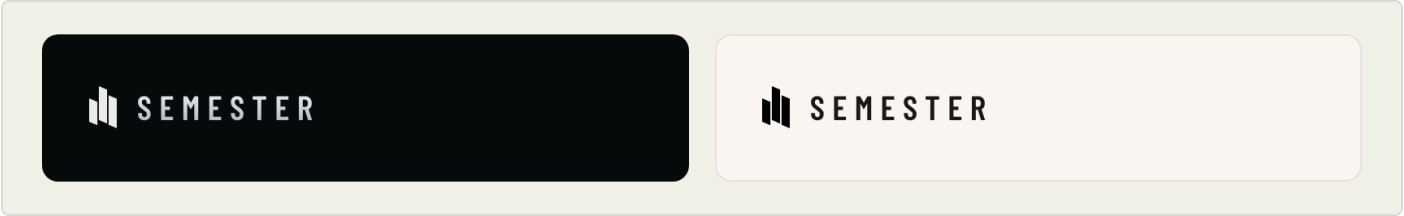


Logo system



Lit silver on Ink for app icons and splash; flat currentColor everywhere in-app so it follows the ground. Never recolour into the accent, add glow, or place on photography.

Logo mark

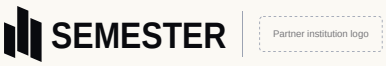


Wordmark lockup

Every logo file



logo-brass.svg



logo-cobrand.svg



logo-horizontal-reversed.svg



logo-horizontal.svg



logo-mark-maskable.svg



logo-mark-tile.svg



logo-mark.svg



logo-mono-black.svg



logo-mono-white.svg



logo-stacked-reversed.svg



logo-stacked.svg



logo-mark-silver.png



logo-mark-512.png



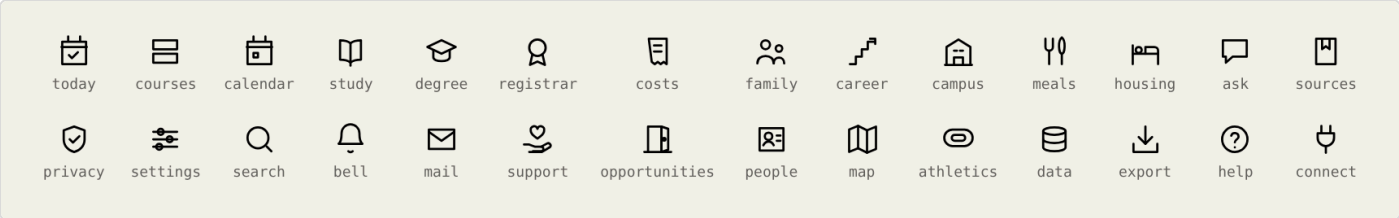
apple-touch-icon.png



favicon.svg

Iconography

- The app ships its **own inline icon set** (`app/src/components/icons.data.ts`): Lucide-like, 24×24 grid, **1.5px stroke, round caps/joins, no fills** (one exception: the favourite star fills when on). 108 glyphs, copied programmatically to `assets/icons/*.svg` and to `components/icons/iconShapes.js` for the `<Icon>` component.
- Default size 19px in rows/rails, 21px in the tab bar, 15–17px inside buttons. Always `currentColor`.
- `assets/icons-sprite.svg` is the app's public sprite; logo files: `assets/logo-horizontal(-reversed).svg`, `logo-stacked(-reversed).svg`, `logo-brass.svg`, `logo-mono-black/white.svg`, `favicon.svg`, `logo-cobrand.svg` (see Brand → Logo system), `assets/logo-mark.svg` (flat, currentColor, generated from `mark.data.ts`), `assets/logo-mark-tile.svg` / `-maskable.svg` / `-512.png` (lit silver app icons), `assets/logo-mark-silver.png` (uploaded render).
- Unicode glyphs carry status (see Content). Emoji are never used. Icon-only controls always have an accessible name. If a glyph you need is missing, use the matching **Lucide** icon at stroke-width 1.5 (CDN) and flag it.



Iconography overview

Sizes

15px 17px 19px 21px

15–17 in buttons · 19 in rows and rails · 21 in the tab bar

Drawing

24×24 grid, 1.5px stroke, round caps and joins, no fills (favourite star fills when on). Always currentColor. 108 glyphs.

Missing glyph
Matching Lucide icon at stroke 1.5, flagged

Status glyphs

◆ official ○ yours ✦ AI

⇄ connected ? review ! attention

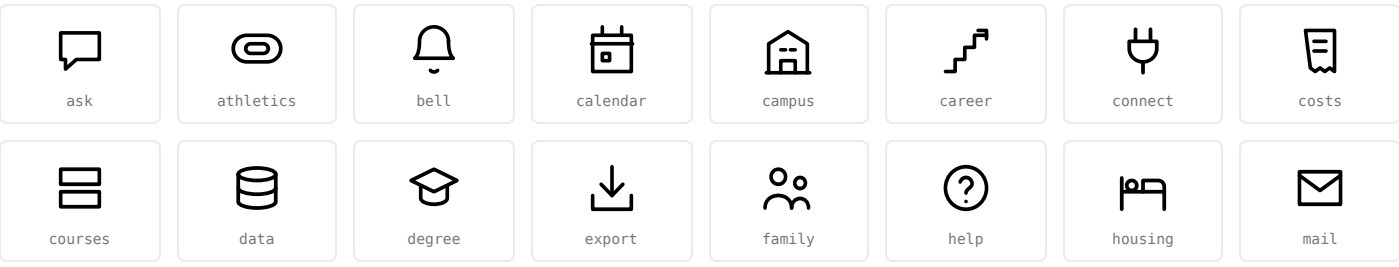
✓ done ⊘ offline … working ◌

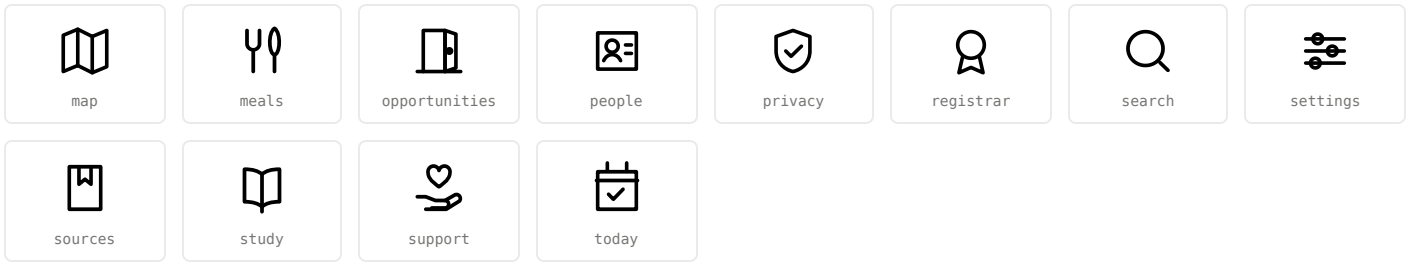
sample

No emoji. Icon-only controls always have an accessible name.

Iconography rules

The complete icon set (28 glyphs)

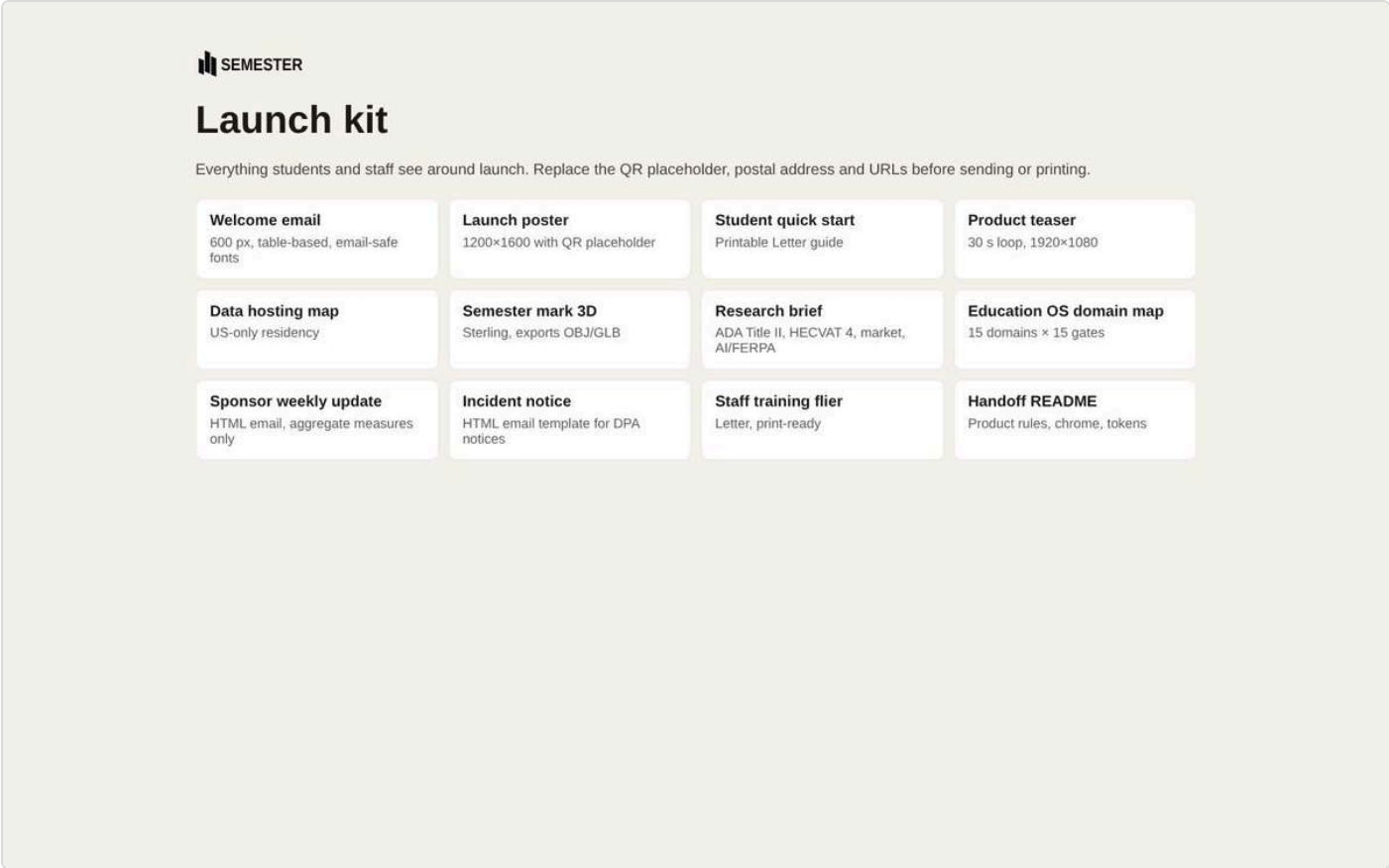



map
meals
opportunities
people
privacy
registrar
search
settings
sources
study
support
today

Launch kit

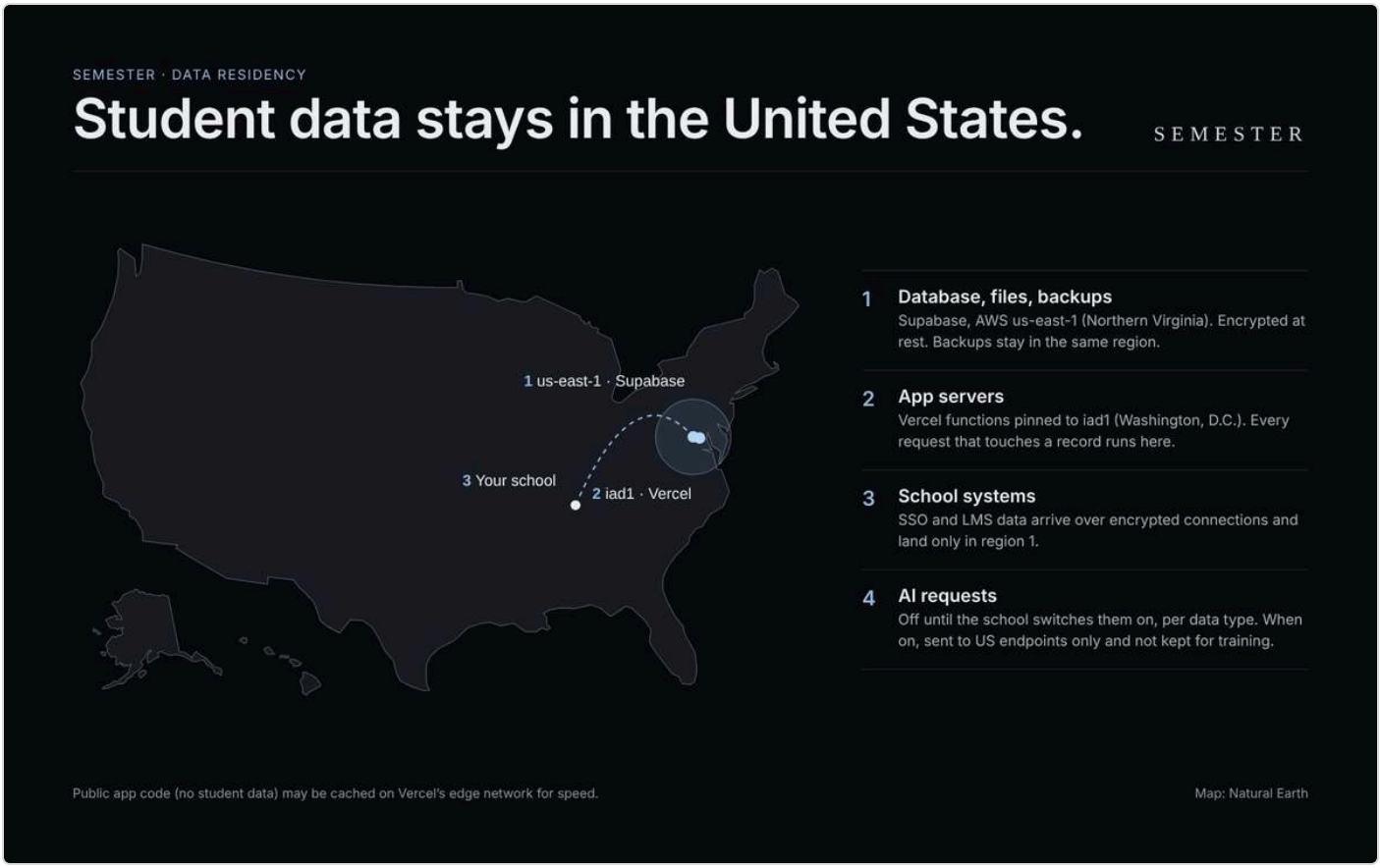
Welcome and incident emails, sponsor update, staff flier, data hosting map and the 3D mark. **6 screens.**

launch-kit



Opening view

Data Hosting Map



Opening view

Incident Notice Email

SEMESTER INCIDENT NOTICE

SEVERITY [S1/S2] · REFERENCE [INC-0001] · [DATE, TIME, TIMEZONE]

[Short plain description, e.g. “Sign-in unavailable for 40 minutes”]

What happened	**[Facts known now; no speculation]**
When	**[Start] – [end or “ongoing”]**
Who is affected	**[Cohort, roles, approximate count]**
Data that may be affected	**[Categories, or “No student data involved”]**
What we have done	**[Feature turned off / fix deployed / access revoked]**
What you can do now	**[Action or “Nothing needed”]**
Next update	**[Time] or sooner if anything changes**

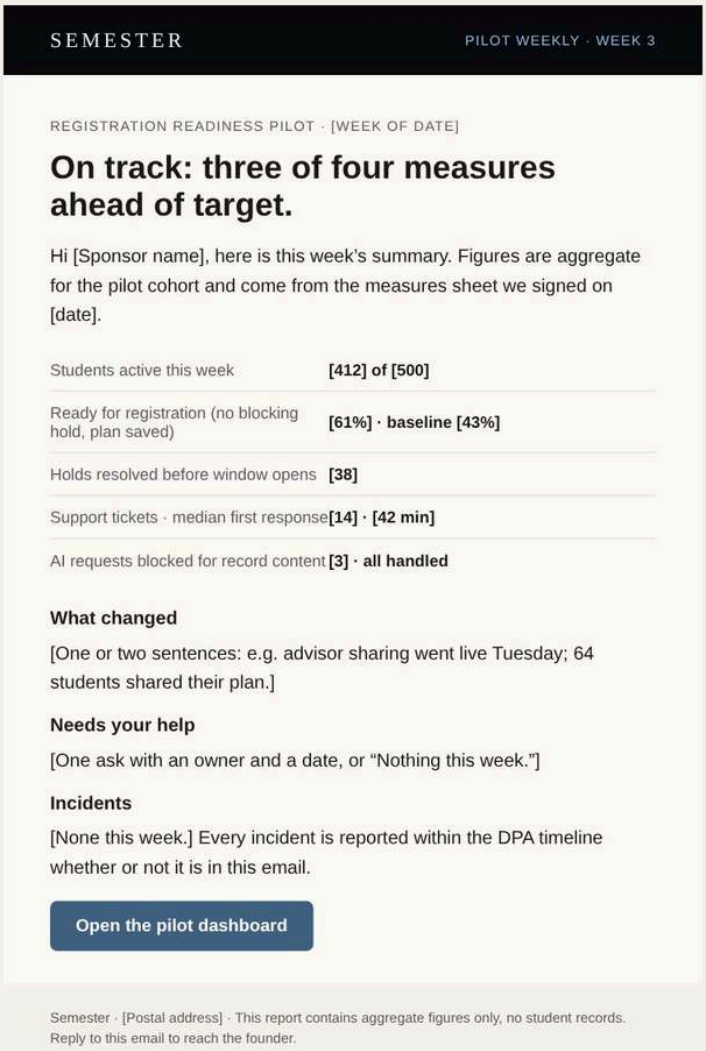
This notice goes to the institution's named security contact under the DPA. The institution decides whether and how to notify students; we will help with wording and facts.

Contact: [Incident commander name], security@semester.app, [phone].

Semester · [Postal address] · This report contains aggregate figures only, no student records. Reply to this email to reach the founder.

Opening view

Sponsor Weekly Update



SEMESTER

PILOT WEEKLY · WEEK 3

REGISTRATION READINESS PILOT · [WEEK OF DATE]

On track: three of four measures ahead of target.

Hi [Sponsor name], here is this week's summary. Figures are aggregate for the pilot cohort and come from the measures sheet we signed on [date].

Students active this week	**[412] of [500]**
Ready for registration (no blocking hold, plan saved)	**[61%] · baseline [43%]**
Holds resolved before window opens	**[38]**
Support tickets · median first response	**[14] · [42 min]**
AI requests blocked for record content	**[3] · all handled**

What changed

[One or two sentences: e.g. advisor sharing went live Tuesday; 64 students shared their plan.]

Needs your help

[One ask with an owner and a date, or "Nothing this week."]

Incidents

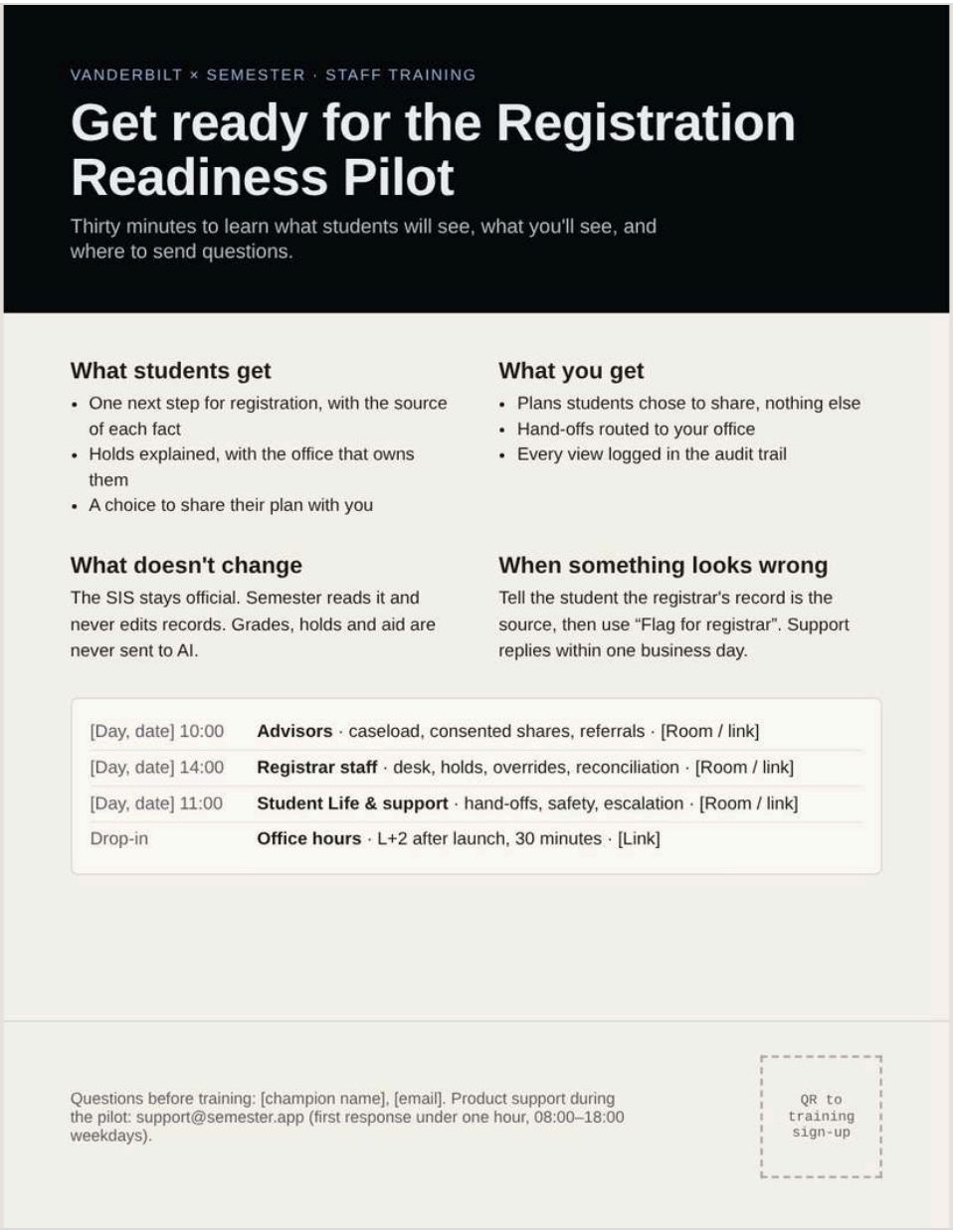
[None this week.] Every incident is reported within the DPA timeline whether or not it is in this email.

Open the pilot dashboard

Semester · [Postal address] · This report contains aggregate figures only, no student records. Reply to this email to reach the founder.

Opening view

Staff Training Flier



VANDERBILT × SEMESTER · STAFF TRAINING

Get ready for the Registration Readiness Pilot

Thirty minutes to learn what students will see, what you'll see, and where to send questions.

What students get

- One next step for registration, with the source of each fact
- Holds explained, with the office that owns them
- A choice to share their plan with you

What you get

- Plans students chose to share, nothing else
- Hand-offs routed to your office
- Every view logged in the audit trail

What doesn't change

The SIS stays official. Semester reads it and never edits records. Grades, holds and aid are never sent to AI.

When something looks wrong

Tell the student the registrar's record is the source, then use “Flag for registrar”. Support replies within one business day.

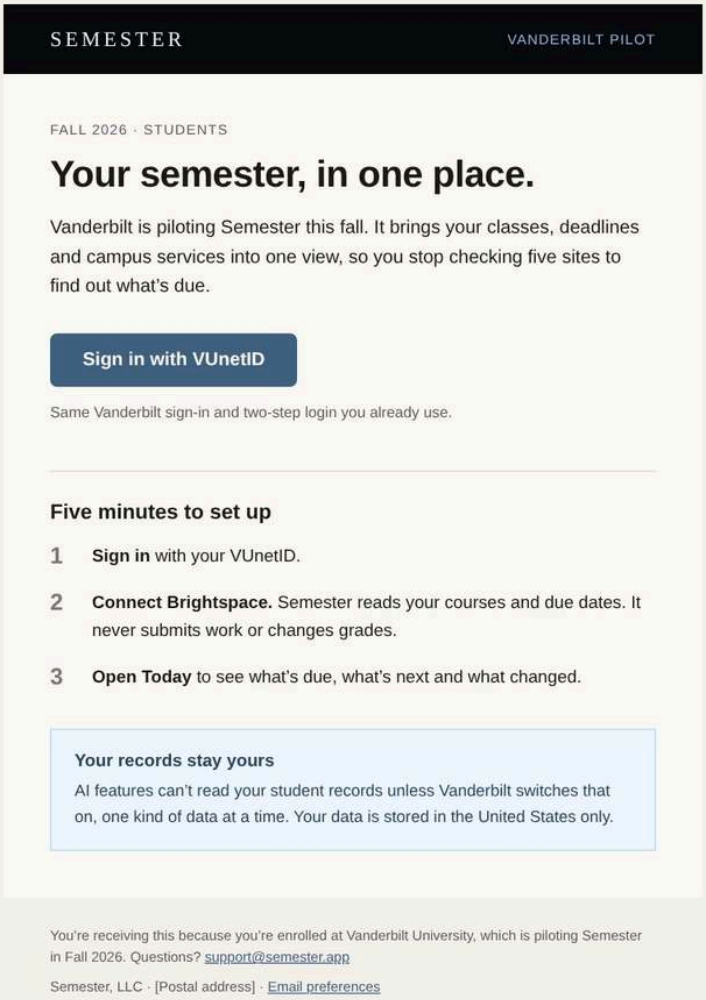
[Day, date] 10:00	**Advisors** · caseload, consented shares, referrals · [Room / link]
[Day, date] 14:00	**Registrar staff** · desk, holds, overrides, reconciliation · [Room / link]
[Day, date] 11:00	**Student Life & support** · hand-offs, safety, escalation · [Room / link]
Drop-in	**Office hours** · L+2 after launch, 30 minutes · [Link]

Questions before training: [champion name], [email]. Product support during the pilot: support@semester.app (first response under one hour, 08:00–18:00 weekdays).

QR to training sign-up

Opening view

Welcome Email



Opening view

Launch kit notes

ui_kits/launch-kit/README.md

Handoff: Semester UI

Overview

Semester is an education operating system. It gives every campus role one home on a shared education graph, connecting first to existing systems (SSO, Brightspace, SIS) and replacing them only once proven. This package holds every designed surface: 13 role onboarding flows, the student Platform, Institution OS, the Company Command Center, the planning maps, the vision deck, and the launch pieces (student quick start, welcome email, poster, teaser, data-hosting map, 3D mark, research brief).

The engineering phase plan lives separately in `handoff/education-os/` (phase prompts + `run.sh`). Build order and review gates come from that kit; this package is the visual and behavioural reference.

About the design files

The `.dc.html` / `.html` files here are **design references built in HTML**. They are prototypes that show intended look, copy and behaviour; they are not production code. Recreate them in the target codebase (the Semester app: Next.js on Vercel, Supabase), using its existing components and patterns. The design-system bundle in `_ds/` mirrors components from the app (`SideRail`, `SystemContextBar`, `MetricTile`, `DataTable`, `SourceBadge`, `Notice`, `NextSteps`, `Choice`, `Switch`, `Button`, `TextField`, `Fields`, `DecisionTrail`, `StepStatus`, `ProvenanceChart`, `Wordmark`, `Mark`). Use the app's own versions where they exist.

Open any `.dc.html` file directly in a browser to see it run. `support.js` is the prototype runtime and is not needed in production.

Fidelity

High fidelity. Colours, type, spacing, copy and interaction states are final, and the screens use real design-system tokens. Sample data is Vanderbilt pilot data and must be replaced with live data and permission checks.

Non-negotiable product rules (enforce in code, not just UI)

- AI never reads student records until the institution switches it on, per data type. The UI shows the current state in Settings › Privacy.

- Every date, grade and answer carries a source label: **Institution verified**, **Yours**, **External**, **Estimated**, or **AI**. Never present AI or estimated values as official.
- Search results are filtered by the viewer's role and permissions before ranking, and AI answers cite sources with those labels.
- Instructors see approved accommodations, never the reason for them.
- Safety reports go to the institution, and Semester keeps no record of them.
- Marketplace apps never receive student records. Partner certification is required.
- Connections only shows users who opted into **Findable**.
- Data residency is US only: Vercel functions on iad1 and Supabase on AWS us-east-1.
- Semester never submits work or changes grades in the LMS; the Brightspace connection is read-only in phase 1.

Screens / views

Application chrome is the same on every product surface: - **Grid:** a `248px` SideRail (always lnk `#090a0e`), then a content column at `minmax(0,1fr)`, full viewport height. - **Context bar:** `SystemContextBar` (44px) shows location, term and sync state. - **Content:** scrolls inside `<main>`, `max-width: 1180px`, padding `28px 30px 64px`. - **Page header:** - Eyebrow: 10.5px Barlow, uppercase, letter-spacing .08em, `--text-secondary`. - H1: Barlow Condensed 600, 26px, letter-spacing –.015em. - Optional subline: `--text-secondary`. - Bottom border: `1px --border-subtle`, with 20px padding below the header. - **Two-column bodies:** `grid-template-columns: repeat(auto-fit, minmax(min(100%,420px),1fr)); gap: 32px`. - **Metric rows:** `repeat(auto-fill, minmax(200px,1fr)); gap: 12px`.

Onboarding (`Onboarding.dc.html` + 13 role files)

- Hub: role picker linking to each role file.
- Each role file has three parts: a sign-in screen ("Sign in with Vanderbilt", simulated SSO delay of about 1.5s), the role home, and a three-step **Finish setting up** checklist (for example, Faculty: Import Brightspace courses → Set your course AI policy → Publish office hours).
- The rail on onboarding homes is static (current item fixed); the destinations are built in Platform and Institution OS.
- Roles: Student, Faculty, TA, Advisor, Registrar, Student affairs, Finance, IT security, Support, Applicant, Guardian, Alumni, Employer.

Semester Platform (`Semester Platform.dc.html`)

Screen	What it does
Search	Filtered results, plus an AI-assisted answer with cited, source-labelled references
Study cards	Flashcards generated from course slides; flip, mark known
Connections	Social layer; only Findable users appear
Safety	One-tap emergency contacts and anonymous reporting (not recorded by Semester)
Accessibility	Accommodations and instructor letters (reason hidden from instructors)
Marketplace	Six certified apps; install never shares records
Developers	Sandbox API keys, webhooks, certification checklist

Institution OS (`Institution OS.dc.html`)

The screens are Executive, Communications, Course Studio, Registrar OS, Research and Admissions. These are operational dashboards built from MetricTile, DataTable and DecisionTrail.

Company Command Center (`Company Command Center.dc.html`)

- **Production strip** above the context bar: `#090a0e` background, 13px text. The "Production" label is uppercase in `#94bce3`. The line reads "Vercel us-east-1 · Supabase us-east-1 · every action here is audited."
- **Overview:** six pilot blockers (HECVAT, data agreement, SSO, accessibility, insurance, incident plan), each a checkbox ticked when evidence is filed.
- **Other screens:** Tenants, Revenue, Releases (gates and feature flags; AI flags belong to the institution), Reliability (incident toggle and sync freshness), Support, Trust (control → evidence table; never write "compliant" without a document), Finance (runway calculator: cash, pilot fee, monthly cost toggles) and Localisation.

Planning surfaces

- `Semester Master Operating Map.dc.html`: the 40 domains, each with what it replaces, its phase and its design link, plus a 35-item definition checklist. Selections persist in localStorage.
- `Education OS Domain Map.dc.html`: 15 domains filterable by phase, each with 15 gates.
- `Semester Finish Line.dc.html`: Pilot loop (18 steps), Readiness (14 domains × 21 gates), Release evidence (20 items) and Cadence. Selections persist.

Launch pieces

- `Semester Vision Deck.dc.html`: 12 slides at 1920×1080 with speaker notes. An offline copy, `Semester Vision Deck (offline).html`, is in the project root.
- `Student Quick Start.dc.html`: printable Letter guide with three setup steps, the source-label table, privacy rules and help contacts.
- `Welcome Email.html`: send-ready, table-based, 600px wide, using email-safe fonts. Replace `[Postal address]` and confirm the `semester.app/vanderbilt` and `/preferences` URLs before sending.
- `Launch Poster.dc.html`: 1200×1600 (3:4). The dashed QR box is a placeholder for a code that points to the sign-in URL.
- `Product Teaser.dc.html` + `teaser.jsx`: 30-second loop at 1920×1080 in five scenes (Chaos, Merge, Today, Trust, Close). Public piece, so it says "your school" rather than Vanderbilt.
- `Data Hosting Map.html`: 1600×1000 map of the US drawn from real Natural Earth geometry (d3), with US-only residency notes.
- `Semester Mark 3D.html`: the three-slab mark extruded in sterling, 0.30 m tall. Exports to OBJ or GLB.
- `Research Brief.dc.html`: sourced brief covering ADA Title II, HECVAT 4, the Canvas breach, Anthology, the market and AI/FERPA.

Interactions & behaviour

- **Rail navigation:** clicking a SideRail item swaps the `<main>` content and resets scroll to the top. The current item is highlighted.
- **Sync states:** `synced`, `syncing` and `delayed` (shown as "Connected · may be out of date"). They appear in the SystemContextBar.
- **Motion:**
- Easing: `--ease: cubic-bezier(.22,1,.36,1)`.
- Durations: fast 130ms, standard 180ms, slow 240ms, sheet 280ms.
- Respect `prefers-reduced-motion`.
- **Checklists:**
- Pilot blockers, the domain checklist and finish-line gates are local toggles in the prototype.
- In production they need persistence and an audit trail of who ticked what, when and with which evidence.
- **Incident toggle** (Reliability): opens a notice and updates the status page. In production this is an audited action.
- **Accessibility:**
- Target WCAG 2.2 AA.
- Minimum hit target 44px for primary controls and 24px minimum overall.
- Focus ring 2px with a 2px offset.
- Every status pairs a word and a glyph, never colour alone.

State management (production)

State	Scope	Notes
Session and role	Per user	Comes from institution SSO
Institution AI switches	Per tenant, per data type	Read by every AI call server-side
Connector status per source	Per tenant	Drives sync badges
Source label	Per record	Stored on the graph record, not derived in the UI
Findable flag	Per user	Gates Connections
Accommodation grants	Per student	The reason field is never sent to instructor clients
Checklist and gate evidence	Per company/tenant	Append-only

Design tokens

These are the source files in `_ds/.../tokens/`. Key values:

Colour, grounds: - Ink: `#090a0e` background, `#12141a` panel, `#191c23` hero, `#22262f` raise, `#eceef2` text. - Parchment: `#f4f1ea` background, `#fbf9f4` panel, `#ffffff` hero, `#1b1a17` text. - Chrome (rail, tab bar, console header) is always Ink. Content defaults to Parchment.

Colour, text: - Secondary: `rgba(27,26,23,.68)` on Parchment, `rgba(236,238,242,.64)` on Ink. - Links: `#416180` on light, `#b5d9fd` on dark.

Colour, borders: `rgba(27,26,23,.09)` subtle, `.16` default, `.34` strong.

Colour, Semester blue: 100 `#eef6ff` · 200 `#d6ebff` · 300 `#b5d9fd` · 400 `#94bce3` · 500 `#749dc4` · 600 `#597ea3` · 700 `#416180` · 800 `#2c455d` · 900 `#1d2d3d`.

Colour, metals: sterling `#d4d9e2` (bright `#f6f8fb`, deep `#9ca3b2`); brass `#d8c79a`.

Colour, source and status (ink on light / tint on dark): - Official: `#2c455d` / `#b5d9fd` - Connected: `#2d5c61` / `#9fcbcd` - Personal: `#4a4b4f` / `#b9b9bd` - AI: `#544a7f` / `#bcb2df` - Pending: `#7a5310` / `#e2c27a` - Risk: `#a3301f` / `#f0907a` - Success: `#3e6141` / `#a9c9a3`

Type: - Families: - Barlow for body text. - Barlow Condensed 600 for headings, labels and controls. - Cinzel for editorial display only: the wordmark, deck titles and the poster mark. - System mono for identifiers. - Scale: 9 · 10 · 10.5 · 11 · 11.5 · 12 · 12.5 · 14 (control) · 16 (base) · 16.5 · 17 · 18 · 19 · 20 · 22 · 24 · 26 · 28 · 32 · 42 · 56px, all multiplied by `--text-scale`.

Spacing: - Compact steps: `--sp-1…7` = 2, 4, 6, 8, 10, 12, 16px, multiplied by `--density` (1 comfortable, .86 snug, .74 tight). - Layout grid: 8, 16, 24, 32, 40, 48, 64, 80, 96px. - Page padding: 18px, then 20px from 760px wide, then 30px from 1100px wide.

Radii: 3px (controls), 6px (cards), 10px (surfaces and sheets), 999px (pill).

Elevation: - On light: `0 1px 2px rgba(43,43,45,.14)`, `0 3px 10px …/.16`, `0 12px 32px …/.22`. - On dark: lift-1/2/3, as in `effects.css`. - Use a border first and a shadow second.

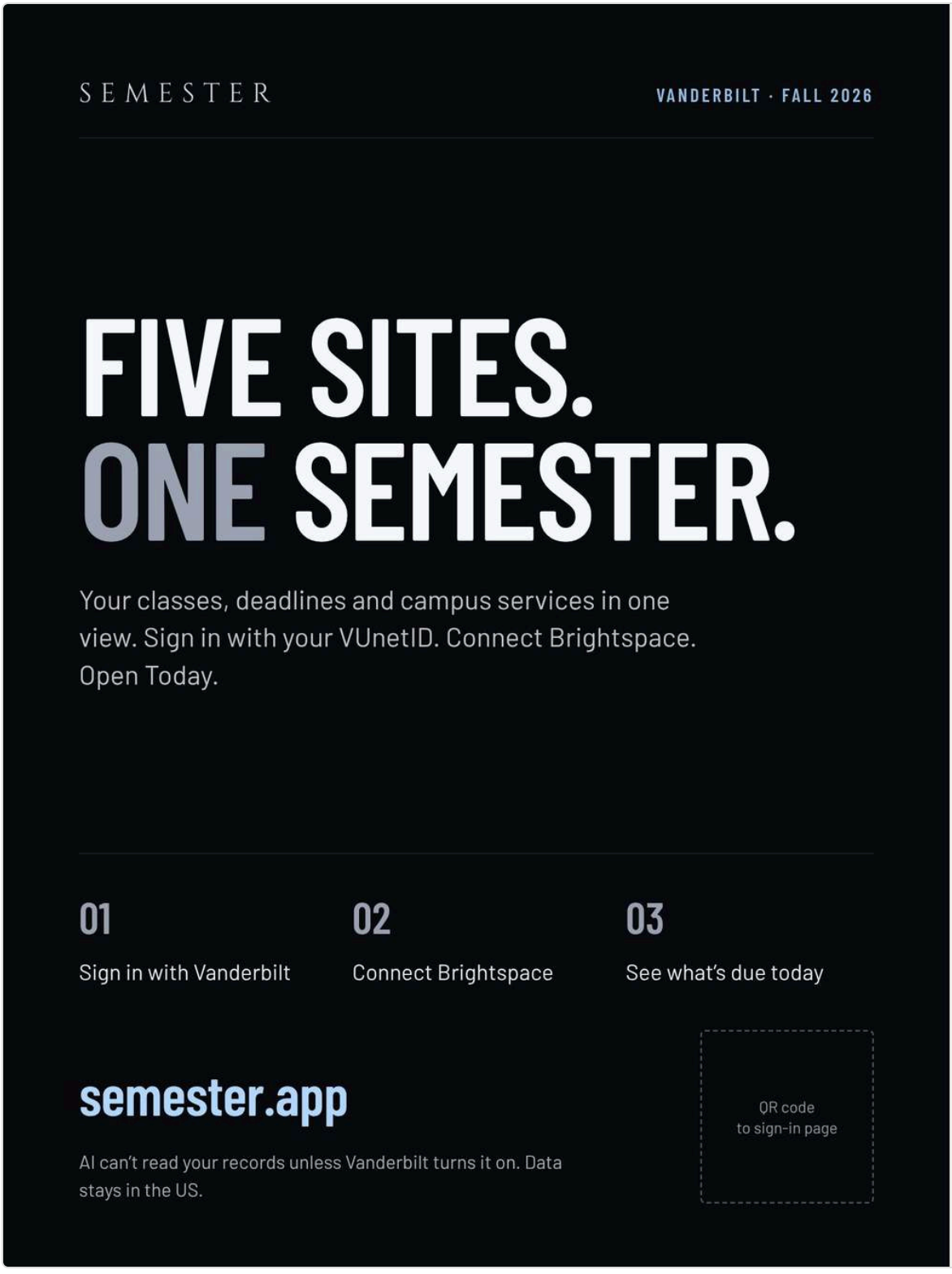
Assets

- Fonts are in `_ds/.../fonts/` as woff2 files: Barlow 400/500/700, Barlow Condensed 400/600, Cinzel.
- The mark is three slabs on a 512 grid, with viewBox `128 65 256 382`:
- `M128 176L204 208L204 420L128 388Z`
- `M218 65L294 97L294 404L218 372Z`
- `M308 147L384 179L384 447L308 415Z`
- Map geometry: Natural Earth via `world-atlas@2.0.2`, public domain.
- Icons come from the design-system bundle's icon set (`SideRail` `icon` ids).
- There's no photography. Image needs are marked as placeholders.

Files

All design files are copied into this folder: - **Design files:** every `.dc.html` / `.html` file listed above. - **Prototype runtime:** `support.js`, `deck-stage.js`, `doc-page.js`, `three-d-stage.js`, `animations-v3.jsx`, `tweaks-panel.jsx`. - **Teaser source:** `teaser.jsx`. - **Design system:** `_ds/` (bundle, styles, tokens, fonts). - **Screen captures:** `Screen Renders.dc.html` in the project root shows every screen, with images in `renders/`. They are not bundled here; ask for them if you want them included.

Launch poster



Opening view

PART 3

Operating

How Semester is run day to day: operations, support, launch, security, trust and compliance.

Support and service operations

docs/business/SUPPORT_AND_SERVICE_OPERATIONS.md

Support and service operations

Semester Company OS · 2026-10-05 · Source: uploads/what else on the bussnius and opprations site also.pdf.

Semester must operate with the same coherence, evidence, reliability and trust it promises to institutions.

Field	Value
Mission	Fast, honest help that feeds the product.
Owner	Founder → support specialist
Inputs	Tickets, status, incidents
System of record	/ops support desk
KPIs	First response; Resolution time; P0/P1 count; CSAT
Reports	Weekly support summary
Meeting cadence	Daily triage in pilot
Risk controls	No student record content in tickets
Approval thresholds	P0 = security/data exposure/broad outage; P1 = critical workflow blocked; P2 degraded with workaround; P3 minor
Required documents	Support plan, Runbooks, Macros, Escalation matrix
Required integrations	Status page, incident console
Current status	docs/launch/Support Plan.html, docs/operate/
Gaps	Help center, KB articles, feature-request taxonomy
Priority	P1
Next action	Write the first 10 KB articles from the pilot paths

Workflows

- Intake → classify → severity → assign → respond → escalate → communicate → resolve → root cause → KB/product update → satisfaction

SEMESTER

Operations handbook · on-call, SLOs, monitoring

Owner: founder (on-call lead until the first engineer joins). Status: draft, October 2026. Companion to the runbooks and the support plan.

Sized for a solo founder: narrow pilot hours, S1 always on, and alerts only for things that need a human now. Everything else goes to the daily review.

1. Service level objectives

Service	SLI	SLO (30-day)	Error budget
Sign-in (SSO)	Successful SSO round-trips ÷ attempts	99.5%	~3.6 h of failures
App availability	Successful page + API requests ÷ total (5xx = bad)	99.5% during pilot hours	~3.6 h
Read-model freshness	Share of minutes SIS projection lag ≤ 15 min	99%	~7.2 h
API latency	p95 of api.* reads	< 800 ms	—
AI gateway	Requests answered or safely refused ÷ total	99%	—
AI safety	Student-record leaks to a provider	0	None: any leak is an S1

These are starting targets for the pilot, not contractual SLAs. Contract SLAs go in the order form after a term of real data.

2. Error budget policy

- Budget above 50%: normal releases.
- Budget 0–50%: only fixes and reliability work; no feature releases to the affected service.
- Budget exhausted: freeze, write a reliability plan, review with the sponsor if a pilot is affected.

3. On-call

Item	Rule
Rotation	Founder until the first engineer; then weekly rotation, handover Monday 09:00
Hours	S1: any hour. S2: 07:00–22:00. S3/S4: pilot hours (08:00–18:00 weekdays)

Item	Rule
Acknowledge	S1 within 15 min, S2 within 30 min
Escalation	On-call → founder → vendor support (Vercel, Supabase, IdP) → institution IT contact
Handover note	Open incidents, alerts silenced and why, risky changes this week
Load limit	More than 2 night pages in a week → next week is reliability work

4. Alerts

Alert	Condition	Severity	Runbook
Error rate high	5xx > 2% for 15 min	S2 (rollback trigger)	R1 Bad release
SSO failures	> 10 failures in 15 min, or IdP metadata error	S2	R2 SSO outage
SIS sync stale	Projection lag > 60 min in pilot hours	S2	R3 SIS sync
Sync mismatches	Reconciliation shows unexplained mismatches	S2	R3 SIS sync
Cross-tenant access attempt	RLS denial spike from one session	S1 (investigate)	R5 Suspected exposure
AI gateway block spike	Blocks > 5× daily baseline	S3	R6 AI gateway
AI provider down	Gateway error rate > 10% for 10 min	S3	R6 AI gateway
Database near limit	Storage > 80% or connections > 80%	S3	R7 Capacity
Backup failed	Nightly backup missing	S2	R4 Backup and restore
Certificate expiry	TLS or SAML cert < 21 days	S3	R2 SSO outage

5. Monitoring

Signal	Source	Where it shows
Errors and traces	Error tracker (no student data in payloads)	/ops incidents
Uptime	External synthetic check on sign-in and Today	/ops SLOs, public status page
Database health	Supabase metrics	/ops site operations
Sync lag and mismatches	Projection worker + reconciliation job	/ops integrations
AI gateway	Gateway logs: blocks, cost, errors	/ops AI gateway
Audit	audit.events	Institution audit explorer

6. Daily and weekly reviews

Cadence	Review
Daily (pilot)	Overnight errors, sync lag, gateway blocks, ticket queue, error budget
Weekly	SLO report, alerts that fired and whether each was useful, top tickets, patch status
Monthly	Restore drill result, access review, dependency report, cost vs finance model

7. Maintenance cadence

Cadence	Task
Weekly	Dependency alerts: patch critical/high within 7 days
Monthly	Restore drill to a scratch project, timed; minor dependency bumps
Quarterly	Access review of all production access; secret rotation; tabletop incident exercise; subprocessor review
Yearly	Pen test (when funded), ACR re-test, policy review, HECVAT refresh

SEMESTER

Runbooks

Owner: on-call. Status: draft, October 2026. Each runbook: detect → stabilise → fix → verify → tell people → write it down. Log every step with time in the incident record in /ops.

R1 · Bad release

1. Confirm the error spike started with the latest deploy (deploy time vs error graph).
2. Promote the previous Vercel deployment. If a migration ran, check it's backwards-compatible; if not, follow R4.
3. Verify error rate back under 1% for 15 min.
4. If a pilot is affected for more than 30 min, tell the sponsor within 1 hour.
5. Open a fix PR with a test that reproduces the failure.

R2 · SSO outage

1. Check the IdP status and the SAML error in logs (metadata, certificate, clock skew, attribute mapping).
2. If the IdP is down: post on the status page, tell the institution IT contact; nothing to fix on our side.
3. If our config: restore the last known-good SP config from the config history; never weaken signature checks.
4. Certificate rotation: exchange new metadata with institution IT, test with a staging account first.
5. Verify a test login per pilot role.

R3 · SIS sync stale or mismatched

1. Open the sync run history: last success, failing step, dead-letter count.
2. Credential or API error: check expiry with institution IT; rotate server-side only.
3. Schema drift: pause the mapping, show the delay badge to users (freshness policy blocks consequential actions automatically), fix mapping in a new version, re-run.
4. Mismatches: never auto-correct. List them, ask the registrar data owner which source is right, re-sync.
5. Replay dead-letter events after the fix; confirm reconciliation shows 0 unexplained mismatches.

R4 · Backup and restore

1. Identify the restore point (point-in-time or nightly backup ID).
2. Restore to a new scratch project first; never overwrite production blindly.
3. Verify row counts and a sample of records against the last reconciliation.
4. Cut over by pointing the app at the restored database, or copy back the affected tables only.
5. Record start and end time: that's the measured recovery time. Monthly drills follow the same steps on a scratch project.

R5 · Suspected student-data exposure

1. **Turn off the affected feature or the pilot cohort flag first.**
2. Preserve evidence: logs, audit events, the request IDs. Don't delete anything.
3. Founder becomes incident commander. Start the incident record (S1).
4. Assess: which records, which tenant, who could see them, for how long.
5. Notify the institution's security contact without undue delay and within the DPA deadline; the institution decides on notices to students.
6. Fix, add a test that proves the fix, re-run RLS suite, re-enable only after the go/no-go check.
7. Postmortem within 5 business days, shared with the institution.

R6 · AI gateway

1. Provider outage: switch to the fallback model if approved for the tenant, else show "Ask Semester is unavailable" with links to the official offices.
2. Block spike: sample blocked prompts (metadata only) to check whether a UI change is sending record fields; fix the client.
3. Cost spike: spend cap stops requests; check for loops or abuse; raise the cap only with founder approval.

R7 · Capacity

1. Check storage, connections and compute in Supabase metrics.
2. Clear stale projections or logs past retention.
3. Upgrade compute size if sustained; note the cost change against the finance model.

R8 · Student can't see their data

1. Confirm membership and role mapping for the user (IdP attributes).
2. Check the student is in the pilot cohort and the feature flag is on.
3. Check sync freshness for that student's records.
4. Reply with the support macro; never paste record content into the ticket.

Support macros

Macro	Use
Sign-in problem	Ask for time and error shown; point to the campus help channel first
Data looks wrong	Explain the registrar is the source; flag for registrar confirmation within one business day
AI and records	Assistant never receives records; how to turn it off
Not in pilot	Pilot is for a set group this term; school will share any rollout

Macro	Use
Known issue	Link the known-issues note; say when we will update
Accessibility barrier	Thank them; workaround if any; fix timeline

SEMESTER

Pilot launch runbook · Vanderbilt University

Owner: founder. Status: draft, October 2026. Pilot dates aren't set yet, so every date below is relative to launch day (L).

Rule: nothing launches until every go/no-go gate is green, with evidence attached. "Ready" means tested in staging with the institution's real configuration, not described in a document.

1. Go / no-go gates

Gate	Evidence required	Owner	Due
DPA / FERPA addendum signed	Countersigned PDF on file	Founder	L−45
HECVAT Full submitted and accepted	Vanderbilt IT acceptance email	Founder	L−30
Cyber and E&O insurance bound	Certificates of insurance sent to Vanderbilt	Founder	L−30
VPAT / ACR delivered	ACR document and test log	Founder	L−30
SAML SSO working in staging	Test logins for each pilot role	Eng	L−21
SIS read sync reconciled	Reconciliation report: 0 unexplained mismatches	Eng	L−14
RLS tests pass	CI run link; company roles can't read student tables	Eng	L−14
AI gateway blocks student records	Red-team test log	Eng	L−14
Backups and restore drill	Restore timed and documented	Eng	L−10
Incident response contacts exchanged	Named contacts on both sides	Founder	L−7
Success measures agreed	Signed one-page measures sheet	Founder + sponsor	L−7

2. Timeline

When	What
L−45 to L−30	Contracts, insurance, security review, accessibility report
L−30 to L−14	SSO, SIS connection, role mapping, staging data checks
L−14 to L−7	Staff training (advisors, registrar, Student Life), dry run with test accounts

When	What
L−3	Final go/no-go meeting with the sponsor, then freeze changes
L	Turn on for the pilot group, send the welcome email, open the watch room
L+1 to L+7	Daily check-ins, then the week-1 review
End of term	Results report against the agreed measures

3. Launch day

Time	Step	Check
08:00	Confirm status page green and SIS sync fresh (<15 min)	Ops console
08:30	Enable pilot cohort flag	Test login per role
09:00	Institution sends the welcome email (from Vanderbilt, not Semester)	Sponsor confirms
09:00–17:00	Watch errors, sign-in failures, support tickets and AI gateway blocks	Hourly note in the log
17:00	Day-1 summary to the sponsor	Sent

4. Rollback

Trigger any one of these: a suspected student-data exposure; SSO down for more than 30 minutes; SIS data shown wrongly to a student; error rate above 2% for 15 minutes.

Steps: 1) turn off the pilot cohort flag; 2) show the holding message; 3) tell the Vanderbilt contact within 1 hour; 4) if student data might be involved, follow the incident response plan and the DPA notice terms; 5) fix, retest in staging, and re-run the go/no-go before re-enabling.

5. Support in week 1

Staff questions go to the support desk (target first response under 1 hour during pilot hours). Student questions go through Vanderbilt's help channel first and are escalated to Semester only when needed. Every issue is logged with its cause and fix, and the log feeds the week-1 review.

6. Communications

Audience	Message	Sender
Pilot students	What it is, what data it uses, how to get help	Vanderbilt
Pilot staff	Training links, the support path, what's in scope	Vanderbilt + Semester
Sponsor	Daily in week 1, then weekly	Founder

Audience	Message	Sender
Public	Nothing until both sides approve. The Vanderbilt name is cleared for use, but the wording is agreed first	Founder

SEMESTER

Production cutover plan · Vanderbilt pilot

Owner: founder. Status: draft, October 2026. Companion to the launch runbook. Times are relative to launch day (L); clock times are US Central.

Scope: moving the pilot from staging to production — environments, identity, SIS data, configuration and DNS. The runbook's go/no-go gates must all be green before step C1 starts. Every step names its check and its undo.

1. Environments

Environment	Hosting	Data	Who has access
Local	Supabase CLI + Next.js dev	Synthetic seed only	Engineers
Staging	Vercel preview + Supabase staging project	Synthetic, plus Vanderbilt test IdP accounts	Engineers, Vanderbilt IT testers
Production	Vercel production + Supabase production project (separate keys)	Real student records under the DPA	Named operators only, MFA required, access logged

Production never receives a copy of staging data, and staging never receives production data. Secrets are set per environment and are not shared.

2. Freeze and roles

Item	Rule
Code freeze	From L−3 after the final go/no-go. Only fixes for a failed cutover check, approved by the founder.
Change log	Every cutover step is logged with time, operator, result and evidence link.
Operator	Founder (or contracted engineer) runs the steps; a second person reads the checklist aloud where available.
Vanderbilt contacts	IT (SSO, SIS), registrar data owner, pilot sponsor — named in the incident contact sheet.

3. Cutover sequence

#	When	Step	Check	Undo
C1	L−2 09:00	Apply migrations to production; run RLS test suite against production schema (no data yet)	CI link: all RLS tests pass; company roles read 0 student rows	Restore empty-schema snapshot

#	When	Step	Check	Undo
C2	L−2 11:00	Set production secrets: Supabase keys, SAML certs, SIS read credentials, AI gateway key, email sender	Secret checklist signed; no staging values present	Rotate and re-set
C3	L−2 13:00	Vanderbilt IT registers the production SAML service provider; exchange metadata	Test login for each pilot role succeeds; attributes map to the right role	Disable SP; stay on staging
C4	L−2 15:00	Load institution configuration: terms, roles, pilot cohort, feature switches (community and marketplace off unless agreed)	Config export matches the signed scope sheet	Re-import previous config
C5	L−1 08:00	First SIS read sync into production (pilot cohort only)	Reconciliation: row counts match the registrar extract; 0 unexplained mismatches	Truncate synced tables; re-run
C6	L−1 11:00	Registrar spot-check: 25 random students viewed by a registrar user	Registrar signs off in writing	Truncate and re-sync
C7	L−1 13:00	Point DNS (app subdomain) to Vercel production; confirm TLS	Certificate valid; HSTS set; status page live	Revert DNS record
C8	L−1 15:00	Take baseline backup; record point-in-time recovery window	Backup ID logged; restore drill already passed (runbook gate)	—
C9	L−1 16:00	Enable staff accounts for advisors, registrar, Student Life (student cohort flag still off)	Each staff role logs in and sees only scoped records	Disable staff flag
C10	L 08:00	Fresh SIS sync; confirm lag < 15 min	Ops console green	Hold launch
C11	L 08:30	Enable pilot student cohort flag	Five test students sign in end to end	Turn flag off; holding message

4. Point of no return

There isn’t one. Until C11, students see nothing. After C11, the cohort flag turns everything off in under a minute without deleting data. Data is deleted only on Vanderbilt’s written instruction under the DPA.

5. Verification after cutover

Check	How	Pass
Role isolation	Sign in as each pilot role; try a cross-role URL	Denied and logged
AI gateway	Send a prompt containing a test student ID	Blocked; event in gateway log
Audit log	View a record as an advisor	Entry with actor, record and time

Check	How	Pass
Email	Trigger a test notification	Delivered from the agreed sender; no student data in body
Performance	Load the student home and advisor queue	Under 2 s on campus Wi-Fi

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6. Sign-off

Cutover is complete when C1–C11 and every section 5 check are logged with evidence, and the sponsor confirms by email. The log is attached to the week-1 review.

SEMESTER

Day-1 and week-1 support plan · Vanderbilt pilot

Owner: founder. Status: draft, October 2026. Companion to the launch runbook and cutover plan.

Reality check: Semester is one founder. This plan is sized for that: narrow hours, a clear first line at Vanderbilt, and a short list of things that get an immediate response.

1. Who answers what

Line	Who	Handles
Tier 0 — self-help	In-app help, User guide, FAQ	How-to questions, where things are
Tier 1 — campus	Vanderbilt help channel (named by IT)	Sign-in, account, routing
Tier 2 — Semester	Founder via the support desk	Bugs, wrong data shown, configuration, staff questions
Tier 3 — vendors	Vercel, Supabase, IdP, SIS vendor	Platform outages, through their status pages and support

2. Severity and response targets

Severity	Example	First response	Updates
S1 — data or safety	Possible student-data exposure; one student sees another’s record	15 min, any hour in week 1	Hourly; incident plan and DPA notice terms apply
S2 — blocked	SSO down; SIS data wrong; app unavailable	30 min, 07:00–22:00	Every 2 h
S3 — degraded	One feature broken; slow pages	1 h during pilot hours (08:00–18:00)	Daily
S4 — question	How do I…; feature request	Same business day	On close

Rollback triggers in the runbook override this table: if one fires, turn the cohort flag off first, then respond.

3. Day 1

Time	Activity
07:30	Read overnight errors, sync lag and gateway blocks; open the watch log
08:00–17:00	Watch room: support desk, error tracker, sign-in failures, SIS lag. Hourly note in the log.
10:00, 14:00	Check-in with the Vanderbilt Tier 1 lead: new themes, anything to escalate

Time	Activity
17:00	Day-1 summary to the sponsor: sign-ins, tickets by severity, open issues, next steps
21:00	Last check of the S1/S2 queue; phone on for S1

4. Week-1 rhythm

Day	Focus
L+1	Fix top day-1 issues; publish a known-issues note to Tier 1
L+2	Staff office hour (30 min) for advisors and registrar
L+3	Re-run SIS reconciliation; registrar spot-checks 10 records
L+4	Student feedback pulse (3 questions, in-app, optional)
L+5	Week-1 review with the sponsor

Daily: 17:00 summary to the sponsor, known-issues note refreshed, no untriaged tickets.

5. Ready-to-send replies

Situation	Reply outline
Can’t sign in	Use your Vanderbilt login at the pilot link. If it fails, contact the campus help channel with the time and the error shown.
My information looks wrong	Semester shows what the registrar holds. We’ve flagged it and the registrar will confirm within one business day. Nothing here changes your official record.
Is AI reading my records?	No. The assistant never receives student records. It sees only what you type, and you can turn it off in settings.
I’m not in the pilot	The pilot is for a set group this term. Your school will share any wider rollout.

6. Logging

Every ticket records severity, role, area, cause, fix and time to resolve. No student record content goes in a ticket; reference records by internal ID only.

7. Week-1 review agenda

Item	Output
Sign-in and adoption by role	Numbers from the ops console
Tickets by severity and cause	Top 5 causes and their fixes
Data accuracy	Reconciliation and spot-check results

Item	Output
Incidents	None, or the incident report
Changes for week 2	Agreed list; anything that needs a go/no-go gate re-run

8. Exit to steady state

Week-1 cover ends when there are no open S1/S2 issues, two consecutive days pass without a new S2, reconciliation is clean, and the sponsor agrees. Support then moves to pilot hours (08:00–18:00 weekdays, S1 always on) and sponsor updates go weekly.

TRUST PROGRAM

docs/business/TRUST_PROGRAM.md

Security, privacy, accessibility and compliance

Semester Company OS · 2026-10-05 · Source: uploads/what else on the bussnius and opprations site also.pdf.

> Semester must operate with the same coherence, evidence, reliability and trust it promises to institutions.

Requires qualified professional review before use.

Field	Value
Mission	Make trust evidence-based: controls designed, implemented, tested and shown to buyers.
Owner	Founder + fractional security lead
Inputs	Asset/data inventory, policies, vendor list, incidents, questionnaires
System of record	/ops trust & compliance (controls, evidence, HECVAT, data requests)
KPIs	Controls with evidence; Questionnaire turnaround; Access reviews on time; Open high vulnerabilities
Reports	Quarterly trust report; HECVAT response
Meeting cadence	Quarterly access review and tabletop; annual policy review
Risk controls	Vendor security obligations in writing, need-to-know access, MFA, encryption, vendor-breach plan (FTC vendor guidance)
Approval thresholds	Any new subprocessor → privacy review + 30-day notice
Required documents	Security policies, Security readiness, Incident response, BCP/DR, Vendor risk, Claims register
Required integrations	Evidence links to GitHub, Supabase, Vercel
Current status	docs/secure/, docs/operate/, ui_kits/compliance/
Gaps	HECVAT submitted, insurance bound, ACR, vendor reviews documented
Priority	P0
Next action	Bind insurance; submit HECVAT Full; complete vendor reviews for Supabase, Vercel, AI provider

Workflows

- Inventory → risk assessment → control design → implementation → evidence → testing → monitoring → intake → remediation → verification → control review → customer evidence
- Vendor intake → purpose → data classification → security/privacy review → contract terms → access scope → onboarding → periodic review → incident escalation → renewal → offboarding

docs/business/trust/SECURITY_PRIVACY_ACCESSIBILITY_COMPLIANCE.md

Security, privacy, accessibility and compliance

Semester business operations · 2026-10-05 · Source: uploads/Show the finance and accounting operations section.pdf.
Accounting, tax, legal, insurance, privacy, security, accessibility and compliance content needs qualified professional review before use.

> Every customer promise connects to a financial owner, delivery owner, support process, security/privacy control, product capability and evidence trail.

Continuous operational systems, not a launch checklist.

Security program

Governance, asset and data inventory, classification, threat modeling, identity and access, MFA, secrets, secure SDLC, dependency and vulnerability management, logging and monitoring, incident response, backup/restore, DR, BCP, vendor risk, access reviews, pen testing, awareness, evidence register, Trust Center, HECVAT, questionnaires, reporting.

Controls by domain

Domain	Required controls
Identity	MFA, least privilege, joiner/mover/leaver, service-account ownership
Authorization	RLS, tenant isolation, capability checks, server-side scope
Secrets	Server-only credentials, rotation, secret scanning, no browser exposure
Application	Code review, testing, SAST, dependency scanning, release gates
Infrastructure	Environment separation, logging, monitoring, backups, recovery
Data	Classification, minimization, encryption, retention, deletion, export
AI	Provider controls, policy, classification, audit, evaluation, spend limits
Vendors	Security review, contract terms, subprocessors, monitoring, offboarding
Incident	Severity, command roles, communications, postmortem, corrective actions
Compliance	HECVAT, evidence, control mapping, review calendar, claims governance

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Privacy operations

Data inventory and map, classification, purpose limitation, consent, retention, deletion, legal holds, subject/export/erasure/correction requests, subprocessors, privacy impact assessments, privacy incidents, policy review, reporting.

Control record

Control → owner → policy → implementation → evidence → test → reviewer → last review → next review → customer claim → procurement response → exception/remediation.

Have: docs/secure/, docs/operate/, docs/legal/ (DPA, privacy, subprocessors), docs/build/ (test plans). **Gaps (P0):** insurance, HECVAT, ACR, vendor reviews, evidence register entries.

`docs/platform/ENTERPRISE_TRUST_PROGRAM.md`

Enterprise trust and procurement readiness

Semester platform maturity program · 2026-10-05 · Source: uploads/what else is needed to become the apple google and.pdf. Status is design-stage: nothing is "done" until repo code, tests and release evidence exist.

Principle: Semester must become the system people prefer to use every day, the system institutions trust to operate, and the system partners prefer to build on.

Standard

- Trust Center, HECVAT readiness, security and privacy overviews, accessibility program, responsible AI documentation, architecture and data-flow diagrams, subprocessor list, DPA process, SLA/support policy.
- Incident response, business continuity, disaster recovery, pen-test roadmap, evidence register, questionnaire library, vendor risk program, compliance roadmap.
- Answer for CIO, security, privacy, accessibility, registrar and procurement: can we trust, operate, migrate to, get our data out of, control, support and hold it accountable?

Capability record

Field	Value
Current evidence	`docs/secure/`, `docs/legal/`, `ui_kits/company-site/ (Trust)`, `ui_kits/compliance/`
Implementation state	Drafted: 10 policies, readiness plan, MSA/DPA/order form, Trust Center page. Insurance, HECVAT, ACR not complete.
Product owner	Founder
Technical owner	Security & compliance (fractional)
Risk owner	Counsel
Success metrics	HECVAT accepted; DPA signed; Insurance bound; ACR delivered; Questionnaire turnaround (days)
Launch gate	All six pilot blockers closed with evidence
Next action	Bind cyber + E&O insurance and submit HECVAT Full
Security / privacy / accessibility	RLS + tenant_id on every row; no student records to AI; WCAG 2.2 AA
Replacement authority gate	Institution approval with reconciliation evidence before Semester becomes authoritative for any domain

Execute

See `handoff/execute/` streams and `13-platform-maturity.md`.

Global reliability and operations

Semester platform maturity program · 2026-10-05 · Source: uploads/what else is needed to become the apple google and.pdf. Status is design-stage: nothing is "done" until repo code, tests and release evidence exist.

Principle: Semester must become the system people prefer to use every day, the system institutions trust to operate, and the system partners prefer to build on.

Standard

- Service catalog, critical journey map, SLIs and SLOs, error-budget policy (feature work slows when the budget is spent), release policy, incident command, status communications.
- Disaster recovery, backup/restore drills, load and capacity testing, dependency map, observability, tenant health, integration health, operations inbox, on-call matrix, RCA and corrective actions, release cohorts and kill switches.

Capability record

Field	Value
Current evidence	`docs/operate/`, `ui_kits/ops/`, `ui_kits/architecture/ (lag simulator)`
Implementation state	Drafted: SLOs, error-budget policy, 10 alerts, 8 runbooks. No monitoring live.
Product owner	Engineering
Technical owner	Founder (on-call)
Risk owner	Founder
Success metrics	SLO attainment; Error budget remaining; Restore drill time; Incidents with postmortem in 5 days
Launch gate	Restore drill timed; alerts firing in staging
Next action	Wire error tracking, uptime checks and the SIS-lag alert in staging
Security / privacy / accessibility	RLS + tenant_id on every row; no student records to AI; WCAG 2.2 AA
Replacement authority gate	Institution approval with reconciliation evidence before Semester becomes authoritative for any domain

Execute

See `handoff/execute/` streams and `13-platform-maturity.md`.

SEMESTER

Security policy set

Version 0.1 draft · October 2026 · Owner: founder (acting security lead). Reviewed every year and after any incident. These policies map to the HECVAT and SOC 2 control areas; we hold neither attestation today.

Scope: Semester production systems (Vercel hosting, Supabase Postgres and auth, the AI gateway), company laptops and accounts, and every person with access. Student data belongs to the institution and is handled only as its DPA allows.

1. Access control

HECVAT: Authentication, Authorization · SOC 2: CC6

- Least privilege by role. Company roles (sales, finance, marketing, investors) get no access to student data.
- Production database access is limited to named engineers, granted through just-in-time requests that are logged.
- MFA is required on every company account. Customer staff sign in through institution SAML SSO.
- Access is reviewed every quarter, and removed within 24 hours when someone leaves.
- Row-level security on every table holding student data, tested in CI.

2. Encryption and keys

SOC 2: CC6.1, CC6.7

- TLS 1.2 or higher in transit, and AES-256 at rest (provider managed).
- Secrets live in the platform secret store, never in the repo. They rotate every year, and immediately if exposed.
- Backups are encrypted with the same controls.

3. AI and student data

- The AI gateway strips and blocks student-record fields before any model call. The block list is tested in CI and red-teamed before each release.
- Model providers are under no-training, zero- or limited-retention terms, and are listed as subprocessors.
- Students are told when content is AI-assisted. A person confirms any consequential action.

4. Vendor management

- Every subprocessor gets a security review before use: their SOC 2 or equivalent, a DPA, and the data location.
- The subprocessor list is published, and institutions get 30 days' notice before a new one is added.
- Vendors are reviewed every year.

5. Incident response

- Severities: **S1** student data possibly exposed; **S2** pilot down or wrong data shown; **S3** degraded; **S4** minor.
- For S1 and S2: an incident lead is named within 15 minutes, and evidence is preserved.
- The institution is notified within the DPA window (target: within 24 hours of confirming an S1). Customers hear from us before the public does.
- A blameless review within 5 business days, with every action item tracked to closure.

6. Business continuity and disaster recovery

- Targets: RPO 24 hours (daily backups plus point-in-time recovery where available), RTO 8 hours.
- A restore drill every quarter, timed and recorded.
- The founder is a single point of failure. Credentials and runbooks are in a sealed emergency kit with a named backup contact.

7. Data retention and deletion

- The institution sets retention. By default, data is deleted within 30 days of contract end, with written confirmation.
- Logs are kept for 1 year. Audit logs are kept as long as the contract requires.
- Student data requests (view, correct, delete) are routed through the institution.

8. Secure development

- Every change goes through a pull request with review. CI runs tests, RLS tests, dependency checks and secret scanning.
- Staging mirrors production configuration with synthetic data. Real student data is never used in development.
- Critical vulnerabilities are patched within 7 days, and high ones within 30.
- A penetration test before the pilot goes broad, then every year.

9. Acceptable use and devices

- Company devices: full-disk encryption, automatic updates, screen lock, and the ability to wipe them remotely.
- No student data on personal devices, in email attachments or in chat tools.
- Phishing and security training when someone joins, then every year.

10. Logging and monitoring

- Auth events, admin actions, data access and AI gateway blocks are logged with the actor's role.
- Alerts for sign-in failure spikes, error rate, sync lag and unusual data export.

Readiness

Status today: policies drafted; HECVAT Full in progress; SOC 2 not started (a Type I is planned after the pilot); no pen test yet; insurance not yet bound. Track progress in the IT & security console (ui_kits/ops → IT & security).

SEMESTER

Security readiness tracker

HECVAT Full draft answers, SOC 2 readiness, pen-test scope and insurance. October 2026. Status key: ✓ **Done** · … **In progress** · ○ **Not started**. Never mark anything done without evidence.

1. HECVAT Full: draft answers by section

Section	Draft position	Evidence	Status
Company overview	LLC, solo founder, US based, pre-revenue, first pilot	Formation docs	…
Documentation	Security policy set v0.1; annual review	Security Policies.html	…
IT accessibility	Designed to WCAG 2.2 AA; VPAT/ACR in progress	ACR, test log	…
Application security	PR review, CI tests, RLS tests, dependency and secret scanning	CI config, run links	…
Authentication	SAML SSO for institution users; MFA on all company accounts	SSO test log	…
Authorization	Role-based access plus Postgres RLS; company roles have no access to student data	RLS test suite	…
Data	Encrypted in transit and at rest; US hosting; no student records sent to AI	Provider docs, gateway tests	…
Data center	Inherited from Vercel and Supabase (their SOC 2 reports)	Vendor reports	○
Change management	Every change via PR; staging before production	Repo settings	…
Incident response	Severities, 24 h notice target, blameless review	IR plan, tabletop	…
Business continuity / DR	RPO 24 h, RTO 8 h, quarterly restore drill	Drill record	○
Policies and training	Security training when someone joins and every year	Completion record	○
Third parties	Subprocessor list with 30-day notice	Subprocessor page	…
Vulnerability management	Critical in 7 days, high in 30; annual pen test	Scan reports, pen test	○

2. SOC 2 readiness (Type I planned after the pilot)

Area	What's needed	Status
CC1 Control environment	Org chart, code of conduct, background checks for hires	○
CC2 Communication	Published security page, internal policy acknowledgment	…
CC3 Risk assessment	Annual risk register (start from the business risk register)	…
CC5 Control activities	Policies mapped to controls	…
CC6 Logical access	MFA, quarterly access reviews, offboarding checklist	…

Area	What's needed	Status
CC7 Operations	Monitoring, alerting, incident tickets	○
CC8 Change management	Branch protection, required review	…
CC9 Vendor risk	Vendor reviews on file	○
A1 Availability	Backups and a tested restore	○
C1 Confidentiality	Data classification, retention and deletion	…

Compliance automation tools and auditors cost money. Budget for them after the pilot, outside the $5k–$20k setup range unless a customer requires it sooner.

3. Pen-test scope (before the pilot goes broad)

In scope	Out of scope
Web app (student, staff, console), auth and SSO flows, Supabase RLS and APIs, AI gateway prompt-injection and data-leak tests, file uploads, marketplace and messaging abuse	Vendor infrastructure (Vercel and Supabase platforms), denial of service, social engineering of institution staff, any production student data (test in a staging environment with synthetic data)

Deliverables: a report with severities, a retest after fixes, and an attestation letter that can be shared with institutions.

4. Insurance checklist

Policy	Why	Status
Cyber liability (first and third party)	Required by Vanderbilt; covers breach response and notification	○
Technology E&O	Required by Vanderbilt; covers service failure claims	○
General liability	Common in vendor contracts	○
Certificate of insurance	Names the institution as certificate holder (and as additional insured if the contract requires)	○

Coverage limits must match the pilot contract. Confirm them with the contract and a licensed broker; this document doesn't set amounts.

SEMESTER

Platform security review · migrations 010–040

Reviewer: design-stage review, October 2026. Scope: handoff/semester-platform. Status: findings written as migration 050 and tests; **not yet run**. Needs review by a qualified security engineer before production.

Result: 11 findings, 1 critical and 3 high. All closed in `050_security_hardening.sql` and proven by `tests/security.test.ts`; each test must fail before 050 and pass after.

Findings

ID	Severity	Finding	Fix in 050
F2	Critical	ops.staff had no RLS. A tenant user could insert themselves as `ceo` and pass every ops policy.	RLS on; self-read only; inserts revoked; staff created by service role from the company IdP
F5	High	profiles_self_update allowed changing institution_id: a student could move into another tenant and read its data.	Trigger freezes id, institution_id and role; SSO provisioning owns them
F1	High	core.institutions had no RLS: every tenant's feature flags readable by any signed-in user.	RLS on; own institution only
F4	High	profiles_same_campus exposed every profile column campus-wide, ignoring per-field visibility.	Self + scoped staff read; everyone else uses core.directory (findable only, visible fields only)
F6	Medium	audit.log executable by clients: anyone could write audit rows.	Execute revoked from clients; called by server command functions
F7	Medium	Audit table not explicitly append-only.	Update/delete/truncate revoked
F9	Medium	Group membership (including sensitive groups) visible campus-wide.	Members, self, and moderators of the same institution only (definer function avoids policy recursion)
F8	Medium	Bidder identities visible to the whole campus.	Own bids only; campus sees counts and top bid via view
F10	Medium	RSVP policy didn't check the event's institution.	Insert requires an event in the caller's institution
F3	Low	Helper functions ran as invoker inside policies (recursion and search_path risk).	Security definer + empty search_path
F11	Low	Anonymous role not explicitly denied.	All privileges revoked from anon, including defaults

Still to review

- **Addressed in 060:** posts, listings, offers and reports now write only through audited `api.*` command functions with validation, rate limits and the integrity filter; direct inserts revoked (tests/commands.test.ts).

- ops.my_role() must never return a role for a tenant user; add a test once tenant and company identities share an auth project.
- **Addressed in 060/080:** listing-photos, student-files (owner only), course-materials (campus read, faculty/TA write) and evidence (service role only) bucket policies.
- Rate limits on AI and auth endpoints live in middleware, not the database.
- **Addressed:** security CI job (gitleaks secret scan, npm audit high, service-role key guard, no record fields in analytics, RLS/command/red-team tests) and security headers middleware (CSP, HSTS, frame-ancestors none, no-store on API).
- **Addressed in 080:** approved-sources-only AI context; delegations with expiry ≤ 1 year, audited grant/revoke.

AI gateway (added)

gate() trusted scope labels only, so a student could paste a record into the prompt. Added a content scan (student-ID pattern per tenant, SSN, DOB, GPA, grades, transcript/aid/accommodation/disciplinary terms, card numbers) that blocks before any provider call, a usage log that never stores prompts, and a 20-case red-team suite.

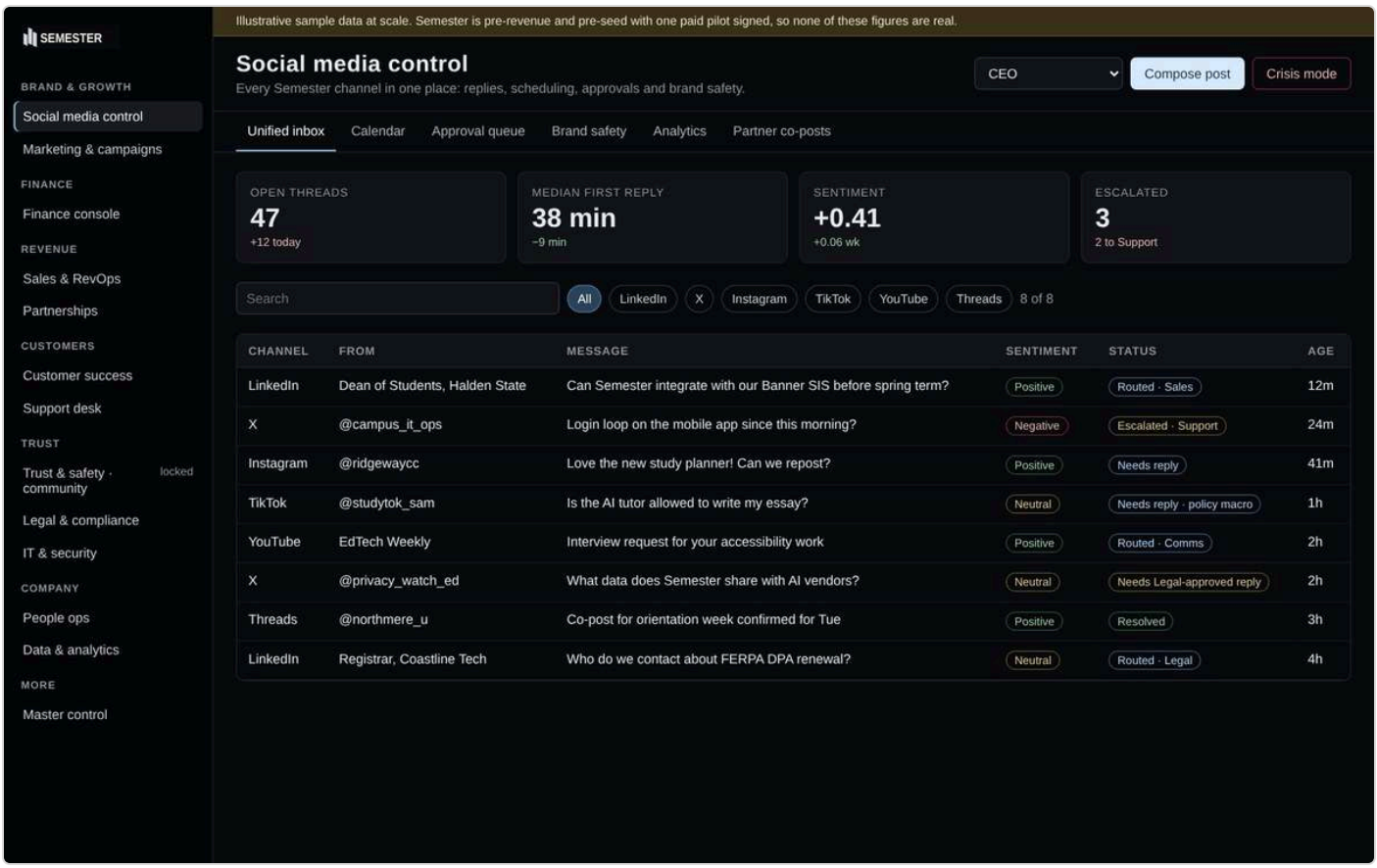
Gate

Migration 050 and its tests are a launch gate alongside the RLS suite in the launch runbook. No real student data until both pass in staging.

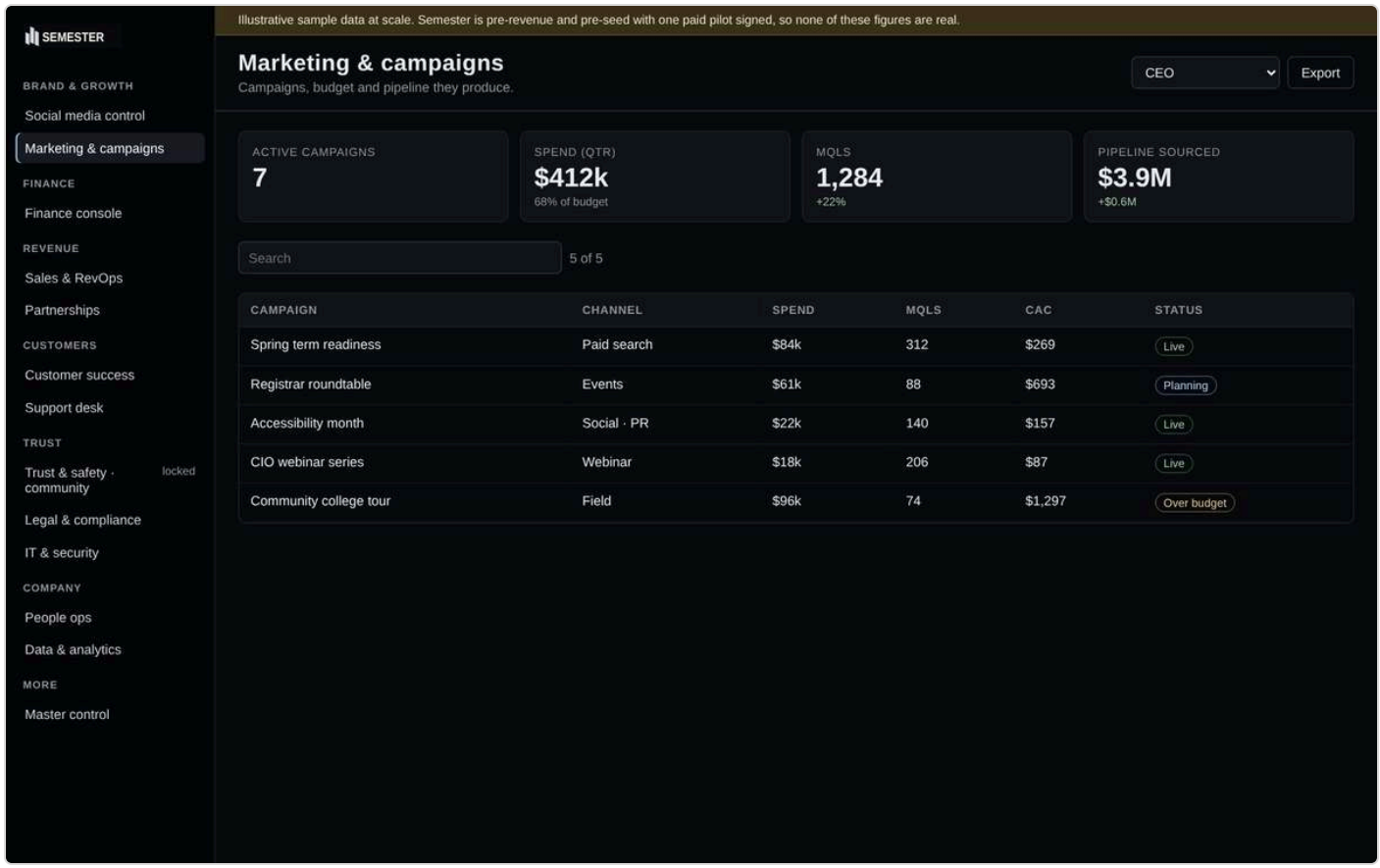
Operations and compliance consoles

The operations consoles and the compliance workspace. **47 screens.**

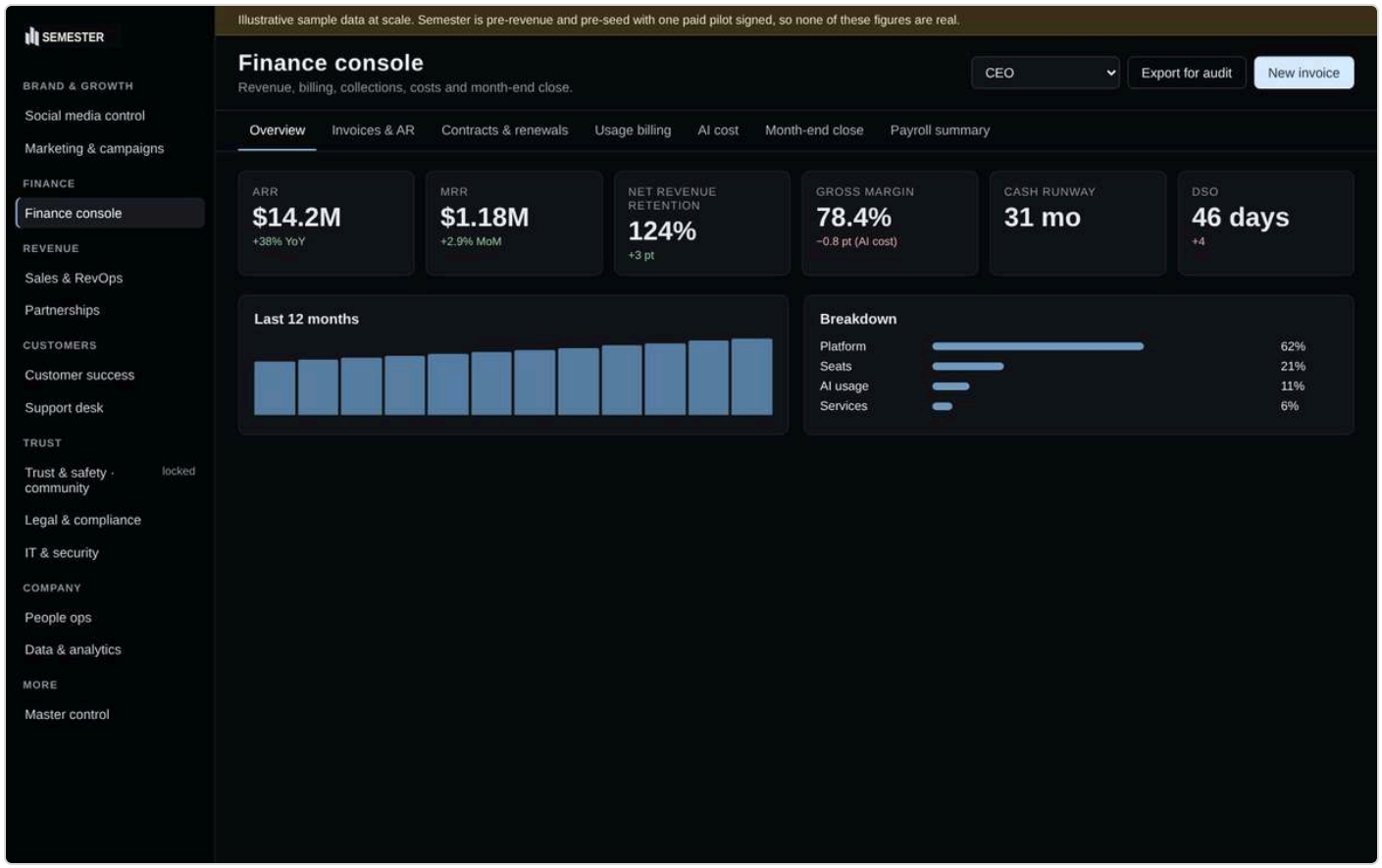
ops



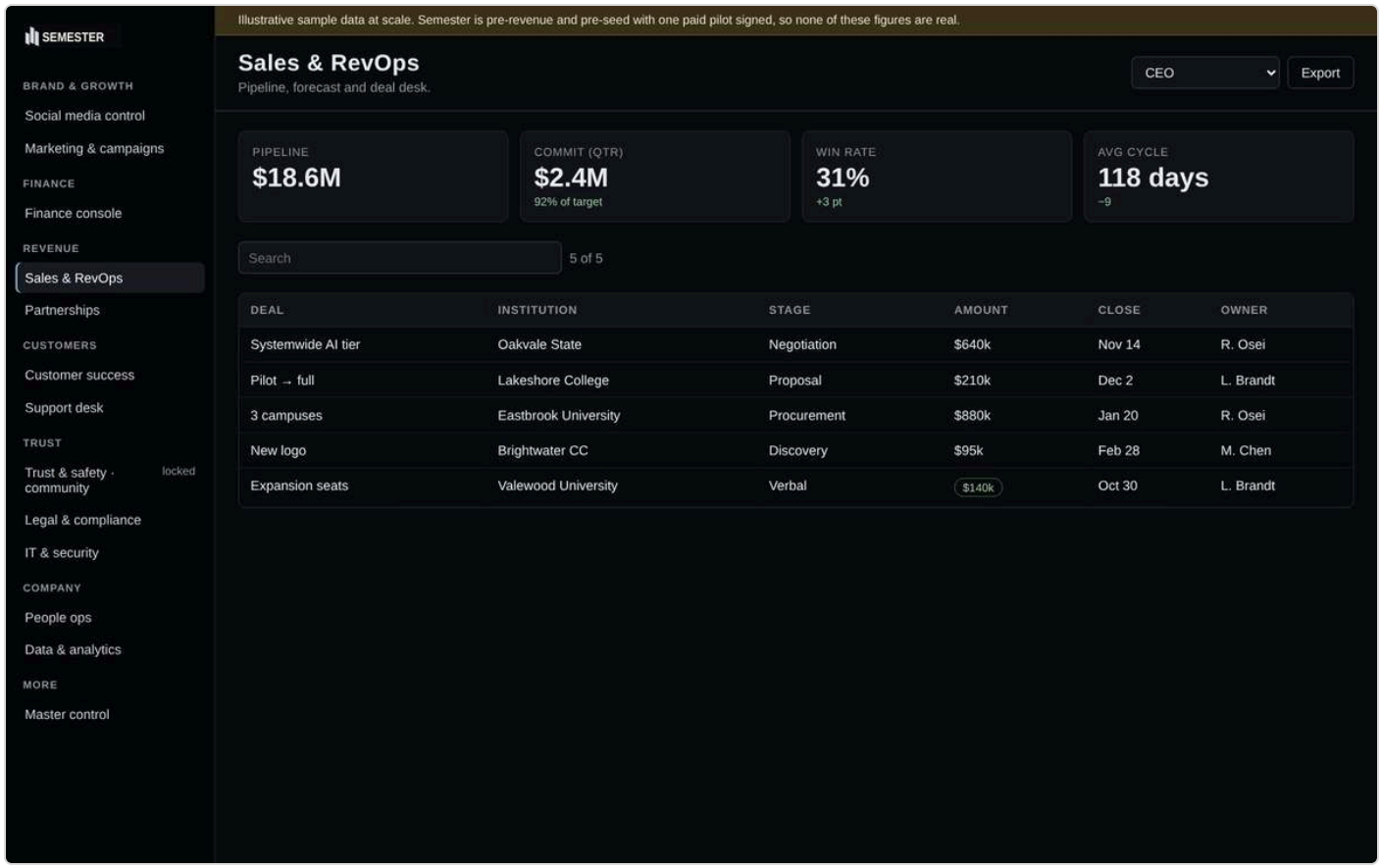
Opening view



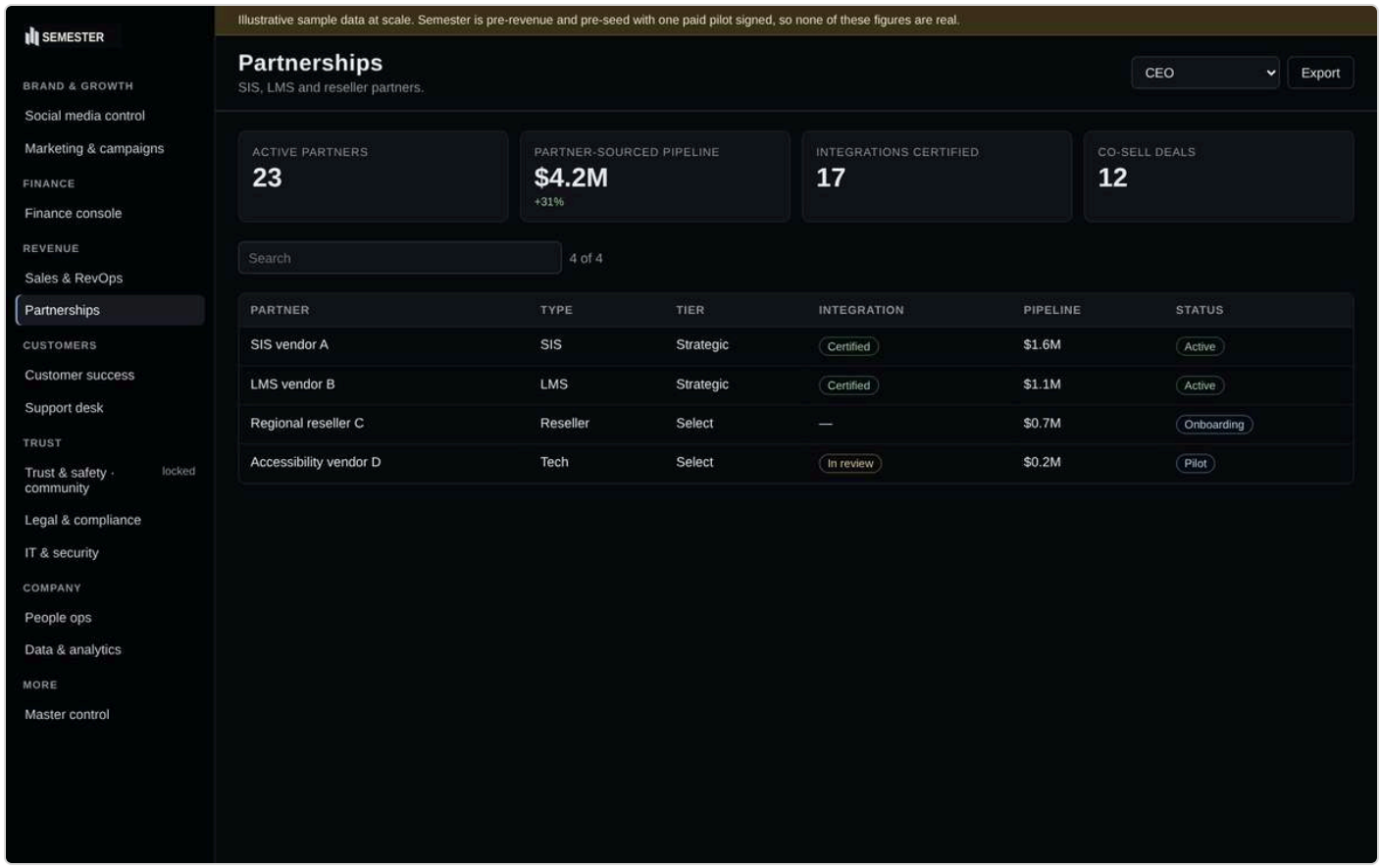
Marketing & campaigns



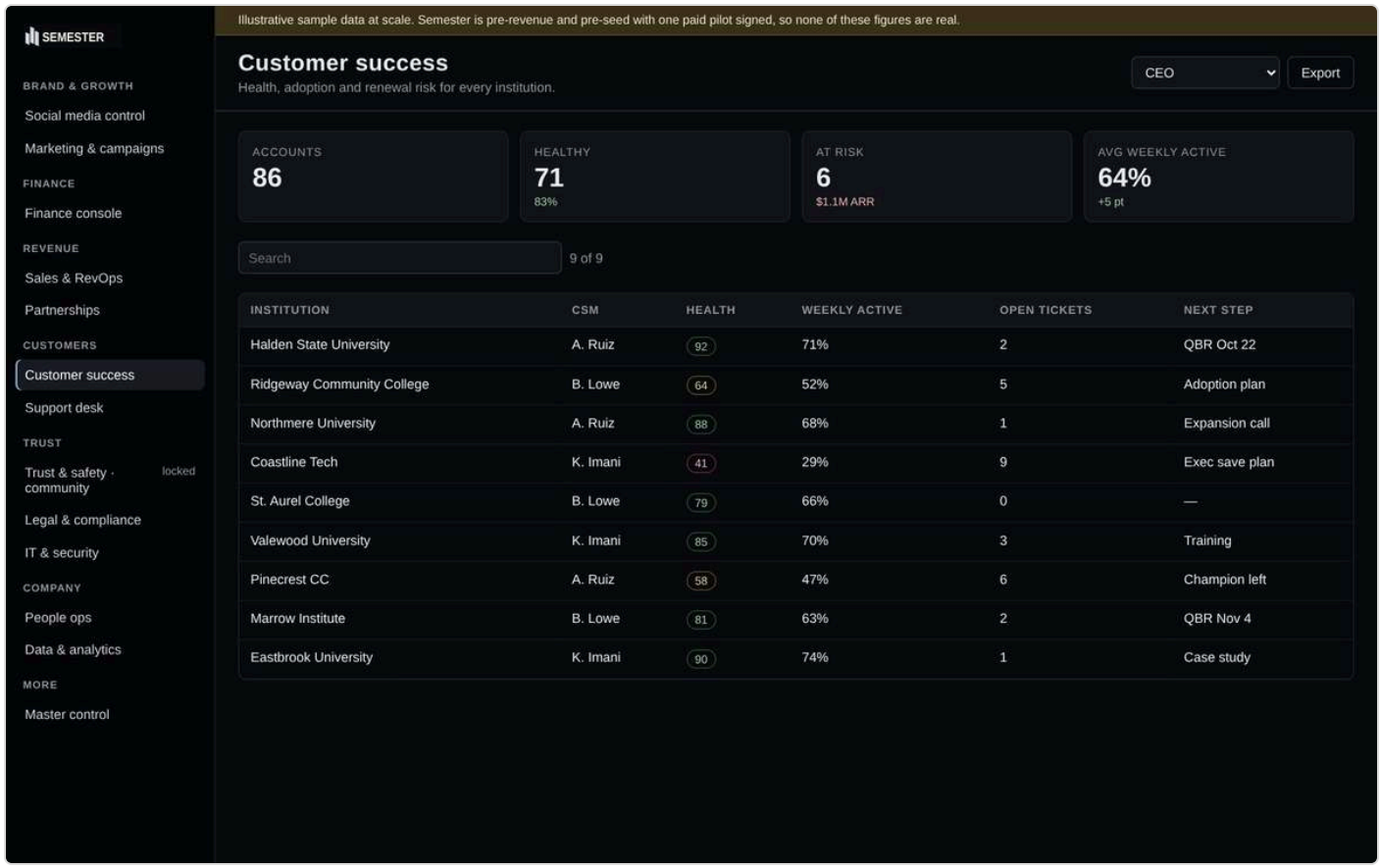
Finance console



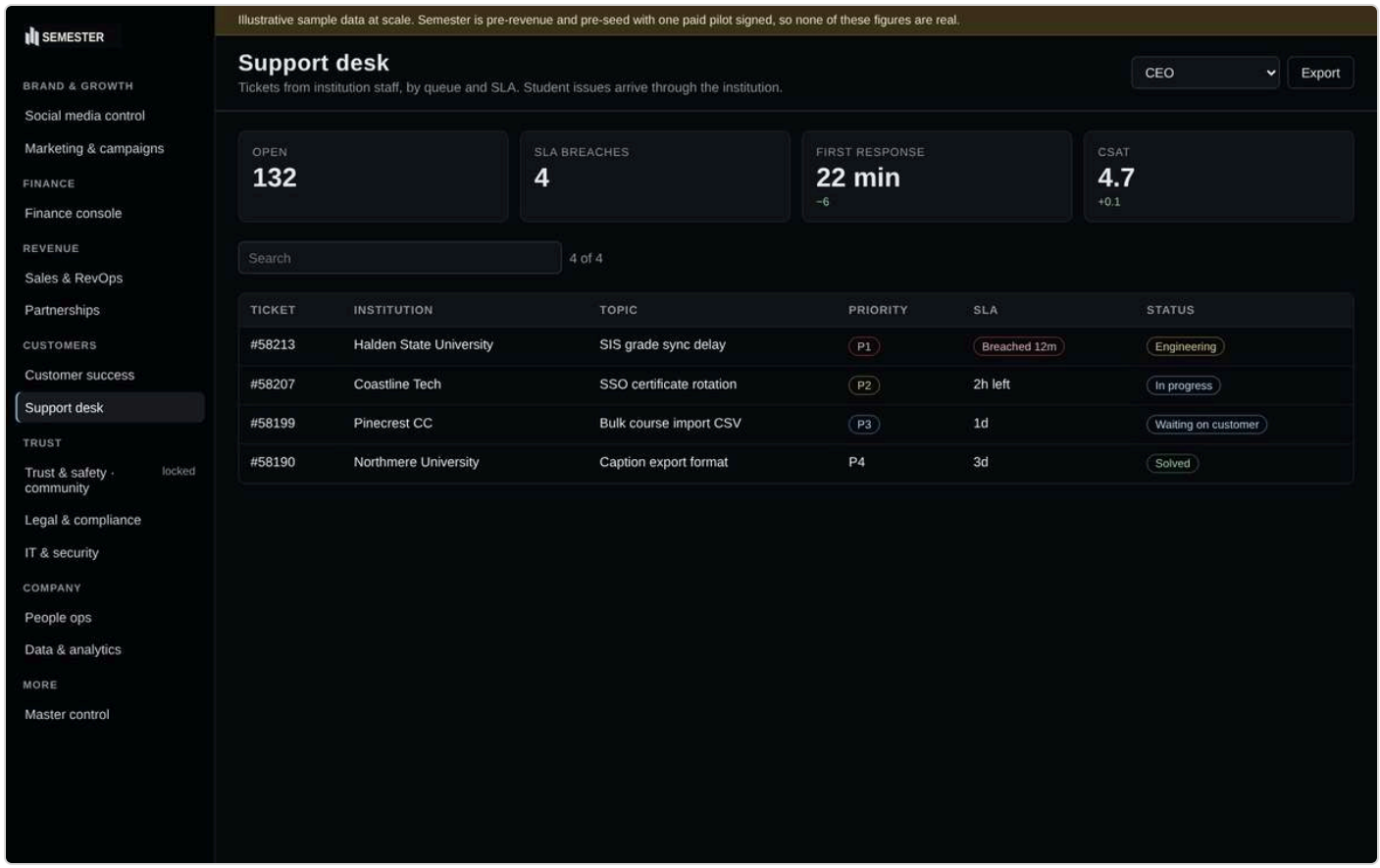
Sales & RevOps



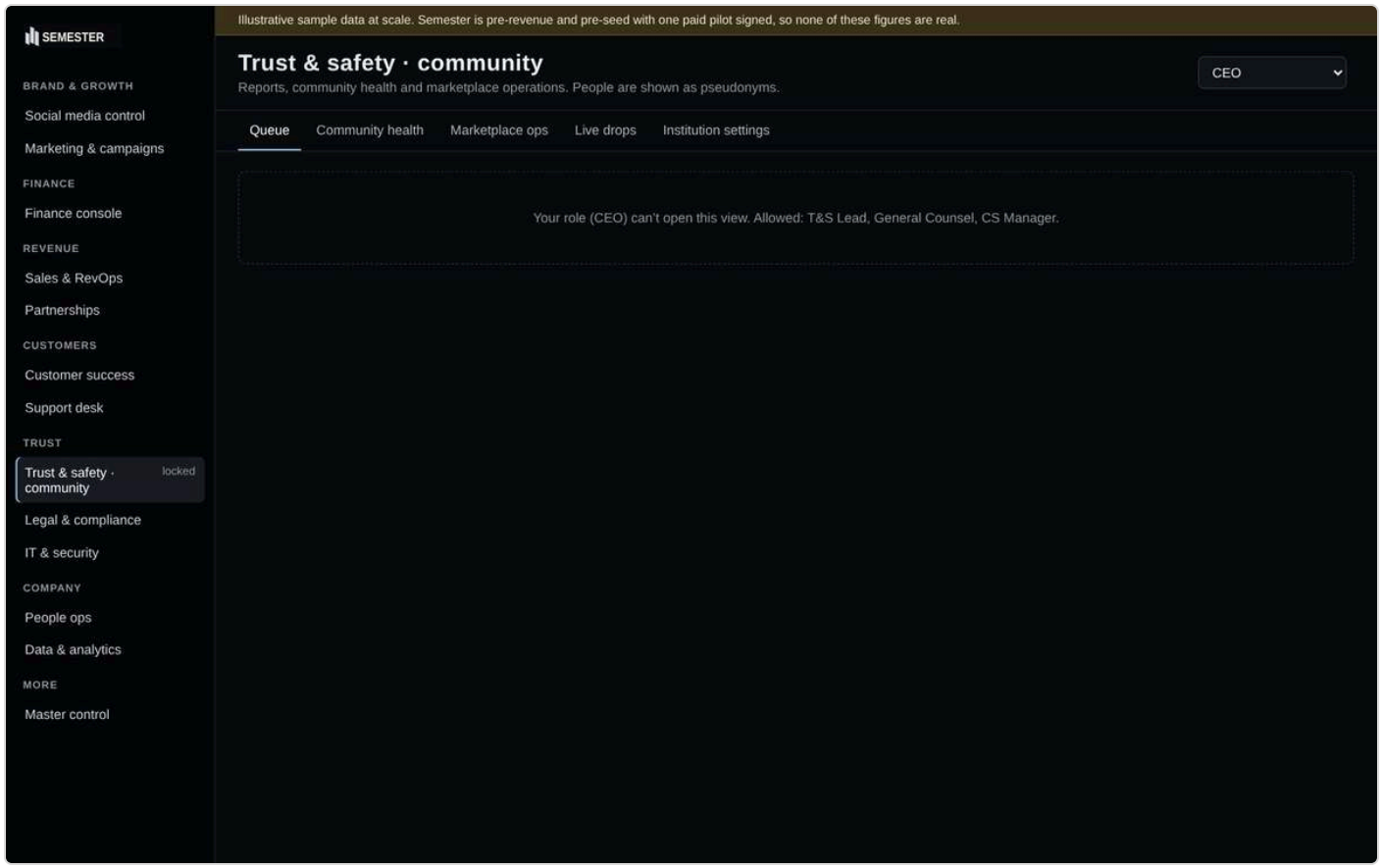
Partnerships



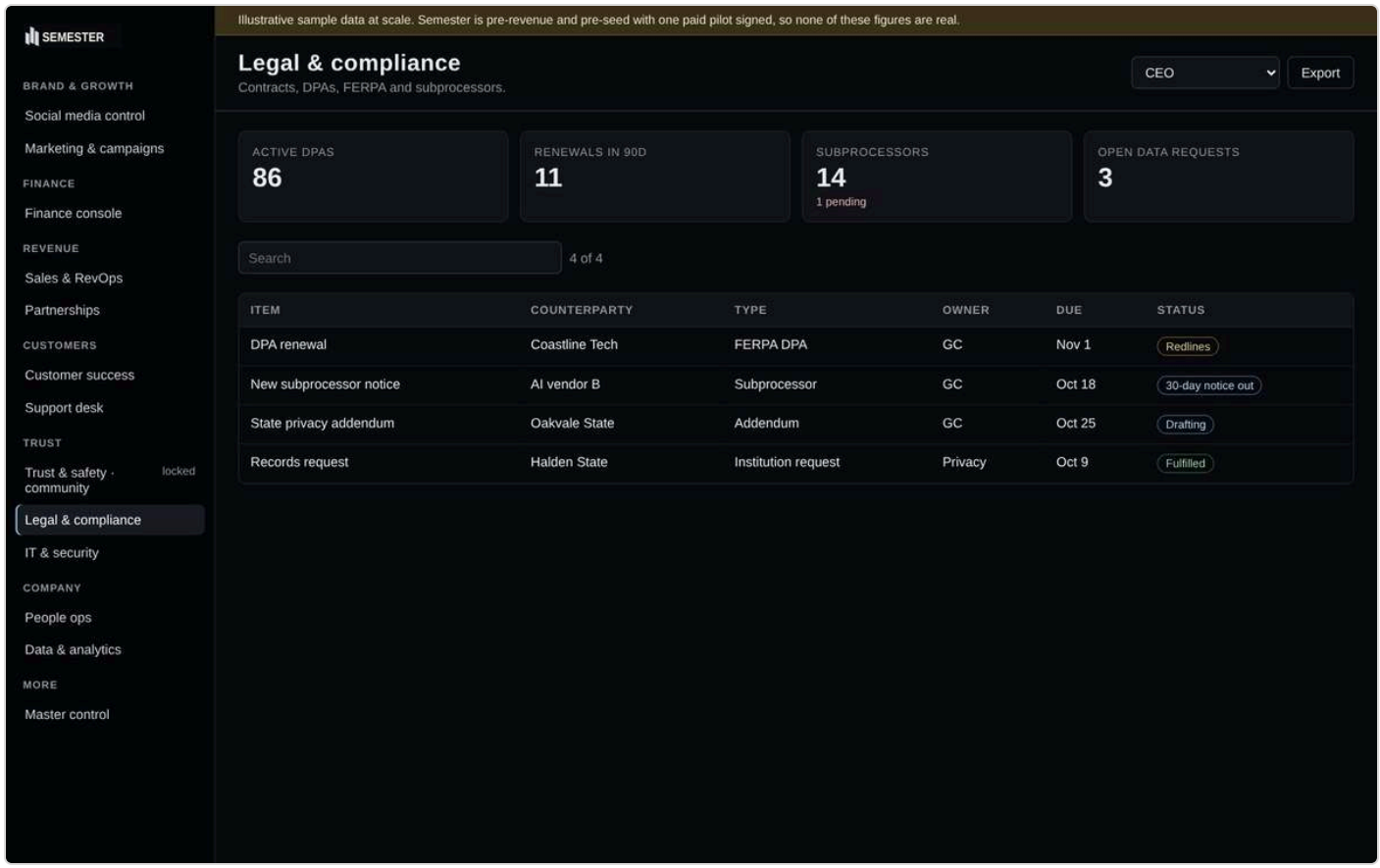
Customer success



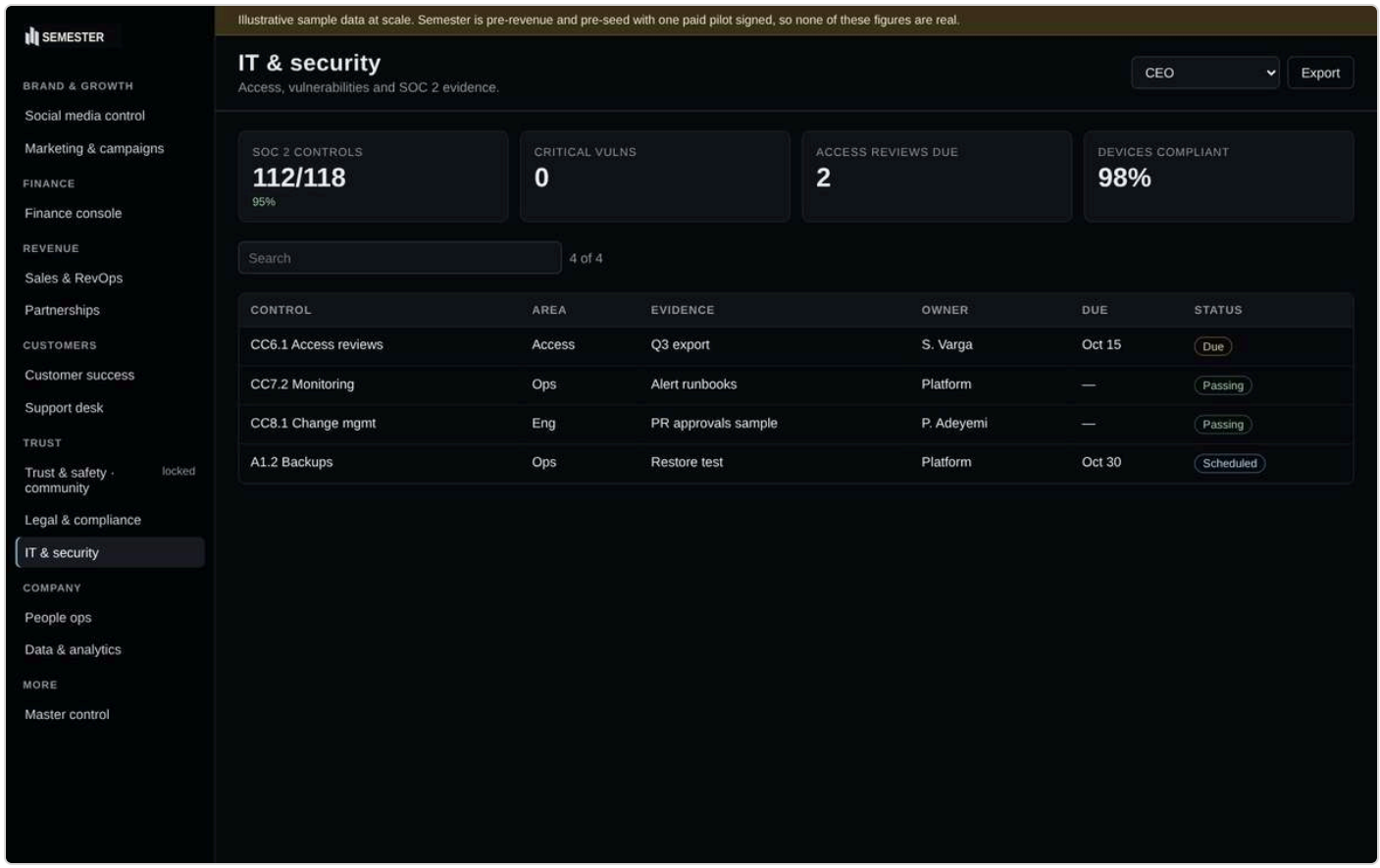
Support desk



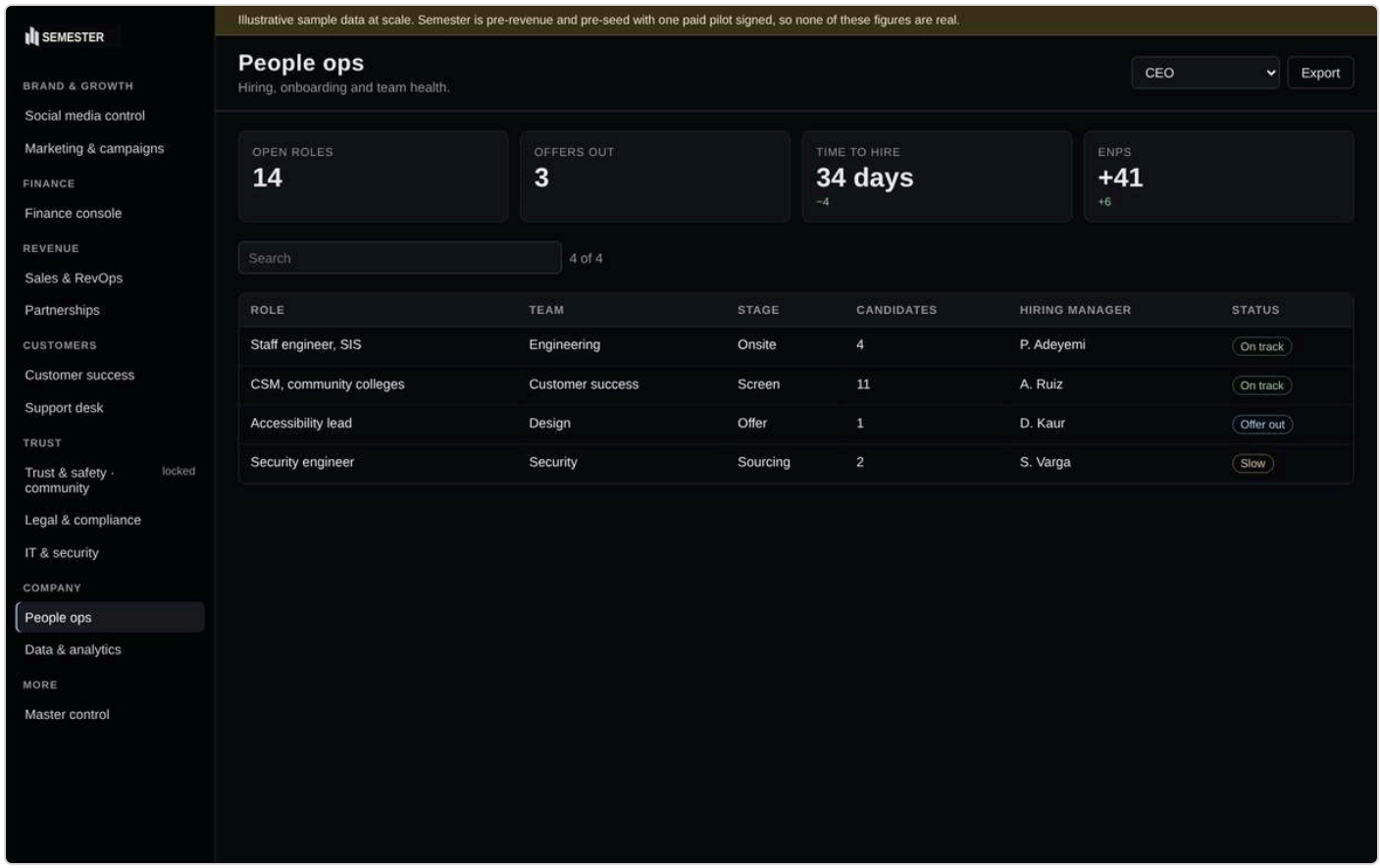
Trust & safety · community



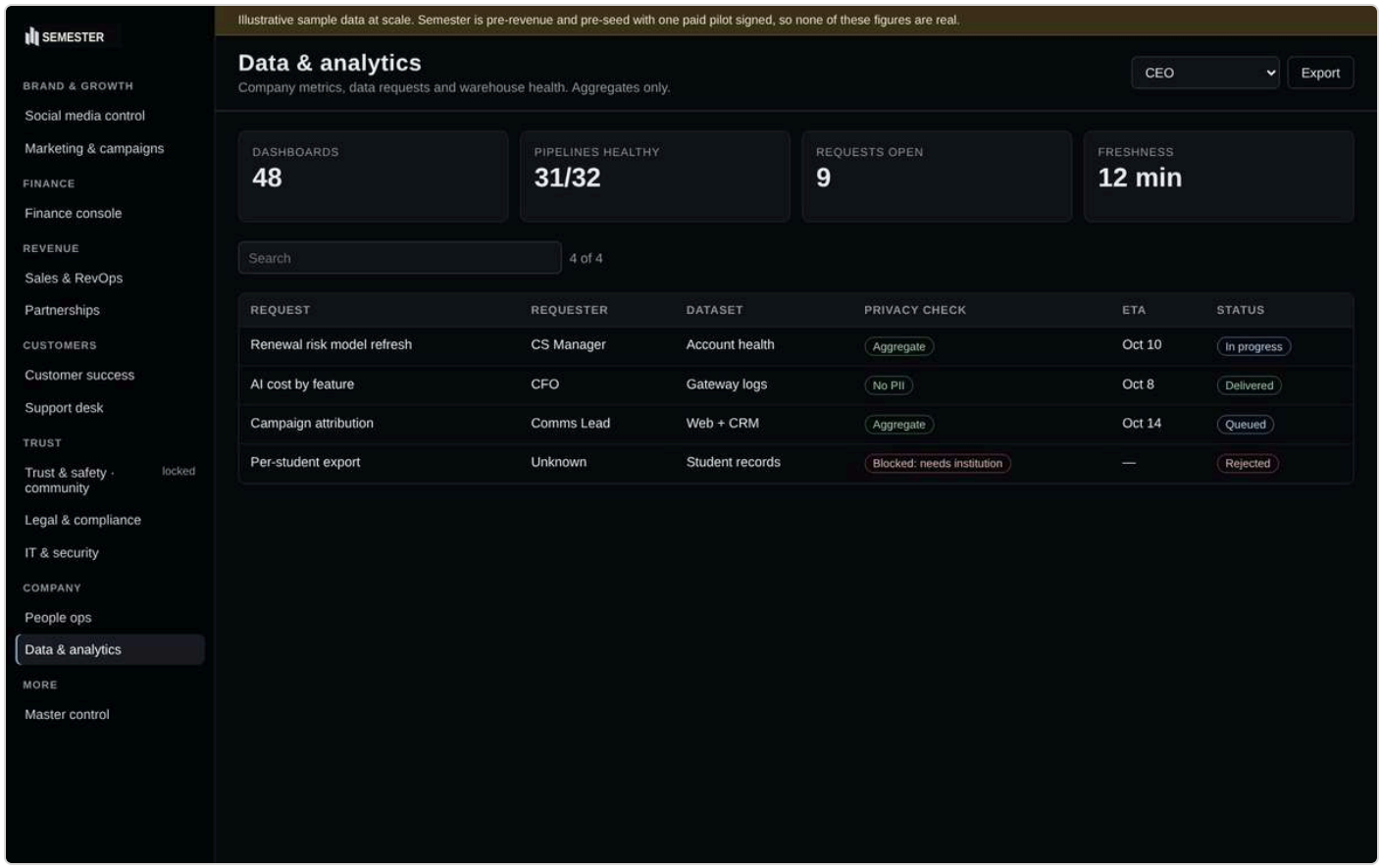
Legal & compliance


SEMESTER
BRAND & GROWTH
Social media control
Marketing & campaigns
FINANCE
Finance console
REVENUE
Sales & RevOps
Partnerships
CUSTOMERS
Customer success
Support desk
TRUST
Trust & safety · community
locked
Legal & compliance
IT & security
COMPANY
People ops
Data & analytics
MORE
Master control
Illustrative sample data at scale. Semester is pre-revenue and pre-seed with one paid pilot signed, so none of these figures are real.
IT & security
Access, vulnerabilities and SOC 2 evidence.
CEO
Export
SOC 2 CONTROLS
112/118
95%
CRITICAL VULNS
0
ACCESS REVIEWS DUE
2
DEVICES COMPLIANT
98%
Search
4 of 4
CONTROL
AREA
EVIDENCE
OWNER
DUE
STATUS
CC6.1 Access reviews
Access
Q3 export
S. Varga
Oct 15
Due
CC7.2 Monitoring
Ops
Alert runbooks
Platform
—
Passing
CC8.1 Change mgmt
Eng
PR approvals sample
P. Adeyemi
—
Passing
A1.2 Backups
Ops
Restore test
Platform
Oct 30
Scheduled

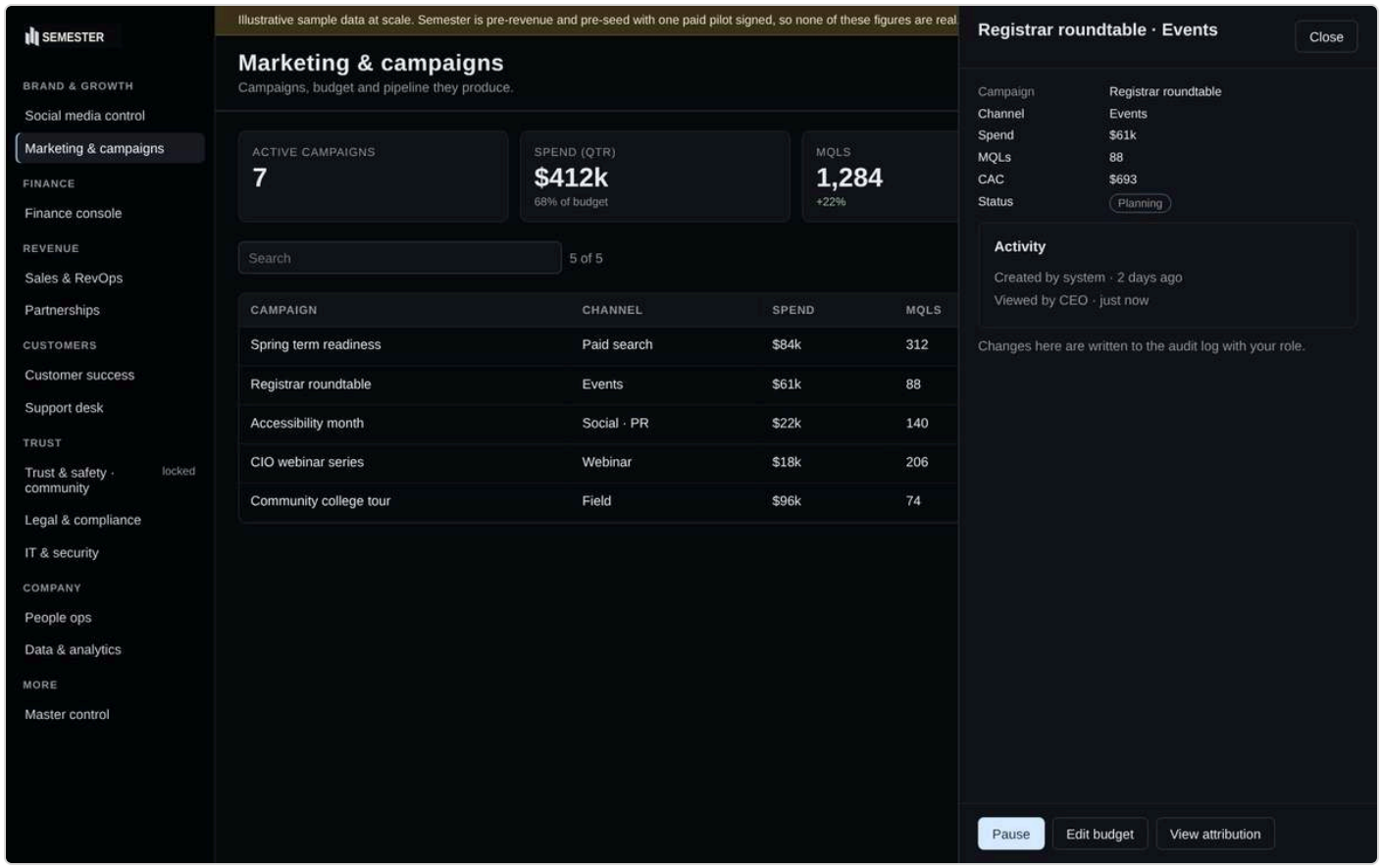
IT & security


SEMESTER
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IT & security
COMPANY
People ops
Data & analytics
MORE
Master control
Illustrative sample data at scale. Semester is pre-revenue and pre-seed with one paid pilot signed, so none of these figures are real.
People ops
Hiring, onboarding and team health.
CEO
Export
OPEN ROLES
14
OFFERS OUT
3
TIME TO HIRE
34 days
−4
ENPS
+41
+6
Search
4 of 4
ROLE
TEAM
STAGE
CANDIDATES
HIRING MANAGER
STATUS
Staff engineer, SIS
Engineering
Onsite
4
P. Adeyemi
On track
CSM, community colleges
Customer success
Screen
11
A. Ruiz
On track
Accessibility lead
Design
Offer
1
D. Kaur
Offer out
Security engineer
Security
Sourcing
2
S. Varga
Slow

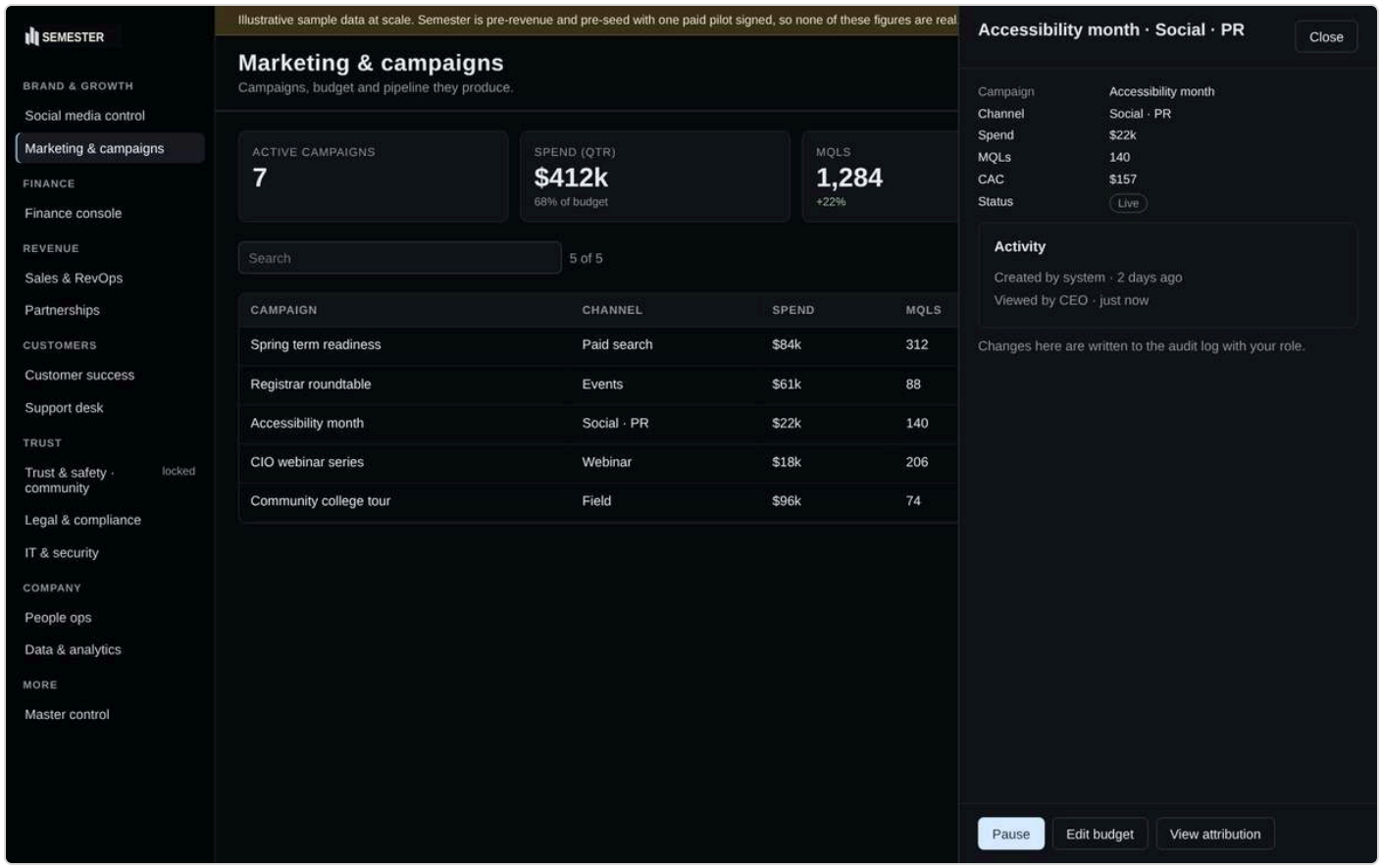
People ops



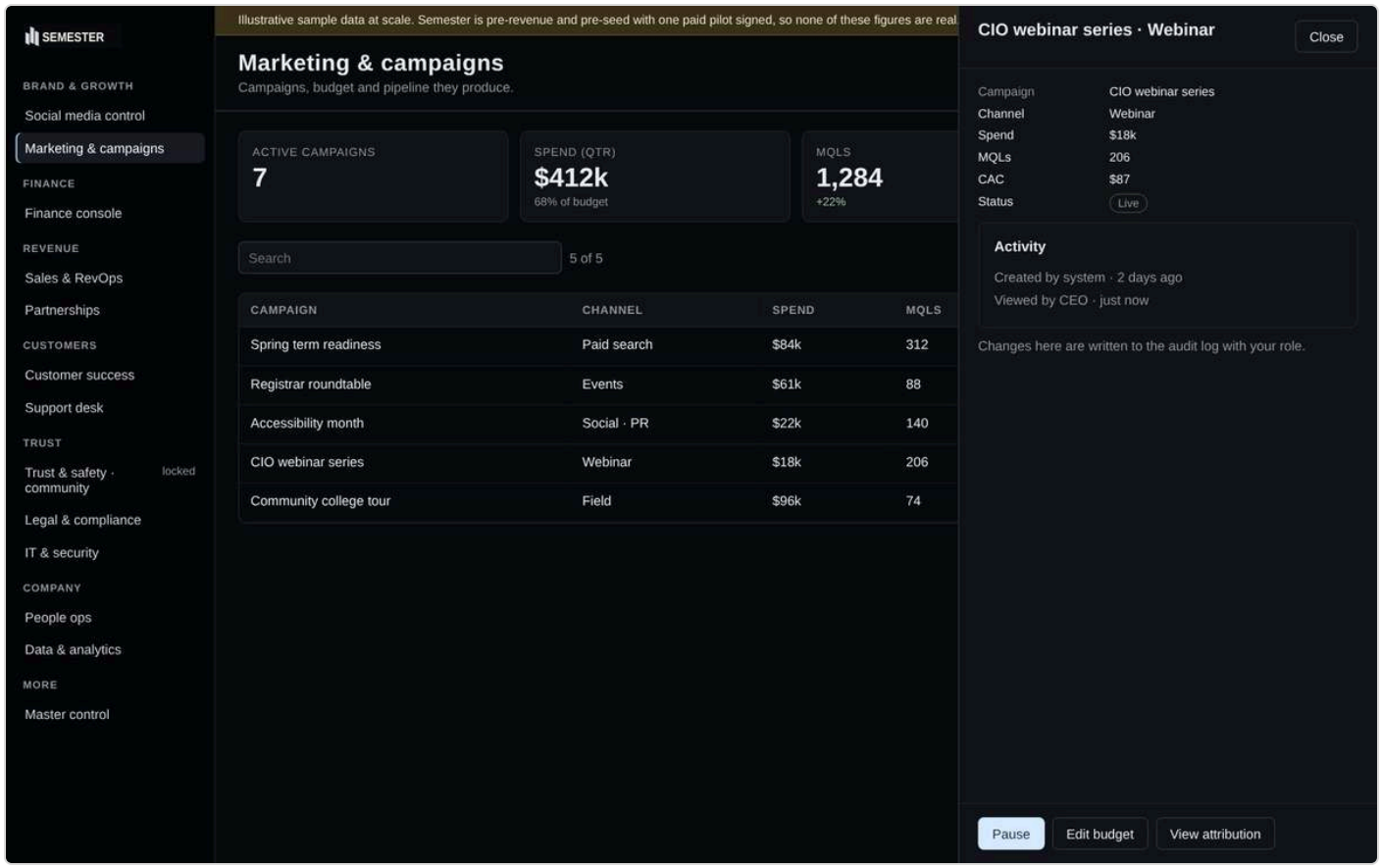
Data & analytics



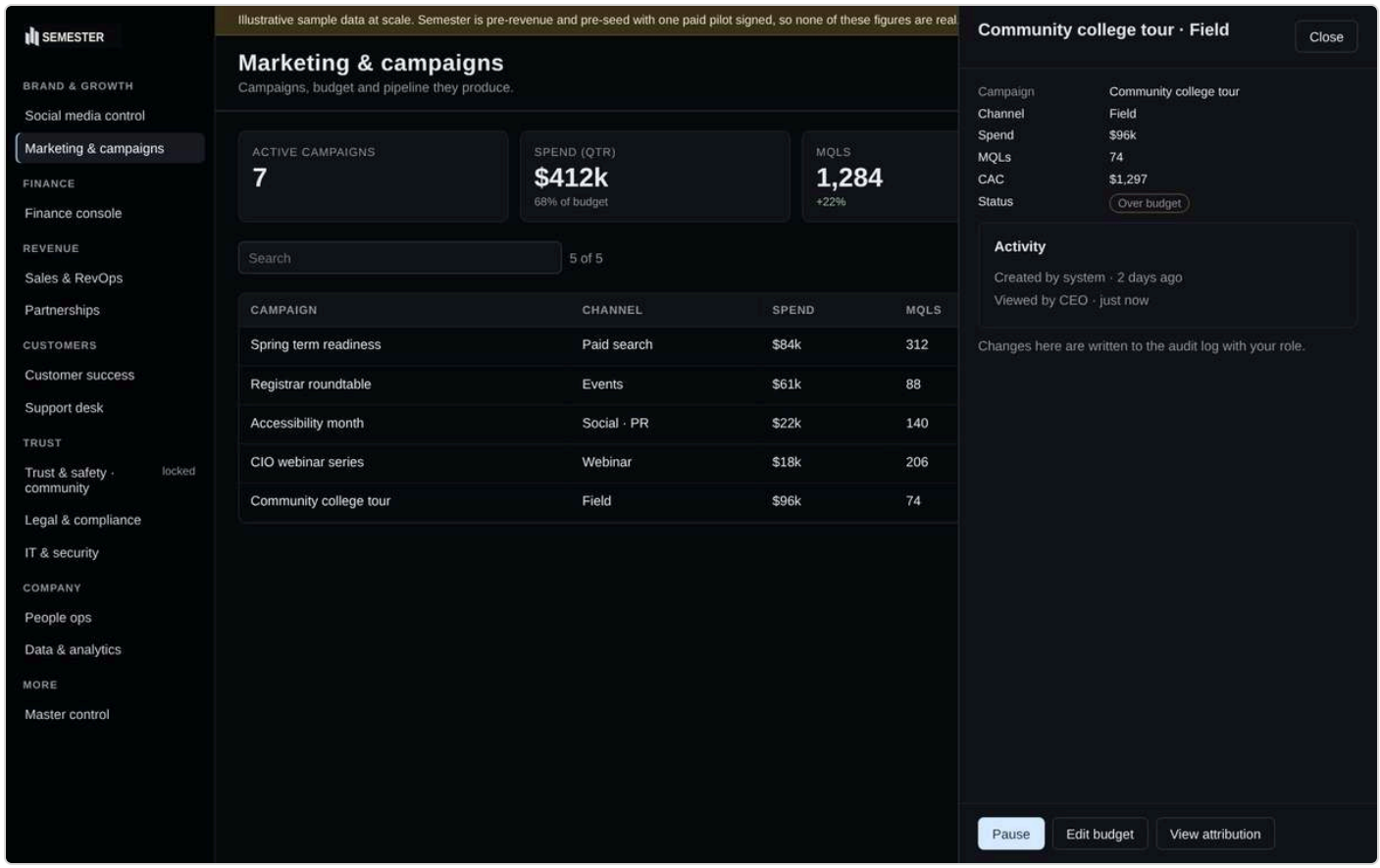
Marketing & campaigns › Registrar roundtable Events $61k 88 $693 Planning



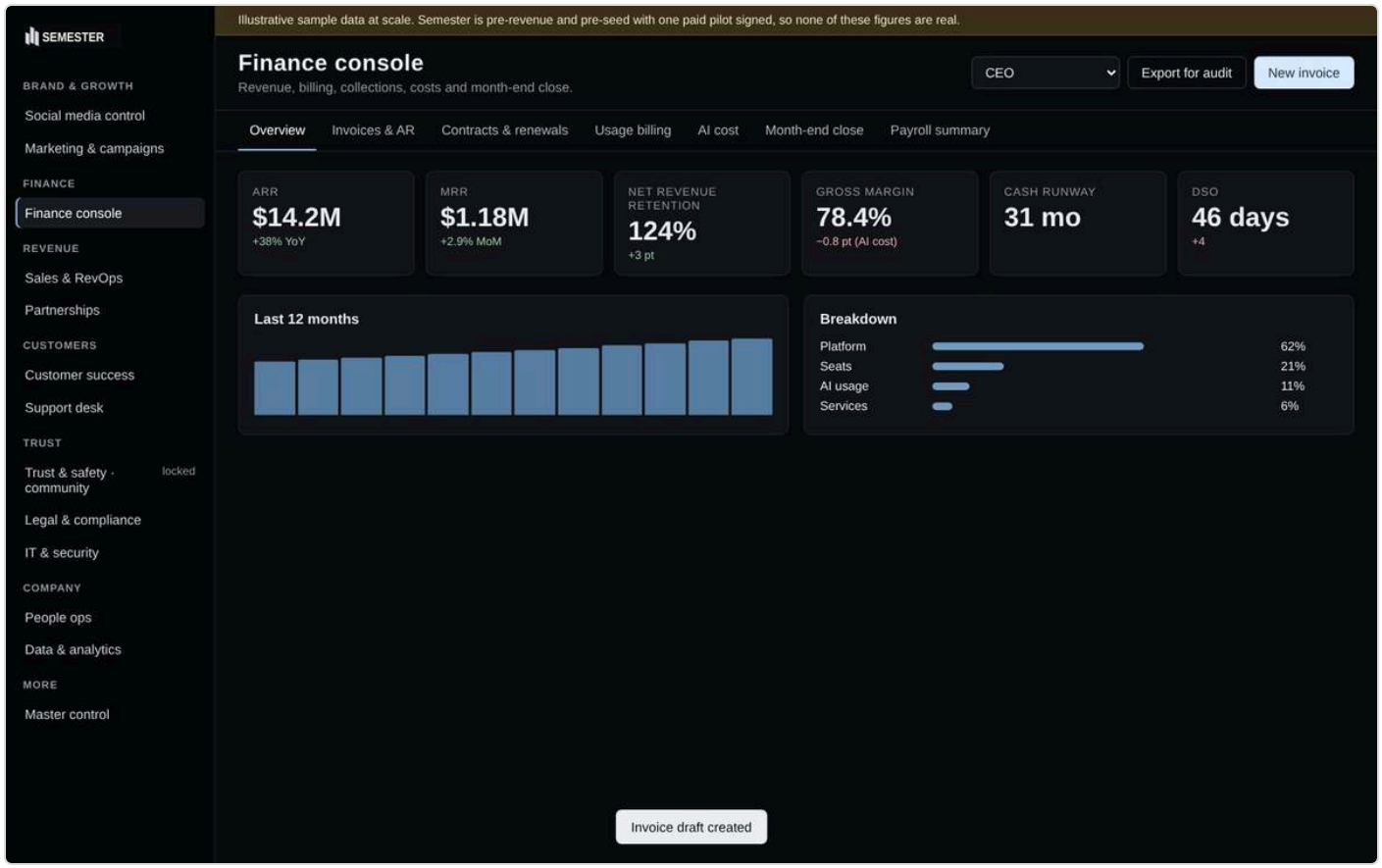
Marketing & campaigns › Accessibility month Social · PR $22k 140 $157 Live



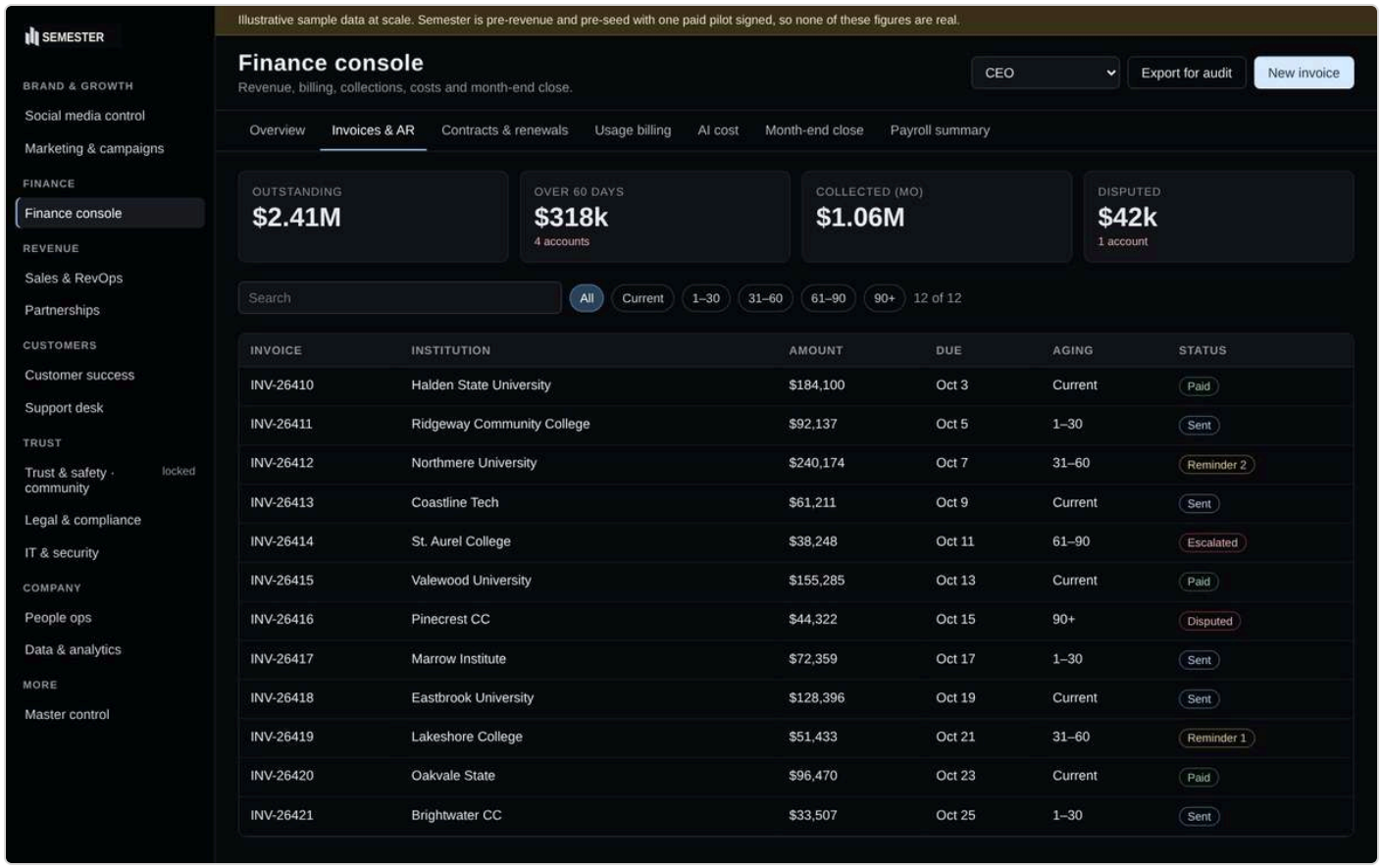
Marketing & campaigns › CIO webinar series Webinar $18k 206 $87 Live



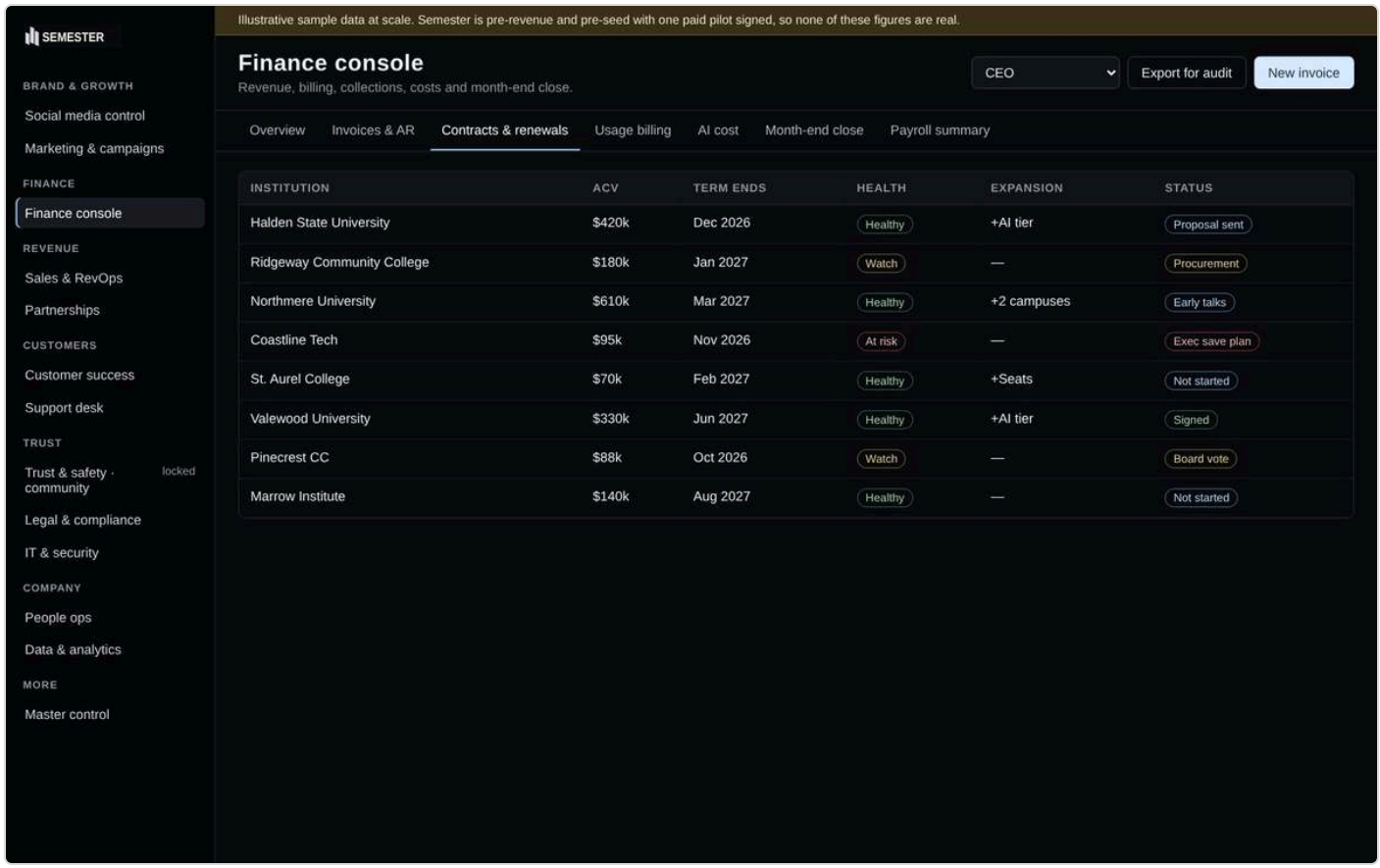
Marketing & campaigns › Community college tour Field $96k 74 $1,297 Over budget



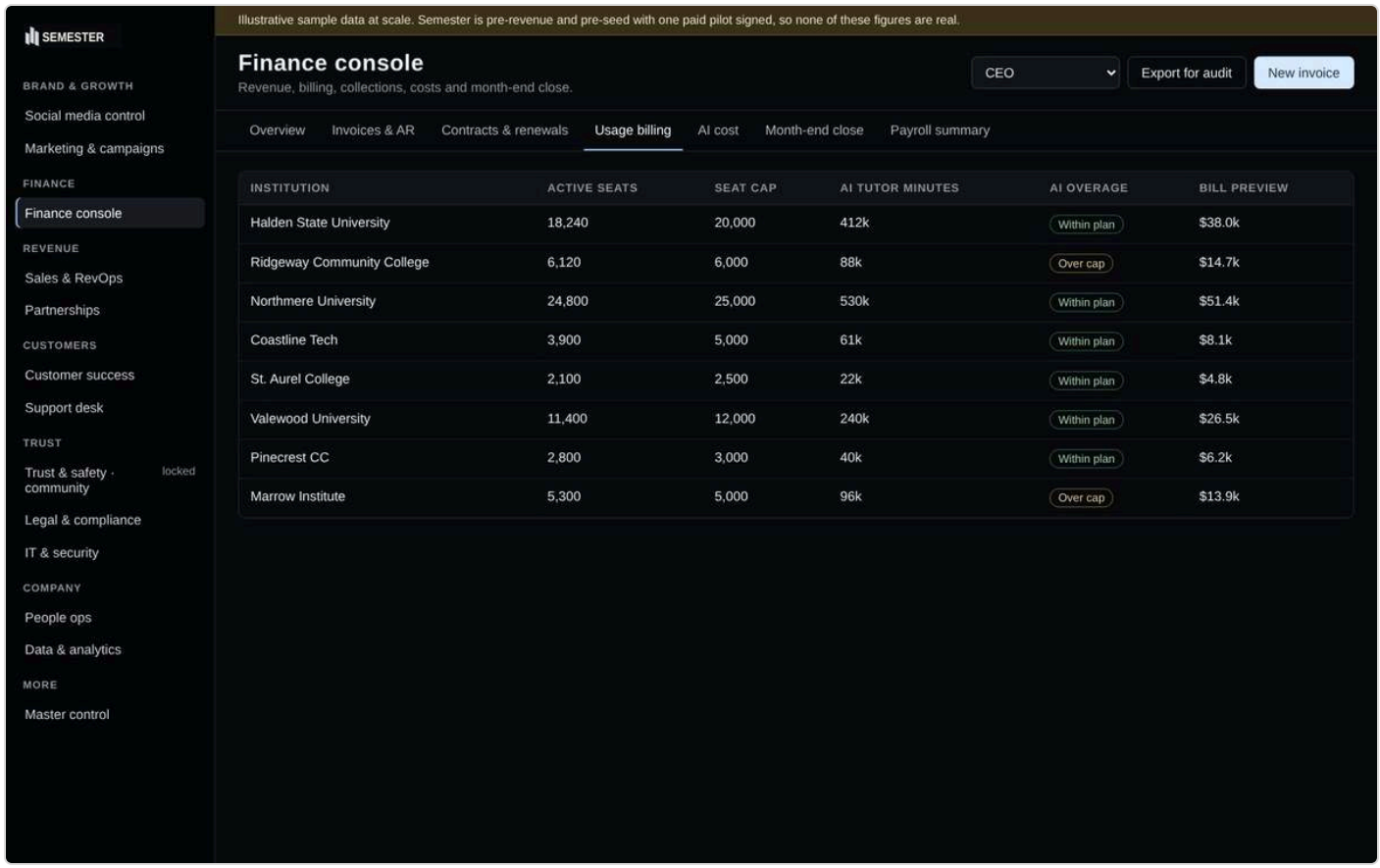
Finance console › New invoice



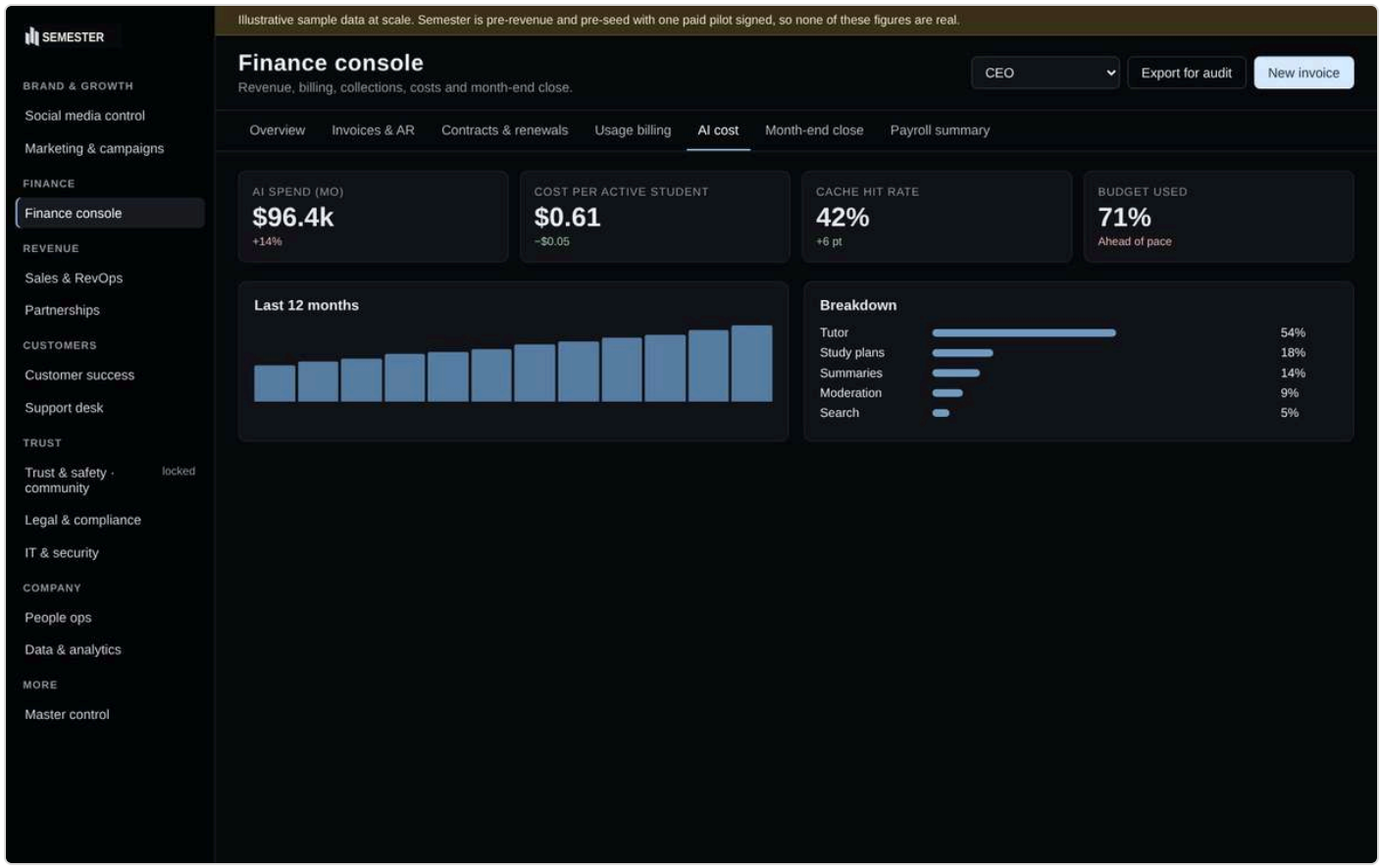
Finance console › Invoices & AR



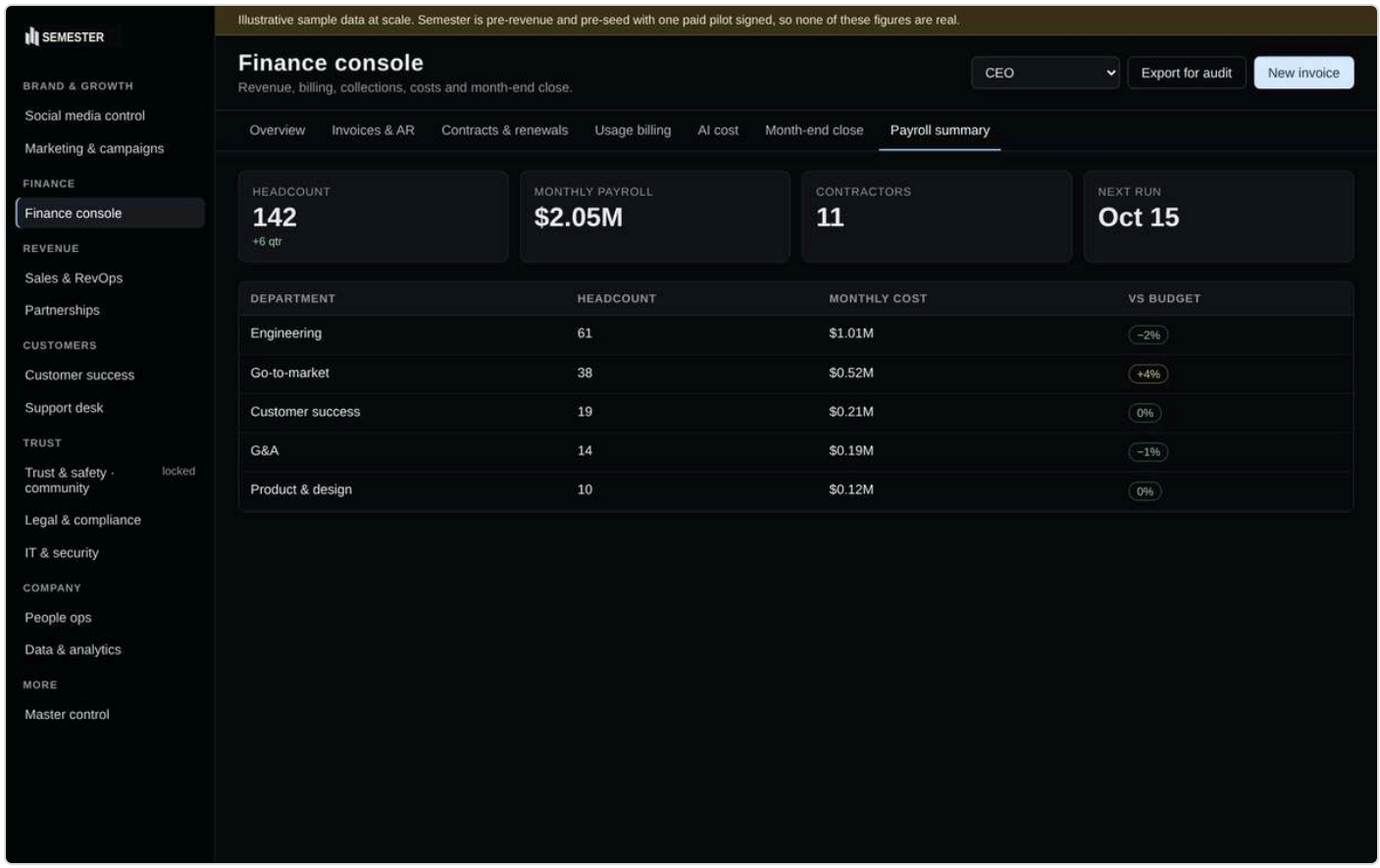
Finance console › Contracts & renewals



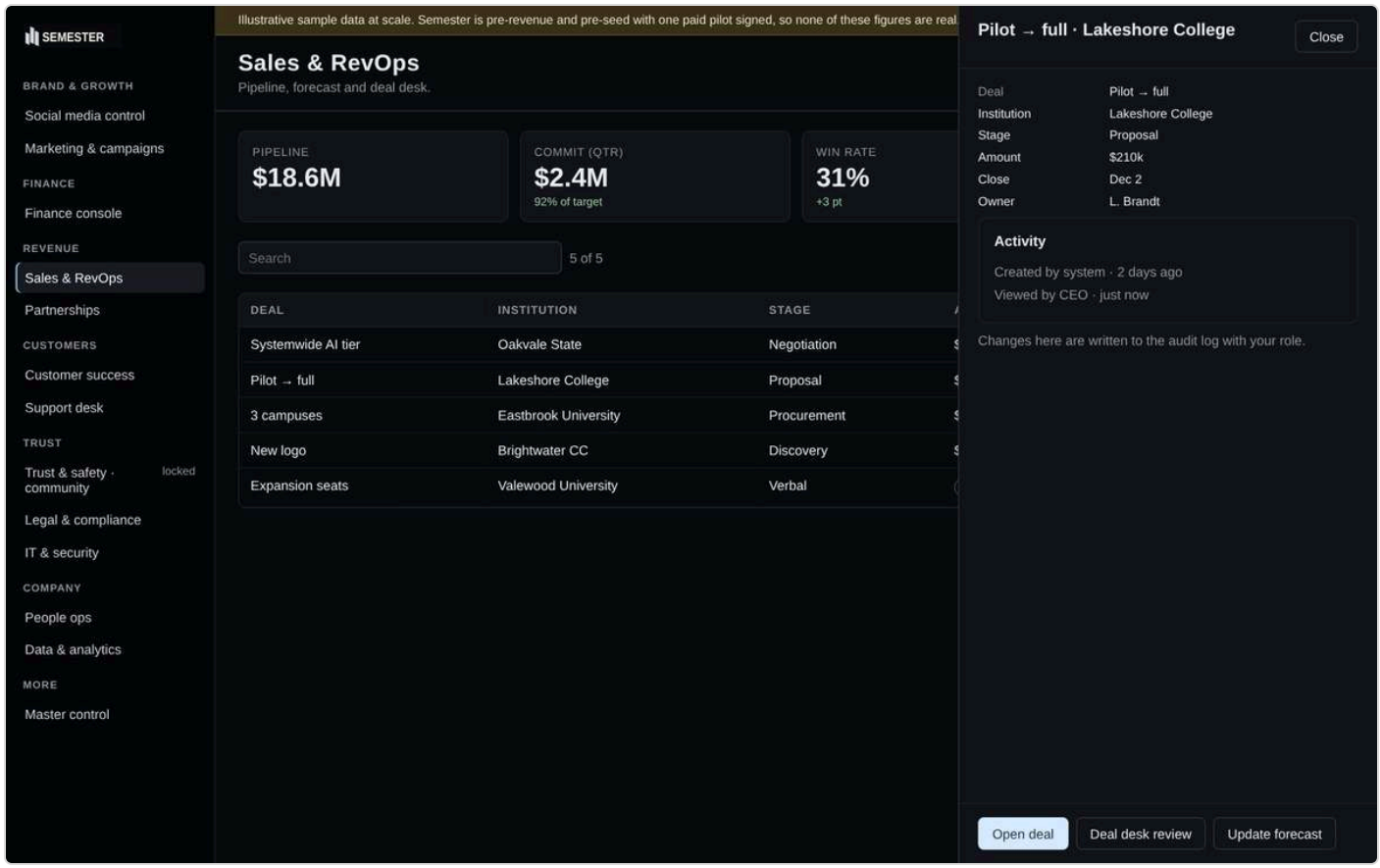
Finance console › Usage billing



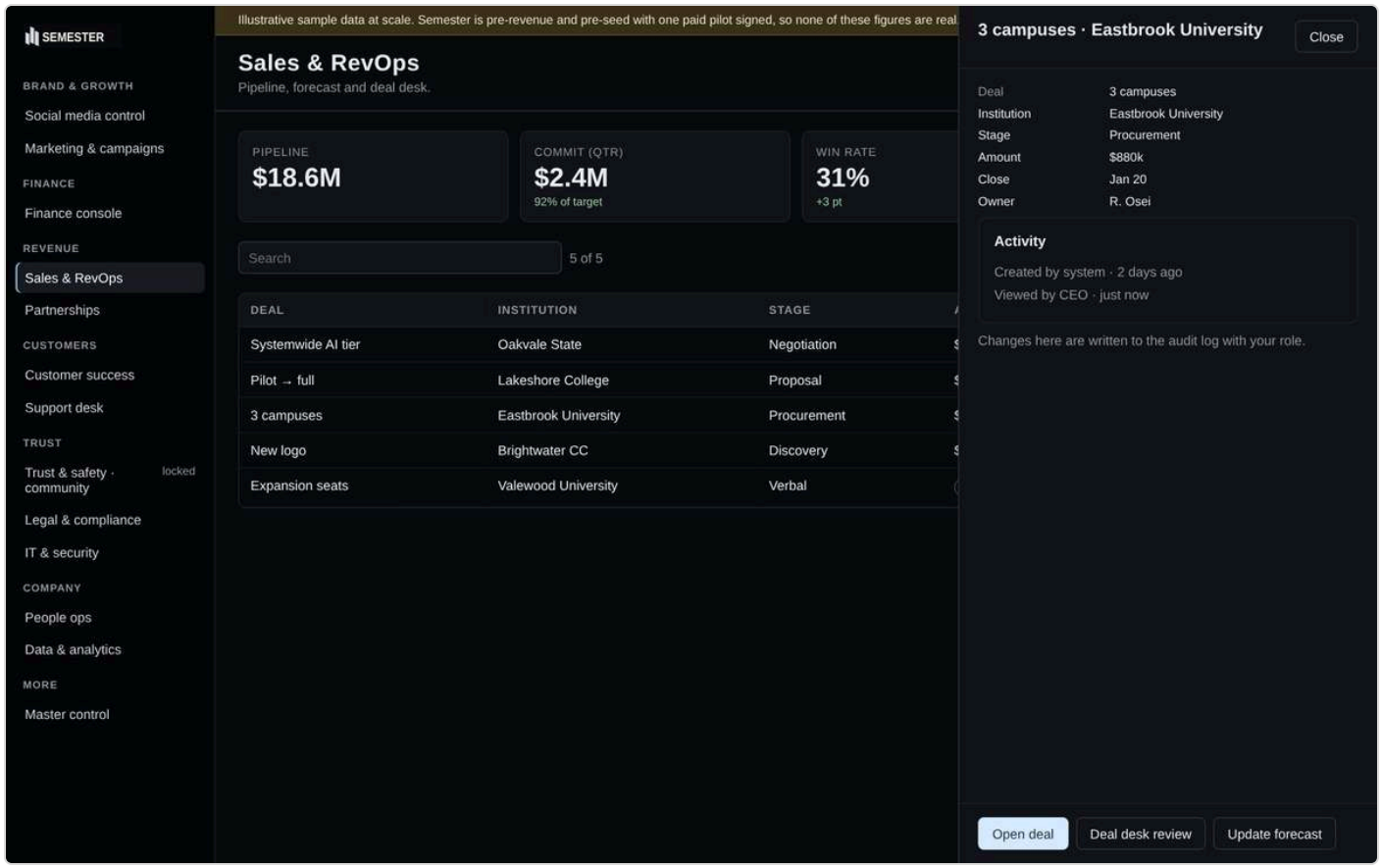
Finance console › AI cost



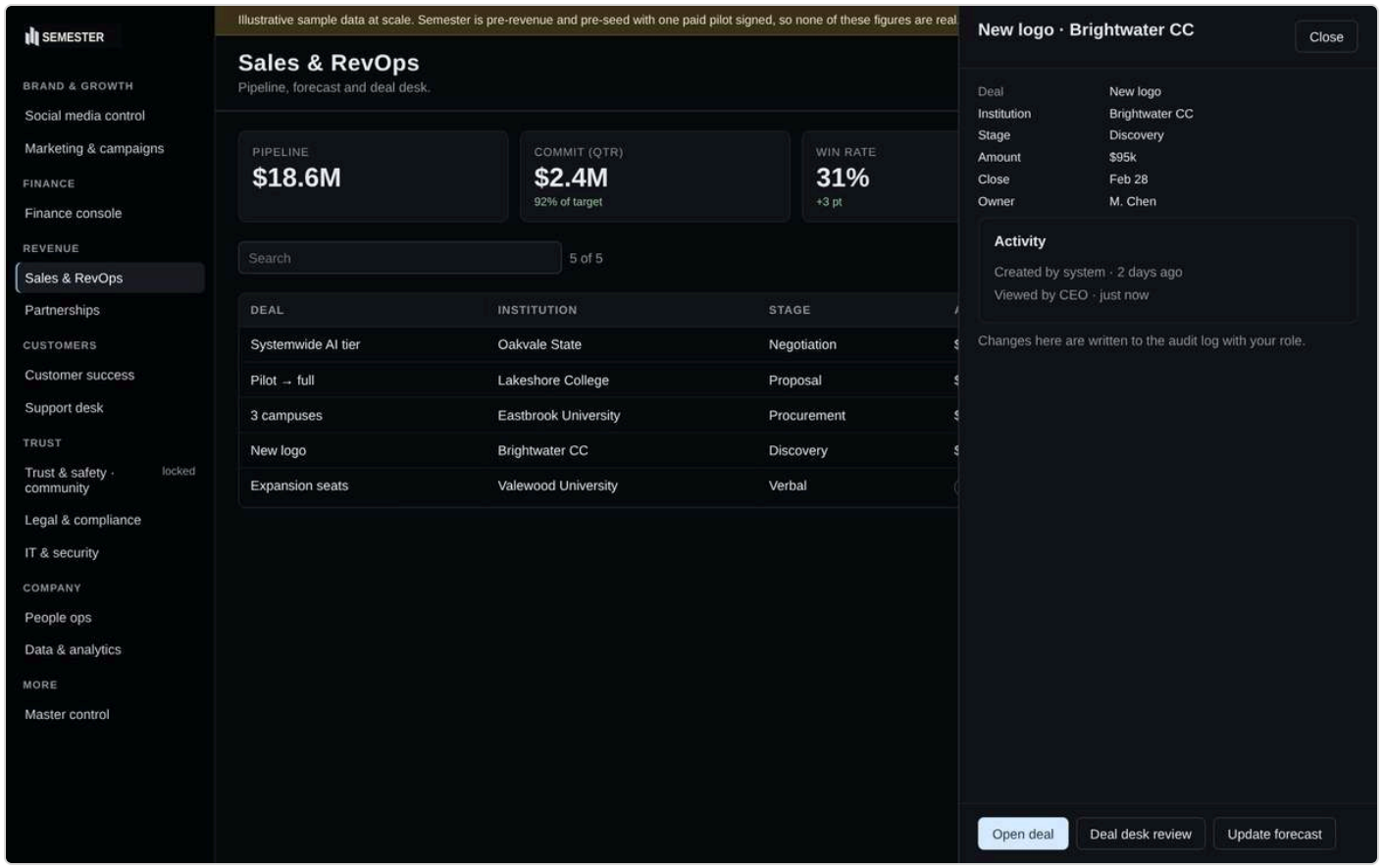
Finance console › Payroll summary



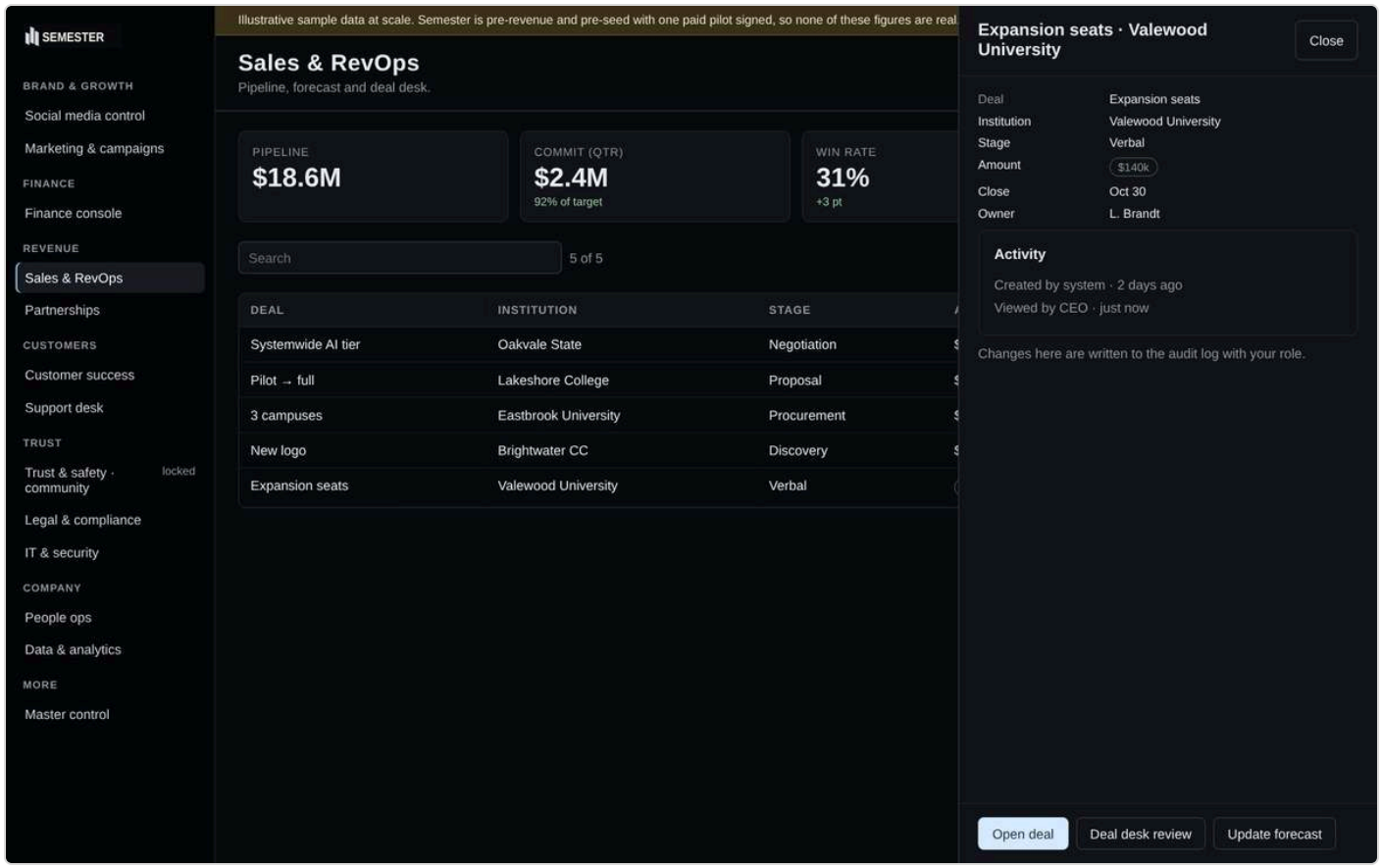
Sales & RevOps › Pilot → full Lakeshore College Proposal $210k Dec 2 L. Brandt



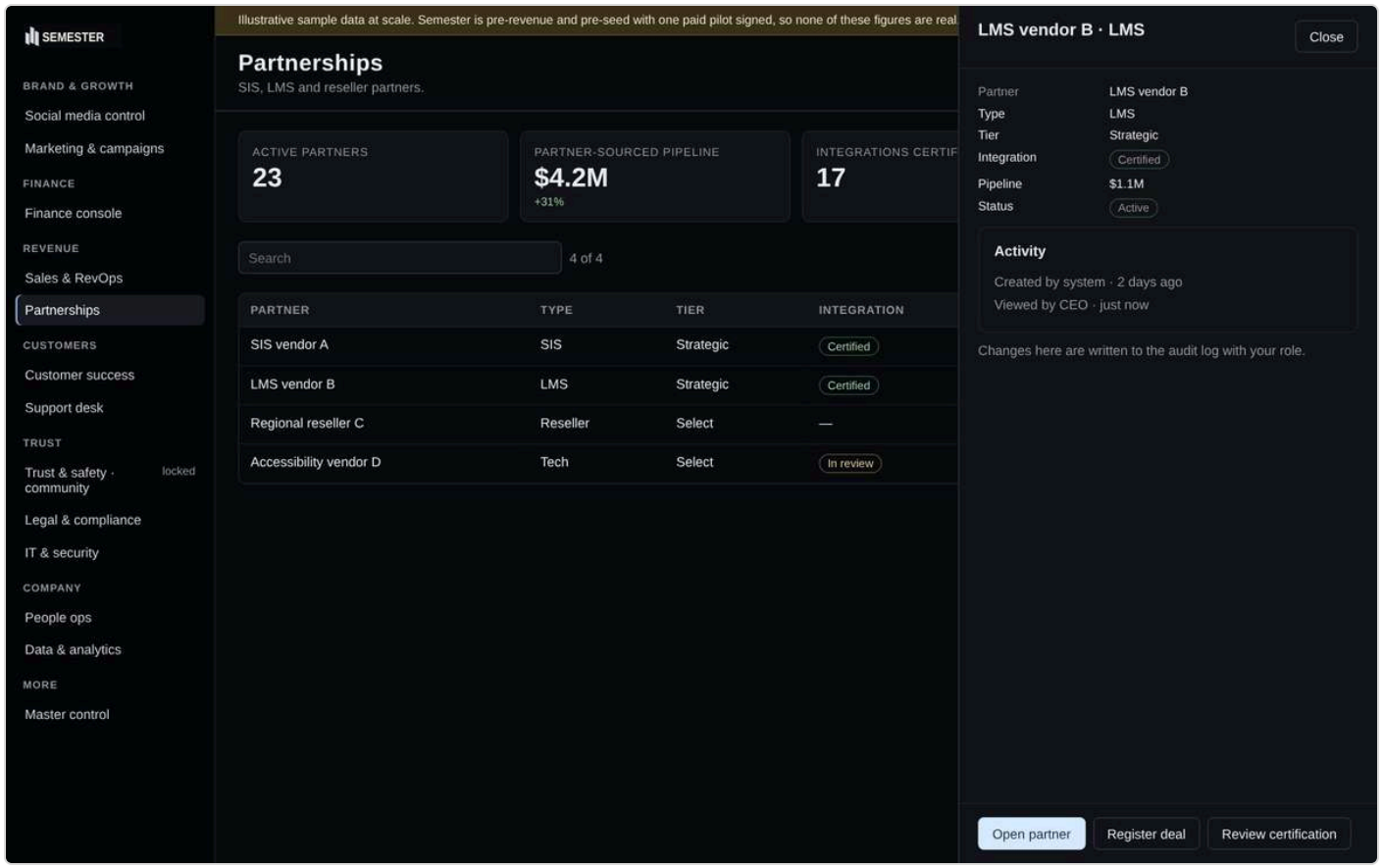
Sales & RevOps › 3 campuses Eastbrook University Procurement $880k Jan 20 R. Osei



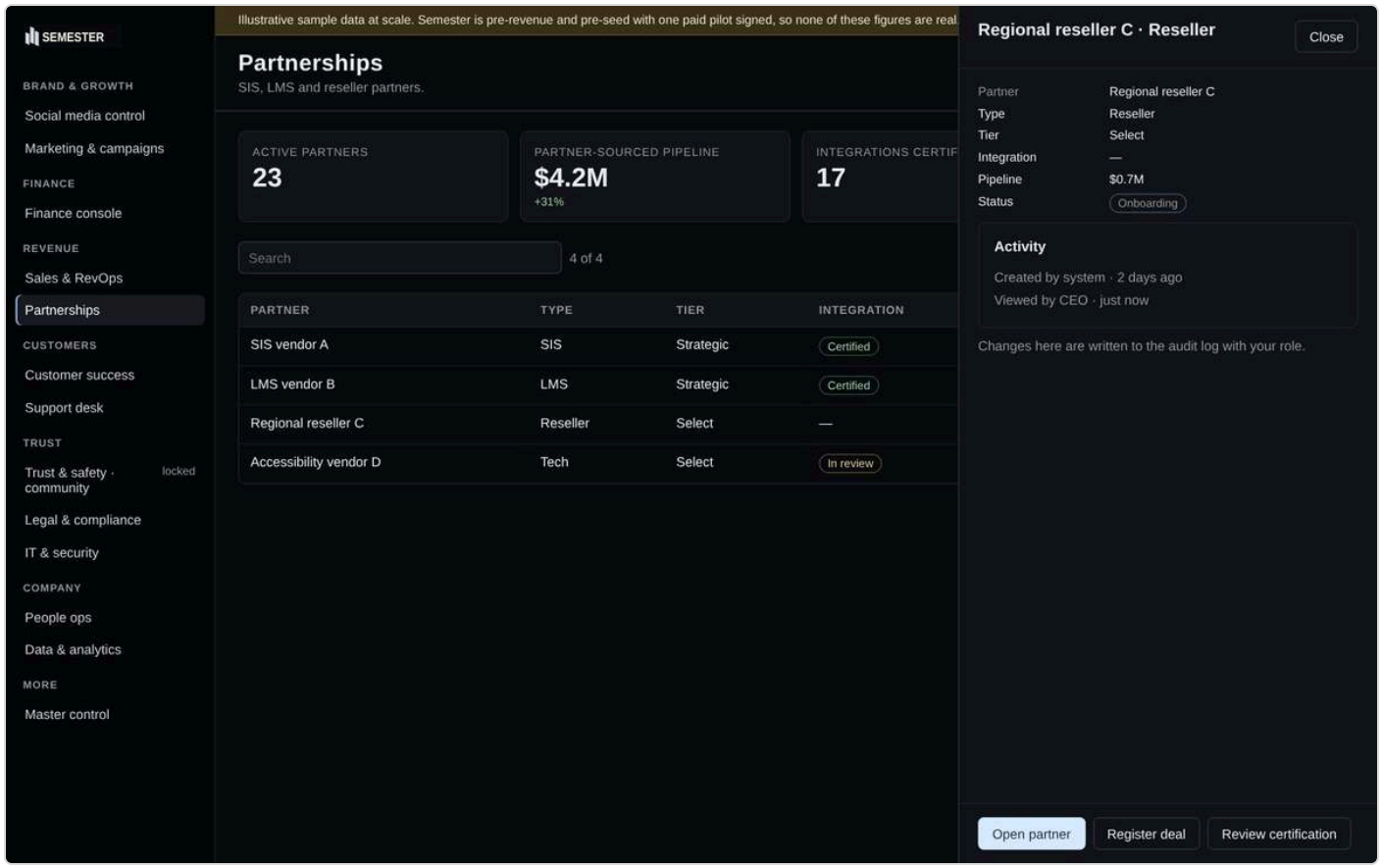
Sales & RevOps › New logo Brightwater CC Discovery $95k Feb 28 M. Chen



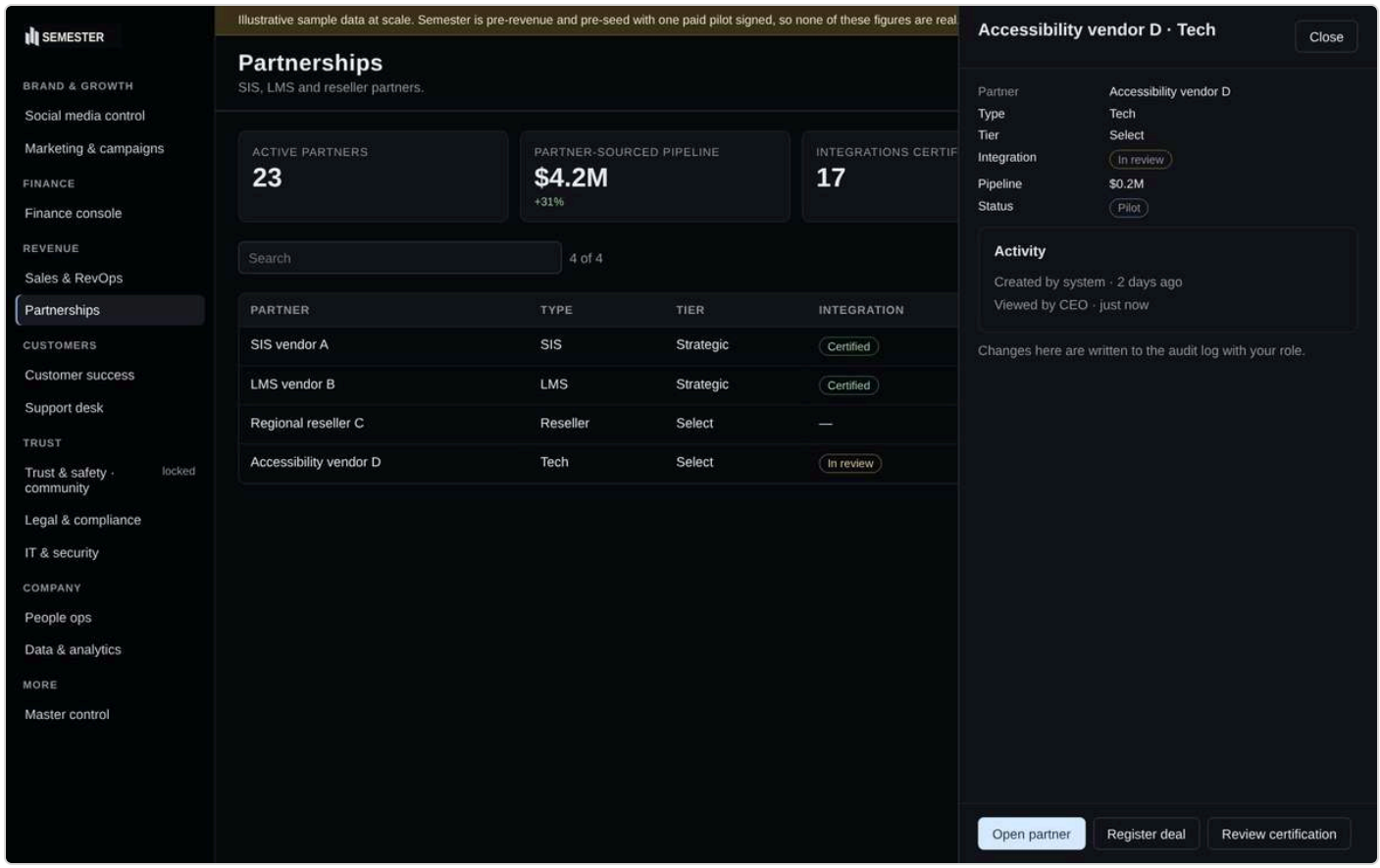
Sales & RevOps › Expansion seats Valewood University Verbal $140k Oct 30 L. Brandt



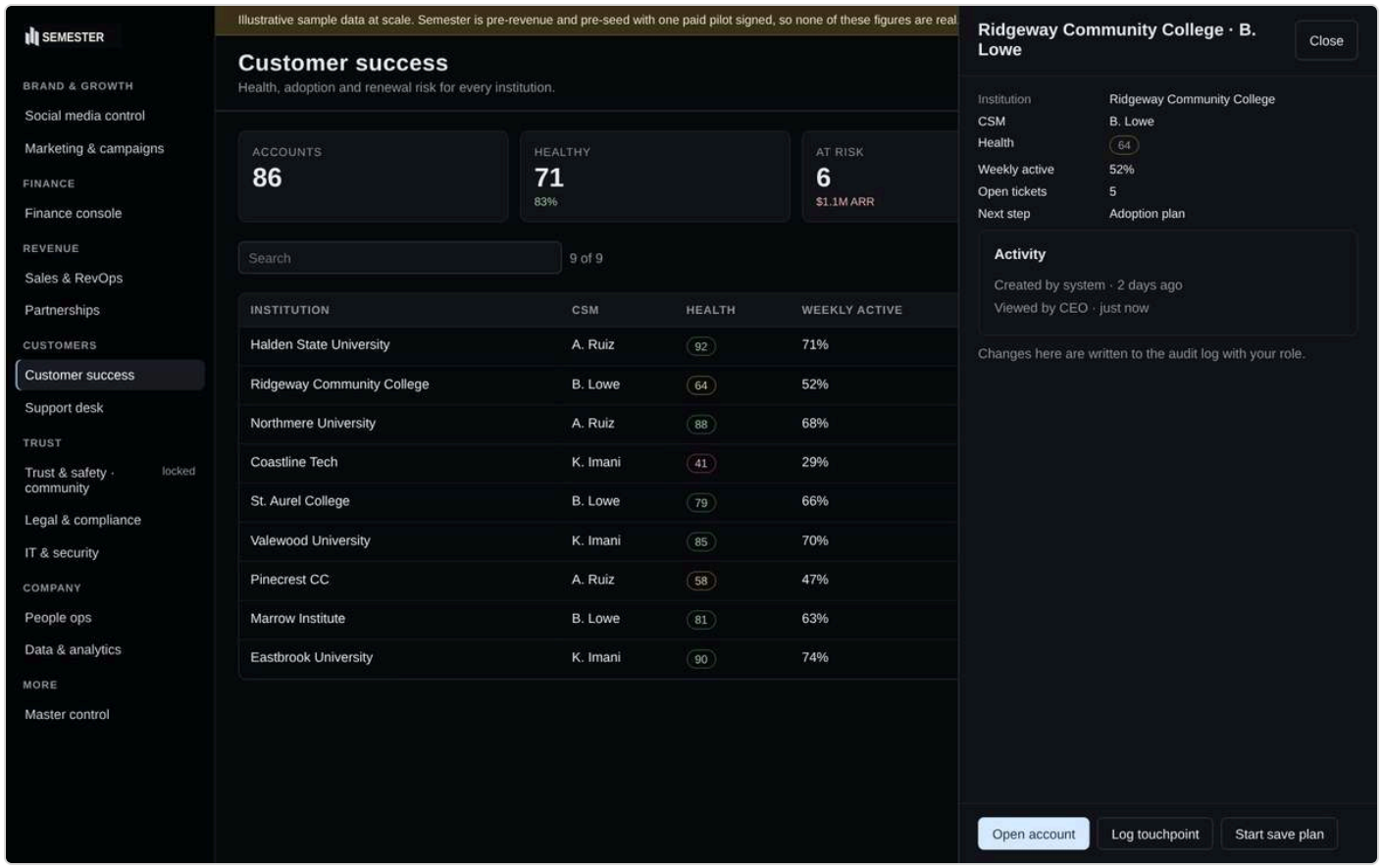
Partnerships › LMS vendor B LMS Strategic Certified $1.1M Active



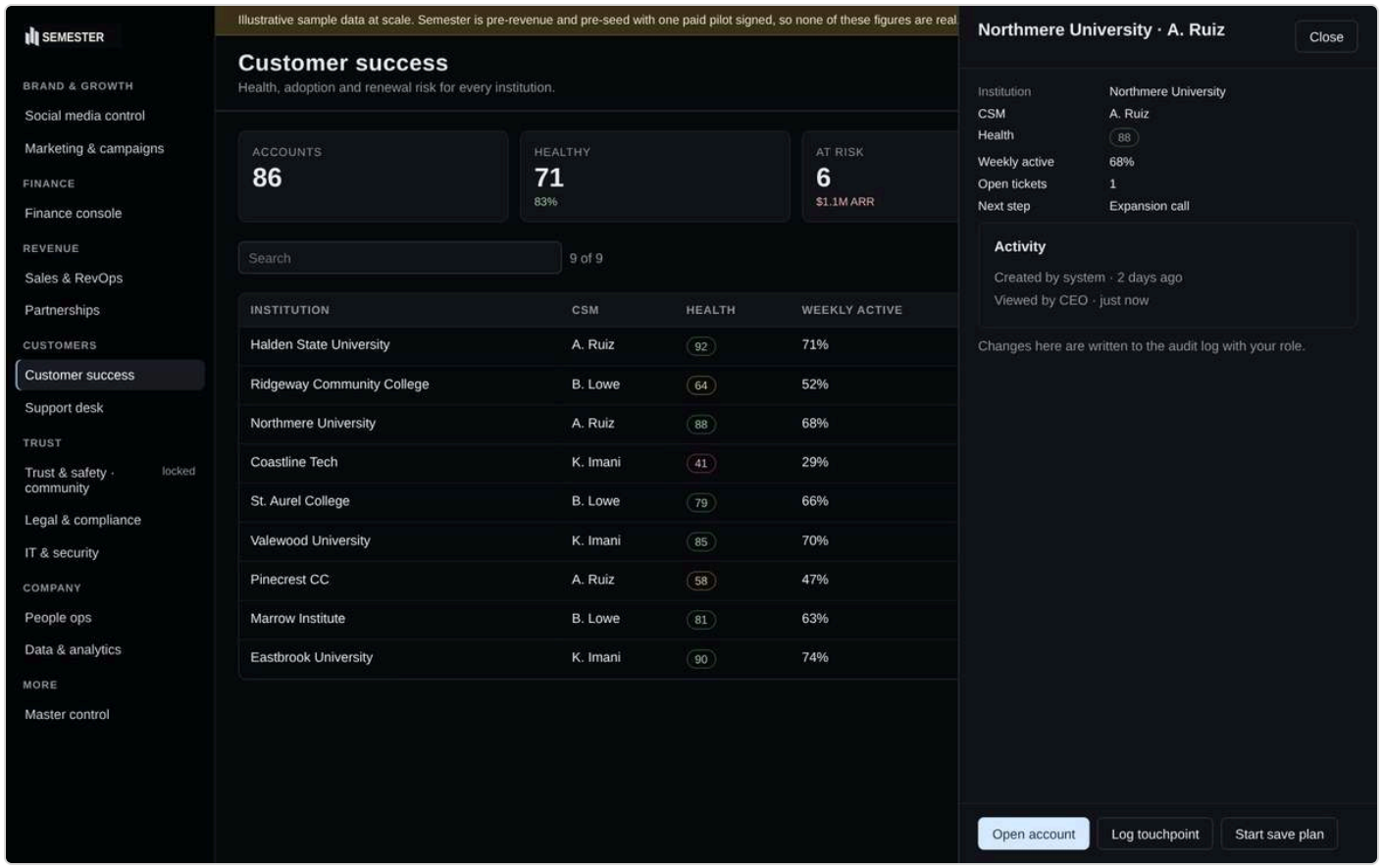
Partnerships › Regional reseller C Reseller Select — $0.7M Onboarding



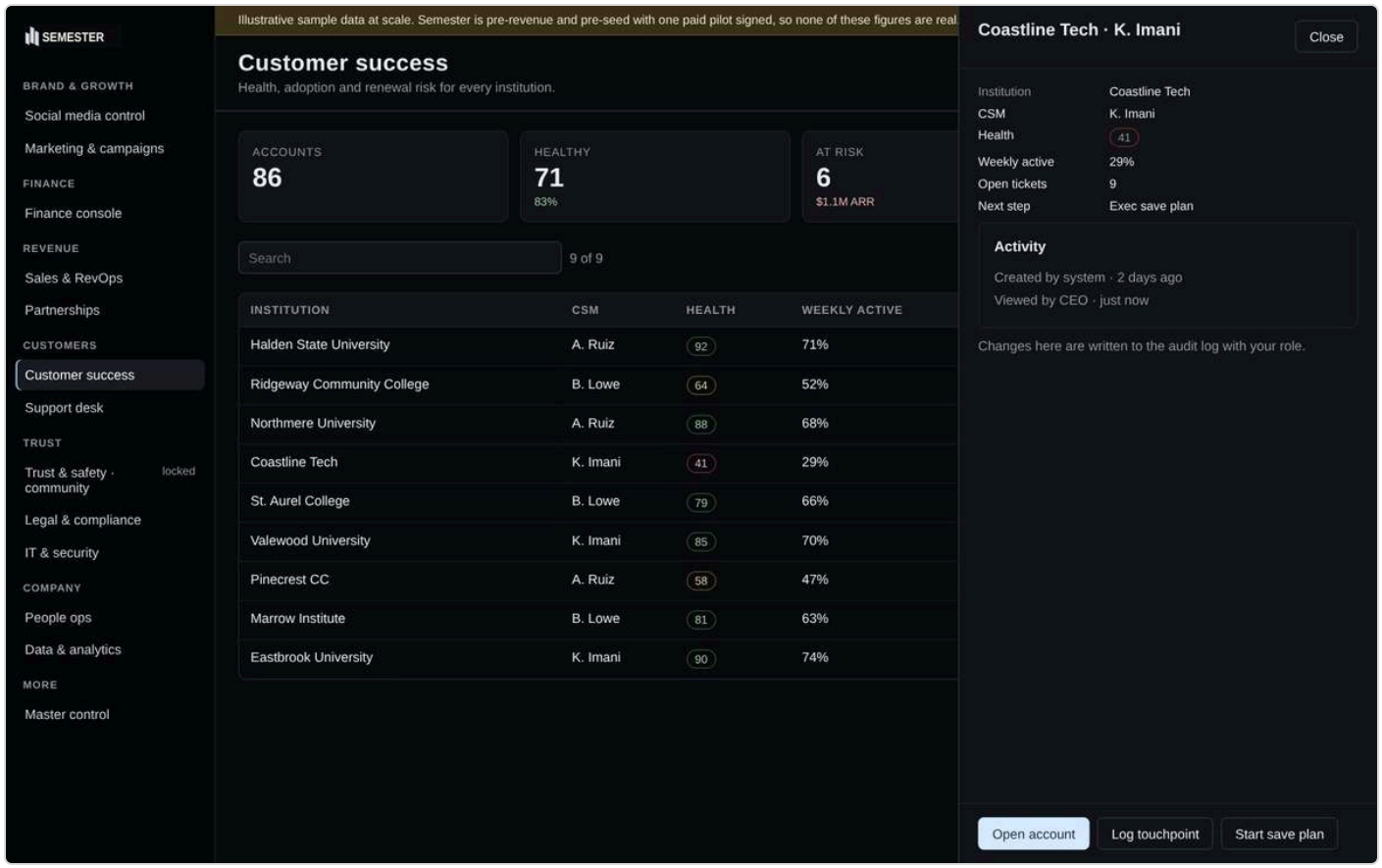
Partnerships › Accessibility vendor D Tech Select In review $0.2M Pilot



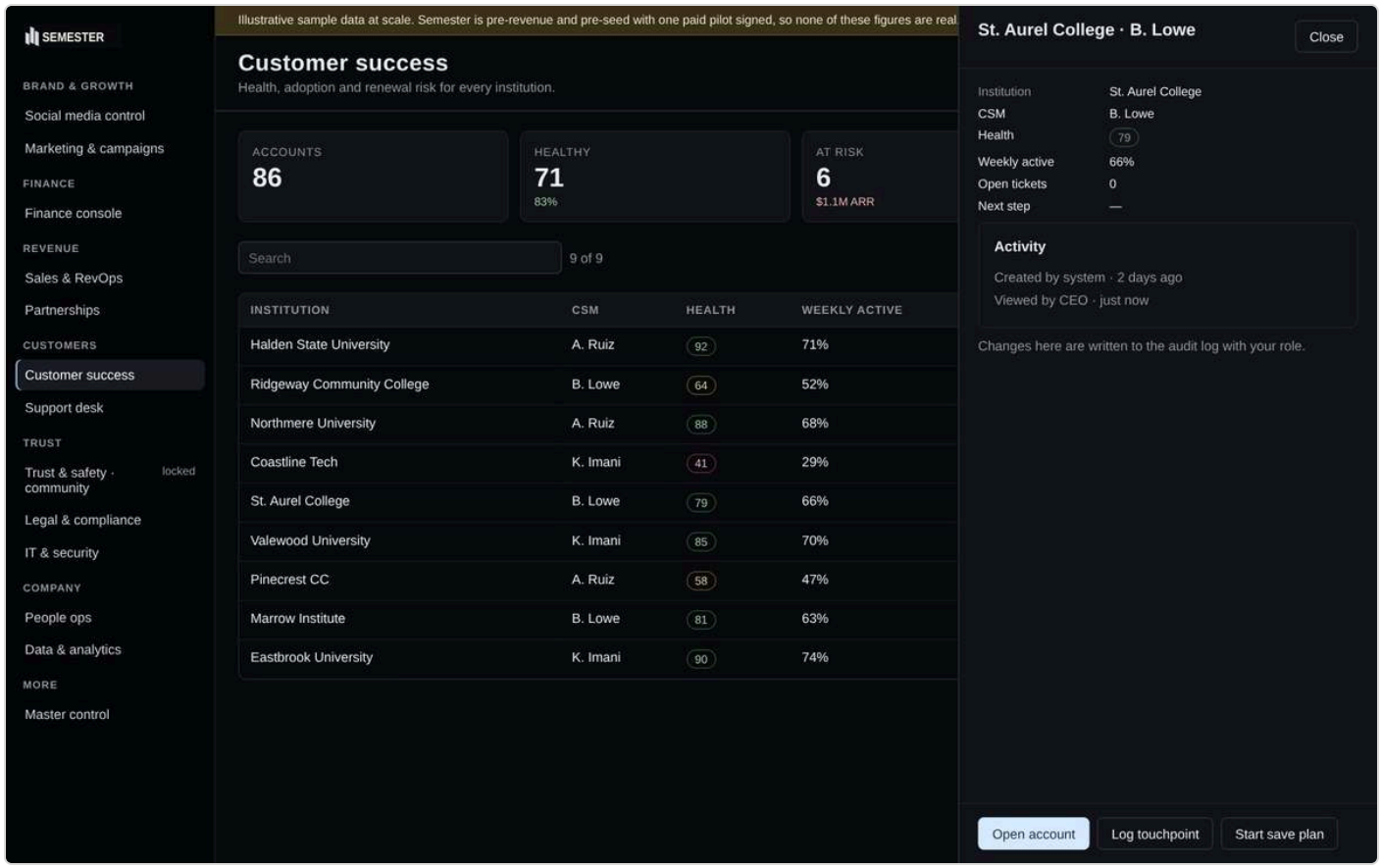
Customer success › Ridgeway Community College B. Lowe 64 52% 5 Adoption plan



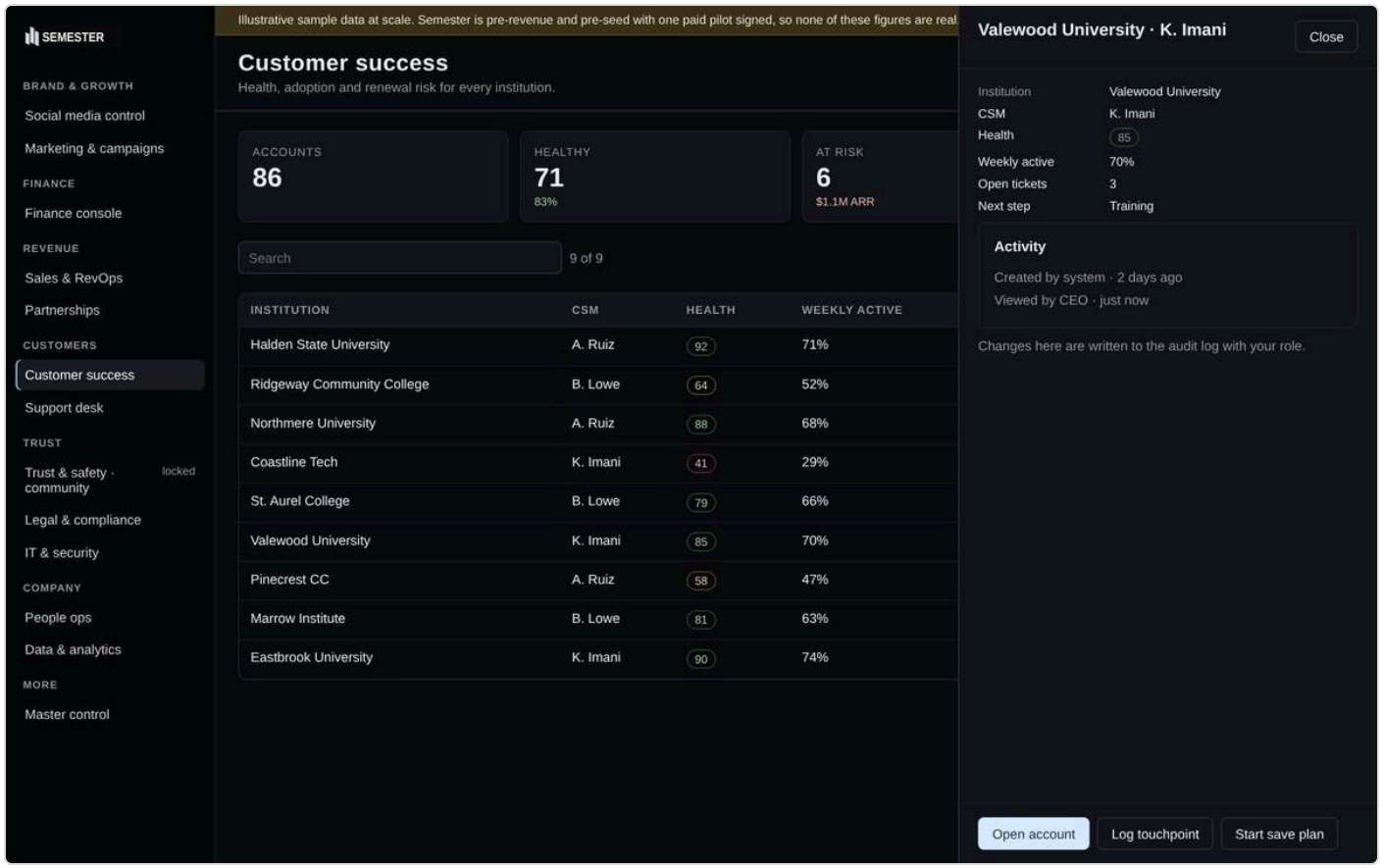
Customer success › Northmere University A. Ruiz 88 68% 1 Expansion call



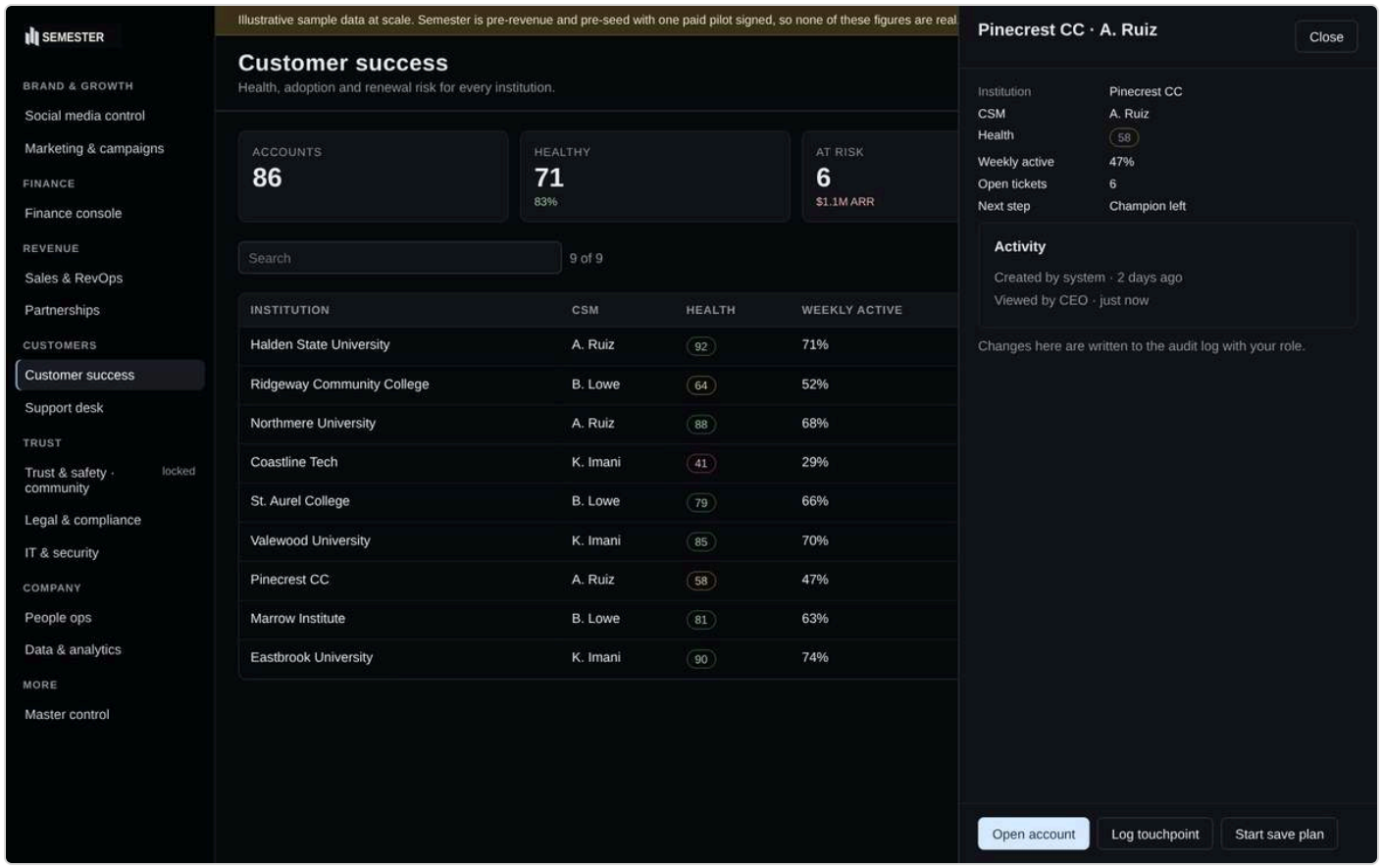
Customer success › Coastline Tech K. Imani 41 29% 9 Exec save plan



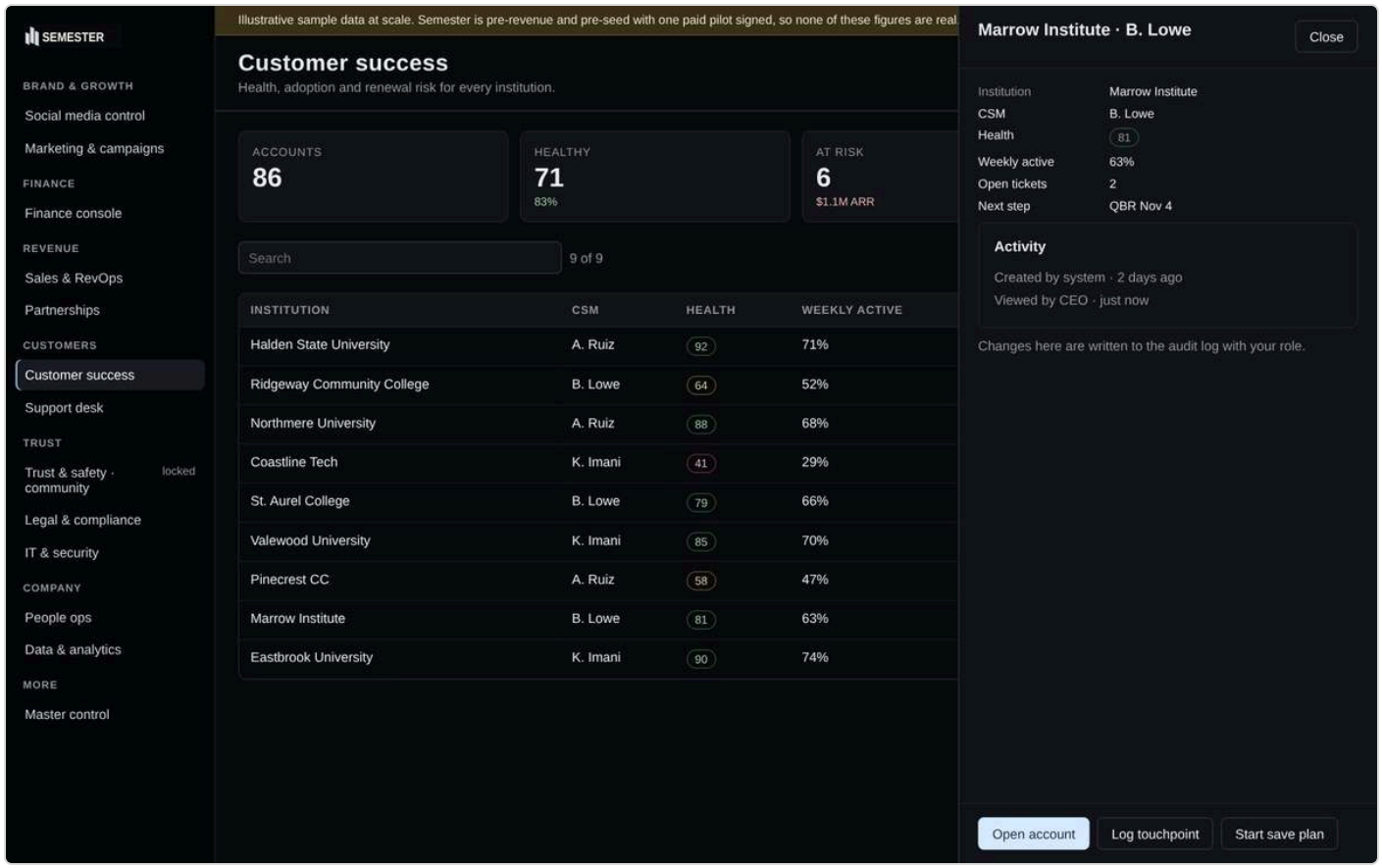
Customer success › St. Aurel College B. Lowe 79 66% 0 —



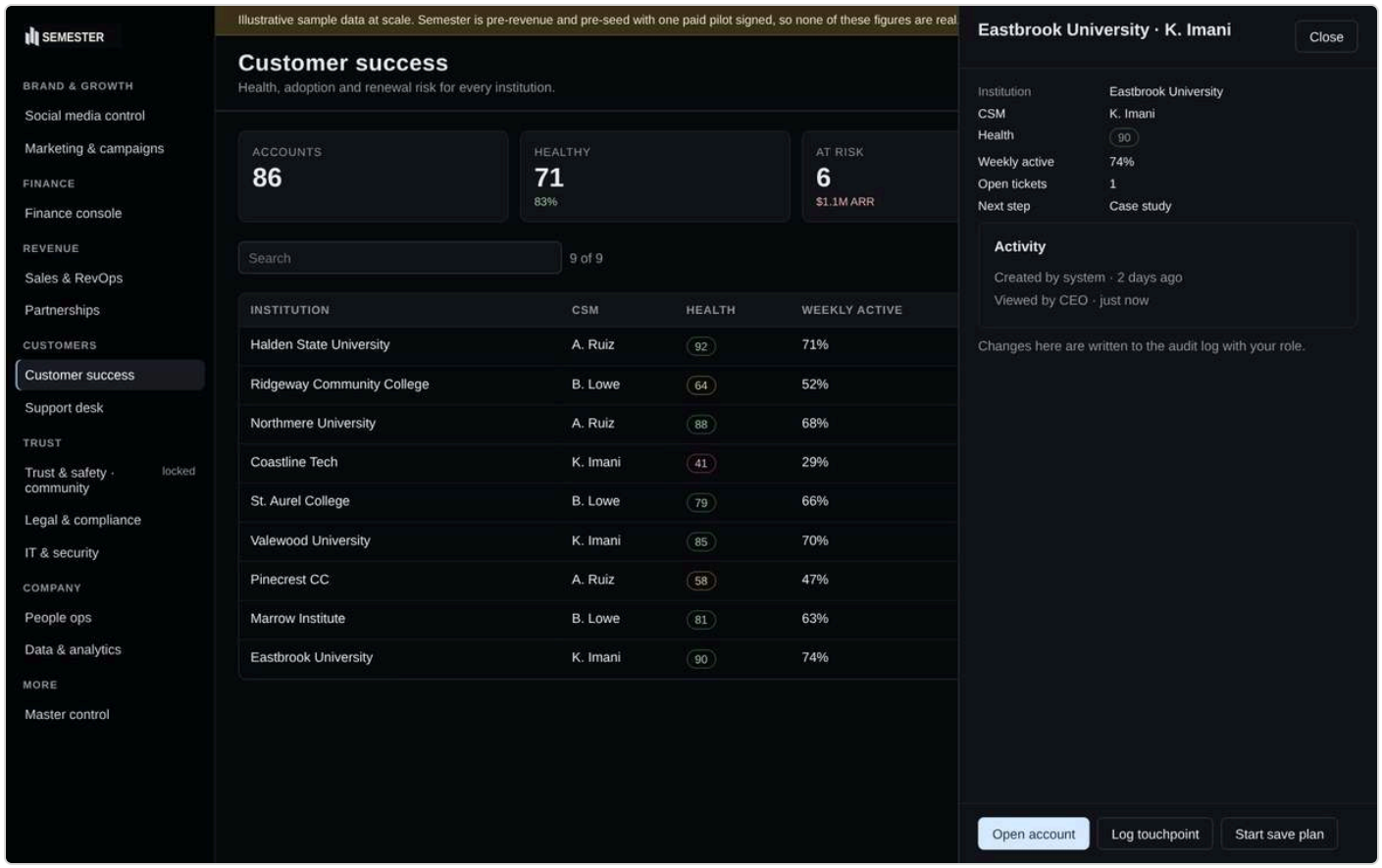
Customer success › Valewood University K. Imani 85 70% 3 Training



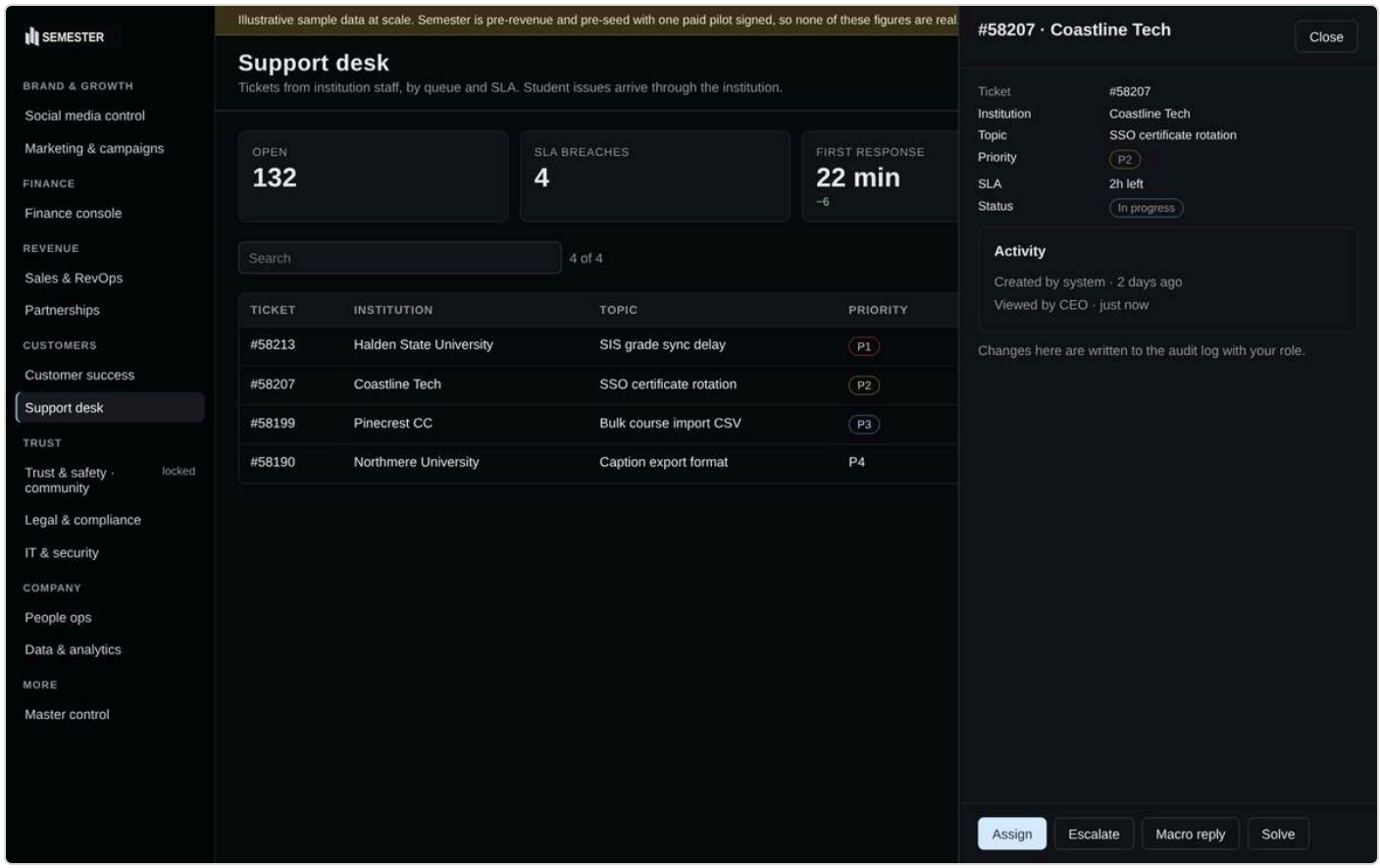
Customer success › Pinecrest CC A. Ruiz 58 47% 6 Champion left



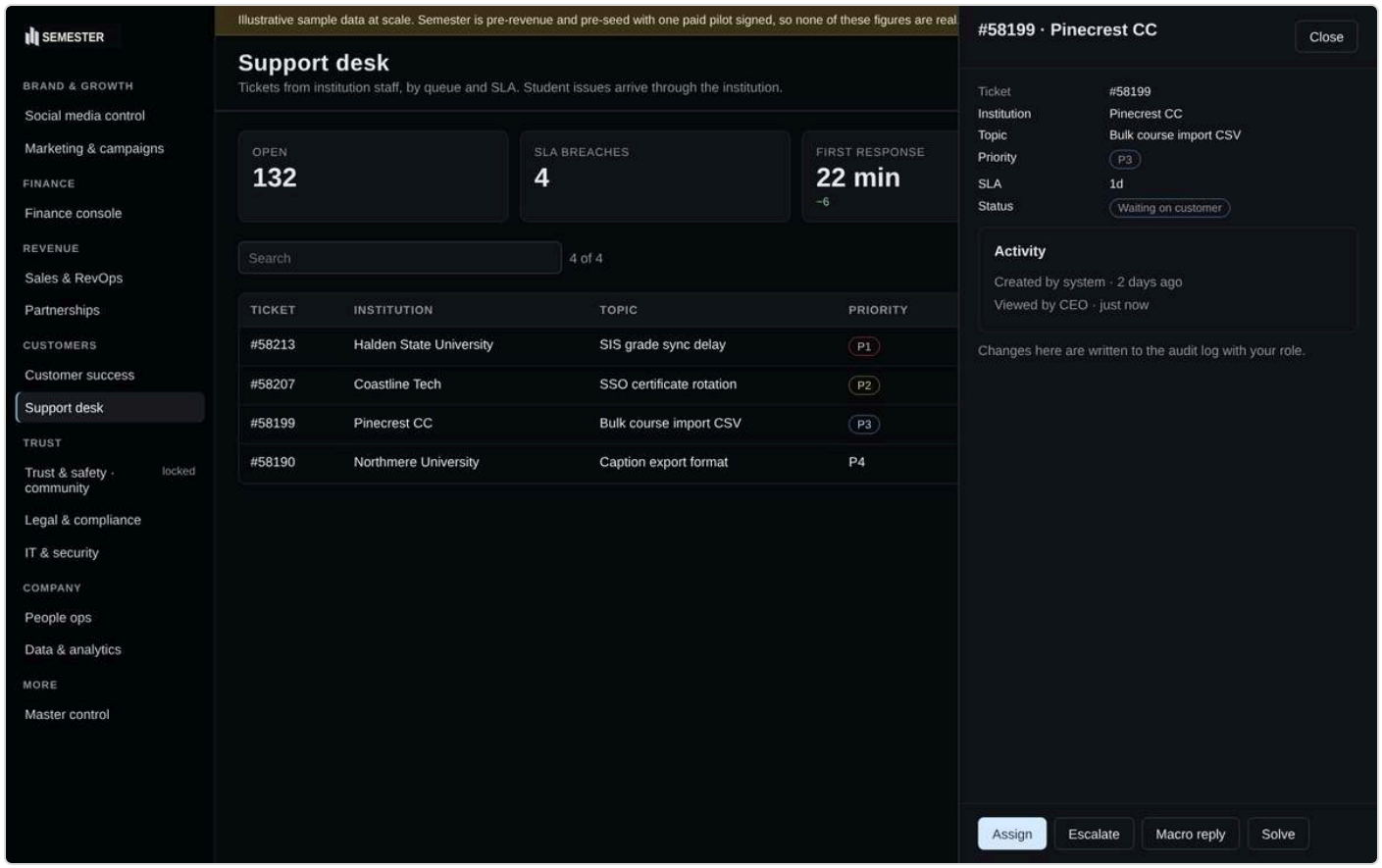
Customer success › Marrow Institute B. Lowe 81 63% 2 QBR Nov 4



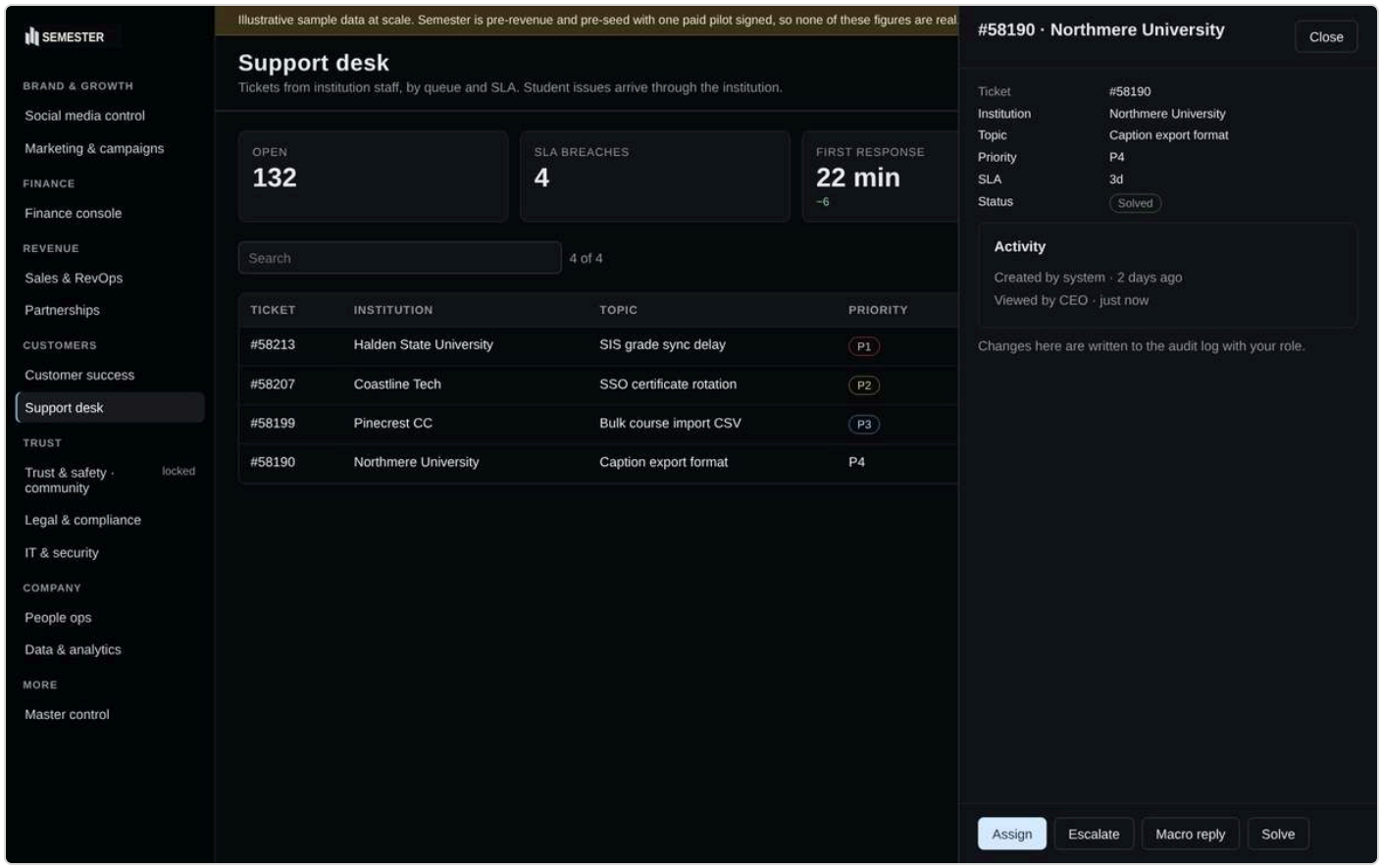
Customer success › Eastbrook University K. Imani 90 74% 1 Case study



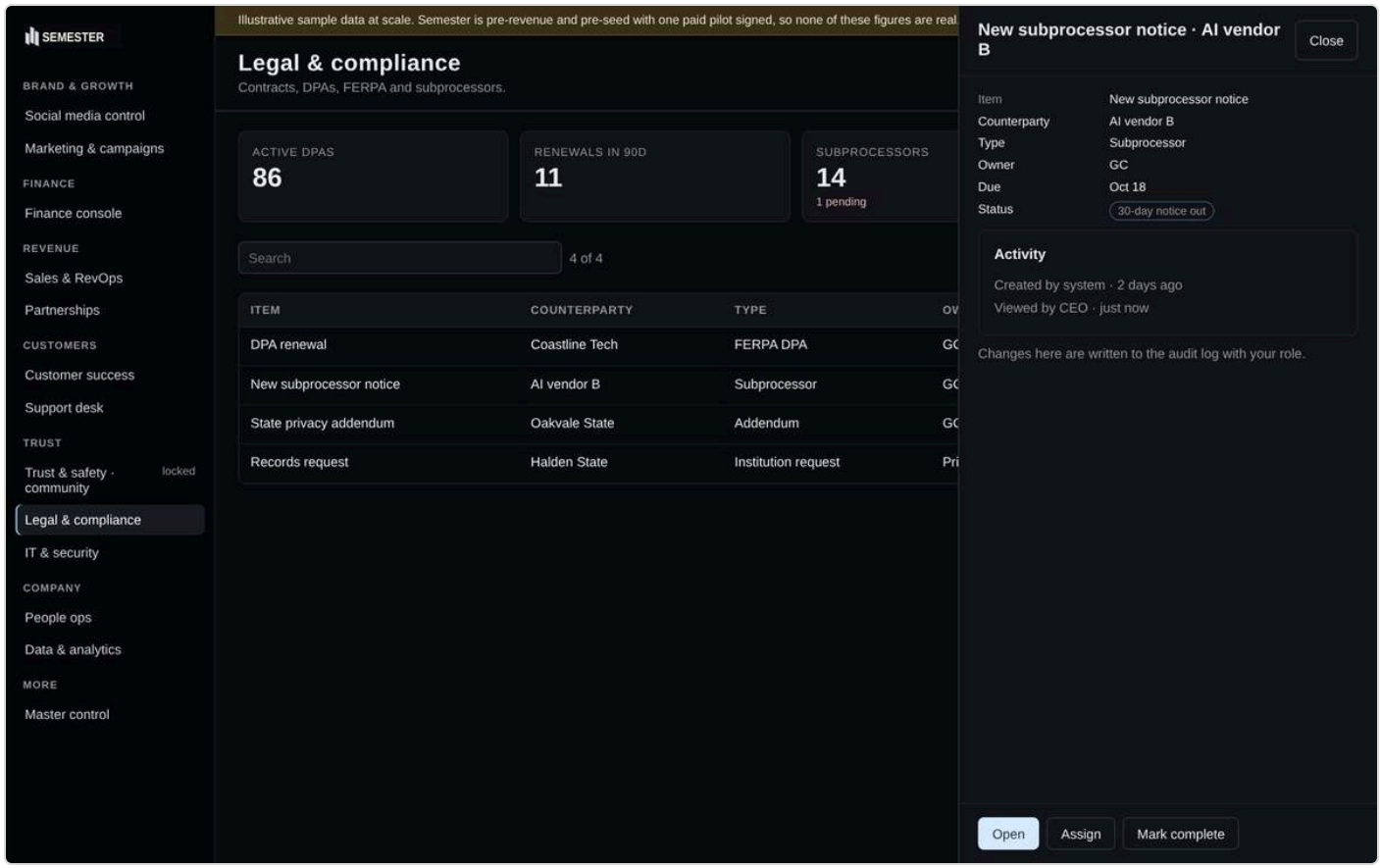
Support desk › #58207 Coastline Tech SSO certificate rotation P2 2h left In progress



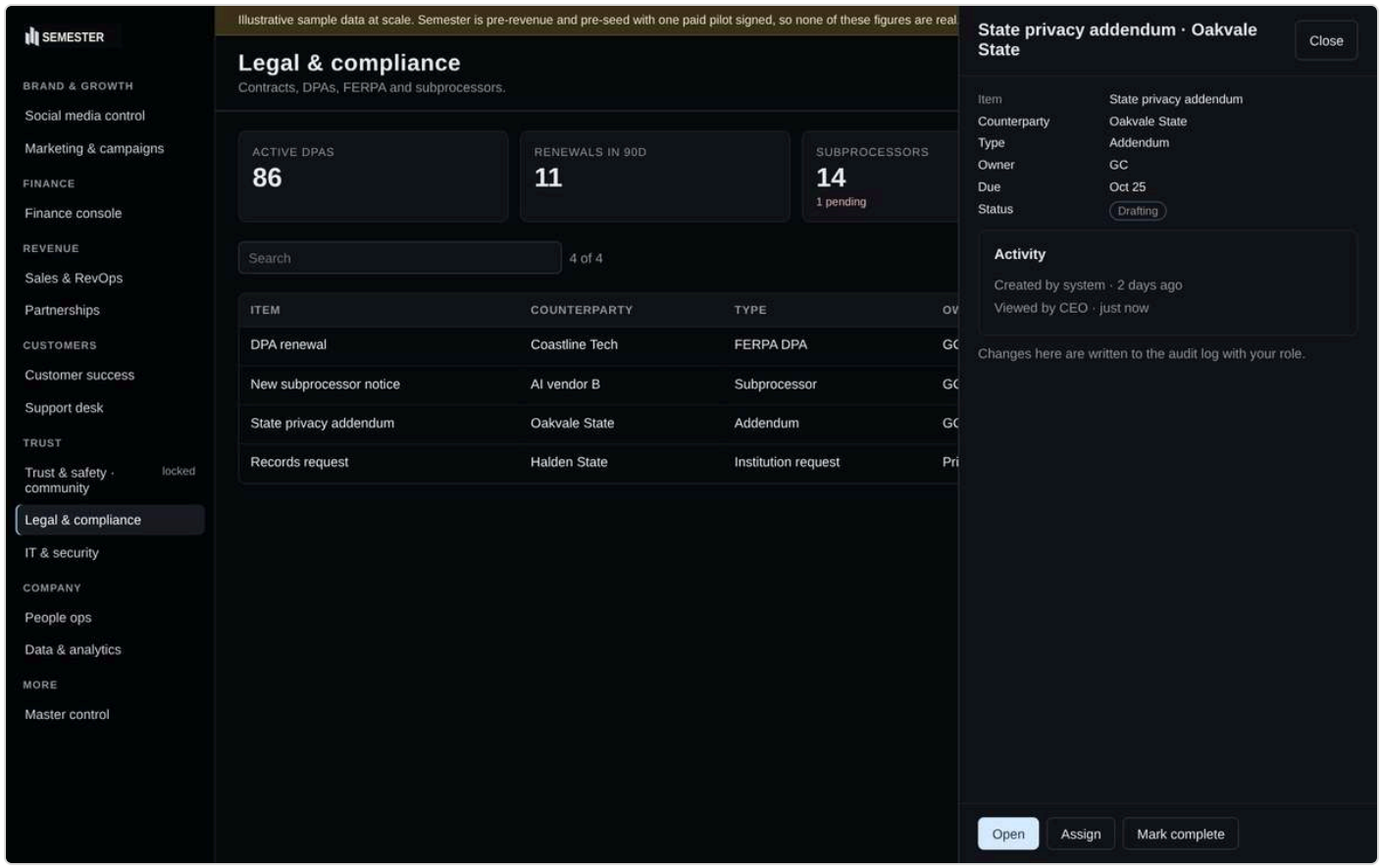
Support desk › #58199 Pinecrest CC Bulk course import CSV P3 1d Waiting on customer



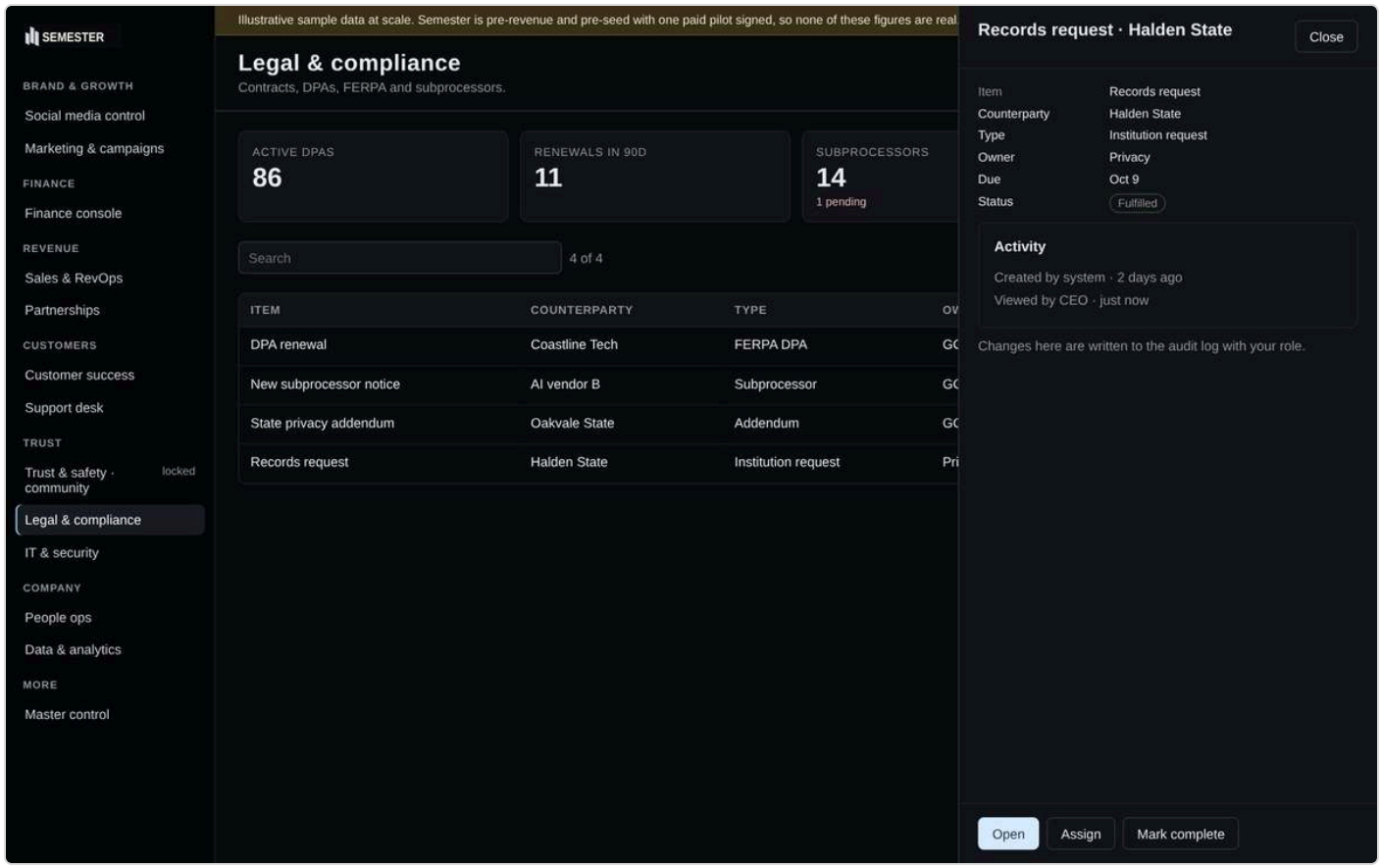
Support desk › #58190 Northmere University Caption export format P4 3d Solved



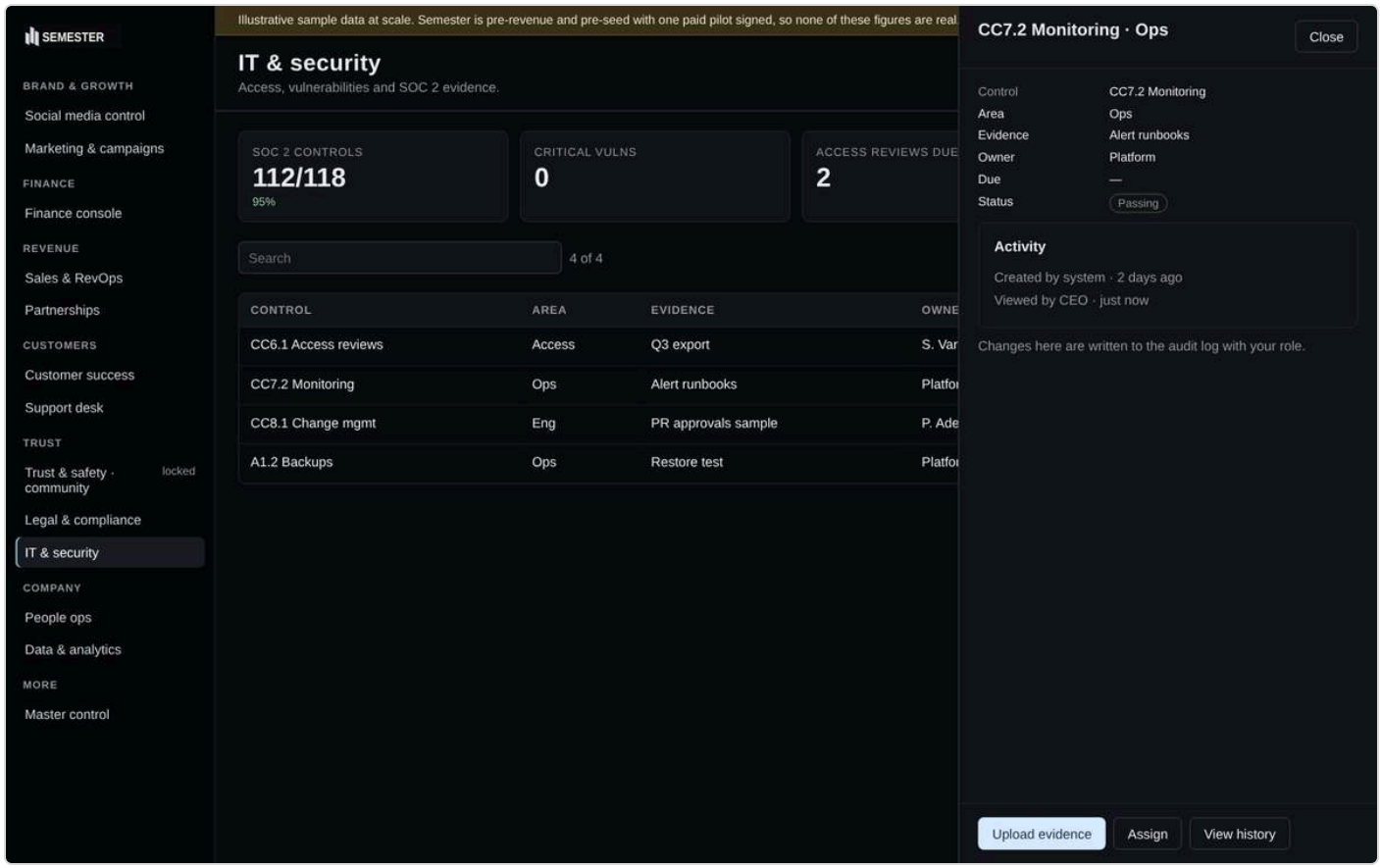
Legal & compliance › New subprocessor notice AI vendor B Subprocessor GC Oct 18 30-day notice out



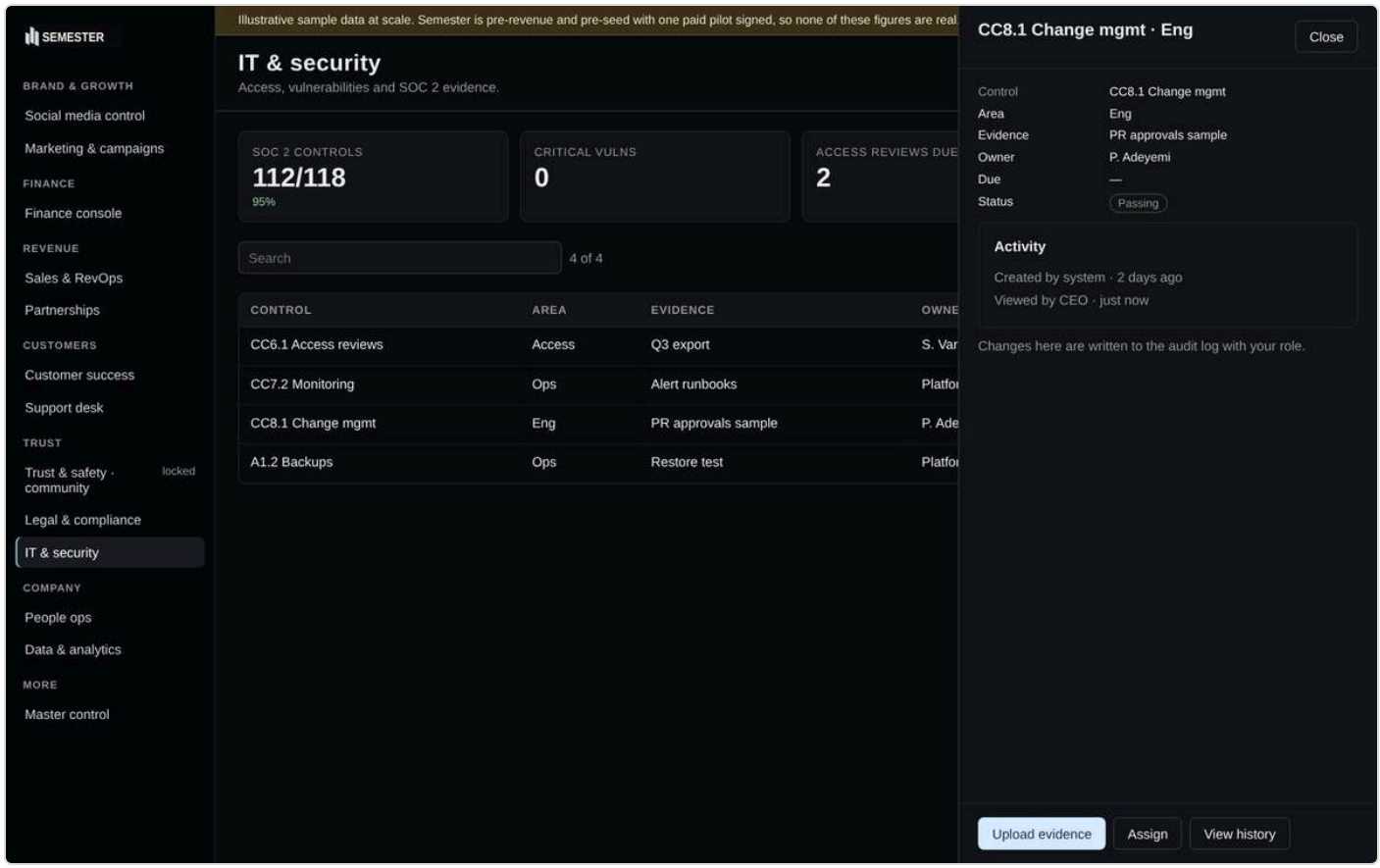
Legal & compliance › State privacy addendum Oakvale State Addendum GC Oct 25 Drafting



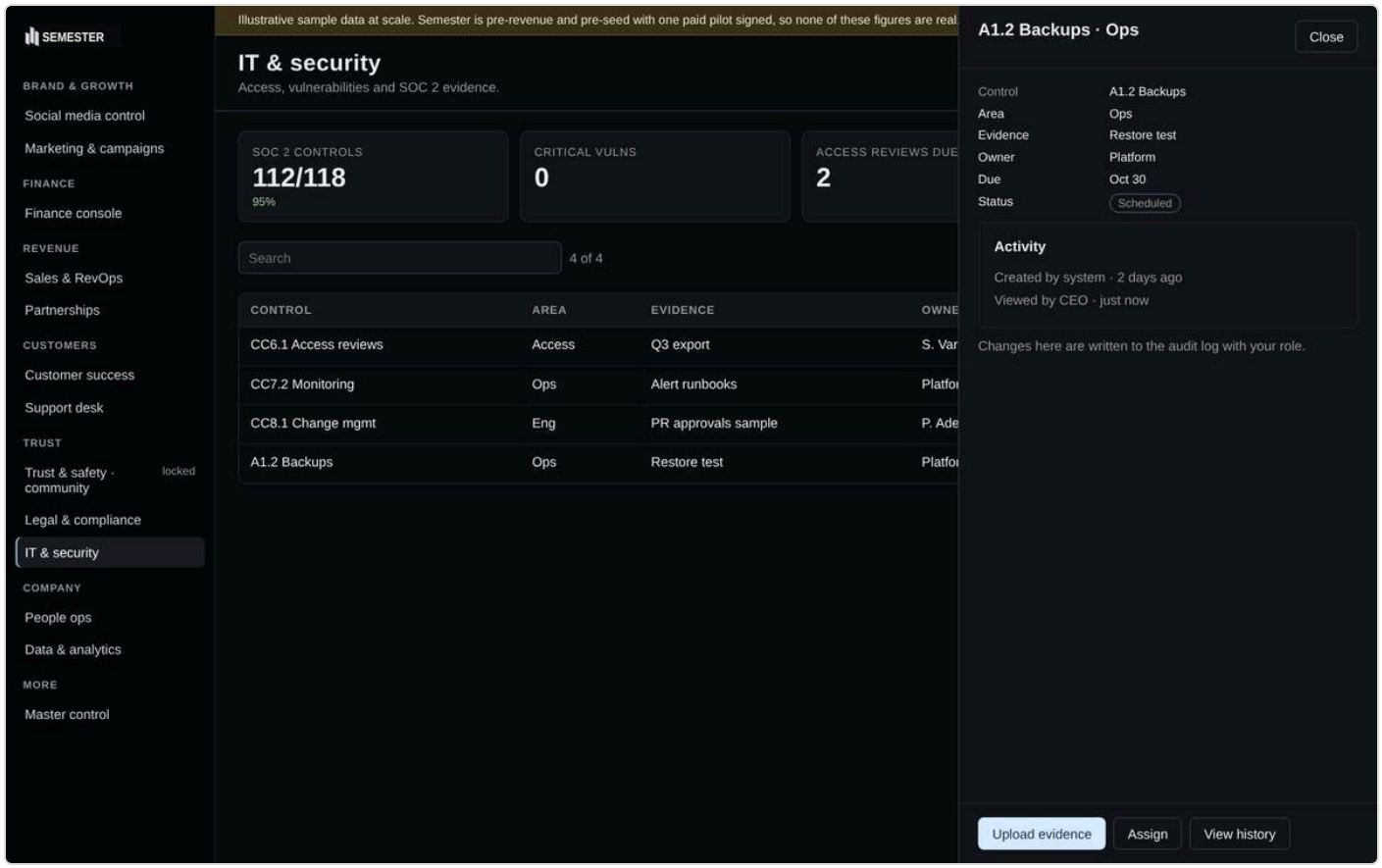
Legal & compliance › Records request Halden State Institution request Privacy Oct 9 Fulfilled



IT & security › CC7.2 Monitoring Ops Alert runbooks Platform — Passing



IT & security › CC8.1 Change mgmt Eng PR approvals sample P. Adeyemi — Passing



IT & security › A1.2 Backups Ops Restore test Platform Oct 30 Scheduled

compliance

SEMESTER

Front-end compliance

WCAG 2.2 · FTC

Front-end compliance auditProduct + company site

Search or ask… ⌘K

On this device only

Compliance

WCAG 2.2 and FTC proof rules

WCAG 2.2

Area	Required checks	Semester implementation	Status
Keyboard	Tab, Shift+Tab, Enter, Space, Escape, arrows reach everything	taps.test.ts, focus clear-top/bottom, skip link	✓In place
Focus visible	2.4.7 / 2.4.11 not obscured	--focus-color ring; scroll margins 96/84px	✓In place
Text alternatives	Images, icons, charts, video	labels.mjs lint; chart tables	◷Partial
Colour + contrast	States never colour-only; 4.5:1 / 3:1	contrast.test.ts (143 pairings); glyph + word + tone	✓In place
Forms	Visible labels, describedby, error text	fields.test.ts; TextField pattern	✓In place
Reflow + zoom	320px, 200%/400% zoom	breakpoints.test.ts; sweep:spacing	◷Partial — needs manual pass
Target size	2.5.8 ≥ 24px; 44px ordinary	taps.test.ts	✓In place
Dialogs	Focus in, trapped, returns; Escape closes	ConfirmDialog	✓In place
Motion	Reduced motion honoured	motion.test.ts; data-calm	✓In place
Media	Captions, transcript, no autoplay	Not audited	!Gap
Consistent help	3.2.6 same place on every page	ScreenGuide · Help	◷Partial
Accessible auth	3.3.8 no cognitive test	SAML SSO; magic link	✓In place
Redundant entry	3.3.7 don't ask twice	Not audited	!Gap

FTC proof hierarchy

Proof

Proof type	Can publish?	Required evidence
Product screenshot	Yes, if current	Product owner review + "demo data" label
Customer logo	Only with permission	Written logo-use approval
Testimonial / quote	Only with consent	Signed approval record; real customer; no edits to meaning
Outcome statistic	Not yet	Measured baseline, method, sample, authority (CLM-014)
"Compliant / certified"	No	Only with a qualified audit
Paid/partner endorsement	Only disclosed	Clear "sponsored" or "partner" label

Claims rule Say "Semester is working toward an accessible experience and maintains an accessibility conformance report." Never "fully accessible" or "WCAG compliant" without a qualified audit.

- ✓ Manual test protocolKeyboard-only, screen reader, 320px, 200% zoom, forced colours
- Testimonial approval recordWho, what, consent date, expiry

Release gate — public pages

Company site · 5 pages

Release gate

Category	Requirement	Test	Site status
Structure	One h1, ordered headings, header/nav/main/footer	Semantic outline	✓In place
Keyboard	Nav, forms, tabs, pricing reachable	Tab / Shift+Tab / Enter / Escape	✓In place
Focus	Visible, not under sticky header	Manual tab-through	✓In place
Contrast	Text, buttons, states 4.5:1 / 3:1	Automated + manual	◷Partial
Colour reliance	Status never colour-only	Greyscale review	✓In place
Forms	Visible labels, required marks, field errors	Submit invalid + valid	◷Partial
Errors	Name field, say how to fix, focus first error	Screen reader	✓In place
Mobile	320px, landscape, 200% zoom	Emulator + manual	◷Partial — needs manual pass
Motion	prefers-reduced-motion honoured	OS setting	✓In place
Tables	Caption, scoped headers, sort buttons	Inspect	✓In place
Timing	No short form timeout	Wait test	✓In place
Language	lang set; acronyms explained once	Content review	◷Partial
Third-party	Calendar/chat/video have accessible fallback	Block and test	!Gap

Form validation states

Work email (required)We reply within two business days.

Work email (required)maya@ !Enter a full email address, like name@university.edu.

✓Request sent

Check your inbox for a confirmation.

Testimonial component rules

Render only if
: Signed approval, real person, current, meaning unedited

Disclose
: Beside the quote: "Pilot participant, Fall 2026" · paid/partner if any

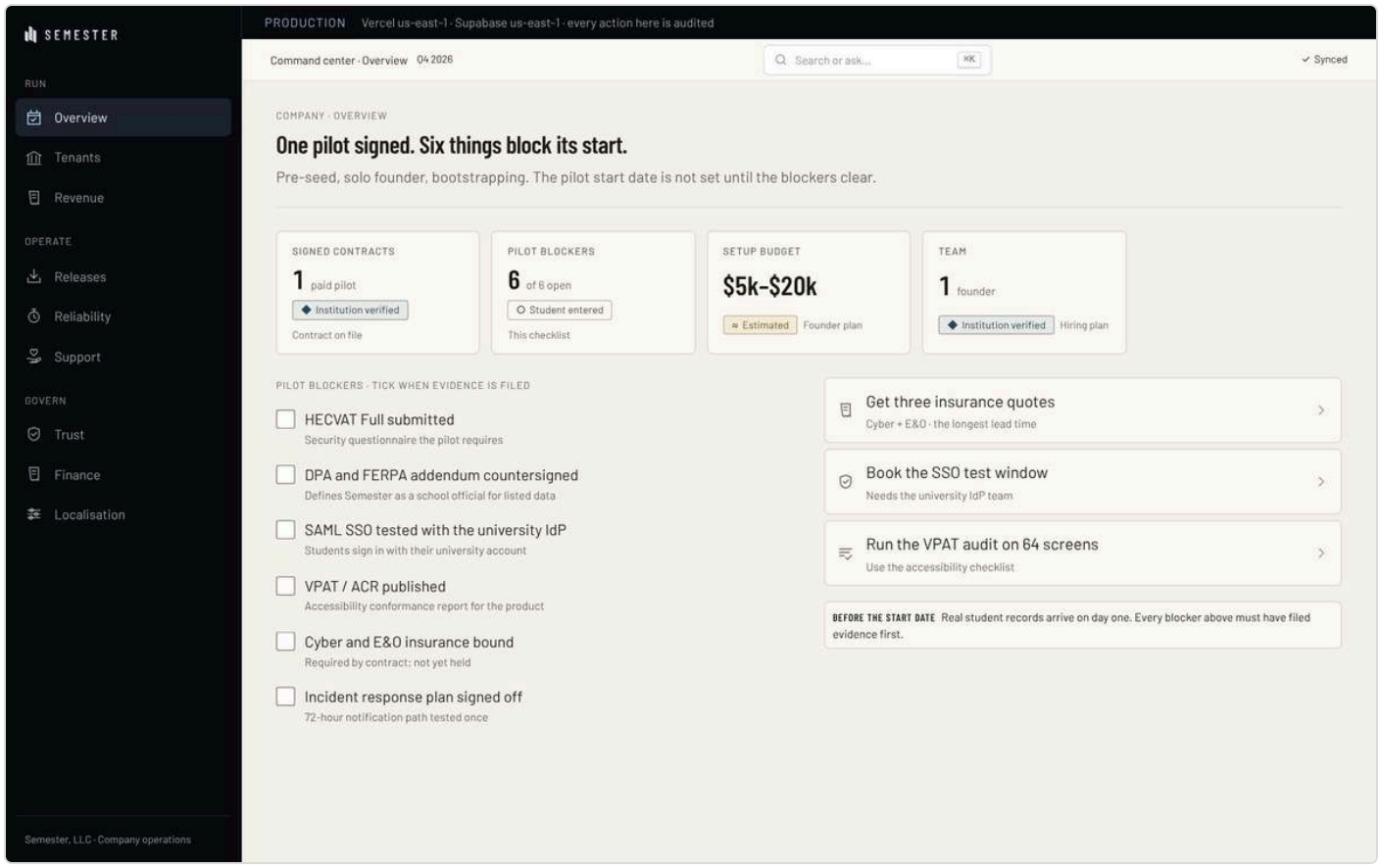
Before customers exist
: No testimonials; screenshots labelled "illustrative product view"

Publish gate
: No unresolved critical a11y issue, unsupported claim or missing disclosure

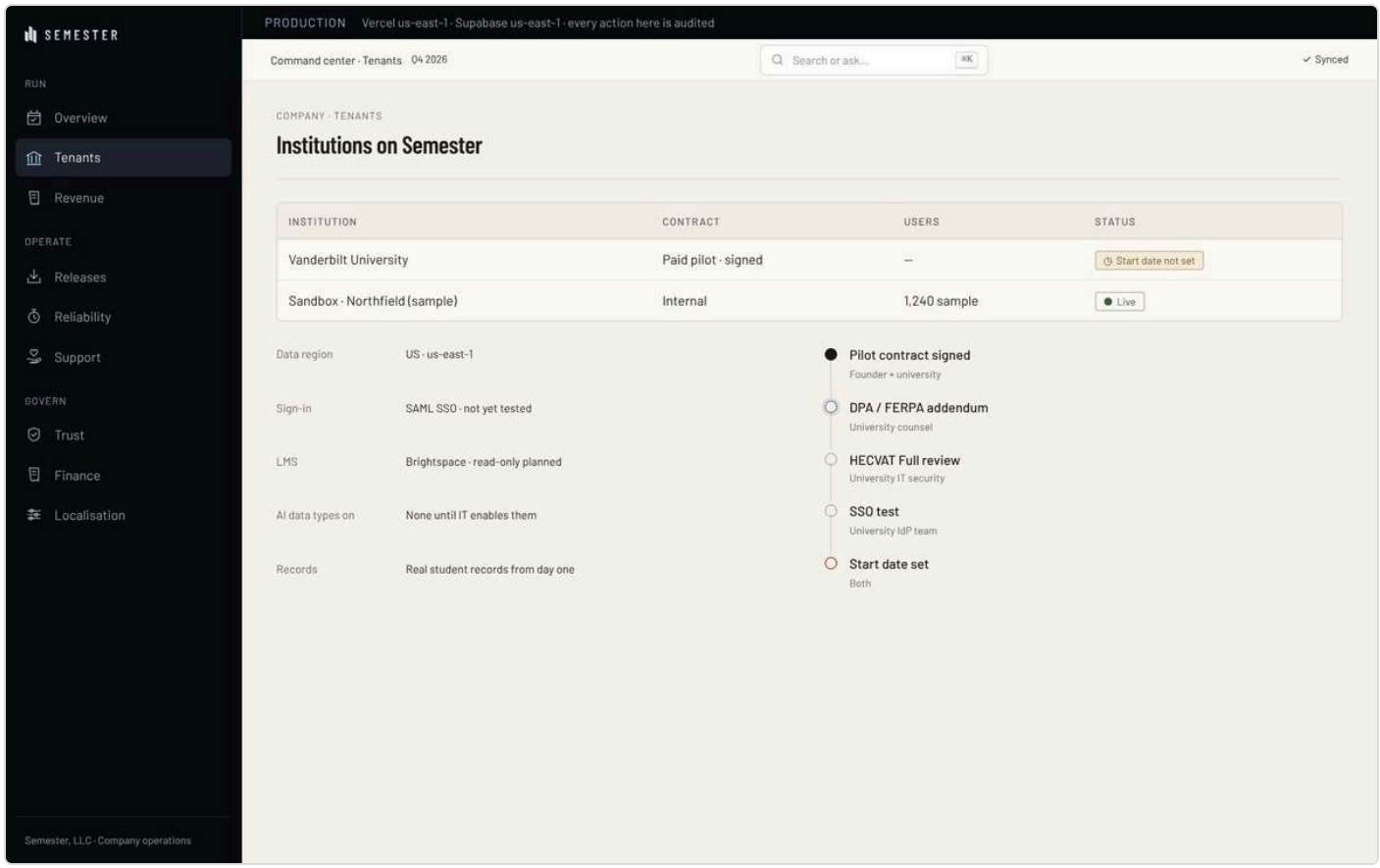
Opening view

Company command center

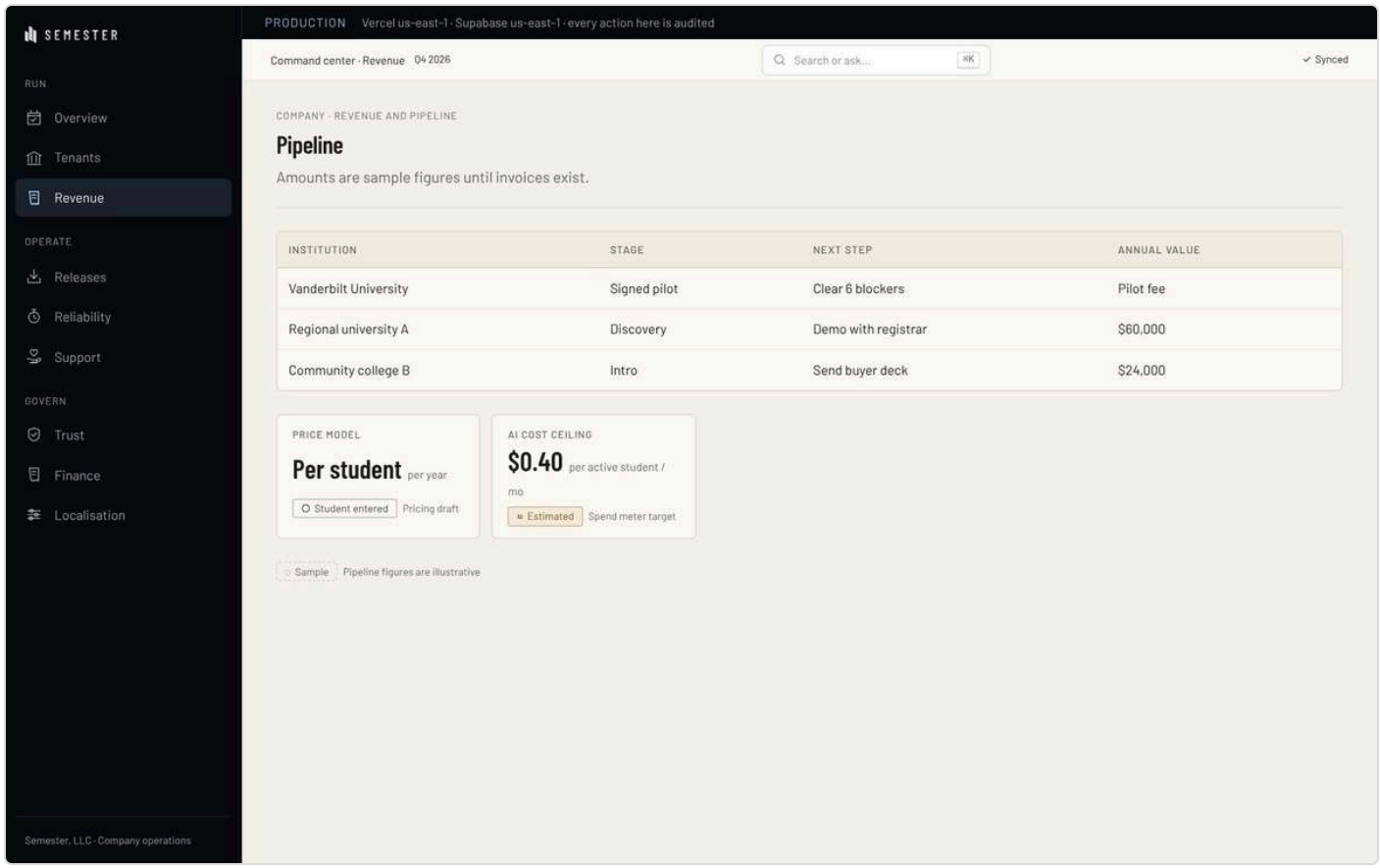
9 screens.



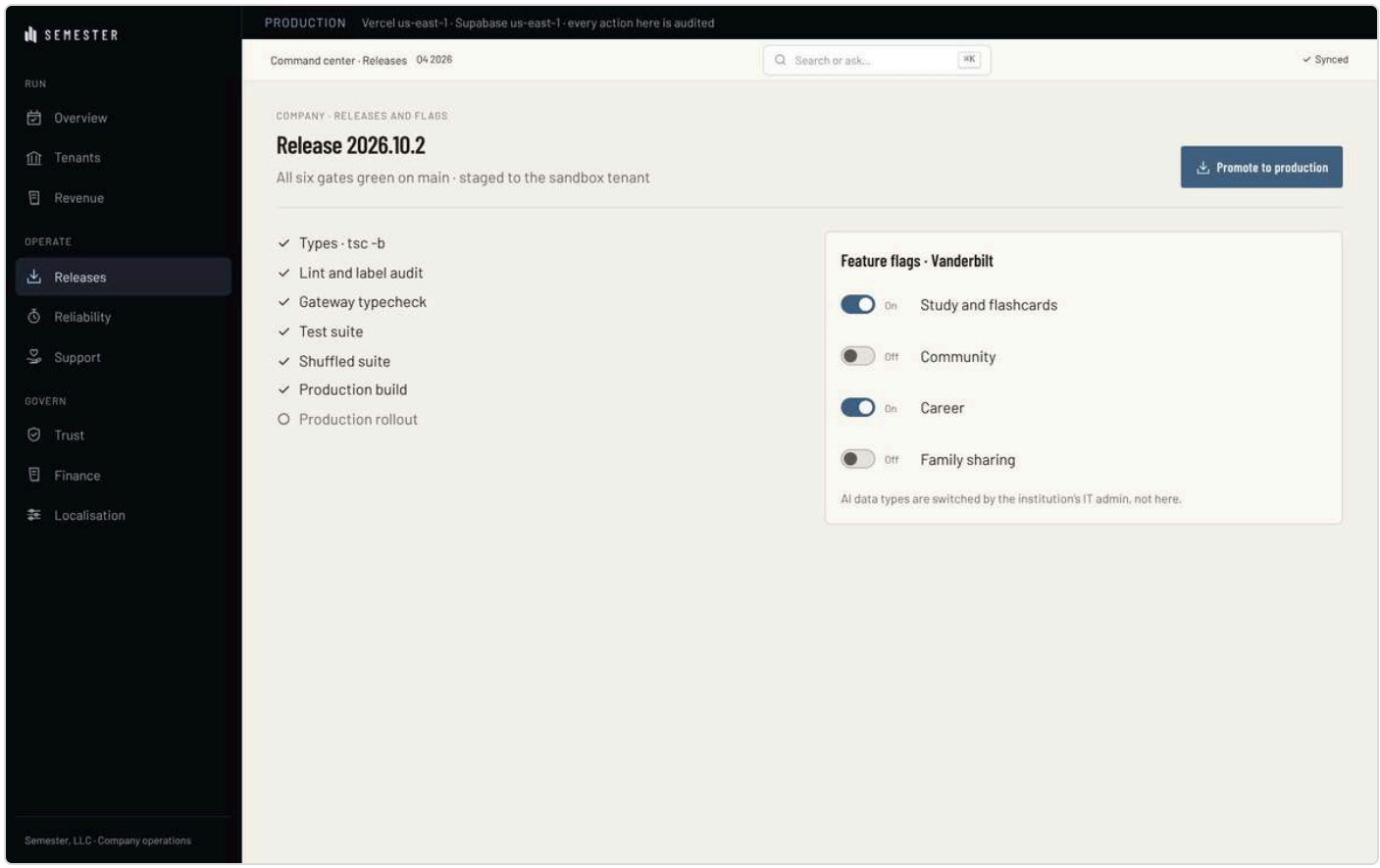
Opening view


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Institutions on Semester
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CONTRACT
USERS
STATUS
Vanderbilt University
Paid pilot · signed
—
Start date not set
Sandbox · Northfield (sample)
Internal
1,240 sample
Live
Data region
US · us-east-1
Sign-in
SAML SSO · not yet tested
LMS
Brightspace · read-only planned
AI data types on
None until IT enables them
Records
Real student records from day one
Pilot contract signed
Founder + university
DPA / FERPA addendum
University counsel
HECVAT Full review
University IT security
SSO test
University IdP team
Start date set
Both

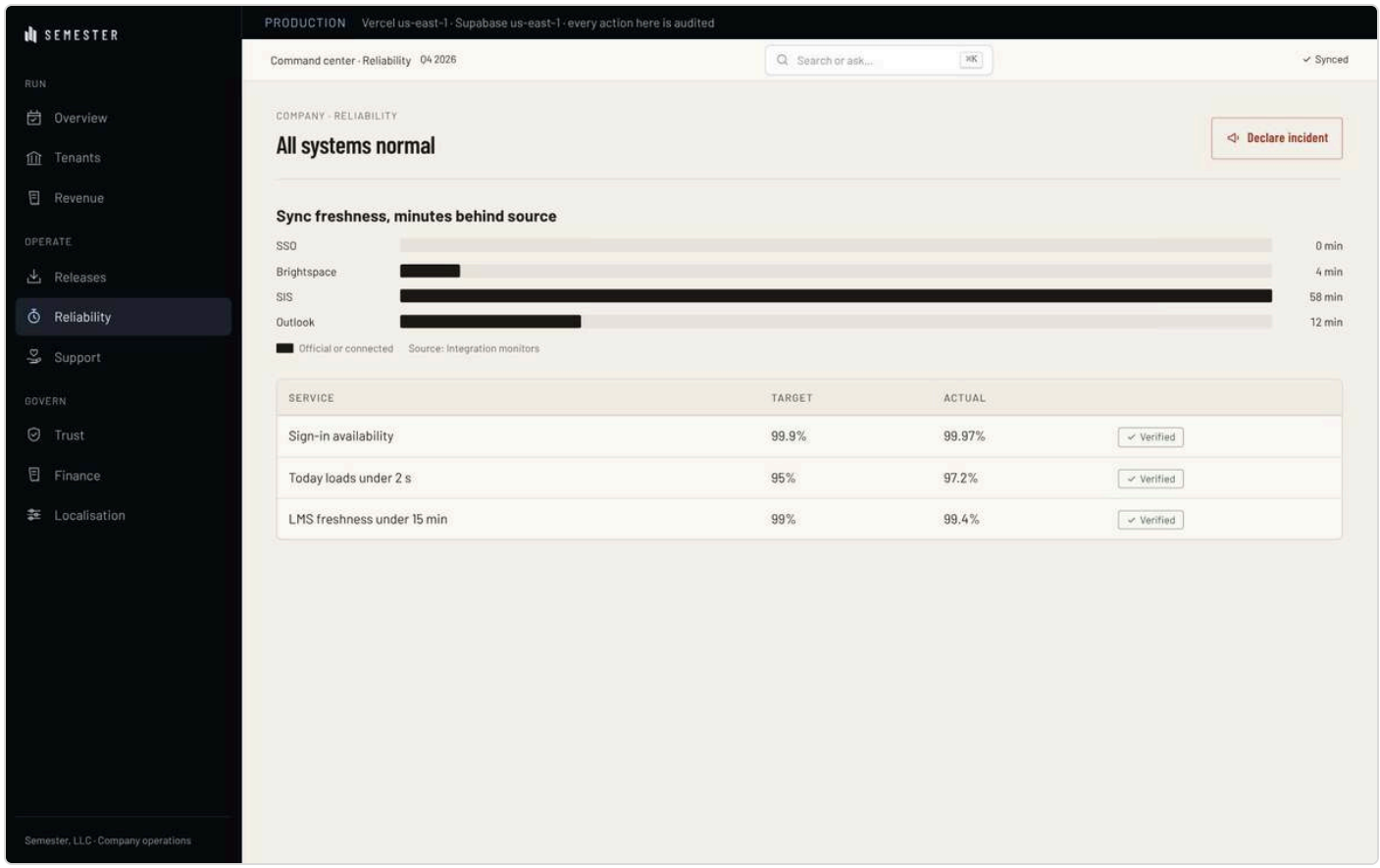
Tenants


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Command center · Revenue 04 2026
Search or ask... ⌘K
Synced
COMPANY · REVENUE AND PIPELINE
Pipeline
Amounts are sample figures until invoices exist.
INSTITUTION
STAGE
NEXT STEP
ANNUAL VALUE
Vanderbilt University
Signed pilot
Clear 6 blockers
Pilot fee
Regional university A
Discovery
Demo with registrar
$60,000
Community college B
Intro
Send buyer deck
$24,000
PRICE MODEL
Per student per year
Student entered
Pricing draft
AI COST CEILING
$0.40 per active student / mo
≈ Estimated
Spend meter target
Sample
Pipeline figures are illustrative

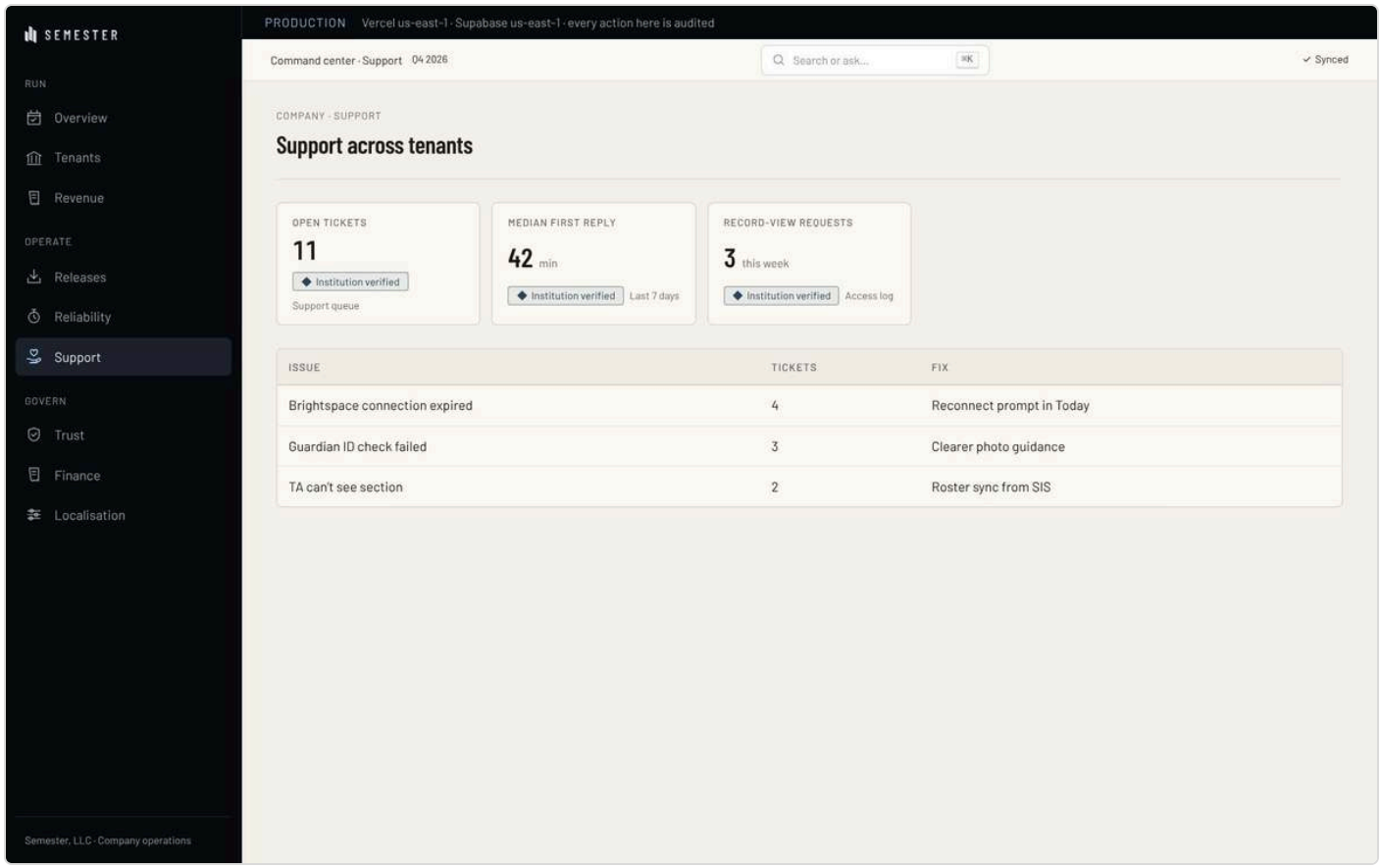
Revenue


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Semester, LLC · Company operations
PRODUCTION Vercel us-east-1 · Supabase us-east-1 · every action here is audited
Command center · Releases 04 2026
Search or ask...
⌘K
Synced
COMPANY · RELEASES AND FLAGS
Release 2026.10.2
All six gates green on main · staged to the sandbox tenant
Promote to production
Types · tsc -b
Lint and label audit
Gateway typecheck
Test suite
Shuffled suite
Production build
Production rollout
Feature flags · Vanderbilt
On Study and flashcards
Off Community
On Career
Off Family sharing
AI data types are switched by the institution's IT admin, not here.

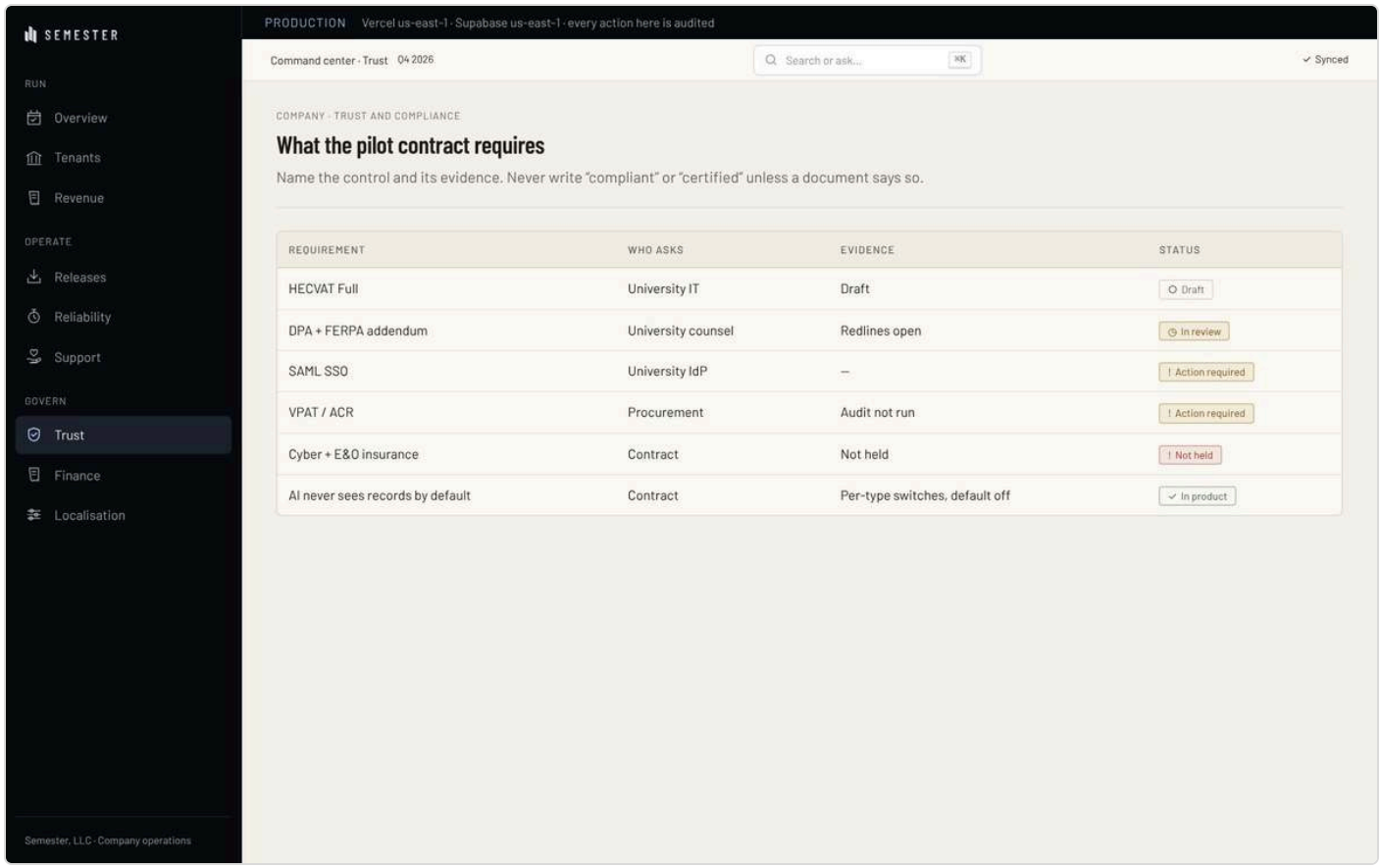
Releases



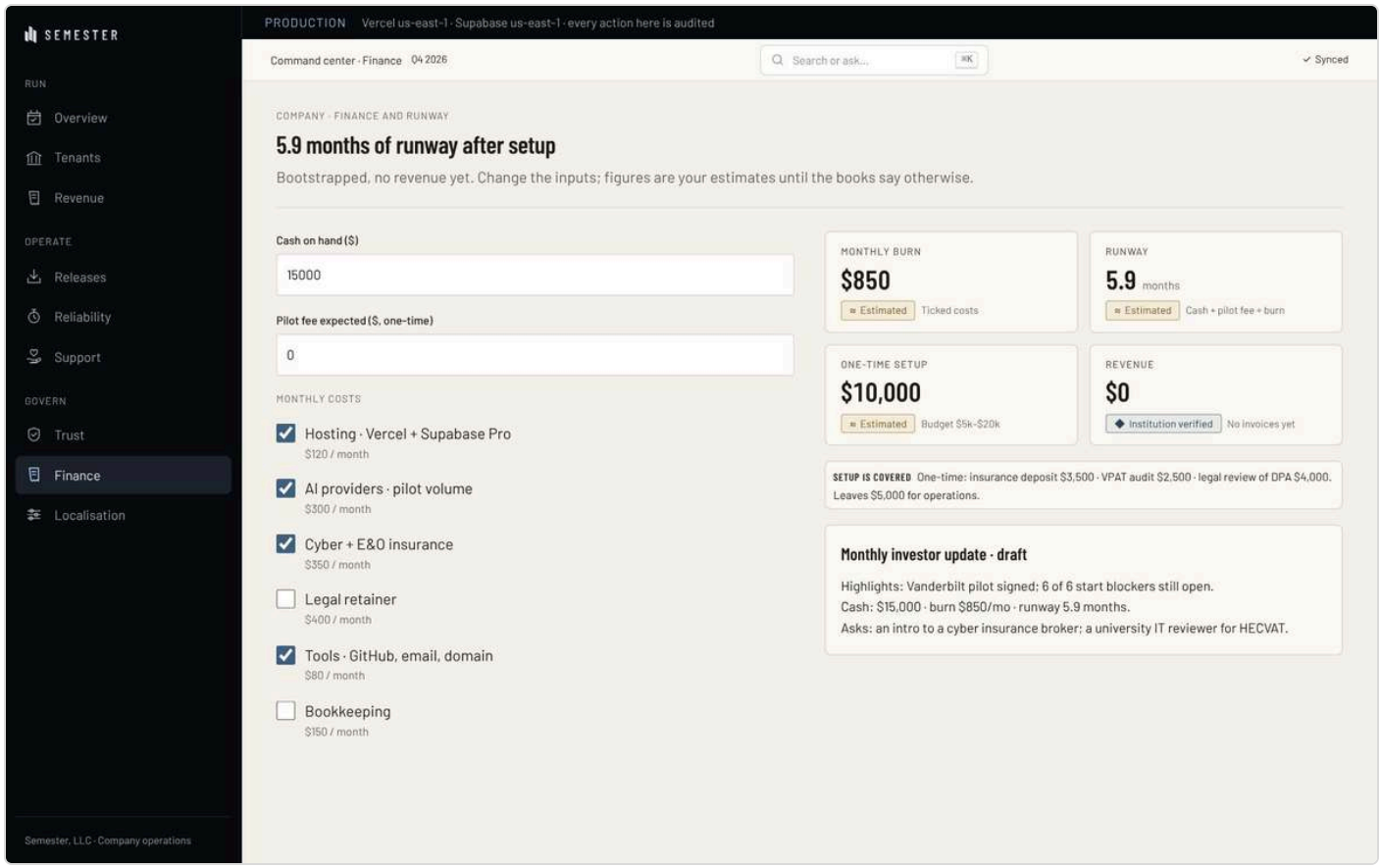
Reliability


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Semester, LLC · Company operations
PRODUCTION Vercel us-east-1 · Supabase us-east-1 · every action here is audited
Command center · Support 04 2026
Search or ask... ⌘K
Synced
COMPANY · SUPPORT
Support across tenants
OPEN TICKETS
11
Institution verified
Support queue
MEDIAN FIRST REPLY
42 min
Institution verified Last 7 days
RECORD-VIEW REQUESTS
3 this week
Institution verified Access log
ISSUE
TICKETS
FIX
Brightspace connection expired
4
Reconnect prompt in Today
Guardian ID check failed
3
Clearer photo guidance
TA can't see section
2
Roster sync from SIS

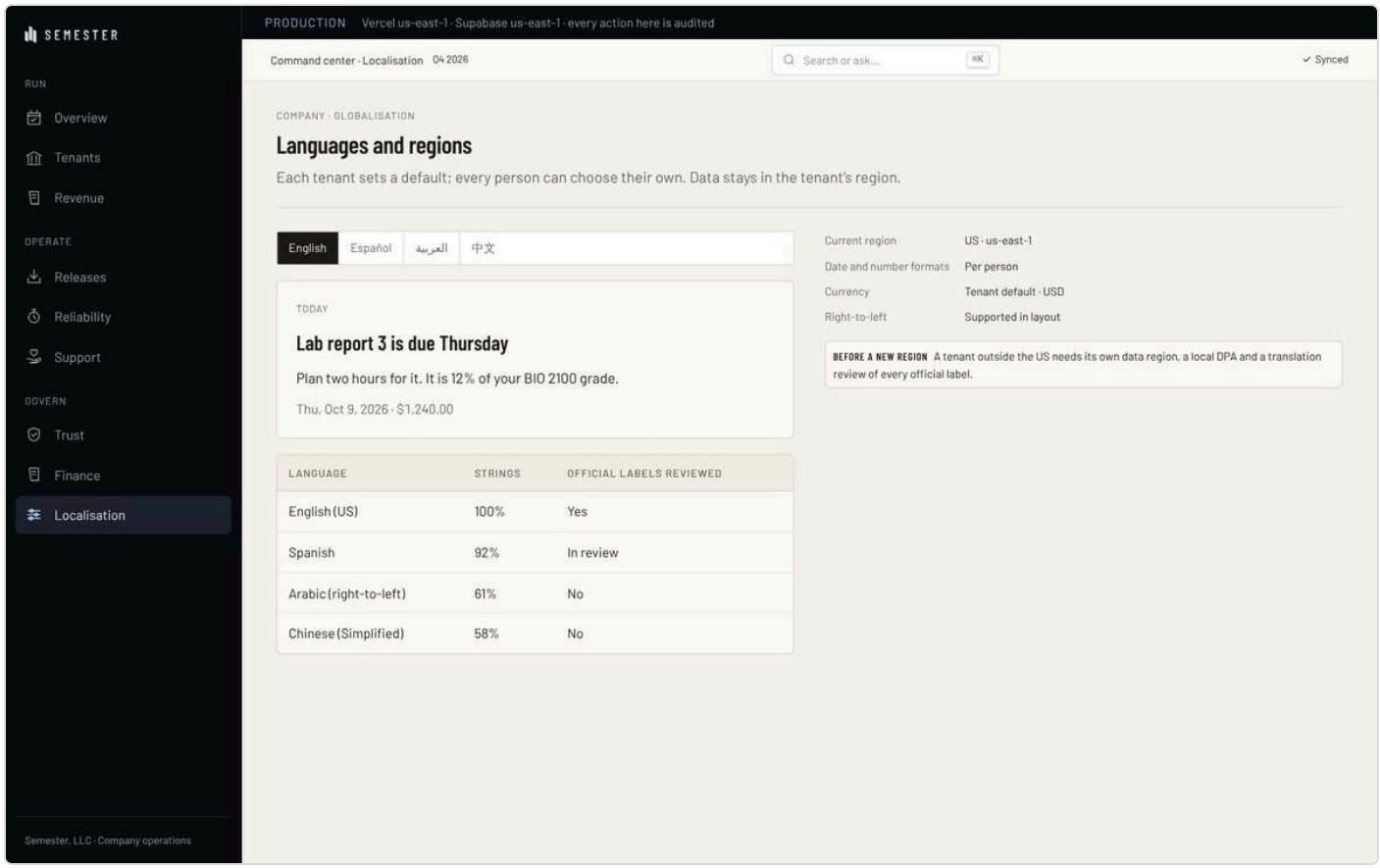
Support


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Semester, LLC · Company operations
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Command center · Trust 04 2026
Search or ask... ⌘K
Synced
COMPANY · TRUST AND COMPLIANCE
What the pilot contract requires
Name the control and its evidence. Never write "compliant" or "certified" unless a document says so.
REQUIREMENT
WHO ASKS
EVIDENCE
STATUS
HECVAT Full
University IT
Draft
Draft
DPA + FERPA addendum
University counsel
Redlines open
In review
SAML SSO
University IdP
–
! Action required
VPAT / ACR
Procurement
Audit not run
! Action required
Cyber + E&O insurance
Contract
Not held
! Not held
AI never sees records by default
Contract
Per-type switches, default off
In product

Trust


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PRODUCTION Vercel us-east-1 · Supabase us-east-1 · every action here is audited
Command center · Finance 04 2026
Search or ask... ⌘K
✓ Synced
COMPANY · FINANCE AND RUNWAY
5.9 months of runway after setup
Bootstrapped, no revenue yet. Change the inputs; figures are your estimates until the books say otherwise.
Cash on hand ($)
15000
Pilot fee expected ($, one-time)
0
MONTHLY COSTS
Hosting · Vercel + Supabase Pro
$120 / month
AI providers · pilot volume
$300 / month
Cyber + E&O insurance
$350 / month
Legal retainer
$400 / month
Tools · GitHub, email, domain
$80 / month
Bookkeeping
$150 / month
MONTHLY BURN
$850
≈ Estimated Ticked costs
RUNWAY
5.9 months
≈ Estimated Cash + pilot fee ÷ burn
ONE-TIME SETUP
$10,000
≈ Estimated Budget $5k–$20k
REVENUE
$0
Institution verified No invoices yet
SETUP IS COVERED One-time: insurance deposit $3,500 · VPAT audit $2,500 · legal review of DPA $4,000. Leaves $5,000 for operations.
Monthly investor update · draft
Highlights: Vanderbilt pilot signed; 6 of 6 start blockers still open.
Cash: $15,000 · burn $850/mo · runway 5.9 months.
Asks: an intro to a cyber insurance broker; a university IT reviewer for HECVAT.

Finance



Localisation

Operations console data

Every console, role and institution configuration modelled in the operations prototype.

Operations consoles — ui_kits/ops/consoles-data.js

ROLES

CEO, CFO, Finance Analyst, Comms Lead, Social Manager, Head of Sales, RevOps, CS Manager, Support Lead, T&S Lead, General Counsel, People Ops, Security Lead, Data Lead, Partnerships Lead

ALL

CEO, CFO, Finance Analyst, Comms Lead, Social Manager, Head of Sales, RevOps, CS Manager, Support Lead, T&S Lead, General Counsel, People Ops, Security Lead, Data Lead, Partnerships Lead

Inst

Halden State University, Ridgeway Community College, Northmere University, Coastline Tech, St. Aurel College, Valewood University, Pinecrest CC, Marrow Institute, Eastbrook University, Lakeshore College, Oakvale State, Brightwater CC

CONSOLES

Social media control

Id: social

Group: Brand & growth

Name: Social media control

Sub: Every Semester channel in one place: replies, scheduling, approvals and brand safety.

Roles: CEO, Comms Lead, Social Manager

Actions:

- **L:** Compose post
  K: p
  A: compose
- **L:** Crisis mode
  K: r
  A: crisis

Tabs:

- **Id:** inbox
  Name: Unified inbox
  Kpis:
  - Open threads, 47, +12 today, dn
  - Median first reply, 38 min, −9 min, up
  - Sentiment, +0.41, +0.06 wk, up
  - Escalated, 3, 2 to Support, dn

  Filter:
  Field: Channel
  Opts: All, LinkedIn, X, Instagram, TikTok, YouTube, Threads
  Search: True
  Cols: Channel, From, Message, Sentiment, Status, Age
  Rows:
  - LinkedIn, Dean of Students, Halden State, Can Semester integrate with our Banner SIS before spring term?, ~ok:Positive, ~info:Routed · Sales, 12m
  - X, @campus_it_ops, Login loop on the mobile app since this morning?, ~bad:Negative, ~warn:Escalated · Support, 24m
  - Instagram, @ridgewaycc, Love the new study planner! Can we repost?, ~ok:Positive, ~info:Needs reply, 41m
  - TikTok, @studytok_sam, Is the AI tutor allowed to write my essay?, ~warn:Neutral, ~info:Needs reply · policy macro, 1h
  - YouTube, EdTech Weekly, Interview request for your accessibility work, ~ok:Positive, ~info:Routed · Comms, 2h
  - X, @privacy_watch_ed, What data does Semester share with AI vendors?, ~warn:Neutral, ~warn:Needs Legal-approved reply, 2h
  - Threads, @northmere_u, Co-post for orientation week confirmed for Tue, ~ok:Positive, ~ok:Resolved, 3h
  - LinkedIn, Registrar, Coastline Tech, Who do we contact about FERPA DPA renewal?, ~warn:Neutral, ~info:Routed · Legal, 4h

  Row Actions: Reply, Assign, Route to Support, Mark resolved
- **Id:** cal
  Name: Calendar
  Type: calendar
- **Id:** appr
  Name: Approval queue
  Kpis:
  - Waiting, 9, 3 due today, dn
  - Avg approval time, 2.1 h, −0.4 h, up
  - Rejected this week, 2, ,
  - Legal review, 3, ,

  Cols: Post, Channels, Author, Scheduled, Checks, Status
  Rows:

- Spring term planner launch, LinkedIn · X · IG, Maya R., Tue 09:00, ~ok:Brand ✓ Access ✓, ~warn:Needs Comms Lead
- Halden State case study, LinkedIn, Jon P., Wed 11:00, ~warn:Partner logo approval, ~warn:Waiting on partner
- AI tutor: what it will and won't do, X · Threads · TikTok, Maya R., Thu 15:00, ~ai:Policy claim, ~warn:Needs Legal
- Accessibility month reel, IG · TikTok · YT, Dee K., Fri 12:00, ~ok:Captions ✓ Alt text ✓, ~info:Ready
- Finals week reminder, All, Auto, Mon 08:00, ~bad:Tone check failed, ~bad:Returned

Row Actions: Approve, Request changes, Reject, Preview

- **Id:** safety

  Name: Brand safety

  Type: panels

  Panels:

  - Keyword watchlist, data breach FERPA lawsuit outage cheating AI wrote refund
  - Crisis playbook, <ol style="margin:0;padding-left:18px;line-height:1.7">
Pause every scheduled post (one click)
Page Comms Lead, General Counsel and Security Lead
Post the holding statement from the approved library
Route all mentions to Comms Lead for triage
Hourly update until status page is green
  - Approved statements, Outagev4 · Legal ✓Data incidentv2 · Legal ✓ · Security ✓AI misusev3 · Legal ✓Price changeDraft
  - Who can post, Comms LeadPublish · approve · crisis modeSocial ManagerDraft · schedule · replyPartnersCo-post requests onlyEveryone elseRead only

- **Id:** ana

  Name: Analytics

  Type: charts

  Kpis:

  - Followers, 184.2k, +3.1% mo, up
  - Engagement rate, 4.8%, +0.6 pt, up
  - Site clicks, 12.9k, +18%, up
  - Demo requests from social, 64, +11, up

  Bars:

  - LinkedIn, 92
  - Instagram, 71
  - TikTok, 64
  - X, 38
  - YouTube, 29
  - Threads, 17

  Spark: 22, 30, 28, 35, 40, 38, 46, 52, 49, 58, 61, 70

- **Id:** co

  Name: Partner co-posts

  Cols: Institution, Campaign, Their approver, Assets, Status

  Rows:

  - Northmere University, Orientation week, Marketing Director, 4/4, ~ok:Live
  - Halden State University, Case study, VP Communications, 2/3, ~warn:Logo pending
  - Ridgeway Community College, Planner launch, Social Coordinator, 3/3, ~info:Scheduled
  - Valewood University, Accessibility month, Disability Services, 0/2, ~warn:Brief sent

  Row Actions: Open brief, Send reminder

Finance console

Id: finance

Group: Finance

Name: Finance console

Sub: Revenue, billing, collections, costs and month-end close.

Roles: CEO, CFO, Finance Analyst

Actions:

- **L:** Export for audit
  K:
  A: toast:Audit pack queued · ready in about 2 min
- **L:** New invoice
  K: p
  A: toast:Invoice draft created

Tabs:

- **Id:** ov
  Name: Overview
  Type: charts
  Kpis:
  - ARR, $14.2M, +38% YoY, up
  - MRR, $1.18M, +2.9% MoM, up
  - Net revenue retention, 124%, +3 pt, up
  - Gross margin, 78.4%, −0.8 pt (AI cost), dn
  - Cash runway, 31 mo, ,
  - DSO, 46 days, +4, dn

  Bars:
  - Platform, 62
  - Seats, 21
  - AI usage, 11
  - Services, 6

  Bar Unit: %
  Spark: 49.199999999999996, 51.6, 53.4, 54.6, 57, 58.8, 60.6, 62.400000000000006, 64.2, 66, 69, 70.8
- **Id:** inv
  Name: Invoices & AR
  Kpis:
  - Outstanding, $2.41M, ,
  - Over 60 days, $318k, 4 accounts, dn
  - Collected (mo), $1.06M, ,
  - Disputed, $42k, 1 account, dn

  Filter:
  Field: Aging
  Opts: All, Current, 1–30, 31–60, 61–90, 90+
  Search: True
  Cols: Invoice, Institution, Amount, Due, Aging, Status
  Rows:
  - INV-26410, Halden State University, $184,100, Oct 3, Current, ~ok:Paid
  - INV-26411, Ridgeway Community College, $92,137, Oct 5, 1–30, ~info:Sent
  - INV-26412, Northmere University, $240,174, Oct 7, 31–60, ~warn:Reminder 2
  - INV-26413, Coastline Tech, $61,211, Oct 9, Current, ~info:Sent
  - INV-26414, St. Aurel College, $38,248, Oct 11, 61–90, ~bad:Escalated
  - INV-26415, Valewood University, $155,285, Oct 13, Current, ~ok:Paid
  - INV-26416, Pinecrest CC, $44,322, Oct 15, 90+, ~bad:Disputed

- INV-26417, Marrow Institute, $72,359, Oct 17, 1–30, ~info:Sent
- INV-26418, Eastbrook University, $128,396, Oct 19, Current, ~info:Sent
- INV-26419, Lakeshore College, $51,433, Oct 21, 31–60, ~warn:Reminder 1
- INV-26420, Oakvale State, $96,470, Oct 23, Current, ~ok:Paid
- INV-26421, Brightwater CC, $33,507, Oct 25, 1–30, ~info:Sent

Row Actions: Send reminder, Record payment, Open contract, Escalate to CS

- **Id:** ren

  Name: Contracts & renewals

  Cols: Institution, ACV, Term ends, Health, Expansion, Status

  Rows:

  - Halden State University, $420k, Dec 2026, ~ok:Healthy, +AI tier, ~info:Proposal sent
  - Ridgeway Community College, $180k, Jan 2027, ~warn:Watch, —, ~warn:Procurement
  - Northmere University, $610k, Mar 2027, ~ok:Healthy, +2 campuses, ~info:Early talks
  - Coastline Tech, $95k, Nov 2026, ~bad:At risk, —, ~bad:Exec save plan
  - St. Aurel College, $70k, Feb 2027, ~ok:Healthy, +Seats, ~info:Not started
  - Valewood University, $330k, Jun 2027, ~ok:Healthy, +AI tier, ~ok:Signed
  - Pinecrest CC, $88k, Oct 2026, ~warn:Watch, —, ~warn:Board vote
  - Marrow Institute, $140k, Aug 2027, ~ok:Healthy, —, ~info:Not started

  Row Actions: Open contract, Draft renewal, Flag to CS

- **Id:** use

  Name: Usage billing

  Cols: Institution, Active seats, Seat cap, AI tutor minutes, AI overage, Bill preview

  Rows:

  - Halden State University, 18,240, 20,000, 412k, ~ok:Within plan, $38.0k
  - Ridgeway Community College, 6,120, 6,000, 88k, ~warn:Over cap, $14.7k
  - Northmere University, 24,800, 25,000, 530k, ~ok:Within plan, $51.4k
  - Coastline Tech, 3,900, 5,000, 61k, ~ok:Within plan, $8.1k
  - St. Aurel College, 2,100, 2,500, 22k, ~ok:Within plan, $4.8k
  - Valewood University, 11,400, 12,000, 240k, ~ok:Within plan, $26.5k
  - Pinecrest CC, 2,800, 3,000, 40k, ~ok:Within plan, $6.2k
  - Marrow Institute, 5,300, 5,000, 96k, ~warn:Over cap, $13.9k

  Row Actions: Preview invoice, Notify institution

- **Id:** ai

  Name: AI cost

  Type: charts

  Kpis:

  - AI spend (mo), $96.4k, +14%, dn
  - Cost per active student, $0.61, −$0.05, up
  - Cache hit rate, 42%, +6 pt, up
  - Budget used, 71%, Ahead of pace, dn

  Bars:

  - Tutor, 54
  - Study plans, 18
  - Summaries, 14
  - Moderation, 9
  - Search, 5

  Bar Unit: %

  Spark: 40, 44, 47, 52, 55, 58, 63, 66, 70, 74, 79, 84

- **Id:** close

  Name: Month-end close

  Type: checklist

Items:

- Revenue recognition run, Finance Analyst, 1
- AR aging reviewed, Finance Analyst, 1
- AI vendor invoices matched, Finance Analyst, 1
- Payroll accrual booked, People Ops, 0
- Deferred revenue roll-forward, CFO, 0
- Bank reconciliations (3 accounts), Finance Analyst, 0
- Flux review >10%, CFO, 0
- Board pack draft, CFO, 0

- **Id:** pay
  Name: Payroll summary
  Role Only: CEO, CFO
  Kpis:
  - Headcount, 142, +6 qtr, up
  - Monthly payroll, $2.05M, ,
  - Contractors, 11, ,
  - Next run, Oct 15, ,

  Cols: Department, Headcount, Monthly cost, vs budget
  Rows:
  - Engineering, 61, $1.01M, ~ok:−2%
  - Go-to-market, 38, $0.52M, ~warn:+4%
  - Customer success, 19, $0.21M, ~ok:0%
  - G&A, 14, $0.19M, ~ok:−1%
  - Product & design, 10, $0.12M, ~ok:0%

Marketing & campaigns

Id: mkt

Group: Brand & growth

Name: Marketing & campaigns

Sub: Campaigns, budget and pipeline they produce.

Roles: CEO, Comms Lead, Head of Sales

Actions:

- **L:** Export
  K:
  A: toast:Export queued

Tabs:

- **Id:** main
  Name: Queue
  Kpis:
  - Active campaigns, 7, ,
  - Spend (qtr), $412k, 68% of budget,
  - MQLs, 1,284, +22%, up
  - Pipeline sourced, $3.9M, +$0.6M, up

  Cols: Campaign, Channel, Spend, MQLs, CAC, Status
  Rows:
  - Spring term readiness, Paid search, $84k, 312, $269, ~ok:Live
  - Registrar roundtable, Events, $61k, 88, $693, ~info:Planning
  - Accessibility month, Social · PR, $22k, 140, $157, ~ok:Live
  - CIO webinar series, Webinar, $18k, 206, $87, ~ok:Live
  - Community college tour, Field, $96k, 74, $1,297, ~warn:Over budget

  Row Actions: Pause, Edit budget, View attribution
  Search: True

Sales & RevOps

Id: sales

Group: Revenue

Name: Sales & RevOps

Sub: Pipeline, forecast and deal desk.

Roles: CEO, CFO, Head of Sales, RevOps

Actions:

- **L:** Export
  K:
  A: toast:Export queued

Tabs:

- **Id:** main
  Name: Queue
  Kpis:
  - Pipeline, $18.6M, ,
  - Commit (qtr), $2.4M, 92% of target, up
  - Win rate, 31%, +3 pt, up
  - Avg cycle, 118 days, −9, up

  Cols: Deal, Institution, Stage, Amount, Close, Owner
  Rows:
  - Systemwide AI tier, Oakvale State, Negotiation, $640k, Nov 14, R. Osei
  - Pilot → full, Lakeshore College, Proposal, $210k, Dec 2, L. Brandt
  - 3 campuses, Eastbrook University, Procurement, $880k, Jan 20, R. Osei
  - New logo, Brightwater CC, Discovery, $95k, Feb 28, M. Chen
  - Expansion seats, Valewood University, Verbal, ~ok:$140k, Oct 30, L. Brandt

  Row Actions: Open deal, Deal desk review, Update forecast
  Search: True

Customer success

Id: cs

Group: Customers

Name: Customer success

Sub: Health, adoption and renewal risk for every institution.

Roles: CEO, CS Manager, Head of Sales

Actions:

- **L:** Export
  K:
  A: toast:Export queued

Tabs:

- **Id:** main
  Name: Queue
  Kpis:
  - Accounts, 86, ,
  - Healthy, 71, 83%, up
  - At risk, 6, $1.1M ARR, dn
  - Avg weekly active, 64%, +5 pt, up

  Cols: Institution, CSM, Health, Weekly active, Open tickets, Next step
  Rows:
  - Halden State University, A. Ruiz, ~ok:92, 71%, 2, QBR Oct 22
  - Ridgeway Community College, B. Lowe, ~warn:64, 52%, 5, Adoption plan
  - Northmere University, A. Ruiz, ~ok:88, 68%, 1, Expansion call
  - Coastline Tech, K. Imani, ~bad:41, 29%, 9, Exec save plan
  - St. Aurel College, B. Lowe, ~ok:79, 66%, 0, —
  - Valewood University, K. Imani, ~ok:85, 70%, 3, Training
  - Pinecrest CC, A. Ruiz, ~warn:58, 47%, 6, Champion left
  - Marrow Institute, B. Lowe, ~ok:81, 63%, 2, QBR Nov 4
  - Eastbrook University, K. Imani, ~ok:90, 74%, 1, Case study

  Row Actions: Open account, Log touchpoint, Start save plan
  Search: True

Support desk

Id: support

Group: Customers

Name: Support desk

Sub: Tickets from institution staff, by queue and SLA. Student issues arrive through the institution.

Roles: Support Lead, CS Manager, CEO

Actions:

- **L:** Export
  K:
  A: toast:Export queued

Tabs:

- **Id:** main
  Name: Queue
  Kpis:
  - Open, 132, ,
  - SLA breaches, 4, , dn
  - First response, 22 min, −6, up
  - CSAT, 4.7, +0.1, up

  Cols: Ticket, Institution, Topic, Priority, SLA, Status
  Rows:
  - #58213, Halden State University, SIS grade sync delay, ~bad:P1, ~bad:Breached 12m, ~warn:Engineering
  - #58207, Coastline Tech, SSO certificate rotation, ~warn:P2, 2h left, ~info:In progress
  - #58199, Pinecrest CC, Bulk course import CSV, ~info:P3, 1d, ~info:Waiting on customer
  - #58190, Northmere University, Caption export format, P4, 3d, ~ok:Solved

  Row Actions: Assign, Escalate, Macro reply, Solve
  Search: True

Trust & safety · community

Id: tns

Group: Trust

Name: Trust & safety · community

Sub: Reports, community health and marketplace operations. People are shown as pseudonyms.

Roles: T&S Lead, General Counsel, CS Manager

Actions:

- **L:** Export
  K:
  A: toast:Export queued

Tabs:

- **Id:** main
  Name: Queue
  Kpis:
  - Reports open, 58, ,
  - Median action, 3.4 h, −0.8, up
  - Appeals, 6, ,
  - AI pre-screen precision, 93%, +1 pt, up

  Cols: Case, Type, Surface, AI flag, Reviewer, Status
  Rows:
  - TS-9921, Harassment, Course discussion, ~ai:0.91, J. Moss, ~warn:In review
  - TS-9918, Academic integrity, Shared notes, ~ai:0.74, —, ~info:Queued
  - TS-9913, Spam, Group chat, ~ai:0.98, Auto, ~ok:Removed
  - TS-9902, Self-harm signal, Tutor chat, ~bad:Urgent, L. Park, ~bad:Escalated to institution

  Row Actions: Take action, Escalate, Dismiss, Open appeal
  Search: True
- **Id:** health
  Name: Community health
  Type: charts
  Kpis:
  - Weekly active posters, 2,140, +9%, up
  - Report rate, 0.6%, −0.1 pt, up
  - Groups, 318, +12,
  - Median time to remove, 41 min, −12, up

  Bars:
  - Course groups, 46
  - Clubs, 28
  - Campus feed, 14
  - Q&A, 8
  - Events, 4

  Bar Unit: %
  Spark: 30, 34, 33, 38, 41, 45, 44, 49, 53, 55, 58, 62
- **Id:** mkt
  Name: Marketplace ops
  Kpis:
  - Live listings, 1,206, ,
  - On hold, 14, integrity / safety, dn
  - Disputes open, 5, ,
  - GMV (mo, sample), $48.2k, +16%, up

  Filter:
  Field: Status

Opts: All, On hold, Disputed, Live

Search: True

Cols: Listing, Category, Seller, Flag, Price, Status

Rows:

- Intro Psych notes, Textbooks, User-4821, ~ai:Integrity 0.62, $10, On hold
- Spring sublet 1BR, Housing, User-1177, ~warn:Off-platform payment ask, $780/mo, On hold
- TI-84 calculator, Gear, User-3390, ~warn:Buyer: not as described, $60, Disputed
- Exam 2 answer key, Textbooks, User-0952, ~bad:Prohibited, $15, Removed
- Homecoming tickets ×2, Tickets, User-2204, ~ok:Face value ✓, $30, Live
- Live drop: lab coats, Gear, Campus Bookstore, ~ok:Official seller, $42, Live

Row Actions: Approve, Keep on hold, Remove, Refund buyer, Message seller

- **Id:** drops

  Name: Live drops

  Cols: Drop, Seller, Starts, Watchers, Reserve, Status

  Rows:

  - Lab coat surplus, Campus Bookstore, Live now, 9, $30, ~bad:LIVE
  - Club merch, Robotics Society, Oct 8 18:00, 44, —, ~info:Scheduled
  - Furniture swap, Housing Office, Oct 20 10:00, 120, —, ~warn:Needs approval

  Row Actions: Approve, Pause, End early

- **Id:** cfg

  Name: Institution settings

  Type: panels

  Panels:

  - Features on (Vanderbilt pilot), Campus feedOnGroups & eventsOnQ&AOnMarketplaceOn · campus verifiedLive dropsOfficial sellers onlyDMsMessage requests required
  - Policy, <ul style="margin:0;padding-left:18px;line-height:1.7">
No sale of graded work, exams or answer keys
No off-platform payments
Housing listings need an address check
Users under 18 can’t use the marketplace
Payments run through a licensed processor

Legal & compliance

Id: legal

Group: Trust

Name: Legal & compliance

Sub: Contracts, DPAs, FERPA and subprocessors.

Roles: General Counsel, CEO, Security Lead

Actions:

- **L:** Export
  K:
  A: toast:Export queued

Tabs:

- **Id:** main
  Name: Queue
  Kpis:
  - Active DPAs, 86, ,
  - Renewals in 90d, 11, ,
  - Subprocessors, 14, 1 pending, dn
  - Open data requests, 3, ,

  Cols: Item, Counterparty, Type, Owner, Due, Status
  Rows:
  - DPA renewal, Coastline Tech, FERPA DPA, GC, Nov 1, ~warn:Redlines
  - New subprocessor notice, AI vendor B, Subprocessor, GC, Oct 18, ~info:30-day notice out
  - State privacy addendum, Oakvale State, Addendum, GC, Oct 25, ~info:Drafting
  - Records request, Halden State, Institution request, Privacy, Oct 9, ~ok:Fulfilled

  Row Actions: Open, Assign, Mark complete
  Search: True

People ops

Id: people

Group: Company

Name: People ops

Sub: Hiring, onboarding and team health.

Roles: People Ops, CEO, CFO

Actions:

- **L:** Export
  K:
  A: toast:Export queued

Tabs:

- **Id:** main
  Name: Queue
  Kpis:
  - Open roles, 14, ,
  - Offers out, 3, ,
  - Time to hire, 34 days, −4, up
  - eNPS, +41, +6, up

  Cols: Role, Team, Stage, Candidates, Hiring manager, Status
  Rows:
  - Staff engineer, SIS, Engineering, Onsite, 4, P. Adeyemi, ~ok:On track
  - CSM, community colleges, Customer success, Screen, 11, A. Ruiz, ~ok:On track
  - Accessibility lead, Design, Offer, 1, D. Kaur, ~info:Offer out
  - Security engineer, Security, Sourcing, 2, S. Varga, ~warn:Slow

  Row Actions: Open pipeline, Schedule, Close role
  Search: True

IT & security

Id: sec

Group: Trust

Name: IT & security

Sub: Access, vulnerabilities and SOC 2 evidence.

Roles: Security Lead, CEO

Actions:

- **L:** Export
  K:
  A: toast:Export queued

Tabs:

- **Id:** main
  Name: Queue
  Kpis:
  - SOC 2 controls, 112/118, 95%, up
  - Critical vulns, 0, ,
  - Access reviews due, 2, ,
  - Devices compliant, 98%, ,

  Cols: Control, Area, Evidence, Owner, Due, Status
  Rows:
  - CC6.1 Access reviews, Access, Q3 export, S. Varga, Oct 15, ~warn:Due
  - CC7.2 Monitoring, Ops, Alert runbooks, Platform, —, ~ok:Passing
  - CC8.1 Change mgmt, Eng, PR approvals sample, P. Adeyemi, —, ~ok:Passing
  - A1.2 Backups, Ops, Restore test, Platform, Oct 30, ~info:Scheduled

  Row Actions: Upload evidence, Assign, View history
  Search: True

Data & analytics

Id: data

Group: Company

Name: Data & analytics

Sub: Company metrics, data requests and warehouse health. Aggregates only.

Roles: Data Lead, CEO, CFO

Actions:

- **L:** Export
  K:
  A: toast:Export queued

Tabs:

- **Id:** main
  Name: Queue
  Kpis:
  - Dashboards, 48, ,
  - Pipelines healthy, 31/32, , dn
  - Requests open, 9, ,
  - Freshness, 12 min, ,

  Cols: Request, Requester, Dataset, Privacy check, ETA, Status
  Rows:
  - Renewal risk model refresh, CS Manager, Account health, ~ok:Aggregate, Oct 10, ~info:In progress
  - AI cost by feature, CFO, Gateway logs, ~ok:No PII, Oct 8, ~ok:Delivered
  - Campaign attribution, Comms Lead, Web + CRM, ~ok:Aggregate, Oct 14, ~info:Queued
  - Per-student export, Unknown, Student records, ~bad:Blocked: needs institution, —, ~bad:Rejected

  Row Actions: Open, Assign, Run privacy check
  Search: True

Partnerships

Id: partners

Group: Revenue

Name: Partnerships

Sub: SIS, LMS and reseller partners.

Roles: Partnerships Lead, Head of Sales, CEO

Actions:

- **L:** Export
  K:
  A: toast:Export queued

Tabs:

- **Id:** main
  Name: Queue
  Kpis:
  - Active partners, 23, ,
  - Partner-sourced pipeline, $4.2M, +31%, up
  - Integrations certified, 17, ,
  - Co-sell deals, 12, ,

  Cols: Partner, Type, Tier, Integration, Pipeline, Status
  Rows:
  - SIS vendor A, SIS, Strategic, ~ok:Certified, $1.6M, ~ok:Active
  - LMS vendor B, LMS, Strategic, ~ok:Certified, $1.1M, ~ok:Active
  - Regional reseller C, Reseller, Select, —, $0.7M, ~info:Onboarding
  - Accessibility vendor D, Tech, Select, ~warn:In review, $0.2M, ~info:Pilot

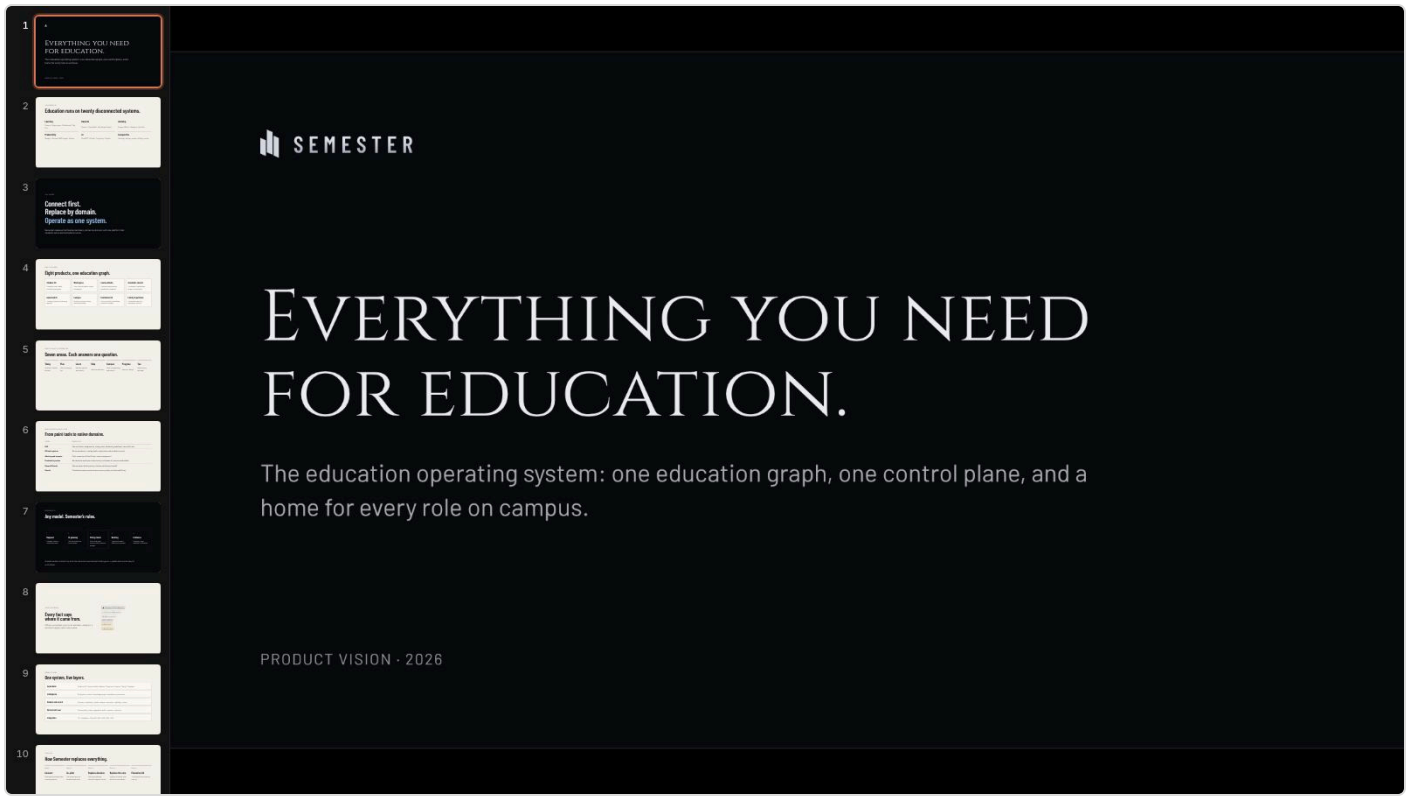
  Row Actions: Open partner, Register deal, Review certification
  Search: True

APPENDIX

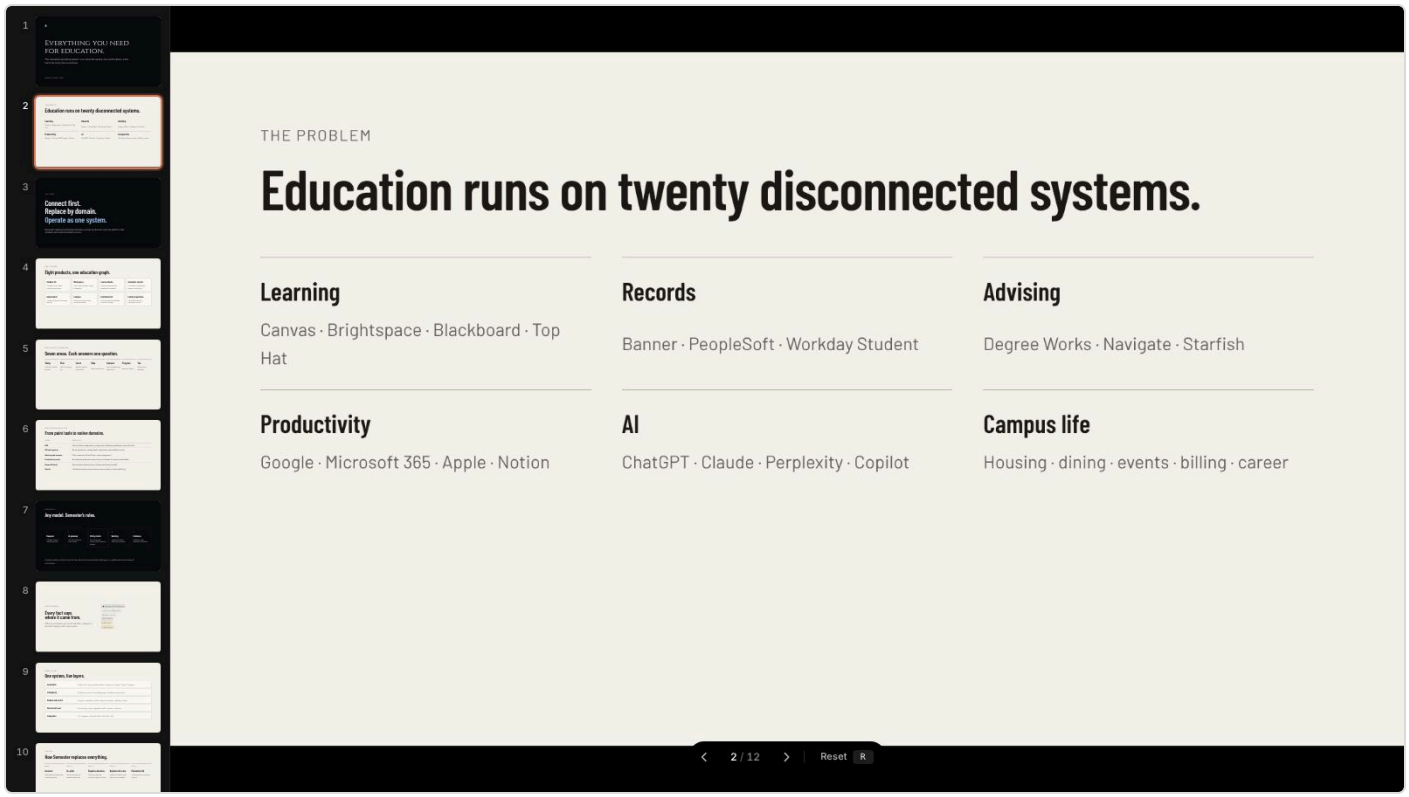
Source research

The research reports and planning documents the founder gathered while building Semester, reproduced in full.

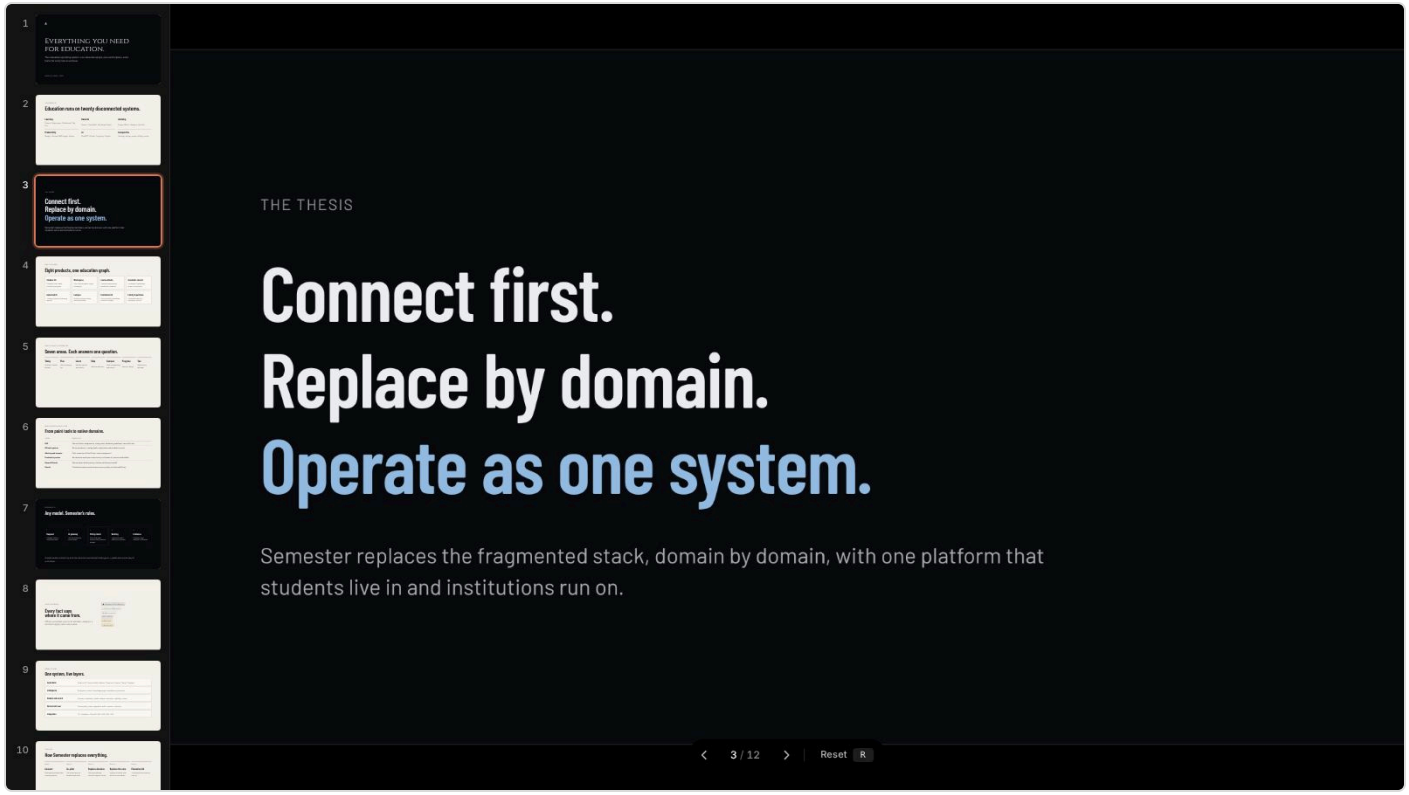
Semester Vision Deck (offline edition)



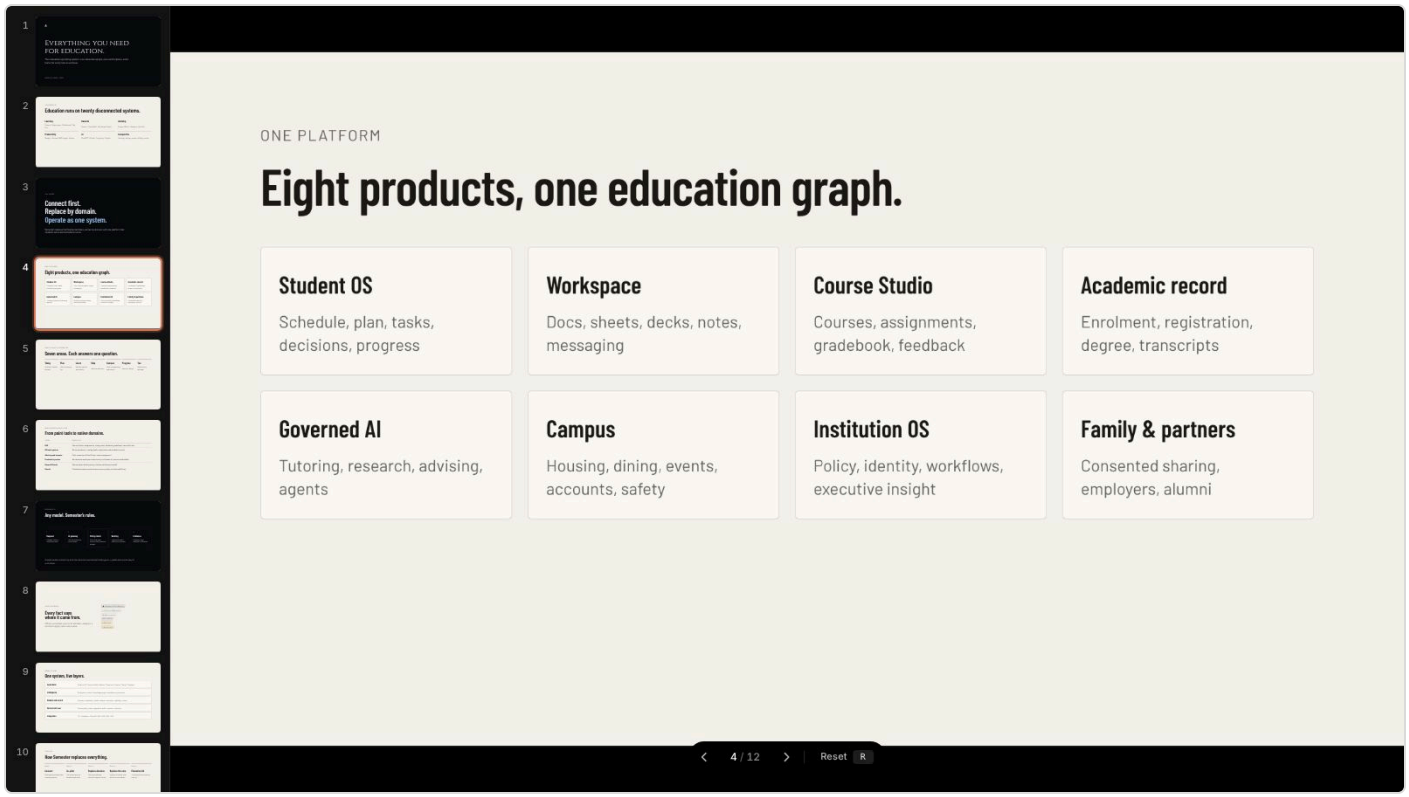
Slide 1



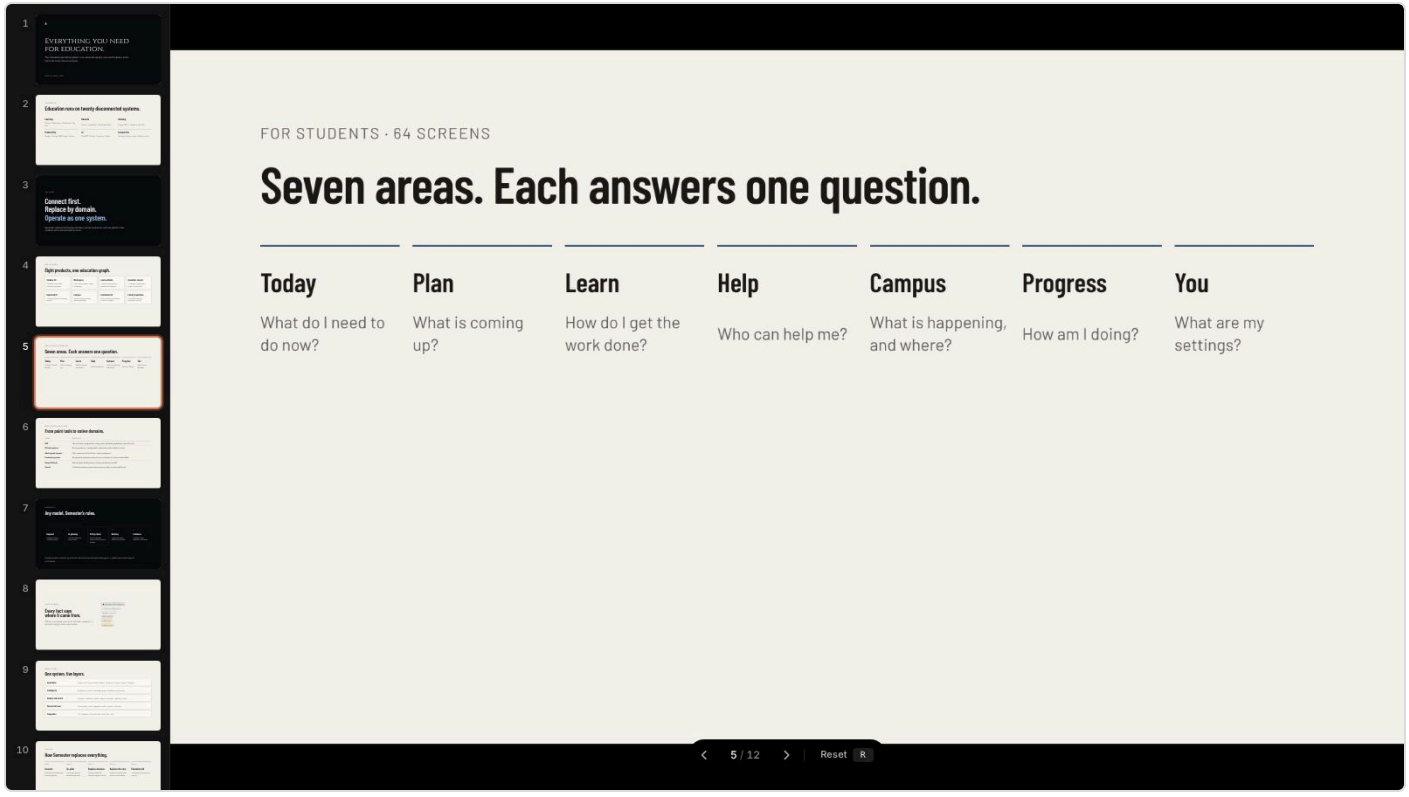
Slide 2



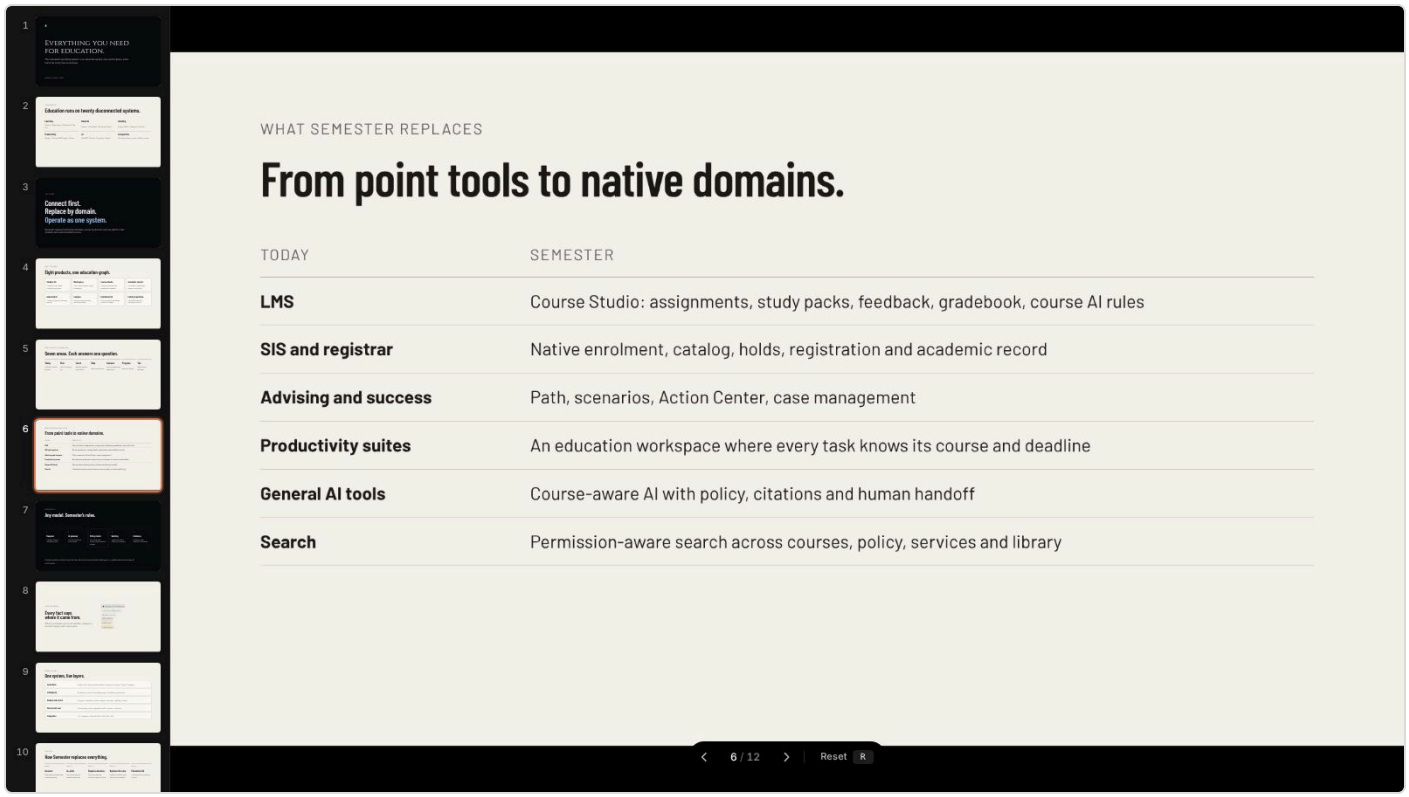
Slide 3



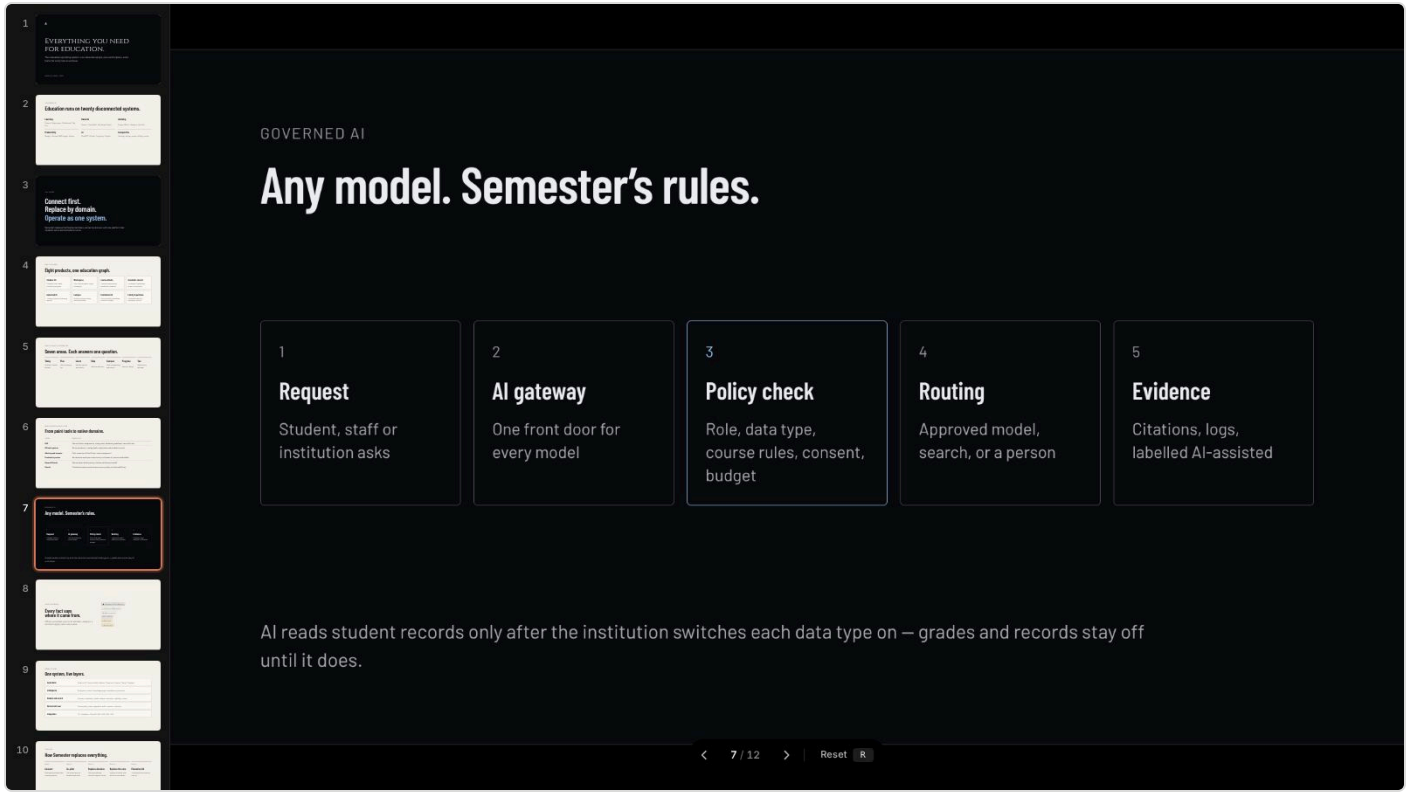
Slide 4



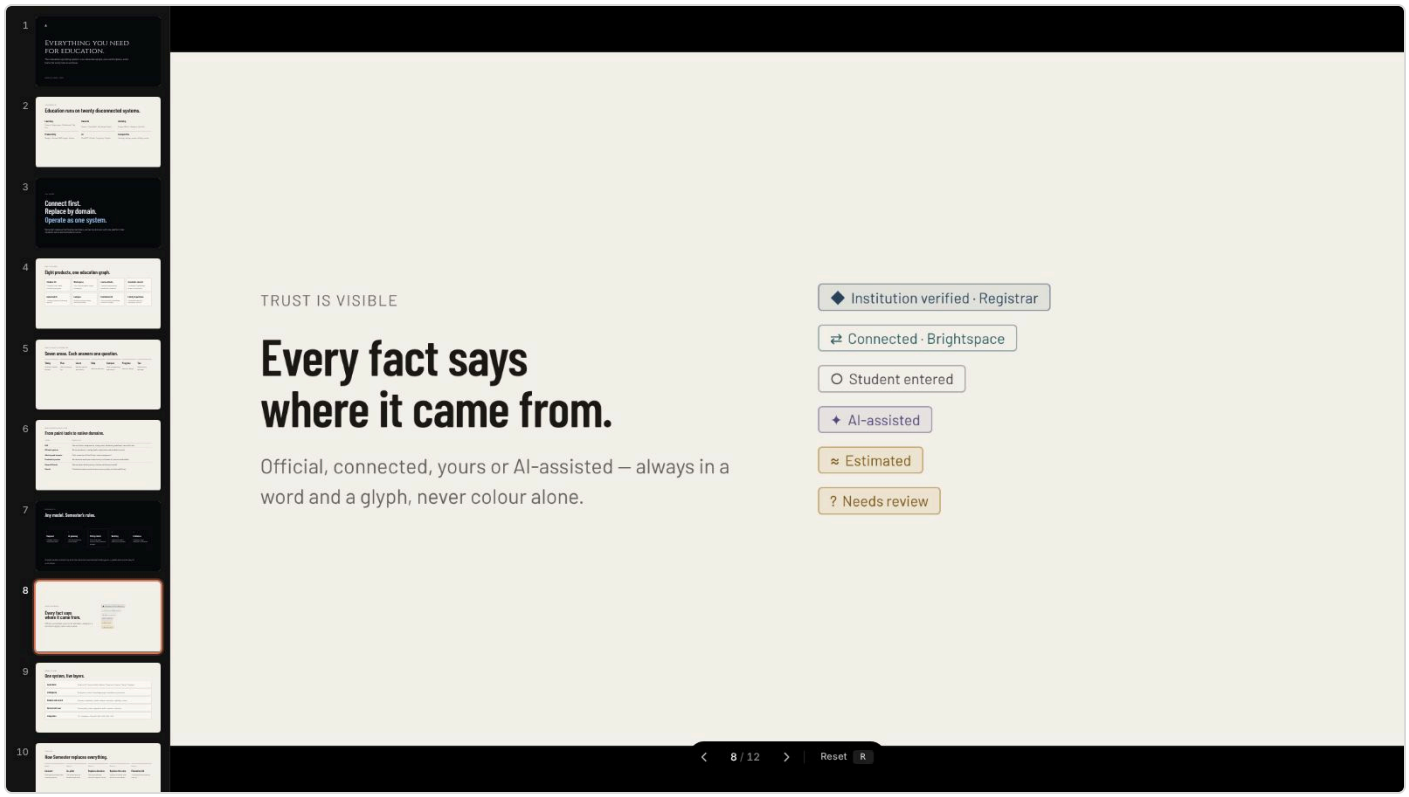
Slide 5



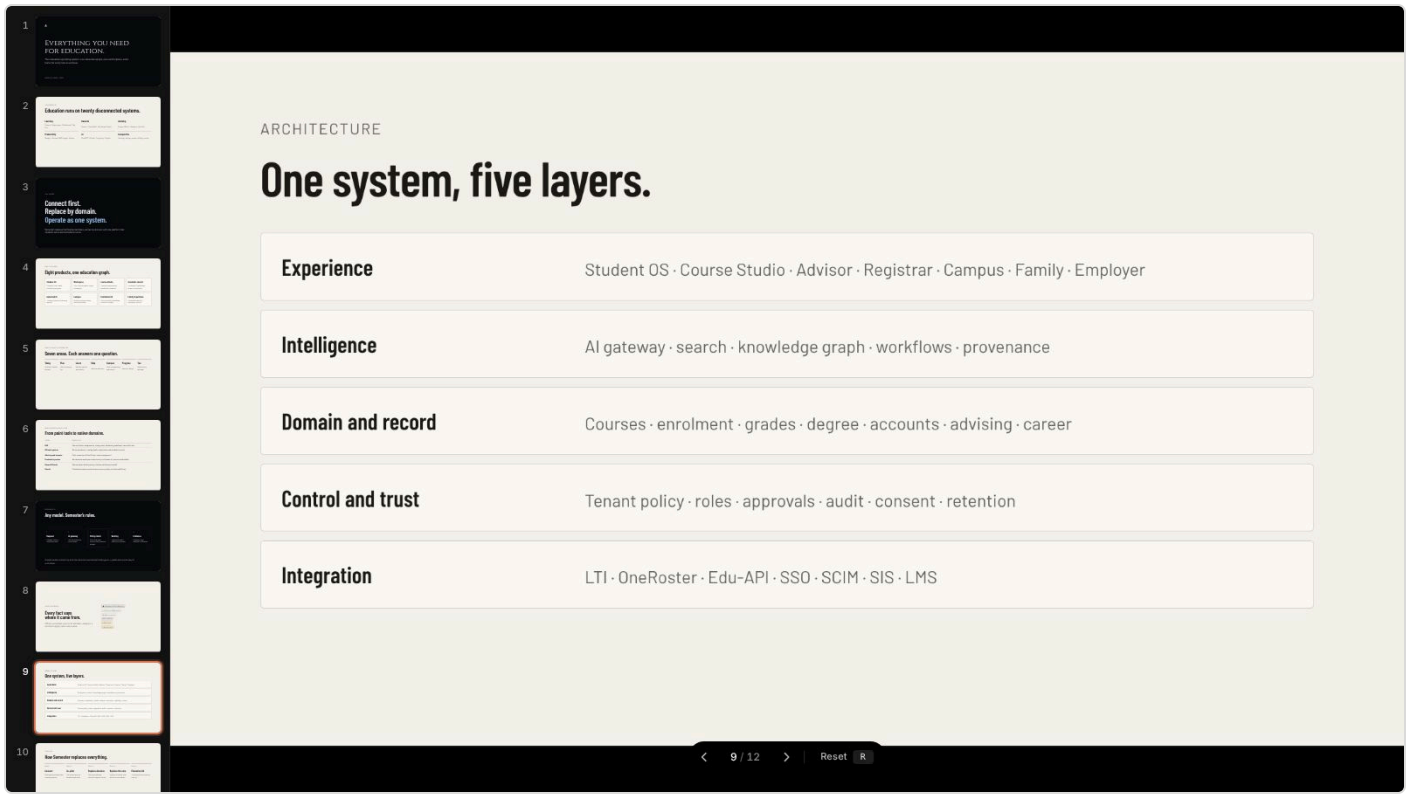
Slide 6



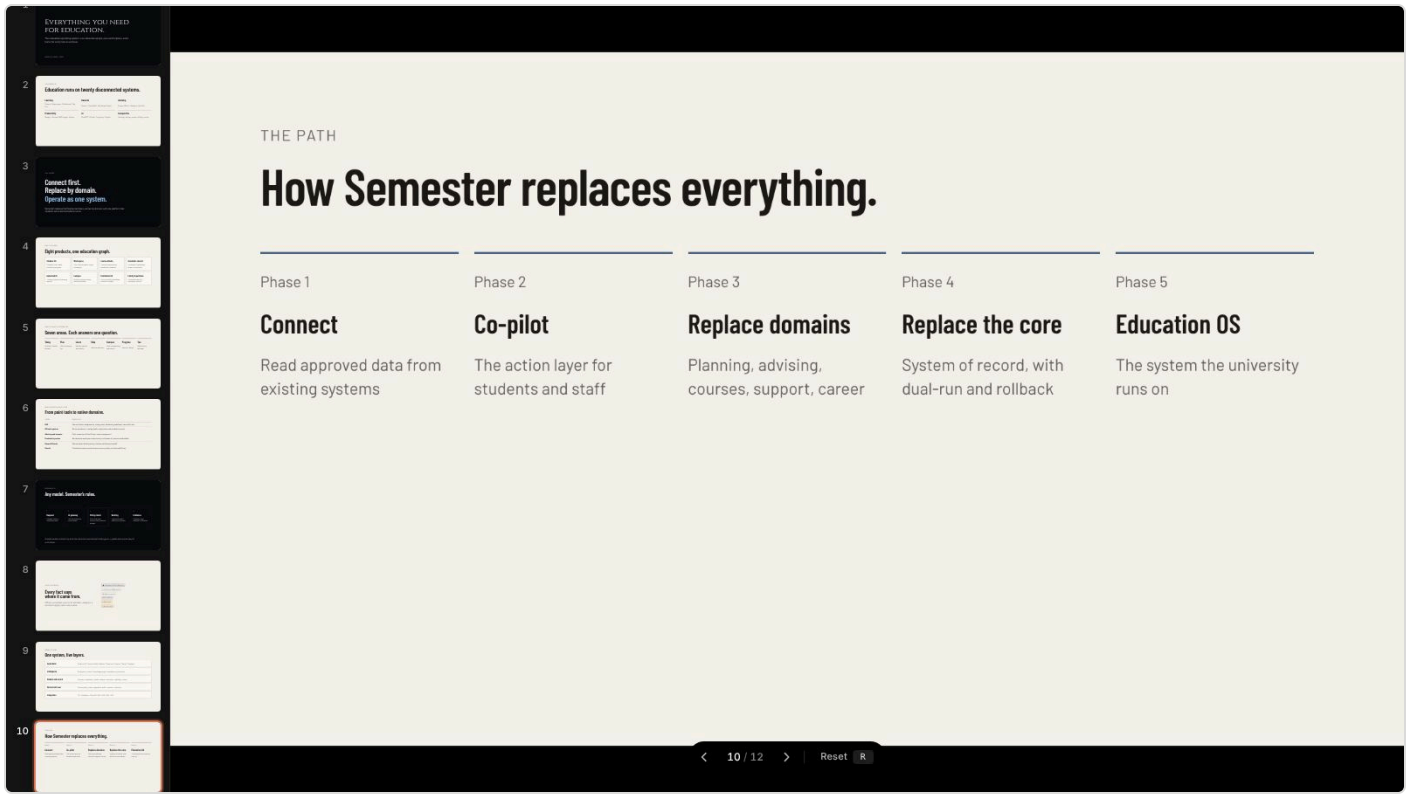
Slide 7



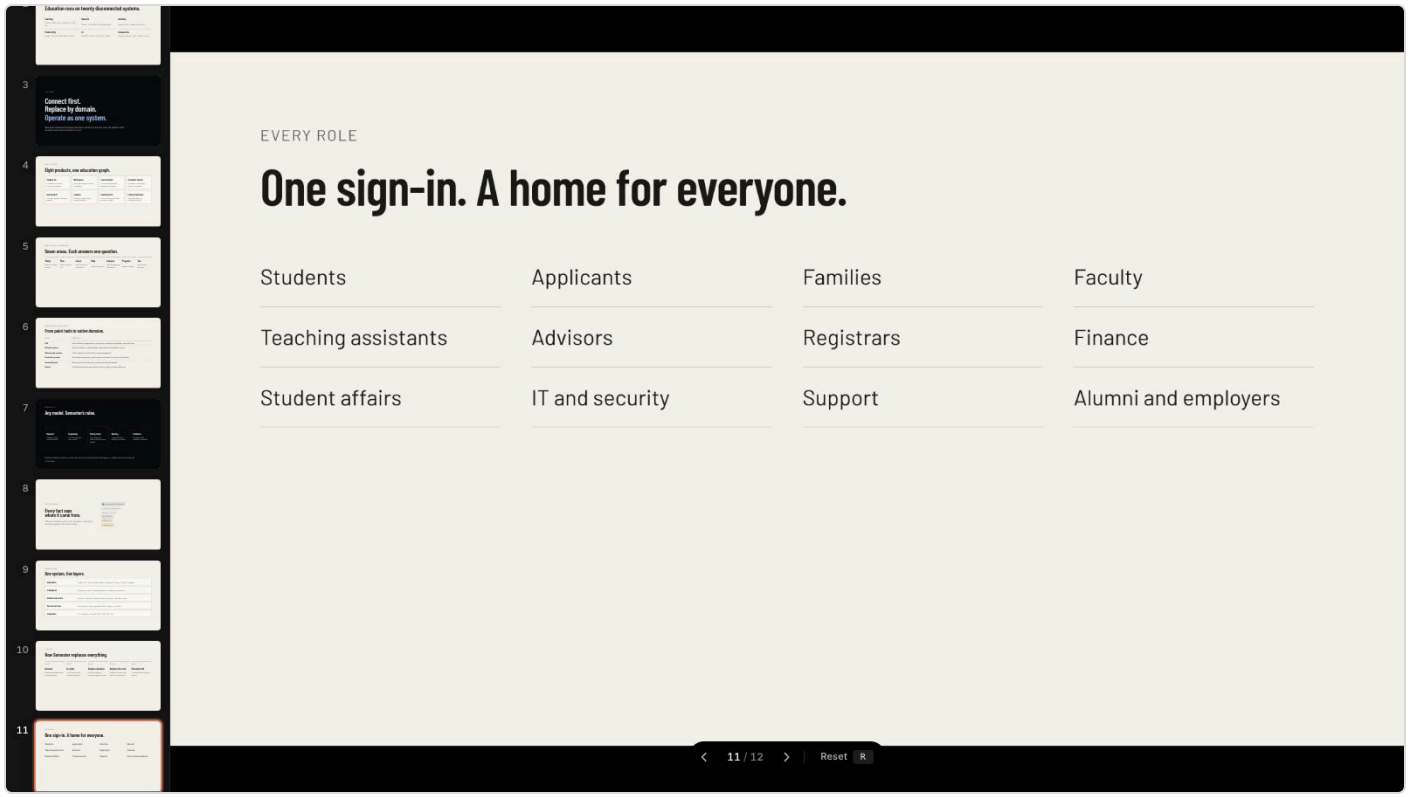
Slide 8



Slide 9



Slide 10



Slide 11


Connect first.
Replace by domain.
Operate as one system.
4
Eight products, one education graph.
5
Seven areas. Each answers one question.
6
From paint nail to entire domains.
7
Any model. Semester's rules.
8
Every fact says
where it came from.
9
One system, five layers.
10
How Semester replaces everything.
11
One sign-in. A home for everyone.
12
ONE SYSTEM. EVERY ROLE.
EVERY YEAR OF EDUCATION.
ONE SYSTEM. EVERY ROLE.
EVERY YEAR OF EDUCATION.
semester · the education operating system
12 / 12
Reset
R

Slide 12

SOURCE RESEARCH · IMAGE

The original lit silver mark



uploads/download-1.png

Apple vs Google vs Microsoft in EdTech: build a strategic expansion matrix for hardware, cloud infrastructure, and enterprise licensing

Computer
Semester OS roadmap: translate Apple, Google, and Microsoft enterprise playbooks into a 3-tier architecture and deployment plan
Computer
Break down the infrastructure layer into APIs
Outline the institutional sales and trust strategy
Detail the student identity and data graph

Semester should borrow the **operating principles** of Apple, Google, and Microsoft—not attempt to copy their entire business models. The winning education-platform architecture has three layers: an exceptional user experience, trusted institutional infrastructure, and an open ecosystem. The goal is to become the education-native control plane connecting identity, learning, records, productivity, AI, services, and outcomes.

Strategic expansion matrix

Strategic model	What to borrow	Semester equivalent	What not to copy
Apple	Integrated experience, design discipline, privacy posture, device-quality standards, premium support	Calm student OS, cohesive navigation, accessibility, offline-safe workflows, student-controlled data sharing, high-quality mobile experience	Closed hardware ecosystem, forced lock-in, opaque platform rules
Google	Search, cloud infrastructure, identity, AI, data systems, developer distribution	Education search, education graph, identity/membership layer, AI gateway, institutional data platform, APIs, partner ecosystem	Ad-tech incentives based on sensitive student data, uncontrolled data aggregation
Microsoft	Enterprise identity, productivity, administration, procurement readiness, long-term contracts, developer platform	Institutional tenant admin, SSO/SCIM, productivity workspace, compliance controls, implementation, annual licensing, APIs and marketplace	Complex enterprise UX, configuration overload, fragmented product surfaces
Canvas/Brightspace	Course workflow and institutional deployment	Course Studio connected to planning, actions, support, AI, and career	Course experience isolated from broader education journey

Strategic model	What to borrow	Semester equivalent	What not to copy
SIS/ERP vendors	Record authority, policy, transaction integrity	Canonical academic domains, deterministic rules, audit, migrations, reconciliation, rollback	Legacy UX and closed integration patterns
ChatGPT/Claude/Perplexity	High-quality conversational intelligence and research	Governed education copilot, policy-aware model routing, evidence/citations, academic context, human escalation	Treating model output as official academic/institutional truth

Three-tier Semester architecture

```
TIER 1 — EXPERIENCE PLATFORM
Student OS · Faculty Course Studio · Advisor workspace
Registrar tools · Campus services · Family portal
Career/alumni · Company site · Operations Console

TIER 2 — EDUCATION INTELLIGENCE PLATFORM
Identity graph · Education graph · Search · AI Gateway
Policy engine · Workflow engine · Evidence/provenance
Analytics · Recommendations · Outcome models

TIER 3 — INSTITUTIONAL INFRASTRUCTURE PLATFORM
Tenant control plane · RLS · SSO/SCIM · Audit
Integrations · Migration factory · APIs · Webhooks
Billing · Trust/compliance · SLOs · Backups · Operations
```

Tier 1: Experience platform

This is the Apple-like layer: students and staff should prefer it daily because it is calm, clear, fast, accessible, and coherent.

```
Student:
Today → Actions → Path → Plan → Courses → Copilot → Support → Career

Faculty:
Course Studio → Resources → Assignments → Feedback → Gradebook → Course policy

Advisor:
Caseload → Student path → Check-ins → Referrals → Success plans → Outcomes

Institution:
Tenant config → Roles → Policies → Integrations → Rollout → Analytics

Semester:
GTM → Pilots → Support → Billing → Trust → Security → Operations
```

Tier 2: Education intelligence platform

This is the Google-like layer: it makes data, search, AI, source authority, and recommendations work together.

```
Education Intelligence
├── Student identity and membership context
├── Academic path graph
├── Course and learning graph
├── Skills and evidence graph
├── Institutional policy graph
├── Search index
├── AI model router
├── Retrieval and source authority
├── Recommendation engine
├── Workflow orchestration
├── Analytics/outcomes
├── AI evaluation
└── Human escalation
```

Tier 3: Institutional infrastructure platform

This is the Microsoft-like layer: it makes Semester safe to buy, configure, deploy, govern, integrate, and operate for years.

```
Institutional Infrastructure
├── Multi-tenant data model
├── SSO / SCIM / membership
├── Role/capability system
├── Tenant policy and configuration
├── RLS and authorization
├── Approval workflows
├── Audit and evidence
├── Integration gateway
├── LTI / OneRoster / Edu-API
├── Migration and reconciliation
├── Feature flags and rollout
├── Billing/commercial
├── Security/privacy/compliance
├── Monitoring/SLO/incident response
├── Backup/restore/offboarding
└── Developer ecosystem
```

Infrastructure API layer

Semester needs APIs organized by **authority and risk**, not merely by frontend page.

```
API Gateway
├── Identity API
├── Tenant and Policy API
├── Academic API
```

```
├── Learning API
├── Student Workspace API
├── AI Gateway API
├── Student Success API
├── Campus Services API
├── Career API
├── Family Consent API
├── Integration API
├── Commercial API
├── Trust and Compliance API
├── Operations API
└── Developer Platform API
```

API domains

API	Primary resources	Write-control model
Identity	Accounts, sessions, memberships, SSO, SCIM, roles	Server-authorized; auditable
Tenant	Institutions, campuses, policies, configurations, feature state	Tenant admin + approval path
Academic	Terms, catalog, sections, enrollment, holds, records, grades	Deterministic policy + registrar authority
Learning	Courses, objectives, resources, assignments, assessments, study packs	Faculty/course-scoped capabilities
Workspace	Tasks, notes, files, calendar, plans, projects	Student ownership and sharing grants
AI	Requests, policy, providers, sources, usage, evaluations	Gateway-enforced, tenant/course policy
Student Success	Caseload, check-ins, referrals, success plans, support	Purpose-limited, consent/role-scoped
Campus	Dining, housing, events, organizations, spaces	Service-owner policy and tenant scope
Career	Skills, evidence, credentials, opportunities, mentors	Student consent + verified claim rules
Family	Grants, invitations, scoped shares, revocation	Student-controlled, time-limited
Integrations	Connections, scopes, mappings, syncs, webhooks	Approval-gated and server-only credentials
Commercial	Quotes, contracts, subscriptions, invoices, entitlements	Finance/revenue capability + approvals
Trust	Controls, evidence, claims, artifacts, trust-room grants	Security/legal/compliance scoped
Operations	Approvals, incidents, SLOs, audits, rollouts, risks	Internal capabilities, evidence, two-person controls
Platform	Apps, API keys, OAuth clients, webhooks, marketplace	Tenant install approval + developer governance

API contract standard

Every Semester API should follow:

```
Identity:
  Who is calling?

Scope:
  Which tenant/customer/course/person may be accessed?

Purpose:
  Why is this data/action needed?

Authority:
  Is this official, derived, AI-generated, user-owned, or external?

Policy:
  Which rules constrain it?

Validation:
  Are inputs structurally and semantically valid?

Idempotency:
  Can a retry create duplicate harm?

Audit:
  What event must be recorded?

Freshness:
  Is data live, delayed, stale, or unavailable?

Error:
  What safe recovery or human handoff is available?
```

Example API resource structure

```
/v1/identity/me
/v1/tenants/{tenantId}
/v1/tenants/{tenantId}/policy
/v1/academic/terms
/v1/academic/catalog
/v1/academic/sections
/v1/academic/enrollments
/v1/academic/registration-requests
/v1/learning/courses/{courseId}
/v1/learning/assignments
/v1/learning/gradebook
/v1/workspace/tasks
/v1/workspace/notes
/v1/workspace/calendar
/v1/ai/requests
/v1/ai/sources
/v1/support/requests
/v1/advising/caseload
```

```
/v1/career/opportunities
/v1/family/grants
/v1/integrations/connections
/v1/integrations/sync-runs
/v1/commercial/quotes
/v1/commercial/subscriptions
/v1/trust/artifacts
/v1/ops/tenants
/v1/ops/approvals
/v1/ops/incidents
/v1/platform/apps
/v1/platform/webhooks
```

High-impact write APIs should not directly mutate raw tables from the browser. They should use capability-checked server/RPC commands:

```
POST /v1/academic/registration-requests
POST /v1/academic/registration-requests/{id}/decision
POST /v1/ops/approval-requests
POST /v1/ops/approval-requests/{id}/decision
POST /v1/integrations/{id}/scope-approval
POST /v1/commercial/quotes/{id}/send
POST /v1/privacy/data-subject-requests/{id}/complete
```

Institutional sales strategy

Semester should sell the **full platform vision** but contract and deploy a narrow, measurable workflow first.

Positioning

```
Semester is the unified education operating system:
one connected platform for student action, learning, planning,
institutional workflows, governed AI, and operational intelligence.
```

Initial institutional wedge

```
Semester Registration Readiness Pilot

Target buyer:
Student Success, Advising, Registrar, or a defined academic department.

Scope:
One student cohort, one workflow, one academic term or 8–12 weeks.

Outcome:
Help students understand registration requirements, complete next actions,
and reduce avoidable support friction.

Evidence:
```

```
Activation, first meaningful action, readiness completion, support load,
student confidence, advisor/staff feedback, pilot-to-annual conversion.
```

Buyer map

Stakeholder	Need	Semester message
President/provost	Student outcomes, institutional coherence, risk	One connected operating layer with phased modernization
CIO	Integration, security, maintainability, vendor consolidation	Tenant controls, APIs, migration factory, standards, audit
CISO/privacy	Data minimization, controls, evidence, incident readiness	Policy engine, RLS, evidence register, Trust Center, HECVAT roadmap
Registrar	Record authority, accuracy, transaction integrity	Deterministic rules, reconciliation, audit, migration gates
Student success leader	Action completion, support coordination, retention	Student Action Center and measurable pilot outcomes
Advisor	Context, referral paths, student clarity	Path, plan, support workflow, consented sharing
Faculty	Course clarity, workload, AI policy	Course Studio with source-aware, policy-bounded AI
Procurement/legal	Contracts, DPA, insurance, SLA, vendor reliability	Controlled trust room, contract library, evidence lifecycle
Student leader	Usability, campus relevance, student value	Calm daily workspace and direct student benefits
CFO	Cost, ROI, delivery, vendor risk	Pilot scope, implementation plan, measurable impact, annual economics

Institutional sales motion

```
1. Named target account
2. Personalized outreach
3. Discovery
4. Qualification
5. Role-specific demo
6. Pilot design session
7. Security/procurement path
8. Pilot proposal
9. Mutual Action Plan
10. Signed pilot
11. Implementation
12. Adoption measurement
13. Midpoint review
14. Outcome report
15. Annual conversion
16. Expansion and reference
```

Trust strategy

The trust strategy must be a product, not a PDF folder.

```
Trust Center
  ↓
Security overview
Privacy overview
Accessibility statement
Responsible AI
Data practices
Subprocessors
Incident response summary
Business continuity summary
Status page
HECVAT readiness
DPA process
Security questionnaire request
Trust room
```

Institutional trust is earned through:

- Clear data authority.
- Explicit tenant isolation.
- Verified access controls.
- Controlled support access.
- Security evidence.
- Accessible UX.
- Measurable implementation.
- Transparent incidents.
- Data portability.
- Rollback/migration capability.
- Honest product and compliance claims.

Student identity and data graph

Semester's core defensibility is the **education graph**, which must balance connected context with privacy, authority, and student agency.

```
Person
├── Identity
├── Account
├── Institution membership
├── Roles
├── Program
├── Courses
├── Terms
```

```
├── Enrollment
├── Requirements
├── Plans
├── Tasks
├── Calendar
├── Learning objectives
├── Assignments
├── Grades
├── Skills
├── Evidence
├── Credentials
├── Support requests
├── Advisors
├── Appointments
├── Community memberships
├── Campus service usage
├── Student account
├── Opportunities
├── Mentors
├── Family grants
├── AI interactions
├── Consent decisions
├── Privacy preferences
└── Outcomes
```

Graph rules

Each node and relationship must carry:

```
Canonical ID
Tenant ID
Owner
Source authority
Source system
Source record ID
Freshness timestamp
Version
Data classification
Consent/grant requirement
Role/capability requirement
Retention policy
Audit history
Export rule
Deletion rule
Migration source
Confidence/verification status
```

Authority categories

Category	Example	Semester handling
Official institutional	Enrollment, grade, hold, term dates	Institution/registrar-authorized record
Instructor-published	Syllabus, course AI rules, study packs	Course/term scoped, versioned
Student-owned	Notes, tasks, private plan, AI preferences	Private by default, student controls sharing
Semester-derived	Workload estimate, action suggestion, health aggregate	Explainable, source-linked, not silently official
AI-generated	Summary, draft, recommendation	Policy-bound, cited, not authoritative by default
External source	Library source, partner opportunity, public policy	Labeled with source and freshness
Community-generated	Post, review, peer tip	Moderated and clearly non-official
Verified credential	Institution-approved skill/award	Evidence and authority required

Student-agency model

```
Default:
Student-owned workspace is private.

Sharing:
Student selects recipient, category, purpose, duration, and items.

Access:
Recipient sees only authorized scope.

Audit:
Every access is recorded.

Revocation:
Student can revoke unless an institutional policy/legal obligation applies.

Institution:
Official records remain governed by institutional authority.

AI:
Only policy-approved context is supplied to the model/provider.
```

Deployment model

```
Development
  ↓
Tenant-safe test environment
  ↓
Sandbox integration
  ↓
Preview deployment
```

```
  ↓
Internal beta
  ↓
Private beta tenant
  ↓
Pilot tenant
  ↓
Controlled production cohort
  ↓
Annual customer deployment
  ↓
Multi-campus expansion
```

Each step requires:

```
Configuration
Policy approval
Security review
Accessibility review
Data validation
Integration test
Rollback plan
Support readiness
Monitoring
Release evidence
Owner approval
```

Expansion strategy

```
Stage 1:
Daily student OS + registration readiness

Stage 2:
Course Studio + advising/support workflows

Stage 3:
Institution control plane + integrations + rollout factory

Stage 4:
Native registrar/academic domains where authorized

Stage 5:
Campus services + student account + career + family

Stage 6:
Developer platform + marketplace + global ecosystem

Stage 7:
Education infrastructure company:
identity, cloud, AI, operating layer, standards, partner ecosystem,
global deployments, and lifelong learner network
```

The key strategic conclusion is:

> Semester should be sold as the unified Education OS, deployed as a focused pilot, expanded as a trusted institutional platform, and matured into an open ecosystem where students, institutions, developers, employers, and partners all gain more value from the same connected graph.

Build a comprehensive go-to-market playbook and launch checklist covering legal incorporation, financial modeling, sales funnels, and compliance in one exportable PDF report

Computer
Interactive GTM financial model and sales-funnel calculator: model customer acquisition costs, lifetime value, pricing tiers, and break-even runway
Computer
Show me how to format the customer acquisition funnel
Draft an institutional pilot agreement template
Build a cloud security and compliance checklist

For Semester, the launch package should be built around a paid, narrowly scoped institutional pilot that proves a student outcome and converts to an annual platform agreement. Below is a practical legal/compliance checklist, a pilot sales playbook, a customer-success workflow, a CAC/LTV funnel format, and a master prompt for generating a complete GTM PDF/report and interactive financial model.

The critical rule: do not sell "everything Semester could eventually become." Sell one urgent workflow, to one clearly defined institutional buyer, with measurable success criteria, a defined pilot price, a conversion date, and a procurement-ready trust package.

Launch master checklist

Corporate and financial

Area	Create / complete	Launch evidence
Legal entity	Entity formation, governing documents, EIN, state registrations, registered agent	Entity is active and in good standing
Ownership	Founder agreements, IP assignment, vesting, cap table, advisor/contractor terms	Company—not individuals—owns code and IP
Banking	Business bank account, approval rules, accounting chart of accounts	Business funds are separated from personal funds
Accounting	Bookkeeping system, monthly close checklist, expense policy, tax calendar	Monthly P&L, balance sheet, cash-flow statement
Financial model	36-month driver-based model with conservative/base/ambitious/downside cases	Unit economics, runway, break-even, hiring plan

Area	Create / complete	Launch evidence
Pricing	Pilot, institutional, implementation, AI overage, support, and expansion pricing	Approved price book and discount policy
Insurance	Cyber, E&O/professional liability, general liability; evaluate D&O as needed	Coverage reviewed against contract requirements
Contract library	NDA, MSA, SaaS agreement, order form, pilot agreement, SOW, DPA, SLA	Versioned and counsel-reviewed templates
Payments	Invoice process, payment terms, collections policy, tax treatment	Quote-to-cash workflow tested
Board/governance	Decision log, consent process, investor update, board package	Clear authority and reporting cadence

The SBA's startup guidance includes choosing a legal structure, registering the business, getting federal/state tax IDs, opening a bank account, and obtaining appropriate insurance; the exact state and tax requirements depend on where and how you operate.[1]

Legal and privacy

- [ ] Founder, employee, contractor, and advisor **IP assignment** agreements.
- [ ] Confidentiality and invention-assignment provisions for all contributors.
- [ ] Mutual NDA and one-way NDA templates.
- [ ] SaaS agreement/MSA, order form, pilot agreement, and SOW.
- [ ] Data Processing Addendum.
- [ ] Privacy Policy, Terms of Service, Acceptable Use Policy, cookie notice.
- [ ] Subprocessor register and customer notification/update process.
- [ ] Data inventory: what data is collected, source, purpose, storage, access, retention, deletion, and vendors.
- [ ] Data classification: public, internal, confidential, restricted.
- [ ] Data-retention and verified deletion policy.
- [ ] Privacy rights/request intake and escalation workflow.
- [ ] Marketing consent, unsubscribe, suppression-list process.
- [ ] AI data-use policy: what data can be sent to model providers, approval controls, retention, and customer disclosure.
- [ ] Accessibility statement and accessibility remediation process.
- [ ] Claims register: every public product, security, accessibility, customer-outcome, and AI claim must have evidence and owner.
- [ ] Legal-review queue with status, contract type, customer risk, owner, reviewer, and renewal date.

The FTC recommends collecting only necessary sensitive information, safeguarding it, and disposing of it securely when no longer needed.[2]

Security and institutional compliance

Control area	Minimum launch requirement
Identity	MFA on admin, code, cloud, finance, CRM, support, and production accounts
Secrets	Secret manager; no credentials in repositories, browser bundles, screenshots, or docs
Access	Least privilege, role review, contractor offboarding, access log
Application security	Pull-request review, dependency scanning, vulnerability process, secure release checklist
Data	Encryption in transit, appropriate encryption at rest, backups, restoration test
Monitoring	Error monitoring, uptime monitoring, security alert triage, audit logging
Incident response	Severity model, response team, customer communications, tabletop exercise
Resilience	Business continuity plan, disaster-recovery runbook, tested recovery steps
Vendor risk	Review subprocessors and maintain a vendor register
Trust	Security overview, data-flow diagram, subprocessor list, status page, security contact
Procurement	HECVAT Lite roadmap, questionnaire response library, DPA/SLA path
Accessibility	Tested accessibility baseline, documented known gaps, remediation plan

For higher-ed buying, prepare HECVAT evidence early. EDUCAUSE describes HECVAT as a campus-preferred vendor-risk evaluation framework spanning information security, privacy, accessibility, and related technology controls; vendors complete the sections applicable to their solution.[3] [4] [5]

Required trust package

Create this before asking an institution to start security review:

```
trust/
├── Security-Overview.pdf
├── Privacy-Overview.pdf
├── Data-Flow-Diagram.pdf
├── Architecture-Diagram.pdf
├── Subprocessor-List.pdf
├── Data-Retention-and-Deletion.pdf
├── Incident-Response-Summary.pdf
├── Business-Continuity-Summary.pdf
├── Accessibility-Statement.pdf
├── HECVAT-Lite-Response.xlsx
├── Security-Questionnaire-Answer-Library.md
├── DPA-template.docx
├── SLA-template.docx
└── Trust-Center-Content.md
```

Initial commercial model

Use a **pilot-to-annual conversion** path:

Offer	Suggested commercial structure	Purpose
Discovery/design session	Free, tightly bounded	Qualify the problem and stakeholders
Paid pilot	Fixed fee for one workflow, one department/cohort, one term or 8–12 weeks	Prove outcomes with limited risk
Implementation	Separate fixed fee based on integration/configuration complexity	Cover real setup cost
Annual institutional platform	Per enrolled student/year with minimum annual commitment	Recurring platform revenue
Premium support	Percentage of annual fee or fixed minimum	Cover institutional success/support requirements
AI overage	Tenant-funded usage above included allocation	Protect gross margin

Your working pricing assumptions can be:

```
Student Premium:
$8.99/month or $69/year

Institutional platform:
$18 per enrolled student/year
$30,000 annual minimum

AI overage:
$30 per 1,000 governed AI requests

Implementation:
$35,000 to $150,000 one-time
based on integration, data, tenant configuration, and rollout complexity

Premium support:
15% of annual platform fee
$15,000 minimum

Marketplace/partner commission:
12%, where applicable
```

These are planning assumptions, not a universal price card. Validate willingness to pay through buyer interviews, pilot proposals, procurement feedback, competitive context, and delivery costs before publishing a final pricing page.

Pick one launch wedge

Your first pilot should be focused. A strong first offer could be:

```
Semester Registration Readiness Pilot

Buyer:
Student Success, Advising, Registrar, or a defined academic department.

Problem:
Students enter registration without a clear plan, miss actions, generate support loa
and struggle to understand requirements, deadlines, resources, and next steps.

Pilot:
Semester supports a defined student cohort through registration readiness and action

Scope:
One institution, one department/cohort, one academic term, limited integrations,
a named executive sponsor, and a defined student population.

Success:
- Student activation
- First meaningful action
- Registration-readiness workflow completion
- Reduced advisor/support friction
- Student confidence/satisfaction
- Measurable improvement against agreed baseline

Commercial:
Paid pilot with explicit implementation scope and annual conversion price.

Decision:
Named executive decision-maker and annual-conversion decision date.
```

Sales funnel format

Track the funnel by **institutional account**, not social impressions.

```
Target Accounts
  ↓
Researched Accounts
  ↓
Warm Introductions / Outbound Contacts
  ↓
Replies / Referrals
  ↓
Discovery Meetings
  ↓
Qualified Opportunities
  ↓
Role-Specific Demos
  ↓
Pilot Design Sessions
  ↓
```

```
Security / Privacy / Procurement Review
  ↓
Pilot Proposal Sent
  ↓
Pilot Signed
  ↓
Pilot Activated
  ↓
Pilot Success Achieved
  ↓
Annual Contract Converted
  ↓
Expansion / Reference / Renewal
```

Funnel spreadsheet columns

Stage	Required fields	Primary metric
Target account	Institution, size, segment, department, priority, trigger event	Target-account coverage
Contacted	Buyer/champion, channel, message, date, outcome	Reply rate
Discovery	Pain, current process, urgency, stakeholders, budget, timeline	Qualification rate
Demo	Use case, attendees, objections, next action	Demo-to-design rate
Pilot design	Scope, success metrics, data needs, implementation owner	Proposal readiness
Security/procurement	Security owner, legal owner, HECVAT/DPA status, blockers	Review progress
Proposal	Pilot fee, annual value, decision date, champion strength	Proposal-to-close rate
Pilot	Activation, weekly usage, success score, risks	Pilot attainment
Annual conversion	Value report, renewal owner, annual quote, close date	Pilot-to-annual conversion
Expansion	New departments/cohorts, upsell value, advocate/reference	Net revenue retention

Funnel math

Use these formulas:

$$\text{Stage Conversion Rate} = \frac{\text{Accounts entering next stage}}{\text{Accounts entering current stage}}$$

$$\text{Win Rate} = \frac{\text{Annual contracts won}}{\text{Qualified opportunities}}$$

$$\text{Pilot Conversion Rate} = \frac{\text{Annual contracts from pilots}}{\text{Pilots completed}}$$

$$\text{CAC} = \frac{\text{Sales and marketing spend for a period}}{\text{New customers acquired}}$$

$$\text{CAC Payback Months} = \frac{\text{CAC}}{\text{Monthly gross profit per new customer}}$$

$$\text{LTV} \approx \frac{\text{Annual recurring revenue} \times \text{Gross margin}}{\text{Annual logo churn rate}}$$

Use LTV cautiously at the beginning; early churn and retention data are too immature for a precise prediction. Treat it as a sensitivity range, not a fact.

Weekly sales scorecard

Metric	Weekly target	Why
New target accounts researched	10–20	Keeps top of funnel healthy
Personalized outreach attempts	25–50	Creates conversations
Buyer/champion conversations	3–8	Market learning and pipeline
Qualified opportunities	1–3	Tests real buying intent
Demos	2–5	Validates narrative/product
Pilot designs	1–2	Converts interest into scope
Security reviews started	Track	Indicates institutional seriousness
Pilot proposals sent	1+	Creates commercial decisions
Pilots signed	Monthly target	Creates proof and revenue
Pilot activation	80%+ of agreed cohort	Validates implementation
Pilot KPI attainment	Defined per pilot	Determines annual conversion
Annual conversions	Track	Proves repeatability

Pilot sales command

```
You are the Head of Institutional Sales for Semester.

Build a complete pilot-to-annual sales engine for an education-technology SaaS compar

The sales motion must begin with one narrow, measurable workflow. Do not sell Semeste

Create:

1. Ideal Customer Profile
2. Target account scoring model
3. 100-account list template
4. Buyer and stakeholder map:
   - economic buyer
   - champion
   - technical buyer
   - security/privacy reviewer
   - procurement
   - legal
   - end-user sponsor
5. Discovery-call script
6. Qualification scorecard
```

```
7. Demo script
8. Demo environment checklist
9. Pilot design-session agenda
10. Paid pilot proposal template
11. Mutual Action Plan
12. Security/procurement response checklist
13. Objection-handling library
14. Pricing and discount approval policy
15. ROI calculator specification
16. CRM stages, definitions, required fields, and exit criteria
17. Weekly pipeline review format
18. Forecasting model
19. Pilot-to-annual conversion playbook
20. Expansion and reference-customer playbook

Use the following commercial baseline:
- Student Premium: $8.99/month or $69/year
- Institution platform: $18/enrolled student/year, $30,000 annual minimum
- Implementation: $35,000–$150,000
- AI overage: $30 per 1,000 governed requests
- Premium support: 15% of annual platform fee, $15,000 minimum

For every sales artifact, define:
- Objective
- Owner
- Trigger
- Inputs
- Steps
- Exit criteria
- KPI
- System of record
- Risks
- Approval requirements

Return a 90-day sales plan that targets 100 named accounts, generates 15–25 qualifie
```

Customer success and onboarding workflow

Customer lifecycle

```
Contract signed
  ↓
Sales-to-CS handoff
  ↓
Welcome and kickoff
  ↓
Configuration / data / integration readiness
  ↓
Admin training
  ↓
Student and staff launch
  ↓
Activation support
  ↓
```

```
Weekly pilot review
  ↓
Midpoint executive review
  ↓
Outcome measurement
  ↓
Final value report
  ↓
Annual conversion / renewal
  ↓
Expansion / reference / advocacy
```

Sales-to-success handoff checklist

Sales must provide these before a customer kickoff:

- [ ] Signed contract/order form/pilot agreement
- [ ] Commercial scope and exclusions
- [ ] Pilot duration
- [ ] Annual conversion date
- [ ] Executive sponsor
- [ ] Economic buyer
- [ ] Operational champion
- [ ] Technical/IT contact
- [ ] Security/privacy/procurement contacts
- [ ] Target user population
- [ ] Workflow being solved
- [ ] Baseline metrics
- [ ] Desired success metrics
- [ ] Promised integrations
- [ ] Data categories
- [ ] Open risks
- [ ] Customer commitments
- [ ] Semester commitments
- [ ] Customer communication preferences
- [ ] Agreed next meeting

First 30 days of a pilot

Timing	Customer action	Semester action	Deliverable
Days 0–3	Confirm sponsor and working team	Send welcome and kickoff agenda	Welcome packet
Days 3–7	Attend kickoff, provide admin/data inputs	Align scope, RACI, risks, metrics	Pilot success plan
Week 1	Confirm user population and workflow	Configure tenant and roles	Configuration checklist
Weeks 1–2	Provide data/integration access if included	Validate data and security assumptions	Data readiness report
Week 2	Attend admin training	Train admins/champions	Training recording + admin guide
Weeks 2–3	Send launch communications	Support launch, office hours, help center	Launch kit
Weeks 3–4	Encourage user activation	Monitor activation and intervene	Activation dashboard
Weekly	Attend operating review	Report KPIs, risks, actions	Weekly pilot report
Midpoint	Executive check-in	Present progress and unblock risk	Midpoint executive deck
Final 2 weeks	Review results	Present value case and annual proposal	Results report + conversion plan

Customer health score

Use a 100-point score:

Signal	Weight	Risk signal
Admin engagement	15	No owner attendance or delayed actions
User activation	20	Cohort activation below target
First meaningful action	15	Users sign in but do not gain value
Core workflow completion	20	Low completion or abandoned tasks
Weekly active use	10	Engagement falls after launch
Support sentiment	5	High friction or repeated unresolved issues
Executive engagement	5	Sponsor disengages or does not attend reviews
Outcome trend	10	Success metrics do not improve

Customer success command

```
You are the Head of Customer Success and Implementation for Semester.

Build an institutional customer-success system that turns a paid pilot into an annual

Create:
```

```
1. Sales-to-CS handoff checklist
2. Customer welcome sequence
3. Kickoff deck and agenda
4. Implementation plan
5. RACI template
6. Data/integration readiness checklist
7. Admin configuration checklist
8. Training curriculum:
   - administrators
   - advisors/staff
   - champions
   - students
9. Student launch kit
10. Support policy and severity model
11. Escalation process
12. Knowledge-base structure
13. Customer health score
14. Weekly pilot operating review
15. Midpoint executive review
16. Pilot success-plan template
17. Final value/results report
18. QBR template
19. Renewal and expansion playbook
20. Churn-risk playbook
21. Customer feedback taxonomy
22. Reference and case-study process

Pilot metrics must prioritize:
- activation
- first meaningful action
- core workflow completion
- weekly active usage
- staff efficiency or time saved
- student satisfaction/confidence
- support-friction reduction
- pilot-to-annual conversion

Do not use downloads, impressions, or vanity engagement as the primary proof of value

For every artifact, include:
- owner
- trigger
- input
- output
- cadence
- escalation rule
- success metric
- system of record
```

GTM report and calculator master prompt

Use this to generate the complete **exportable PDF report** and a companion interactive calculator.

```
Create a comprehensive “Semester Go-to-Market, Financial Model, and Launch Readiness

Deliverables:
1. A polished, exportable PDF report.
2. A companion interactive web calculator.
3. A CSV-ready operating model with assumptions and scenarios.
4. A Markdown source document.

Company:
Semester is an education-technology SaaS platform serving institutions, departments,
- Institutional B2B sales and paid pilots
- Student adoption and retention
- Annual institutional platform licensing
- Implementation services
- Premium support
- Carefully governed AI usage/overage
- Optional marketplace/partner revenue

Use these baseline commercial assumptions:
- Student Premium: $8.99/month or $69/year
- Institution platform: $18 per enrolled student/year
- Institution annual minimum: $30,000
- Included institutional AI allocation: 2,400 governed requests per enrolled student/
- AI overage: $30 per 1,000 governed requests
- Implementation fee: $35,000–$150,000
- Premium support: 15% of annual platform fee, $15,000 minimum
- Marketplace/partner commission: 12%, optional and separately modeled

Required report sections:

A. Executive summary
- Company thesis
- Initial launch wedge
- Buyer and customer segments
- Why the pilot-to-annual model is the first revenue engine
- Major risks and mitigation

B. Legal and company formation checklist
- Entity, IP, ownership, banking, tax, insurance, contracts, privacy, terms, DPA, sec
- Mark every item requiring counsel, accountant, broker, or security review

C. Security and compliance roadmap
- Trust Center
- Data inventory
- Data flows
- retention/deletion
- incident response
- vendor management
- HECVAT Lite and Full roadmap
- accessibility evidence
```

```
- security questionnaire library

D. Go-to-market playbook
- ICP
- personas
- target-account scoring
- sales funnel
- CRM design
- discovery
- demo
- pilot offer
- procurement
- proposal
- conversion
- expansion
- student adoption
- content and channel strategy

E. Pricing and packaging
- Student, department, institution, enterprise/pilot, implementation, support, AI ove
- discount policy
- margin guardrails
- pricing sensitivity

F. Financial model
Create monthly models for 36 months, with:
- Conservative
- Base
- Ambitious
- Downside/delayed-sales
- High-growth/high-cost
- Low-adoption
- High-AI-usage
- Long-sales-cycle
- Pilot-heavy
- Annual-contract-heavy

Model:
- Leads
- meetings
- qualified opportunities
- demos
- pilot designs
- pilot proposals
- pilots signed
- pilot activation
- pilot success
- pilot-to-annual conversion
- annual contract value
- student subscription conversion
- implementation revenue
- AI overage
- gross margin
- cloud, AI, support, implementation, sales, marketing, legal, accounting, security,
- CAC
- CAC payback
```

```
- LTV
- gross retention
- net revenue retention
- monthly burn
- runway
- break-even month
- hiring capacity
- cash required

G. Customer-success system
- Onboarding
- implementation
- training
- support
- health score
- pilot success plan
- QBR
- renewal
- expansion
- churn prevention

H. KPI tree and operating cadence
- weekly revenue review
- weekly product/engineering review
- weekly customer success review
- monthly finance review
- monthly security/risk review
- quarterly strategy and OKR review

Interactive calculator requirements:
- Adjustable input cells/sliders
- Pricing-tier controls
- Funnel-conversion controls
- Headcount/cost controls
- CAC/LTV calculation
- Break-even/runway chart
- Scenario selector
- Monthly revenue and expense tables
- Sensitivity charts
- Export current scenario to CSV and Markdown
- Clearly label assumptions versus validated data

Do not present forecasts as facts. Show formulas, assumptions, risks, ranges, and sen
```

Immediate actions

1. Choose the first pilot wedge and target buyer.
2. Finalize the pilot offer, success metrics, and conversion date.
3. Complete the basic contract/trust package with qualified review.
4. Set up CRM and load 100 target accounts.
5. Build the sales deck, demo, proposal, and Mutual Action Plan.
6. Build the onboarding, support, and customer-health process before signing pilots.

7. Start weekly funnel, product, customer success, finance, and security reviews.
8. Use the financial calculator to decide whether each pilot price and implementation scope produces acceptable gross margin and runway.

⁂

1. https://www.sba.gov/counseling/
2. https://consumer.ftc.gov/business-guidance/privacy-security/data-security
3. https://www.educause.edu/higher-education-community-vendor-assessment-toolkit/how-to-use-the-higher-education-community-vendor-assessment-toolkit
4. https://www.educause.edu/higher-education-community-vendor-assessment-toolkit/hecvat-faqs-for-higher-education
5. https://www.educause.edu/higher-education-community-vendor-assessment-toolkit/hecvat-faqs-for-corporations
6. https://www.saltycloud.com/blog/hecvat-compliance/
7. https://www.perplexity.ai/search/98d1acab-6209-4793-805f-f7f2d343652d
8. https://www.perplexity.ai/search/aa4ef530-0e29-4728-a5d3-5f6711e3c528
9. https://www.perplexity.ai/search/b858d9f3-9743-4c05-95f7-983dce22ac45
10. https://www.perplexity.ai/search/1fe85c07-e152-4f7e-8cd4-8dbda808df4d
11. https://www.perplexity.ai/search/a08f0380-787d-4291-a34a-45eeedb86258
12. https://www.ftc.gov/business-guidance/privacy-security/data-security
13. https://www.ftc.gov/business-guidance/resources/protecting-personal-information-guide-business
14. https://www.sba.gov/counseling/launch-your-business/
15. https://www.educause.edu/higher-education-community-vendor-assessment-toolkit
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17. https://er.educause.edu/articles/2025/2/hecvat-4-better-than-ever
18. https://www.alston.com/en/insights/publications/2023/02/secure-data-disposal-and-data-minimization
19. https://www.ren-isac.net/services/hecvat.html
20. https://wolfia.com/hecvat

Business Master Checklist: legal, finance, sales, ops, and compliance roadmap for taking a tech product to market

Computer
Go-To-Market Playbook: sales funnel, pricing tiers, customer acquisition, and marketing infrastructure for a new company
Computer
Show me the exact legal and compliance checklist
Give me the go-to-market pilot sales playbook
Provide the customer success and onboarding workflow

To take Semester to market, build three systems in parallel: a **legal-and-trust system** that lets institutions buy safely, a go-to-market system that creates and closes measurable pilots, and a customer-success system that turns pilots into renewals and case studies. Do not treat the checklists below as legal or compliance advice—use them as an execution and evidence checklist for qualified counsel, accountants, insurers, and security reviewers.

For an education-focused SaaS company, the minimum credible launch posture is: registered company, tax/banking/accounting setup, ownership and contract pack, privacy/security controls, an institutional pilot offer, a sales pipeline, onboarding and support, and evidence that customers achieve the promised outcome. The SBA and IRS both identify entity structure, registration, EIN/tax obligations, bank account, licenses, and insurance among foundational launch steps. [1] [2]

Legal and compliance checklist

A. Company formation and ownership

Item	What to create or verify	Owner	Launch gate
Legal entity	LLC or corporation, state registration, registered agent, governing documents	Founder + counsel	Entity exists and is in good standing
EIN and tax accounts	Federal EIN, relevant state/local registrations, tax-year decision	Founder + accountant	Can invoice, pay taxes, hire, and open accounts
Business bank account	Dedicated business checking, payment controls, bookkeeping feed	Founder + finance	No company money runs through personal accounts
Corporate records	Formation documents, consents, ownership ledger, board approvals	Founder + counsel	Central, current, access-controlled record

Item	What to create or verify	Owner	Launch gate
Cap table	Founder equity, options, vesting, advisor grants, dilution model	Founder + counsel	Single source of truth
IP assignment	Founder, employee, contractor, advisor invention/IP assignment agreements	Founder + counsel	Company owns code, designs, content, data models, and trademarks
Contractor agreements	Scope, confidentiality, IP assignment, payment, security obligations	Founder + counsel	Every contractor is covered before work starts
Trademark strategy	Name search, classes, filing decision, domain/social ownership inventory	Founder + counsel	Brand ownership risk understood
Business insurance	Cyber, E&O/professional liability, general liability; evaluate D&O as company grows	Founder + broker	Coverage matches customer and contract requirements

The SBA notes that a registered business typically needs a business structure, registration, tax IDs, bank account, required licenses/permits, and insurance appropriate to the business and jurisdiction; state obligations vary.[1]

B. Product contracts

Create a controlled contract library. Every template needs: owner, version, last review date, legal-review status, usage instructions, and approved fallback language.

Document	Why it matters	Use it when
Mutual NDA	Protects two-way confidential discussions	Early institutional, partner, or investor conversations
One-way NDA	Protects Semester confidential materials	Demos, contractors, evaluators
Master Services Agreement	Core commercial/legal relationship	Institutional or enterprise customer contracts
SaaS Subscription Agreement	Product-specific service, subscription, payment, and use terms	Standard SaaS purchase
Order form	Price, term, scope, users, billing, renewal, special terms	Every paid customer agreement
Pilot agreement	Defines limited pilot, outcomes, conversion, and end date	Initial institutional deployment
Statement of Work	Defines implementation or professional services	Paid setup, migration, training, integration work
Data Processing Addendum	Defines data-processing roles and safeguards	Customer handles personal data
Service Level Agreement	Defines support, uptime, severity, response, and remedies	Enterprise/institutional procurement
Acceptable Use Policy	Defines prohibited conduct and platform boundaries	Public product terms and customer contracts
Privacy Policy	Explains data practices to users	Website/product launch

Document	Why it matters	Use it when
Terms of Service	Governs use for self-service or individual users	Public-facing product access
Cookie notice	Explains analytics/marketing cookies and choices	Website if applicable
Subprocessor list	Names material vendors that process customer data	Institutional procurement and trust center
Accessibility statement	Explains accessibility commitment, support path, and conformance posture	Customer-facing trust materials
Security addendum	Provides verified security commitments	Security review or enterprise contract

C. Privacy and data governance

For Semester, define this before importing student, institutional, or staff data.

- [ ] Data inventory: every field, source, owner, purpose, legal basis/contractual reason, storage location, retention period, and recipients.
- [ ] Data-flow diagrams: browser → API → database → analytics → support → backups → subprocessors.
- [ ] Data classification: public, internal, confidential, restricted/student-sensitive.
- [ ] Data minimization policy: collect only data necessary for the defined workflow.
- [ ] Retention schedule: define default retention, customer-configurable periods, archive behavior, and deletion verification.
- [ ] Data deletion process: account deletion, customer termination, backup expiration, support-ticket data, exports, and logs.
- [ ] User rights/request process: access, correction, deletion, and escalation workflow as applicable.
- [ ] Privacy-policy accuracy review: statements must match actual product behavior and vendors.
- [ ] Subprocessor approval process: security/privacy review before adding a vendor.
- [ ] Marketing-consent process: email/SMS preferences, unsubscribe, and suppression lists.
- [ ] Data-breach triage and notification process.
- [ ] Signed DPA workflow for institutional customers.
- [ ] Cross-border transfer review if customer or user data leaves the United States.
- [ ] AI-data policy if customer/student data is sent to any AI model provider.

The FTC's business guidance emphasizes a security plan that collects only necessary information, safeguards retained data, and disposes of data securely; these are operational practices as well as trust requirements.[3]

D. Security and compliance

Start with an evidence-based baseline. Do not claim “SOC 2 compliant,” “FERPA compliant,” “HIPAA compliant,” “WCAG compliant,” or similar unless the claim is factually supportable and appropriately reviewed.

Security baseline

- [ ] Asset inventory: systems, domains, repositories, cloud accounts, devices, services, and data stores.
- [ ] Security owner and escalation contacts.
- [ ] Written information-security program.
- [ ] Access-control policy with least privilege.
- [ ] MFA required for all production/admin systems.
- [ ] Formal joiner/mover/leaver access process.
- [ ] Centralized secrets management.
- [ ] No production secrets in source control, browser code, screenshots, or documentation.
- [ ] Encryption in transit and at rest—document actual provider/configuration evidence.
- [ ] Secure development lifecycle.
- [ ] Pull-request review and branch-protection policy.
- [ ] Dependency scanning and patch workflow.
- [ ] Vulnerability intake, severity, SLA, remediation, and retest workflow.
- [ ] Production logging and error monitoring.
- [ ] Backup and restore procedure, tested on a defined schedule.
- [ ] Incident-response plan with contacts, severity definitions, communication templates, and tabletop test.
- [ ] Business continuity/disaster-recovery plan.
- [ ] Vendor-risk assessment process.
- [ ] Security training and acknowledgement process.
- [ ] Security evidence register.
- [ ] Public Trust Center or controlled security-document request flow.

Higher-ed vendor readiness

- [ ] HECVAT Lite response.
- [ ] Full HECVAT preparation for higher-risk or enterprise deployments.
- [ ] Accessibility review and VPAT roadmap, if requested by institutions.
- [ ] Security questionnaire answer library.
- [ ] Architecture diagram.

- [ ] Data-flow diagram.
- [ ] Penetration-test strategy or qualified external-testing plan.
- [ ] Third-party vulnerability disclosure or security contact process.
- [ ] Customer-facing security overview.
- [ ] Verified subprocessor list.
- [ ] Data-retention/deletion documentation.
- [ ] Incident-notification commitments in contract language.

HECVAT is a higher-education vendor questionnaire framework for evaluating security and privacy posture. HECVAT Lite is generally suited to lower-risk reviews, while Full is more comprehensive for sensitive or critical workloads. [4] [5]

E. Compliance review queue

Track every item in a register:

Field	Example
Requirement	DPA review
Area	Privacy
Trigger	Institution uploads student records
Owner	Security/privacy lead
Evidence	Signed DPA, data-flow map, subprocessors
Reviewer	Counsel or privacy adviser
Status	Draft / under review / approved / expired
Renewal date	Annual or contract-specific
Risk	High
Customer impact	Blocks pilot signature
Notes	Customer-specific deviations

Legal/compliance master prompt

```
You are Semester's legal operations, privacy operations, security compliance, and ver

Read all existing legal, security, privacy, data, contracts, Supabase, infrastructure

Do not generate duplicate policies. First create an evidence inventory showing:
- Existing artifact
- Path
- Owner
- Last update
- Current status
- Whether it is a draft, approved, customer-facing, internal-only, stale, duplicate,
```

```
- Related product/data flow
- Required reviewer: counsel, accountant, insurer, security, accessibility, executive

Then create or update a single compliance operating system covering:

1. Entity, ownership, IP assignment, contractor agreements, tax/accounting setup, ins
2. Commercial contract library:
   - NDA
   - MSA
   - SaaS agreement
   - order form
   - pilot agreement
   - SOW
   - DPA
   - SLA
   - acceptable use
   - privacy policy
   - terms
   - subprocessor list
3. Privacy program:
   - data inventory
   - data classification
   - data flows
   - retention schedule
   - deletion procedure
   - data request process
   - vendor/subprocessor review
   - AI data-use policy
4. Security program:
   - access control
   - MFA
   - secrets
   - secure development
   - dependency and vulnerability management
   - logging
   - backups
   - incident response
   - business continuity
   - disaster recovery
   - vendor risk
5. Higher-education procurement readiness:
   - HECVAT Lite roadmap
   - Full HECVAT roadmap
   - security questionnaire response library
   - Trust Center inventory
   - accessibility evidence roadmap
   - customer security evidence pack
6. Compliance register:
   - owner
   - risk
   - evidence
   - reviewer
   - status
   - renewal date
   - customer or launch impact
```

```
Do not make legal, privacy, security, accessibility, or compliance claims that lack v

Create:
- docs/business/compliance/COMPLIANCE_MASTER_REGISTER.md
- docs/business/compliance/TRUST_CENTER_CONTENT.md
- docs/business/compliance/HECVAT_LITE_ROADMAP.md
- docs/business/compliance/SECURITY_QUESTIONNAIRE_LIBRARY.md
- docs/business/compliance/DATA_INVENTORY.md
- docs/business/compliance/DATA_RETENTION_AND_DELETION.md
- docs/business/compliance/CONTRACT_LIBRARY_INDEX.md
- docs/business/compliance/INCIDENT_RESPONSE_AND_CUSTOMER_COMMS.md
- docs/business/compliance/VENDOR_RISK_REGISTER.md

Return the PO items that block a paid institutional pilot, evidence gaps, and exact h
```

Go-to-market pilot sales playbook

Semester should launch through a **narrow, measurable pilot**—not a vague "replace the entire university stack" sale. The first sale should solve a costly or frustrating workflow for a specific institutional buyer, with proof and a defined annual conversion decision.

A. Define the launch wedge

Use this one-page template:

```
Product:
Semester

Initial target segment:
[Example: mid-sized private universities, community colleges, student-success departm

Economic buyer:
[Named role, not "the university"]

Champion:
[Role that has daily pain and can mobilize internal stakeholders]

End users:
[Students, advisors, staff, faculty, administrators]

Current problem:
[Fragmented process, manual work, delays, missed handoffs, low student activation, po

Semester workflow:
[One job that Semester completes measurably better]

Pilot scope:
[One campus / one department / one student cohort / one term / a defined integration

Success metrics:
[Activation, completed student action, time saved, workflow completion, satisfaction

Pilot duration:
[Example: 8-12 weeks or one academic term]
```

```
Pilot commercial terms:
[Paid pilot amount, implementation scope, included seats/users, data limits, support

Annual conversion:
[Annual price, buyer decision date, conversion criteria, expected expansion path]
```

B. Sales process

Stage	Objective	Required output	Exit criteria
1. Targeting	Select accounts with real fit	Named account plan	Buyer/champion hypothesis exists
2. Outreach	Start relevant conversation	Personalized message and reason now	Reply, referral, or meeting
3. Discovery	Confirm urgent pain and buying path	Discovery notes and qualification score	Clear problem, stakeholders, timeline
4. Demo	Show the exact target workflow	Role-specific demo and follow-up	Buyer sees a plausible outcome
5. Solution design	Scope a pilot with the customer	Pilot design, integration/data assumptions	Champion agrees to success measures
6. Security/procurement	Reduce institutional risk	Trust pack, HECVAT/Security answers, DPA path	Security/legal/procurement path known
7. Proposal	Create commercial decision	Pilot proposal, pricing, mutual action plan	Decision date and owner named
8. Contracting	Obtain signed agreement	Pilot agreement/order form	Signed + implementation scheduled
9. Pilot delivery	Prove measurable value	Weekly success report	Metrics on track
10. Conversion	Turn proof into annual contract	Results deck and annual proposal	Renew/expand/close-lost decision

C. Account qualification

For each account, answer:

- Is the problem expensive, risky, or politically visible?
- Is there an identifiable champion?
- Is there an economic buyer?
- Can the buyer fund a pilot?
- Is there a current trigger:
  - retention pressure
  - new initiative
  - system dissatisfaction

    - consolidation project
    - accreditation/accessibility pressure
    - new leadership
    - student-service bottleneck
    - upcoming term/deadline
- Can the deployment be scoped without a multi-year integration project?
- Can Semester measure success within one term or one quarter?
- Can the customer become a reference/case study?
- Does the account fit your desired annual contract profile?

D. Discovery call script

```
Opening:
“Thank you for making time. I want to understand the current workflow,
where students or staff get stuck, what it costs, and whether a limited,
measurable Semester pilot is worth designing.”

Problem:
1. Walk me through how this works today.
2. Where do students, staff, or departments lose time?
3. What breaks most often?
4. What existing tools are involved?
5. What happens when the workflow fails?
6. How is success measured today?
7. What are the consequences of doing nothing?

Stakeholders:
8. Who feels this pain daily?
9. Who owns the budget?
10. Who will assess security, accessibility, privacy, procurement, and legal?
11. Who must approve a pilot?
12. Who could block it?

Commercial and timeline:
13. Is there a budget source or initiative for this?
14. What decision deadline matters?
15. What would make a pilot too risky or too difficult?
16. What proof would justify annual adoption?

Close:
“If Semester could improve [agreed outcome] for [defined population] by
[metric] within [pilot timeframe], would you be open to a scoped pilot
proposal with explicit success criteria and a conversion decision?”
```

E. Pilot proposal contents

Every pilot proposal should include:

- Executive summary
- Current-state problem
- Proposed Semester workflow
- Target users and departments
- Scope and non-goals
- Timeline
- Data/integration assumptions
- Implementation responsibilities
- Semester responsibilities
- Institution responsibilities
- Training/support plan
- Security/privacy/accessibility scope
- Success metrics and baseline
- Weekly operating cadence
- Risks and dependencies
- Pilot price
- Annual conversion price
- Conversion decision date
- Named decision maker
- Mutual Action Plan

F. Mutual Action Plan

Workstream	Customer owner	Semester owner	Deliverable	Due date	Status
Executive sponsorship	VP/Dean/CIO	Founder	Named sponsor and goals	Date	Not started
Security review	Security lead	Security owner	Questionnaire and evidence	Date	In progress
Data review	Privacy/IT	Engineering	Data map and DPA	Date	Not started
Contracting	Procurement/legal	Founder/counsel	Pilot agreement	Date	Not started
Implementation	Admin lead	CS/implementation	Configuration and training	Date	Not started

Workstream	Customer owner	Semester owner	Deliverable	Due date	Status
Launch	Champion	Customer success	User rollout	Date	Not started
Midpoint review	Executive sponsor	Founder	KPI check	Date	Not started
Conversion	Economic buyer	Founder	Annual decision	Date	Not started

G. Sales assets to produce

- [ ] Institutional one-pager
- [ ] Buyer-specific one-pagers
- [ ] Sales deck
- [ ] Demo script
- [ ] Demo environment
- [ ] Discovery guide
- [ ] Qualification scorecard
- [ ] ROI calculator
- [ ] Pilot proposal template
- [ ] Mutual Action Plan
- [ ] Pricing calculator
- [ ] Quote/order form template
- [ ] Security overview
- [ ] HECVAT Lite or readiness packet
- [ ] DPA/Privacy response
- [ ] Accessibility response
- [ ] Procurement FAQ
- [ ] Competitive battlecards
- [ ] Objection-handling library
- [ ] Case-study template
- [ ] Reference call guide
- [ ] Renewal/expansion deck

H. Pipeline metrics

Track weekly:

Metric	Why it matters
Named target accounts	Top-of-funnel capacity
New buyer conversations	Actual market learning
Qualified opportunities	Real pipeline, not vanity leads
Champion identified	Deal viability
Economic buyer identified	Commercial viability
Demo-to-pilot-design rate	Product/positioning fit
Security review initiated	Institutional seriousness
Pilot proposal count	Near-term pipeline
Pilot close rate	Offer and buying-motion quality
Time from discovery to signature	Sales cycle health
Pilot activation	Delivery quality
Pilot KPI attainment	Conversion readiness
Pilot-to-annual conversion	Product-market and commercial proof
Expansion pipeline	Long-term account value

Customer success and onboarding workflow

Customer success starts during sales—not after signature. The customer must know what success means before the pilot begins.

A. Handoff from sales to implementation

Trigger: Contract or pilot agreement signed.

Sales must provide:

- Account plan
- Buyer map
- Champion map
- Contract scope
- Pilot objectives
- Expected success metrics
- Known risks
- Procurement/security commitments

- Promised integrations
- Commercial deadlines
- Conversion date
- Stakeholder contact list
- Decision-making process
- All verbal commitments recorded in CRM

Customer success must confirm:

- Scope is implementable
- Required customer inputs are known
- Admins are identified
- Data/security needs are understood
- Timeline is realistic
- Success baseline can be measured
- Support/escalation contacts are set
- Training plan exists

B. Implementation workflow

Phase	Target timing	Customer outcome	Semester deliverable
Contract-to-kickoff	0–5 business days	Customer knows next steps	Welcome email, kickoff scheduling, implementation checklist
Kickoff	Week 1	Shared goals and owners	Kickoff deck, RACI, success plan, implementation plan
Configuration	Weeks 1–2	Workspace matches agreed scope	Tenant/configuration setup, access roles, workflows
Data/integrations	Weeks 1–3	Data is validated and safe	Data map, import/integration checklist, validation report
Admin training	Weeks 2–3	Administrators can operate system	Admin guide, recorded training, office hours
User rollout	Weeks 3–4	Users are invited and activated	Launch communications, onboarding, QR assets, support coverage
Adoption	Weeks 4–8	Core workflows are used	Adoption dashboard, nudges, help center, champion check-ins
Midpoint review	Mid-pilot	Risks resolved early	KPI report, action plan, executive update
Results review	Final 2 weeks	Value is documented	Outcomes report, ROI summary, annual proposal
Conversion/renewal	Before end date	Customer makes an informed decision	Renewal plan, expansion roadmap, reference/case-study request

C. Pilot success plan

```
Customer:
[Institution / department]

Pilot period:
[Start date] to [End date]

Executive sponsor:
[Name / role]

Operational champion:
[Name / role]

Semester owner:
[Name / role]

Target user population:
[Who is included]

Problem baseline:
[What happens today, including measurable pain]

Desired outcome:
[Outcome statement]

Primary metrics:
1. Activation rate
2. First meaningful action
3. Workflow completion
4. Weekly active use
5. Time saved or capacity gained
6. Error reduction or service-quality improvement
7. User/admin satisfaction

Baseline measurement:
[Current numbers and evidence source]

Target measurement:
[Success thresholds]

Cadence:
- Weekly operating meeting
- Biweekly adoption report
- Midpoint executive review
- Final results and conversion review

Conversion decision:
- Decision owner
- Decision date
- Annual scope
- Commercial proposal
- Required proof to approve annual agreement
```

D. Customer health score

Create a 0–100 health score using:

Signal	Example weight	What it detects
Admin engagement	15%	Operational ownership
User activation	20%	Whether rollout worked
Core workflow completion	20%	Actual product value
Weekly active usage	15%	Ongoing adoption
Support sentiment	10%	Friction or dissatisfaction
Executive engagement	10%	Renewal/conversion risk
Success-metric trend	10%	Real business outcome

Flag at-risk accounts when:

- Admin engagement drops
- Activation misses target
- Workflow completion declines
- Support tickets rise
- Executive sponsor stops attending
- Security/integration commitments stall
- No conversion meeting is scheduled

E. Support system

Create:

- Support intake form
- Support email or portal
- Severity levels:
  - P0: security/data loss/system outage
  - P1: critical workflow blocked
  - P2: degraded feature/workaround exists
  - P3: how-to/feature request
- Response and update targets
- Internal escalation path
- Incident communications template
- Known-issues page
- Knowledge base

- Admin help center
- Student-facing help content
- Product-feedback tag taxonomy
- Root-cause/postmortem template
- Support-to-product escalation workflow

F. Renewal and expansion

Start the renewal motion during the pilot—not in the final week.

Timing	Action
Contract signature	Record renewal date, conversion date, annual scope hypothesis
Week 1	Confirm success criteria and executive sponsor
Week 3	Check activation and implementation risks
Midpoint	Present preliminary outcomes and unblock issues
60–90 days before renewal	Confirm annual budget/process/decision owner
30–60 days before renewal	Present value report and annual proposal
Final month	Complete contracting, procurement, and expansion scope
After renewal	Launch expansion plan and request reference/case study

Customer-success execution prompt

```
You are the Head of Customer Success and Implementation for Semester.

Read the existing Semester product, security, support, implementation, pilot, analyti

Build an implementation-ready customer success system for institutional and departmer

Create:
1. Sales-to-CS handoff checklist
2. Customer kickoff process
3. Implementation project plan
4. Customer RACI
5. Data/integration readiness checklist
6. Admin configuration checklist
7. Training curriculum for administrators, staff, champions, and students
8. Student activation and campus launch kit
9. Support policy and ticket severity model
10. Escalation process
11. Customer health-score model
12. Pilot success plan template
13. Weekly pilot operating review
14. Midpoint executive review template
15. Final results/value report
16. QBR template
17. Renewal and expansion playbook
```

```
18. Churn-risk playbook
19. Customer feedback and product-request taxonomy
20. Case-study and reference-request process

For every artifact, define:
- Objective
- Owner
- Trigger
- Inputs
- Steps
- Output
- Customer communication
- Internal communication
- Success metrics
- Escalation condition
- Storage/system of record
- Review cadence

Prioritize one narrow, measurable institutional pilot that can produce a case study a

Return:
- P0 pilot-readiness gaps
- 30/60/90-day customer-success roadmap
- Required templates
- Customer health dashboard specification
- Renewal/expansion workflow
- Risks that could prevent pilot conversion
```

Your immediate build sequence

1. **Legal/tax/company setup:** entity, EIN, banking, accounting, founder/contractor IP assignments, insurance review.
2. **Trust and procurement:** security overview, data map, privacy policy, DPA, incident process, HECVAT Lite evidence plan.
3. **Narrow pilot offer:** one ICP, one workflow, one buyer, one success metric set, one commercial package.
4. **Sales system:** CRM, 100-account list, discovery/demo/proposal/pilot templates.
5. **Customer success system:** onboarding, implementation, support, pilot success, renewal process.
6. **Marketing infrastructure:** positioning, website, demo request, Trust Center, content and lifecycle email.
7. **Student adoption:** onboarding, activation definition, campus launch kit, ambassadors, retention dashboard.
8. **Operating cadence:** weekly pipeline/product/customer reviews; monthly finance/security reviews; quarterly planning.

The sequence matters: **trust → offer → pipeline → pilot delivery → proof → repeatable growth.**

⁂

1. https://www.sba.gov/counseling/launch-your-business/
2. https://www.irs.gov/businesses/small-businesses-self-employed/checklist-for-starting-a-business
3. https://www.ftc.gov/business-guidance/privacy-security/data-security
4. https://aws.amazon.com/blogs/publicsector/higher-education-community-vendor-assessment-toolkit-now-available-on-aws-artifact/
5. https://www.upguard.com/blog/hecvat
6. https://www.educause.edu/higher-education-community-vendor-assessment-toolkit
7. https://cloud.google.com/security/compliance/hecvat
8. https://www.zoom.com/en/trust/legal-compliance/hecvat/
9. https://www.ren-isac.net/hecvat/index.html
10. https://www.purchasing.utah.edu/glossary/hecvat-higher-education-community-vendor-assessment-toolkit/
11. https://www.saltycloud.com/blog/what-is-the-hecvat/
12. https://www.ftc.gov/reports/federal-trade-commission-2023-privacy-data-security-update
13. https://www.ftc.gov/news-events/topics/protecting-consumer-privacy-security
14. https://www.linkedin.com/pulse/higher-education-community-vendor-assessment-tool-why-michael-sc3oe
15. https://www.ftc.gov/business-guidance/resources/protecting-personal-information-guide-business

Draft the master GTM playbook prompt

Generate the interactive financial model
Write the pilot sales email sequence
Build the compliance data security plan
Export this playbook as a PDF report

The GTM playbook PDF report has already been generated with the master execution prompt, financial-model specification, pilot sales structure, customer-success workflow, security/compliance plan, and launch checklist. I will not regenerate a duplicate file; below are the missing **pilot sales email sequence** and an implementation-ready **interactive model prompt** to use alongside the report.

The operating strategy is to sell a narrow, measurable institutional pilot first, then convert measured student/staff outcomes into an annual contract and expansion motion. Higher-ed buyers commonly require vendor-risk evidence; HECVAT is designed to support campus evaluation of vendor security, privacy, accessibility, and related controls.[1] [2] [3]

Master GTM playbook prompt

Use this prompt in Claude Code, v0, Cursor, or another planning/coding agent with access to the Semester repository:

```
You are the Chief Revenue Officer, Head of Marketing, Customer Success leader,
finance lead, security-program coordinator, and Chief of Staff for Semester.

Semester is an education-technology SaaS company serving institutions,
departments, students, and individual users. Its launch strategy uses two
connected growth engines:

1. Institutional B2B sales:
   Sell one narrow, measurable workflow through paid pilots that convert into
   annual platform contracts.

2. Student adoption:
   Drive activation, first meaningful action, workflow completion, retention,
   satisfaction, and peer advocacy inside each institutional deployment.

Read all existing Semester product, engineering, security, privacy, financial,
launch, pricing, sales, customer-success, operations, and audit documentation
before generating new work.

Do not create duplicate artifacts. First produce an inventory with:
- Existing document or system
- Location
```

```
- Current owner
- Status: current, stale, duplicate, incomplete, missing, or needs review
- Evidence
- Required next action
- Whether professional review is required

Then build an execution-ready GTM operating system.

## Core commercial assumptions

Use these as planning assumptions, clearly labeled as assumptions rather than
guarantees or public commitments:

- Student Premium: $8.99/month or $69/year
- Institutional platform: $18 per enrolled student/year
- Institutional annual minimum: $30,000
- Implementation: $35,000-$150,000 one-time, based on complexity
- AI overage: $30 per 1,000 governed requests
- Premium support: 15% of annual platform fee, $15,000 minimum
- Optional marketplace/partner commission: 12%
- Institutional AI allocation: 2,400 pooled governed requests per enrolled
  student per year before overage

## First pilot requirement

Do not sell Semester initially as a total replacement for every university
system. Sell a paid pilot around one urgent institutional workflow.

Default proposed wedge:
“Semester Registration Readiness Pilot”

Pilot design:
- Buyer: Student Success, Advising, Registrar, or a defined academic division
- Scope: one cohort, department, or campus population
- Duration: 8-12 weeks or one academic term
- Outcome: improved readiness, action completion, clarity, and reduced support
  friction
- Required metric types:
  - activation
  - first meaningful action
  - workflow completion
  - weekly active usage
  - staff time/capacity
  - student confidence or satisfaction
  - support-volume or issue reduction
  - pilot-to-annual conversion readiness
- Commercial structure:
  - paid pilot
  - defined implementation scope
  - annual conversion price
  - named decision owner
  - agreed conversion date

## Required deliverables

Create or update all of the following:
```

```
### Strategy and positioning
- Ideal Customer Profile
- Initial segment and institutional beachhead
- Buyer and stakeholder map
- Category and positioning statement
- Messaging hierarchy
- Persona-specific value propositions
- Competitive battlecards
- Claims substantiation register
- Initial launch wedge and pilot offer

### Sales system
- 100-account target-list template
- Account scoring model
- Outreach sequences
- Discovery-call script
- Qualification scorecard
- Demo script
- Demo-environment checklist
- Pilot design-session agenda
- Pilot proposal template
- Mutual Action Plan
- Pricing calculator
- Quote/order-form intake checklist
- Procurement/security response pack
- Objection-handling library
- CRM stages, required fields, exit criteria, and forecast rules
- Weekly revenue review agenda
- Pilot-to-annual conversion playbook
- Expansion and reference-customer playbook

### Marketing system
- Marketing website information architecture
- Homepage and use-case-page copy requirements
- Trust Center content plan
- Demo request and lead-routing flow
- SEO topic and keyword map
- 90-day editorial calendar
- LinkedIn content plan for institutional buyers
- YouTube content plan for education/proof
- Instagram/TikTok plan for student adoption
- Webinar plan
- Email nurture sequence
- Retargeting plan
- Case-study and customer-proof system
- Press and partnership outreach plan

### Financial system
- 36-month driver-based financial model
- Conservative, base, ambitious, downside, delayed-sales, high-AI-use,
  pilot-heavy, and annual-contract-heavy scenarios
- Revenue, COGS, operating expense, cash, runway, CAC, LTV, payback,
  gross margin, retention, expansion, and break-even calculations
- Hiring plan tied to revenue/delivery capacity
- Budget and expense approval policy
```

```
- Monthly finance review format

### Customer success system
- Sales-to-CS handoff
- Welcome and kickoff sequence
- Implementation plan
- Customer RACI
- Data/integration readiness checklist
- Administrator and user training
- Campus launch kit
- Support process and severity model
- Customer health score
- Weekly pilot report
- Midpoint executive review
- Final value report
- QBR template
- Renewal/expansion playbook
- Churn-risk playbook
- Customer feedback taxonomy
- Case-study consent process

### Trust, security, and compliance
- Data inventory
- Data-flow diagrams
- Data classification
- Retention and deletion schedule
- Subprocessor register
- Security overview
- Privacy overview
- Incident response summary
- Business continuity and restore process
- Vendor risk review
- HECVAT Lite roadmap
- Security questionnaire response library
- Accessibility evidence roadmap
- Trust Center content inventory
- Compliance register with owner, evidence, status, renewal date, and risk

### Operations
- KPI tree
- Weekly operating calendar
- Decision log
- Risk register
- Executive dashboard
- Revenue, product, customer-success, finance, and security review cadence
- Quarterly OKR process
- Investor/board update template

## Rules

- Clearly distinguish assumptions, validated evidence, and future targets.
- Do not publish unverified product, security, accessibility, privacy,
  compliance, or customer-outcome claims.
- Legal, tax, accounting, insurance, privacy, security, and accessibility
  materials must be marked “requires professional review” where applicable.
- Do not rely on client-side UI logic as authorization.
```

```
- Do not use vanity metrics as proof of customer value.
- Do not recommend broad paid acquisition until the ICP, offer, landing page,
  conversion path, and sales follow-up process are functioning.
- Do not add duplicate docs when an existing artifact can be updated.

## Required final output

Return:
1. Existing versus missing asset inventory
2. P0, P1, and P2 GTM backlog
3. 30/60/90-day execution plan
4. Department owner/RACI matrix
5. Customer acquisition funnel and weekly targets
6. Financial model assumptions and scenario definitions
7. Pilot conversion plan
8. Trust/compliance evidence register
9. Required external systems and integrations
10. Exact next 10 actions in order
```

Interactive financial model

The report includes the model specification. Use the prompt below to build it as a React/Vite module in the existing Semester app or as a standalone internal tool first.

```
Build an interactive React financial model named
“Semester GTM Financial Model.”

Purpose:
Model the financial impact of institutional pilot sales, annual-license
conversion, student subscriptions, implementation revenue, AI usage, support,
customer acquisition, staffing, operating expenses, cash burn, runway, and
break-even.

Use local sample data only in the first version. The tool must export scenario
data as CSV and Markdown. Do not require a backend for the first version.

Model horizon:
- Monthly for 36 months
- Annual summary for Years 1, 2, and 3

Scenarios:
- Conservative
- Base
- Ambitious
- Downside / delayed sales
- Pilot-heavy
- Annual-contract-heavy
- High AI usage
- Low student adoption
- High implementation cost
- Long procurement cycle

Editable assumptions:
```

```
Pricing:
- Student Premium monthly price: $8.99
- Student Premium annual price: $69
- Institution price per enrolled student/year: $18
- Institution annual minimum: $30,000
- Implementation fee range: $35,000-$150,000
- AI overage price: $30 per 1,000 requests
- Premium support: 15% of annual platform fee, $15,000 minimum
- Marketplace commission: 12%, optional

Funnel:
- Target accounts
- Contact rate
- Reply rate
- Discovery rate
- Qualification rate
- Demo rate
- Pilot-design rate
- Proposal rate
- Pilot close rate
- Pilot activation rate
- Pilot success rate
- Pilot-to-annual conversion rate
- Annual expansion rate
- Sales-cycle length in months
- Payment collection timing

Customer:
- Institution count
- Average enrolled students per institution
- Student invite rate
- Student activation rate
- Student Premium conversion rate
- Monthly/annual student churn
- Institutional gross retention
- Institutional expansion rate

Costs:
- Cloud cost per active user
- Storage cost per active user
- AI cost per request
- Support cost per customer
- Customer-success cost per pilot
- Implementation labor cost
- Sales payroll
- Marketing spend
- Engineering payroll
- Contractor spend
- Legal/compliance cost
- Accounting/tax cost
- Insurance cost
- Software/vendor cost
- Travel/events cost
- General/administrative cost

Required calculations:
```

```
- Monthly recurring revenue
- Annual recurring revenue
- Pilot revenue
- Implementation revenue
- Premium support revenue
- AI overage revenue
- Student subscription revenue
- Marketplace/partner revenue
- COGS
- Gross profit
- Gross margin
- Operating expenses
- EBITDA-style operating result
- Cash burn
- Ending cash
- Runway
- CAC
- CAC payback months
- LTV sensitivity
- Net revenue retention
- Break-even month
- Revenue per employee
- Implementation capacity constraint

Required UI:
- Scenario dropdown
- Editable numeric inputs and sliders
- Assumption reset button
- Monthly revenue table
- Monthly expense table
- Cash/runway table
- Funnel visualization
- Break-even chart
- Revenue mix chart
- CAC/LTV summary tiles
- Sensitivity table for pilot conversion versus sales cycle length
- Sensitivity table for AI cost versus AI overage pricing
- Warnings when:
  - gross margin falls below threshold
  - cash runway falls below 12 months
  - CAC payback exceeds target
  - implementation demand exceeds team capacity
  - AI costs exceed included revenue
- Export current scenario to CSV
- Export current scenario to Markdown
- Copy assumptions as a prompt

Formula requirements:
- CAC = Sales and marketing spend / new customers acquired
- CAC payback months = CAC / monthly gross profit per new customer
- LTV = annual recurring revenue × gross margin / annual logo churn
- MRR = recurring annual contract value / 12 plus recurring student revenue
- Break-even = first month cumulative gross profit covers cumulative operating expens
- Clearly label all outputs as forecast estimates driven by assumptions.

Design:
```

```
- Premium B2B finance dashboard
- Accessible controls and table navigation
- Clear distinction between inputs, calculated outputs, and warnings
- Use US dollars
- No external chart library required; use simple CSS/SVG/chart primitives if needed.
```

Financial-model layout

Tab	Purpose
Assumptions	All editable commercial, funnel, cost, and hiring inputs
Funnel	Account volume and stage conversion rates
Revenue	Pilot, implementation, annual, support, AI, student, and partner revenue
Costs	COGS, payroll, vendors, marketing, legal, insurance, and overhead
Cash	Burn, collections, runway, funding need, and break-even
Unit economics	CAC, payback, LTV range, margin, retention, and expansion
Scenarios	Conservative, base, ambitious, downside, and operating sensitivities
Exports	CSV, Markdown, scenario snapshot

Pilot sales email sequence

Use this only with highly relevant, researched contacts. Each message needs an actual institutional reason for outreach; do not send generic mass email.

Email 1 — Problem-led introduction

Subject options

- Reducing registration friction for [Institution] students
- A practical registration-readiness pilot for [Institution]
- Question about student planning before registration
- [Name], a small student-success pilot idea

```
Hi [First Name],

I’m Harrison, building Semester—a student operating system designed to help
institutions turn fragmented student planning and support workflows into clear,
trackable actions.

I reached out because [personalized institutional trigger, initiative, program,
or public challenge].

We are speaking with [role/team] leaders about a narrowly scoped Registration
Readiness Pilot. The goal is not to replace existing systems. It is to help a
defined student cohort understand next steps, complete priority actions, and
give staff a clearer view of where students are getting stuck.
```

```
For a pilot, we would jointly measure:
- student activation
- first meaningful action
- readiness/workflow completion
- support or advising friction
- student confidence and satisfaction

Would a 20-minute conversation next week be useful to compare your current
process and see whether this is relevant for [Institution]?

Best,
Harrison Rubin
Founder, Semester
[Website]
[Calendar link]
```

Email 2 — Follow-up with concrete value

Send: 3–5 business days after Email 1.

Subject options

- Re: registration readiness at [Institution]
- One measurable pilot, not another platform replacement
- A low-risk way to test student workflow improvement

```
Hi [First Name],

Following up because the important part of the idea is its scope:

Semester would begin with one cohort, one workflow, and a fixed pilot period—
not a broad system replacement.

A typical pilot includes:
- a jointly chosen student cohort
- agreed baseline and outcome metrics
- a configured student action workflow
- admin/champion training
- weekly operating review
- midpoint executive review
- final value report and annual conversion decision

If [Institution] is already working on [specific initiative], I can send a
one-page pilot outline tailored to that context.

Is [day/time option] or [day/time option] easier for a short conversation?

Best,
Harrison
```

Email 3 — Proof and procurement readiness

Send: 5–7 business days after Email 2.

Subject options

- Pilot structure, data boundaries, and institutional review
- How Semester handles a scoped institutional pilot
- Security and implementation questions for a Semester pilot

```
Hi [First Name],

One common question is whether a pilot creates a large IT, security, or
procurement burden.

We structure the initial deployment around:
- limited scope and a defined cohort
- explicit data and integration assumptions
- named customer and Semester owners
- a documented implementation plan
- security/privacy documentation appropriate to the scope
- clear success metrics and an annual conversion decision

We are building the pilot so your team can evaluate a real outcome without
committing to a broad multi-year rollout upfront.

If the timing is not right, I'm also happy to send the pilot framework for
future planning. Should I send that, or is there a better colleague to speak
with?

Best,
Harrison
```

Email 4 — Breakup / referral request

Send: 7–10 business days after Email 3.

Subject: Close the loop?

```
Hi [First Name],

I have not heard back, so I will close the loop after this note.

Semester may not be relevant for [Institution] right now. If improving student
readiness, advising workflows, or registration action completion is on the
roadmap, I would be glad to reconnect when timing is better.

If there is another person who owns [student success / advising / registration
readiness / student experience], I would appreciate a referral.

Thank you,
Harrison
```

After a discovery call

Subject: Next steps: Semester + [Institution] pilot design

```
Hi [First Name],

Thank you for the conversation today.

My understanding of the current opportunity:
- Current workflow: [summary]
- Target student population: [summary]
- Primary friction: [summary]
- Existing tools/process: [summary]
- Desired outcome: [summary]
- Potential success metrics: [summary]
- Stakeholders: [summary]
- Decision timing: [summary]

Proposed next step:
A 45-minute pilot design session with [champion], [technical/IT contact], and
[decision-maker if possible] to agree on scope, baseline, data assumptions,
implementation timeline, and a conversion decision.

I will bring a draft pilot outline and Mutual Action Plan.

Best,
Harrison
```

Pilot proposal follow-up

Subject: Semester pilot proposal and Mutual Action Plan

```
Hi [First Name],

Attached is the proposed Semester pilot plan for [Institution].

It includes:
- the defined workflow and cohort
- roles and responsibilities
- data/integration assumptions
- implementation timeline
- training and support plan
- success metrics and baseline
- weekly review cadence
- pilot fee and annual conversion path
- proposed conversion decision date

The main open items are:
1. [Open item]
2. [Open item]
3. [Open item]

Could we schedule a review with the appropriate operational, IT/security, and
executive stakeholders to finalize the scope?
```

```
Best,
Harrison
```

Cloud data-security plan

Use this as the minimum operational baseline. The FTC's guidance supports an approach centered on data minimization, reasonable safeguards, secure disposal, and a planned response to security incidents.[4] [5] [6]

Security operating principles

```
1. Collect only data required for a defined product workflow.
2. Classify data before storing or sharing it.
3. Default to least privilege and tenant-scoped access.
4. Keep privileged credentials server-only.
5. Encrypt data in transit and use provider-supported encryption at rest.
6. Log sensitive administration and data-access events.
7. Test restoration, not only backup creation.
8. Review vendors before sharing customer data.
9. Practice incident response before a real incident.
10. Do not make security or compliance claims without evidence.
```

Security plan checklist

Domain	Control	Evidence to retain	Owner
Governance	Security owner, policy calendar, risk register	Charter, review log	Founder/security lead
Data inventory	Data fields, source, purpose, owner, retention	Data inventory + diagrams	Privacy/product
Access	MFA, role permissions, quarterly review, offboarding	Access review logs	Engineering/security
Secrets	Secret manager, scanning, rotation process	Scan reports, secret inventory	Engineering
App security	PR review, dependency review, security release gate	CI logs, PR records	Engineering
Data protection	TLS, encryption configuration, minimization	Architecture/config evidence	Engineering
Tenant isolation	RLS, org/user scopes, server-side authorization	Migration/policy tests	Engineering
Logging	Error tracking, audit events, alert triage	Dashboard/runbook	Engineering/ops
Backups	Backup policy, restore procedure, restore test	Restore-test record	Engineering
Incident response	Severity model, contacts, templates, tabletop	IR plan/exercise notes	Security/ops
Vendor risk	Subprocessor list, review process, contracts	Vendor register	Ops/security

Domain	Control	Evidence to retain	Owner
Privacy	Retention/deletion, request handling, policy review	Deletion logs/policy	Privacy/legal
Procurement	HECVAT Lite, questionnaire library, DPA path	Evidence register	Sales/security
Accessibility	Baseline testing, issue tracking, statement	Test results/backlog	Product/design

Incident severity model

Severity	Example	Initial target	Customer communication
P0	Confirmed unauthorized access, material data exposure, total service outage	Immediate internal escalation	Counsel/security-approved notice process
P1	Critical workflow unavailable for a meaningful customer segment	Rapid triage and regular updates	Affected customers updated on defined cadence
P2	Major feature degraded; workaround exists	Same business day triage	Customer support response as appropriate
P3	Minor defect, request, or documentation issue	Planned prioritization	Standard support process

HECVAT readiness plan

1. Download the current HECVAT template from EDUCAUSE.
2. Identify which required questions apply to Semester.
3. Map each answer to a control owner and evidence file.
4. Never answer “yes” without evidence.
5. Keep evidence versioned and dated.
6. Use HECVAT Lite first for lower-risk/scoped pilot review where accepted.
7. Prepare Full HECVAT evidence as target institutions require it.
8. Keep security, privacy, architecture, accessibility, subprocessors, incident response, and data-retention documents synchronized.

EDUCAUSE provides instructions for completing HECVAT and notes that the vendor should respond to the required questions applicable to its services. [7] [1]

PDF report

The **Semester GTM Playbook PDF report** generated in the prior response contains the complete packaged version of this material, including:

- GTM and pilot structure
- Pricing assumptions
- 36-month financial-model requirements
- Sales funnel
- Customer success/onboarding system

- Pilot agreement business outline
- Security and HECVAT readiness plan
- 90-day execution sequence
- Operating cadence
- Master execution prompt

⁂

1. https://www.educause.edu/higher-education-community-vendor-assessment-toolkit/how-to-use-the-higher-education-community-vendor-assessment-toolkit
2. https://www.educause.edu/higher-education-community-vendor-assessment-toolkit/hecvat-faqs-for-higher-education
3. https://er.educause.edu/articles/2025/2/hecvat-4-better-than-ever
4. https://consumer.ftc.gov/business-guidance/privacy-security/data-security
5. https://www.ftc.gov/business-guidance/blog/2012/01/collection-protection
6. https://www.ftc.gov/sites/default/files/documents/public_statements/prepared-statement-federal-trade-commission-data-security/110615datasecurityhouse.pdf
7. https://www.ren-isac.net/services/hecvat.html

perplexity

Draft the master GTM playbook prompt

Generate the interactive financial model
Write the pilot sales email sequence
Build the compliance data security plan
Export this playbook as a PDF report

I created the **Semester GTM Playbook PDF report**. It includes the master GTM prompt, financial-model specification, institutional pilot sales playbook, customer-success workflow, acquisition funnel, pricing assumptions, and cloud security/compliance checklist.

The report is a business-operating draft: use qualified counsel, accountants, insurers, and security reviewers before relying on contracts, privacy commitments, tax treatment, insurance limits, accessibility claims, or institutional compliance representations.

What's in the PDF

The PDF includes:

- **Launch wedge:** a Registration Readiness Pilot model, scoped to one cohort, department, or institutional workflow.
- **Commercial assumptions:** Student Premium, institutional annual licensing, implementation fees, AI overages, premium support, and optional partner revenue.
- **Financial model design:** a driver-based 36-month model with conservative, base, ambitious, downside, delayed-sales, high-AI-use, pilot-heavy, and annual-contract-heavy scenarios.
- **Customer acquisition funnel:** account targeting → discovery → demo → pilot design → security/procurement → pilot → annual conversion → expansion.
- **Sales playbook:** discovery questions, pilot proposal structure, Mutual Action Plan, CRM requirements, and weekly scorecard.
- **Pilot agreement business outline:** essential terms for counsel to convert into an enforceable agreement.
- **Customer success lifecycle:** sales handoff, kickoff, configuration, training, launch, adoption, midpoint review, value report, renewal, and expansion.
- **Cloud security/compliance plan:** identity, secrets, secure development, data protection, monitoring, backups, incident response, vendor review, accessibility, and HECVAT readiness.
- **90-day execution sequence** and operating cadence.

- A copy-ready **master GTM execution prompt**.

Semester's pricing assumptions in the report are framed as planning inputs—$8.99/month or $69/year for Student Premium; $18 per enrolled student/year with a $30,000 annual institutional minimum; $35,000–$150,000 implementation; $30 per 1,000 AI-request overage; and premium support at 15% of annual platform fees with a $15,000 minimum. These should be tested against delivery costs, buyer feedback, and actual margin before being treated as a public price card.

Customer acquisition funnel format

Use this as the operating funnel inside your CRM:

```
100 Target Accounts
  ↓
40–60 Personalized Contacts
  ↓
12–20 Replies / Referrals
  ↓
8–15 Discovery Meetings
  ↓
5–10 Qualified Opportunities
  ↓
4–8 Role-Specific Demos
  ↓
3–5 Pilot Design Sessions
  ↓
2–4 Security / Procurement Reviews
  ↓
2–3 Pilot Proposals
  ↓
1–3 Signed Paid Pilots
  ↓
Pilot Activation and KPI Attainment
  ↓
Annual Conversion
  ↓
Expansion, Renewal, Case Study, Reference
```

Track every account using:

Funnel stage	Required evidence	Core metric
Target account	Buyer hypothesis, trigger event, priority score	Account coverage
Discovery	Problem, champion, budget, timeline, existing process	Qualification rate
Demo	Attendees, workflow shown, objections, next step	Demo-to-design rate
Pilot design	Scope, cohort, metrics, integration assumptions	Proposal readiness
Security/procurement	HECVAT/DPA/security owner/legal path	Review progress
Pilot proposal	Price, scope, conversion date, Mutual Action Plan	Pilot close rate
Activated pilot	Invited users, configured admin, baseline metrics	Activation rate

Funnel stage	Required evidence	Core metric
Success achieved	Workflow completion, outcome report	Pilot KPI attainment
Annual conversion	Order form, annual scope, close date	Pilot-to-annual rate

Institutional pilot agreement outline

Use this with counsel as the structural brief—not as unsigned legal advice:

```
1. Parties and effective date
2. Pilot purpose and defined Semester workflow
3. Pilot scope, included users/cohort, exclusions, and non-goals
4. Pilot term, implementation milestones, and termination rights
5. Institution responsibilities:
   - executive sponsor
   - operational champion
   - data/access approvals
   - stakeholder participation
   - communications and training support
6. Semester responsibilities:
   - configuration
   - implementation support
   - documented support path
   - reporting cadence
   - verified security commitments
7. Fees, invoicing, payment terms, taxes, and implementation fees
8. Success metrics, baseline, reporting, midpoint review, and final review
9. Data protection:
   - data categories
   - permitted processing
   - retention
   - deletion/return
   - DPA and subprocessors
10. Security, accessibility, support, and incident commitments
11. Confidentiality, IP, feedback, and publicity/reference rights
12. Warranty/disclaimer, liability, indemnity, governing law
13. Annual conversion:
   - annual price
   - conversion date
   - decision owner
   - conversion criteria
   - expansion options
```

Cloud security checklist

FTC guidance emphasizes collecting only what is needed, protecting retained data, disposing of it when no longer necessary, and maintaining incident-response readiness.[1] [2] [3]

Domain	Minimum evidence before pilot
Governance	Security owner, risk register, policy review cycle
Identity	MFA, least privilege, offboarding process

Domain	Minimum evidence before pilot
Secrets	Managed secrets, secret scan, no browser-exposed privileged keys
Data inventory	Fields, sources, purposes, owners, vendors, retention, deletion
Secure development	PR review, dependency scanning, release checklist, vulnerability process
Data protection	TLS, provider-backed encryption at rest, data minimization
Monitoring	Error monitoring, audit events, alert triage
Backups	Backup scope, recovery procedure, restore-test record
Incident response	Severity matrix, contacts, customer templates, tabletop exercise
Vendor risk	Subprocessor register and review process
Higher-ed procurement	HECVAT Lite plan, security questionnaire library, DPA path
Accessibility	Public statement, known-gap log, remediation process

For university procurement, HECVAT is a key preparation artifact: EDUCAUSE describes it as a comprehensive framework for evaluating technology vendors' security, privacy, accessibility, and related risk controls.[4] [5] [6]

Recommended next sequence

1. Choose the exact pilot wedge: buyer, cohort, workflow, baseline, and outcome.
2. Build the financial model using the PDF's driver structure before finalizing public pricing.
3. Set up CRM stages and load 100 target institutional accounts.
4. Finalize the pilot proposal, Mutual Action Plan, sales deck, and demo.
5. Complete the initial Trust Center and HECVAT Lite evidence roadmap.
6. Have counsel review the pilot agreement, MSA, DPA, Terms, Privacy Policy, and SLA.
7. Implement the customer onboarding, health score, support, and renewal workflow before the first signed pilot.
8. Measure activation, first meaningful action, workflow completion, support friction, and conversion—not only downloads or social engagement.

⁂

1. https://consumer.ftc.gov/business-guidance/privacy-security/data-security
2. https://www.ftc.gov/business-guidance/blog/2012/01/collection-protection
3. https://www.ftc.gov/sites/default/files/documents/public_statements/prepared-statement-federal-trade-commission-data-security/110615datasecurityhouse.pdf
4. https://www.educause.edu/higher-education-community-vendor-assessment-toolkit/how-to-use-the-higher-education-community-vendor-assessment-toolkit
5. https://www.educause.edu/higher-education-community-vendor-assessment-toolkit/hecvat-faqs-for-higher-education

6. https://er.educause.edu/articles/2025/2/hecvat-4-better-than-ever
7. https://www.perplexity.ai/search/4cab66a0-68e7-4697-b060-725e6bb37917
8. https://www.sba.gov/counseling/launch-your-business/
9. https://www.irs.gov/businesses/small-businesses-self-employed/checklist-for-starting-a-business
10. https://www.sba.gov/counseling/
11. https://www.educause.edu/higher-education-community-vendor-assessment-toolkit
12. https://www.educause.edu/higher-education-community-vendor-assessment-toolkit/hecvat-faqs-for-corporations
13. https://aws.amazon.com/blogs/publicsector/higher-education-community-vendor-assessment-toolkit-now-available-on-aws-artifact/
14. https://www.ren-isac.net/services/hecvat.html
15. https://wolfia.com/hecvat
16. https://www.sba.gov/counseling/plan-your-business/
17. https://www.manatt.com/insights/articles/2016/new-ftc-guide-offers-tips-for-protecting-personal
18. https://www.perplexity.ai/search/a52de1ab-276c-4fc0-b475-dc0dff5fee6b

Show the finance and accounting operations section

Explain the Go-to-Market and Revenue operations
Show the security and compliance systems
Explain the Customer Success and Implementation side
Show the People hiring and culture systems

Semester needs five business operating systems that work together: **finance/accounting**, go-to-market/revenue, security/compliance, customer success/implementation, and people/culture. These are not back-office extras—they are what make a large Education OS credible, sellable, supportable, and durable.

The operating rule is:

> Every customer promise must connect to a financial owner, delivery owner, support process, security/privacy control, product capability, and evidence trail.

Finance and accounting operations

Semester's finance system must answer, at any time:

```
How much cash do we have?
How long is the runway?
What is committed revenue?
What is actually collected?
Which contracts/pilots are profitable?
What does each customer cost to serve?
What is the margin impact of AI and infrastructure?
What can we afford to hire or build next?
```

Finance architecture

```
Finance and Accounting OS
├── Chart of accounts
├── Bank and cash management
├── Accounts receivable
├── Accounts payable
├── Billing
├── Invoices
├── Payments
├── Collections
├── Revenue recognition review
├── Pricing and discounts
├── Budget
```

```
├── Forecast
├── Cash flow
├── Payroll and contractors
├── Expense management
├── Tax calendar
├── Insurance
├── Vendor spend
├── Unit economics
├── Customer profitability
├── AI/cloud cost allocation
├── Financial controls
├── Monthly close
├── Audit support
├── Board reporting
└── Fundraising model
```

Finance screens and console modules

```
/ops/finance
├── Cash dashboard
├── Runway dashboard
├── Revenue dashboard
├── Revenue forecast
├── P&L view
├── Balance sheet view
├── Cash-flow view
├── Budget vs actual
├── Expense categories
├── Vendor spend
├── Payroll and contractor forecast
├── Unit economics
├── Customer profitability
├── AI cost dashboard
├── Cloud cost dashboard
├── Pricing calculator
├── Discount approvals
├── Finance risk alerts
├── Collections/dunning
├── Invoices
├── Payment reconciliation
├── Tax calendar
├── Insurance tracker
├── Board finance pack
└── Forecast scenarios
```

Core financial data model

```
Finance
├── Accounting periods
├── Accounts
├── Journal entry references
├── Bank accounts
├── Cash snapshots
```

```
├── Budgets
├── Forecast scenarios
├── Revenue plans
├── Expense plans
├── Cost centers
├── Departments
├── Customers
├── Contracts
├── Orders
├── Subscriptions
├── Invoices
├── Invoice lines
├── Payments
├── Credits/refunds
├── Dunning cases
├── Vendor contracts
├── Purchase orders
├── Expenses
├── Payroll costs
├── Contractor costs
├── Cloud costs
├── AI costs
├── Security/compliance costs
└── Financial reporting snapshots
```

The product database should track commercial and operational billing state—quotes, orders, subscriptions, invoices, entitlements, payment events, dunning, and customer profitability. It should **not** become your statutory accounting ledger without accountant-approved design and a proper accounting system.

Revenue model

```
Revenue
├── Paid institutional pilots
├── Implementation fees
├── Annual institutional platform licenses
├── Per-enrolled-student license fees
├── Premium support
├── AI usage overages
├── Student Premium subscriptions
├── Department plans
├── Enterprise/multi-campus plans
├── Marketplace commissions
├── Partner revenue
├── Professional services
├── Training services
└── Data migration/integration services
```

Planning prices

```
Student Premium:
$8.99/month or $69/year

Institution Platform:
$18/enrolled student/year
$30,000 annual minimum

AI overage:
$30 per 1,000 governed requests

Implementation:
$35,000-$150,000 one-time

Premium support:
15% of annual platform fee
$15,000 minimum

Marketplace/partner commission:
12%, optional and separate from core viability
```

Finance workflow

```
Quote created
→ pricing exception check
→ approval if required
→ customer accepts order form
→ subscription/contract activated
→ invoice generated
→ payment collected/reconciled
→ entitlement granted
→ revenue recognized/reviewed
→ renewal tracked
→ expansion/cancellation/dunning handled
→ customer profitability reviewed
```

Financial controls

Action	Required control
Create draft quote	Revenue operations role
Approve discount	Deal desk based on margin/ACV threshold
Send final quote	Revenue approval
Change commercial plan	Approval plus entitlement impact review
Issue credit/refund	Finance approval plus invoice/payment reference
Write off receivable	Finance + executive approval above threshold
Change billing account	Verified customer authority

Action	Required control
Change bank/payment settings	Strong authentication + finance approval
Publish financial forecast	Finance owner review
Board/investor reporting	Founder/finance approval
Create vendor commitment	Procurement/budget owner approval

Financial KPIs

```
Cash on hand
Monthly burn
Runway
Committed ARR
Recognized revenue
Collected cash
MRR
ARR
Pilot revenue
Implementation revenue
Expansion revenue
Gross margin
Contribution margin
AI cost per active user
Cloud cost per active user
Support cost per customer
Implementation cost per pilot
CAC
CAC payback
LTV sensitivity
Gross retention
Net revenue retention
Average contract value
Sales cycle
Invoice aging
Collections rate
Dunning recovery
Budget variance
Headcount cost
Revenue per employee
```

Monthly close

```
Close calendar opens
→ invoices reviewed
→ payments reconciled
→ vendor invoices recorded
→ payroll and contractor costs recorded
→ cloud and AI costs allocated
→ expenses categorized
→ deferred revenue reviewed
→ P&L generated
```

```
→ balance sheet reviewed
→ cash flow updated
→ forecast variance explained
→ runway updated
→ executive review
→ board/investor summary
```

Go-to-Market and Revenue Operations

Semester's GTM system has two connected engines:

```
Institutional B2B engine:
Paid pilots → annual contracts → expansion → reference customers

Student adoption engine:
Student value → activation → retained use → institutional proof → referrals
```

GTM architecture

```
GTM and Revenue OS
├── Market definition
├── ICP
├── Segmentation
├── Account scoring
├── Buyer mapping
├── CRM
├── Outreach
├── Discovery
├── Qualification
├── Demos
├── Pilot design
├── Security/procurement
├── Proposal
├── Mutual Action Plan
├── Contracting
├── Implementation handoff
├── Pipeline forecasting
├── Sales enablement
├── Marketing automation
├── Content and demand generation
├── Channel partners
├── Customer proof
├── Renewal/expansion
├── Attribution
├── Pricing governance
└── Revenue analytics
```

Sales funnel

```
Target Accounts
  ↓
Researched Accounts
  ↓
Personalized Outreach
  ↓
Replies / Referrals
  ↓
Discovery Meetings
  ↓
Qualified Opportunities
  ↓
Role-Specific Demos
  ↓
Pilot Design Sessions
  ↓
Security / Privacy / Procurement Review
  ↓
Pilot Proposal
  ↓
Paid Pilot Signed
  ↓
Tenant Implementation
  ↓
Pilot Activation
  ↓
Measured Success
  ↓
Annual Contract Conversion
  ↓
Expansion / Renewal / Reference
```

CRM data requirements

```
Account
├── Institution name
├── Segment
├── Enrollment range
├── System type
├── Geography
├── Existing technology stack
├── Priority score
├── Trigger event
├── Champion
├── Economic buyer
├── Technical buyer
├── Security/privacy reviewer
├── Procurement/legal contact
├── Current stage
├── Estimated ACV
├── Pilot value
├── Annual potential
```

```
├── Probability
├── Close date
├── Risks
├── Next step
└── Owner

Opportunity
├── Problem statement
├── Current workflow
├── Scope
├── Student cohort
├── Buyer goals
├── Baseline metrics
├── Success metrics
├── Security requirements
├── Integration needs
├── Commercial terms
├── Mutual Action Plan
├── Decision process
├── Competitors
├── Objections
└── Win/loss reason
```

Sales stages

Stage	Exit criteria
Target	Account researched and scored
Contacted	Relevant stakeholder reached with personalized message
Discovery	Pain, champion, timeline, and buyer path documented
Qualified	Problem, budget path, decision process, and deployment feasibility confirmed
Demo	Use case demonstrated to required stakeholders
Pilot design	Cohort, scope, baseline, success criteria, and implementation assumptions agreed
Procurement/security	Review owners, artifacts, and decision path identified
Proposal	Price, terms, annual conversion path, and decision date delivered
Contracting	Legal/procurement actively reviewing agreement
Closed won: pilot	Agreement executed; implementation kickoff scheduled
Pilot active	Cohort launched; success metrics measured
Conversion	Annual decision in process
Closed won: annual	Annual agreement active
Expansion	Additional campus, department, module, or user scope identified
Closed lost	Reason, competitor, and future re-engagement path recorded

Required sales assets

```
ICP document
Buyer persona library
Account scoring model
Discovery script
Qualification scorecard
Demo script
Demo environment
Pilot design agenda
Pilot proposal
Mutual Action Plan
ROI calculator
Pricing calculator
Quote template
Order form intake
Security overview
HECVAT roadmap
DPA/SLA process
Accessibility response
Procurement FAQ
Competitive battlecards
Objection-handling library
Case-study template
Reference-call guide
Renewal/expansion deck
```

Marketing and acquisition infrastructure

```
Website
├── Homepage
├── Product pages
├── Pilot page
├── Pricing
├── Demo request
├── Trust Center
├── Resource hub
├── SEO pages
├── Case studies
└── Contact

Content
├── LinkedIn
├── YouTube
├── Webinars
├── Newsletter
├── Guides
├── Research
├── Founder content
├── Student content
└── Partner content

Lifecycle
├── Lead nurture
```

```
├── Demo follow-up
├── Webinar follow-up
├── Pilot nurture
├── Customer onboarding
├── Student activation
├── Retention
├── Renewal
└── Referral
```

Security and compliance systems

Security and compliance must be treated as continuous operational systems—not a “launch checklist.”

Security architecture

```
Security Program
├── Governance
├── Asset inventory
├── Data inventory
├── Data classification
├── Threat modeling
├── Identity and access
├── MFA
├── Secrets management
├── Secure development lifecycle
├── Dependency management
├── Vulnerability management
├── Logging and monitoring
├── Incident response
├── Backup and restore
├── Disaster recovery
├── Business continuity
├── Vendor risk
├── Access reviews
├── Penetration testing
├── Security awareness
├── Evidence register
├── Trust Center
├── HECVAT
├── Security questionnaires
└── Security reporting
```

Security operations workflow

```
Asset/data inventory
→ risk assessment
→ control design
→ implementation
→ evidence collection
→ testing
→ monitoring
```

```
→ alert or incident
→ triage
→ remediation
→ verification
→ control review
→ customer/procurement evidence
```

Security controls

Domain	Required controls
Identity	MFA, least privilege, joiner/mover/leaver, service-account ownership
Authorization	RLS, tenant isolation, capability checks, server-side scope enforcement
Secrets	Server-only credentials, rotation, secret scanning, no browser exposure
Application	Code review, testing, SAST, dependency scanning, release gates
Infrastructure	Environment separation, logging, monitoring, backups, recovery
Data	Classification, minimization, encryption, retention, deletion, export
AI	Provider controls, policy, classification, audit, evaluation, spend limits
Vendors	Security review, contract terms, subprocessors, monitoring, offboarding
Incident	Severity, command roles, communications, postmortem, corrective actions
Compliance	HECVAT, evidence, control mapping, review calendar, claims governance

Privacy system

```
Privacy Operations
├── Data inventory
├── Data map
├── Classification
├── Purpose limitation
├── Consent
├── Retention
├── Deletion
├── Legal holds
├── Subject requests
├── Export requests
├── Erasure requests
├── Correction requests
├── Subprocessors
├── Privacy impact assessments
├── Privacy incidents
├── Policy review
└── Privacy reporting
```

Compliance evidence record

```
Control
→ owner
→ policy
→ implementation
→ evidence
→ test
→ reviewer
→ last review
→ next review
→ customer claim
→ procurement response
→ exception/remediation
```

Customer Success and Implementation

The customer-success system converts a signed contract into activation, proof, renewal, and expansion.

Customer lifecycle

```
Contract signed
→ sales-to-CS handoff
→ kickoff
→ implementation plan
→ data/integration readiness
→ tenant configuration
→ admin training
→ student/staff launch
→ activation
→ adoption
→ weekly operating review
→ midpoint executive review
→ final value report
→ annual conversion
→ QBR
→ renewal
→ expansion
→ reference/case study
```

Sales-to-CS handoff

Sales must deliver:

```
Signed agreement
Commercial scope
Implementation scope
Pilot timeline
Annual conversion date
Executive sponsor
```

```
Economic buyer
Operational champion
Technical/IT contact
Security/privacy/procurement contacts
Target cohort
Workflow
Baseline metrics
Success criteria
Promised integrations
Data categories
Known risks
Customer commitments
Semester commitments
Decision process
```

Implementation workspace

```
Implementation Project
├── Project plan
├── RACI
├── Milestones
├── Dependencies
├── Data readiness
├── Integration readiness
├── Tenant setup
├── Role setup
├── Training
├── Launch communications
├── Risk register
├── Issue tracker
├── Status report
├── Acceptance testing
├── Go-live gate
└── Transition to success
```

Customer health score

```
Customer Health
├── Commercial
├── Implementation
├── Activation
├── Adoption
├── Workflow completion
├── Support sentiment
├── Executive engagement
├── Renewal status
├── Integration health
├── Security/compliance status
├── Product fit
└── Expansion signal
```

Example weights

Signal	Weight
Admin engagement	15%
Student/user activation	20%
First meaningful action	15%
Core workflow completion	20%
Weekly active use	10%
Support sentiment	5%
Executive engagement	5%
Pilot/renewal outcome trend	10%

Customer-success assets

```
Welcome sequence
Kickoff deck
Implementation plan
RACI
Data readiness checklist
Admin setup guide
Training curriculum
Office hours plan
Student launch kit
Support policy
Escalation matrix
Weekly pilot report
Midpoint executive review
Final value report
QBR
Renewal plan
Expansion plan
Churn-risk playbook
Case-study consent
Reference process
Customer advisory board charter
```

People, hiring, and culture systems

Semester's product ambition requires a company that can operate responsibly under complexity.

People operating system

```
People OS
├── Org design
├── Workforce plan
├── Hiring plan
├── Role scorecards
├── Recruiting
├── Interview loops
├── Reference checks
├── Contractor management
├── Onboarding
├── Access provisioning
├── Security training
├── Performance management
├── Compensation
├── Equity
├── Benefits
├── Career development
├── Learning and development
├── Culture
├── Employee handbook
├── Incident/ethics reporting
├── Offboarding
├── Access revocation
└── Alumni network
```

Org design

```
Founder / CEO
├── Product and Design
├── Engineering and Platform
├── Learning and Academic Operations
├── Student Success and Implementation
├── Sales and GTM
├── Customer Success and Support
├── Security, Privacy, Compliance, and Legal Ops
├── Finance and Business Operations
├── Partnerships and Developer Ecosystem
└── People and Culture
```

Hiring sequence

Stage	First priority hires
Prototype to pilot	Full-stack/platform engineer, product designer, implementation/customer-success lead
First paid pilots	Institutional sales lead, security/compliance adviser, support/implementation capacity
Pilot conversion	Product manager, data/analytics, academic operations/registrar expert
Expansion	Platform/SRE, partnerships/integrations, marketing/content, finance/operations
Platform scale	Developer relations, marketplace/partner team, regional operations, research/outcomes

Hiring scorecard

Every role should have:

```
Mission
Outcomes
Core competencies
Technical/domain requirements
Decision rights
Metrics
Interview process
Reference checks
Compensation range
Equity range
Onboarding plan
30/60/90-day deliverables
Access needed
Security/privacy training
Performance-review expectations
```

Cultural standards

```
Student agency over surveillance
Evidence over hype
Accessibility by default
Trust before shortcuts
Interoperability over lock-in
Human judgment in high-stakes decisions
Reliability before vanity features
Documentation is part of the product
Every critical workflow has a rollback
Every public claim has evidence
Every customer promise has an owner
Every incident creates a learning loop
```

Integrated business operating cadence

Cadence	Review	Required output
Daily	Operations triage	P0/P1 issues, customer blockers, incident decisions
Weekly	Revenue review	Pipeline, deals, pilots, forecast, next steps
Weekly	Product/engineering	Releases, quality, technical debt, customer feedback
Weekly	Customer success	Adoption, support, health, renewal/pilot risk
Weekly	Security/reliability	Vulnerabilities, incidents, SLOs, access, changes
Weekly	Marketing/growth	Funnel, content, campaigns, activation, attribution
Monthly	Finance	P&L, cash, burn, runway, budget variance, collections
Monthly	Trust/compliance	Evidence, reviews, vendor risk, HECVAT, privacy

Cadence	Review	Required output
Monthly	Leadership	KPI review, strategic decisions, hiring, risks
Quarterly	OKR/board	Strategy, roadmap, capital, performance, risk, priorities

Master business execution command

```
Build the complete Semester Business and Operations System.

Semester is an Education Operating System and Company of Education. It requires
the same level of operational coherence as the product itself.

Create and operationalize five connected systems:

1. Finance and Accounting Operations
2. Go-to-Market and Revenue Operations
3. Security, Privacy, Accessibility, and Compliance
4. Customer Success and Implementation
5. People, Hiring, and Culture

For each system create:

- Operating model
- Owner roles
- Workflows
- Console screens
- Systems of record
- Data model
- Required integrations
- KPIs
- Dashboards
- Meeting cadence
- Approval thresholds
- Risk controls
- Required documents
- Required templates
- Customer impact
- Product dependencies
- Security/privacy implications
- Budget/capacity model
- Current-state audit
- Gap register
- P0/P1/P2/P3 backlog
- 90-day plan
- 12-month plan
- 36-month maturity roadmap

Create:

docs/business/finance/FINANCE_AND_ACCOUNTING_OPERATIONS.md
docs/business/revenue/GTM_AND_REVENUE_OPERATIONS.md
docs/business/trust/SECURITY_PRIVACY_ACCESSIBILITY_COMPLIANCE.md
docs/business/customer/CUSTOMER_SUCCESS_AND_IMPLEMENTATION.md
docs/business/people/PEOPLE_HIRING_AND_CULTURE.md
```

```
docs/business/COMPANY_OPERATING_CADENCE.md
docs/business/COMPANY_KPI_TREE.md
docs/business/BUSINESS_SYSTEMS_OF_RECORD.md
docs/business/BUSINESS_RISK_REGISTER.md
docs/business/BUSINESS_MASTER_BACKLOG.md

For every business process define:

- Trigger
- Owner
- Inputs
- System of record
- Required approval
- Steps
- Output
- KPI
- Failure condition
- Escalation
- Audit trail
- Review cadence
- Documentation
- Next action

Do not treat legal, tax, accounting, insurance, privacy, security, accessibility,
or compliance drafts as final. Clearly flag items needing qualified professional
review.

Return:
- company operating map
- finance operations map
- revenue operations map
- trust/compliance map
- customer-success map
- people/culture map
- exact systems to connect
- dashboard and console requirements
- 90-day execution plan
- top 50 business operations actions in priority order.
```

The business-side finish line is straightforward:

> **Semester becomes credible when it can sell a pilot, implement it safely, support it reliably, prove value, convert it into recurring revenue, protect customer data, retain the customer, and repeat the process without founder heroics.**

Semester Go-to-Market Playbook

Pilot-to-annual institutional sales, financial model assumptions, customer acquisition funnel, compliance/security plan, and customer-success operating workflow.

Purpose. This working playbook helps Semester move from a technically capable education-technology product to a sellable, trustworthy, repeatable business. It is an operating plan—not legal, tax, accounting, insurance, privacy, security, or accessibility advice. Have qualified professionals review customer-facing commitments and binding documents.

Executive direction

Use a two-engine launch model: sell a narrow, measurable institutional workflow through a paid pilot, then use student adoption and verified outcomes as the evidence that converts the pilot to an annual contract and supports expansion.

Do not lead with "replace the university stack." Lead with one urgent workflow, one buyer, a defined cohort, a short timeline, success metrics, and a conversion decision.

1. Launch wedge and offer

Element	Semester pilot definition
Offer	Semester Registration Readiness Pilot
Target buyer	Student Success, Advising, Registrar, or a defined academic division
Problem	Students lack clear next actions before registration; staff manage fragmented guidance, reminders, and support load.
Scope	One department/cohort, one term or 8–12 weeks, limited data/integration scope, named sponsor and champion.
Success	Activation, first meaningful action, workflow completion, staff friction reduction, student confidence/satisfaction, and annual conversion readiness.
Decision	Named economic buyer makes annual conversion decision on an agreed date.

2. Commercial assumptions

Revenue stream	Planning assumption	Guardrail
Student Premium	$8.99/month or $69/year	Validate conversion and support/AI cost before public commitment.
Institution platform	$18 per enrolled student/year; $30,000 annual minimum	Use contract-level volume and scope assumptions.
Implementation	$35,000–$150,000 one-time	Price based on integration, configuration, training, and delivery effort.
AI overage	$30 per 1,000 governed requests	Meter usage; disclose consumption before high-cost actions.
Premium support	15% of annual platform fee; $15,000 minimum	Tie to defined support/response commitments.
Partner/marketplace revenue	12% commission where applicable	Model separately; do not depend on it for core viability.

These are operating assumptions for testing, not promises or universal price terms. Every pilot and annual price should be checked against delivery cost, customer value, procurement feedback, margin, and cash runway.

3. Customer acquisition funnel

Use an account-based B2B funnel for institutional revenue. Student social channels support activation and proof; they are not the primary measurement of enterprise demand.

Stage	Required evidence	Primary KPI
Target accounts	Institution, segment, buyer hypothesis, trigger, priority score	Target-account coverage
Contacted	Personalized outreach, channel, date, contact role	Reply/referral rate
Discovery	Pain, stakeholders, budget, timeline, current workflow	Qualification rate
Demo	Role-specific demo, objections, next action	Demo-to-design rate
Pilot design	Scope, metric baseline, data/integration needs, decision process	Proposal readiness
Security/procurement	Security owner, DPA/HECVAT status, legal/procurement blockers	Review progression
Pilot proposal	Price, annual conversion path, Mutual Action Plan	Proposal-to-pilot close rate
Activated pilot	Admin setup, invitations, adoption baseline	Activation rate
Success achieved	Outcome report and sponsor validation	Pilot KPI attainment
Annual conversion	Annual order form, scope, close date	Pilot-to-annual conversion
Expansion	New cohort/department, reference opportunity	Net revenue retention

Core formulas

• CAC = Sales and marketing spend ÷ new customers acquired.

• CAC payback months = CAC ÷ monthly gross profit from the new customer.

• Stage conversion = accounts entering next stage ÷ accounts entering current stage.

• Pilot conversion = annual contracts converted from pilots ÷ pilots completed.

• LTV sensitivity = annual recurring revenue × gross margin ÷ annual logo churn rate. Use ranges until retention data matures.

• Break-even month = first month in which cumulative gross profit covers cumulative operating expense and required cash obligations.

4. Interactive financial model specification

Build a driver-based 36-month model with monthly columns. Make every forecast assumption editable and visibly distinguish assumed inputs from validated actuals.

Model tab	Required inputs and outputs
Assumptions	Pricing, users per institution, funnel conversion, sales cycle, implementation capacity, cloud/AI cost, payroll, contractor cost, churn, payment terms.
Funnel	Target accounts, contacts, meetings, qualified opportunities, demos, pilot designs, proposals, pilots, annual conversions.

Model tab	Required inputs and outputs
Revenue	Pilot fees, implementation, annual license, student premium, AI overage, support, optional partner revenue.
COGS	Cloud, AI/model usage, storage, support, onboarding/implementation labor, third-party platform costs.
Operating expense	Payroll, contractors, sales/marketing, legal, accounting, insurance, security, software, travel, office/admin.
Cash/runway	Beginning cash, collections timing, burn, scenario runway, financing need, break-even month.
Unit economics	CAC, CAC payback, gross margin, ACV, LTV range, retention and expansion sensitivity.
Scenarios	Conservative, base, ambitious, downside/delayed sales, high-AI-use, pilot-heavy, annual-contract-heavy.

Example monthly driver sequence

Target accounts → outreach → replies → discovery → qualified opportunities → demos → pilot design → proposals → pilots signed → activated pilots → annual conversions. Model collections based on actual payment terms rather than assuming all contract value becomes cash immediately.

5. Institutional pilot sales playbook

Discovery questions

• Walk me through the workflow today. Where do students or staff get stuck?

• What does the problem cost in time, support load, missed actions, or risk?

• Which existing tools and teams are involved?

• Who experiences the pain, who owns budget, and who can block a pilot?

• What is the buying or decision timeline? Is there a triggering event?

• What baseline metric exists today, and what proof would justify annual adoption?

• What security, privacy, accessibility, procurement, and legal review will be required?

Pilot proposal contents

• Executive summary and current-state problem.

• Customer-specific workflow, scope, non-goals, population, timeline, and responsibilities.

• Data/integration assumptions and security/privacy/accessibility boundaries.

• Baseline, success metrics, reporting cadence, midpoint review, and final value review.

• Pilot fee, implementation fee, annual conversion pricing, conversion date, and Mutual Action Plan.

• Known risks, dependencies, support model, and escalation contacts.

Mutual Action Plan minimum fields

Workstream	Customer owner	Semester owner	Completion evidence
Executive sponsorship	Named VP/Dean/CIO	Founder	Goals, decision date, sponsor attendance
Security/privacy	IT/security/privacy reviewer	Security owner	Questionnaire, DPA, data-flow signoff
Contracting	Procurement/legal	Founder/counsel	Pilot agreement/order form

Workstream	Customer owner	Semester owner	Completion evidence
Implementation	Admin/operational champion	Implementation lead	Configured tenant, roles, launch checklist
Training/launch	Champion/comms lead	Customer success	Training complete, communications sent
Outcome review	Economic buyer	Founder/CS	KPI report, annual decision

6. Pilot agreement — business template

This is a commercial outline for counsel to turn into binding language. Do not use it as a signed agreement without higher-ed SaaS counsel review.

Required sections

• Parties and effective date.

• Pilot purpose and defined service/workflow.

• Pilot term, launch milestones, and termination rights.

• Scope, included users/cohort, permitted use, and explicit non-goals.

• Customer responsibilities: champion, access, data, approvals, communications, training attendance.

• Semester responsibilities: configuration, support, reporting, security commitments that are verified, and escalation contacts.

• Fees, invoicing, payment timing, implementation charges, taxes, and expenses.

• Success metrics, baseline, reporting cadence, midpoint review, final review, and non-guarantee language.

• Data protection: roles, data categories, permitted processing, retention, deletion/return, DPA reference, subprocessors.

• Security, incident notification, support, availability, accessibility, and service limits—only as verified and approved.

• Confidentiality, IP ownership, feedback rights, publicity/reference rights, warranties/disclaimers, liability/indemnity, governing law, and order-of-precedence.

• Annual conversion option: price, scope, decision date, and process. Ensure it is optional unless counsel specifies otherwise.

7. Customer success and onboarding

Phase	Target timing	Semester output	Customer outcome
Sales handoff	Immediately after signature	Account plan, scope, risks, success criteria	No surprises between sale and delivery
Welcome + kickoff	Days 0–5	Welcome, agenda, RACI, implementation plan	Shared owners and timeline
Configuration/data	Weeks 1–2	Tenant setup, data/integration validation	Safe, usable configured environment
Training	Weeks 2–3	Admin/champion training, guides, office hours	Operators ready to support users
Launch	Weeks 3–4	Comms kit, onboarding, help center, monitoring	Users invited and activated
Adoption	Weeks 4–8	Usage dashboard, nudges, support triage	Core workflow is used
Midpoint review	Mid-pilot	KPI report, risk plan, executive update	Issues resolved before final review
Results + conversion	Final 2 weeks	Value report, annual proposal, roadmap	Annual decision based on evidence

Customer health score

Signal	Weight	At-risk trigger
Admin engagement	15%	No owner attendance or delayed actions
User activation	20%	Below agreed activation threshold
First meaningful action	15%	Sign-in without value-producing activity
Core workflow completion	20%	Low or declining completion
Weekly active use	10%	Rapid post-launch decline
Support sentiment	5%	Repeated unresolved friction
Executive engagement	5%	Sponsor disengages
Outcome trend	10%	Pilot success metrics stagnate or worsen

8. Cloud security and compliance plan

Operating principle: collect data only for legitimate business need, protect it with administrative, technical, and physical safeguards appropriate to the risk, retain it only as needed, securely dispose of it, and maintain a tested incident response process. [This is a business operating interpretation—not legal advice.]

Control domain	Minimum launch control	Evidence
Governance	Named security owner; risk register; policy review cadence	Security program charter and register
Asset/data inventory	Systems, vendors, data fields, owners, flows, retention	Inventory and data-flow diagrams
Identity/access	MFA; least privilege; joiner/mover/leaver process	Access review evidence
Secrets	Managed secrets; no credentials in Git/client bundles	Secret scan + environment controls
Secure development	PR review; dependency scanning; vulnerability workflow; release checklist	CI reports and remediation log
Data protection	TLS; provider-backed encryption at rest; data minimization	Architecture and configuration evidence
Logging/monitoring	Error monitoring; audit events; alert triage	Dashboard/runbook
Resilience	Backups, restore test, DR runbook	Restore-test record
Incident response	Severity matrix, response team, customer communications, tabletop	IR plan and exercise record
Vendor risk	Subprocessor review and register	Vendor assessments
Higher-ed readiness	HECVAT Lite roadmap and questionnaire library	Completed responses and evidence register
Accessibility	Statement, tested baseline, remediation process	Accessibility evidence and backlog

9. 90-day execution sequence

Window	Primary objective	Deliverables
Days 1–30	Become sellable	Launch wedge, ICP, pricing assumptions, financial model, CRM/account list, sales deck/demo, pilot offer, contract/trust inventory, website conversion paths.

Window	Primary objective	Deliverables
Days 31–60	Become pilot-ready	Pilot agreement through counsel, HECVAT Lite evidence plan, onboarding/training/support workflow, ambassador/student activation kit, first webinars/outbound sequences, pilot proposals.
Days 61–90	Become repeatable	Signed/near-signed pilot, measured outcomes, value report, annual conversion process, case-study process, QBR/renewal cadence, KPI/board rhythm, expansion plan.

10. Owner and meeting cadence

Cadence	Meeting/report	Core measures
Weekly	Revenue review	Accounts, meetings, pipeline, proposal, pilot, close risk
Weekly	Product/engineering review	Delivery, quality, incidents, customer feedback, release risk
Weekly	Customer-success review	Activation, workflow completion, support, health, conversion risk
Weekly	Growth review	Lead conversion, content, channel learning, student activation
Monthly	Finance review	Cash, burn, runway, collections, budget variance, gross margin
Monthly	Security/risk review	Vulnerabilities, vendor changes, evidence gaps, incidents, control owners
Quarterly	Strategy/OKR review	Market learning, product bets, hiring, plan changes, board/investor update

Appendix: Master GTM execution prompt

You are the Chief Revenue Officer, Head of Customer Success, finance lead, marketing lead, security-program coordinator, and operations lead for Semester. Build an execution-ready GTM operating system for an education-technology SaaS company.

Do not create duplicate documents before inventorying existing artifacts. First identify current, stale, duplicate, incomplete, and missing work across sales, marketing, customer success, finance, legal, privacy, security, support, partnerships, and operations.

Build a two-engine model:
1. Institutional B2B revenue through paid, narrow, measurable pilots that convert to annual agreements.
2. Student adoption that creates verifiable activation, workflow-completion, and satisfaction evidence.

Create or update: ICP, positioning, account scoring, 100-account list template, CRM stages, discovery script, demo script, pilot design agenda, pilot proposal, Mutual Action Plan, security/procurement packet, pricing calculator, 36-month financial model, trust-center plan, HECVAT roadmap, customer onboarding, support model, health score, renewal/expansion playbook, student ambassador program, content calendar, KPI tree, weekly operating reviews, and 90-day execution calendar.

Use planning assumptions: Student Premium $8.99/month or $69/year; institution platform $18/enrolled student/year with $30,000 annual minimum; implementation $35,000–$150,000; AI overage $30 per 1,000 governed requests; premium support 15% of annual platform fee with $15,000 minimum; optional partner commission 12%.

For every deliverable, include owner, trigger, inputs, steps, output, system of record, KPI, risks, approval requirements, and acceptance criteria. Clearly label legal, tax, accounting, insurance, privacy, security, accessibility, and contract material that needs qualified professional review. Do not make unverified public claims.

Return: a prioritized P0/P1/P2 backlog, 30/60/90-day plan, weekly scorecard, customer acquisition funnel, financial scenario model specification, trust/compliance evidence register, and first-pilot conversion plan.

Sources used for compliance orientation

FTC guidance highlights data minimization, reasonable safeguards, clear notices, appropriate retention, secure disposal, and incident planning. EDUCAUSE materials describe HECVAT as a higher-education vendor assessment framework. SBA guidance covers business-planning and formation fundamentals. These sources do not replace professional advice.

perplexity

now what else do i need to do create add and genrate on the bussnius and opprations side implentation side sales and marketing side and any other function of a bussnius a company what else to i need to create do build and connect on that deoartment

You need to build **the company operating system around Semester**, not only the product. For an education-technology SaaS business, the remaining work falls into: corporate/legal, finance, security/compliance, product operations, institutional sales, student adoption, marketing, customer success, partnerships, data/analytics, people/HR, and executive governance.

Your current repository already contains unusually extensive product, engineering, audit, security, launch, rollback, retention, and operating documentation. The biggest business-side gap is likely not "more random documents"—it is turning those documents into a **single owned, measurable, recurring operating system** with real pipelines, contracts, dashboards, controls, and customer evidence. [github_mcp_direct]

What to create next

Priority order

Priority	Department	What must exist before serious selling	Outcome
P0	Company/legal	Entity, IP ownership, contracts, privacy terms, data rules	You can legally contract and operate
P0	Security/compliance	Trust Center, security overview, HECVAT evidence, incident process	Institutions can assess you
P0	Finance	Pricing, budget, runway, invoicing, tax/accounting workflow	You know what you sell and whether it is profitable
P0	Sales	ICP, account list, sales process, pilot offer, deck, proposal, CRM	You can create and close pipeline
P0	Marketing	Positioning, site, proof, content, lead capture, lifecycle emails	Buyers can understand and trust Semester
P0	Customer success	Onboarding, support, training, pilot success plan, QBR/renewal process	Customers activate, renew, and refer
P1	Operations	Weekly cadence, metrics, decision log, risk register, vendor management	The company runs predictably

Priority	Department	What must exist before serious selling	Outcome
P1	Product ops	Roadmap governance, feedback system, analytics, release process	Product decisions are evidence-based
P1	Partnerships	Integration strategy, channel partners, student ambassadors	Distribution expands without relying only on outbound
P2	People	Hiring scorecards, handbook, contractors, performance system	You can scale a team safely
P2	Benchmark lab	AI workflow router/benchmark from earlier discussion	Useful internal capability, not a launch blocker

1. Company, legal, and governance

Create these as real, reviewed company artifacts—not just AI drafts:

- Company formation and ownership records
- Founder agreements and equity/vesting documentation
- IP assignment agreements for founders, contractors, employees, and collaborators
- Cap-table system and board/consent records
- Tax registrations and accounting setup
- Business insurance plan:
  - General liability
  - Professional/E&O
  - Cyber liability
  - Directors & officers, when appropriate
- Standard NDA
- Mutual NDA
- Master Services Agreement
- SaaS subscription agreement
- Order form
- Statement of Work template
- Pilot agreement
- Data Processing Addendum
- Privacy Policy
- Terms of Service
- Acceptable Use Policy
- Cookie notice and consent configuration, if applicable
- Subprocessor list
- Service Level Agreement/support policy

- Accessibility statement
- Open-source software policy
- Trademark/name clearance process
- Corporate records folder and contract repository
- Legal-review queue with owner, risk, stage, and outside-counsel escalation criteria

For higher-ed sales, your pilot and contract package should explicitly define: pilot scope, institution roles, data categories, implementation obligations, success criteria, security obligations, accessibility commitment, payment terms, conversion option, renewal terms, termination, and data return/deletion procedure.

Do not publish legal language unreviewed. Use AI to generate structured first drafts and negotiation summaries, then have qualified counsel review terms for the actual entity, customers, data flows, and jurisdiction.

2. Security, privacy, and trust

This is a core sales asset for Semester because institutional buyers will assess vendor risk. HECVAT is specifically designed to help higher-ed institutions evaluate a vendor's cybersecurity, privacy, accessibility, and compliance practices. [1] [2]

Build a Trust Center

Create a public or controlled-access **Trust Center** containing:

- Security overview
- Privacy overview
- Data-processing overview
- Subprocessor list
- Security contact address
- Incident/breach notification commitments
- Availability/status link
- Data deletion and retention summary
- Backup and disaster-recovery summary
- Authentication and access-control summary
- Encryption summary, only for verified controls
- Accessibility statement
- Compliance roadmap and evidence request process
- Download/request flow for security documents under NDA, if needed

Internal security pack

Create and maintain:

- Asset inventory
- Data inventory and data-flow map
- Data classification policy
- Data-retention and deletion schedule
- Access-control policy
- Least-privilege and privileged-access process
- Secure development lifecycle policy
- Vulnerability-management process
- Change-management policy
- Logging and monitoring policy
- Incident-response plan and tabletop exercise
- Business continuity plan
- Disaster-recovery runbook
- Vendor-risk review process
- Secure contractor onboarding/offboarding process
- Security training record
- Penetration-testing roadmap
- Evidence register mapped to controls
- Security questionnaire answer library
- HECVAT Lite first, then a full HECVAT response when target accounts require it

A practical framework is NIST CSF 2.0, which organizes cybersecurity outcomes as **Govern, Identify, Protect, Detect, Respond, and Recover** and explicitly applies to organizations regardless of size or maturity.[3] [4]

Data minimization baseline

For student and institutional data, use the FTC's practical principles:

1. Know what data you collect.
2. Keep only what you need.
3. Protect the data you retain.
4. Dispose of data you no longer need.
5. Maintain an incident-response plan.[5]

3. Finance and business model

You need a real operating model, not only a pricing page.

Create the financial model

Build a 36-month model with:

- Monthly recurring revenue
- Annual contract value
- Pilot revenue
- Implementation/services revenue, if applicable
- Per-seat, per-student, per-department, and enterprise pricing scenarios
- Gross margin
- Cloud/infrastructure costs
- AI/API cost per active user or workflow
- Support and implementation cost
- Sales and marketing spend
- Contractor and employee cost
- Legal, accounting, insurance, and compliance costs
- Burn rate
- Cash runway
- Hiring plan
- Best/base/worst-case scenarios
- Fundraising requirements and timing
- Break-even analysis
- CAC
- CAC payback
- Pipeline conversion assumptions
- Sales cycle assumptions
- Gross retention
- Net revenue retention
- Churn assumptions
- Expansion revenue assumptions

Pricing and packaging

Create:

- A pricing strategy memo
- Packaging architecture:
  - Student/individual, if applicable
  - Department
  - Institution
  - Enterprise/systemwide
  - Pilot
- Feature entitlements per plan
- Usage and overage policy, if relevant
- Implementation fee policy
- Annual-prepay incentive
- Contract length options
- Discount approval policy
- Pricing calculator
- Quote template
- Order form generator
- ROI calculator for institutional buyers
- Procurement justification memo template

For Semester, start with a **narrow, measurable institutional workflow** instead of trying to sell a complete university operating system at once. A buyer should understand the outcome, deployment scope, pilot cost, success metrics, and annual conversion path in one meeting.

4. Institutional sales

Semester needs an institutional **B2B sales engine** plus student adoption. The institutional engine produces revenue; student activity creates proof that the product delivers real outcomes.

Create the sales foundation

- Ideal Customer Profile
- Target vertical and initial beachhead
- Account segmentation:
  - Tier 1: ideal pilots
  - Tier 2: adjacent accounts
  - Tier 3: long-tail/outbound

- Buyer and stakeholder map:
  - CIO/IT
  - Provost/academic leadership
  - Student success
  - Registrar
  - Student affairs
  - Advising
  - Accessibility
  - Security/privacy
  - Procurement
  - Legal
  - Department champion
  - Student champion
- Jobs-to-be-done by buyer
- Problem and ROI narrative by persona
- Competitive battlecards
- Objection-handling library
- Discovery-call script
- Demo script
- Pilot proposal
- Pilot success plan
- Mutual Action Plan
- Security/procurement response kit
- RFP/RFI answer library
- Implementation scope document
- Renewal/expansion playbook
- CRM stages and definitions
- Forecast methodology
- Sales activity standards
- Call-note template
- Account plan template
- Deal-risk review process

Your first sales offer

Define one launch offer in this format:

```
Target customer:
[Specific institution type / department]

Problem:
[One painful workflow with measurable cost, delay, or risk]

Semester workflow:
[What the product does in the first deployment]

Pilot scope:
[Users, departments, integrations, term, implementation timeline]

Success metrics:
[Activation, completed actions, time saved, satisfaction, retention, accuracy]

Commercials:
[Pilot price, implementation fee, annual conversion price]

Conversion decision:
[Named date, decision owner, measurable criteria]
```

Build a 100-account pipeline

Create a CRM target list with:

- Institution
- Enrollment
- Sector/type
- State/region
- Technology stack clues
- Relevant department
- Champion candidate
- Economic buyer
- Security/procurement contact
- Existing tools/alternatives
- Trigger event
- Priority score
- Last activity
- Next step
- Pipeline stage
- Estimated ACV

- Pilot probability
- Close date
- Blocker

Do not measure only demos booked. Measure:

- Qualified accounts
- Discovery conversations
- Security reviews initiated
- Pilot proposals sent
- Pilots signed
- Pilot activation
- Pilot success-metric attainment
- Pilot-to-annual conversion
- Expansion opportunities
- Sales cycle duration
- Win/loss reason

5. Marketing and demand generation

You need one positioning system that powers the website, sales, social, ads, demos, and customer onboarding.

Core brand artifacts

Create:

- Category definition
- Positioning statement
- Ideal customer profile
- Persona messaging
- Messaging hierarchy
- Value proposition matrix
- Brand narrative
- Founder story
- Company boilerplate
- Voice and tone guide
- Claims substantiation register
- Case-study structure
- Proof-point library

- FAQ and objection answers
- Naming/trademark review process
- Design system and visual guidelines

Website requirements

Build or complete:

- Homepage
- Product page
- Specific workflow/use-case pages
- Department/persona pages
- Security/Trust Center
- Pricing or “request pricing” page
- Demo-request page
- Pilot-program page
- Case studies
- Resource center
- Comparison pages
- Careers page, when hiring
- Contact page
- Legal pages
- Status page
- SEO metadata and technical SEO baseline
- Analytics, consent, and conversion tracking
- Lead capture and routing
- Calendar scheduling integration
- CRM integration
- Email nurture trigger after form submission

Content engine

Create:

- 90-day editorial calendar
- SEO topic map
- Keyword-to-page map
- Founder-led content framework
- Customer-proof content framework

- Monthly webinar format
- Email newsletter template
- Case study template
- Research-report template
- Demo-video scripts
- Product explainer video
- Sales clips for social
- Student activation assets
- Press kit
- Media pitch list
- Podcast/outreach list
- Webinar registration and follow-up sequence

Channel strategy

Channel	Primary audience	Main job
Website	All	Explain, qualify, convert
LinkedIn	Institutional buyers	Trust, thought leadership, outbound support
Email	Buyers and leads	Nurture, book meetings, move deals
Webinars	Buyers/champions	Demonstrate expertise and product outcomes
YouTube	Students, buyers, evaluators	Product proof, tutorials, long-form explainers
Instagram/TikTok	Students	Awareness, usefulness, activation
Campus ambassadors	Students	Trust, onboarding, peer adoption
SEO	Future buyers/users	Durable inbound demand
Partnerships	Institutions and channels	Borrowed trust and reach
Paid ads	Retargeting and proven offers	Scale validated conversion—not initial discovery

Do not rely on viral content as the go-to-market model. First prove one institutional workflow works, then turn those measured results into product pages, demos, case studies, webinars, and targeted outbound.

6. Student adoption

Student adoption is a product and operations system, not just social media.

Create:

- Student value proposition
- Student onboarding flow

- “First meaningful action” definition
- Activation checklist
- In-product onboarding
- QR-code and orientation materials
- Faculty/advisor enablement kit
- Student ambassador program
- Ambassador agreement and code of conduct
- Ambassador training
- Ambassador playbook
- Ambassador KPI dashboard
- Campus launch calendar
- Student feedback system
- Referral program, if appropriate
- Student support content
- In-app notification strategy
- Email/SMS policy and consent process
- Re-engagement campaigns
- Student success story template

Track:

- Invited users
- Activated users
- First meaningful action
- Weekly active users
- Workflow completion
- Retention
- Support volume
- Satisfaction
- Referral rate
- Department adoption
- Pilot success outcomes

7. Customer success and support

Create the full post-sale system before scaling sales.

Customer success artifacts

- Customer onboarding plan
- Implementation project plan
- Customer kickoff deck
- Admin setup guide
- Data/import/integration checklist
- Training curriculum
- Training deck
- Office hours plan
- Support center/knowledge base
- In-app help content
- Customer support SLAs
- Ticket categorization
- Escalation policy
- Incident communication templates
- Customer health score
- Adoption dashboard
- QBR template
- Renewal timeline
- Renewal playbook
- Expansion playbook
- Churn-risk playbook
- Customer advisory board charter
- NPS/CSAT program
- Customer feedback-to-roadmap process
- Case-study consent process

Your first pilot should have a written success plan before kickoff:

```
Baseline:
Current process, time, cost, friction, and existing usage

Target:
What “success” looks like by the end of the pilot
```

```
Metrics:
Activation, usage, completion, satisfaction, time saved, errors avoided,
student outcome proxy, staff efficiency, or other buyer-approved metrics

Cadence:
Weekly operating check-in and mid-pilot review

Decision:
Named executive owner, decision date, conversion criteria, next commercial step
```

8. Product operations

Your app repository is strong on audits and technical documentation; now connect product decisions to customer evidence.

Build:

- Product strategy and annual roadmap
- Quarterly OKRs
- Product intake process
- Feature request taxonomy
- Research repository
- Customer feedback tagging
- Opportunity-solution tree
- Prioritization framework
- PRD template
- Technical design document template
- Architecture decision record process
- Experiment template
- Analytics event taxonomy
- Release checklist
- Release notes workflow
- Beta program
- Feature flag governance
- Defect severity policy
- Incident-to-roadmap process
- Product health dashboard
- Data-quality checks
- AI feature evaluation/guardrail process if Semester uses AI

The most important product metrics:

- Time to value
- Activation rate
- First meaningful action
- Weekly/monthly active users
- Workflow completion
- Retention
- Customer health
- Support burden
- Feature adoption
- Pilot-success attainment
- Conversion to annual contract

9. Company operations

Create a lightweight operating cadence that turns all of the above into weekly execution.

Cadence

Cadence	Meeting/report	Purpose
Daily	Founder operating check	Highest-risk decisions, blockers, customer commitments
Weekly	Revenue meeting	Pipeline, deals, next steps, forecast
Weekly	Product/engineering review	Delivery, quality, incidents, customer feedback
Weekly	Customer-success review	Onboarding, health, support, pilot risk
Weekly	Growth review	Funnel, content, campaigns, activation
Monthly	Financial review	Cash, runway, spend, revenue, forecast variance
Monthly	Security/risk review	Vulnerabilities, vendors, incidents, evidence gaps
Monthly	Leadership review	KPIs, decisions, hiring, priorities
Quarterly	OKR and board review	Strategy, resourcing, roadmap, operating plan

Operations artifacts

- Company operating manual
- KPI tree
- Executive dashboard
- Weekly business review format
- Decision log
- Risk register
- RACI matrix

- Operating calendar
- Vendor register
- Procurement process
- Contract repository
- Policy repository
- Corporate records repository
- Budget approval process
- Expense policy
- Invoice and collections workflow
- Renewal calendar
- Data-room index
- Board reporting package
- Investor update template
- Insurance renewal tracker
- Compliance evidence register
- Business continuity plan

10. People and hiring

You may not need a large team now, but you need safe hiring foundations.

Create:

- Org design for the next 12–18 months
- Hiring plan tied to revenue/product milestones
- Role scorecards
- Job descriptions
- Contractor agreements and IP assignment
- Recruiting pipeline
- Interview plans and rubrics
- Reference-check process
- Compensation philosophy
- Equity policy
- Contractor/vendor classification process
- Employee handbook
- Onboarding plan
- Offboarding checklist

- Access-provisioning and deprovisioning process
- Performance-review framework
- Code of conduct
- Whistleblower/complaint escalation process where appropriate
- Security and privacy training

11. Partnerships and ecosystem

For Semester, partners can reduce the cost of trust and distribution.

Build:

- Integration roadmap:
  - SSO/identity
  - LMS
  - SIS/registrar
  - calendar/email
  - analytics
  - data warehouse
  - accessibility tooling
- Partner evaluation rubric
- Integration security review
- Partner agreement template
- Referral partner program
- Campus partner playbook
- Student-success consultant/advisor network
- Implementation partner model
- Channel partner strategy
- University consortium strategy
- Student organization partnership kit
- Ambassador/affiliate policy
- Marketplace listing plan, where applicable
- Integration documentation and developer portal, when ready

12. What to connect

This is the systems layer that prevents every department from operating in isolation.

Business need	Connect to	Purpose
Product users and permissions	Supabase Auth/RLS	Secure customer, institution, and student access
App data and auditability	Supabase/Postgres	Reliable records, tenant scope, event history
Product analytics	Analytics platform + warehouse	Activation, retention, funnel, adoption
CRM	HubSpot, Salesforce, or equivalent	Pipeline, accounts, contacts, forecasting
Website forms	CRM + calendar	Lead routing and meeting conversion
Customer support	Help desk + knowledge base	Ticket tracking and support SLAs
Customer success	CRM/CS platform	Health scores, onboarding, renewals
Billing	Stripe or accounting/invoicing system	Contracts, invoices, payment collection
Accounting	Bookkeeping platform	P&L, cash flow, taxes, reporting
Contract management	Contract repository/CLM	Signed agreements, renewals, obligations
Email	Transactional + lifecycle provider	Product, support, onboarding, sales emails
Status/monitoring	Error tracking + uptime/status platform	Reliability, incident response, transparency
Security	Secret manager, dependency scanning, audit logs	Risk reduction and procurement evidence
Social/content	Scheduling + analytics	Repeatable marketing operations
Data room	Structured Drive/Notion/secure repository	Investor, legal, security, and procurement evidence

Recommended 90-day company build order

Days 1–30: Become sellable

Build:

- One narrow institutional use case
- Clear positioning and ICP
- Website plus demo/pilot page
- Pricing and pilot offer
- CRM and 100-account target list
- Sales deck, demo script, discovery script, proposal
- Legal contract package
- Trust Center minimum viable version
- HECVAT Lite start

- Security overview and questionnaire library
- Financial model and 12-month budget
- Customer onboarding plan
- Product analytics baseline
- Weekly operating dashboard

Days 31–60: Become pilot-ready

Build:

- Pilot agreement and success plan
- Implementation plan
- Customer training materials
- Student adoption kit
- Ambassador pilot
- Support center and escalation process
- CRM lifecycle stages and forecasting
- Email nurture sequence
- First webinar/demo event
- First 25–50 buyer conversations
- First 3–5 pilot proposals
- Product feedback/research loop
- Security evidence pack
- Incident and rollback drills

Days 61–90: Become repeatable

Build:

- Signed pilot or tightly scoped design partner
- Measured pilot outcomes
- Case study or anonymized proof
- Renewal/conversion playbook
- Referral and partner motion
- Improved website from buyer feedback
- Content engine and SEO base
- Board/investor reporting rhythm
- Hiring plan based on actual bottlenecks
- Formalized OKRs and quarterly planning

- Launch/go-no-go review
- Scalable implementation and support playbook

Master business execution command

Paste this into Claude Code, Cursor, or another coding/operations agent **after it has access to your Semester repo and your chosen operating workspace:**

```
You are the Chief of Staff, COO, GTM lead, product operations lead, and security-prog

Semester is an education-technology SaaS company selling to institutions, departments

1. Institutional B2B sales and procurement motion
2. Student adoption and retention motion

Read the existing Semester repository, product documentation, operational documents,

Do not generate duplicate documents that already exist. First create a source-of-tru
- Existing artifact
- Location
- Current owner
- Status: current, stale, duplicate, incomplete, missing, or needs review
- Evidence
- Next action

Then build a unified company operating system across these functions:

A. Corporate, legal, and governance
B. Finance and pricing
C. Security, privacy, compliance, and trust
D. Institutional sales
E. Marketing and demand generation
F. Student adoption
G. Customer success and support
H. Product operations
I. Company operations and executive cadence
J. Partnerships and integrations
K. People and hiring
L. Analytics and data governance

For each function create:
- Objective
- Owner role
- 90-day outcomes
- Required recurring metrics
- Required operating cadence
- Required system of record
- Existing assets
- Missing assets
- Risks
- Dependencies
- P0, P1, P2 backlog
- Acceptance criteria
```

```
Prioritize the following launch-critical deliverables:

1. One clear institutional ICP and one narrow launch workflow
2. Positioning, messaging, website, demo, and pilot offer
3. Pricing, financial model, budget, runway, CAC, and payback model
4. CRM pipeline with 100 named target accounts
5. Sales deck, discovery script, demo script, proposal, pilot agreement, and mutual a
6. Trust Center, security overview, HECVAT Lite evidence plan, security questionnaire
7. Customer onboarding, implementation plan, training, support process, pilot success
8. Student activation kit, ambassador plan, onboarding, first meaningful action, rete
9. Analytics taxonomy and dashboards for revenue, pipeline, activation, retention, ac
10. Weekly business review, revenue review, product review, customer-success review,
11. Partnership and integration strategy
12. Hiring plan tied to actual revenue and product milestones

For every deliverable:
- Reuse and improve existing repository artifacts when possible.
- State whether it is internal, customer-facing, legal-review-required, security-revi
- Add an owner, due sequence, dependency, completion criteria, and review cycle.
- Do not treat AI-generated legal, tax, accounting, privacy, accessibility, or securi
- Do not publish unverified product, security, compliance, accessibility, outcome, or
- Do not build vanity marketing before the ICP, offer, proof, and conversion path are

Create these source-of-truth documents:
- docs/business/COMPANY_OPERATING_SYSTEM.md
- docs/business/90_DAY_COMPANY_BUILD_PLAN.md
- docs/business/GTM_SYSTEM.md
- docs/business/SALES_PLAYBOOK.md
- docs/business/MARKETING_SYSTEM.md
- docs/business/CUSTOMER_SUCCESS_PLAYBOOK.md
- docs/business/FINANCE_AND_PRICING.md
- docs/business/TRUST_AND_COMPLIANCE_ROADMAP.md
- docs/business/STUDENT_ADOPTION_SYSTEM.md
- docs/business/PARTNERSHIPS_AND_INTEGRATIONS.md
- docs/business/PEOPLE_AND_HIRING_PLAN.md
- docs/business/COMPANY_KPI_TREE.md
- docs/business/MASTER_BUSINESS_BACKLOG.md

Create implementation-ready templates where missing:
- ICP template
- Account plan
- Discovery call notes
- Demo script
- Pilot proposal
- Pilot success plan
- Mutual action plan
- Quote and pricing calculator
- Customer onboarding plan
- QBR template
- Security questionnaire response library
- Trust Center content inventory
- Risk register
- Weekly business review
- Investor update
- Board update
- Product feedback record
```

```
- Case-study consent and case-study template
- Student ambassador agreement/training/playbook
- Partner evaluation scorecard
- Vendor risk review
- Job scorecard and interview rubric

At the end, return:
1. Business-function inventory
2. Existing versus missing artifact map
3. P0 launch-critical list
4. 30/60/90-day execution calendar
5. Department ownership matrix
6. KPI tree
7. Required external systems to connect
8. Legal/security/finance items requiring professional review
9. Recommended next 10 actions, in order
10. Files created or updated
```

The single biggest next move

Do these three things first:

1. **Choose one institutional buyer and one workflow** to sell—not "all of higher education."
2. **Build the pilot package**: offer, pricing, deck, demo, security pack, agreement, implementation plan, success metrics, conversion date.
3. **Start 50–100 targeted institutional conversations** while simultaneously building student activation proof.

That sequence turns Semester from a large app and documentation base into a company that can establish trust, close a pilot, prove measurable value, and repeat the motion.

⁂

1. https://www.educause.edu/higher-education-community-vendor-assessment-toolkit
2. https://www.ren-isac.net/hecvat/index.html
3. https://nvlpubs.nist.gov/nistpubs/SpecialPublications/NIST.SP.1300.pdf
4. https://nvlpubs.nist.gov/nistpubs/CSWP/NIST.CSWP.29.pdf
5. https://www.ftc.gov/business-guidance/resources/protecting-personal-information-guide-business
6. https://go.wmich.edu/s/article/Higher-Education-Cloud-Vendor-Assessment-Tool-HECVAT
7. https://www.smith-howard.com/how-smbs-can-take-advantage-of-the-nist-cybersecurity-framework-2-0/
8. https://www.purchasing.utah.edu/glossary/hecvat-higher-education-community-vendor-assessment-toolkit/
9. https://www.saltycloud.com/blog/what-is-the-hecvat/
10. https://x.com/NISTcyber/status/1934586756772540924
11. https://www.onestepsecureit.com/blog/navigating-ftc-compliance-a-guide-for-business-owners
12. finance.semester_business_plan
13. projects.semester.gtm_strategy

14. projects.semester.operations_console
15. projects.semester.frontend_company_site
16. https://www.perplexity.ai/search/bde11398-d4d9-44e3-8c2f-f29cfcbf6c8e
17. https://www.perplexity.ai/search/4bbdba62-35e3-4c6e-a35d-1e96479a5e5b
18. https://www.perplexity.ai/search/c0c86bce-5574-48c3-8509-a418276299a8
19. https://www.ftc.gov/business-guidance/privacy-security
20. https://www.nist.gov/itl/smallbusinesscyber/nist-cybersecurity-framework-0
21. https://cloud.google.com/security/compliance/hecvat
22. https://www.zoom.com/en/trust/legal-compliance/hecvat/

now expand on how semester aims to be the chatgpt claude perplexity top hat bright space canvas SIS registar universy systems services google apple microsoft and central education OS and platform want to become like google and micofot for education expand in how to become that entire point and thiesis is that it replaces everything from its inception

Semester's thesis can be much bigger than "an AI study tool" or "a better university portal." The full ambition is to become the **central operating system for education**: the unified platform through which students live their educational journey and institutions run the systems, workflows, intelligence, services, and decisions that support it.

The strategic doctrine is:

> **Connect first. Replace by domain. Operate as one system.**

Semester can begin by interoperating with existing systems where institutions require continuity, then progressively become the system of record and operating layer for each domain as capability, trust, migration readiness, and institutional authorization mature. Education interoperability standards such as LTI, OneRoster, and Edu-API exist specifically to connect learning tools, roster/course data, and administrative/teaching systems in a more secure and standardized way.[1] [2] [3]

The complete Semester thesis

One platform, many roles

Semester is intended to be all of the following as **one coherent education platform**, not a loose bundle of apps:

Role	What Semester becomes
Student OS	The daily home for identity, schedule, planning, tasks, learning, decisions, progress, support, and opportunity
Productivity suite	Notes, tasks, calendar, planning, files, collaboration, messaging, focus, and workflow automation
Learning platform	Courses, content, assignments, feedback, study tools, assessment support, grade visibility, tutoring, and AI-guided learning

Role	What Semester becomes
Institutional OS	Tenant configuration, policy, identity, roles, workflows, academic operations, student services, analytics, compliance, and rollout controls
AI platform	Governed assistants, search, research, tutoring, planning, advising, agent workflows, evaluation, policy controls, and human oversight
Campus super-app	Housing, dining, events, organizations, student accounts, campus services, support, career, safety, and community
Academic record layer	Controlled records, registrar workflows, enrollment, registration, grades, progression, degree planning, transcripts/records integration or native operation
Marketplace/platform	Approved integrations, institutional services, learning resources, partners, career opportunities, and commerce where appropriate
Family/guardian platform	Student-consented, minimum-necessary, time-bounded views and support pathways
Institutional intelligence layer	Aggregate outcomes, demand signals, service bottlenecks, retention risk, capacity planning, and decision support
Company platform	Sales, pilots, customer success, billing, trust, compliance, support, release management, and business operations

The product should feel like **one education graph and one daily workspace:**

```
Identity
  ↓
Path
  ↓
Plan
  ↓
Courses
  ↓
Actions
  ↓
Support
  ↓
Progress
  ↓
Career
  ↓
Lifelong relationship
```

A student should not experience Semester as 20 portals. They should experience:

> "This is where I understand where I am, what matters next, what I can do, who can help, and how I move forward."

What Semester replaces

AI and intelligence layer

Semester aims to replace the fragmented educational use of ChatGPT, Claude, Perplexity, generic search, scattered tutoring tools, and unmanaged AI experiments—not necessarily by forbidding external models, but by making them operate through a unified governed education layer.

Fragmented tool pattern	Semester replacement
ChatGPT used without course context	Course-aware AI assistant with policy, source, and instructor boundaries
Claude used as isolated writing/reasoning workspace	Semester study, planning, drafting, research, and project workspace
Perplexity used for broad research	Source-aware research workflow with citations, approved sources, and institution policy
Separate AI tutor apps	Student-path-aware tutoring and study support
Separate advising chatbot	Explainable, policy-bounded student guidance with human handoff
Generic AI agents	Permissioned education agents with audit trails, approval gates, and data classification
Uncontrolled AI data sharing	Tenant-level provider policy, data minimization, retention rules, and spend controls
AI use without academic integrity context	Course-level AI rules, disclosure guidance, permitted-use boundaries, and educator controls

The AI architecture should be **model-flexible but Semester-governed**:

```
Student / Staff / Institution
        ↓
Semester AI Gateway
        ↓
Policy check
- Role and tenant permissions
- Data classification
- Course/institution AI rules
- Consent
- Budget and rate limit
- Approved source policy
- Integrity requirement
        ↓
Model and tool routing
- Internal capability
- Approved external model
- Search/research provider
- Institutional knowledge source
- Human escalation
        ↓
Evidence, citations, logs, and outcome
```

NIST's AI Risk Management Framework is relevant here because it is designed to help organizations incorporate trustworthiness into the design, development, deployment, use, and evaluation of AI systems. [4] [5]

Learning management and courseware

Semester ultimately aims to replace or absorb the role played by Canvas, Brightspace, Blackboard, Top Hat, courseware tools, separate study apps, disconnected assignment systems, and fragmented class communication.

```
Course Studio
├── Course home
├── Learning objectives
├── Instructor guidance
├── Course AI rules
├── Resources and approved sources
├── Assignments
├── Study packs
├── Notes and annotations
├── Discussions and collaboration
├── Attendance/participation, where authorized
├── Assessment workflows
├── Feedback
├── Gradebook
├── Regrade process
├── Integrity and provenance controls
├── Learning analytics
└── LTI / external-tool transition support
```

The native Course Studio must not merely mimic an LMS page. It should connect the course to the student's actual plan, schedule, workload, goals, support needs, career interests, and institutional policies.

SIS, ERP, registrar, and academic records

Semester's long-term goal is to replace fragmented SIS, registrar, academic planning, records, billing, degree audit, and student account workflows with one canonical operating layer.

```
Academic and registrar core
├── Identity and affiliation
├── Programs and pathways
├── Terms and calendars
├── Course catalog
├── Sections and schedules
├── Enrollment
├── Waitlists
├── Holds
├── Prerequisites
├── Overrides
├── Registration
├── Degree planning
├── Transfer evaluation
```

```
├── Articulation rules
├── Academic records
├── Grade ledger
├── Regrades
├── Graduation scenarios
├── Official handoffs and exports
└── Audit and compliance history
```

The migration path matters:

```
Phase 1: Connect
Existing SIS/ERP remains authoritative.
Semester reads approved, minimum-required data.

Phase 2: Co-pilot
Semester becomes the student and staff action layer.
Institution validates workflow outcomes and data quality.

Phase 3: Domain replacement
Semester natively operates selected domains:
- planning
- advising workflow
- registration readiness
- student action center
- course experience
- community
- support
- career
- communications

Phase 4: Core-system replacement
Semester becomes the authoritative system of record for approved domains,
with migrations, dual-run validation, audit, reconciliation, and rollback.

Phase 5: Education operating system
Semester becomes the primary system through which university operations,
learning, student life, administration, intelligence, and services run.
```

The correct end state is not “Semester always sits beside the SIS.” The end state is:

> Semester becomes the authoritative platform where the institution chooses it to be authoritative, while preserving data portability, official auditability, interoperability, and controlled transition paths.

Productivity and collaboration

Semester should replace the education-specific use of Google Workspace, Microsoft 365, Apple productivity workflows, Notion, task tools, calendar tools, note apps, group-chat tools, and scattered student productivity systems.

```
Semester Workspace
├── Personal dashboard
```

```
├── Academic calendar
├── Tasks and action center
├── Notes and knowledge capture
├── Documents and files
├── Planner
├── Projects
├── Group work
├── Messaging
├── Reminders
├── Study sessions
├── Focus tools
├── Research workspace
├── AI workspace
├── Portfolio
├── Career workspace
└── Cross-device sync
```

The difference is contextual integration:

```
Google/Microsoft/Apple-style productivity:
General tools → user adapts them to education.

Semester productivity:
Educational context → tools adapt to the student's academic reality.
```

A task is not merely "write paper." It can be connected to:

- A course
- A learning objective
- A due date
- An instructor's policy
- Study resources
- A support office
- A degree requirement
- A career competency
- A student's workload and wellbeing constraints

Search and knowledge

Semester should replace fragmented web search, campus search, course search, document search, policy search, support search, and institutional knowledge silos.

```
Semester Search
├── Personal workspace search
├── Course content search
├── Institution policy search
├── Student-service search
├── Campus-resource search
```

```
├── Career and opportunity search
├── Library/research search
├── Approved-source search
├── AI-assisted answer generation
├── Citation and provenance
├── Permission-aware results
└── Human handoff when confidence is insufficient
```

The search system must distinguish:

Source type	Semester behavior
Official institution record	Clearly labeled as official and source-authoritative
Instructor/course material	Scoped to course and term
Student-owned content	Private by default
Approved learning source	Labeled with owner/version
Public web/research	Cited, time-aware, policy-controlled
AI-generated guidance	Explained, attributable, and non-authoritative unless verified
Community content	Moderated and clearly distinguished from official guidance

Semester as Google and Microsoft for education

The comparison is useful if it is understood correctly.

Semester does **not** become "Google with a campus theme" or "Microsoft 365 for students." It becomes the infrastructure layer that combines what those companies do best—identity, productivity, search, collaboration, developer ecosystems, cloud operations, and AI—with education-specific authority, workflows, protections, and outcomes.

Platform model	What it provides	Semester equivalent
Google	Search, identity, workspace, cloud, AI, ecosystem	Education search, education identity, student workspace, institutional cloud/control plane, governed AI, education ecosystem
Microsoft	Productivity, identity, collaboration, enterprise admin, developer platform	Academic productivity, student/staff identity, course/community collaboration, institutional administration, education developer platform
Apple	Integrated hardware/software experience, privacy, premium UX	Calm integrated cross-device education experience, student agency, privacy-centered product design
ChatGPT/Claude/Perplexity	General-purpose reasoning, writing, research, conversation	Governed educational intelligence connected to courses, policies, sources, plans, and human support
Canvas/Brightspace/Blackboard/Top Hat	Course delivery and learning workflows	A connected course experience integrated into every other education workflow

Platform model	What it provides	Semester equivalent
SIS/ERP/Registrar systems	Institutional records and transactions	A unified education record, action, policy, and workflow engine
Student success point tools	Advising, nudges, alerts, retention	One coherent student-path and intervention system
Campus apps	Dining, housing, events, transit, organizations	Unified campus life and services layer
CRM/operations tooling	Sales, support, renewal, billing	Internal company command center for running Semester itself

The education graph

The deepest defensibility is not any one feature. It is the **education graph.**

```
Person
├── Identity
├── Institution
├── Program
├── Courses
├── Terms
├── Requirements
├── Skills
├── Tasks
├── Deadlines
├── Resources
├── Instructors
├── Advisors
├── Support offices
├── Communities
├── Financial obligations
├── Housing/dining/campus services
├── Career opportunities
├── Family/guardian permissions
├── AI interactions
├── Evidence/provenance
└── Outcomes
```

Every interaction strengthens the graph:

```
Student plans a course
→ plan updates workload
→ workload changes task suggestions
→ task connects to course objectives
→ course connects to study resources
→ missed task creates support signal
→ support signal creates explainable intervention option
→ intervention outcome informs institutional insight
→ student still controls private content and sharing boundaries
```

This is why Semester can become difficult to replace: it is not merely a collection of features. It becomes the connected operational memory of the educational journey.

Non-negotiable operating principles

To replace everything responsibly, Semester must be stronger than the systems it replaces in these areas:

1. Authority

```
Official records must have a defined authoritative source.
No AI output becomes an official record by accident.
No external source is silently treated as official.
Every high-impact institutional action is attributable and auditable.
```

2. Tenant isolation

```
Institution A cannot access Institution B.
One school's policy cannot accidentally apply to another.
Student data is scoped to student, tenant, role, grant, and purpose.
Cross-tenant analytics is aggregated, approved, and privacy-governed.
```

3. Student agency

```
Student-owned workspace data is private by default.
Family/advisor/support sharing is explicit, scoped, time-bounded, revocable,
and logged.
Students see what is shared, with whom, and why.
```

4. Interoperability

```
No lock-in through trapped data.
Import/export exists.
Institutional systems can integrate through governed APIs.
Migration paths are reversible until formal cutover.
Standards are adopted where practical:
- LTI
- OneRoster
- Edu-API
- SSO
- SCIM
- secure APIs
```

LTI is designed to connect learning tools securely with institutional learning environments, including user, enrollment, and role information. OneRoster supports secure exchange of users, courses, enrollments, learning resources, and grades across education systems. [2] [6] [1]

5. Explainability

```
Semester can explain:
- why a recommendation appears
- what data was used
- what source is authoritative
- what policy constrained the result
- what the user can change
- when human review is needed
```

6. Governance

```
Every major configuration has:
- owner
- policy
- approval path
- evidence
- effective date
- audit history
- rollback plan
```

7. Safety and resilience

```
Core education workflows must survive:
- vendor outage
- failed sync
- bad import
- release regression
- mistaken configuration
- compromised account
- privacy request
- data retention deadline
- institution offboarding
```

The product architecture

```
Semester Education OS
│
├── Experience Layer
│   ├── Student OS
│   ├── Faculty/Course Studio
│   ├── Advisor and Student Success Workspace
│   ├── Registrar/Academic Operations
│   ├── Campus Services
│   ├── Family/Guardian Portal
│   ├── Employer/Partner Portal
│   └── Semester Company Operations Console
│
├── Intelligence Layer
│   ├── AI Gateway
```

```
│   ├── Policy engine
│   ├── Search and knowledge graph
│   ├── Recommendation engine
│   ├── Workflow automation
│   ├── Analytics and outcomes
│   └── Evidence/provenance engine
│
├── Domain Layer
│   ├── Identity and roles
│   ├── Academic records
│   ├── Course and learning
│   ├── Registration
│   ├── Degree planning
│   ├── Student accounts
│   ├── Campus services
│   ├── Support
│   ├── Community
│   ├── Career
│   ├── Family/guardian
│   ├── Billing and commercial
│   └── Governance/compliance
│
├── Control Layer
│   ├── Tenant policy
│   ├── Approval system
│   ├── Audit trail
│   ├── Break-glass access
│   ├── Feature flags
│   ├── Rollout controls
│   ├── SLOs/incident response
│   ├── Privacy/retention
│   └── Trust/compliance evidence
│
└── Integration Layer
    ├── SIS/ERP
    ├── LMS
    ├── LTI tools
    ├── SSO/SCIM
    ├── Productivity suites
    ├── Library/research systems
    ├── Payment providers
    ├── Identity providers
    ├── Campus services
    ├── External AI providers
    └── Partner ecosystem
```

Product doctrine

Use this as the central internal statement:

> **Everything belongs in Semester—but nothing should feel bolted on.**

Every feature must answer:

1. Which role uses it?

2. Which domain owns the data?
3. What is the source of authority?
4. Which tenant policy governs it?
5. Which permissions are required?
6. What is the student/teacher/staff value?
7. How does it connect to the education graph?
8. How is it audited, supported, tested, and rolled back?
9. Does it replace, connect to, or hand off to an external system?
10. What is the migration path from external dependency to native Semester operation?

Migration model: connect, replace, operate

Phase 1: Connect

Semester connects to existing fragmented systems.

```
Existing tools:
SIS
LMS
Email
Calendar
Cloud storage
Library
Payment providers
Campus card
Housing
Dining
Career tools
External AI
```

Semester provides:

- One identity-aware workspace
- One action center
- One planning layer
- One search layer
- One student journey
- One support route
- One governed AI interface
- One institutional control plane

Phase 2: Replace visible workflows

Semester replaces the fragmented **experience** first:

- Student portal
- Planner
- Advising action center
- Registration readiness
- Course workspace
- Campus event/service navigation
- Support intake
- Community
- Career action center
- AI assistant
- Institutional workflow approvals

Phase 3: Replace operational domains

Semester becomes native system of record for selected domains:

- Productivity workspace
- Course Studio
- Student tasks/actions
- Student support workflows
- Institutional communications
- Community
- Campus services
- Career opportunity workflows
- Student success operations
- Tenant policy
- Commercial/customer lifecycle

Phase 4: Replace core institutional systems

Only when governance, migrations, auditability, legal review, operational readiness, and institutional approval exist:

- Registration
- Academic records
- Gradebook

- Student accounts
- Payment plans
- Degree progression
- Institutional analytics
- Core identity/provisioning
- Multi-campus governance
- Enterprise education operations

How to communicate this externally

Do not say:

> “Semester replaces Google, Microsoft, ChatGPT, Canvas, Brightspace, the SIS, the registrar, and every university system tomorrow.”

Say:

> “Semester is building the unified operating system for education: one connected platform for the student journey, learning, academic operations, campus services, institutional intelligence, and governed AI. It can connect to existing systems during transition and become the authoritative operating layer for domains institutions choose to modernize.”

For a pilot:

> “Semester begins with one measurable workflow—such as registration readiness—then proves student and institutional value before expanding across the education operating system.”

That protects the full thesis without making an unbuyable first sales claim.

Master product-thesis prompt

```
You are the Chief Product Officer, Chief Technology Officer, Chief Learning
Officer, Chief Information Security Officer, Chief Operating Officer, and
enterprise education architect for Semester.

Semester’s thesis is not to become another point solution, AI wrapper, LMS
plugin, or student planner.

Semester is building the unified operating system for education.

Its long-term mission is to become the central platform through which students,
institutions, faculty, staff, families, partners, and employers experience,
operate, govern, and improve education.

Semester must unify and progressively replace the fragmented functions now
spread across:
```

```
- ChatGPT
- Claude
- Perplexity
- generic AI assistants
- Google Workspace
- Microsoft 365
- Apple productivity workflows
- Canvas
- Brightspace
- Blackboard
- Top Hat
- courseware tools
- SIS
- ERP
- Registrar systems
- academic records
- degree audit
- registration systems
- student accounts
- payment plans
- advising tools
- student success tools
- tutoring tools
- campus apps
- housing
- dining
- events
- student organizations
- career platforms
- support portals
- CRM and operational tools
- family/guardian portals
- fragmented university service systems

The strategy is:

CONNECT FIRST.
REPLACE BY DOMAIN.
OPERATE AS ONE SYSTEM.

Do not narrow the long-term product thesis. The platform must be designed from
its inception as:

- Student OS
- Productivity suite
- Campus super-app
- Course and learning platform
- Institutional operating system
- AI and intelligence platform
- Academic/registrar platform
- Marketplace and partner ecosystem
- Family/guardian platform
- Career and lifelong learner platform
- SaaS company operating platform

However, do not implement it as disconnected feature modules. Build one coherent
```

```
education graph and one role-aware operating system.

For every domain, define:

1. User roles
2. Jobs to be done
3. System of record
4. Source authority
5. Tenant boundaries
6. Permission model
7. Data classification
8. AI policy
9. Integrations required during transition
10. Native replacement capability
11. Migration path
12. Audit requirements
13. Rollback path
14. Support model
15. Compliance requirements
16. Success metrics
17. Commercial model
18. Launch readiness criteria

Build or update:

docs/product/SEMESTER_UNIFIED_EDUCATION_OS_THESIS.md
docs/product/EDUCATION_GRAPH_ARCHITECTURE.md
docs/product/DOMAIN_REPLACEMENT_ROADMAP.md
docs/product/CONNECT_REPLACE_OPERATE_STRATEGY.md
docs/product/AI_GOVERNANCE_AND_MODEL_ROUTING.md
docs/product/LEARNING_AND_COURSE_STUDIO.md
docs/product/ACADEMIC_RECORDS_AND_REGISTRAR.md
docs/product/STUDENT_PRODUCTIVITY_AND_WORKSPACE.md
docs/product/CAMPUS_SERVICES_PLATFORM.md
docs/product/FAMILY_GUARDIAN_MODEL.md
docs/product/CAREER_AND_LIFELONG_LEARNING.md
docs/product/INSTITUTIONAL_CONTROL_PLANE.md
docs/product/INTEROPERABILITY_AND_MIGRATION_STRATEGY.md
docs/product/EDUCATION_OS_ROLE_MATRIX.md
docs/product/EDUCATION_OS_DATA_AUTHORITY_MATRIX.md
docs/product/EDUCATION_OS_RELEASE_GATES.md

For every replacement claim:
- distinguish current implementation, planned capability, integration, pilot,
  native system of record, and future roadmap
- do not imply a native capability exists if it does not
- do not make a compliance, security, accessibility, or institutional authority
  claim without evidence
- do not replace official records, grades, financial accounts, identity,
  registration, or legal processes without formal governance, migration,
  authorization, audit, rollback, and institutional approval

The final product must make users feel:
“This is not another portal. This is where my educational life works.”
```

The central one-sentence thesis

> **Semester is the unified, AI-native operating system for education: one trusted platform that connects and progressively replaces the fragmented tools, portals, learning systems, institutional records, campus services, productivity suites, AI assistants, and operational workflows that currently make education difficult to navigate and operate.**

⁂

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perplexity

expand on eveything you can possiably thing of to build run oprate mange update opprate Semmester SaaS whole point to be the google apple micosoft chat gpt claud perplexity quizlit brightspace canvas regisar sis market place social connection universty OS and Company of Education provide and rendr eveything needed for semester and further enhance expand and imporve Semester is the education operating system that replaces the fragmented infrastructure of learning, academic life, student support, campus services, institutional operations, productivity, and AI with one connected, governed, human-centered platform Build everything natively. Integrate responsibly. Replace only with proof. Operate every domain as one system.

Semester should be designed and operated as a **complete education infrastructure company**, not simply an app, LMS, AI feature, student portal, or SaaS dashboard. Its total scope is the connected operating system for learning, academic life, institutional administration, campus services, productivity, AI, data, trust, commerce, and lifelong outcomes.

The implementation doctrine remains:

> **Build every core capability natively. Integrate responsibly during transition. Replace each domain only with proof. Operate every domain as one coherent system.**

The prior architecture already establishes the main domains—student OS, learning/Course Studio, AI gateway, student success, registrar, finance, campus services, career, family/guardian, institutional control plane, and ecosystem. This response expands the missing company, platform, reliability, governance, research, operations, data, commercial, people, and developer layers required to make that thesis real. [1]

Semester’s complete operating model

The 12 systems Semester must become

```
1. Education Experience System
2. Learning and Assessment System
3. Academic Records and Registrar System
4. Student Success and Support System
5. Productivity, Knowledge, and Collaboration System
6. Governed AI and Intelligence System
7. Campus Life and Commerce System
8. Career, Credential, and Lifelong Learning System
9. Identity, Trust, Privacy, and Governance System
10. Institutional Operations and Intelligence System
11. Platform, Developer, and Partner Ecosystem
12. Semester Company Operating System
```

Every system must connect to the same:

```
Identity
→ Tenant
→ Role
→ Capability
→ Policy
→ Data classification
→ Consent
→ Source authority
→ Workflow
→ Audit
→ Evidence
→ Outcome
```

That shared foundation is what makes Semester an operating system rather than a bundle of products.

1. Education experience system

The education experience system is the interface layer for every major role.

Role	Primary Semester experience	Daily value
Student	Student OS	Understand current status, make decisions, complete actions, learn, get support
Faculty	Course Studio	Teach, publish guidance, manage learning, assess, communicate, govern AI use
Advisor	Student Success workspace	Understand student path, coordinate support, manage actions and referrals

Role	Primary Semester experience	Daily value
Registrar	Academic Operations	Manage terms, catalog, enrollment, holds, rules, records, and graduation workflows
Institution leader	Institutional intelligence	See aggregate outcomes, risk, adoption, service bottlenecks, and operational health
Family/guardian	Consent-based support portal	Receive only student-authorized, time-bounded information and support paths
Employer	Talent and opportunity portal	Discover verified talent evidence and connect to candidates appropriately
Partner	Integration/marketplace portal	Build governed integrations, extensions, resources, and services
Semester operator	Operations Command Center	Run tenants, pilots, support, security, billing, releases, compliance, and company operations

Experience requirements

Every role-specific surface needs:

- Clear primary job-to-be-done.
- Role-aware navigation.
- Correct tenant scope.
- Minimum necessary information.
- Source authority labels.
- Data freshness state.
- Accessibility support.
- Human escalation path.
- Auditability for sensitive actions.
- Mobile and desktop behavior.
- Clear distinction between:
  - official record
  - guidance
  - recommendation
  - student-owned content
  - institutional content
  - external source
  - AI-generated content
  - community-generated content

2. Learning and assessment system

Semester must become a full learning environment, not merely a course-content viewer.

```
Learning OS
├── Course Studio
├── Curriculum map
├── Learning objectives
├── Syllabus and policies
├── Course schedule
├── Assignments
├── Resources
├── Readings and annotations
├── Notes
├── Practice
├── Flashcards
├── Study packs
├── Peer learning
├── Tutoring
├── Discussions
├── Office hours
├── Assessment
├── Feedback
├── Gradebook
├── Regrade process
├── Academic integrity
├── Accessibility accommodations
├── Course AI rules
├── Learning evidence
├── Competency map
└── Course improvement analytics
```

Further capabilities to build

Learning design

- Course templates.
- Curriculum-to-course mapping.
- Program learning outcome mapping.
- Objective-to-assignment alignment.
- Objective-to-assessment alignment.
- Rubric builder.
- Competency framework.
- Mastery progression.
- Prerequisite knowledge maps.
- Adaptive study recommendations.
- Workload estimation.

- Assessment calendar load balancing.
- Course versioning by term.
- Course archive/export.
- Course accessibility review workflow.
- Course policy publication workflow.
- Content approval and licensing records.

Assessment and integrity

- Native assessments.
- Question banks.
- Rubrics.
- Blind grading where configured.
- Moderation workflow.
- Regrade requests.
- Grade release controls.
- Assessment accommodations.
- Assignment submission provenance.
- Academic-integrity guidance.
- Course-specific AI allowed/disallowed uses.
- Citation assistance.
- Draft disclosure tools.
- Plagiarism/integrity integration where approved.
- Human review queue.
- Appeal workflow.
- Immutable grade version history.
- Grade passback controls during transition.

Learning analytics

Do not reduce learning to engagement surveillance. Use explainable, purpose-limited signals:

```
Learning signals
├── Submitted work
├── Objective completion
├── Practice behavior
├── Study-plan progress
├── Optional self-checks
├── Instructor feedback cycles
├── Resource usefulness
```

```
├── Support requests
└── Student-reported confidence
```

Avoid hidden scoring of students based on unrelated behavioral data. Students and institutions should understand what signals exist, why they are used, and how they affect recommendations.

3. Academic records and registrar system

Semester must eventually operate a complete academic transaction system.

```
Academic Core
├── Institutions
├── Campuses
├── Schools
├── Departments
├── Programs
├── Credentials
├── Terms
├── Catalog
├── Courses
├── Sections
├── Meetings
├── Instructors
├── Rooms
├── Enrollment
├── Waitlists
├── Holds
├── Prerequisites
├── Overrides
├── Registration windows
├── Time tickets
├── Add/drop
├── Withdrawal
├── Grades
├── Academic record
├── Transfer credit
├── Articulation agreements
├── Degree audit
├── Graduation scenarios
├── Conferral
├── Transcript/export
└── Institutional reporting
```

Academic-system design requirements

Every academic operation requires:

Requirement	Why
Idempotency	Prevent duplicate registration, grade, payment, or record changes
Source authority	Identify whether Semester or an external system is official

Requirement	Why
Effective dates	Rules and records change over terms/time
Immutable history	Preserve grade, enrollment, and record changes
Two-person approvals	Required for high-risk corrections or system migration
Reconciliation	Compare old and new system outcomes
Capacity correctness	Prevent over-enrollment and waitlist corruption
Policy versioning	Academic rules must be traceable to version/effective date
Audit trail	Explain who changed what, when, and why
Rollback	Restore from failed migration/configuration
Exportability	Ensure institution/data portability
Privacy controls	Limit access to educational records

Native academic rules engine

Build a deterministic rules engine for:

```
Eligibility
Prerequisites
Co-requisites
Credit limits
Program requirements
Residency requirements
Transfer equivalencies
Academic standing
Holds
Time tickets
Waitlist promotion
Graduation requirements
Policy exceptions
```

AI can explain an academic rule, but it must not be the final rule engine.

```
Deterministic policy engine
→ computes official eligible/ineligible state

AI copilot
→ explains the decision in plain language
→ identifies next steps
→ links to official rule/policy
→ routes exceptions to humans
```

4. Student success and support system

Semester should make support proactive without becoming invasive.

```
Student Success OS
├── Action Center
├── Advising
├── Case management
├── Appointment scheduling
├── Check-ins
├── Success plans
├── Academic planning
├── Registration readiness
├── Referral workflows
├── Financial-support handoffs
├── Accessibility-service handoffs
├── Tutoring
├── Peer mentoring
├── Emergency/safety handoffs
├── Office action feeds
├── Support ticketing
├── Knowledge base
├── Communications
├── Outreach
├── Intervention review
├── Outcome tracking
└── Aggregate institutional insights
```

Support model

```
Student signal or request
  ↓
Student sees available self-service information
  ↓
Student can take action or request help
  ↓
Correct office/team receives structured request
  ↓
Owner accepts, routes, resolves, or escalates
  ↓
Student receives status and next steps
  ↓
Outcome is recorded without excessive sensitive detail
  ↓
Aggregate data improves service design
```

Support principles

- Student asks for help without navigating institutional org charts.
- Support requests retain context only when necessary.
- No broad administrator visibility into private student material.
- Referrals require policy and purpose.
- Sensitive support categories require stronger controls.
- Emergency/safety actions follow institution-specific official protocols.
- Students can see the status of their own requests.
- Support quality is measurable:
  - response time
  - resolution time
  - satisfaction
  - repeat issue rate
  - escalation rate
  - outcome completion

5. Productivity, knowledge, and collaboration system

Semester's productivity layer replaces generic tools through education context—not through superficial clones.

```
Semester Workspace
├── Personal knowledge base
├── Notes
├── Tasks
├── Calendar
├── Documents
├── Files
├── Projects
├── Groups
├── Shared workspaces
├── Study sessions
├── Focus timer
├── Research workspace
├── Writing workspace
├── Course notebooks
├── Meeting notes
├── Decision records
├── Version history
├── Search
├── Automations
├── Templates
└── Cross-device sync
```

Capabilities that make it education-native

Generic productivity tool	Semester-native upgrade
To-do item	Connected to course, deadline, learning objective, support office, academic requirement, and workload
Calendar event	Connected to course, term, assessment, registration window, appointment, campus event, and action
Note	Connected to course, reading, objective, assignment, AI citation, and study resource
File	Connected to ownership, course, privacy policy, retention, sharing, and academic integrity
Project	Connected to group roles, course rubric, milestones, feedback, and assessment requirements
Reminder	Connected to urgency, dependency, institutional deadline, and user preference
Search	Permission-aware across personal, course, institutional, and approved public sources
Collaboration	Course/group/workspace-specific with appropriate membership and visibility

6. AI and intelligence system

Semester must build a complete **Education Intelligence Platform**, not a generic chatbot panel.

```
Education Intelligence Platform
├── AI gateway
├── Model registry
├── Provider policy
├── Tenant policy
├── Course AI rules
├── Student preferences
├── Data classification engine
├── Consent engine
├── Prompt policy
├── Retrieval pipeline
├── Source authority engine
├── Citation/provenance
├── Agent workflow engine
├── Tool permissions
├── Cost and quota meter
├── Evaluation framework
├── Safety/red-team program
├── Human escalation
├── Override workflow
├── Incident response
├── AI audit log
└── AI transparency interface
```

AI roles to build

Role	Semester AI capability
Student	Copilot, planner, tutor, study assistant, research assistant, writing partner, path explainer
Faculty	Course-authoring assistant, rubric assistant, accessible-content assistant, policy-aware teaching assistant
Advisor	Student-context summarizer, action-plan assistant, support routing, meeting preparation
Registrar	Policy explanation and exception-routing assistant, never final academic authority
Student success	Aggregate trend explanation, workflow suggestions, human-reviewed outreach
Institutional admin	Policy assistant, configuration assistant, evidence/risk summarizer
Security/privacy	Data classification, policy review, AI usage audit
Semester operator	Support summarization, incident assistance, release/evidence search, internal workflow assistant

AI governance checklist

- [ ] Provider registry
- [ ] Model version registry
- [ ] Tenant-approved provider policy
- [ ] Course-level AI policy
- [ ] Academic-integrity boundary
- [ ] Data classification checks
- [ ] Sensitive-data exclusions
- [ ] Consent requirements
- [ ] Source restrictions
- [ ] Approved retrieval sources
- [ ] Citation/provenance requirement
- [ ] Human escalation triggers
- [ ] Spend quota/rate limit
- [ ] Evaluation datasets
- [ ] Bias/safety evaluation
- [ ] Prompt injection defenses
- [ ] Tool permission boundaries
- [ ] AI action audit
- [ ] User correction/feedback loop
- [ ] Incident response procedure
- [ ] Model fallback behavior
- [ ] Explainability UI

- [ ] Retention/deletion policy for AI interactions

7. Campus life and community system

```
Campus Life OS
├── Dining
├── Campus card
├── Housing
├── Room and study-space booking
├── Events
├── Organizations
├── Clubs
├── Volunteer work
├── Student government
├── Recreation
├── Transportation
├── Parking
├── Library
├── Bookstore
├── Campus jobs
├── Local business/off-campus services
├── Community discussions
├── Peer connections
├── Study groups
├── Safety handoffs
├── Wellness resources
└── Accessibility resources
```

Community system requirements

```
Community
├── Community creation
├── Membership
├── Roles
├── Posting
├── Moderation
├── Reports
├── Appeals
├── Alias/pseudonym policy
├── Events
├── Study sessions
├── Media
├── Content retention
├── Safety escalation
├── Volunteer moderation
├── Review calibration
└── Audit
```

The community layer must have:

- Code of conduct.
- Reporting and appeals.

- Human moderation.
- Escalation policy.
- Anti-harassment controls.
- Content retention/deletion rules.
- Strict policy around safety/urgent harm.
- No ungoverned direct messaging for sensitive institutional contexts unless safety and privacy controls are mature.

8. Campus commerce and financial system

Semester may become the student-facing commerce and account layer, but must respect financial controls and payment-provider boundaries.

```
Campus Commerce OS
├── Student account
├── Charges
├── Credits
├── Balances
├── Holds
├── Payment plans
├── Refund status
├── Payments handoff
├── Dining/campus card
├── Bookstore
├── Fees
├── Scholarships
├── Budget planner
├── Financial-aid handoffs
├── Emergency aid handoffs
├── Receipts
├── Reconciliation
├── Dunning/collections workflows
└── Audit ledger
```

Never store raw payment-card data unless you intentionally become a PCI-regulated payment processor—which is unnecessary for Semester. Use approved payment providers and store only required tokens/statuses/reconciliation records.

9. Career, credential, and lifelong learner system

```
Lifelong Education OS
├── Academic record
├── Skills graph
├── Learning evidence
├── Portfolio
├── Credentials
├── Badges
├── Verified achievements
├── Resume
```

```
├── Career planning
├── Opportunities
├── Internships
├── Employer network
├── Alumni mentoring
├── Continuing education
├── Microcredentials
├── Career outcomes
├── Learning pathways
├── Credential wallet
└── Data portability
```

Build toward portable credentials carefully:

```
Learning activity
→ evidence
→ verified skill claim
→ institution/faculty approval where required
→ credential/badge
→ student-controlled sharing
→ employer verification
```

Do not let self-reported claims masquerade as institution-verified credentials.

10. Institutional intelligence and analytics system

Semester must give institutions insight without becoming a student-surveillance platform.

```
Institutional Intelligence
├── Adoption analytics
├── Action completion
├── Service bottlenecks
├── Support trends
├── Registration readiness
├── Course workload signals
├── Capacity planning
├── Demand forecasting
├── Integration health
├── Feature adoption
├── Pilot outcomes
├── Retention proxies
├── Student success outcomes
├── Operational quality
├── Financial/commercial health
├── Security/compliance posture
└── Executive reporting
```

Analytics rules

- Use aggregates by default.
- Enforce minimum cohort size before displaying sensitive group statistics.
- Do not show protected/sensitive data unless policy allows.
- Make metric definitions visible.
- Show data freshness, coverage, and authority.
- Do not use opaque risk scores without explanation.
- Support institutional review/approval for high-impact intervention models.
- Allow audit of how a metric or recommendation was generated.
- Separate correlation from causation.
- Avoid automated punitive decisions.

11. Institutional governance, trust, and compliance system

```
Education Governance OS
├── Tenant hierarchy
├── Policy hierarchy
├── Stewardship assignments
├── Configuration studio
├── Workflow builder
├── Feature flags
├── Rollouts
├── Approvals
├── Two-person controls
├── Break-glass access
├── Audit events
├── Data classification
├── Consent
├── Retention
├── Legal holds
├── Data requests
├── Privacy
├── Security controls
├── Compliance framework mapping
├── Trust Center
├── HECVAT evidence
├── Accessibility evidence
├── Claims governance
├── Vendor governance
├── Incident management
├── Business continuity
├── Disaster recovery
└── Offboarding and portability
```

Trust Center system

```
Trust Center
├── Security overview
├── Privacy overview
├── Accessibility statement
├── Responsible AI
├── Data practices
├── Subprocessors
├── Availability and status
├── Incident communication
├── Compliance roadmap
├── HECVAT materials
├── DPA process
├── Security questionnaire request
├── Trust room
├── Vulnerability reporting
└── Customer document access
```

12. Platform ecosystem and marketplace

Semester becomes a platform when others can safely build on it.

```
Semester Developer Platform
├── API gateway
├── OAuth/OIDC
├── API keys
├── Service accounts
├── Webhooks
├── Event subscriptions
├── SDKs
├── Developer docs
├── Sandbox tenants
├── Test data
├── Integration certification
├── Marketplace
├── App review
├── Partner policies
├── Revenue share
├── Billing metering
├── Extension permissions
├── Tenant install controls
├── Versioning
├── Deprecation policy
└── Incident notifications
```

Marketplace categories

- Learning tools
- Accessibility tools
- Tutoring

- Career services
- Library/research services
- Campus services
- Advising services
- Financial wellness
- Scheduling
- Student organizations
- Institutional analytics
- AI models/providers
- Publisher/courseware
- Identity/integration tools
- Developer extensions

Every marketplace app must have:

```
Publisher identity
Security review
Privacy review
Data scopes
Tenant install approval
Permission request
Version history
Support owner
Pricing model
Incident contact
Offboarding/export process
```

13. Semester company operating system

Semester must run itself with the same quality it sells.

```
Semester Company OS
├── Corporate governance
├── Finance
├── Budget/runway
├── Pricing
├── Billing
├── Sales
├── GTM
├── Marketing
├── Customer success
├── Implementation
├── Support
├── Product operations
├── Engineering
├── Security
├── Compliance
```

```
├── Legal operations
├── Vendor management
├── Partnerships
├── People and hiring
├── Board/investor reporting
├── Risk management
├── Incident operations
├── Release operations
├── Data governance
├── AI governance
└── Operations Command Center
```

Internal company dashboards

```
Executive dashboard
├── Revenue
├── Pipeline
├── Pilots
├── Conversion
├── Product adoption
├── Customer health
├── Churn risk
├── Support
├── Reliability
├── Security
├── Compliance
├── Cash runway
├── Hiring capacity
└── Risks requiring decision
```

14. Required operating functions

Function	Must own
Product	Roadmap, requirements, outcomes, research, feature decisions
Engineering	Architecture, quality, performance, reliability, security implementation
Design	User research, interaction, accessibility, design system
Learning	Pedagogy, course design, learning evidence, assessment integrity
Academic operations	Registrar, records, policies, degree progression, institutional rules
Student success	Advising workflows, support, interventions, outcomes
Campus services	Service integrations, student experience, operational handoffs
AI governance	Model policy, evaluation, provider controls, safety, spend
Security	Access, vulnerabilities, incident response, evidence
Privacy/legal	Data policy, contracts, retention, requests, legal holds
GTM	ICP, messaging, funnel, pilots, pricing, pipeline

Function	Must own
Customer success	Onboarding, implementation, health, renewal, expansion
Finance	Pricing, budget, collections, runway, reporting
Partnerships	Integrations, marketplace, channels, ecosystem
People	Hiring, culture, access lifecycle, training
Operations	Cadence, risks, decisions, execution, reporting

15. Full operating cadence

Cadence	Review	Core questions
Daily	Operations triage	What is broken, blocked, urgent, or customer-impacting?
Weekly	Product/engineering	What shipped, failed, learned, and needs decision?
Weekly	Revenue/pilot	What accounts moved, what is blocked, what closes next?
Weekly	Customer success	Which pilots/customers are at risk or ready to expand?
Weekly	Security/reliability	What changed, what is vulnerable, what is consuming error budget?
Monthly	Finance	What is runway, spend, margin, collections, and forecast variance?
Monthly	Trust/compliance	What evidence, policy, vendor, or review is due?
Monthly	Leadership	What are the highest-leverage decisions and risks?
Quarterly	Strategy/OKR	What to stop, continue, fund, hire, replace, or scale?
Quarterly	Board/investor	What is true about traction, risks, capital, and strategic choices?

16. Full release and replacement gate

No feature, domain, migration, or institutional capability is complete until it has:

```
1. Product requirement
2. Design specification
3. Accessibility review
4. Data classification
5. Permission model
6. Tenant isolation
7. Source authority
8. Audit model
9. Security threat model
10. Privacy/retention plan
11. AI policy, if AI is involved
12. Integration plan
13. Migration plan
14. Rollback plan
15. Support playbook
16. Monitoring/SLO
17. Test suite
18. Documentation
```

```
19. Release evidence
20. Owner and review date
```

Ultimate Semester command

Use this as the broadest possible execution prompt. It expands the previous architecture and instructs an agent to build, audit, prioritize, and operationalize the full company/platform.

```
You are the complete executive, technical, product, learning, operations,
security, governance, commercial, and platform leadership team for Semester.

Repository:
https://github.com/harrisonjrubin7-cmyk/semester

Semester is not a point solution.

Semester is the unified, AI-native operating system for education.

Its mission is to replace the fragmented infrastructure of:

- learning
- courses
- LMS
- SIS/ERP
- registrar
- academic records
- registration
- degree audit
- advising
- student success
- support
- productivity
- calendar
- tasks
- notes
- files
- collaboration
- search
- AI assistants
- research
- assessment
- gradebook
- student accounts
- payment plans
- financial workflows
- campus services
- housing
- dining
- events
- organizations
- community
- safety handoffs
- accessibility services
- career systems
```

```
- alumni
- employer networks
- family/guardian systems
- marketplace partners
- developer ecosystem
- institutional governance
- trust/compliance
- company operations

Semester must become:

- Student OS
- Productivity suite
- Learning OS
- Course Studio
- AI intelligence platform
- Registrar and academic OS
- Student success OS
- Campus super-app
- Financial/account OS
- Career and lifelong-learning OS
- Family/guardian consent platform
- Institutional operating system
- Developer platform
- Marketplace
- Company operating system

The core doctrine is:

BUILD EVERYTHING NATIVELY.
INTEGRATE RESPONSIBLY.
REPLACE ONLY WITH PROOF.
OPERATE EVERY DOMAIN AS ONE SYSTEM.

Do not narrow the thesis.

However, do not make false claims that a native replacement exists before it is
implemented, tested, accessible, secure, governed, migrated, approved, and
supportable.

Do not replace official institutional records, identity, registration, grades,
financial accounts, legal processes, or high-stakes decisions without formal
institutional authority, migration, reconciliation, audit, rollback, and
operational readiness.

============================================================
YOUR FIRST TASK: CREATE THE MASTER OPERATING MAP
============================================================

Audit the complete current Semester repository, database, migrations,
documentation, code, feature inventory, marketing, security, operations, GTM,
customer success, integrations, and deployment system.

Create:

docs/master/SEMESTER_COMPLETE_OPERATING_SYSTEM.md
```

```
docs/master/SEMESTER_PRODUCT_UNIVERSE.md
docs/master/SEMESTER_DOMAIN_CATALOG.md
docs/master/SEMESTER_ROLE_CATALOG.md
docs/master/SEMESTER_CAPABILITY_MATRIX.md
docs/master/SEMESTER_DATA_AUTHORITY_MATRIX.md
docs/master/SEMESTER_INTEROPERABILITY_MATRIX.md
docs/master/SEMESTER_DOMAIN_REPLACEMENT_GATES.md
docs/master/SEMESTER_MIGRATION_FACTORY.md
docs/master/SEMESTER_TRUST_AND_GOVERNANCE_MODEL.md
docs/master/SEMESTER_COMPANY_OPERATING_SYSTEM.md
docs/master/SEMESTER_PLATFORM_ECOSYSTEM.md
docs/master/SEMESTER_OUTCOME_MEASUREMENT.md
docs/master/SEMESTER_RISK_REGISTER.md
docs/master/SEMESTER_12_MONTH_EXECUTION_PLAN.md
docs/master/SEMESTER_MASTER_BACKLOG.md

For every current and planned capability, classify:

- Native and verified
- Native but incomplete
- Integrated
- Transitional
- Pilot-only
- Designed/documented
- Planned
- Not started
- Requires security review
- Requires privacy/legal review
- Requires accessibility review
- Requires institutional approval
- Requires migration
- Requires reconciliation
- Requires rollback
- Unsafe to activate
- Ready for pilot
- Ready for production
- Ready to become authoritative system of record

============================================================
PRODUCT DOMAINS TO MAP, DESIGN, AND BUILD
============================================================

1. Student OS
2. Workspace/productivity
3. Path and degree planning
4. Course Studio/LMS
5. Learning evidence and assessment
6. AI gateway and copilot
7. Search and knowledge graph
8. Faculty experience
9. Advisor/student success
10. Registrar and academic operations
11. Academic records and grade ledger
12. Registration and enrollment
13. Student finance/account/payment plans
14. Financial aid and scholarship handoffs
```

15. Campus life/services
16. Housing
17. Dining
18. Events
19. Community and organizations
20. Accessibility services
21. Safety and emergency handoffs
22. Library/research
23. Career/employer/alumni
24. Family/guardian grants
25. Institutional governance
26. Identity/SSO/SCIM
27. Integrations/LTI/OneRoster/Edu-API
28. Privacy/retention/legal holds
29. Security/audit/incident response
30. Trust/compliance/HECVAT
31. Operations Command Center
32. Commercial/billing/customer success
33. Marketing/sales/company site
34. Developer platform
35. Marketplace/partners
36. Data/analytics/outcomes
37. Reliability/SLO/release operations
38. People/hiring/company operations
39. Finance/runway/board reporting
40. Globalization/localization/accessibility expansion

For every domain define:

- Vision
- Primary users
- User jobs to be done
- Current source of truth
- Native Semester source of truth
- Integration strategy
- Data model
- Tenant scope
- Role/capability model
- Data classification
- Consent model
- AI model/policy
- Accessibility requirements
- Security requirements
- Audit requirements
- Privacy/retention requirements
- Migration plan
- Reconciliation plan
- Dual-run plan
- Cutover criteria
- Rollback plan
- Support model
- Incident model
- SLO/reliability requirements
- Commercial model
- Customer success model
- Outcome metrics

- Required documentation
- Release gates
- Replacement authority gates
- Team owner
- Dependencies
- Risks
- Priority
- Implementation branch
- Tests

==
IMPLEMENTATION PROGRAM
==

PHASE 0:
Establish current truth. No unsupported claims. No production-impacting changes.

PHASE 1:
Identity, tenancy, capability, RLS, audit, data classification, consent, retention, integrations, rollout controls, observability, support baseline.

PHASE 2:
Student OS:
Home, Today, Action Center, Path, Plan, Calendar, Tasks, Notes, Search, Workspace, Copilot, Support, Career.

PHASE 3:
Learning OS:
Course Studio, resources, study packs, objectives, assessments, feedback, gradebook, integrity, course AI policy, learning evidence.

PHASE 4:
Student Success:
Advising, check-ins, referrals, success plans, support, institutional actions, outcome analytics.

PHASE 5:
Academic Core:
Catalog, terms, sections, enrollment, registration, holds, prerequisites, overrides, records, grade ledger, degree planning, transfer, graduation.

PHASE 6:
Campus Services:
Dining, housing, events, community, organizations, spaces, accessibility, campus employment, support, safe handoffs.

PHASE 7:
Career/Lifelong:
Skills graph, portfolio, credential wallet, employer network, mentoring, opportunities, alumni and continuing education.

PHASE 8:
Institutional OS:
Configuration, policy, workflow builder, integrations, trust, compliance, privacy, security, rollout, offboarding.

```
PHASE 9:
Company OS:
GTM, pilots, billing, customer success, support, renewals, finance,
operations, people, partnerships, board reporting.

PHASE 10:
Platform Ecosystem:
APIs, webhooks, OAuth/OIDC, developer portal, SDKs, sandbox tenants,
marketplace, partner certification, extension framework.

============================================================
NON-NEGOTIABLE CONTROLS
============================================================

Every feature/domain requires:

- Source authority
- Tenant isolation
- Role/capability check
- Data classification
- Consent where appropriate
- Accessibility requirement
- Security threat model
- Privacy/retention plan
- Audit event
- Support route
- Monitoring/SLO
- Test coverage
- Migration/rollback plan where relevant
- Documentation
- Owner
- Review date
- Release evidence

AI must be:

- Policy-bound
- Course-aware
- Tenant-aware
- Permission-aware
- Source-aware
- Citation/provenance-aware
- Cost-aware
- Integrity-aware
- Human-escalation-capable
- Audited
- Evaluated
- Never silently authoritative for official institutional decisions

============================================================
FINAL REQUIRED OUTPUT
============================================================

Return:

1. Complete architecture map
```

```
2. Complete domain catalog
3. Capability matrix
4. Role matrix
5. Data authority matrix
6. Integration and migration factory
7. Domain replacement gates
8. Security/privacy/accessibility/control model
9. Company operating system
10. Platform ecosystem plan
11. Outcomes and moat plan
12. 12-month roadmap
13. P0/P1/P2/P3 backlog
14. Required team/ownership model
15. Required external systems
16. Test strategy
17. Release strategy
18. Budget/capacity model
19. Risk register
20. Exact next 25 actions in order

Do not stop at a vision document. Produce implementation-ready artifacts,
schemas, APIs, screens, tests, migrations, workflows, operating procedures,
and traceability records.
```

Final test

Every time you consider adding a module, ask:

```
Does this make Semester more like one coherent education operating system,
or does it create another disconnected app inside Semester?
```

If it creates a disconnected app, it must be redesigned until it connects to the shared identity, path, action, policy, evidence, trust, and operations layers.

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1. expand-evan-further-provide-prompt-and-comand-to-e.pdf